

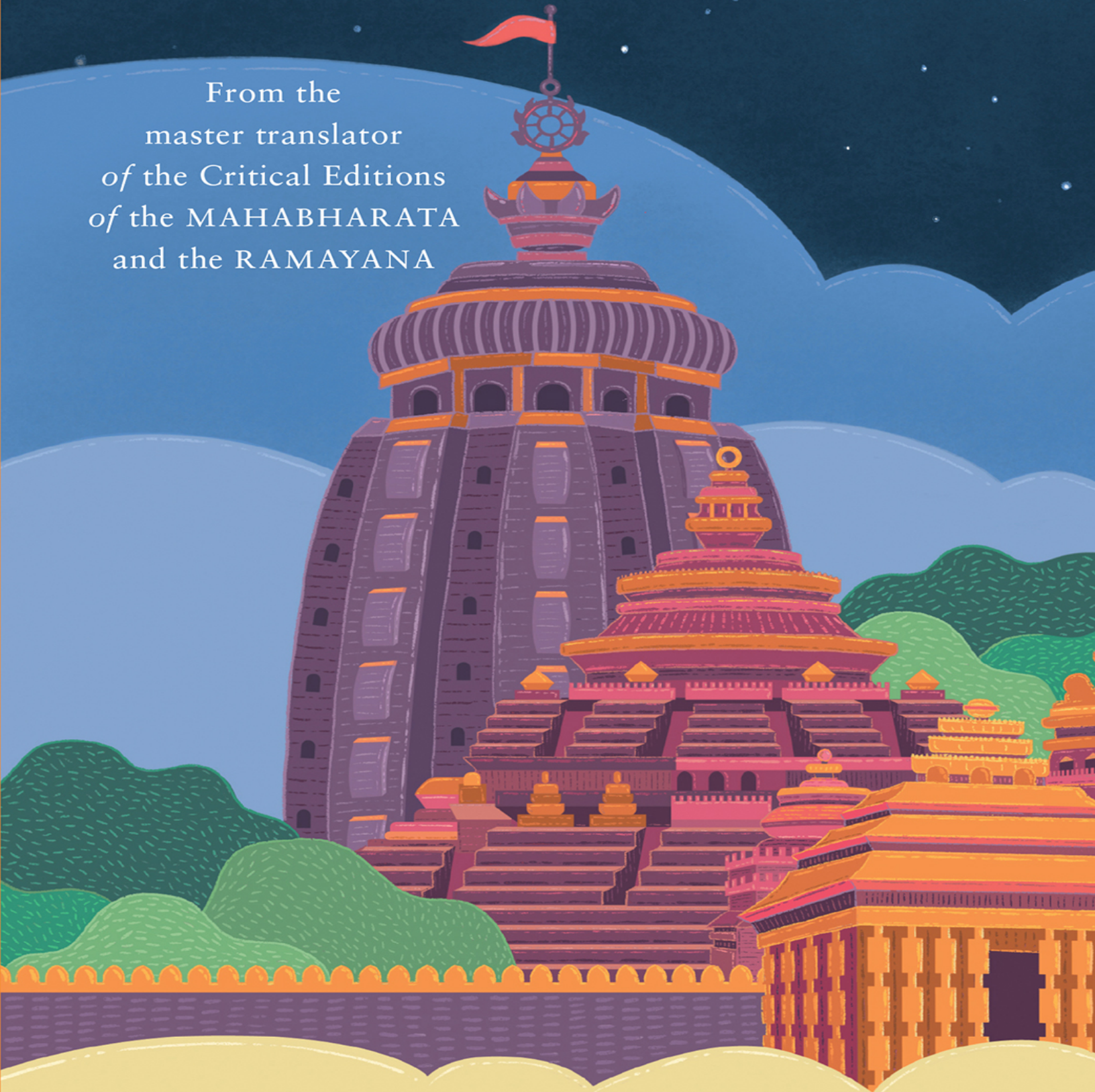
Translated *by* Bibek Debroy



THE BRAHMA PURANA

Volume 1

From the
master translator
of the Critical Editions
of the MAHABHARATA
and the RAMAYANA





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Bibek Debroy

THE BRAHMA PURANA
Volume 1



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Bibek Debroy is a renowned economist, scholar and translator. He has worked in universities, research institutes, the industry and for the government. He has widely published books, papers and articles on economics. As a translator, he is best known for his magnificent rendition of the Mahabharata in ten volumes, the three-volume translation of the Valmiki Ramayana and additionally the *Harivamsha*, published to wide acclaim by Penguin Classics. He is also the author of *Sarama and Her Children*, which splices his interest in Hinduism with his love for dogs.

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For Shaifalika Panda and Subhrakant Panda

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Introduction

The word Purana means old, ancient. The Puranas are old texts, usually referred to in conjunction with *Itihasa* (the Ramayana and the Mahabharata). ¹ Whether *Itihasa* originally meant only the Mahabharata, with the Ramayana being added to that expression later, is a proposition on which there has been some discussion. But that's not relevant for our purposes. In the Chandogya Upanishad, there is an instance of the sage Narada approaching the sage Sanatkumara for instruction. Asked about what he already knows, Narada says he knows *Itihasa* and Purana, the Fifth Veda. ² In other words, *Itihasa*–Purana possessed an elevated status. This by no means implies that the word Purana, as used in these two Upanishads and other texts too, is to be understood in the sense of the word being applied to a set of texts known as the Puranas today. The Valmiki Ramayana is believed to have been composed by Valmiki and the Mahabharata by Krishna Dvaipayana Vedavyasa. After composing the Mahabharata, Krishna Dvaipayana Vedavyasa is believed to have composed the Puranas. The use of the word composed immediately indicates that *Itihasa*–Purana are 'smriti' texts, with a human origin. They are not 'shruti' texts, with a divine origin. Composition does not mean these texts were rendered into writing. Instead, there was a process of oral transmission, with inevitable noise in the transmission and distribution process. Writing came much later.

Pargiter's book on the Puranas is still one of the best introductions to this corpus. ³ To explain the composition and transmission process, one can do no better than to quote him. 'The Vayu and Padma Puranas tell us how ancient genealogies, tales and ballads were preserved, namely, by the *sutas*, ⁴ and they describe the *suta*'s duty . . . The Vayu, Brahmanda and Visnu give an account on how the original Purana came into existence. Those three Puranas say: Krishna Dvaipayana divided the single Veda into four and

arranged them, and so was called Vyasa. He entrusted them to his four disciples, one to each, namely Paila, Vaisampayana, Jaimini and Sumantu. Then with tales, anecdotes, songs and lore that had come down from the ages, he compiled a Purana, and taught it and the *Itihasa* to his fifth disciple, the suta Romaharsana or Lomaharsana . . . After that he composed the Mahabharata. The epic itself implies that the Purana preceded it . . . As explained above, the *sutas* had from remote times preserved the genealogies of gods, rishis and kings, and traditions and ballads about celebrated men, that is, exactly the material—tales, songs and ancient lore—out of which the Purana was constructed. Whether or not Vyasa composed the original Purana or superintended its compilation, is immaterial for the present purpose. After the original Purana was composed, by Vyasa as is said, his disciple Romaharsana taught it to his son Ugrasravas, and Ugrasravas the *sauti* appears as the reciter in some of the present Puranas; and the *sutas* still retained the right to recite it for their livelihood. But, as stated above, Romaharsana taught it to his six disciples, at least five of whom were brahmans. It, thus, passed into the hands of the brahmans, and their appropriation and development of it increased in the course of time, as the Purana grew into many Puranas, as Sanskrit learning became peculiarly the province of the brahmans, and as new and frankly sectarian Puranas were composed.’ Pargiter cited reasons for his belief that the Mahabharata was composed after the original Purana, though that runs contrary to the popular perception about the Mahabharata having been composed before the Puranas. That popular and linear perception is too simplistic, since texts evolved in parallel, not necessarily sequentially.

In popular perception, Krishna Dvaipayana Vedavyasa composed the Mahabharata. He then composed the Puranas. Alternatively, he composed an original core Purana text, which has been lost, and others embellished it through additions. The adjective ‘Purana’, meaning old account or old text, became a proper noun, signifying a specific text. To be classified as a Purana, it has to possess five attributes—*pancha lakshmana*. That is, five topics must be discussed—*sarga*, *pratisarga*, *vamsha*, *manvantara* and *vamshanucharita*. The clearest statement of this is in the Matsya Purana.

Unlike the Ramayana and the Mahabharata, there is no Critical Edition of the Puranas.⁵ Therefore, citing chapter and verse from a Purana text is somewhat more difficult, since verse, if not chapter, may vary from text to text. With that caveat, the relevant *shloka* (verse) should be in the fifty-third chapter of the Matsya Purana. *Sarga* means the original or primary creation. The converse of *sarga* is universal destruction, or *pralaya*. That period of *sarga* lasts for one of Brahma's days, known as *kalpa*. When Brahma sleeps, during his night, there is universal destruction.

In measuring time, there is the notion of a *yuga* (era) and there are four *yugas*—*satya yuga* (also known as *krita yuga*), *treta yuga*, *dvapara yuga* and *kali yuga*. *Satya yuga* lasts for 4,000 years, *treta yuga* for 3,000 years, *dvapara yuga* for 2,000 years and *kali yuga* for 1,000 years. However, all these are not human years. The gods have a different timescale and these are the years of the gods. As one progressively moves from *satya yuga* to *kali yuga*, virtue (*dharma*) declines. But at the end of *kali yuga*, the cycle begins afresh, with *satya yuga*. An entire cycle, from *satya yuga* to *kali yuga*, is known as a *mahayuga* (great era). However, a *mahayuga* is not just 10,000 years. There is further complication. At the beginning and the end of every *yuga*, there are some additional years. These additional years are 400 for *satya yuga*, 300 for *treta yuga*, 200 for *dvapara yuga* and 100 for *kali yuga*. A *mahayuga*, thus, has 12,000 years, adding years both at the beginning and at the end. One thousand *mahayugas* make up one *kalpa* (eon), a single day for Brahma. A *kalpa* is also divided into fourteen *manvantaras*, a *manvantara* being a period during which a Manu presides and rules over creation. Therefore, there are 71.4 *mahayugas* in a *manvantara*. Our present *kalpa* is known as the Shveta Varaha Kalpa. Within that, six Manus have come and gone. Their names are (1) Svyambhuva Manu, (2) Svarochisha Manu, (3) Uttama Manu, (4) Tapasa Manu, (5) Raivata Manu and (6) Chakshusha Manu. The present Manu is known as Vaivasvata Manu. Vivasvat, also written as Vivasvan, is the name of Surya, the sun-god. Vaivasvata Manu has that name because he is Surya's son. Not only do Manus change from one *manvantara* to another. So do the gods, the ruler of the gods and the seven great sages, known as the

saptarshis (seven rishis). Indra is a title of the ruler of the gods. It is not a proper name. The present Indra is Purandara. However, in a different *manvantara*, someone else will hold the title. In the present seventh *manvantara*, known as *Vaivasvata manvantara*, there will also be 71.4 *mahayugas*. We are in the twenty-eighth of these. Since a different Vedavyasa performs that task of classifying and collating the Vedas in every *mahayuga*, Krishna Dvaipayana Vedavyasa is the twenty-eighth in that series. Just so that it is clear, Vedavyasa isn't a proper name. It is a title conferred on someone who collates and classifies the Vedas. There have been twenty-seven who have held the title of Vedavyasa before him and he is the twenty-eighth. His proper name is Krishna Dvaipayana, Krishna because he was dark and Dvaipayana because he was born on an island (*dvipa*). This gives us an idea of what the topic of *manvantara* is about. This still leaves *pratisarga*, *vamsha* and *vamshanucharita*. The two famous dynasties/lineages were the solar dynasty (*survya vamsha*) and lunar dynasty (*chandra vamsha*) and all the famous kings belonged to one or the other of these two dynasties. *Vamshanucharita* is about these lineages and the conduct of these kings. There were the gods and sages (*rishis*) too, not always born through a process of physical procreation. Their lineages are described under the heading of *vamsha*. Finally, within that cycle of primary creation and destruction, there are smaller and secondary cycles of creation and destruction. That's the domain of *pratisarga*. In greater or lesser degree, all the Puranas cover these five topics, some more than the others. The Purana which strictly adheres to this five-topic classification is the Vishnu Purana.

There are Puranas and Puranas. Some are known as Sthala Puranas, describing the greatness and sanctity of a specific geographical place. Some are known as Upa-Puranas, minor Puranas. The listing of Upa-Puranas has regional variations and there is no country-wide consensus about the list of Upa-Puranas, though it is often accepted there are eighteen. The Puranas we have in mind are known as Maha-Puranas, major Puranas. Henceforth, when we use the word Puranas, we mean Maha-Puranas. There is consensus that there are eighteen Maha-Puranas, though it is not obvious that this

number of eighteen existed right from the beginning. The names are mentioned in several of these texts, including a *shloka* that follows the *shloka* cited from the Matsya Purana. Thus, the eighteen Puranas are (1) Agni (15,400); (2) Bhagavata (18,000); (3) Brahma (10,000); (4) Brahmanda (12,000); (5) Brahmavaivarta (18,000); (6) Garuda (19,000); (7) Kurma (17,000); (8) Linga (11,000); (9) Markandeya (9,000); (10) Matsya (14,000); (11) Narada (25,000); (12) Padma (55,000); (13) Shiva (24,000); (14) Skanda (81,100); (15) Vamana (10,000); (16) Varaha (24,000); (17) Vayu (24,000); and (18) Vishnu (23,000). A few additional points about this list. First, the Harivamsha is sometimes loosely described as a Purana, but strictly speaking, it is not a Purana. It is more like an addendum to the Mahabharata. Second, Bhavishya (14,500) is sometimes mentioned, with Vayu excised from the list. However, the Vayu Purana exhibits many more Purana characteristics than the Bhavishya Purana does. There are references to a Bhavishya Purana that existed, but that may not necessarily be the Bhavishya Purana as we know it today. That's true of some other Puranas too. Texts have been completely restructured hundreds of years later. Third, it is not just a question of Bhavishya Purana and Vayu Purana. In the lists given in some Puranas, Vayu is part of the eighteen, but Agni is knocked out. In some others, Narasimha and Vayu are included, but Brahmanda and Garuda are knocked out. Fourth, when a list is given, the order also indicates some notion of priority or importance. Since that varies from text to text, our listing is simply alphabetical, according to the English alphabet. The text of the Brahma Purana has no such listing of Puranas. But in the last chapter of Part I, Chapter 1(138), which praises the Purana, it describes itself as the first Purana, Adi Purana. Indeed, the Brahma Purana is described as Adi Purana in several other Purana texts too, underlining its importance.

The numbers within brackets indicate the number of *shlokas* each of these Puranas has, or is believed to have. The range is from 9,000 in Markandeya to a mammoth 81,100 in Skanda. The aggregate is a colossal 409,500 *shlokas*. To convey a rough idea of the orders of magnitude, the Mahabharata has, or is believed to have, 100,000 *shlokas*. It's a bit difficult

to convert a *shloka* into word counts in English, especially because Sanskrit words have a slightly different structure. However, as a very crude approximation, one *shloka* is roughly twenty words. Thus, 100,000 *shlokas* become 2 million words and 400,000 *shlokas*, four times the size of the Mahabharata, amounts to 8 million words. There is a reason for using the expression ‘is believed to have’, as opposed to ‘has’. Rendering into writing is of later vintage, the initial process was one of oral transmission. In the process, many texts have been lost, or are retained in imperfect condition. This is true of texts in general and is also specifically true of *Itihasa* and Puranas. The Critical Edition of the Mahabharata, mentioned earlier, no longer possesses 100,000 *shlokas*. Including the Harivamsha, there are around 80,000 *shlokas*. The Critical Edition of the Mahabharata has of course deliberately excised some *shlokas*. For the Puranas, there is no counterpart of Critical Editions. However, whichever edition of the Puranas one chooses, the number of *shlokas* in that specific Purana will be smaller than the numbers given above. Either those many *shlokas* did not originally exist, or they have been lost. This is the right place to mention that a reading of the Puranas assumes a basic degree of familiarity with the Valmiki Ramayana and the Mahabharata, more the latter than the former. Without that familiarity, one will often fail to appreciate the context completely. More than passing familiarity with the Bhagavad Gita, strictly speaking a part of the Mahabharata, helps. ⁶

Other than the five attributes, the Puranas have a considerable amount of information on geography and even geological changes (changes in courses of river) and astronomy. Therefore, those five attributes shouldn’t suggest the Puranas have nothing more. They do, and they have, therefore, been described as encyclopedias. Bharatavarsha is vast and heterogeneous and each Purana may very well have originated in one particular part of the country. Accordingly, within that broad compass of an overall geographical description, the extent of geographical information varies from Purana to Purana. Some are more familiar with one part of the country than with another. For example, for the Brahma Purana, Part I has extensive descriptions of the Utkala region, while Part II has the same for the region

of Dandakaranya, through which the Godavari flows. Though not explicitly mentioned in the five attributes, the Puranas are also about pursuing *dharma*, *artha*, *kama* and *moksha*, the four objectives of human existence, and about the four *varnas* and the four *ashramas*. The general understanding and practice of *dharma* is based much more on the Puranas than on the *Vedas*. Culture, notions of law, rituals, architecture and iconography are based on the Puranas. There is beautiful poetry too.

Perhaps one should mention that there are two ways these eighteen Puranas are classified. The trinity has Brahma as the creator, Vishnu as the preserver and Shiva as the destroyer. Therefore, Puranas where creation themes feature prominently are identified with Brahma (Brahma, Brahmanda, Brahmavaivarta, Markandeya). Puranas where Vishnu features prominently are identified as Vaishnava Puranas (Bhagavata, Garuda, Kurma, Matysa, Narada, Padma, Vamana, Varaha, Vishnu). Puranas where Shiva features prominently are identified as Shaiva Puranas (Agni, Linga, Shiva, Skanda, Vayu). While there is a grain of truth in this, Brahma, Vishnu and Shiva are all important and all three feature in every Purana. Therefore, beyond the relative superiority of Vishnu vis-à-vis Shiva, the taxonomy probably doesn't serve much purpose. The Brahma Purana is so named because it was originally recounted by Brahma, with subsequent transmissions by Vedavyasa and Lomaharshana, Vedavyasa's disciple. The second classification is even more tenuous and is based on the three *gunas* of *sattva* (purity), *rajas* (passion) and *tamas* (ignorance). For example, the Uttara Khanda of the Padma Purana has a few *shlokas* along these lines, recited by Shiva to Parvati. With a caveat similar to the one mentioned earlier, this should be in the 236th chapter of Uttara Khanda. According to this, the Puranas characterized by *sattva* are Bhagavata, Garuda, Narada, Padma, Varaha and Vishnu. Those characterized by *rajas* are Bhavishya, Brahma, Brahmanda, Brahmavaivarta, Markandeya and Vamana. Those characterized by *tamas* are Agni, Kurma, Linga, Matysa, Skanda and Shiva.

Within a specific Purana text, there are earlier sections, as well as later ones. That makes it difficult to date a Purana, except as a range. Across Purana texts, there are older Puranas, as well as later ones. Extremely

speculatively, the dating will be something like the following. (1) Agni (800–1100 CE); (2) Bhagavata (500–1000 CE); (3) Brahma (700–1500 CE); (4) Brahmanda (400–600 CE); (5) Brahmavaivarta (700–1500 CE); (6) Garuda (800–1100 CE); (7) Kurma (600–900 CE); (8) Linga (500–1000 CE); (9) Markandeya (250–700 CE); (10) Matsya (200–500 CE); (11) Narada (900–1600 CE); (12) Padma (400–1600 CE); (13) Shiva (1000–1400 CE); (14) Skanda (600–1200 CE); (15) Vamana (450–900 CE); (16) Varaha (1000–1200 CE); (17) Vayu (350–550 CE); (18) Vishnu (300 bce to 450 CE); and (19) Bhavishya (500–1900 CE). Reiterating once again that there is no great precision in these ranges, by this reckoning, the Vishnu Purana is the oldest and some parts of the Bhavishya Purana are as recent as the nineteenth century.

As mentioned earlier, there is no Critical Edition for the Puranas. Therefore, one has to choose a Sanskrit text one is going to translate from. If one is going to translate all the Puranas, it is preferable, though not essential, that one opts for a common source for all the Purana texts. The common source for the Brahma Purana, and all the Purana translations, is the one brought out by Nag Publishers, with funding from the Ministry of Human Resource Development.⁷ To the best of my knowledge, other than this translation, there is only one unabridged translation of the Brahma Purana in English.⁸ Though this translation was undertaken by a board of scholars, a discerning reader, who compares the two translations, will find that we have differed from this earlier translation in interpreting some verses and words.

For some Puranas, the range of possible dates of composition, as indicated above, is narrow. Agni, Brahmanda, Garuda, Kurma, Matsya, Varaha, Vayu and Vishnu are examples. The range is, however, extremely wide for Brahma Purana, from 700 to 1500 CE. There clearly was an original Brahma Purana, large chunks of which have been lost. In other words, the present Brahma Purana might not be the same as the original Brahma Purana, which has been lost.

R.C. Hazra's dissertation is still one of the best introductions to the Purana corpus, for all the Puranas, not just the Brahma Purana.⁹ 'It is a general belief that the present Brahma Purana is the original one, the peculiarity being that it has suffered through additions and losses. This belief is at the base of almost all statements that have been made so long by scholars about its date and authoritativeness. From an examination of the Puranas and the Smriti-Nibandhas, however, it has been found that the present Brahma Purana is not the original one but is merely an Upa Purana of the same title and that it was known as such even as late as in the sixteenth century AD, if not later. Almost all the Nibandha-writers have profusely drawn upon the 'Brahma Purana' or 'Brahma' which was, therefore, one of the most authoritative works in the whole range of Puranic literature. But, curiously enough, not a single of the numerous quotations made is traceable in the present Brahma Purana. The apocryphal Brahma Purana, with its borrowed and non-borrowed chapters, does not seem to have been composed, or rather compiled, earlier than the beginning of the tenth century AD. Had it been composed earlier, it should have been drawn upon, or at least referred to, by the Nibandha-writers earlier than the middle of the thirteenth century. The determination of the date of composition of the chapters of Purusottamaksetra-mahatmya is rather difficult. They could not possibly have been written earlier than the end of the ninth century AD because there is mention of the Siva-temple at the side of the Markandeya Lake. This temple was built in 820 AD by Kundala-kesarin, king of Orissa. Again, the expensive stone temple, which mythical king Indradyumna is said to have built at Purusottama-ksetra, may be identical with that built by Ananta-varman Codaganga (Saka 998–1069), one of the eastern Ganga kings of Orissa. We cannot, however, put much stress on this supposition because it is not known definitely that there was no Vishnu-temple at Puri before the time of Ananta-varman Codaganga . . . It is extremely difficult to prove that the Sun-temple mentioned by the Brahma Purana is the same as that built between 1240 and 1251 AD by Narasimhadeva I of the Ganga dynasty of Orissa. It is, therefore, highly probable that there was already an

ancient Sun-temple at Konarka before 1240 AD, and Narasimhadeva I either built another which has superseded the ancient temple in its fame and glory or rebuilt the ancient one which can be expected to have been in a dilapidated condition.'

Stated simply, there are sections on Purushottama *kshetra* and Jagannatha, underlining the lower end of the range of 1500 CE. There are references to Indradyumna and Konarka, the present temple having been built around 1250 CE, though an earlier temple might have existed at the same site. However, there are also sections that are of earlier vintage. There is the question of the relative superiority of Shiva and Surya, vis-à-vis Vishnu. For example, the Brahma Purana has 108 of Surya's names. There are chapters that are verbatim reproductions of sections from the Mahabharata, Hari Vamsha and other Puranas, but there are also sections on Surya that are new. One should not deduce that the Brahma Purana is copied from these texts, since these various texts might have had a common origin. The sections on Utkala read like a Sthala Purana, not deserving of the status of a Maha-Purana. To compound matters, there is the Goutami Mahatmya section, about the greatness of the river Goutami or Godavari. This too, has the attribute of a Sthala Purana and is different in nature from the rest of the Brahma Purana. Should it at all have been included in a translation of the Brahma Purana? We have decided to include it, because it is part of the Brahma Purana text published by Nag Publishers. It was also included in the Brahma Purana translation undertaken earlier by the board of scholars. Accordingly, we have labelled the main Brahma Purana text as Part I of the text and the Goutami Mahatmya section as Part II of the text. As mentioned earlier, the Brahma Purana text is believed to possess 10,000 *shlokas*. Part I, the main portion of the text, has 9,137 *shlokas*, fairly close to the cited number of 10,000. Part II has 4,681 *shlokas*, with an aggregate of 13,818 *shlokas* for the entire text. There are 138 chapters in Part I and 105 in Part II, a total of 243 chapters for the entire text. In numbering the chapters, the first number refers to the part and the second number (within brackets) refers to the number of the chapter within that part. Thus, Chapter 2(35) means the thirty-fifth chapter from Part II. While parts of the Brahma

Purana were composed by those familiar with the region of Utkala and Dandakaranya, Chapter 1(23) reveals some familiarity with other parts of the country too.

In the translations of the Bhagavad Gita, the Mahabharata, the Hari Vamsha, the Valmiki Ramayana, the Bhagavata Purana and the Markandeya Purana, ¹⁰ we followed the principle of not using diacritical marks. The use of diacritical marks (effectively the international alphabet of Sanskrit transliteration) makes the pronunciation and rendering more accurate, but also tends to put off readers who are less academically inclined. Since diacritical marks are not being used, there is a challenge of rendering Sanskrit names in English. Sanskrit is a phonetic language and we have used that principle as a basis. Applied consistently, this means that words are rendered in ways that may seem unfamiliar. Hence, Gautama will appear as Goutama here. This is true of proper names, and, in a few rare cases, of geographical names. The absence of diacritical marks causes some minor problems. How does one distinguish Vasudeva Krishna from Krishna's father, Vasudeva? Often, the context will make the difference clear. If not, we have written the son as Vaasudeva and the father as Vasudeva. In translating, the attempt has been to provide a word for word translation, so that if one were to hold up the Sanskrit text, there would be a perfect match. In the process, the English is not as smooth as it might have been, deliberately so.

The intention is also to offer a translation, not an interpretation. That sounds like a simple principle to adopt and, for the most part, is easy to follow. However, there is a thin dividing line between translation and interpretation. In some instances, it is impossible to translate without bringing in a little bit of interpretation. Inevitably, interpretation is subjective. We have tried to minimize the problem by (a) reducing interpretation; (b) relegating interpretation to footnotes; and (c) when there are alternative interpretations, pointing this out to the reader through those footnotes.

But all said and done, there is no substitute to reading these texts in the original Sanskrit. To the average person, the name of the Brahma Purana

may not be as familiar as that of the Bhagavata Purana or the Markandeya Purana, but it is an important Purana. Therefore, it is worth reading and translating.

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The Brahma Purana

Chapter 1(1): 238 shlokas
Chapter 1(2): 122 shlokas
Chapter 1(3): 64 shlokas
Chapter 1(4): 54 shlokas
Chapter 1(5): 109 shlokas
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Chapter 1(25): 80 shlokas
Chapter 1(26): 65 shlokas
Chapter 1(27): 61 shlokas

Chapter 1(28): 92 shlokas
Chapter 1(29): 39 shlokas
Chapter 1(30): 109 shlokas
Chapter 1(31): 49 shlokas
Chapter 1(32): 101 shlokas
Chapter 1(33): 64 shlokas
Chapter 1(34): 135 shlokas
Chapter 1(35): 30 shlokas
Chapter 1(36): 40 shlokas
Chapter 1(37): 97 shlokas
Chapter 1(38): 137 shlokas
Chapter 1(39): 95 shlokas
Chapter 1(40): 49 shlokas
Chapter 1(41): 89 shlokas
Chapter 1(42): 84 shlokas
Chapter 1(43): 89 shlokas
Chapter 1(44): 30 shlokas
Chapter 1(45): 82 shlokas
Chapter 1(46): 67 shlokas
Chapter 1(47): 60 shlokas
Chapter 1(48): 71 shlokas
Chapter 1(49): 19 shlokas
Chapter 1(50): 43 shlokas
Chapter 1(51): 16 shlokas
Chapter 1(52): 35 shlokas
Chapter 1(53): 69 shlokas
Chapter 1(54): 61 shlokas
Chapter 1(55): 77 shlokas
Chapter 1(56): 91 shlokas
Chapter 1(57): 65 shlokas
Chapter 1(58): 57 shlokas
Chapter 1(59): 23 shlokas
Chapter 1(60): 22 shlokas

Chapter 1(61): 20 shlokas
Chapter 1(62): 97 shlokas
Chapter 1(63): 23 shlokas
Chapter 1(64): 81 shlokas
Chapter 1(65): 77 shlokas
Chapter 1(66): 43 shlokas
Chapter 1(67): 74 shlokas
Chapter 1(68): 30 shlokas
Chapter 1(69): 195 shlokas
Chapter 1(70): 75 shlokas
Chapter 1(71): 42 shlokas
Chapter 1(72): 53 shlokas
Chapter 1(73): 32 shlokas
Chapter 1(74): 11 shlokas
Chapter 1(75): 29 shlokas
Chapter 1(76): 32 shlokas
Chapter 1(77): 56 shlokas
Chapter 1(78): 44 shlokas
Chapter 1(79): 32 shlokas
Chapter 1(80): 49 shlokas
Chapter 1(81): 56 shlokas
Chapter 1(82): 49 shlokas
Chapter 1(83): 36 shlokas
Chapter 1(84): 86 shlokas
Chapter 1(85): 91 shlokas
Chapter 1(86): 32 shlokas
Chapter 1(87): 18 shlokas
Chapter 1(88): 45 shlokas
Chapter 1(89): 21 shlokas
Chapter 1(90): 19 shlokas
Chapter 1(91): 42 shlokas
Chapter 1(92): 28 shlokas
Chapter 1(93): 35 shlokas

Chapter 1(94): 73 shlokas
Chapter 1(95): 18 shlokas
Chapter 1(96): 22 shlokas
Chapter 1(97): 50 shlokas
Chapter 1(98): 43 shlokas
Chapter 1(99): 39 shlokas
Chapter 1(100): 23 shlokas
Chapter 1(101): 58 shlokas
Chapter 1(102): 12 shlokas
Chapter 1(103): 95 shlokas
Chapter 1(104): 163 shlokas
Chapter 1(105): 128 shlokas
Chapter 1(106): 152 shlokas
Chapter 1(107): 89 shlokas
Chapter 1(108): 118 shlokas
Chapter 1(109): 32 shlokas
Chapter 1(110): 116 shlokas
Chapter 1(111): 67 shlokas
Chapter 1(112): 145 shlokas

7,274 shlokas

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Chapter 1(1) (Origin of *devas* and *asuras*)

Jaya must be uttered after worshipping the excellent Nara-Narayana, and goddess Sarasvati. ¹ I worship Hari, the one who grants emancipation. He is the one who pervades everything. He is the one who has composed this manifestation. He is the origin of the universe and its *maya*. ² In the course of time from one *kalpa* to another *kalpa*, ³ it is in him that it is repeatedly established. It is into him that it is drawn in. For the welfare of this manifestation, sages meditate on him and certainly obtain emancipation. I worship the unblemished one who is known as Purushottama. ⁴ He is the eternal one who does not move. At the time of *samadhi*, he is the one the learned meditate on. He is as pure as the atmosphere. He is always full of perpetual bliss. He is pleasant and without blemish. He is the lord of everything. He is without *gunas*. ⁵ He is beyond the manifest and the unmanifest. The lord can only be reached through meditation. For the sake of destroying this cycle of *samsara*, ⁶ I bow down to the one who is without decay.

The forest of Naimisha was extremely sacred. It was holy and enchanting. It was full of large numbers of diverse sages and adorned with many kinds of flowers and trees like *shalas*, *karnikaras*, *panasas*, *dhavas*, *khadiras*, *amras*, *jambus*, *kapitthas*, *nyagrodhas*, *devadarus*, *ashvatthas*, *parijatas*, *chandanas*, *agarus*, *patalas*, *bakulas*, *saptaparnis*, *punnagas*, *nagakesharas*, *shalas* ⁷, *tamalas*, *narikelas*, *arjunas*, *champakas*. It was populated with large numbers of different kinds of birds and animals. There were many water bodies. It was ornamented with many sacred lakes. There were *brahmanas*, *kshatriyas*, *vaishyas*, *shudras* and other classes of people. There were those in *vanaprastha*, *garhasthya* and *brahmacharya* stages and mendicants. ⁸ The forest was flourishing with prosperous pens of cattle.

There were also stores of barley, wheat, chickpea, pulses, kidney beans, sesamum, sugarcane, paddy, barley ⁹ and other kinds of grain. At a great sacrifice there, the bearer of oblations ¹⁰ was kindled and oblations were offered to it. In the forest of Naimisha, a sacrifice went on for twelve years. Sages and all the other *brahmanas* gathered there. As is appropriate, the *brahmanas* who arrived were suitably worshipped. Along with the officiating priests, they seated themselves there. The intelligent suta, Lomaharshana, arrived there. ¹¹ On seeing him, the best among sages were delighted and worshipped him. He honoured them back and seated himself on an excellent seat. The suta and the *brahmanas* started to converse with each other. When the conversation was over, the officiating priests, who had consecrated themselves for the sacrifice, cheerfully asked Vyasa's disciple about their doubts.

The sages said, 'O excellent one! You know about the Puranas, the *agama* texts, ¹² other sacred texts and *Itihasa*. You know about the birth, deeds and conduct of gods and *daityas*. ¹³ There is nothing that is unknown to you from the Vedas, the sacred texts and in Bharata. ¹⁴ O immensely intelligent one! You know everything about the Puranas and the sacred texts on emancipation. ¹⁵ O Suta! We wish to know, right from the beginning, how everything, mobile and immobile, originated—the *suras*, *asuras*, *gandharvas*, *yakshas*, *uragas* and *rakshasas*. ¹⁶ O immensely fortunate one! Tell us everything about how the universe was created, where it exists and where it will go. O Suta! At the time of destruction, what will the universe and all its mobile and immobile objects merge into? What is the destination?'

Lomaharshana replied, 'I bow down to the immutable Vishnu. He is mysterious. He is the eternal *paramatman*. His form is always one. He is the one who is victorious over everything. I bow down before Hiranyagarbha, ¹⁷ Hari and Shankara. I bow down before Vasudeva, the one who delivers. He is the one who brings about creation, preservation and destruction. I bow down before the one who has one form and many forms. His *atman* is gross and subtle. Vishnu finds expression in manifest and unmanifest forms. He is the cause behind emancipation. He is behind the

creation, preservation and destruction of the universe. He pervades the universe. I bow down to the reason behind all foundations, Vishnu, the *paramatman*. He is the one who supports this universe, from the largest to the smallest. I bow down before Achyuta Purushottama, who is in all beings. *Jnana* is his form. ¹⁸ He is absolutely perfect and is the supreme objective. It is his form that is the ultimate objective. But he is also established in the confusion of our vision. He is also the lord of creation and preservation. Vishnu is the omniscient lord of the universe. He is without birth, without transformation and without decay. He is original and subtle. I prostrate myself before him, Brahma and the others. I prostrate myself before my *guru*, the lord who was Parashara's son. ¹⁹ He knows about *Itihasa* and Puranas. He is accomplished in the Vedas and the Vedangas. ²⁰ He knows the true meaning of all the sacred texts. I will tell you about Purana, which is as revered as the Vedas. I will tell you exactly what the illustrious grandfather, ²¹ born from the egg, said earlier, when he was asked by Daksha and other excellent sages. Listen. I will give you an account that cleanses all sins. This account, related by me, is colourful, with many deep meanings. It extends what is there in the Vedas. If a person always nurtures it and listens to it, he nurtures his own lineage and obtains greatness in the world of heaven.'

The unmanifest cause is eternal. What exists, and what does not exist, is in its *atman*. This is Purusha, the lord of the universe, and Pradhana evolved from there. ²² O best among sages! You should know that this is the infinitely energetic Brahma. He is the creator of all beings. He is the supreme Aja ²³ Narayana. *Ahamkara* was born from the principle of Mahat. The elements were born from Mahat. Different kinds of beings were born from the elements. This is eternal creation. ²⁴ As is my wisdom and depending on what I have heard, I will now describe its nature in detail. Listen to me as I recount it. This enhances the fame of everyone. There are those who are auspicious in their deeds and their fame is permanent. It tells us about all of them. The illustrious Svayambhu ²⁵ desired to create different kinds of subjects. He first created water and released his energy into it. The water is spoken of as Naara. ²⁶ Water is spoken of as the offspring of Nara.

Originally, he lay down in the water. Therefore, he is spoken of as Narayana.²⁷ A golden egg, the embryo, originated and floated in the water. Brahma himself was born from this. We have heard that he is Svayambhu. The illustrious and golden-complexioned one resided there for one year. He then divided the egg into two parts and these became heaven and earth. In between the two halves, the lord created the sky. As it was floating in the flood of water, he created the ten directions of the earth. At the same time, he created mind, speech, desire, anger and attachment. Wishing to engender a creation that would be appropriate, he created the Prajapatis²⁸—Marichi, Atri, Angiras, Pulastya, Pulaha, Kratu and Vasishtha. He created these seven immensely energetic ones through his mental powers. It is the conviction of the Puranas that these are like seven Brahmas. These seven, born from Brahma, have Narayana in their atmans. After this, from his rage, Brahma created Rudra. The lord created Sanatkumara, who was the eldest among his earlier sons.²⁹ O *brahmanas*! Subjects and the Rudras were born from the seven.³⁰ Skanda³¹ and Sanatkumara remained there, scattering their energy. Those seven led to the creation of great and divine lineages, ornamented by large numbers of gods and *maharshis* who had offspring and performed sacrifices. He³² created lightning, thunder, clouds and the red-tinged rainbow. He created birds.³³ Right at the beginning, he created Parjanya.³⁴ For success in sacrifices, he created Rig, Yajur and Sama hymns. We have always heard that he created Sadhyas and other gods. Inferior and superior species were born from his body. However, even though these categories of subjects were created, there was no further creation of subjects. Without more subjects being created, they did not multiply at that time.

Therefore, he divided his body into two parts. One half of the body was male, the other half of the body was female. Through the woman, many kinds of subjects were created. Vishnu pervaded heaven and earth with his greatness. He created Virat and Virat created Purusha. Manu is known as Purusha and *manvantara* is named after him. This second *manvantara* is said to be that of mental creation.³⁵ For the sake of creating subjects, the lord created Vairaja³⁶ Purusha. The subjects created during Narayana's

creation were not born from wombs. If a man knows about this original creation, he obtains his desired objective, has a long lifespan, is famous and is blessed with offspring. Apava Purusha ³⁷ was a Prajapati who wished to have offspring. He obtained Shatarupa as his wife, who was not born from a womb. Apava was stationed there, covering the firmament with his greatness. O best among sages! Shatarupa followed *dharma* and gave birth. For ten thousand years, she tormented herself in extremely difficult austerity. After this, she obtained Purusha as her husband, who blazed in his austerity. O *brahmanas*! This Purusha is spoken of as Svayambhuva Manu. ³⁸ Each of his manvantaras consists of seventy-one yugas. ³⁹ Through Shatarupa, Vairaja Purusha had two brave sons—Priyavrata and Uttanapada. After these two brave ones, a daughter named Kamya was born. O best among sages! The one named Kamya was the wife of Kardama Prajapati. Kamya had four sons—Samrat, Kukshi, Virat and Prabhu. Prajapati Atri accepted Uttanapada as his son. Dharma's daughter possessed beautiful buttocks and is known by the name of Sunrita. The auspicious one was born through a horse sacrifice and was Dhruva's mother. Through Sunrita, Uttanapada had four sons—Dhruva, Kirtiman, Ayushman and Vasu. O *brahmanas*! The immensely fortunate Dhruva tormented himself in austerity for three thousand years. Pleased at this, the lord Prajapati Brahma gave him an immovable position that was like his own and he was placed before the Saptarshis. ⁴⁰ Witnessing the increase in his honour and greatness, Ushanas ⁴¹, the preceptor of the gods and the *asuras*, chanted a *shloka*. 'Wonderful are his austerities. Wonderful is his learning. Dhruva is extraordinary. The Saptarishis have placed him ahead of themselves.' Through Shambhu, Dhruva had two sons—Shlishti and Bhavya. Through Succhaya, Shlishti had five unblemished sons—Ripu, Puranjaya, Putra, Vrikala and Vrikatejas. Through Brihati, Ripu had Chakshusha as a son and he was energetic in every way. Vairini, from Pushkarini, was the daughter of the great-souled Prajapati, Aranya. Through her, Chakshusha had Chakshusha Manu as a son.

O tigers among sages! Through Nadvala, the daughter of Prajapati Vairaja, Manu ⁴² had ten immensely energetic sons—Kutsa, Puru,

Shatadyumna, Tapasvi, Satyavak, Kavi, Agnishtubh, Atiratra and Sudyumna. The tenth was Abhimanyu. Through Agneyi, Puru had six immensely radiant sons—Anga, Sumanas, Khyati, Kratu, Angiras and Gaya. Through Sunitha, Anga had a son named Vena. Because of Vena's wicked deeds, there was great rage. For the sake of offspring, the *rishis* kneaded his right hand.⁴³ When Vena's hand was kneaded, a great king was born. On seeing him, the sages said, 'He will act so as to delight the subjects. The immensely energetic one will obtain great fame.' He was born wielding a bow and clad in armour. He was as resplendent as a blazing fire. Prithu, Vena's son, protected the earth and was the ancestor of all the *kshatriyas*.⁴⁴ He was the first lord of the earth who consecrated himself for a royal sacrifice.⁴⁵ The accomplished sutas and *magadhas* were born from him.⁴⁶ O best among sages! Desiring crops that would enable subjects to subsist, the lord of the earth milked the earth, in the form of a cow, along with the gods, large numbers of *rishis*, ancestors, *danavas*, *gandharvas* and large numbers of *apsaras*, snakes, sacred people,⁴⁷ herbs and mountains. Using their own respective vessels, they milked the earth. Thus milked, the earth gave them the milk that they desired, so that they could sustain their lives. When the sacrifice was over, two sons who knew about *dharma* were born to Prithu—Antardhi and Patin. Through Shikhandini, Antardhana⁴⁸ had a son named Havirdhana. Dhishana, Agni's daughter, bore six sons to Havirdhana—Prachinabarhi, Shukra, Gaya, Krishna, Vraja and Ajina. The illustrious Prachinabarhi was a great Prajapati. O best among sages! Havirdhana had made the subjects prosper. Like that, the illustrious Prachinabarhi made all those who roamed around on earth prosper. The lord of the earth performed great austerity along the shores of the ocean and married Savarna, the ocean's daughter. Prachinabarhi had ten sons through Savarna, the daughter of the ocean. They were known as Prachetas and all of them were accomplished in *dhanurveda*.⁴⁹ All of them followed the same *dharma* and tormented themselves in great austerities for ten thousand years, immersing themselves in the waters of the ocean. While the Prachetas performed austerities, the earth was no longer protected. Giant trees grew and covered everything. There was a destruction of subjects. The

trees were so dense that the wind could no longer blow. For ten thousand years, the subjects could not move. All the Prachetas, who were engaged in austerities, heard about this. Filled with rage, they generated wind and fire through their mouths. The wind uprooted the trees and dried them up. The fire burnt them down. Thus, most trees were destroyed and only a few were left. On learning this, Soma approached these Prajapatis and spoke to them. ‘O kings! O sons of Prachinabarhi! Restrain your anger. The earth is bereft of trees. Pacify the wind and the fire. This daughter of the trees is beautiful in complexion and is full of jewels. O sons! ⁵⁰ Since I knew about the future, I held her in my womb. This maiden is named Marisha and she has been fashioned by the trees. O immensely fortunate ones! She will be your wife and extend the lunar dynasty. With half of your energy and half of my energy, she will have the learned Prajapati Daksha as her son. This earth has been burnt down by the energy of your fire. He will be Agni’s ⁵¹ equal and will make the earth and the subjects prosper again.’ Those stores of austerity accepted Soma’s words. They restrained their rage towards the trees and following *dharma*, accepted Marisha as their wife. O *brahmanas*! Through Marisha, the ten Prachetas had the immensely energetic Prajapati Daksha as a son and he was born from Soma’s portion. Using his mental powers, Daksha created mobile and immobile objects, bipeds and quadrupeds. Thereafter, he created women. The lord bestowed ten of his daughters on Dharma, thirteen on Kashyapa and the remainder, known as *nakshatras*, ⁵² on King Soma. The gods, birds, cattle, *nagas*, Diti’s offspring, *danavas*, *gandharvas*, *apsaras* and all other species were born through them. O Indras among *brahmanas*! Since then, subjects have been born through sexual intercourse. It is said that earlier, subjects were born through mental resolution, sight and touch.

The sages said, ‘We have heard about the origin of gods, *danavas*, *gandharvas*, *uragas*, *rakshasas* and the great-souled Daksha. But we have also heard that Daksha, auspicious in his vows, was born from Brahma’s right thumb and that his wife was born from his left thumb. How could he then have originated from the Prachetas, great in their austerities? O Suta!

We have a doubt about this and you should explain it to us. How did Soma's daughter's son become his father-in-law?'

Lomaharshana replied, 'O *brahmanas*! Origin and destruction are constant phenomena among beings. The *rishis* and learned people are not confused about this. Daksha and the other kings are born from one yuga to another yuga and they are again destroyed. O best among *brahmanas*! Earlier, there was no concept of older or younger. Austerities were more important and their powers were the determining factor. If a person knows about this creation of mobile and immobile objects by Daksha, he has offspring and enjoys a full lifespan. He obtains greatness in heaven.'

The sages said, 'O Lomaharshana! Describe in detail the origin of gods, *danavas*, *gandharvas*, *uragas* and *rakshasas*.'

Lomaharshana replied, 'Svayambhu ⁵³ had earlier instructed Daksha to create subjects. O *brahmanas*! Listen to how he created subjects. Prajapati used his mental powers to create beings—*rishis*, gods, *gandharvas*, *asuras*, *yakshas* and *rakshasas*. O *brahmanas*! But the subjects created through mental powers did not multiply. For the sake of subjects, Prajapati, with *dharma* in his soul, started to think. He wished to create different kinds of subjects by using the *dharma* of sexual intercourse. Asikni, daughter of Prajapati Virana, became his wife. She had performed great austerity and was capable of holding up the worlds. Through Asikni, Virana's daughter, the valiant Prajapati Daksha had five thousand sons. Those immensely fortunate ones were ready to create subjects. However, on seeing this, *devarshi* ⁵⁴ Narada, pleasant in speech, addressed them in words that led to their destruction, and to a curse being invoked on him. Formerly, the sage Kashyapa was scared that Daksha would curse him. Therefore, through Daksha's daughter, he had an excellent and foremost son. ⁵⁵ Earlier, Narada had been Brahma's son. ⁵⁶ The excellent *devarshi* was later born as the son of Asikni, Virana's daughter. ⁵⁷ Like his father, ⁵⁸ the bull among sages ⁵⁹ also had him as a son. Daksha's sons ⁶⁰ were known as Haryashvas. All of them were crushed and destroyed. There is no doubt that this was because of destiny. ⁶¹ At this, the infinitely valiant Daksha got ready to bring about his ⁶² destruction. However, placing the brahmana *rishi* ⁶³ in front of him,

Parameshthi ⁶⁴ entreated him. Thereupon, there was an agreement between Daksha and Parameshthi, ‘Let your son, Narada, be born as my son, through your daughter.’ ⁶⁵ At this, Parameshthi bestowed his beloved daughter on Daksha. ⁶⁶ Scared of being cursed, the *rishi* Narada was born in this way.

The sages asked, ‘O illustrious one! How were Prajapati’s sons destroyed by Maharshi Narada? We wish to hear the truth about this.’

Lomaharshana replied, ‘The Haryashvas, Daksha’s sons, desired to multiply subjects. Narada approached those extremely valiant ones and spoke to them. ‘You are foolish. You do not know anything about the earth and its dimensions. O descendants of the Prachetas! Nevertheless, you desire to create subjects. Without knowing what is inside, above and below, how will you create subjects?’ Hearing these words, they departed in different directions. Like rivers merging into the ocean, they have not yet returned. When the Haryashvas were destroyed, lord Daksha, descended from the Prachetas, again had one thousand sons through Virana’s daughter. These Shabalashvas also desired to multiply subjects. However, Narada goaded them with the words he had used earlier. All of them spoke to each other. ‘The great *rishi* has spoken correctly. There is no doubt that we must follow the footsteps of our brothers. When we have ascertained the dimensions of the earth, we will happily create subjects.’ They also followed those trails in different directions. Like rivers merging into an ocean, they have not yet returned. O *brahmanas*! Ever since then, a brother who sets out in search of a lost brother is swiftly destroyed. A learned person must never do this. Knowing that his sons had been destroyed, we have heard that Prajapati Daksha had sixty daughters through Virana’s daughter. O *brahmanas*! Lord Kashyapa, Soma, Dharma and other maharshis accepted them as wives. He ⁶⁷ bestowed ten on Dharma, thirteen on Kashyapa, twenty-seven on Soma, four on Arishtanemi, two on Bahuputra, two on Angiras and two on Krishashva. Hear and learn about their names. O *brahmanas*! Dharma’s ten wives were Arundhati, Vasu, Yami, Lamba, Bala, Marutvati, Sankalpa, Muhurta, Sadhya and Vishva. Hear about their offspring. Vishva gave birth to the Vishvadevas and

Sadhya to the Sadhyas. Marutvati's sons were the Marutvats and Vasu's sons were the Vasus. Bhanu's sons were the Bhanus and the Muhurtas were born from Muhurta. Ghosha was the son of Lamba and Yami's daughter was Nagavithi. All entities on earth were born from Arundhati. From Sankalpa was born Sankalpa, the resolution that is in the atmans of the universe. Nagavithi, Yami's daughter, gave birth to Vrishala. Daksha descended from the Prachetas and gave his daughters in marriage to King Soma. All of them are known as *nakshatras* and are famous in *jyotisha*.⁶⁸ There are others who are famous as gods and proceed ahead of the stellar bodies. They are known as the eight Vasus and I will speak about them in detail. The names of the Vasus are said to be Aya, Dhruva, Soma,⁶⁹ Dhava, Anila, Anala,⁷⁰ Pratyusha and Prabhasa. Aya's sons were Vaitandya, Shrama, Shranta and Muni. Dhruva's son was the illustrious Kala, who reckons time in the worlds. Soma's son was the illustrious Varcha and radiance results from him. Through Manohara, the sons of Dhava were Dravina, Hutahavyavaha, Shishira, Prana and Ramana. Shiva⁷¹ was Anila's wife and her son was Manojava. Anila had two sons, the other was Avijnatagati. In a clump of reeds, Agni's son, Kumara, was surrounded by radiance and his descendants were Shakha, Vishakha and Naigameya. He is known as Kartikeya because he was the son of the Krittikas.⁷² It is known that Pratyusha's son was the *rishi* Devala. Devala had two sons who were forgiving and learned. Brihaspati's sister was a supreme lady who knew about the *brahman*. Her name was Yogasiddha and she roamed around the entire earth. She became the wife of Prabhasa, the eighth Vasu. The immensely fortunate Prajapati Vishvakarma was born from her. He is the creator of thousands of works of artisanship and is the architect of the gods. The supreme among artisans created all the ornaments of the gods and also all the divine *vimanas*. Humans earn subsistence through the great-soul's art of craftsmanship.'

'The virtuous Surabhi⁷³ satisfied Mahadeva with her austerity and because of his favours, bore eleven Rudras as Kashyapa's sons. O excellent *brahmanas*! They were Ajaikapada, Ahirbudhnya, Tvashta, the valiant Rudra, Hara, Bahurupa, Tryambaka, Aparajita, Vrishakapi, Shambhu,

Kapardi, Raivata, Mrigavyadha, Sharva and Kapali.⁷⁴ These eleven Rudras are famous as the lords of the worlds. O tigers among sages! The Puranas have spoken about one hundred infinitely energetic Rudras. Mobile and immobile objects are pervaded by them. O Indras among *brahmanas*! Hear about the wives of Prajapati Kashyapa. They were Aditi, Diti, Danu, Arishta, Surasa, Khasa, Surabhi, Vinata, Tamra, Krodhavasha, Ira, Kadru and Muni. O *brahmanas*! Hear about their offspring. In the earlier *manvantara*, there were twelve excellent *suras*. They were named the Tushitas. When Vaivasvata *manvantara* approached, they spoke to each other. ‘Chakshusha Manu was immensely famous. O gods! For the welfare of the worlds, let all of us gather together and quickly enter Aditi’s womb. When the new *manvantara* presents itself, we will be born. That will be best for us.’ During Chakshusha Manu’s *manvantara*, all of those radiant ones said this. They have been born as the sons of Kashyapa and Aditi. Vishnu and Shakra have been born again. The twelve infinitely energetic Adityas are said to be Aryama, Dhatri, Tvashta, Pusha, Vivasvat, Savitar, Mitra, Varuna, Amsha and Bhaga.⁷⁵ In Chakshusha *manvantara*, the *suras* were known as the Tushitas. In Vaivasvata *manvantara*, they are known as the twelve Adityas. Soma’s twenty-seven wives have been mentioned and they were great in their vows. Their offspring blazed and were infinitely energetic.’

Arishtanemi’s wives had sixteen offspring. The sons of the learned Bahuputra were the four Vidyutas.⁷⁶ In the former Chakshusha *manvantara*, the brahmana *rishis* honoured them with hymns. The sons of *devarshi* Krishashva are said to be the weapons of the gods. As they desire, when one thousand yugas are over, all of them are born again. O *brahmanas*! There are thirty-three categories of gods.⁷⁷ They are also said to have origin and destruction. Just as the sun rises and sets in the sky, from one yuga to another yuga, the gods are created and destroyed.’

We have heard that from Kashyapa, two sons were born to Diti—the valiant Hiranyakashipu and Hiranyaksha. She had a daughter named Simhika, who was married to Viprachitti. Their sons were immensely strong and were known as the Saimhikeyas. Hiranyakashipu had four sons who

were famous for their energy—Hrada, Anuhrada and the valiant Prahrada. Samhrada was the fourth. Hrada's son was Hraada. Hrada's other sons were Mayavi, Shiva and Kala. Prahrada's son was Virochana and Virochana's son was Bali. O stores of austerities! Bali had one hundred sons and Bana was the eldest. They were Dhritarashtra, Surya, Chandramas, Indratapana, Kumbha, Nabha, Gardabhaksha. The eldest, Bana, was extremely strong and was loved by Pashupati. In an earlier *kalpa*, Bana had obtained the favours of the lord who is Uma's consort ⁷⁸ and had sought the boon, 'Let me always find pleasure by your side.' Hiranyaksha's five sons were learned and extremely strong. They were Bharbhara, Shakuni, Bhutasantapana, the valiant Mahanabha and Kalanabha. Danu had one hundred sons who were fierce and brave. They were extremely valiant ascetics. I will tell you the names of the most important—Dvimurdha, Shankukarna, Hayashira, Vibhu, Ayomukha, Shambara, Kapila, Vamana, Marichi, Maghavan, Ilvala, Shrimana, Viskhobhana, Ketu, Ketuvirya, Shatahrada, Indrajit, Sarvajit, Vajranabha, Ekachakra, Mahabahu, the immensely valiant Taraka, Vaishvanara, Puloma, Vidravana, Mahashira, Svarbhanu, Vrishaparva and the valiant Viprachitti. All these sons of Kashyapa were born through Danu. Viprachitti was foremost among the *danavas* and was extremely strong. O best among *brahmanas*! It is impossible to enumerate their offspring. There were too many and the sons and grandsons were innumerable. Svarbhanu's daughter was Prabha and Puloma's daughter was Shachi. Upadanavi was the daughter of Hayashira and Vrishaparva's daughter was Sharmishtha. Vaishvanara's two daughters were Pulomaa and Kalaka. They were great in spirit and had many offspring. They married Marichi and their sixty thousand sons were the delight of the *danavas*. Marichi performed great austerities and had another fourteen hundred sons who resided in Hiranyapura. The *danavas* Poulomas and Kalakeyas ⁷⁹ were extremely terrible. Viprachitti had sons through Simhika. Since they were born through a mix of *daityas* and *danavas*, they were fierce and valiant. The thirteen extremely strong Saimhikeyas are known as Vamshya, Shalya, the powerful Nala, Bala, Vatapi, Namuchi, Ilvala, Shrimana, Anjika, Naraka, Kalanabha, Saramana and the valiant

Svarakalpa. Hrada's two sons were Mushaka and Hunda. Maricha was the son of Sunda and Tadaka. These are the best among *danavas*, and they extended Danu's lineage. They had hundreds and thousands of sons and grandsons. The Nivatakavachas were born in the lineage of the *daitya* Samhrada, who had cleansed his *atman* and had performed extremely great austerities. The immensely fortunate Vaidyutas are said to have been born to Tamra. They had three crore sons who lived in Manivati. They could not be slain by the gods and were brought down by Arjuna. ⁸⁰

There were Krouchi, Shyeni, Bhasi, Sugrivi, Shuchi and Gridhika. ⁸¹ Krouchi gave birth to owls and crows, Shyeni to hawks and falcons, Bhasi to cocks, Gridhika to vultures, Shuchi to aquatic birds and Sugrivi to horses, camels and donkeys. O excellent *brahmanas*! This is said to be Tamra's lineage. Vinata had two famous sons, Garuda and Aruna. Garuda is the best among birds and his own deeds are terrible. O *brahmanas*! Surasa's sons were one thousand great-souled and infinitely energetic *sarpas*, who had many heads and roamed around in the sky. Kadru's sons were one thousand powerful and infinitely energetic *nagas*, who possessed more than one head. They were always subjugated by Suparna. ⁸² The foremost among them were Shesha, Vasuki, Takshaka, Airavata, Mahapadma, Kambala, Ashvatara, Elapatra, Shankha, Karkotaka, Dhananjaya, Mahanila, Mahakarna, Dhritarashtra, Balahaka, Kuhara, Pushpadanshtra, Durmukha, Sumukha, Shankha, ⁸³ Shankhapala, Kapila, Vamana, Nahusha, Shankharoma, Mani and others. They had hundreds and thousands of sons and grandsons. Among them, fourteen thousand are cruel and only subsist on air. O *brahmanas*! All those in the category of Krodhavashas are fanged. The number of birds on land and born on the earth is said to be infinite. Surabhi gave birth to cows and buffaloes. Ira gave birth to trees, creepers, lantanas and all the different kinds of grass. Khasha gave birth to *yakshas* and *rakshasas* and Muni gave birth to *apsaras*. Arishta gave birth to the infinitely energetic *gandharvas* who are great in spirit. Kashyapa's descendants, mobile and immobile, have thus been described. They had hundreds and thousands of sons and grandsons. O *brahmanas*! This creation is said to have existed in Svarochisha *manvantara*.'

For the sake of creating subjects in this world, during Vaivasvata *manvantara*, it is said that Brahma undertook an extremely great sacrifice to Varuna. As was the case earlier, the grandfather himself created seven brahmana *rishis* through his mental powers. O *brahmanas*! There was a conflict between the gods and the *danavas*. As a result of this, all of Diti's sons were destroyed. She worshipped Kashyapa properly and his mind was pleased. He offered to grant her a boon and she asked to have an infinitely energetic son who would be capable of killing Indra. This is the boon she sought from the one who was great in his austerity. Having granted the eager one the boon, the radiant one told her, 'If you are pure and devoted to your vows, bearing the fetus in this way for one hundred autumns, you will have a son who will kill Indra.' O excellent sages! The goddess devotedly agreed to what the one who was great in austerity had said. Pure, she conceived and bore the fetus. Kashyapa wished for a category of gods who would be infinitely energetic, impossible of being assailed or slain even by the immortals. He restrained his energy and impregnated Diti. After this, he left for the mountains. Devoted to his vows, he performed austerity. The chastiser of Paka ⁸⁴ waited, desiring to find a weakness. When the period of one hundred years was almost over, he detected this weakness. Diti went to bed without having washed her feet first. When she went to sleep, he entered her through her flank. He used the *vajra* in his hand to sever the fetus into seven parts. When the fetus was sliced by the *vajra*, it started to weep. Shakra told the child, '*Ma ruda*'. ⁸⁵ Angry, Indra, the one who showers down rain, sliced each of these seven parts into seven parts with the *vajra*. O best among *brahmanas*! Thus, the child came to have the name of Marut. ⁸⁶ They became Maruts because of what Maghavan had said. These forty-nine gods are aides of the one who wields a *vajra* in his hand. Among all creatures, their conduct is like a category of gods who are infinitely energetic. O best among *brahmanas*! For each category of creatures, Hari determined a respective Prajapati. O *brahmanas*! Beginning with Prithu, kingdoms were progressively formed. Hari is the valiant Purusha. He is Krishna, Vishnu and Prajapati. He is Parjanya and Tapanas. ⁸⁷ Everything in the universe belongs to the infinite one. O excellent

brahmanas! If a person properly knows about this creation of beings, he has no fear about lack of subsistence in this world. How can he suffer any fear of the world hereafter?’

Chapter 1(2) (Prithu's birth and greatness)

Lomaharshana said, 'The grandfather instated Prithu, Vena's son, as an Indra among kings. He then started to organize the other kingdoms. He made Soma the lord of the kingdom of birds, herbs, *nakshatras*, planets, sacrifices and austerities. He made Varuna the lord of waters and Vaishravana the lord of kings. Vishnu was made the lord of Adityas and Pavaka of Vasus. Daksha was made the lord of Prajapatis and Vasava⁸⁸ of the Maruts. The infinitely energetic Prahrada was made lord of *daityas* and *danavas*. Vaivasvata Yama was instated as the lord in the kingdom of ancestors. Girisha, with the trident in his hand, was made the lord of *yakshas*, *rakshasas*, kings, and all *bhutas* and *pishachas*.⁸⁹ The Himalayas were made the lord of mountains and the ocean, of rivers. The lord Chitraratha was made the lord of *gandharvas*, Vasuki of *nagas* and Takshaka of *sarpas*. Airavata was instructed to be the lord of elephants, Ucchaishrava, of horses and Garuda, of birds. The tiger was made the lord of animals and the bull, of cows. Plaksha was instated as the lord of *vanaspatis*.⁹⁰ In this way, the grandfather progressively divided the kingdoms. Having done this, the lord established the guardians of the directions. Sudhanvan, the son of Prajapati Vairaja, was instated as the king and guardian of the eastern direction. He instated Shankhapada, the son of the great-souled Kardama Prajapati, as the king of the southern direction. He instated the great-souled Ketuman, the undecaying son of Rajas, as the king of the western direction. He instated the unassailable Hiranyaroma, the son of Prajapati Parjanya, as king of the northern direction. Even now, they follow *dharma* and protect the earth with all its seven *dvipas*,⁹¹ habitations and regions. Following the rituals laid down in the Vedas, in the course of a *rajasuya* sacrifice, the lords of the earth made Prithu the king over the

kingdom. When the immensely energetic Chakshusha *manvantara* was over, he instated Vaivasvata Manu in the kingdom on earth. ⁹² If you wish to hear about this, for your sake, I will tell you in detail about Vaivasvata *manvantara*. This great consecration has been described in the Puranas.'

The sages said, 'O Lomaharshana! Please describe Prithu's birth to us in detail. How did the great soul milk the earth? How did the ancestors, gods, *maharshis*, *daityas*, *nagas*, *yakshas*, trees, mountains, *pishachas*, *gandharvas*, best among *brahmanas*, *rakshasas* and great spirits milk the earth? O one who is excellent in vows! You should tell us about the specific vessels they used. In due order, tell us about the calves used for the milking and the milk that was obtained. What was the reason that Vena's arm was kneaded in those ancient times? O son! ⁹³ Describe to us the reason why the *maharshis* became angry.'

Lomaharshana replied, 'I will tell you in detail about Prithu and Vena. Listen. O bulls among *brahmanas*! Control yourselves and listen with single-minded attention. O *brahmanas*! This must never be described to a person who is impure or inferior in mind, someone who is not a disciple, someone who is lacking in vows, an ungrateful person, or to someone who causes injury. This account leads to heaven, fame, a long lifespan and blessedness. It is as revered as the Vedas. It is mysterious and the *maharshis* have spoken about it. Listen to what happened exactly. If a person always bows down to *brahmanas* and recites this account of Prithu and Vena in detail, he does not have to grieve about what he has done and about what he has not done. Earlier, there was a Prajapati who was Atri's equal. The lord was born in Atri's lineage and he was a protector of *dharma*. His name was Anga. He had a son named Vena, who knew about neither *artha*, nor *dharma*. ⁹⁴ This Prajapati ⁹⁵ was born from Sunitha, Mrityu's daughter. He was, thus, the son of Kala's daughter and suffered from his maternal grandfather's taint. ⁹⁶ He turned his back on his own *dharma* and pursued *kama* and avarice. The lord of the earth transgressed the ordinances required by *dharma*. He violated the *dharma* of the Vedas and was addicted to *adharma*. When he was Prajapati, the subjects were deprived of studies and the utterance of *vashatkara*. ⁹⁷ No oblations were offered at sacrifices and

the gods could not drink *soma*. The Prajapati was cruel and issued the command, ‘There should be no sacrifices, and no oblations should be offered’.

Destruction presented itself. ‘I am the one to whom sacrifices must be offered. I am the one who will perform *yajnas* and *kratus*.⁹⁸ I am the foremost person at sacrifices. I am the one to whom oblations must be offered.’ Because of his transgressions, a violation of the ordinances presented itself. With Marichi at the forefront, all the *maharshis* said, ‘O Vena! For many years, we have consecrated ourselves for this sacrifice. This is eternal *dharma*. Do not commit an act of *adharma*. O king! You have been born in Atri’s lineage and there is no doubt that you are a Prajapati. You have taken an oath, ‘I will protect the subjects.’ All the *maharshis* spoke to him in this way. But Vena was evil in his intelligence. He pursued a perverse objective. He laughed and spoke to them. Vena said, ‘Other than me, who else is the creator of *dharma*? Other than me, who else needs to be heard? On earth, who else is my equal in learning, valour, austerities and truthfulness? I am the origin of all creatures. In particular, *dharma* flows from me. There is no doubt that you are foolish. You are insensible. Therefore, you do not know me. If I wish, I can burn down this earth, or flood it with water. I can obstruct the earth and heaven. There is no need to reflect about this.’ Since the lord of the earth was deluded about his strength, the *maharshis* were unable to dissuade Vena and became angry. The great-souled ones seized the immensely strong one, who began to tremble in rage, and kneaded his left thigh. As the king’s thigh was kneaded, from his rage, a man was born. He was extremely short and dark in complexion. O excellent *brahmanas*! He was terrified and stood there, hands joined in salutation. Seeing that he was confused, Atri, supreme among eloquent ones, told him, ‘Nishida’.⁹⁹ He was the founder of the lineage of *nishadas*.¹⁰⁰ *Dhivaras*¹⁰¹ were created from Vena’s sins. O *brahmanas*! Tusharas, Tunduras and others who reside in the Vindhya mountains and are addicted to *adharma*, were also born from Vena’s sins. Since those great souls were still angry, they next kneaded Vena’s right arm, like *arani*.’¹⁰²

‘Prithu was born from the hand and he blazed like the fire. His body was resplendent, just like a blazing fire. He wielded a bow, named Ajagava, that twanged extremely loudly with divine arrows. To protect him, he was clad in immensely radiant armour. When he was born, all the beings were delighted and assembled there. O immensely fortunate ones! Vena went to heaven. O *brahmanas*! Since a great-souled virtuous son had been born, the tiger among men was saved from the hell named *Put*.¹⁰³ The oceans and rivers arrived with all their jewels and all their waters so that he could be consecrated.¹⁰⁴ The illustrious grandfather arrived along with the gods, and those from the Angiras lineage. All the mobile and immobile beings arrived. Having arrived, they consecrated Vena’s son as the lord of men. The subjects were delighted with this great king.¹⁰⁵ Those who knew about *dharma* followed the rites and consecrated the immensely energetic one. The powerful Prithu, Vena’s son, became the lord of kings. The subjects were not as delighted with the father as they were with the son. Because of this delight, he came to be known as *Rajan*. As he advanced, the waters of the oceans were stupefied.¹⁰⁶ The mountains gave him right of way. His standard was not obstructed anywhere. Without being ploughed, the earth yielded crops. Indeed, there were crops when one thought of them. Cows yielded every kind of milk one desired. Every cup of a flower had honey. At this time, an auspicious sacrifice was held for the grandfather. On the day of *soutya*,¹⁰⁷ the immensely intelligent Suta was born as Suti’s son. Suta and Magadha were born from that great sacrifice. The *maharshis* summoned them, so that they could sing praises to Prithu. All the *rishis* said, ‘Chant praises to this king. This is an appropriate task for you and this lord of men is a worthy recipient.’ Suta and Magadha replied to all those *rishis*, ‘Through our deeds, we bring delight to gods and *rishis*. We do not know anything about his deeds, name, signs or fame. O *brahmanas*! How can we then sing praises of this spirited king?’ Because of what would occur in the future, the *rishis* engaged them in this task. The immensely strong Prithu would perform these deeds later. O excellent sages! Since that day, in the three worlds, *sutas*, *magadhas* and *bandis* have eulogized and pronounced benedictions. Prithu was extremely delighted by their praises. The lord of

subjects bestowed the region of Anupa on sutas and that of Magadha on *magadhas*.¹⁰⁸ On seeing that the subjects were greatly delighted, the learned people said, ‘This lord of men will grant you a means of subsistence.’ The subjects went to Vena’s great-souled son and said, ‘As the *maharshis* have said, please grant us a means of subsistence.’ All the subjects approached him in this way. Desiring the welfare of the subjects, the powerful one seized his bow and arrows and pursued the earth. The earth was scared of Vena’s son. She assumed the form of a cow and fled. As she fled, holding the bow, Prithu chased her. Scared of Vena’s son, she went to Brahma’s world, and all others. However, she saw Vena’s son standing in front of her, holding the bow. The sharp arrows blazed. He was resplendent in his energy and his aim was unwavering. His yoga was great and the great-souled one could not be assailed, even by the immortals. She did not find a way of saving herself from Vena’s son. Though she was herself worshipped by the three worlds, she joined her hands in salutation. She said, ‘O son of Vena! Do you not see that there is *adharma* in killing a woman? O king! Without me, how will you sustain the subjects? O king! The worlds are established in me. I am the one who holds up the universe. If I am destroyed, all the subjects will be destroyed. O lord of the earth! Please understand this. If you wish for welfare, you should not kill me. O protector of the earth! For the welfare of the subjects, listen to my words. If one thinks of good means, all objectives can be accomplished. Devise a means so that these subjects can be sustained. O lord of men! Even if you kill me, you will not be able to nurture the subjects. O immensely intelligent one! Control your rage and I will be kindly disposed towards you. It is said that even if they belong to inferior species, females must not be killed. O protector of the earth! Consider this. You should not abandon *dharma*.’ The great-minded king heard these and many other words. He possessed *dharma* in his soul. He controlled his rage and spoke to the earth.’¹⁰⁹

Prithu said, ‘For one’s own sake, or for others, if one kills a being, one commits a sin. If one kills many, there is a major sin. However, if a single inauspicious one is killed, many may obtain happiness. O fortunate one! In that case, there is neither a major sin, nor a minor sin. O Vasundhara! I was

going to kill you for the sake of the subjects. Unless you act in accordance with my words now, for the welfare of the universe, I will do that. If you turn away from my instructions now, I will kill you with my arrows. I will proclaim who I am and will nurture the subjects myself. O supreme among those who uphold *dharma*! Therefore, follow my commands. Revive all the subjects. You are capable of nurturing them. Become my daughter and I will take back the arrow, terrible to behold, that I have affixed for your destruction.’ Vasudha replied, ‘O brave one! There is no doubt that I will abide by everything you have instructed. Unite me with my calf, so that maternal affection makes my milk flow. O supreme among those who uphold *dharma*! Level me everywhere, so that the milk that flows spreads evenly everywhere.’ The mountains had increased in size and with the tip of his bow, Vena’s son levelled hundreds and thousands of mountains. During the earlier creation, the surface of the ground was uneven and there was no division of cities and villages. There were no crops. There was no animal husbandry. There was no agriculture. There were no routes for traders. There was no truth or falsehood. There was no avarice or envy. At the time of Vaivasvata *manvantara*, these manifested themselves. O *brahmanas*! Since the time of Vena’s son, all of these became apparent. O *brahmanas*! Wherever the ground was levelled in those regions, all the subjects started to construct their abodes. The food for subjects consisted of roots and fruits and we have heard that this was associated with great hardships. The powerful Prithu, Vena’s son and tiger among men, thought of the lord Svayambhu Manu as the calf and used his own hands to milk the earth. Even today, all the subjects sustain themselves on all the crops that resulted. O best among *brahmanas*! In those former times, the *rishis*, the gods, the ancestors, the reptiles, the *daityas*, the *yakshas*, the *punyjanas*, the *gandharvas*, the mountains and the trees also milked the earth. The milk, the calf, the vessel and the milkman were separate for each of them. For the *rishis*, Soma was the calf and Brihaspati was the milkman. O *brahmanas*! The milk was austerity and the metres ¹¹⁰ were the vessel. For the gods, gold was the vessel and Shatakratu ¹¹¹ was the milkman. The milk was that which gives energy and the milkman was the illustrious Ravi. ¹¹² For the ancestors,

silver was the vessel and the powerful Yama was the calf. The milkman was Antaka and the milk was said to be *sudha*.¹¹³ For the *nagas*, the calf was Takshaka and the vessel was that which is known as *alabu*.¹¹⁴ The milkman was *naga* Airavata and the milk is said to be poison. For the *asuras*, the milkman was Madhu and the milk is said to be *maya*.¹¹⁵ Virochana was the calf and the vessel was iron. For the *yakshas*, the vessel was an unbaked pot and lord Vaishravana was the calf. The milkman was Rajatanabha and the milk was *antardhana*.¹¹⁶ For the Indras among *rakshasas*, the calf was Sumali and the milk was blood. The milkman was Rajatanabha¹¹⁷ and the vessel was a skull. For the *gandharvas*, Chitraratha was the calf and the vessel was a lotus. The milkman was Suruchi and the milk is said to have been pure fragrance. For mountain ranges, the mountains were vessels and the milk was jewels and herbs. The Himalayas were the calf and the milkman was the giant mountain, Meru. For trees, the calf was Plaksha and the milkman was a *shala* tree¹¹⁸ in blossom. The vessel was the leaf of a *palasha* tree and the milk was the technique of growing crops after they have been cut or burnt. Vasundhara is Dhatri, Vidhatri and Pavani.¹¹⁹ She is the source and foundation for everything, mobile and immobile. She is the one who can be milked for all objects of desire. She is the one who leads to the growth of every kind of crop. The earth extends up to the ocean and is famous by the name of Medini. This is because she was flooded by the fat of Madhu and Kaitabha.¹²⁰ That is the reason those who know about the *brahman* speak of her as Goddess Medini. O *brahmanas*! She had an agreement with King Prithu, Vena's son. Therefore, the goddess became his daughter and came to be known as Prithvi.¹²¹ Prithu divided and purified the earth. She became full of crops and mines and became prosperous. She became full of cities and habitations. Such were the powers of the king who was Vena's son. He was supreme among kings. There is no doubt that all categories of beings should bow down before him and worship him. Immensely fortunate *brahmanas* who are accomplished in the Vedas and Vedangas should also bow down before Prithu. Since he originated from Brahma himself, he is eternal. The powerful Prithu, Vena's son, was the first king. Immensely fortunate kings who wish to be kings on earth should bow

down before him. The greatly famous one granted a means of subsistence. Valiant warriors who desire to be victorious in battle should bow down before the first king. If a warrior advances into battle after praising King Prithu, he undertakes deeds and emerges unscathed from battles that are terrible in form. He is the one who arranged for means of subsistence for *vaishyas*. Therefore, *vaishyas* should bow down before him. Pure shudras serve the three *varnas*. If they desire their supreme benefit, they too should bow down before Prithu. I have spoken to you about specific calves, milkmen, milk and vessels. What will I describe to you now?’

Chapter 1(3) (Description of manvantaras)

The sages said, ‘O Lomaharshana! O immensely intelligent one! Describe to us all the manvantaras, along with their former creations. O Suta! We wish to hear the truth about the Manus and about the duration of a *manvantara*.’

Lomaharshana replied, ‘O *brahmanas*! Even if I speak for hundreds of years, I am incapable of describing the manvantaras in detail. O *brahmanas*! Therefore, hear about them in brief. O *brahmanas*! The current Manu is said to be Vaivasvata. Before this, the Manus were Svayambhuva Manu, Svarochisha Manu, Uttama, Tamasa, Raivata and Chakshusha. Those in the future are said to be Savarni Manu, Raibhya, Rouchya and four Merusavarni Manus. O *brahmanas*! I have described the past, present and future Manus as I have heard them. I will tell you about their sons, the *rishis* and the categories of gods. Marichi, Atri, the illustrious Angiras, Pulaha, Kratu, Pulasya and Vasishtha—these seven were Brahma’s sons. O *brahmanas*! These were the saptarshis in the northern direction.

Svayambhuva Manu had ten immensely energetic sons—Agnidhra, Agnibahu, Medhya, Medhatithi, Vasu, Jyotishman, Dyutiman and Havya.¹²²

O *brahmanas*! I have, thus, spoken to you about the first *manvantara*. O *brahmanas*! Ourva, Vasishtha’s son, Stamba, Kashyapa, Prana, Brihaspati, Datta, Atri and Chyavana—Vayu has spoken of these *maharshis* as being great in their vows.¹²³ During Svarochisha *manvantara*, the gods are said to be named Tushitas. O *brahmanas*! Havighna, Sukriti, Jyoti, Apa, Murti, Pratita, Nabhasya, Nabha and Urja—these are said to have been the great-souled Svarochisha Manu’s sons.¹²⁴ These immensely brave and valiant ones are spoken of as the lords of the earth. O *brahmanas*! I have described the second *manvantara* to you. O supreme *brahmanas*! I will now speak to

you about the third. Vasishtha had seven sons who were famous as the Vaasishthas. Hiranyagarbha had extremely energetic sons and they were named the Urjas. I have spoken to you about the *rishis*.¹²⁵ Now hear what I describe. O best among sages! Uttama Manu had ten sons—Isha, Urja, Tanurja, Madhu, Madhava, Shuchi, Shukra, Saha, Nabhasya and Nabha. The gods were the Bhanus. This *manvantara* has been spoken about. I will now speak to you about the fourth *manvantara*. O supreme *brahmanas*! Kavya, Prithu, Agni, Jahnu, Dhata, Kapivan and Akapivan—these were the *saptarshis* then. O *brahmanas*! The Puranas have spoken about their sons and grandsons as having been excellent *brahmanas*. O *brahmanas*! During the *manvantara* of Tamasa Manu, the categories of gods were known as the Satyas. Tamasa Manu's ten sons are described as Dyuti, Tapasya, Sutapa, Tapobhuta, Sanatana, Taporati, Akalmasha, Tanvi, Dhanvi and Parantapa. O best among sages! This is what Vayu said about the *manvantara* that came after the fourth. Devabahu, Yadudhra, the sage Vedashira, Hiranyaroma, Parjanya, Soma's son Urdhvabahu and Atri's son Satyanetra—these were the *saptarshis* in this next *manvantara*. The gods during this *manvantara* were said to be the Abhuktajas, Prakritis, Pariplavas and Raibhyas. Now listen to me and know about his sons. During the fifth *manvantara*, Raivata Manu's sons were Dhritiman, Avyaya, Yukta, Tattvadarshi, Nirutsuka, Aranya, Prakasha, Nirmoha, Satyavak and Kriti. O supreme among *brahmanas*! I will now tell you about the sixth. Understand. Bhrigu, Nabha, Vivasvat, Sudhama, Viraja, Atinama and Sahishnu—these were the seven *maharshis*. O *brahmanas*! O sages! During Chakshusha *manvantara*, the five categories of gods, residents of heaven, are said to have been named Aprabhutas, Prithakas and Lekhas.¹²⁶ All of these great-souled and immensely energetic ones were the sons of *rishi* Angiras. O *brahmanas*! O best among sages! During Chakshusha *manvantara*, Manu's ten sons, born through Nangvala, were Ruru and others.¹²⁷ The sixth *manvantara* has been spoken about. Now understand the seventh. The *saptarshis* in the firmament now are Atri, Vasishtha, the great *rishi* Kashyapa, Goutama from the Bharadvaja lineage, Vishvamitra, and as the seventh, Jamadagni, the son of the illustrious and great-souled Richika. The gods during the current

Vaivasvata *manvantara* of Vaivasvata Manu are said to be Sadhyas, Rudra, Vishvas, ¹²⁸ Vasus, Maruts, Adityas and the two gods, the Ashvins, who are the sons of Vivasvat. The ten sons of the great-souled one ¹²⁹ are Ikshvaku and the others. O *brahmanas*! The immensely energetic *maharshis* have been described. Their sons and grandsons are present in all the directions. In each of the manvantaras, seven groups of seven ¹³⁰ are famous as those who establish *dharma* in the worlds and protect the worlds. When a *manvantara* is over, having accomplished their tasks, four of the seven categories go to heaven. ¹³¹ They go to Brahma's world, where there is no disease. Others, who are full of austerities, take their places. O *brahmanas*! This is the order of the past and the present. In the future manvantaras, the seven *maharshis* who will be in the firmament have been spoken about. O *brahmanas*! When Savarni *manvantara* presents itself, they will be Rama, Vyasa and Atreya, who are radiant and extremely learned. The others will be the extremely radiant Ashvatthama, descended from Bharadvaja and Drona's son; Sharadvat Goutama, ¹³² descended from Goutama, who does not age; Galava, descended from Koushika; and Ourva, descended from Kashyapa. O supreme among sages! Savarni Manu's sons will be Vairi, Adhvariva, Shamana, Dhritiman, Vasu, Arishta, Adhrishta, Vaji and Sumati. O bulls among *brahmanas*! These seven great-souled ones will be brave. ¹³³ If a man gets up at the right time and chants their names, he obtains happiness and fame and an extremely long lifespan. In truth, each of them is associated with seven times seven. ¹³⁴ Hear briefly about the future manvantaras. O *brahmanas*! There are five Savarni Manus. ¹³⁵ Understand them. O *brahmanas*! Vaivasvata is only one of them. ¹³⁶ Prajapati Parameshthi had four sons who were as golden as Meru. These kings were Daksha's grandsons, the sons of his daughter, Priya. These extremely energetic ones are engaged in great austerity on the slopes of Mount Meru. Ruchi had a son named Rouchya Manu. Through goddess Bhuti, Ruchi had a son named Bhoutya. In this *kalpa*, these are said to be the future seven Manus. O supreme *brahmanas*! For an entire one thousand yugas, they will protect the earth, with its seven *dvipas* and habitations. Because of Prajapati's austerities, destruction will always occur. This is said to happen

after a little more than seventy-one yugas, divided into *krita*, *treta* and the others. During the manvantaras, fourteen Manus are spoken about and they extend their fame. The Vedas and Puranas describe all of them as possessing powers. O *brahmanas*! They are Prajapatis and one should chant about these blessed ones! When the manvantaras are over, there is destruction. When destruction is over, there is creation. Even if I speak for hundreds of years, I am incapable of speaking about the ultimate end of this process of creation and destruction of subjects. O *brahmanas*! O supreme among *brahmanas*! It has been heard that, at the end of a *manvantara*, since they possess austerities, *brahmacharya* and learning, the gods and the *saptarshis* remain. However, when one thousand yugas pass, the *kalpa* is said to be over. At that time, all beings are burnt down by the rays of the sun. Placing Brahma at the forefront, the large number of Adityas and *brahmanas* enter Lord Hari Narayana, the best among the gods. At the end of a *kalpa*, he is the one who repeatedly creates beings. He is not manifest. He is eternal. Everything in the universe belongs to that divinity. I will now tell you about Vaivasvata Manu. O tigers among sages! It is the creation of the immensely radiant one that has now presented itself. In this connection, I will speak to you about an ancient Vrishni lineage, where the great-souled Lord Hari was born.

Chapter 1(4) (Aditya's origin)

Lomaharshana said, 'O excellent *brahmanas*! Vivasvat was born through Kashyapa and Dakshayani. ¹³⁷ Goddess Samjna was Tvashta's daughter and was Vivasvat's wife. The beautiful one was famous in the three worlds as the goddess of all the gods. She was the wife of the great-souled Martanda. ¹³⁸ She possessed beauty and youth, but was not satisfied with her husband's form. She was named Samjna and she was extremely resplendent because of her own austerity. Aditya's form was such that his disc was full of energy. It burnt her body and she did not find this form to be very agreeable. He was known as Martanda because of a reason. When he was in the womb, Kashyapa had inadvertently spoken some affectionate words. 'I hope the fetus is not dead.' ¹³⁹ Vivasvat, Kashyapa's son, always possessed an excess of energy. Because of this, the three worlds were greatly scorched. O *brahmanas*! The foremost among those who were scorched had three children through Samjna. Aditya had two Prajapatis as sons, and a daughter. The first was Vaivasvata Manu, the Prajapati who was Shraddhadeva earlier. Thereafter, there were two twins—Yama and Yamuna. Samjna saw that Vivasvat's form was dark in complexion and could not tolerate it. Samjna created an illusory form out of her shadow that was exactly like her in appearance. O supreme among *brahmanas*! When Chhaya ¹⁴⁰ arose, she joined her hands in salutation and bowed down. Chhaya asked Samjna, 'O one with the beautiful smiles! What is my task? Tell me. I am standing before you. O one with the beautiful complexion! Command and instruct me.' Samjna replied, 'O fortunate one! I am leaving for my father's residence. Without any hesitation, reside here, in my own house. O slender-waisted one! I have these two sons and a daughter. O illustrious one! O auspicious one! Never let it be known that they are not

your children.’ Savarna ¹⁴¹ said, ‘O goddess! I will do that as long as I am not seized by the heir nor cursed. If that happens, I will reveal the truth. O goddess! I bow down to you. Go as you please.’ She instructed Savarna, and Savarna agreed. The ascetic lady went to Tvashta, as if she was ashamed. ¹⁴² When she reached her father, her father reprimanded the auspicious one. He repeatedly urged her to return to her husband’s presence. At this, the unblemished one assumed the form of a mare. She went to the Uttara Kuru region and started to graze on the grass there.’

‘Aditya took the second Samjna to be the original Samjna. O *brahmanas*! Through her, he had a son who was exactly like his own self. This lord was like his elder brother, Manu, ¹⁴³ and was named Savarna. ¹⁴⁴ There was a second son, known as Shanaishchara. O *brahmanas*! Samjna behaved like an ordinary mortal woman and loved her own sons more than their elder brothers. Manu ¹⁴⁵ forgave this, but Yama was incapable of doing so. He was angry. And because of his childish sentiments, Vaivasvata Yama innocently raised his leg to kick Samjna. Savarna’s mother was extremely upset at this and cursed him angrily. ‘May your leg fall down.’ Yama was extremely scared and anxious because of the curse. Samjna’s words also made him suspicious. He went to his father, joined his hands in salutation and reported everything. O *brahmanas*! He told his father, ‘Let this curse be taken back. A mother should always be affectionate towards all her sons. O Vivasvat! But she wishes to deprive us of everything. I raised my leg towards her, I did not bring it down on her body. I may have been agitated. I may have been deluded. But I am a child. I should be pardoned. O lord of the worlds! O supreme among those who scorch! I have been cursed by her. O lord of the rays! Through your favours, let my leg not fall down.’ Vivasvat replied, ‘O son! O one who knows about dharma! O one who is truthful in speech! There was no doubt a grave reason for you to succumb to rage. However, I am incapable of rendering your mother’s words false. Worms will seize flesh from your foot and it will fall on the ground. In that way, your mother’s words will come true. However, you will be saved from the terrible effects of the curse.’ Aditya spoke to Samjna. ‘How is it that you display more affection towards one son than towards the others?’ She

avoided the answer and did not tell Vivasvat. At this, he meditated in yoga and discerned the truth. O supreme among sages! The illustrious one was about to curse and destroy her. At this, she told Vivasvat everything, exactly as it had happened. Hearing this, Vivasvat became angry and went to Tvashta. He worshipped Vibhavasū,¹⁴⁶ who wished to burn him down in rage in the proper way and pacify him. Tvashta said, ‘Since you possess an excess of energy, this form of yours is not desired and is not handsome. Unable to tolerate it, Samjna is now grazing in a pasture in the forest. Your wife is auspicious in conduct and you will see her today. O lord of the rays! You are praised because of the strength of your yoga. Resort to yoga. O god! O scorcher of enemies! If you pay heed to my words and honour them, I will pare down your form and make it handsome.’ When Martanda Vivasvat agreed to this, he placed him on his wheel and sliced off some of the energy. When the energy was reduced, his form could be tolerated. It became even more handsome, even more resplendent.’

‘Resorting to yoga, he saw his own wife in the form of a mare. Because of her energy and rituals, no being had been able to assail her. O *brahmanas*! Without any fear, she was roaming around in the form of a mare. The illustrious one also assumed the form of a horse. Suspecting that he was someone else’s husband seeking to have intercourse, she faced him.¹⁴⁷ Vivasvat’s semen entered her through her nostrils. Two gods were born from this and they were the two Ashvins, supreme among physicians. These two Ashvins are known as Nasatya and Dasra. They were the sons of the eighth Prajapati, Martanda. Bhaskara¹⁴⁸ revealed his handsome form to her. O supreme among sages! On seeing this, she was satisfied with her husband. Because of what he had done, Yama suffered a lot in his mind. As Dharmaraja, he delighted the subjects by practising *dharma*. Because of these auspicious deeds, he became extremely radiant. He became a guardian of the world, with lordship over the ancestors. O stores of austerities! When Savarni *manvantara* arrives, Savarni Manu will be a Manu and a Prajapati. Even today, he is roaming around on the slopes of Meru in austerity. His brother, Shanaishchara¹⁴⁹ obtained the status of becoming a planet. Through the energy that was shaved off, Tvashta fashioned Vishnu’s *chakra*. When it

wishes to destroy *danavas*, it can never be repulsed in a battle. Yami ¹⁵⁰ was the illustrious youngest daughter. She became Yamuna, the best among rivers, a nurturer of the worlds. The second son was Manu's brother, Shanaishchara. He obtained the status of a planet and is worshipped by all the worlds. If a person hears about this birth of gods and remembers it, he is freed from all calamities and obtains great fame.'

Chapter 1(5) (Aditya's lineage)

Lomaharshana said, 'O supreme among sages! Vaivasvata Manu had nine sons who were his equals—Ikshvaku, Nabhaga, Dhrishta, Sharyati, Narishyanta, Pramshu as the sixth, Rishta as the seventh, Karusha, and Prishadhra as the ninth. O *brahmanas*! Prior to this, in a desire to obtain sons, the immensely intelligent Prajapati Manu had performed a sacrifice to Mitra and Varuna. O *brahmanas*! This is because he had still not obtained these many sons. O best among *brahmanas*! It has been said that Ila, divine in form, was born from this, attired in divine garments and adorned with divine ornaments. Manu, wielder of the staff, ¹⁵¹ addressed her as Ila and told her, 'O fortunate one! Follow me.' Prajapati was full of *dharma* and desired a son. Ila replied to him in the following words, 'O supreme among eloquent ones! I have been born from Mitra and Varuna's portions. I will go to them. Do not act so as to violate my *dharma*.' Having addressed Lord Manu in this way, Ila went to Mitra and Varuna. The one with the beautiful hips joined her hands in salutation and addressed them in these words, 'O gods! I have been born from your portions. What shall I do for you? Manu has asked me to follow him.' Ila was virtuous and devoted to *dharma*. O supreme among *brahmanas*! When she addressed them in this way, Mitra and Varuna replied. 'O one with the excellent loins! O one who is beautiful in complexion! We are pleased with your *dharma*, humility, self-control and truthfulness. O immensely fortunate one! You will become famous as our daughter. You will become Manu's son and will extend his lineage. You will be known as Sudyumna and will be famous in the three worlds. You will be devoted to *dharma* and the world will love you. You will extend Manu's lineage.' Having heard this, she was returning to her father's ¹⁵² presence. At that time, Budha met her and invited her to have intercourse with him. O

brahmanas! Budha was Soma's son, and Pururava was born as a result of this union. ¹⁵³

'After giving birth to him, Ila turned into Sudyumna. As Sudyumna, he had three sons who were extremely devoted to *dharma*. O *brahmanas*! They were Utkala, Gaya and Vinatashva. O *brahmanas*! Utkala was given the land of Utkala and Vinatashva was given the western region. O tigers among sages! It is said that Gaya was given the eastern region, the land of Gaya. O *brahmanas*! Manu, the son of the sun, was a scorcher of enemies. He again divided the earth into ten sections that needed to be protected. Ikshaku, the eldest son, obtained the central region. Since he had been a woman earlier, Sudyumna did not obtain a kingdom. However, on Vasishtha's words, the great-souled one was established in Pratishtana. ¹⁵⁴ Dhrishnuka, Ambarisha and Dandaka obtained equal shares. ¹⁵⁵ The excellent forest of Dandaka ¹⁵⁶ was named after the famous and great-souled one. As soon as a man enters that place, he is freed from sins. O *brahmanas*! After obtaining these sons, Ila-Sudyumna went to heaven. O supreme among *brahmanas*! Thus, where there was *dharma*, Sudyumna's kingdom was established. Having obtained the kingdom, the immensely illustrious one gave it to Pururava. O best among sages! He was Manu's son, with the traits of both a man and a woman. The kingdoms are known as those of both Ila and Sudyumna. O *brahmanas*! The sons of Narishyanta were the Shakas. O *brahmanas*! The excellent Ambarisha, a bull among kings, was the son of Nabhaga. Dhrishta's sons were the Dharshtaka *kshatriyas*, proud in battle. Karusha's sons were the Karusha *kshatriyas*, indomitable in battle. The sons of Nabhaga and Dhrishta were originally *kshatriyas*, but later became *vaishyas*. Pramshu had a single son and he is known as a Prajapati. Narishyanta's son was King Yama, the wielder of the staff. ¹⁵⁷ Sharyati had twins. The son was famous as Anarta and the daughter was Sukanya, Chyavana's wife. Anarta's immensely radiant son was named Raiva. In the kingdom of Anarta, his city was Kushasthali. ¹⁵⁸ Raiva's son was Raivata. He was devoted to *dharma* and he was also known by the name of Kakudmi. As the eldest son, he obtained the kingdom of Kushasthali. With his daughter, he went to Brahma to listen to the music of

the *gandharvas*. O *brahmanas*! This was only one instant for the gods, but many *yugas* on earth. When he returned to his own city, it was full of Yadavas. They had created the beautiful city of Dvaravati, one with many gates. ¹⁵⁹ He bestowed his daughter Revati, who was excellent in her vows, on Baladeva. ¹⁶⁰ Having bestowed her, he went to Mount Meru to perform austerity. Rama, with *dharma* in his soul, happily enjoyed himself with Revati.'

The sages asked, 'O immensely intelligent one! Though a period of many *yugas* had passed, how is it that Revati and Raivata Kakudmi did not suffer from old age? If Sharyati's descendant ¹⁶¹ went to Meru, how is it that his descendants are still here on earth? We wish to hear the truth about this.'

Lomaharshana replied, 'O excellent sages! O unblemished ones! Old age, hunger, thirst, death and the cycle of the seasons never have influence over those in Brahma's world. O *brahmanas*! When Raivata Kakdumi went to heaven, Kushashtali was destroyed by *punyajanas* and *rakshasas*. The great-souled one, ¹⁶² devoted to *dharma*, had one hundred brothers. However, slaughtered by the *rakshasas*, they fled in different directions. O Indras among *brahmanas*! O excellent *brahmanas*! Having run away, those one hundred brothers established great lineages elsewhere. O best among sages! They are famous as the Sharyatas. Possessing the qualities of *kshatriyas*, they are famous in all the directions. All those immensely energetic ones entered dense forests. Nabhaga and Rishta's two sons were originally *vaishyas*, but they later became *brahmanas*. ¹⁶³ Karusha's sons were the *kshatriyas* known as Karushas, and they were indomitable in battle. O excellent *brahmanas*! Prishadhra caused injury to a cow that belonged to his guru. Because of this, he was cursed that he would become a shudra. O excellent sages! The nine sons of Vaisvasvata Manu have, thus, been described to you. O *brahmanas*! When Manu sneezed, Ikshvaku was born as a son. ¹⁶⁴ Ikshvaku had one hundred sons who distributed copious amounts of *dakshina*. Among them, Vikukshi was the eldest and he was full of valour. He was supreme in his knowledge of *dharma* and he obtained the position of the lord of Ayodhya. He is said to have had five hundred sons, Shakuni being the foremost. Those immensely strong ones protected the

region of Uttarapatha. ¹⁶⁵ There were fifty-eight kingdoms in the southern direction. O excellent *brahmanas*! Shashada and the others protected these. On the day of *ashtaka*, ¹⁶⁶ Ikshvaku instructed Vikukshi, ‘O immensely strong one! For the sake of a *shraddha* ceremony, ¹⁶⁷ kill a hare and bring its flesh.’ O *brahmanas*! He was instructed to do this for a *shraddha* rite, so he hunted a hare. However, while it had not yet been offered at the *shraddha* ceremony, he ate its flesh and came to be known as Shashada. ¹⁶⁸ Following Vasishtha’s words, Lord Ikshvaku exiled him. O *brahmanas*! When Ikshvaku died, Shashada was instated as the king. Shashada’s valiant son was known by the name of Kakutstha. Kakutstha’s son was Anena and Anena’s son is said to have been Prithu. ¹⁶⁹ Prithu’s son was Virashva and Virashva’s son was Ardra. O *brahmanas*! Ardra’s son was Yuvanashva and Yuvanashva’s son was Shrava. This is the king who constructed Shravasti. ¹⁷⁰ Shrava had King Brihadashva as his son. Brihadashva’s son was Kuvalashva, who was extremely devoted to *dharma*. Having killed Dhundhu, the king obtained the name of Dhundhumara.’

The sages said, ‘O immensely wise one! We wish to hear the truth about the slaying of Dhundhu. How did Kuvalashva become Dhundhumara?’

Lomaharshana replied, ‘Kuvalashva had one hundred sons who were archers. They were accomplished in all kinds of learning. They were powerful and impossible to assail. All of them followed *dharma*. All of them performed sacrifices in which copious quantities of *dakshina* were given. Brihadashva instated his son Kuvalashva in the kingdom. After transferring the prosperity to his son, the king wanted to enter the forest. However, when he was about to leave, the brahmana *rishi*, Utanka, restrained him. Utanka, said, ‘Your task is to protect, and you should perform that task. O lord of the earth! I am unable to perform my austerity without anxiety. The plain of the desert is near my hermitage. This is an ocean that is full of sand and is known by the name of Uddalaka. There is an extremely terrible *asura*, Dhundhu, and he is the son of *rakshasa* Madhu. He is gigantic in size and immensely strong. He cannot be slain by the gods. He hides himself inside the earth, in the vast territory that is covered with sand. To destroy the worlds, he lies down there and practises terrible

austerity. O lord of men! He exhales his breath after an entire year and at those times, the earth trembles. A great dust arises from the wind, created by his breath. The path of the sun is obstructed and the earth trembles for an entire week. There are sparks from the coal and there is an extremely terrible smoke. O son! Because of this, I am incapable of remaining in my hermitage. For the welfare of the worlds, slay the one who is gigantic in form. When he is killed by you now, the worlds will be comforted. O lord of the earth! You alone are capable of slaying him. O king! Vishnu had granted me a boon in an earlier yuga. Thanks to that, you will be able to kill that immensely strong, fierce and gigantic asura. Because of the boon, you will be permeated by that energy. ¹⁷¹ O lord of the earth! A little bit of energy is incapable of withstanding Dhundhu's great energy. Even if the person tries for a long period of one hundred yugas, he will only be burnt down. His valour is so great that even the gods are incapable of withstanding him.' The great-souled Utanka spoke in this way to the *rajarshi*. ¹⁷² For Dhundhu's destruction, he offered him his son, Kuvalashva. Brihadashva said, 'O illustrious one! O best among *brahmanas*! I have laid down my weapons. But there is no doubt that this son of mine will become Dhundhumara.' Having instructed his son to kill Dhundhu, the *rajarshi* left for the mountains, firm in his vows.

'O *brahmanas*! To kill Dhundhu, with his one hundred sons, King Kuvalashva left with Utanka. On Utanka's invocation and for the welfare of the worlds, the illustrious Lord Vishnu's energy entered his body. As the invincible one advanced, a loud voice was heard from the firmament. 'This handsome one will become Dhundumara now.' All the directions were covered with divine fragrances and garlands. Divine drums were loudly sounded. The valiant one, best among victorious ones, advanced with his sons. On reaching, he began to dig the extensive ocean of sand. O *brahmanas*! His sons dug and discovered Dhundhu hidden inside the sand, enveloping the western direction. Flames issued from his mouth and he seemed to whirl the worlds around in his rage. O tigers among sages! Torrents of water issued, as if from the great ocean. It was as if large waves of water had been stirred by the rising of the moon. Leaving aside three, the

rakshasa burnt down the one hundred sons. At this, wishing to destroy Dhundhu, the immensely energetic and radiant king approached the immensely strong *rakshasa* Dhundhu. The lord of men, who was a yogi, resorted to yoga. He stemmed the force of the water, drank it up, and then used the water to quench the fire. He slew the gigantic *rakshasa*, whose strength was in the water. The lord of men then showed Utanka what he had done. Utanka granted a boon to the great-souled king. He would possess inexhaustible riches and would not be vanquished by the enemy. He would always be devoted to *dharma* and would have an eternal residence in heaven. The sons who had been killed by the *rakshasa* would obtain undecaying worlds in heaven.

‘Of the three sons who survived, Dridhashva is said to have been the eldest. Chandrashva and Kapilashva were the two younger princes. Dhundhumara’s son, Dridhashva, is said to have had a son named Haryashva. Haryashva’s son was Nikumbha, always devoted to the *dharma* of *kshatriyas*. O *brahmanas*! Nikumbha’s son, Samhatashva was accomplished in battle, and Akrishashva and Krishashva were Samhatashva’s sons. His ¹⁷³ daughter was Haimavati, famous as Dhrishadvati. She had a son named Prasenajit, famous in the three worlds. Prasenajit obtained a wife named Gouri, who was devoted to her husband. Cursed by her husband, she became the river Bahuda. His ¹⁷⁴ son was the great king, Yuvanashva. Yuvanashva’s son was Mandhata, who conquered the three worlds. His wife was Chaitrarathi and her son was Shashabindu. The virtuous lady was also known as Bindumati and her beauty was unsurpassed on earth. She was devoted to her husband, and she had ten thousand younger brothers. O *brahmanas*! Through her, Mandhata had two sons—Purukutsa, who knew about *dharma*, and King Muchukunda. Purukutsa had a son named Trasadasyu, who was a lord of the earth. Through Narmada, he ¹⁷⁵ had a son named Sambhuta. Sambhuta had a son named Sudhanva, who was the afflicter of enemies. Sudhanva, afflicter of enemies, had Tridhanva as a son. King Tridhanva had the learned lord, Trayyaruna, as a son. Trayyaruna had an extremely strong son named Satyavrata. However, he was evil-minded. He abducted and married a lady

who had already been married to someone else, thus violating the *mantras* of marriage. He was driven by childishness, desire, delusion, rashness and fickleness. In his desire, he abducted a maiden who belonged to someone else in the city. Scared of *adharma*, Trayyaruna abandoned him, and spoke many words of censure in rage. Thus, addressed and abandoned by his father, he repeatedly asked, ‘Where will I go?’ His father told him, ‘Dwell with *shvapakas*.¹⁷⁶ O worst of the lineage! I no longer desire descendants through a son like you.’ Thus addressed, he followed his father’s words and left the city, and the illustrious *rishi* Vasishtha did not restrain him. O *brahmanas*! Abandoned by his father, the brave Satyavrata began to dwell near *shvapakas*. His father left for the forest. O *brahmanas*! Because of that *adharma*,¹⁷⁷ for twelve years, the chastiser of Paka did not bring rain to that kingdom. At that time, the great ascetic, Vishvamitra had left his wife in that kingdom and had gone to the shores of the ocean to perform great austerity. To sustain the lives of the other sons, his wife tied a noose around the neck of the son in the middle, offering to sell him in exchange for one hundred cows. O *brahmanas*! The prince,¹⁷⁸ with *dharma* in his soul, saw that the *maharshi*’s son was being offered for sale with a noose round his neck, and freed him. To satisfy Vishvamitra, and out of compassion, the mighty-armed Satyavrata sustained them. Because he had been bound at the neck, *maharshi* Koushika’s son became the intelligent and great ascetic, Galava, and he was freed by that brave one.’¹⁷⁹

Chapter 1(6) (Aditya's lineage continued)

Lomaharshana said, 'Because of compassion and pledge, the illustrious Satyavrata humbly sustained Vishvamitra's wife. He slew deer, boar and buffaloes that roamed around in the forest and tied their flesh to a tree near Vishvamitra's hermitage. For a period of twelve years, he initiated himself into observing the *upamshu vrata*.¹⁸⁰ He did this because he had been asked to do so by his father. When the king left for the forest, the official priest, Vasishtha protected Ayodhya, the kingdom and the inner quarters. O unblemished ones! Because he was childish, or because this was inevitable, Satyavrata always possessed excessive intolerance towards Vasishtha. When his father had cast away his beloved son from the kingdom, sage Vasishtha had not restrained him. This was the reason. The *mantras* of marriage are completed when seven steps have been taken together. But Satyavrata did not allow these seven steps to be completed.¹⁸¹ O *brahmanas*! 'Vasishtha knows *dharma*. However, he did not save me.' These were the thoughts and rage Satyavrata harboured towards Vasishtha. The intelligent Vasishtha had used his intelligence to evaluate the qualities before determining action. But Satyavrata did not understand this secret reason. This was the reason he was dissatisfied with his great-souled father. The chastiser of Paka did not shower for twelve years. 'He has initiated himself into a vow that will be extremely difficult to observe on earth now. If he is able to follow this great vow, he will save his lineage. I will, thereafter, instate this son in the kingdom.' This was the view of the sage and that was the reason why the illustrious Vasishtha did not restrain his father from abandoning him. The powerful one observed that great vow for twelve years.'

‘There was a time when flesh could not be obtained, and the prince saw the great-souled Vasishtha’s cow, which was capable of yielding milk to satisfy every object of desire. O supreme sages! Overcome by anger, delusion, exhaustion, hunger and *adharma*, the king slew it. He ate the flesh himself, and fed it to Vishvamitra’s sons too. On hearing that he had fed them this, Vasishtha was enraged. Vasishtha said, ‘O cruel one! Even if you had not committed two more sins again, I would have brought you down because of this sin. Failing to satisfy your father, slaying a cow that belongs to your preceptor, and intercourse with someone you should not have intercourse with—these are the three sins you have committed.’ Because of the three sins he had witnessed, the great ascetic addressed him as Trishanku, and he came to be known as Trishanku.¹⁸² Vishvamitra returned and saw that his wife had been sustained. Delighted with Trishanku, the sage granted him a boon. The prince told his preceptor about the boon he desired, ‘Let me go to heaven in my physical body.’ The fear resulting from twelve years of drought was over. While the gods and Vasishtha looked on, sage Koushika performed a sacrifice and instated him in the kingdom. The great ascetic also made him ascend to heaven in his own physical body. His wife was named Satyaratha and she was born in the Kekaya lineage. She gave birth to an unsullied son, Harishchandra. King Harishchandra was known as Traishankava.¹⁸³ He performed a royal sacrifice and was renowned as an emperor. Harishchandra’s son was the king named Rohita. Rohita’s son was Harita and Harita’s son is said to have been Chanchu. O best among sages! Chanchu had a son named Vijaya. Since he conquered the entire earth, he was known as Vijaya.¹⁸⁴ His son was Ruruka, who knew about the *artha* and *dharma* of kings. Ruruka’s son was Vrika and Vrika gave birth to Bahu. The Haihayas and Talajanghas dislodged this king¹⁸⁵ and his pregnant wife took refuge in Ourva’s hermitage. Though he was born in a yuga of *dharma*, he was not excessively devoted to *dharma*.¹⁸⁶ Therefore, this king was driven away by the Haihayas and the Talajanghas. Bahu had a son named Sagara and he was born with poison.¹⁸⁷ He resorted to Ourva’s hermitage and was protected by Bhargava.¹⁸⁸ King Sagara obtained the *agneya* weapon from Bhargava and having slain the

Talajanghas and the Haihayas, conquered the earth. O best among sages! The undecaying one knew about *dharma* and restrained the *dharma*, followed by Shakas, Pahlavas, Paradas and other *kshatriyas*.'

The sages asked, 'Why was he born with poison in the forest? How did the angry and undecaying king destroy the *dharma* followed by Shakas and other immensely energetic *kshatriyas*? O immensely wise one! Tell us everything about this in detail.'

Lomaharshana replied, 'O best among *brahmanas*! Bahu indulged in vices and his kingdom was seized by the Haihayas and the Talajanghas, accompanied by the Shakas, Yavanas, Paradas, Kambojas and Pahlavas. These five categories contributed their valour for the sake of the Haihayas. With his kingdom having been seized, King Bahu left for the forest. He gave up his life there. His miserable wives followed him there. One of these was born in the Yadava lineage. Though she was expecting, she followed him. O unblemished ones! Her co-wife had given her some poison earlier. Having prepared her husband's funeral pyre in the forest, she got ready to ascend it. O *brahmanas*! However, overcome by compassion, Bhargava Ourva restrained her. She went to his hermitage and the embryo and the poison were delivered there. Thus, the mighty-armed king, Sagara was born. The great-souled Ourva performed his birth and other rites. He taught him the Vedas and sacred texts and gave him weapons. The immensely fortunate one gave him the *agneya* weapon, difficult for even the immortals to withstand. Because of the strength of these weapons, he became powerful. He swiftly slew the Haihayas, like an enraged Rudra among the animals. The supreme among renowned ones spread his fame throughout the world. The king decided that he would annihilate the Shakas, Yavanas, Kambojas, Paradas and Pahlavas. Slaughtered by the great-souled and brave Sagara, they sought refuge with the learned Vasishtha and bowed down before him. On seeing them, the immensely radiant Vasishtha subjected them to a pledge. He granted them freedom from fear and restrained Sagara. Sagara followed his preceptor's words, and the pledge he himself made. Having destroyed their *dharma*, he altered their attire and adornments. He shaved half of the heads of the Shakas and released them. He shaved entire

heads of the Yavanas and did the same for the Kambojas. He made the Paradas wear their hair loose and made the Pahlavas sport beards. The great-souled one robbed them of studies and *vashatkara*. O supreme *brahmanas*! The Shakas, Yavanas, Kambojas, Paradas, Kalasarpas, Mahishakas, Daryas, Cholas and Keralas were all *kshatriyas*. But because of the great-souled Vasishtha's command, Sagara took their *dharma* away from them. The king conquered them through *dharma*. He conquered the earth. Consecrating himself in a horse sacrifice, he made the horse wander around. While the horse was wandering along the south-eastern shores of the ocean, it was stolen and taken inside the earth. The king's sons began to dig in that region. As they dug in that spot along the great ocean, they came upon the original Purusha, God Hari Krishna Prajapati Vishnu sleeping in the human form of Kapila. O best among sages! As he awoke, the energy from his eyes burnt down all the sons, barring four. O king! These were Barhiketu, Suketu, King Dharmaratha and the brave Panchanada—kings who would extend the lineage. The illustrious Hari Narayana granted them the boon that the fame of the lineage of Ikshvaku would be without decay and would never fade, that the ocean would be known as the lord's son, and that he would dwell in heaven for eternity.¹⁸⁹ The ocean brought *arghya*¹⁹⁰ and worshipped the king, thus obtaining the name of Sagara because of his deeds.¹⁹¹ From the ocean, he also obtained the horse meant for the horse sacrifice. We have heard that the extremely illustrious one performed one hundred horse sacrifices and had sixty thousand sons.'

The sages asked, 'O Sutaja!¹⁹² How were those sixty thousand immensely strong valiant and brave sons born to Sagara? What was the method?'

Lomaharshana replied, 'Sagara had two wives and they destroyed their sins through austerities. The elder was named Keshini and she was the daughter of Vidarbha. The younger wife was Mahati. She was Arishtanemi's daughter and was extremely devoted to *dharma*. She was unmatched in beauty on earth. O supreme among *brahmanas*! Ourva granted them both a boon. Understand what it was. 'One of you ascetic ladies can accept a boon of sixty thousand sons. The other one can desire

the boon of a single son who will extend the lineage.’ So one of them accepted the boon of sixty thousand ones, the other the boon of a single son who would extend the lineage. The sage agreed to this. Through Keshini, Sagara had a son named Panchajana. The immensely radiant King Asamanja was Sagara’s descendant through him. It is in the sacred texts that the other gave birth to a bottle gourd that was full of seeds. Like sesamum, there were sixty thousand in that fetus that cheerfully began to grow, waiting for the right time. O *brahmanas*! Each of these was immersed in a pot that was full of ghee and the king appointed a maid to take care of each. In the course of time, ten months passed and at the right time, sons who extended Sagara’s delight were born. In this way, the lord of the earth had sixty thousand sons who were born from the seeds of the gourd. Through Narayana’s energy having penetrated, the king also had a great-souled son, named Panchajana. Panchajana’s son was the valiant Amshuman. His son was Dilipa, famous as Khatvanga. He ascended to heaven for a *muhurta*, but got back his life again. ¹⁹³ O unblemished ones! Through his intelligence and spirit, he comprehended the nature of the three worlds. Dilipa’s son was the great king Bhagiratha. He is the lord who made Ganga, the best among rivers, descend and advance towards the ocean, which is why she is thought of as his daughter. Thus, those who have listed the dynasties speak of Ganga as Bhagirathi. Bhagiratha’s son was famous as King Shruta. Shruta had a son named Nabhaga, who was extremely devoted to *dharma*. Nabhaga’s son was Ambarisha, the father of Sindhudvipa. Sindhudvipa’s son was the valiant Ayutajit. Ayutajit’s son was the extremely illustrious Rituparna. He was powerful and knew the divine art of playing dice. ¹⁹⁴ He was also King Nala’s friend. Rituparna’s son was the immensely illustrious Artaparni. His son was King Sudasa, Indra’s friend. Sudasa’s son is said to have been the king named Soudasa. This king was also known by the names of Kalmashapada and Mitrasaha. Kalmashapada’s son was the famous Sarvakarma. Sarvakarma’s son was known by the name of Anaranya. Anaranya’s son was Nighna. Nighna had two sons, Anamitra and Raghu. They were supreme and bulls among kings. Anamitra had the learned king Duliduha as his son. Dilipa, Rama’s great grandfather, was his son. The

long-armed Dilipa had a son named Raghu. The immensely strong Raghu was the great king of Ayodhya. Raghu's son was Aja and Aja's son was Dasharatha. Dasharatha's son was Rama. He was immensely illustrious and had *dharma* in his soul. Rama had a famous son named Kusha. Kusha's son was Atithi. He was also extremely illustrious and had *dharma* in his soul. Atithi's son was the valiant Nishadha. Nishadha's son was Nala and Nala's son was Nabha. Nabha's son was Pundarika and Pundarika's son was known as Kshemadhanva. Kshemadhanva's son was the powerful Devanika. Devanika's son was the lord known as Ahinagu. Ahinagu's son was the king named Sudhanva. King Shala was Sudhanva's son. Shala's son was named Ukyā and he had *dharma* in his soul. Vajranabha was Ukyā's son and Nala was the great-souled Vajranabha's son. O supreme among sages! In the Puranas, there are two famous Nalas. The first was the son of Virasena and the other was an extender of the Ikshvaku lineage. The most important and powerful ones in the Ikshvaku lineage have been described. The kings in Vivasvat's lineage were extremely energetic. If a person properly reads about this creation of Aditya Vivasvat, and about god Shraddhadeva who nourishes subjects, he has offspring and obtains Vivasvat's world.'

Chapter 1(7) (Soma's birth)

Lomaharshana said, ‘O *brahmanas*! The illustrious rishi, Atri was born as Brahma’s mental son earlier, when he had desired to create subjects. Soma was Atri’s son. We have heard that earlier Atri tormented himself in great austerity for three thousand divine years, through the austerity named *anuttara*.¹⁹⁵ His semen ascended upwards and attained the status of becoming Soma. Tears flowed from his eyes and illuminated the ten directions.¹⁹⁶ The goddesses of the ten directions rejoiced at this and accepted this in their wombs. However, though they sought to bear this collectively, they were unable to do so. The ten directions were unable to bear this fetus and the fetus, along with them swiftly fell down on the earth. Brahma, grandfather of the worlds, saw that Soma had fallen. To ensure the welfare of the worlds, he placed him on a chariot. O supreme sages! When Atri’s extremely great-souled son fell down, the gods, Brahma’s sons, and others praised him. Thus, praised by them, Soma’s energy was resplendent and spread everywhere in the worlds so as to nurture them. On that excellent chariot, he circumambulated¹⁹⁷ the earth twenty-one times. The energy that flowed reached the earth. The herbs that sustain the universe originated from this. Through the praise and the rites, the illustrious one obtained energy. For one hundred *padma* years,¹⁹⁸ the immensely fortunate one tormented himself in austerity. O supreme sages! Brahma, supreme among those who know about the *brahman*, bestowed on him the kingdom of seeds, herbs, *brahmanas* and water. Having obtained that great kingdom, Soma, supreme among those who are amiable, performed a *rajasuya* sacrifice with *dakshina* amounting to one hundred thousand.¹⁹⁹ O *brahmanas*! We have heard that Soma gave the foremost brahmana *rishis* and the assistant priests the three worlds as *dakshina*. Hiranyagarbha

Brahma was the priest and Atri and Bhrigu were the assistant priests. Hari was there, surrounded by many sages. He was attended to by nine goddesses—Sinivali, Kuhu, Dyuti, Pushti, Prabha, Vasu, Kirti, Dhriti and Lakshmi. ²⁰⁰ When the *avabhritha* ²⁰¹ was over, as the foremost person present, the lord of all the kings ²⁰² was worshipped by all the gods and the *rishis*. He illuminated the ten directions.

‘He obtained a prosperity that was extremely difficult to obtain and was honoured by the *rishis*. He lost his humility and his mind was in a whirl. Therefore, confounded and intoxicated by his prosperity, he abducted Brihaspati’s wife. Though he was repeatedly entreated by the son of Angiras ²⁰³ and by the gods and the *rishis*, having quickly abducted her, Soma didn’t return Tara to the son of Angiras. Ushanas ²⁰⁴ attacked the son of Angiras from the flank. Wielding the Ajagava bow, ²⁰⁵ Rudra also attacked him from the flank. The great-souled one used the supreme weapon known as *brahmashira*, and when he directed this towards the gods, all their fame was destroyed. The famous encounter known as the Tarakamaya ²⁰⁶ battle took place between the gods and the *danavas* and it led to great destruction in the worlds. O *brahmanas*! The gods and Tushitas who were left, went and sought refuge with Brahma, the eternal and original god. The grandfather restrained Ushanas and Rudra Shankara. He himself gave Tara back to the son of Angiras. However, on seeing that she was pregnant, Brihaspati became angry. He said, ‘This vagina belongs to me and you should never nurture this fetus.’ She went to a clump of reeds and discharged the embryo there. As soon as he was born, the illustrious one attacked the bodies of the gods. The supreme gods became suspicious and asked Tara, ‘Tell us the truth. Whose son is this, Soma’s or Brihaspati’s?’ Though she was asked by the gods, she said that she did not know. At this, Kumara, the slayer of bandits, started to curse her. But Brahma restrained him and asked Tara about the doubt. ‘O Tara! Tell us the truth. Whose son have you delivered?’ She joined her hands in salutation and told the grandfather that this was Soma’s son. Therefore, the intelligent King Soma, the Prajapati, inhaled the fragrance of his head ²⁰⁷ and named the child Budha. In the sky, Budha rises in the opposite direction. ²⁰⁸ He had a son

through a princess, and this was the immensely energetic Pururava, born as Ila's son. Through Urvashi, this great-souled one had seven sons. The story of Soma's birth, which enhances deeds, has thus been described. O best among sages! Please understand the description of this lineage. If one hears the sacred account of Soma's birth, one is blessed, obtains a long lifespan and is free from disease. All resolutions are accomplished. A listener is freed from sins.'

Chapter 1(8) (Soma's lineage)

Lomaharshana said, 'O best among sages! Budha's son was the learned Pururava. He was energetic and generous and performed sacrifices with copious quantities of *dakshina*. He was valorous and knew about the *brahman*. In a battle, the enemies found it impossible to defeat him. The lord of the earth performed *agnihotra* and other sacrifices. He was truthful and his intelligence was auspicious. He was restrained from indulging in sexual intercourse. In the three worlds, his fame was always unmatched. Because of his austerity, he possessed knowledge about the *brahman*. Abandoning her pride, the illustrious Urvashi accepted him.²⁰⁹ O *brahmanas*! For ten years, five years, five years, six years, seven years and eight years, the king resided with Urvashi in the beautiful Chaitraratha forest, along the banks of the Mandakini, in Alaka²¹⁰, in Vishala²¹¹, in Nandana, which is supreme among forests, in Uttarakuru, which possesses trees that yield all the fruits one desires, in the foothills of Gandhamadana and thereafter, on the summit of Meru, respectively.²¹² The king was supremely happy and with Urvashi, amused himself in these best of groves, treasured even by the gods. These sacred regions were frequented by the *maharshis*. The lord of the earth ruled over his kingdom from Prayaga. Such were the powers of the king who was Ila's son, supreme among men. He obtained great fame in Pratishthana, on the northern banks of Jahnavi.²¹³ Ila's son had seven sons who were like the sons of the gods. These great-souled ones were born in heaven, and they were the intelligent Ayu, Amavasū, Vishvayu, with *dharma* in his soul, Shrutayu, Dridhayu, Vanayu and Bahvayu. They were Urvashi's sons. Amavasū's son was King Bhima, the king of kings. The prosperous King Kanchanaprabha was Bhima's son. The learned and immensely strong Suhotra was Kanchana's son.²¹⁴

Through Keshini's womb, Jahnu was born as Suhotra's son. He performed a great sacrifice and at this great sacrifice, snakes were sacrificed. Desiring a husband, Ganga sought to make him a husband. However, since he did not want this, Ganga flooded the sacrificial hall. In every direction, the sacrificial arena was flooded in this fashion. O supreme *brahmanas*! Seeing this, the king who was Suhotra's son became angry and cursed Ganga. 'I will drink up your waters and render your attempt unsuccessful. O Ganga! You will instantly reap the fruits of your haughtiness.' The *maharshis* saw that the royal sage had drunk up the Ganga. They brought the immensely fortunate one back and she became Jahnavi, his daughter. ²¹⁵ Jahnu married Kaveri, Yuvanashva's daughter. Because she was cursed by Ganga, half of the body of Yuvanashva's daughter started to flow as a river. ²¹⁶ One half became Kaveri, supreme among rivers. The other half was Jahnu's unblemished wife. Through Kaveri, Jahnu had a beloved son named Sunanda, devoted to *dharma*. His son was Ajaka. Ajaka's son was Balakashva, lord of the earth. Kusha, who was extremely attached to hunting, was his son. This king was reared with Pahlavas and other forest-dwellers. Kusha had four sons who were as radiant as the gods—Kushika, Kushanabha, Kushamba and Murtiman.

'The Pahlavas dislodged King Kushika and he had to roam around in the forest. He tormented himself in austerity, so that he might have a son who would be the equal of Lord Indra. Shakra was terrified that he might have such a son. Shakra saw him perform these extremely fierce austerities for one thousand years and realized that he was himself capable of obtaining such a son. Therefore, the thousand-eyed Purandara revealed himself before him. Indra of the gods, supreme among gods, decided to become his son. Maghavan was himself born as King Gadhi, Kushika's son. His ²¹⁷ wife was Purukutsa's daughter and she gave birth to Gadhi. Gadhi had an immensely fortunate and auspicious daughter, named Satyavati. The Lord Gadhi bestowed her on Richika, Kavya's son. Her husband, Bhargava, who descended from Bhrigu, was pleased with her. So that there might be a son, Richika Bhargava prepared some *charu* for her and for Gadhi. ²¹⁸ Richika Bhargava summoned his wife and told her, 'One part of the *charu* is for you

and the other is for your mother. She will give birth to a dazzling son who will be a bull among *kshatriyas*. No other *kshatriya* in the world will be able to vanquish him and he will slay the bulls among *kshatriyas*. O fortunate one! This will ensure you a son who will possess fortitude. He will be a store of austerities, tranquil in his soul and the best among *brahmanas*. Richika descended from the Bhrigu lineage and told his wife this. Always devoted to austerity, he then entered the forest. At that time, along with his wife, Gadhi came to Richika's hermitage. They were on a journey to visit the *tirthas* and in that connection, the lord of men wished to see his daughter. Satyavati picked up the two portions of *charu* given by the *rishi*. Carefully holding the two portions of *charu*, she gave them to her mother. Inadvertently, her mother gave her daughter the *charu* that was meant for her and herself ate the *charu* that was meant for her daughter. Hence, Satyavati conceived a fetus that would destroy the *kshatriyas*. Her form turned radiant and she was impossible to behold. Seeing her, Richika resorted to yoga and understood what had happened. The best among *brahmanas* told his wife, who possessed a beautiful complexion, 'O fortunate one! You have been deceived by your mother. ²¹⁹ Since the two portions of *charu* have been exchanged, you will have an extremely terrible son who will be cruel in his deeds. You will have a brother who will be immersed in the *brahman* and will be a store of austerities. Using all my austerities, I have imbibed him with the *brahman*.' The immensely fortunate Satyavati was told this by her husband. She placated her husband and said, 'Let my son not be like that. Let him not be the worst among brahmans.' Thus addressed, the sage replied, 'O fortunate one! This was not my intention. I did not wish that it should be this way. However, because of what his father and mother have done, your son will be fierce in his deeds.' Satyavati again addressed him in the following words. She said, 'O sage! If you wish, you can create the worlds, not to speak of a son. You should give me a son who is upright in nature. O lord! O supreme among *brahmanas*! If countering is not possible, I desire that my grandson should be like that.' Using the strength of his austerities, he pacified her. 'O one who is beautiful in complexion! I see no distinction between a son and a grandson. O

fortunate one! It shall be as you have said.’ Thus, Satyavati gave birth to the son who was Bhargava Jamadagni, who was tranquil in his soul. He was self-controlled and devoted to austerities. In earlier times, Bhrigu had mixed up the *charu* offered to Indra and Vishnu in the course of a sacrifice. ²²⁰ Jamadagni was born from the part that had been offered to Vishnu. The virtuous Satyavati was devoted to truth and supreme *dharma*. She started to flow as a great river and is known as Koushiki. ²²¹

‘In the Ikshvaku lineage, there was a powerful lord of men by the name of Renu. He had an immensely fortunate daughter, known by the name of Kamali or Renuka. Richika’s son possessed austerity and learning. Through Renuka Kamali, Jamadagni had an extremely terrible son. He ²²² was the best among all those who knew all kinds of learning. He was accomplished in *dhanurveda*. This was Rama, the slayer of *kshatriyas*. He blazed like the fire. Jamadagni was immensely illustrious, supreme among those who knew about the *brahman*. Because of the power of austerity of Richika, Ourva’s son, he was born through Satyavati. Shunahshepha was the son in the middle and Shunahpuccha was the youngest. ²²³ Gadhi, Kushika’s son, had Vishvamitra as a son. He had a son who was tranquil in his soul and possessed austerity and learning. He obtained the respect of *brahmarshis* and himself became a *brahmarshi*. ²²⁴ Vishvamitra possessed *dharma* in his soul and is also remembered by the name of Vishvaratha. Through Bhrigu’s favours, he became an extender of Koushika’s lineage. Vishvamitra’s sons were Devarata and others. Later, their names became famous in the three worlds. They are known as Devarata and Kati, born through Katyayani; Hiranyaksha, born through Shalavati; Renu, born through Renuka; Samkriti, Galava, the famous Mudgala, Madhucchanda, Jaya, Devala, Ashtaka, Kacchapa and Harita. These were Vishvamitra’s sons. The *gotras* of the great-souled Koushikas are said to be Prani, Babhrava, Dhyanajapya, Parthiva, Devarata, Shalankayana, Bashkala, Lohita, Yamaduta, Karushaka, Soushrava, Koushika, Saindhavayana, Devala, Renava, Yajnavalkya, Marshana, Oudumbara, Ambubhishnava, Tarakayana, Chunchula, Shalavatya, Hiranyaksha, Samkritya, Galava and Narayani. There were others descended from the intelligent Vishvamitra. O best among sages!

Among the Koushikas, there are said to be many cases of *rishis* who were in between. ²²⁵ In this lineage, there were relationships between *brahmana rishis* from the Koushika line and Pouravas. This lineage is famous for *brahmanas* marrying *kshatriyas*. Vishvamitra's oldest son is said to have been Shunahshepha. From being a Bhargava, that supreme sage became a Koushika. ²²⁶ Shunahshepha was used as an animal in Harishchandra's sacrifice, and later became Vishvamitra's son. Shunahshepha was, thus, handed over to Vishvamitra by the gods. Since he was given by the gods, he came to be known as Devarata. ²²⁷ Vishvamitra had seven sons, Devarata and the others. ²²⁸ Ashtaka, Vishvamitra's son, was born through Drishadvati. Ashtaka's son was Louhi. I have spoken about those who were descended from Jahnu. I will now speak about the great-souled Ayu's lineage.'

Chapter 1(9) (Soma's lineage continued)

Lomaharshana said, 'Ayu had five sons and all of them were brave *maharathas*.²²⁹ These kings were born through Svarbhanu's daughter, Prabha. Nahusha was the first to be born and Vriddhasharma came after that. Rambha, Raji and Anena were famous in the three worlds. Raji had five hundred sons. They were famous as Rajeyas and these *kshatriyas* caused fear in Indra himself. There was an extremely terrible battle between the gods and the *asuras*. At that time, both the gods and the *asuras* went to Brahma and spoke to him. The gods and the *asuras* asked, 'O illustrious one! Who amongst us will be victorious in the battle? O lord of all creatures! Tell us. We wish to hear the truth.' Brahma replied, 'On whichever side lord Raji fights, wielding his weapons, there is no doubt in the three worlds about that side being victorious in the battle. Perseverance exists wherever Raji is. Prosperity exists wherever perseverance is. Wherever there is perseverance and prosperity, *dharma* and victory exist there.' When the gods and the *danavas* heard what the god said about Raji, they were delighted. Desiring their own respective victories, they went to solicit the bull among men. The extremely energetic king was an extender of Soma's lineage. He was Svarbhanu's maternal grandson and Prabha's son. Cheerful in their minds, all the gods and *danavas* went to Raji and told him, 'Please pick up your excellent bow for our victory.' Raji knew the objective of making his own fame manifest. Therefore, with his own interest in mind, he spoke to the gods and the *daityas*. Raji said, 'O Vasava! When the large number of *daityas* have been vanquished through my valour, if following *dharma*, I am made the Indra, only then will I fight in this battle.' O *brahmanas*! He spoke to the gods first. Happy in their minds, they replied. 'O king! What you wish and desire will be done.' Hearing the

words of the large number of gods, King Raji then asked the foremost among the *asuras*, just as he had asked the gods. The *danavas* were full of insolence and driven by selfish motives. They replied to the supreme among kings in words that were filled with pride. The *danavas* said, ‘Our Indra is Prahlada and it is for his sake that we are trying for victory. O king! O supreme among kings! Accordingly, station yourself in this battle.’ The king agreed to this and the gods urged him. The gods said, ‘When we are victorious, you will be the Indra.’ He slew all the *danavas*, who could not be killed by the one with the *vajra* in his hand. The supreme prosperity of the gods had been destroyed. However, having slain all the *danavas*, Lord Raji conquered their prosperity and gave it to the gods. Along with the gods, Shatakratu told the immensely valiant Raji, ‘I am Raji’s son.’ He again added, ‘O father! ²³⁰ There is no doubt that you are the Indra of all the gods. As your son, I, Indra, will attain fame through my deeds.’ He heard Shakra’s words and was deceived by his *maya*. Pleased with Shatakratu, the king signified his assent. Later, the royal sage, the lord of the earth went to heaven. Raji had five hundred sons. They took away Indra’s kingdom, which they were heirs to. They attacked Shatakratu’s place several times in the world of heaven, known as Trivishtapa. But they became deluded and attached to passion. They turned against *dharma*. They acted against *brahmanas* and lost their energy and valour. Indra regained his own prosperity and his excellent position. All Raji’s sons, addicted to desire and anger, were killed. A person who listens to this account of Shatakratu losing and regaining his state, and retains it, never suffers from any calamities.

‘Rambha did not have any sons. I will speak about Anena’s lineage. The immensely illustrious king, Pratikshatra, was Anena’s son. Pratikshatra’s son was famous by the name of Srinjaya. Srinjaya’s son was Jaya and Jaya’s son was Vijaya. Vijaya’s son was Kriti and Kriti’s son was Haryatvata. Haryatvata’s son was the powerful king, Sahadeva. Sahadeva’s son was the famous Nadina and he possessed *dharma* in his soul. Nadina’s son was Jayatsena and Jayatsena’s son was Samkriti. Samkriti’s son was Kshatravridha. He was immensely illustrious and possessed *dharma* in his soul. The line of Anena has been described. That of Kshatravridha comes

next. Kshatravridha's son was the immensely illustrious Sunohatra. Sunohatra had three sons who were extremely devoted to *dharma*. Two of them were Kashya and Shalla and the third was Gritsamada. Gritasmada's son was Shunaka, and Shounakas²³¹ were *brahmanas*, *kshatriyas*, *vaishyas* and *shudras*. Shalla's son was Arshtishena and Arshtishena's son was Lord Kashyapa. Kashya's son²³² was Dirghatapa, the king of Kashi. Dirghatapa's son was Dhanu, and Dhanu's son was the learned Dhanvantari. The intelligent one was born after the king²³³ had become old, performing extremely great austerities. God Dhanvantari assumed a human form on earth. Thus, God Dhanvantari was born in his house. This great king²³⁴ was the king of Kashi and knew how to treat all ailments. He learnt *ayurveda*²³⁵ and the art of being a physician from Bharadvaja. He again divided this knowledge into eight parts²³⁶ and taught it to his disciples. Dhanvantari's son was known as Ketuman and Ketuman's son is said to have been the brave Bhimaratha. Bhimaratha's son was Divodasa, the lord of subjects. Divodasa had *dharma* in his soul and was the lord of Varanasi. O *brahmanas*! At this time, a *rakshasa* named Kshemaka rendered the city of Varanasi bereft of all inhabitants. The intelligent Nikumbha, great in his soul, had cursed that it would remain empty for one thousand years.²³⁷ There was no doubt about this. When it was cursed for this duration, Divodasa, Lord of subjects, established the beautiful city of Gomati beyond these boundaries and populated it. Earlier, the city of Varanasi belonged to Bhadrashrenya. Bhadrashrenya had one hundred sons who were excellent archers. Divodasa, lord of men, got the city populated after killing them. Using his strength, he seized Bhadrashrenya's kingdom. Bhadrashrenya had a son who was known by the name of Durdama. Since he was a child, Divodasa released him out of compassion. The lord of the earth²³⁸ also seized the hereditary kingdom of the Haihayas. Bhadrashrenya's son, Durdama was great-souled. His ancestral kingdom had been taken away by Divodasa, but he used his strength to get it back. O immensely fortunate ones! In this way, the infinitely energetic one brought an end to the enmity. The brave Pratardana was born through Divodasa and Drishadvati. Even when he was a child, he used his strength to get the kingdom back again.

Pratardana had two extremely famous sons—Vatsa and Bharga. Shatrujit was Vatsa's son and Ritadhvaja was Shatrujit's son. Ritadhvaja's son was Alarka. He was devoted to *brahmanas* and devoted to the truth. There is an ancient *shloka* that is chanted about the royal sage, Alarka. This extender of the lineage possessed youth and beauty that lasted for sixty thousand and six hundred years. Through Lopamudra's ²³⁹ favours, he obtained a long life. With youth and beauty, he ruled over an extremely large kingdom. When the period of the curse was over, the mighty-armed one ²⁴⁰ slew the *rakshasa* Kshemaka. He again populated the beautiful city of Varanasi. Sannati's ²⁴¹ son was named Sunitha and he was devoted to *dharma*. Sunitha's immensely illustrious son was named Kshema. Kshema's son was Ketuman and Ketuman's son was Suketu. It has been heard that Suketu's son was Dharmaketu. Dharmaketu's son was the *maharatha* Satyaketu. Satyaketu's son was the lord of subjects, named Vibhu. Vibhu's son was Anarta and Anarta's son was Sukumara. Sukumara's son was Dhrishtaketu and he was extremely devoted to *dharma*. Dhrishtaketu's son was Venuhotra, the lord of subjects. Venuhotra's son was the lord of subjects, named Bharga. Vatsa's ²⁴² son was Vatsabhumi and Bharga's son was Bhargabhumi. These were the sons of Angiras born in the Bhargava lineage. There were thousands of *brahmanas*, *kshatriyas* and *vaishyas*, full of energy. The Kashyapas have been spoken about. Now hear about those descended from Nahusha.'

Chapter 1(10) (Yayati's account)

Lomaharshana said, 'Nahusha has six sons who were like Indra and Upendra ²⁴³ in their energy. These immensely energetic ones were the sons of Viraja, the daughter of the ancestors. They were Yati, Yayati, Sharyati, Ayati, Aryati and Suyati. Among these six, Yayati became the king. Yati was the eldest and Yayati was born after him. As a wife, Yati obtained Kakutstha's daughter, named Gam. Yati resorted to the path of *moksha* and became a sage who was immersed in the *brahman*. Among the other five, Yayati conquered the earth. His wives were Devayani, the daughter of Ushanas, and Sharmishtha, the daughter of the *asura* Vrishaparva. Devayani gave birth to Yadu and Turvasu. Sharmishtha, Vrishaparva's daughter, gave birth to Druhyu, Anu and Puru. Pleased, Shukra gave him ²⁴⁴ an extremely radiant chariot. It was divine and made from celestial gold, drawn by divine and supreme horses that were as swift as thought. He performed his deeds on that sparkling chariot. On that best of chariots, he conquered the earth in six days. Yayati was invincible in battle, even against the gods and the *danavas* combined. All the Kouravas have possessed this chariot. It passed down to King Parikshit's son, the Indra among kings and Kuru's descendant, Kourava Janamejaya, also named Samvartavasu. After that, because of the intelligent Garga's curse, the chariot was lost. Garga had a young son. By causing violence to him through cruel words, King Janamejaya became guilty of the sin of killing a brahmana. The royal sage's body began to smell of iron and he roamed around, here and there. Though he avoided cities and the countryside, he could not obtain peace anywhere. He was tormented by grief and could not find comfort anywhere. The king sought refuge with Shounaka, Indra among *brahmanas*. O supreme among *brahmanas*! Shounaka performed a sacrifice for Janamejaya. So that the

king might be purified, he performed a horse sacrifice. After the *avabhrittha*, the smell of iron vanished. Pleased, Shakra gave that chariot to the king of Chedi and it came into his possession and Brihadratha obtained it from him.²⁴⁵ When King Brihadratha died, it remained in Brihadratha's dynasty. After killing Jarasandha, Bhima, descendant of the Kourava lineage, cheerfully gave this excellent chariot to Vasudeva.'

'Yayati conquered the earth with its seven *dvipas*, right up to the frontiers of the ocean. The king who was Nahusha's son divided the kingdom among his sons. Yayati instated his eldest son, Yadu, in the eastern direction. Nahusha's son instated Puru as the king in the middle region. The intelligent king gave Turvasu the south-eastern direction.²⁴⁶ Even today, the earth with its seven *dvipas* and habitations and its regions are ruled by their descendants, following *dharma*. O supreme among sages! I will tell you about their offspring later. The king was aging. He cast aside his bow and arrows and entrusted the burden to his five relatives, bulls among men. Having cast aside his weapons, the lord of the earth roamed around the earth. The unvanquished king, Yayati was pleased. Having divided the earth in this way, Yayati spoke to Yadu. 'O son! There is something else that remains to be done. Accept my old age. In the form of a handsome youth, I wish to roam around the earth. Accept my old age.' However, Yadu replied to him, 'O king! I have promised a *brahmana* alms and he has not yet told me what he wants. Until that task is done, I cannot accept your old age. There are many taints associated with old age. One cannot eat and drink as one wills. O king! Therefore, I am not interested in accepting your old age. O king! You have other sons and you love them more than me. O one who knows about *dharma*! Ask one of the other sons to comply with this request.' Having been thus addressed by Yadu, the king became full of anger. Yayati, supreme among eloquent ones, censured his son. Yayati said, 'O extremely foolish one! I am the one who instructs you. Other than me, what *dharma* and what refuge do you possess?' O *brahmanas*! Telling his son this, he angrily cursed him. 'O foolish one! There is no doubt that your offspring will never enjoy a kingdom.' O supreme among *brahmanas*! The king was also refused by Turvasu, Druhyu and Anu in a similar way. Angry,

the unvanquished Yayati also cursed them in that way. O supreme among *brahmanas*! I have told you everything accurately. Thus, he cursed the four sons who were older than Puru. O *brahmanas*! The king then addressed Puru in these words. 'In the form of a handsome youth, I wish to roam around this earth. O Puru! If you think it proper, please accept my old age.' The powerful Puru accepted his father's old age. In Puru's form, Yayati roamed around the earth. With Vishvachi, the lord sported himself in the grove of Chaitraratha. The supreme among kings searched for an end to desire. When the lord of men saw that his desire for objects of pleasure was satisfied, he went to Puru and took back his old age. O best among sages! Indeed, in this connection, a song was chanted by Yayati. 'Like a tortoise drawing in all its limbs, a person must withdraw from desire. Through enjoying objects of pleasure, the birth of desire is never pacified. Instead, it increases again, like *ghee* offered into the one with a black trail. ²⁴⁷

Otherwise, all the paddy, barley, gold, animals and women on earth will not be enough and one will not stop being deluded. If one does not harbour evil sentiments towards all creatures, in deeds, thoughts and words, one obtains the *brahman*. Such a person does not frighten others, nor is he frightened by them. If one does not desire or hate, one obtains the *brahman*. Desire is extremely difficult to cast aside, but a person who casts it aside is happy. It cannot be cast aside by a person who is evil-minded. Even when one ages, it is not exhausted. It is like an ailment that only ends when the breath of life has gone. As one ages, the hair turn grey. As one ages, the teeth decay. However, even though one ages, the desire for wealth and life is not exhausted. There is happiness that comes from satisfying desire in this world. There is great happiness in heaven. But these do not account for even a sixteenth *kala* of the bliss that results from the exhaustion of desire.'

²⁴⁸ Having said this, with his wife, the royal sage entered the forest. For a long period of time, he performed great austerity. He tormented himself in austerity on Bhrigutunga. At the end of this austerity, the immensely famous one gave up food and gave up his body. With his wife, he obtained heaven. O best among sages! There were five supreme and royal sages in his lineage. They pervaded the entire earth, like the sun with its rays. I will tell

you about Yadu's lineage, revered by kings. Listen. Hari Narayana, the extender of the Vrishni lineage was born in it. O supreme *brahmanas*! A man who always listens to Yayati's conduct obtains offspring, a long life and fame.'

Chapter 1(11) (Yayati's lineage)

The *brahmanas* said, 'O Suta! We wish to hear the truth about Puru's lineage and about those of Druhyu, Anu, Yadu and Turvasu separately.'

Lomaharshana replied, 'O tigers among sages! First hear about the lineage of the great-souled Puru. I will tell you about it in detail, in due order. Puru's son was Suvira and his son was Manasyu. Manasyu's son was the king named Abhayada. Abhayada's son was the lord of the earth named Sudhanva. Sudhanva's son was Subahu, and his son was Roudrashva. Roudrashva had Dasharneyu, Krikaneyu, Kaksheyu, Sthandileyu, Sannateyu, Richeyu, Jaleyu, the immensely illustrious Sthaleyu, Dhaneyu and Vaneyu as sons. He also had ten daughters, who were *putrikas* ²⁴⁹ — Bhadra, Shudra, Madra, Shalada, Malada, Khalada, Nalada, Surasa, Gochapala and Striratnakuta. O *brahmanas*! These were the ten. The *rishi* Prabhakara was born in Atri's lineage and he became their husband. Through Bhadra, he had the illustrious Soma as a son. Svarbhanu ²⁵⁰ attacked Surya and made him fall from the firmament to earth. When the world was enveloped in darkness, he brought light. ²⁵¹ As the sun was falling, the *brahmana rishi* said, 'May all be well with you.' At these words, the sun did not fall from the firmament to earth. The famous and great ascetic, thus, established the supremacy of Atri's *gotra*. In sacrifices, the gods accordingly decreed that he should possess the same powers as Atri. Through the *putrikas*, he had ten sons who were great in spirit, always engaged in fierce austerities. O *brahmanas*! Those *rishis* were accomplished in the Vedas and established their own *gotras*. They were known as Svastyatreya and did not possess any of the three kinds of riches.

‘Kaksheyu had three sons who were *maharathas*—Sabhanara, Chakshusha and Paramanyu. Sabhanara’s son was the learned King Kalanala. Kalanala had a son named Srinjaya who knew about *dharma*. Srinjaya’s son was the brave King Puranjaya. O best among sages! Puranjaya’s son was Janamejaya. The royal sage, Janamejaya had a son named Mahashala. His fame was established on earth and even the gods knew about him. Mahashala had a son named Mahamana who was devoted to *dharma*. When the brave Mahamana was born, large numbers of gods worshipped him. O *brahmanas*! Mahamana had two sons—Ushinara, who was knowledgeable about *dharma*, and the immensely strong Titikshu. Ushinara had five wives who were born in the family of a royal sage—Nrigaa, Krimi, Navaa, Darva and Dhrishadvati as the fifth. Through them, Ushinara had five sons who were the extenders of the lineage. King Vriksha obtained these daughters ²⁵³ after performing great austerity. Nrigaa had a son named Nriga. Krimi had one named Krimi. Navaa had a son named Nava. Darva had one named Suvrata. Through Dhrishadvati, King Ushinara had a son named Shibi. O *brahmanas*! Shibi’s descendants are known as Shibis and Nriga’s as Youdheyas. Nava’s city is Navarashtra and Krimi’s is Krimila. Suvrata’s is known as Ambashtha. Hear about Shibi’s sons. Shibi had four sons, the Shibis, and they were famous in the worlds. They were Vrishadarbha, Suvira, Kaikeya and Madraka. Their prosperous kingdoms were Kekaya, Madraka, Vrishadarbha and Suvira. O *brahmanas*! Titikshu had offspring. Titikshu became the king in the eastern direction. His son was the mighty-armed Ushadratha, whose son was Phena. Phena’s son was Sutapa and Sutapa’s son was Bali. Though this king was born in a human womb, he used golden arrows. In ancient times, this king used to be the great yogi, Bali. He had five sons who extended the lineage on earth. Anga was born first and Vanga and Suhma came after that. Next there were Pundra and Kalingam. These are said to be the Baleya *kshatriyas*. Baleya *brahmanas* also extended their lineages on earth. O *brahmanas*! Delighted, Brahma granted a boon to Bali. This ensured that he would be a great yogi and would have a lifespan that would endure for one *kalpa*. He would have unlimited strength and would possess insight about *dharma* and *artha*. He

would be unvanquished in battle and would be foremost amongst those who knew about *dharma*. He would have insight about the three worlds and his offspring would be foremost. He would also control and establish four *varnas* on earth. Having been thus addressed by the lord, Bali obtained supreme peace. O *brahmanas*! After a long period of time, he obtained his position in heaven.

‘The five regions of his offspring were Anga, Vanga, Suhma, Kalingam and Pundra. Now hear about Anga’s offspring. Anga’s son was the great Dadhivahana, Indra among kings. Dadhivahana’s son was King Diviratha. Diviratha’s son was like Shakra in his valour. He was learned and was named Svargaratha. His son was Chitraratha. The great-souled Lord Svargaratha performed a sacrifice on Mount Kalanjara and drank *soma* with Shakra there. Chitraratha’s son was Dasharatha. He was famous as Lomapada and his daughter was Shanta.²⁵⁴ Dasharatha’s son was the brave and immensely famous Chaturanga. This extender of the lineage was born through Rishyashringa’s favours. Chaturanga’s son was known as Prithulaksha. Prithulaksha’s son was the immensely famous king, Champa. Champa’s city was Champa, which was earlier known as Malini. Through the favours of Purnabhadra, Champa had a son named Haryanga. For him, Vibhandaka’s son²⁵⁵ used *mantras* and brought down the supreme mount and elephant, Shakra’s elephant, down to earth. Haryanga’s son is said to have been King Bhadraratha. Bhadraratha’s son was Brihatkarma, lord of subjects. His son was Brihaddarbha and Brihaddarbha’s son was Brihanmana. Brihanmana, Indra among kings, had a son named Jayadratha. Jayadratha’s son was King Dridharatha. Dridharatha’s son was Janamejaya, the conqueror of the world. His son was Vikarna and Vikarna’s son was Vaikarna. Vaikarna had one hundred sons who extended Anga’s lineage. All the kings in Anga’s lineage have thus been recounted by me. They were great-souled and devoted, to the, truth. They were *maharathas* who had offspring.

‘O best among sages! Now hear about the lineage of Richeyu, Roudrashva’s son. I will tell you about the lineage of that king. King Richeyu’s son was Matinara, lord of the earth. Matinara had three sons who

were extremely devoted to *dharma*. They were Vasurodha, Pratritha and Subahu, who was devoted to *dharma*. All of them were knowledgeable about the Vedas and devoted to *brahmanas*. They were truthful in speech. O excellent sages! There was a maiden named Ila who knew about the *brahman*. Tamsu approached her. ²⁵⁶ Through her, Tamsu had the powerful and royal sage Dharmanetra as a son. He was valiant and knew about the *brahman*. His wife was Upadanavi. Upadanavi had four auspicious sons—Dushyanta, Sushmanta, Pravira and Anagha. Dushyanta's son was the valiant Bharata. He was also known as the great Sarvadamana and he possessed the strength of ten thousand elephants. Through Shakuntala, the great-souled Dushyanta had this son, who would become an emperor. It is after Bharata that Bharata ²⁵⁷ has been named. The sons of the great king, Bharata, were destroyed because of the rage of their mothers. I have described this account earlier. ²⁵⁸ The great *brahmana* sage, Bharadvaja was the son of Brihaspati and was descended from the Angiras lineage. Since the other sons had been futile, the lord performed a sacrifice so that a son might be born. Since the births of the earlier sons had been unsuccessful, the son born through Bharadvaja's attempts was named Vitatha. ²⁵⁹ When Vitatha was born, Bharata went to heaven. Having instated Vitatha, Bharadvaja left for the forest. Vitatha had five sons—Suhotra, Suhotara, Gaya, Garga and the great-souled Kapila. Suhotara had two sons—the great-spirited Kashika and King Gritsamati. Gritsamati's sons were *brahmanas*, *kshatriyas* and *vaishyas*. Kashika's son was Kasheya Dirghatapa. Dirghatapa had a learned son named Dhanvantari. Dhanvantari's son was famous as Ketuman. Ketuman's son is said to be the learned Bhimaratha. Bhimaratha's son became the lord of Varanasi. He was also famous as Divodasa, the destroyer of all the *kshatriyas*. ²⁶⁰ Divodasa's son was the brave King Pratardana. Pratardana had two sons, Vatsa and Bhargava. Prince Alarka was the same as King Sannati. ²⁶¹ The lord of the earth seized the paternal kingdom of the Haihayas. The great-souled Durdama was one of Bhadrashrenya's sons. However, because he was a child, Divodasa had compassionately spared him. He forcefully seized his ancestral kingdom back from Divodasa. The king named Ashtaratha was

Bhimaratha's son. O *brahmanas*! Following the norms followed by *kshatriyas*, his young son was killed, and this brought an end to the enmity. O best among sages! Alarka became the king of Kashi. He was devoted to the truth and to *brahmanas*. He ruled for six thousand and six hundred years. He was youthful and handsome and extended the lineage of the Kashis. Through the favours of Lopamudra, he obtained an extremely long life. O best among sages! Towards the end of his life, he killed the *rakshasa* Kshemaka. The king repopulated the beautiful city of Varanasi. Alarka's son was the king named Kshemaka. Kshemaka's son was Varshaketu. Varshaketu's son, the lord of subjects, was named Vibhu. Anarta was Vibhu's son and his son was Sukumara. Sukumara's son was *maharatha* Satyaketu. He had an immensely energetic son who became a king, and who was extremely devoted to *dharma*. Vatsa's son was Vatsabhumi and Bharga's son was Bhargabhumi. All these sons of Angiras were born in the Bhargava lineage. O supreme among sages! There were *brahmanas*, *kshatriyas*, *vaishyas* and shudras among them.

‘O best among *brahmanas*! After this, hear about Ajamidha's lineage. Suhotra had a son named Brihat. Brihat had three sons—Ajamidha, Dvimidha and the valiant Purumidha. Ajamidha had three illustrious women as wives—Nili, Keshini and Dhumini. All of them were beautiful. Through Keshini, Ajamidha had a powerful son named Jahnu, a lord who performed the great sacrifice known as the immense *sarvamedha* sacrifice. ²⁶² While this was going on, Ganga desired to have him as her husband and approached him. When he did not desire this, Ganga started to flood the sacrificial ground. O *brahmanas*! On seeing that the sacrificial ground was being flooded in all directions, King Jahnu angrily told Ganga, ‘I will drink up the water that you are flooding the three worlds with. O Ganga! You will instantly reap the consequences of your pride.’ The *maharshis* saw that the great-souled one began to drink up the Ganga. They brought back the immensely fortunate one and she came to be known as Jahnavi, his daughter. Jahnu married Kaveri, the daughter of Yuvanashva. Because of Ganga's curse, half of her body later became a river. Jahnu had a beloved and valiant son named Ajaka. Ajaka's son was Balakashva, lord of the earth. Kushika,

who was extremely attached to hunting, was his son. This king was reared with Pahlavas and other forest-dwellers. Lord Kushika tormented himself in austerity so that he might have a son who was Indra's equal. Frightened that this might happen, Shakra took birth as his son. Maghavan himself was born as Kushika's son, King Gadhi. Vishvamitra was Gadhi's son and Ashtaka was Vishvamitra's son. There were also Vishvabadhi, Shvajit and Satyavati. ²⁶³ Through Satyavati, Richika had Jamadagni as a son.

Vishvamitra's sons are famous as Devarata and the others. O *brahmanas*! Their names are reknowned in the three worlds. ²⁶⁴ O *brahmanas*! They are known as Devarata and Kati, born through Katyayani; Hiranyaksha, born through Shalavati; Renu, born through Renuka; Samkriti; Galava; and the famous Mudgala. The *gotras* of the great-souled Koushikas are said to be Prani, Babhrava, Dhyanajapya, Parthiva, Devarata, Shalankayana, Soushrava, Lohita, Yamabhuta, Karishi and Saindhavayana. O *brahmanas*! There were other famous Koushikas. Among the Koushikas, there are said to be many cases of *rishis* marrying among themselves. O best among sages! There were matrimonial alliances between Pouravas and brahmana *rishis* who were Koushikas. This lineage is famous for *brahmanas* marrying *kshatriyas*. Vishvamitra's oldest son is said to have been Shunahshepha. From being a Bhargava, that bull among sages became a Koushika. Shunahshepha was used as an animal in Harishchandra's sacrifice and later became Vishvamitra's son. Shunahshepha was, thus, handed over to Vishvamitra by the gods. Devarata ²⁶⁵ and the others were Vishvamitra's sons. Ashtaka, Vishvamitra's son, was born through Drishadvati. Ashtaka's son was Louhi. I have spoken about those who were descended from Jahnu.

‘O best among sages! Now hear about Ajamidha's other line. Through Nili, Ajamidha had a son named Sushanti. Purujati was Sushanti's son and Purujati's son was Bahyashva. Bahyashva had five sons who were the equals of the immortals. They were Mudgala, Srinjaya, King Brihadishu, the brave Yavinara and Krimilashva as the fifth. These five protected a famous region. Know that the prosperous region protected by these five, and full of habitations, is Panchala. ‘We are sufficient to protect this spot.’ That is the reason it came to be known as Panchala. ²⁶⁶ Mudgala's son was

the extremely illustrious Moudgalya. Through Indrasena, Vadhnyasvha was born to him. His son, Satyadhriti was accomplished in *dhanurveda*. On seeing an *apsara* in front of him, Satyadhriti discharged his semen. This was deposited in a clump of reeds, resulting in twins. Shantanu had gone hunting and accepted them out of compassion. They were, thus, known as Kripa and Goutami Kripi.²⁶⁷ Their descendants are known as the Sharadvatas and also as the Goutamas. After this, I will speak about Divodasa's offspring. Divodasa's son was King Mitrayu, who became a brahmana *rishi*. Mitrayu's son was Soma, and the descendants were known as Maitreyas. Though they were born in the Bharagava lineage, they became *kshatriyas*. The great-souled Srinjaya had a son named Panchajana and Panchajana's son was Somadatta, lord of the earth. Somadatta's son was the immensely illustrious Sahadeva. Sahadeva's son was famous by the name of Somaka. This immensely strong Ajamidha²⁶⁸ was born as Gritsamati's son. Somaka, Ajamidha's descendant, was born when the lineage was in decline. Somaka's son was Jantu, who had one hundred sons. The youngest of these was Prishata, the lord who was Drupada's father. These great-souled Somakas are also known as Ajamidhas. Dhumini, Ajamidha's queen, desired a son. O supreme among sages! The immensely fortunate one was born in a noble lineage and was devoted to her husband. Desiring a son, the queen started to observe vows. She performed extremely difficult austerity for ten thousand years. She ate auspicious food in limited quantities. Following the ordinances, she poured oblations into the fire. O excellent sages! She observed *agnihotra* and slept on a mat of *kusha* grass. When Queen Dhumini was thus engaged, Ajamidha united with her. She gave birth to Riksha, who was handsome with a complexion like that of smoke. Samvarana was Riksha's son and Samvarana's son was Kuru, who abandoned Prayaga and set up Kurukshetra. This was a beautiful and sacred spot, frequented by auspicious ones. His lineage is extremely vast, and they are named the Kouravas. Kuru had four sons—Sudhanva, Sudhanu, the mighty-armed Parikshit and Pravara, whom the enemies could not vanquish. Parikshit's son was Janamejaya, who was extremely devoted to *dharma*. The names of the other sons were Shrutasena, Ugrasena and

Bhimasena. The intelligent Suhotra is said to have been Sudhanva's son. His son was King Chyavana, who was accomplished in *dharma* and *artha*. Kritayajna was Chyavana's son. He knew about *dharma* and performed sacrifices. His son was a famous king who was Indra's friend. This was the brave Vasu who could travel through the sky. He belonged to the Chedi dynasty.²⁶⁹ Through Girika, that Chedi dynasty had seven manly sons. They were *maharatha* Brihadratha, the famous king of Magadha; Pratyagratha; Kratha, also known as Manivahana; Shakala; Juhu; Matsya; and Kali as the seventh. Brihadratha's famous son was named Kushagra. Kushagra's brave and learned son was named Rishabha. I will now speak about Juhu's lineage, which possessed all the qualities. Juhu had a son name Suratha, who became a lord of the earth. All of these were immensely fortunate and brave, full of strength.

'Janamejaya had an intelligent son named Suratha.²⁷⁰ Suratha had a valiant son named Viduratha. Viduratha's son was the immensely strong Riksha. The second son was famous under the name of Bharadvaja. In the lunar dynasty, there were two Rikshas and two Parikshits. O *brahmanas*! There were three Bhimasenas and two Janamejayas. The second Riksha's son was Bhimasena. Pratipa was Bhimasena's son and Pratipa's sons were the three *maharathas*, Shantanu, Devapi and Bahlika. O excellent *brahmanas*! In this lineage, Shantanu was the king. O *brahmanas*! Now hear about the lineage of the royal sage, Bahlika. Bahlika's son was the extremely illustrious Somadatta. Somadatta had sons named Bhuri, Bhurishrava and Shala. Devapi became a sage, who was a teacher for the gods. The great-souled Chyavana lovingly accepted him as an adopted son. Shantanu accepted the burden and became the king of the Kouravas. I will tell you about Shantanu's lineage, which is famous in the three worlds. Through Ganga, the lord had a son named Devavrata. He was the grandfather of the Pandavas and became famous under the name of Bhishma. O *brahmanas*! Through Kali, Shantanu had a beloved son, who was unblemished and had *dharma* in his soul.²⁷¹ In Vichitravirya's field,²⁷² Krishna Dvaipayana had sons named Dhritarashtra, Pandu and Vidura. Through Gandhari, Dhritarashtra had one hundred sons. Lord Duryodhana

was the best among all of them. Pandu's son was Dhananjaya and Dhananjaya's son was Soubhadra.²⁷³ O lord of men! Abhimanyu's son was, Parikshit. Through Kashi, Parikshit had two sons—King Chandrapida and Suryapida, who knew about *moksha*. Chandrapida had one hundred sons who were excellent archers. They are famous on earth as Janamejaya's *kshatriya* descendants. Among them, the mighty-armed Satyakarna was the eldest. In the city of Varanasahvya,²⁷⁴ the mighty-armed one performed a sacrifice in which copious quantities of *dakshina* were given. Satyakarna's son was the powerful Shvetakarna. He possessed *dharma* in his soul and went to a hermitage in the forest, without having had a son. His wife possessed excellent eyebrows and was descended from the Yadava lineage. Her name was Malini or Grahamalini and she was Subahu's daughter. When she conceived, Shvetakarna, the undecaying lord of subjects, had left for the forest, pursuing *mahaprasthan*.²⁷⁵ He had already left and in that pregnant state, she followed him. Seeing that her beloved had gone, Malini followed him from the rear. Subahu's²⁷⁶ virtuous and lotus-eyed daughter was chaste and followed him there. Along the path, the maiden gave birth to a delicate boy. Leaving him there, she followed the king. The immensely fortunate one was chaste and devoted to her husband and acted like Droupadi in earlier times.²⁷⁷ The delicate boy wept amidst the bushes in the mountain. Out of pity towards the great-souled one, clouds appeared. Shravishta had two sons, Paippaladi and Koushika. They were filled with pity. They picked him and washed him with water. He was covered in blood and they cleaned his sides by rubbing him on the rocks. When he was rubbed in this way, he turned as dark as a goat. He was quite serene. Through destiny, his sides became as dark as a goat. Therefore, the two of them gave him the name of Ajaparshva.²⁷⁸ The two *brahmanas* reared him in Romaka's house. Since she didn't have a son, Romaka's wife adopted him. He became Romaki's²⁷⁹ son and the two *brahmanas* were advisers. Along with him, their sons and grandsons also led their lives. Such was the Pourava lineage and the Pandavas belonged to it. In this connection, Yayati, the son of Nahusha sang a *shloka*. The intelligent one had formerly suffered greatly from the onset of old age and was pleased.²⁸⁰ 'The sun, the moon and the planets may cease

to exist on earth, but there is no doubt that the earth will never be devoid of Pouravas.’ Such was the famous Pourava lineage and I have described it.

‘I will now speak about the lineages of Turvasu, Druhya, Anu and Yadu. Turvasu’s son was Vahni, and Gobhanu was his son. Gobhanu’s son was the undefeated king, Traishanu. Traishanu’s son was Karandhama and his son was Marutta. I have earlier spoken about another King Marutta, who was Avikshit’s son. Since this king was without a son, he undertook a sacrifice and gave away copious quantities of *dakshina*. Thus, the lord of the earth had a daughter named Samyata. As *dakshina*, he gave her away to the great-souled Samvarta. She had an unblemished son in the form of Pourava Dushyanta. ²⁸¹ O best among *brahmanas*! In this way, the curse that Yayati imposed on the lineage of Turvasu after the onset of old age, passed into the Pourava lineage. Dushyanta’s son was Karuroma, the lord of subjects. Karuroma’s son was Ahrida, and Ahrida had four sons—Pandya, Kerala, Kola and King Chola. The prosperous countries of Pandya, Chola and Kerala were named after them. O king! ²⁸² Druhya’s son was King Babhrusetu. His son was Angarasetu, who was also known as the lord of the wind-gods. In a battle, after an extremely great encounter that lasted for ten months, Yuvanashva’s son killed the powerful one with a great deal of effort. Angarasetu’s son was King Gandhara. It is after him that the great kingdom of Gandhara was named. The horses from the land of Gandhara are supreme among horses. Anu’s son was Dharma, and his son was Dhrita. Dhrita had a son named Shatadruha and Pracheta was his son. Pracheta’s son was Sucheta. I have spoken about his sons. ²⁸³ Yadu had five sons who were like the sons of the gods—Sahasrada, Payoda, Kroshta, Nila and Anjika. Sahasrada had three sons who were extremely devoted to *dharma*—Haihaya, Haya and King Venuhaya. Haihaya had a son named Dharmanetra. Dharmanetra’s son was Karta, and Karta had a son named Sahanja. The city named Sahanjani was established by that king. It has been heard that Mahishmat’s son was Bhadrashrenya. ²⁸⁴ Bhadrashrenya’s son was famous by the name of Durdama. Durdama’s intelligent son was named Kanaka. Kanaka had four sons who were famous in the world—Kritavirya, Kritouja, Kritakarma and Kritagni as the fourth.

‘Arjuna ²⁸⁵ was born as Kritavirya’s son. He possessed one thousand arms and became the lord of the seven *dvipas*. On a chariot that was as resplendent as the sun, he single-handedly conquered the entire earth. For ten thousand years, he performed extremely difficult austerities and tormented himself. Kartavirya worshipped Datta, who had been born from Atri’s lineage. The greatly energetic one granted him four boons. As his first supreme boon, he desired that he might possess one thousand arms. As the second, he desired that if he turned towards *adharma*, a virtuous person should restrain him. As the third, he desired that he should be able to conquer the earth through his ferocity, while being devoted to *dharma*. As the fourth, he desired that he would defeat many in battle and kill thousands of enemies, but while being engaged in an encounter, would be slain by someone who was superior in fighting. O *brahmanas*! When he fought, there were indeed one thousand arms. ²⁸⁶ He was a lord of yoga and through his yoga and his *maya*, they manifested themselves when he fought. Following the proper norms and using his ferocity, he conquered the entire earth, with all its seven *dvipas* and habitations, with its cities and its oceans. Following the decreed ordinances, he performed seven hundred sacrifices in those seven *dvipas*. O best among sages! This is what we have heard. O best among sages! In all the sacrifices, he gave away hundreds and thousands ²⁸⁷ of *dakshina*. All the sacrificial stakes and all the sacrificial altars were made out of gold. O best among sages! All the gods, stationed on their ornamented *vimanas*, and the *gandharvas* and the *apsaras*, always attended these sacrifices. There was a learned *gandharva* named Narada, the son of Varidasa. He was astounded at the grandeur of the sacrifice and recited a chant.’

Narada said, ‘Indeed, no other king can follow the path Kartavirya has taken and match him in sacrifices, donations, austerities, valour and learning. Even when he used his chariot to advance into the seven *dvipas* with a sword, a shield, and bow and arrows, men saw that a yogi was roaming around in those *dvipas*. The great king followed *dharma* and protected the subjects. Because of his powers, there was no grief or bewilderment. Possessions were not lost. He was a *chakravarti* who

enjoyed all the jewels. ²⁸⁸ He was the one who protected animals. He was the one who protected fields. Because of his yoga, Arjuna could shower rain, like Parjanya. ²⁸⁹ He possessed one thousand arms that were hard because of the twanging of the bowstring. His arrows illuminated like the one thousand rays of the sun. The immensely radiant defeated the *nagas*, sons of Karkotaka, and made them reside in the city of Mahishmati. ²⁹⁰ During the monsoon, the lotus-eyed one used his arms to playfully make the waves of the ocean roll back. The river Narmada was adorned with villages. ²⁹¹ When he sported in it, it was scared and agitated, and thousands of waves arose. When he agitated the great ocean with his one thousand arms, the giant *asuras*, residents of Patala ²⁹² were terrified and gave up all activities. When the king struck the giant waves with his arms, the fish and giant whales were agitated, and the gusts of wind that were created resulted in billows of foam and eddies. It was as if the gods and *asuras* were using Mandara to churn the ocean. ²⁹³ Because of the turbulence, the giant serpents thought that Tarkshya ²⁹⁴ had suddenly arrived and was descending on them. Therefore, they were terrified. But on seeing that terrible and supreme king, they stood quietly and lowered their hoods. They resembled the trunks of plantain trees, trembling in the evening wind. He used five arrows to confound Ravana, the lord of Lanka, and his army. He used his strength to bind him and drag him with the string of his bow. He defeated and subjugated him. Binding him, he brought him to Mahishmati. Pulastya heard that Poulastya Ravana had been bound by Arjuna. ²⁹⁵ He himself went and met Arjuna. Entreated by Pulastya, he released the *rakshasa* Poulastya. The sound of his twanging the bow with his one thousand arms was like the roaring of clouds, tinged with flickering lightning at the end of a yuga. The king's one thousand arms resembled a golden forest of palm trees. Since Bhargava ²⁹⁶ severed them in a battle, his valour was wonderful. Once, Chitrabhanu was thirsty and sought alms from him. As alms, the valiant one offered the seven *dvipas* to Vibhavas. ²⁹⁷ To satisfy Chitrabhanu, all the cities, villages, settlements of cattles and kingdoms blazed. Such were the powers of the great-souled one, Indra among men. Kartavirya burnt down mountains and forests. Using his powers, along with Chitrabhanu, Haihaya

²⁹⁸ burnt down the beautiful hermitage of Varuna's son, ²⁹⁹ though it was empty then. He got scared. Earlier, Varuna had obtained this radiant and excellent son. This was the sage named Vasishtha, also known as Apava. At this, lord Apava angrily cursed Arjuna. 'O Haihaya! You have not spared that part of the forest which belongs to me. You have perpetrated a wicked deed and someone else will kill you. This will be the mighty-armed and powerful son of Jamadagni, named Rama. That powerful one will sever your one thousand arms and swiftly crush you. The energetic brahmana, Bhargava will slay you.' He afflicted his enemies and no objects were lost while he ruled. The powerful Indra among men followed *dharma* and protected his subjects. However, because of the great sage's curse, he came by his death.

Lomaharshana continued, ³⁰⁰ 'O *brahmanas*! These are boons that he had himself asked for earlier. The great-souled one had one hundred sons, but only five of them survived. They were accomplished in the use of weapons—powerful, brave, illustrious and had *dharma* in their souls. They were Shurasena, Shura, Vrishana, Madhupadhvaja and Jayadhvaja. Of these, the one named Jayadhvaja was the great king of Avanti. Kartavirya's sons were brave and immensely strong. Jayadhvaja's son was the immensely strong Talajangha. It has been heard that his one hundred sons were famous as the Talajanghas. O best among sages! There were great-souled ones in the lineage of the Haihayas. They were said to be Vitihotras, Suvratas, Bhojas, Avantis, Toundikeras, the famous Talajanghas, Bharatas and Sujatas. There are many who are described. O *brahmanas*! Among the Yadavas, there were many performers of auspicious deeds, Vrisha and others. Vrisha established a lineage and his son was Madhu. Madhu had one hundred sons. These descendants of Vrisha were known as Vrishanas or Vrishnis. Since they were all descended from Madhu, they were also known as the Madhavas. Those descended from Yadu are known as the Yadavas, and not spoken of as the Haihayas. ³⁰¹ If a person always recounts the story of Kartavirya's birth, his riches are never destroyed in this world. Instead, what has been lost is regained. O best among *brahmanas*! These are the five lineages of the sons of Yayati and they have been described. Just as the five elements

nurture all mobile and immobile objects, these brave ones were praised in the worlds and held up the worlds. A king who listens to the creation of these five lineages becomes learned in *dharma* and *artha*. Such a lord has five sons who remain under his control. He obtains five boons that are extremely difficult to obtain in this world. These are a long life, fame, riches, sons and prosperity. O *brahmanas*! The account of the creation of these five lineages must be heard and retained. O best among sages! Now listen to my words about Kroshta's lineage. He extended Yadu's lineage, performed sacrifices and performed auspicious deeds. If a person hears about Kroshta's lineage, he is freed from all sins. It is in his lineage that Vishnu Hari, the extender of the Vrishni lineage, was born.'

Chapter 1(12) (Krishna's birth)

Lomaharshana said, 'Kroshta had two wives, Gandhari and Madri. Gandhari gave birth to the extremely strong Anamitra. Madri's two sons were Yudhajit and Devamidhusha. From these three sources, their descendants extended the Vrishni lineage. Madri's two sons had two auspicious sons, Vrishni and Andhaka.³⁰² Vrishni had two sons, Shvaphalka and Chitraka. O best among sages! Shvaphalka had *dharma* in his soul. Therefore, wherever he happened to be, there was no fear of disease. Nor was there fear of drought. O supreme among sages! On one occasion, the lord who is the chastiser of Paka³⁰³ did not rain in the kingdom of the king of Kashi for three years. He³⁰⁴ brought the extremely revered Shvaphalka there and because of his arrival, Harivahana³⁰⁵ showered down. In return, the king of Kashi bestowed his daughter on Shvaphalka as a wife. Every day, she used to give a cow to a brahmana. So, she came to be known as Gandini.³⁰⁶ Shvaphalka's son was Akrura. He was generous and brave and performed sacrifices. He was learned and devoted to guests. He gave away large quantities of *dakshina*. There were also Upamadgu, Madgu, Medura, Arimejaya, Avikshita, Upeksha, Shatrughna, Arimardana, Dharmadhrik, Yatidharma, Dharmoksha, Andhakar, Avaha and Prativaha.³⁰⁷ There was a beautiful daughter named Varangana. O excellent *brahmanas*! Through the beautiful-limbed Ugrasena,³⁰⁸ Akrura had two sons named Prasena and Upadeva, who were as radiant as the gods. Chitraka had sons named Prithu, Viprithu, Ashvagriva, Ashvabahu, Svaparshvaka, Gaveshana, Arishtanemi, Ashva, Sudharma, Dharmabhrit, Subahu and Bahubahu. He had two daughters named Shravishtha and Shravana. Through Asikni, Devamidhusha had a son named Shura. Shura had ten sons through his queen, Bhojya. The eldest was the mighty-armed Vasudeva, also known as

Anakadundubhi.³⁰⁹ When he was born, drums were sounded in the firmament. A great sound of drums arose in heaven and a great shower of flowers rained down on Shura's house. In the entire world of men on earth, there was no one who was his equal in beauty. He was best among men and his beauty was like that of the full moon. After this were born Devabhaga, Devashrava, Anadhrishti, Kanavaka, Vatsavan, Grinjama, Shyama, Shamika and Gandusha. There were also five beautiful daughters—Prithukirti, Pritha, Shrutadeva, Shrutashrava and Rajadhidevi. Each of these was a mother of brave sons. Avanti³¹⁰ married Shrutadeva and their son was Jagrihu. The king of Chedi married Shrutashrava and their son was King Shishupala. In an earlier life, he had been Hiranyakashipu, the king of the *daityas*. Vriddhasharma married Prithukirti. Their son was the brave and immensely strong Dantavakra, the lord of Karusha. Kunti³¹¹ adopted Pritha as a daughter and she married Pandu. Yudhishtira, who knew about *dharma*, was born from her and Dharma. Bhimasena was born from the wind-god. Dhananjaya was born from Indra and became a brave *atiratha*³¹² in this world, Shakra's equal in valour.'

'Anamitra's son was Shini, the youngest of those in the Vrishni lineage. Shini's son was Satyaka, and Satyaka's son was Yuyudhana Satyaki. Devabhaga had an immensely fortunate son named Uddhava. He was best among the learned and was spoken of as the excellent Devashrava. Through Ashmaki, Anadhrishti had an illustrious son named Shatrughna, who repulsed enemies. It has been heard that Shrutadeva³¹³ had Naishadi as a son. O best among sages! He was reared by the *nishadas* and his name was Ekalavya. Vatsavan had no sons. Therefore, the powerful Vasudeva, Shura's son, gave him his own son Koushika. Gandusha was also without sons, until Vishvaksena³¹⁴ gave him the sons—Charudeshna, Sucharu, Panchala, who possessed all the auspicious signs. He was brave and never retreated from the field of battle. O excellent *brahmanas*! Rukmini's mighty-armed son is the youngest of them all.³¹⁵ Whenever Charudeshna advanced, thousands of crows followed him at the rear, wishing to feed on the ones that Charudeshna would slay. Tantriya and Tantripala were Kanavaka's sons. Grinjima had two brave sons named Vira and Ashvahanu. Shyama's son

was Shamika, and Shamika obtained a kingdom. He desired to be more than an ordinary Bhoja and performed a *rajasuya* sacrifice. His son was Ajatashatru, the destroyer of enemies. I will now recount the names of Vasudeva's brave sons. Originating from three sources, the Vrishnis had many extremely energetic branches. A person who nurtures this extensive account and worships it, never suffers from a calamity.

'Vasudeva had fourteen beautiful women as his wives. They were Rohini, descended from the Pourava lineage, Madira, Vaishakhi, Bhadra and Sunamni as the fifth. There were Sahadeva, Shantideva, Shridevi, Devarakshita, Vrikadevi, Upadevi and Devaki as the seventh.³¹⁶ The two others, Sutanu and Vadava, were actually attendants. Bahlika's daughter was Rohini, descended from the Puru lineage. O best among sages! She was Anakadundubhi's favourite and eldest wife. Through her, he obtained his eldest son, Rama.³¹⁷ The other sons were Sarana, Shatha, Durdama, Damana, Shubhra, Pindaraka and Kushinara. Rohini also had a daughter named Chitra. These were the nine children. O best among sages! Chitra was given the new name of Subhadra and was known by it. Through Devaki, Vasudeva had the immensely illustrious Shouri³¹⁸ as a son. Through Revati, Rama had a beloved son named Nishatha. Through Subhadra, Partha had the charioteer Abhimanyu as a son. Through the princess of Kashi, Akrura had Satyaketu as a son.³¹⁹ Vasudeva had seven immensely fortunate wives.³²⁰ Listen to the names of the brave sons that he had. Bhoja and Vijaya were sons through Shantideva. Vrikadeva and Gada were sons through Sunama. The great-souled Agavaha was a son through Vrikadevi, who was the daughter of the king of Trigarta, whose priest was Shishirayana. He had a question about virility and to test the manliness, placed his hand on the testicles.³²¹ Having been falsely accused, Gargya was overcome by rage and for twelve years, his complexion assumed the hue of black iron. To prove the accusation wrong, he proceeded to have intercourse with a cowherd girl. However, the cowherd girl was actually an *apsara* who had assumed the attire of a cowherd girl. Though the undecaying Gargya's seed was extremely difficult to hold, she nurtured the embryo. It was on the instructions of the wielder of the trident³²² that she

had assumed human form and had become Gargya's wife. She, thus, gave birth to the immensely strong and brave Kalayavana. The upper half of the youth's body was round and symmetrical, and his frame was like that of a lion. O best among sages! The king of the *yavanas* was without a son and reared the child in the interior quarters of his palace. ³²³ That is the reason he came to be known as Kalayavana. When he became a king, desiring to fight, he asked the best among the *brahmanas* about who he should fight with. Lord Narada told him about the Vrishni and Andhaka lineages. He attacked Mathura with an *akshouhini* of soldiers. ³²⁴ Once there, he sent a messenger to the houses of the Vrishnis and the Andhakas. With the immensely intelligent Krishna at the forefront, scared as they were of the Yavana king, the Vrishnis and the Andhakas consulted among themselves. ³²⁵ Though this is not what they desired, all of them resolved to flee. Showing their respect for the wielder of the *pinaka* ³²⁶, they abandoned the beautiful city of Mathura. They desired to set up their homes in Kushasthali Dvaravati. If a person is pure and controlled in his senses, and if he listens to this account of Krishna's birth on auspicious occasions, he becomes happy and learned and does not suffer from any debts.'

Chapter 1(13) (Vrishni's lineage)

Lomaharshana said, 'Kroshta had an immensely illustrious son named Vrijinivan. Vrinjivan's son was Svahi, supreme among those who offered oblations to the gods. Svahi's son was King Ushadgu, supreme among eloquent ones. Ushadgu performed a great sacrifice at which many kinds of *dakshina* were offered, so that he might have the best of sons. The foremost among these sons was Chitraratha, with many kinds of deeds. Chitraratha's son was the brave Shashabindu. He was a supreme royal sage who undertook sacrifices at which large quantities of *dakshina* were offered. King Prithushrava, extensive in fame, was Shashabindu's son. He was praised as someone who knew about the Puranas. Prithushrava's son was Antara. Antara's son was Suyajna. Suyajna's son was Ushata, who performed all the sacrifices. Ushata was supreme among those who upheld their own *dharma*. Shineyu, the tormentor of enemies, was Ushata's son. Marutta, the king who was a royal sage, was his son. Marutta's eldest son was Kambalabarhisha. Though he was intolerant towards the rites of *dharma*, Kambalabarhisha had performed them. After one hundred stillborn sons, he obtained Rukmakavacha as a son. In a battle, Rukmakavacha killed one hundred armoured archers, shooting sharp arrows from his bow. He, thus, obtained supreme prosperity. Rukmakavacha's son was Parajita, the slayer of enemy heroes. Parajita had five immensely valiant and unvanquished sons named Rukmeshu, Prithurukma, Jyamagha, Palita and Hari. Their father gave away Palita and Hari to the king of Videha. Rukmeshu became the king and Prithurukma supported him. The two of them banished Jyamagha from the kingdom and he started to dwell in a hermitage. The king found peace in the forest, until he was goaded by some *brahmanas*. He then mounted a chariot and foisting a standard,

headed for another country. He dwelt alone on the banks of the Narmada, in Mekhala and Mrityikavati. Having conquered Mount Rikshavan, he next began to dwell in Shuktimati. Jyamagha's wife was Shaibya and she was powerful and virtuous. Though the king was without a son, he did not take another wife. Having been victorious in a battle, he obtained a maiden. Scared, the lord of men went to his wife and said, 'This is a daughter-in-law.' On hearing this, she asked, 'Whose daughter-in-law is she?' Jyamagha, supreme among kings, replied to her. The king said, 'She will be the wife of the son you give birth to.' The maiden then resorted to fierce austerity. Because of that immensely fortunate maiden, the virtuous and aged Shaibya had a son named Vidarbha. Through the princess who became a daughter-in-law, Vidharbha later had two brave and learned sons, Kratha and Koushika. They were accomplished in fighting. Vidarbha had another son named Bhima, and Bhima's son was Kunti. Kunti had a son named Dhrishta, who was powerful and irresistible in battle. Dhrishta had three brave sons who were extremely devoted to *dharma*. Their names were Avanta, Dasharha and the powerful Vishahara. Dasharha's son was Vyoma and his son is said to have been Jimuta. Jimuta's son was Vikriti, and Bhimaratha was his son. Bhimaratha had a son named Navaratha. Navaratha had a son named Dasharatha, and Shakuni was his son. Shakuni's son was King Karambha, and Karambha's son was Devarata. Devakshatra was his son. Devakshatra's son was the immensely illustrious Daivakshatri. Devakshatra's beloved son seemed to have been born in the womb of the gods. Since his speech was sweet, he was known as Madhu ³²⁷ and his lineage is known as that of King Madhu. Through a princess of Vidarbha, Madhu had a son named Purudvan, who was supreme among men. Madhu had another wife who belonged to the Ikshvaku lineage and through her, he had a son named Satvat. He possessed spirit and all the qualities that extended his fame. A person who knows about the offspring of the great-souled Jyamagha obtains supreme delight and is always blessed with offspring.

'Satvata was spirited. Through Koushalya, he had sons—Bhagina, Bhajamana, the divine King Devavridha, the mighty-armed Andhaka and

Vrishni, the delight of the Yadu lineage. Hear in detail about the offspring of these four, as they are described. Bhajamana's two wives were the daughters of Srinjaya—Bahyaka and Upabahyaka. Through them, he had many sons. Through Bahyaka, Srinjaya's daughter, Bhajamana's sons were Krimi, Kramana, Dhrista and the brave Puranjaya. Through Upabahyaka, Srinjaya's daughter, Bhajamana's sons were Ayutajit, Sahasrajit, Shatajit and Dashaka. King Devavridha performed extensive austerities, having made up his mind that he desired a son who would possess all the qualities. He made up his mind to perform austerity and touched the waters of the river Parnasha.³²⁸ Because he constantly touched the water, the river was kindly disposed towards him. The river thought and could not make up her mind. 'He has turned his mind towards the beneficial. However, he has not yet approached a woman who can bear him such a son. Therefore, I should myself approach him and help him.' The river assumed the form of a supremely radiant maiden. The lord, the king, accepted her. Because of the energy of that generous one, she conceived. O *brahmanas*! After ten months, the supreme among rivers delivered King Devavridha's son, Babhru, the possessor of all the qualities. Those who know about the Puranas chant the qualities of the great-souled Devavridha. 'Babhru is best among men and Devavridha is the equal of the gods. We had not heard about a person like him³²⁹ earlier. Nor had we seen such a person at close quarters, or from a distance.' Babhru, Devavridha's son, despatched seven thousand and sixty-six men to heaven. He was generous and performed sacrifices. He was intelligent and devoted to *brahmanas*. He was firm in wielding weapons. He had an extremely great lineage, those known as Sartikavata Bhojas. Through the daughter of Kashi, Andhaka had four sons—Kukura, Bhajamana, Sasaka and Balabarhisha. Kukura's son was Vrishti, and Vrishti's son was Kapotaroma. Kapotaroma's son was Tittiri, and his son was Punarvasu. Punarvasu's son was Abhijit. Abhijit had twins, Ahuka and Shrahuka. They were famous and supreme among those who were renowned. This chant about Ahuka is cited. 'He was surrounded by those dressed in white. He was great, young in form and unmatched. With eighty shields, Ahuka advanced in front of the army. Among those who followed

this infinitely energetic Bhoja, there was no one who did not have one hundred sons, no one who had a lifespan of less than one thousand years, no one who was not the performer of auspicious deeds, and no one who was not the performer of sacrifices. With Bhoja's permission, ten thousand elephants marched in the eastern direction, along with ten thousand chariots that rumbled like the clouds. The chariots possessed bumpers and their standards seemed to touch the lap of the moon. There were twenty-one thousand chests filled with silver and gold. Similarly, there were thousands in the northern direction. The Bhoja brought the lords of the earth under his subjugation with a bow-string that tinkled with bells.' It is said that the Andhakas bestowed their sisters on those from Avanti. Through the daughter of Kashi, Ahuka had two sons—Devaka and Ugrasena. They were like those born from the wombs of the gods. Devaka had four sons who were like the residents of heaven—Devavan, Upadeva, Sudeva and Devarakshita. He had seven daughters whom he bestowed on Vasudeva—Devaki, Shantideva, Sudeva, Devarakshita, Vrikadevi, Upadevi and Sunamni as the seventh.³³⁰ Ugrasena had nine sons and Kamsa was the eldest. The others were Nyagrodha, Sunama, Kanka, Subhushana, Rashtrapala, Sutanu, Anavrishti and Pushtiman. They had five sisters—Kamsa³³¹, Kamsavati, Sutanu³³², Rashtrapali and the beautiful Kanka. Ugrasena and his offspring, born in the Kukura lineage, have been described. A man who sustains the account of this infinitely energetic Kukura lineage in his heart, obtains an extensive lineage with many sons.'

Chapter 1(14) (Return of Syamantaka)

Lomaharshana said, ‘Bhajamana’s son was Viduratha, foremost among charioteers.³³³ Viduratha’s son was the brave Rajadhideva. Rajadhideva then had brave sons—Datta, Atidatta, the powerful Shonashva, Shvetavahana, Shami, Dandasharma, Dattashatru and Shatrujit. Their sisters were Shravana and Shravishtha. Shami’s son was Pratichatra, and Pratichatra’s son was Svayambhoja. Svayambhoja’s son was Hridika. All of Hridika’s sons were terrible in valour. Kritavarma was the eldest and Shatadhanva was in the middle. There were also Devanta, Naranta, Vaitarana the physician, Sudanta, Atidanta, Nikashya and Kamadambhaka. Devanta had a learned son, Kambalabarhisha. His other sons were Asamouja and Nasamouja. Since Asamouja possessed no sons, it is said that Andhaka bestowed his sons, Sudamshtara, Sucharu and Krishna, on him. Kroshta had two wives, Gandhari and Madri. Gandhari gave birth to the immensely strong Anamitra.³³⁴ Madri’s son was Yudhajit, also known as Devamidhusha. Anamitra was victorious and could not be vanquished by his enemies. Anamitra had a son named Nighna,³³⁵ and Nighna’s two sons were Prasena and Satrajit, who were the conquerors of enemy soldiers.

‘While he dwelt in Dvaravati, through Surya,³³⁶ Prasena obtained a divine and extremely large gem named Syamantaka. Satrajit was Surya’s friend, and Surya was as dear to him as his own life. On one occasion, at the end of the night, the supreme among charioteers mounted his chariot and went to the banks of a river to touch water and worship Ravi. While he was worshipping Surya, Vivasvat appeared in front of him. The illustrious lord manifested himself in a form with a radiant disc. The king³³⁷ spoke to Vivasvat, who was standing in front of him. ‘O lord of shining bodies! O god! I see you in front of me, in your disc of energy, just as I always see

you in the sky. What is special about this? In truth, what have I gained by being associated with you?’ Hearing this, in privacy, the illustrious lord took Syamantaka, the best of jewels, off from his neck and put it aside. The king was then able to see his form alone. ³³⁸ On seeing this, he was pleased, and they conversed for a while. As Vivasvat got ready to leave, Satrajit spoke to him. ‘O lord! You always illuminate the world with your radiance. O illustrious one! Therefore, you should give me this best among jewels.’ ³³⁹ At this, Bhaskara ³⁴⁰ gave him the Syamantaka jewel. Hanging it around his neck, the lord of the earth entered the city. Thinking that it was Surya who was arriving, people started to run away. The king astounded the city and his inner quarters. Out of affection, Satrajit, the lord of men, gave that extraordinary and divine gem, Syamantaka, to his brother, Prasena. Placed in the abode of the Vrishnis and the Andhakas, this gem produced gold. The rain-god showered at the right time and there was no fear of disease.’

‘From Prasena, Govinda desired the gem Syamantaka. ³⁴¹ Although he was capable of doing so, he did not seize it. On one occasion, adorned with the gem, Prasena went out on a hunt. While he was roaming around in the forest, for the sake of the gem, a lion killed him. The immensely strong king of the bears chased after the lion and killed it. On killing it and seizing the gem, it entered its cave. Knowing that Krishna had desired the gem, all the Vrishnis and the Andhakas suspected that Krishna had killed Prasena. Knowing of their suspicions, the one with *dharma* in his soul didn’t tell them that he had not done the deed. Instead, he resolved to go to the forest and bring the gem back. Krishna and the men who wished him well ³⁴² followed Prasena’s footsteps and went to all the places where Prasena had gone in the course of his hunt. He searched the supreme Mount Rikshavan and the excellent Mount Vindhya. After he tired out from searching, the great-minded one saw the dead bodies of Prasena and his horse. However, he did not find the gem. Then, not very far from Prasena’s body, he saw the lion’s dead body. Because of the footprints of the bear, he deduced that it had been killed by a bear. Following those footprints, Madhava ³⁴³ entered the bear’s home. In the bear’s den, he heard a female voice. O *brahmanas*! This was the nurse speaking to Jambavat’s ³⁴⁴ young son, using the

Syamantaka gem to play with him. The nurse said, ‘Do not cry. The lion killed Prasena and Jambavat killed the lion. O delicate child! Do not weep. Here is Syamantaka.’ These words clearly came from inside the den. Placing the Yadus and the wielder of the plough ³⁴⁵ at the entrance of the cave, the illustrious one quickly entered the cave that he saw. Inside the cave, the wielder of the Sharnga bow ³⁴⁶ saw Jambavat. Inside the cave, Vasudeva ³⁴⁷ fought with Jambavat. Govinda used his fists and fought for twenty-one days. When Krishna entered the hole and did not emerge, the others, with Baladeva at the forefront, returned to Dvaravati and reported that Krishna had been killed. Meanwhile, Vasudeva defeated the immensely strong Jambavat and obtained from him Jambavati, the respected daughter of the king of the bears. Because of the entreaties of the king of the bears and to cleanse himself of the false stain, he also accepted the gem Syamantaka and emerged from the hole. With the humble attendants ahead of him, ³⁴⁸ Krishna returned to Dvaraka. Having obtained the gem, Achyuta ³⁴⁹ cleared his name. In an assembly of all the Satvatas, he gave it to Satrajit. Thus, Krishna, the slayer of enemies, cleansed himself of the false accusation. By obtaining the Syamantaka back, he overcame that taint.

‘Satrajit had ten wives and one hundred sons through them. Three of them are famous, and Bhangakara was the eldest. The brave Vatamati and Vasumedha were others. O best among *brahmanas*! He also had three daughters who were famous in all the directions. Satyabhama was the best among them. The others were Vratini, firm in her vows, and Prasvapini. As a wife, he bestowed her ³⁵⁰ on Krishna. Bhangakara had two sons, Sabhaksha and Naveya, both supreme among men. They possessed all the qualities and were handsome and learned. Yudhajit was born as the son of Madri and Vrishni’s descendant. ³⁵¹ Vrishni’s descendant ³⁵² had two sons, Shvaphalka and Chitraka. Shvaphalka obtained the daughter of the king of Kashi as a wife. Her name was Gandini and her father gave her many cows. She gave birth to the mighty-armed, learned and famous Akrura. He was immensely fortunate and performed sacrifices at which copious quantities of *dakshina* were distributed. The other sons were Upamadgu, Madgu, Mudara, Arimardana, Arikshnepa, Upeksha, Shatruha, Arimejaya,

Dharmabhrit, Dharma, Gridhrabhoja, Andhaka, Avaha and Prativaha. There was a beautiful daughter named Varangana. She was a famous queen, ³⁵³ and her daughter was Vasundhara, who possessed beauty and youth and charmed all creatures. O descendant of the Kuru lineage! Through Ugrasena's daughter, Akrura had two sons named Sudeva and Upadeva. They were as radiant as the gods and were the delight of their lineage. Chitraka had sons named Prithu, Viprithu, Ashvagriva, Ashvabahu, Suparshvaka, Gaveshana, Arishtanemi, Dharma, Dharmabhrit, Subahu and Bahubahu. The daughters were Shravishtha and Shravana. Thus, the great account of the false accusation against Krishna has been recited. If a person knows about it, a false accusation never touches him.'

Chapter 1(15) (Akrura gets Syamantaka)

Lomaharshana said, ‘Krishna gave the Syamantaka jewel to Satrajit. Shatadhanva, who descended from the Bhoja lineage, desired it, as he had desired the unblemished Satyabhama. Akrura also desired her, and Syamantaka. In the night, the immensely strong Shatadhanva killed Satrajit. Seizing the gem, he gave it to Akrura. O *brahmanas*! Akrura accepted the gem and had an agreement with him. ‘Let it not be known that the gem is with me. If Krishna attacks you, I will help you. There is no doubt that everyone in Dvaraka will be under my subjugation now.’ When her father was slain, the spirited Satyabhama was afflicted with grief. She ascended a chariot and left for the city of Varanavata.³⁵⁴ She reached her husband’s side and shedding tears, miserably told him about what Bhoja Shatadhanva had done. With the Pandavas having been burnt, Hari offered oblations of water to them. For the sake of the Pandu lineage, he handed over the task of the funeral rites to Satyaki.

‘Madhusudana swiftly arrived in Dvaraka. The handsome one spoke these words to his elder brother, the wielder of the plough.³⁵⁵ Krishna said, ‘O lord! The lion killed Prasena and Satrajit has been slain by Shatadhanva. It seems to me that Syamantaka is headed towards me and that I will be its owner. Let us quickly ascend a chariot and go and kill the *maharatha* Bhoja. O mighty-armed one! Syamantaka will belong to us.’ There was a tumultuous encounter between Bhoja and Krishna. Shatadhanva looked for Akrura in all directions. Akrura saw that Bhoja and Janardana were engaged in a duel. Scared of the curse,³⁵⁶ Akrura did not help Hridika’s son,³⁵⁷ though he was capable. Afraid, Bhoja’s thoughts turned towards running away. On Hridaya, he fled for one hundred *yojanas*.³⁵⁸ O *brahmanas*! Bhoja possessed a famous horse named Hridaya and it could dash for one

hundred *yojanas*. However, Krishna pursued him. After one hundred *yojanas*, Hridaya tired and slowed down. On seeing the chariot pursuing him, Shatadhanva's mind was afflicted. O *brahmanas*! He abandoned the dead horse, which had died because of fatigue and exertion, its breath of life having ascended upwards. Krishna spoke to Rama. Krishna said, 'O mighty-armed one! You remain here. I discern a weakness in my horse too. I will pursue him on foot and seize the gem Syamantaka.' Achyuta pursued Shatadhanva on foot. O *brahmanas*! The one who knew about supreme weapons slew him near the boundaries of Mithila. But though he killed the immensely strong Bhoja, he did not see Syamantaka. When Krishna returned, the wielder of the plough told him, 'Give me the gem.' Krishna replied, 'I don't have it.' Rama became full of anger and spoke to Janardana. Balarama said, 'Shame on you. You have dishonoured me earlier too. I have tolerated it because you are my brother. May you be fortunate. I am departing. I have nothing more to do with you, or with Dvaraka, or with the Vrishnis.' Rama, the destroyer of enemies, entered Mithila. The lord of Mithila honoured him and gave him all the objects of desire.

'During this time, the supremely intelligent one of the Babhru lineage collected all the diverse kinds of materials required and incessantly performed sacrifices. ³⁵⁹ The gem was like a talisman, and he consecrated himself for the sacrifices to protect it. Gandi's wise and immensely illustrious descendant did this for the sake of Syamantaka. There were many kinds of objects and the best of riches and jewels. The one with *dharma* in his soul performed sacrifices for sixty years. The great-souled one's sacrifice has come to be known as *Akrura yajna*. All the many kinds of *dakshina* and all the diverse objects of pleasure were offered. King Duryodhana went to the lord who was in Mithila. ³⁶⁰ From the powerful Baladeva, he learnt the divine art of fighting with the mace. Later, with the Vrishni and Andhaka *maharathas*, the great-souled Krishna sought Rama's favours and brought him back to Dvaraka. With Satrajit and his relatives having been killed while they were asleep, Akrura, bull among men, and the Andhakas became extremely strong. Fearing a clash within the kin, Krishna ignored this. When Akrura left, the chastiser of Paka ceased to shower. ³⁶¹

When it did not rain, the kingdom faced many kinds of difficulties. The Kukuras and Andhakas pacified Akrura. When the lord of generosity returned to Dvaravati again, the one with the thousand eyes ³⁶² showered down and there were water bodies in Kaksha. ³⁶³ O supreme among sages! To please Vasudeva ³⁶⁴, the intelligent Akrura showed him proper honour and bestowed his sister on him. Through his yoga, Krishna deciphered that the jewel was with the descendant of the Babhru lineage. Amid an assembly, Janardana spoke to Akrura. Krishna said, ‘O lord! You have the gem, supreme among jewels, in your possession. O one who deserves honours! Give it to me. Otherwise, do not show me false signs of leadership. O unblemished one! For sixty years, my rage against you has been increasing. After this great period has elapsed, you must show me proper respect.’ Thus, addressed by Krishna in the assembly of all the Satvatas, the immensely intelligent one from the Babhru lineage gave him the gem with great difficulty. The scorcher of enemies received it from Babhru’s hands in this straightforward way. However, cheerful in his mind, Krishna again returned the gem to Babhru. Having obtained the supreme gem Syamantaka from Krishna’s hands, Gandini’s son tied it around his neck. ³⁶⁵ He was as radiant as the one with the rays. ³⁶⁶

Chapter 1(16) (Description of *dvipas*)

The sages said, ‘You have recited an extremely great account about the descendants of the Bharata lineage, of all the kings, gods, *danavas*, *gandharvas*, *uragas*, *rakshasas*, *daityas*, *siddhas* and *guhyakas*,³⁶⁷ of their extraordinary deeds, valour and determination of *dharma*. There are supreme, divine and diverse accounts of their births. O immensely intelligent one! You have properly described Prajapati’s creation to us and about how everything in this wonderful universe, mobile and immobile, originated—all the Prajapatis, *guhyakas* and *apsaras*. O immensely fortunate one! You have recited and we have heard this wonderful account. This ancient account articulated in melodious words brings auspicious fruits. It is pleasant to the mind and to the ears. Indeed, this pleasant account is as revered as *amrita*. We now wish to hear about the entire globe of the earth. O one who knows everything! We have a great curiosity and you should describe it to us. O immensely intelligent one! Right up to the frontiers of the ocean, what are the *dvipas*, *varshas*, mountains, forests, rivers and regions sacred to gods and others?³⁶⁸ What are their dimensions? What are their foundations and natures? What is the earth established on? You should speak to us about this.’

Lomaharshana replied, ‘O sages! Listen. I will tell you about this briefly. Even if I speak for one hundred years, I am incapable of describing it in detail. O *brahmanas*! The *dvipas* are Jambu, Plaksha, Shalmala, Kusha, Krouncha, Shaka and Pushkara as the seventh. Each of these seven *dvipas* is surrounded by seven oceans—Lavana, Ikshu, Sura, Sarpi, Dadhi, Dugdha and Jala.³⁶⁹ O Indras among *brahmanas*! Jamdu-dvipa is located right in the middle of these and in its centre is Meru, the golden mountain. Its height is eighty-four thousand *yojanas*. Sixteen thousand *yojanas* penetrate inside the

earth. The breadth at the top is thirty-two thousand *yojanas* and at the base, it is sixteen thousand *yojanas* in every direction. ³⁷⁰ The earth is like a lotus and the mountain is established like its pericarp. Himalayas, Hemakuta and Nishadha are *varsha* mountains to the south and Nila, Shveta and Shringi are *varsha* mountains to the south. The two great mountains in the centre ³⁷¹ are each one hundred thousand *yojanas* long. Each mountain is progressively ten thousand *yojanas* shorter than the preceding one. ³⁷² All the mountains are two thousand *yojanas* high and broad. O *brahmanas*! Bharata is said to be the first *varsha* and Kimpurusha is the one that comes next. ³⁷³ Harivarsha is to the south of Meru. Ramyaka is to the north and Hiranmaya is next to it. O supreme *brahmanas*! Uttarakuru is like Bharata. Each of these extends for nine thousand *yojanas*. Ilavrita is in the centre and the golden mountain of Meru rises up there. O immensely fortunate ones! In four directions from Meru, Ilavrita extends for nine thousand *yojanas*. There are four mountains, each ten thousand *yojanas* high, which exist like supporting pillars for Meru. The one to the east is named Mandara, the one to the south Gandhamadana, the one to the west Vipula and the one to the north Suparshva. A *kadamba* tree, a *jambu* tree, a *pippala* tree in Vipula and a *vata* tree rise like standards in these mountains. ³⁷⁴ Each of these mountains stretches for eleven hundred *yojanas*. O supreme among *brahmanas*! Jambu-dvipa is so named because of the *jambu* tree. The fruit of the *jambu* tree is as large as a huge elephant. It falls from the summit ³⁷⁵ on the ground in all directions and is shattered. The flow of that juice is known as River Jambu and the people who reside there, drink it. Therefore, they do not perspire, or suffer from bad odour in their bodies. They do not suffer from old age, or the decay of the senses. Having drunk it, people who are born there do not suffer from any mental ailments. The juice, which is like *amrita*, reaches the banks and dried up by the pleasant wind that blows, becomes the gold known as *jambunada*. This is used to make ornaments for the *siddhas*. Bhadrashva is to the east of Meru and Ketumala is to the west. O best among sages! Ilavrita is between these two. In the east, there is the grove named Chaitraratha and in the south, Gandhamadana. In the west, there is said to be Vaibhrajya and in the north, the one named Nandana. ³⁷⁶

There are four lakes that are always enjoyed by the gods—Arunodaya, Mahabhadra, Asitoda and Manasa. The mountains Shantavan, Chakrakumbha, Kurari, Malyavan, Vaikanka and others are like filaments³⁷⁷ on Meru's eastern flank. The mountains Trikuta, Shishira, Patanga, Ruchaka, Nishadha and others are like filaments on Meru's southern flank. The mountains Shikhivasa, Vaidurya, Kapila, Gandhamadana, Janudhi and so on are like filaments on Meru's western flank. These are just after Meru and they are stationed as if they form Meru's stomach. The mountains Shankhakuta, Rishabha, Hamsa, Naga, Kalanjara and others are like filaments on Meru's northern flank. O Indras among *brahmanas*! Brahma's famous, divine and great city is on Meru's summit and extends for fourteen thousand *yojanas*. Around it, in the eight directions and sub-directions, there are the famous and excellent cities of Indra and the other guardians of the worlds. Emerging from Vishnu's feet and flooding the lunar disc, Ganga descends from heaven and flows all around Brahma's city. Having descended there, it flows in four directions. In due order, they are Sita, Alakananda, Chakshu and Bhadra. Towards the east and in the firmament, Sita flows from one mountain to another mountain. It passes through Bhadrashva, the *varsha* towards the east, and flows into the ocean. O best among *brahmanas*! In a similar way, Alakananda flows towards the south, through Bharata, divides itself into seven streams, and flows into the ocean. Chakshu flows through all the western mountains, flows through the *varsha* towards the west, known as Ketumala, and flows into the ocean. O best among *brahmanas*! In a similar way, Bhadra flows towards the north, passes through the mountains and Uttarakuru, and meets the ocean in the north. Malyavan and Gandhamadana extend up to the mountains Nila and Nishadha. Meru is in between these two, in the shape of a pericarp. Bharata, Ketumala, Bhadrashva and Kuru are like petals of the mountain of the world.³⁷⁸ They are outside the mountains that form the boundary. Jathara and Devakuta are the two mountains that constitute the boundary. Between Nila and Nishadha, they extend from the south to the north. Gandhamadana and Kailasa stretch from the west to the east, up to the oceans, for a length of eighty thousand *yojanas*. Nishadha and Pariyatra are mountains that

constitute a boundary, stretching from the south to the north between Nila and Nishadha. ³⁷⁹ They are established on the east and the west of Meru. ³⁸⁰ Trishira and Jarudhi are mountains that constitute a boundary to the north. They stretch from the ocean on the east to the ocean on the west. O *brahmanas*! I have, thus, spoken about the mountains that constitute boundaries. They are established along Meru's stomach in four directions, two mountains in each direction. There are mountains that are like filaments in four directions of Meru. O *brahmanas*! These are Shitanta and the others, and are extremely pleasant. There are valleys in these mountains frequented by *siddhas* and *charanas*. ³⁸¹ There, the groves and the cities are extremely beautiful. O supreme among sages! Excellent abodes exist there for Lakshmi, Vishnu, Agni, Surya and Indra of the gods, frequented by men and *kinnaras*. ³⁸² Night and day, *gandharvas*, *yakshas*, *rakshasas*, *daityas* and *danavas* always sport in the beautiful valleys in those mountains. O *brahmanas*! These regions are said to be like heaven on earth, with the residences of those who are devoted to *dharma*. The performers of wicked deeds can never go there, not even in hundreds of births.'

'O *brahmanas*! In Bhadrashva, the illustrious Vishnu exists in the form of Hayashira. In Ketumala, he is in the form of *varaha*. In Bharata, he is in the form of *kurma*. In Kuru, the eternal Govinda exists in the form of *matsya*. He exists everywhere in his *vishvarupa* form. ³⁸³ Hari is the lord of everything. O *brahmanas*! He is the foundation of everything. He is in the *atman* of everything. O supreme among *brahmanas*! In the eight *varshas*, ³⁸⁴ Kimpurusha and the others, there is no grief, exertion, anxiety or fear of hunger. The subjects are always healthy, without any fear. They do not suffer from any kind of misery. The lifespan is fixed at ten or twelve thousand years. O *brahmanas*! The inhabitants do not suffer from hunger and thirst, or other feelings associated with the earth. In those regions, there is no conception of *krita*, *treta* and the other yugas. O supreme among *brahmanas*! There are seven *kulachalas* in each of those *varshas*. ³⁸⁵ Hundreds of rivers flow there.'

Chapter 1(17) (Jambudvipa)

Lomaharshana said, ‘The *varsha* that is to the north of the ocean and south of the Himalayas is known by the name of Bharata and the subjects there are known as Bharati. O lords among sages! It extends for nine thousand *yojanas*. This is *karma bhumi* ³⁸⁶ for those who desire heaven or emancipation. The seven *kulaparvatas* here are Mahendra, Malaya, Sahya, Shuktimat, Mount Riksha, Vindhya and Pariyatra. O *brahmanas*! From here, people go to heaven. It is from here that they obtain emancipation. It is also from here that men are born as inferior species, or go to hell. When the middle is over, ³⁸⁷ it is from here that one goes to heaven, or obtains *moksha*. Indeed, for mortals, there is no other place that has been ordained as *karma bhumi*. Hear about the nine sub-divisions of Bharatavarsha—Indradvipa, Kaserumat, Tamraparna, Gabhastimat, Nagadvipa, Soumya, Gandharva and Varuna. ³⁸⁸ Out of them, the ninth sub-division is surrounded by the ocean. From the south to the north, this sub-division extends for one thousand *yojanas*. The Kiratas live to the east and the Yavanas to the west. In the middle region, *brahmanas*, *kshatriyas*, *vaishyas* and shudras reside. They perform sacrifices, fight, engage in trade and do other things to ensure subsistence. Shatadru, Chandrabhaga and others flow from the feet of the Himalayas. O sages! Others flow from Pariyatra, Vedasmriti being the foremost. Narmada, Surasa and other rivers flow from the Vindhyas. Tapi, ³⁸⁹ Payoshni, ³⁹⁰ Nirvindhya ³⁹¹ and Kaveri are the chief rivers that flow from the feet of Riksha. The sins of those who hear about these are cleansed. Godavari, Bhimarathi, ³⁹² Krishna, Venya and others—these rivers are said to flow from the feet of Sahya. They dispel all fear of sin. Kritamala and Tamraparni are the foremost among those that flow from Malayas. Trisandhya, Rishikulya and others are said to be the ones that flow from

Mahendra. Rishikulya, ³⁹³ Kumara and others flow from the feet of Shuktimat. There are said to be thousands of minor rivers that are tributaries of these. The Kurus and Panchalas are those who live in the central region. There are those who reside in the east, such as the inhabitants of Kamarupa. The Poundras, Kalingams and Magadhas dwell everywhere in the south. Beyond these boundaries are those from Sourashtra, Shundras, Abhiras, Arbudas, Malavas, those who live in Pariyatra, Souviras, Saindhapannas, Shalvas, those who live in Shakala, Madraramas, Ambashthas, Parasikas and others. They reside along the banks of the rivers and always drink their waters. They are immensely fortunate, happy and healthy. O great sage! ³⁹⁴ The four yugas, *krita*, *treta*, *dvapara* and *kali*, exist in Bharatavarsha and nowhere else. Mendicants torment themselves in austerities here. The performers of sacrifices offer oblations. For the sake of the world hereafter, people donate lovingly. It is in Jambudvipa that sacrifices are always performed for Purusha, who is embodied in sacrifices. Vishnu is worshipped through sacrifices and he is the sacrifice. It is not like this in the other *dvipas*. O great sage! ³⁹⁵ Within Jambudvipa, Bharata is the best. It is here that one performs *karma*. The other places are *bhoga bhumi*. ³⁹⁶ O excellent one! After thousands and thousands of births here, one sometimes acquires enough good merits to be born as a human being. Therefore, the gods sing a song. ‘Those who are born in this land of Bharata are blessed. That is because beings who are born as humans here can obtain both, heaven and emancipation. One must resolve to undertake deeds for the sake of the fruits. Everything must be vested in Vishnu, a form of the *paramatman*. When *karma* is exhausted, one obtains union with the infinite one. One obtains that unblemished end. We know that when the good merits that have granted us heaven have been exhausted, we will again be tied to *karma* and the bondage of the body. Blessed are those who are born as humans in Bharata. Indeed, those who are devoid of senses and intelligence, but are born here, are also blessed.’ O *brahmanas*! I have briefly described Jambudvipa and its nine *varshas* to you. Its expanse is one hundred thousand *yojanas*. O *brahmanas*! On the outside of Jambudvipa,

surrounding it for that expanse of one hundred thousand *yojanas*, the salty ocean exists like a girdle.'

Chapter 1(18) (Oceans and continents)

Lomaharshana said, ‘Just as the *dvipa*, known as Jambu, is surrounded by a salty ocean, Plakshadvipa surrounds that salty ocean. The expanse of Jambudvipa is said to be one hundred thousand *yojanas*. O *brahmanas*! Plakshadvipa is said to be double the size. The lord of Plakshadvipa, Medhatithi, had seven sons. The eldest was named Shantamaya and the others were Shishira, Sukhodaya, Ananda, Shiva, Kshemaka and Dhruva. All these seven were the lords of Plakshadvipa. Thus, the *varshas* of Plakshadvipa are named Shantamaya, Shishira, Sukhoda, Ananda, Shiva, Kshemaka and Dhruva. O supreme among sages! There are seven mountains that exist as boundaries of this region. Listen to their names. They are Gomeda, Chandra, Narada, Dundubhi, Somaka, Sumanas and Mount Vaibhaja as the seventh. O unblemished ones! Along with gods and *gandharvas*, subjects always reside in these beautiful *varshas* and in the mountains of these *varshas*. Those habitations are sacred. People are born after a long period of time. ³⁹⁷ They do not suffer from physical or mental ailments and are happy all the time. There are seven rivers in these *varshas*, and they flow into the ocean. I will tell you their names. Hearing about them cleanses all sins. They are Anutapta, Shikhi, Vipasha, Tridiva, Kramu, Amrita and Sukrita. These are the seven rivers. O *brahmanas*! The chief mountains and rivers have been mentioned. There are thousands of minor mountains and rivers. The people in the habitations drink the water from these rivers and are always happy. O *brahmanas*! All the rivers flow downwards, not a single one flows upwards. O supreme among *brahmanas*! The divisions into yugas do not exist in those seven regions. The time is always like that in *treta yuga*. O *brahmanas*! Beginning with Plakshadvipa and ending with Shakadvipa, people live for five thousand years and do not

suffer from any disease. Depending on the *varna* and the *ashrama*, there are four types of divisions of *dharma* there. There are four *varnas* too. O learned ones! I will tell you about them. O supreme among sages! Aryakas, Kurus, Vivishvas and Bhavinas are respectively *brahmanas*, *kshatriyas*, *vaishyas* and shudras. O supreme among *brahmanas*! Right in the middle, there is an extremely large *plaksha* tree that is as large as the *jambu* tree.³⁹⁸ This results in the name Plakshadvipa. Hari is the creator of everything in the universe and the lord of everything. Aryakas and the other *varnas* there worship the illustrious one in the form of Soma. Plakshadvipa is surrounded by an ocean of sugar-cane juice that girdles it. This is of the same size as Plakshadvipa itself. O best among sages! I have, thus, spoken to you about Plakshadvipa.'

'I will now briefly tell you about Shalmala. Listen to me again. O *brahmanas*! The lord of Shalmala was the valiant Vapushmat. O supreme among *brahmanas*! His sons were Shveta, Harita, Jimuta, Rohita, Vaidyuta, Manasa and Suprabha. There are seven *varshas* named after them. Shalmaladvipa surrounds the ocean of sugar-cane juice on every side and is twice the size of the ocean. It should be known that there are seven mountains that are the source of jewels. There are seven rivers that divide the *varshas*. The mountains are Kumuda, Unnata, Balahaka as the third, Drona with great herbs, Mount Kanka as the fifth, Mahisha as the sixth and Kakudma, supreme among mountains, as the seventh. O *brahmanas*! The names of the rivers are Shroni, Toya, Vitrishna, Chakra, Shukra, Vimochini and Nivritti as the seventh. Remembering them pacifies all sins. The seven *varshas* there are Shveta, Lohita,³⁹⁹ Jimuta, Harita, Vaidyuta, Manasa and Suprabha as the seventh. There are four *varnas* in those seven *varshas*. O supreme among *brahmanas*! *Varnas* exist in Shalmala. They are distinct and Kapilas, Arunas, Pitas and Krishnas are respectively *brahmanas*, *kshatriyas*, *vaishyas* and shudras. All of them worship the undecaying Vishnu, who is in all atmans, in the form of Vayu. They worship him through the best of sacrifices, and he is present in those sacrifices. The gods reside in that extremely beautiful region. There is a giant *shalmali*⁴⁰⁰ tree that gives the

region its name. This *dvipa* is surrounded by an ocean of liquor on all sides and the size of this ocean is the same as Shalmala itself.’

‘In every direction, that ocean of liquor is surrounded by Kushadvipa. Its dimensions are double the size of Shalmala. It was Jyotishmat in Kushadvipa. ⁴⁰¹ Hear about his seven sons—Udbhida, Venumat, Svairatha, Randhana, Dhriti, Prabhakara and Kapila. The mountains and the *varshas* are named after them. Along with *daityas*, *danavas*, gods, *gandharvas*, *yakshas*, *kimpurushas* and others, humans reside there. There are four *varnas*, engaged in their own activities. O supreme among *brahmanas*! In respective order, Damins, Shushmins, Snehas and Mandehas are said to be *brahmanas*, *kshatriyas*, *vaishyas* and shudras. For the sake of protecting their rights of ownership in the decreed rites, they observe them. In Kushadvipa, they worship Janardana in the form of the *brahman*. They worship him and cast aside the strong sense of ownership that exists in the fruits of the rites. O supreme among *brahmanas*! In that *dvipa*, the seven mountains in the *varshas* are Vidruma, Hemashaila, Dyutimat, Pushtimat, Kusheshaya, Hari and Mount Mandara as the seventh. There are seven rivers. In due order, hear their names—Dhutapapa, Shiva, Pavitra, Sanmati, Vidyutdambha, Mahi and another one. ⁴⁰² All of them dispel all sins. There are thousands of other minor rivers and mountains. Kushadvipa has a clump of *kusha* grass. This is said to be the reason for the name. The *dvipa* is surrounded by an ocean of *ghee*, which has the same size as the *dvipa* itself.

‘The ocean of *ghee* is surrounded by Krounchadvipa. O best among sages! It has been heard that Krounchadvipa is another great region. In expanse, its dimensions are double the size of Kushadvipa. It is the great-souled Dyutimat ⁴⁰³ in Krounchadvipa and he had seven sons. The king named the *varshas* after their names—Kushaga, Mandaga, Ushna, Pivara, Andhakaraka, Muni and Dundubhi. O *brahmanas*! These were the seven sons. O best among sages! There are extremely beautiful mountains in these *varshas*, frequented by gods and *gandharvas*. I will name them next—Krouncha, Vamana, Andhakaraka as the third, Devavrata, Dhama, Pundarikvan and the great mountain of Dundubhi. Just as each *dvipa* is twice the size of the preceding one, each beautiful mountain in a *varsha* is

twice the size of the mountain in the preceding *varsha*. Along with large numbers of gods, the subjects reside there without any fear. O best among *brahmanas*! Respectively, Pushkalas, Pushkaras and Dhanyas ⁴⁰⁴ are *brahmanas*, *kshatriyas*, *vaishyas* and *shudras*. O best among sages! They drink the waters of the rivers. Hear about those now. There are hundreds of rivers that flow downwards. But the seven main ones are Gouri, Kumudvati, Sandhya, Ratri, Manojava, Khyati and Pundarika. These are the seven rivers in the *varshas*. There, the *varnas*, Pushkaras and others, use sacrifices to worship the illustrious Janardana in the form of Yogirudra. In every direction, Krounachadvipa is surrounded by an ocean of curds that is the same size as Krounachadvipa itself.

‘O supreme *brahmanas*! The ocean of curds is surrounded by Shakadvipa, which is twice the size of Krounachadvipa. The extremely great-souled lord of Shakadvipa, Bhavya, had seven sons, and he gave them seven *varshas*. They were Jalada, Kumara, Sukumara, Maniraka, Kusumoda, Modaki and Mahadruma as the seventh. The seven *varshas* were respectively named after them. There are seven mountains that divide the *varshas*. O *brahmanas*! They are Udayagiri, Jaladhara, Raivataka, Shyama, Ambhogiri, Astikeya and the beautiful Kesari, supreme among mountains. There is a great *shaka* tree ⁴⁰⁵ there, frequented by *siddhas* and *gandharvas*. If one touches the breeze that blows through its leaves, one is filled with great delight. There are sacred habitations there, filled with the four *varnas*. Those great-souled ones reside there, without any fear and without any disease. There are extremely sacred rivers there and they cleanse all sins. They are Sukumari, Kumari, Nalini, Renuka, Ikshu, Dhenuka and Gabhasti as the seventh. O supreme among *brahmanas*! Other than these, there are tens of thousands minor rivers. There are hundreds and thousands of mountains. Those who reside in the clouds and other places drink those waters and are happy. The habitations in the *varshas* are characterized by the fourth objective of existence. ⁴⁰⁶ The rivers there are extremely sacred and descend from heaven to earth. *Dharma* does not suffer. There is no excessive delight, no harshness. In those seven regions, there is no violation of the ordinances. There are Magas, Magadhas,

Manasas and Mandagas. The Magas are *brahmanas*, the Magadhas are *kshatriyas*, the Manasas are *vaishyas* and the Mandagas are known as shudras. In Shakadvipa, Vishnu Hari exists in the form of Surya and is properly worshipped, following the prescribed rites by those who have controlled their souls. O *brahmanas*! In every direction, Shakadvipa is girdled by an ocean of milk that has the same dimensions as Shakadvipa.'

'O *brahmanas*! In every direction, that ocean of milk is surrounded by the region known as Pushkara and this *dvipa* is double the size of Shakadvipa. Savana was there in Pushkara, ⁴⁰⁷ and his sons were Mahavita and Dhataki. The two *varshas* there are named after them and are known as Mahavita's region and Dhataki's region. O immensely fortunate ones! There is only one famous mountain in these *varshas*, and it is known as Manasottara. It is right in the middle, circular in shape, with an altitude of fifty thousand *yojanas*. In every direction like a cylinder, its expanse is the same. ⁴⁰⁸ Pushkaradvipa is like a circle and stationed in the middle, the mountain divides it into two parts. The great mountain is located in the centre and each part is like a half-circle. Men live for ten thousand years there. They are free from disease and free from grief. They are devoid of attachment and hatred. O *brahmanas*! There is no superior or inferior there, no one who is a killer and no one who is killed. There is no jealousy, malice, fear, anger or avarice and the other vices. Mahavita's region is on the outside and ornaments Dhataki's regions. The mountain of Manasottara is frequented by gods and *daityas*. In the region known as Pushkaradvipa, there is no notion of truth or falsehood. In the region known as Pushkaradvipa, there are no rivers or mountains. ⁴⁰⁹ Through destiny, all the men there are identical in form. There is no notion of *varna* or *ashrama* and no notion of rites of *dharma*. Concepts of the three Vedas, ⁴¹⁰ livelihood, punishment, policy and service do not exist. O *brahmanas*! The two *varshas* there are described as heaven on earth. It is pleasant for everyone, all the time. Old age and disease do not exist. O *brahmanas*! This is what happens in the Mahavita and Dhataki parts of Pushkara. There is a *nyagrodha* tree in Pushkaradvipa and it is Brahma's excellent spot. Worshipped by the gods and the *asuras*, Brahma resides there. Pushkara is

surrounded by an ocean of sweet water. Its expanse is exactly the same as that of Pushkara itself. Thus, each of the seven *dvipas* is surrounded by an ocean. Each *dvipa* and each ocean is twice the size of the preceding one. In each of the oceans, the volume of the liquid always remains constant. Unlike water in a vessel when it is heated, the volume never increases or decreases. Like that, when the moon waxes, the volume of liquid in the oceans remains constant. O best among *brahmanas*! There is no increase or decrease in the waters. However, in both *shuklapaksha* and *krishnapaksha*,⁴¹¹ when the moon rises or sets, the waters in the oceans are seen to increase and decrease by five hundred and ten *angulas*.⁴¹² In Pushkaradvipa, food arrives on its own. O *brahmanas*! The subjects always enjoy the six kinds of taste.⁴¹³

‘A world is seen to exist around that ocean of sweet water, double the size of the ocean. The ground is golden and is devoid of all creatures. The mountain known as Lokaloka⁴¹⁴ exists there and it is ten thousand *yojanas* in expanse. The mountain is also many *yojanas* high. Established there, the mountain is surrounded by darkness on every side. In every direction, that terrible mountain is surrounded by darkness. O supreme among *brahmanas*! Beyond this terrible mountain, the ground extends for fifty crores of *yojanas*, with *dvipas*, oceans and mountains.⁴¹⁵ O supreme among *brahmanas*! This is the foundation of everything in the universe. Its attributes are superior to all the elements. This is both the creator and the ordainer.’

Chapter 1(19) (Dimensions of nether regions)

Lomaharshana said, ‘O supreme among sages! I have spoken about the expanse of the earth. Its height is said to be seventy thousand *yojanas*. O supreme among sages! Each of the nether regions is ten thousand *yojanas* below the preceding one. They are Atala, Vitala, Nitala, Sutala, Talatala, Rasatala and Patala as the seventh. O Indras among *brahmanas*! The grounds there are respectively black, white, red, yellow, graveled, mountainous and golden. They are adorned with excellent mansions. O supreme *brahmanas*! Thousands of species of *danavas*, *daityas*, *nagas*, those with gigantic bodies and their kin, dwell there. From the nether regions, Narada went to an assembly in heaven and said that the nether regions are more beautiful than the world of heaven. There are sparkling and radiant jewels that bring delight. In the nether regions, these form the ornaments of the *nagas*. What can possibly match this? The *daitya* and *danava* maidens are extremely beautiful. Even an emancipated person is enchanted in the nether regions. During the day, the sun’s rays illuminate, but do not scorch. During the night, the moon’s beams illuminate, but do not cause a chill. The *nagas* rejoice with food, objects of pleasure and excellent drinks. The *danavas* and others do not even realize how time passes. There are beautiful groves and rivers, water bodies filled with lotuses. There are the melodious calls of male cuckoos and other birds. The sky is pleasant. The ornaments, fragrances and unguents are exceedingly beautiful. O *brahmanas*! The sounds of *veenas*, flutes and drums can be heard all the time. Other than this, there are objects of pleasure that the *danavas* enjoy. *Daityas*, *uragas* and others who reside in the nether regions also enjoy them. In his *tamas* form, Vishnu exists below the nether regions. He is known as Shesha, and the *daityas* and *danavas* are incapable of

describing his qualities. He is described as Ananta and is worshipped by *siddhas*, gods and *devarshis*. His one thousand hoods are evident, decorated with a *svastika* mark and sparkling ornaments. The jewels on his one thousand hoods illuminate the directions. For the welfare of the universe, he deprives the *asuras* of all their energy. He always wears a single earring and his eyes roll around in intoxication. With a diadem and a garland, he is as radiant as a mountain that is on fire. He is attired in blue garments and is intoxicated. He is adorned with a white necklace. The divine Ganga descends on Mount Kailasa and he is as lofty as that. The tip of his hand rests on a plough and he holds an excellent and radiant mace. He is worshipped by the handsome and embodied form of Varuna. At the end of a *kalpa*, Rudra emerges from his mouth in the form of Samkarshana, blazing like a fire with poisonous flames to devour the three worlds. The resplendent form of Shesha holds up the globe of the earth on his hoods. Shesha resides in the nether regions and is worshipped by all the gods. Even the gods are incapable of knowing or describing his valour, powers, nature and form. The flames from the jewels on his hoods turn the entire earth red. It ⁴¹⁶ is like a garland of flowers for him. Who can speak about his valour? His eyes rolling around in intoxication, Ananta yawns and the earth, with its mountains, water bodies and forests, starts to tremble and quake. The *gandharvas*, *apsaras siddhas*, *kinnnaras*, *uragas* and *rakshasas* do not know the extent of his qualities. He is Ananta, the one without decay. The wives of the *nagas* use their hands to apply yellow sandalwood paste on him. The wind from his repeated breathing wafts this fragrance in all the directions. In ancient times, Garga worshipped him and learnt the truth about *jyotisha*. He, thus, understood everything about cause and effect. That supreme serpent holds up the earth on his hoods. He illuminates all the worlds, along with the gods, the *asuras* and humans.

Chapter 1(20) (*Patala* and *naraka*)

Lomaharshana said, ‘O *brahmanas*! The *narakas* ⁴¹⁷ are located beneath the waters. The sinners are cast down there. O best among *brahmanas*! Hear about them. They are Rourava, Shoukara, Rodhastana, Vishasana, Mahajvala, Taptakumbha, Mohalobha, Vimohana, Rudhirandha, Vaitarani, Krimisha, Krimibhojana, Asipatravana, Krishna, Lalabhoksha, Daruna, Puyavaha, Papa, Vahnijvala, Adhahshira, Samdasha, Krishnasutra, Tamas, Avichi, Shvabhajana, Apratishtha and the second Avichi. ⁴¹⁸ Apart from these, there are other extremely terrible *narakas*. Those are terrible and with weapons and fire, generate fear. Men who are engaged in sinful activities fall there. If a man bears false witness, speaks with partiality, or utters other kinds of falsehood, he goes to Rourava. ⁴¹⁹ O supreme among sages! A person who kills a fetus, kills a *guru*, kills a cow, or strangles someone by obstructing his breath, goes to the terrible Rourava. If a person drinks liquor, kills a *brahmana*, steals gold, or is associated with those who do these things, he goes to the hell Shoukara. ⁴²⁰ If a person kills someone from the royal family, kills a *vaishya*, has intercourse with his *guru*’s wife, has intercourse with his sister, or kills a king’s servant, he goes to Taptakumbha. If a person sells his faithful wife, stores liquor to sell it, sells *kesara*, ⁴²¹ or abandons someone who is faithful to him, he falls into Taptaloha. ⁴²² If a person has intercourse with his daughter or his daughter-in-law, he falls into Mahajvala. ⁴²³ O *brahmanas*! If the worst among men disrespects or reviles his *guru*, abuses the Vedas, sells the Vedas or has intercourse with someone he should not have intercourse with, he goes to Shabala. ⁴²⁴ A thief, or a person who violates a contract falls into Vimohana. ⁴²⁵ A person who hates gods, *brahmanas* or ancestors, or a person who spoils a jewel, goes to Krimibhojana. ⁴²⁶ A person who sacrifices in the wrong way goes to

Krimisha.⁴²⁷ The worst among men who has his food before ancestors, gods and guests goes to Lalabhoksha.⁴²⁸ A person who makes excessively fierce arrows goes to Vedhaka.⁴²⁹ If a person makes barbed arrows, or makes swords and similar weapons, he goes to the extremely terrible hell named Vishasana.⁴³⁰ If a person receives gifts from a wicked person, he goes to the hell named Adhomukha.⁴³¹ If a person performs a sacrifice for someone who is not entitled to sacrifice, is a bad astrologer, or constantly eats sweetmeats alone, he goes to Krimipuya.⁴³² O *brahmanas*! If a brahma na sells lac, the extract of meat, sesamum or salt, he too goes to the same hell.⁴³³ O best among *brahmanas*! If a person keeps cats, hens, goats, dogs, pigs or dogs, he goes to the same hell. If a brahmana earns a living as an actor, a fisherman, a pimp, a seller of poison, a spy, a buffalo-keeper or if he indulges in sexual intercourse on *parva* days,⁴³⁴ he descends into Rudhirandha. This is also true of an arsonist, a slayer of friends, a person who performs a sacrifice in a village of astrologers and a seller of *soma*. If a man destroys honey, he goes to Vaitarani. If a person forces the drinking of semen, violates a contract, does not follow norms of purification, or earns a living through deception, he goes to Kriccha.⁴³⁵ If a person cuts down a forest unnecessarily, he goes to Asipatravana.⁴³⁶ O *brahmanas*! Those who hunt sheep and deer fall into Vahnijvala.⁴³⁷ Those who use a fire to cook what should not be cooked also go there. If a person deviates from his vows or from his own *ashrama*, he falls into Samdasha⁴³⁸ and undergoes pain there. If men are following *brahmacharya*, but discharge semen during the day or in their dreams, or if they are taught by their sons, they descend into Shvabhojana.⁴³⁹ There are hundreds and thousands of other hells. Evil-doers are cooked there and face pain. In that way, there are thousands of other sins. After the time in *naraka* is over, men are reborn and suffer the consequences of these. Men who act against *varna* and *ashrama* in their deeds, thoughts or speech, go to hells. With their heads hanging downwards, those in *naraka* can see the gods in heaven. The gods also see all of them in *naraka*, with their heads hanging downwards. In progressive order, the stages⁴⁴⁰ are immobile objects, worms, aquatic creatures, birds, animals, ordinary men, men devoted to *dharma*, gods and those who attain

moksha. Progressively, one thousand parts of the first amount to one part of the second. ⁴⁴¹ O immensely fortunate ones! Before attaining emancipation, everyone must pass through these stages. For as long as creatures go to heaven, there will be residence in hell too.’

‘Sinners who turn away from *prayashchitta* ⁴⁴² go to hell. Atonement is proportionate to the sin that has been committed. The supreme *rishis* have spoken about these and they must be remembered. If the sin is major, the atonement is major. If the sin is minor, the atonement is also minor. O Indras among *brahmanas*! Svayambhu ⁴⁴³ and others have spoken about *prayashchitta*. Among many kinds of atonement are acts of austerity. However, among all these, remembering Krishna is the best. After committing a sin, if there is repentance in a man, the best atonement for him is to remember Hari. A man must remember Narayana in the morning, at night, at the time of the *sandhyas* ⁴⁴⁴ and at midday. All his sins will then be instantly destroyed. Through remembering Vishnu, all the stores of hardship are destroyed. For such a person, even the attainment of heaven is an impediment, and he proceeds towards emancipation. O Indras among *brahmanas*! If a person’s mind is intent on Vasudeva and he worships him through *japa* and oblations, even reaping a fruit like becoming Indra of the gods is an impediment. What is there in going to the vault of heaven? It has the quality of returning to *samsara* again. How can that compare with *japa* towards Vasudeva, which is the excellent seed of emancipation? Therefore, if a brahmana, or any man, remembers Vishnu night and day, he does not go to *naraka*. He is pure and all his sins are destroyed. That which causes delight to the mind is heaven. Anything that is contrary is hell. O supreme among *brahmanas*! Good deeds and wicked deeds are given the names of heaven and hell. The same object can cause misery, as well as joy. It can also give rise to anger. Therefore, there is no object that solely gives rise to misery, or to joy. Even if there is joy, there is misery again. When the anger disappears, there is pleasure. Hence, there is nothing that innately gives rise to misery, or to joy. The symptoms of misery and joy are consequences of the mind. *Jnana* is the supreme *brahman*. *Jnana* destroys bondage. The universe is formed out of *jnana*. *Jnana* is supreme. O *brahmanas*! *Jnana* is

the foundation of learning and ignorance. I have, thus, spoken to you about the earth's globe. O *brahmanas*! I have also spoken to you about all the nether regions, hells, oceans, mountains, *dvipas*, *varshas* and rivers. I have spoken briefly about these. What else do you wish to hear?'

Chapter 1(21) (Bhuloka and upper regions)

The sages said, ‘You have spoken to all of us about everything. We wish to hear about Bhuloka and the other *lokas*,⁴⁴⁵ and about the positions and dimensions of the planets.⁴⁴⁶ O immensely fortunate one! O Lomaharshana! Tell us accurately about these.’

Lomaharshana replied, ‘That which is illuminated by the rays of the sun and the beams of the moon, along with its oceans, rivers and mountains, is known as the earth. The size and circumference of the earth is the same as the size and circumference of the sky.⁴⁴⁷ O *brahmanas*! The solar disc is at a distance of one hundred thousand *yojanas* from the earth. The lunar disc is at a distance of one hundred thousand *yojanas* from the sun. The entire circle of *nakshatras* shines a full one hundred thousand *yojanas* away from the moon. O *brahmanas*! Budha⁴⁴⁸ is at a distance of two hundred thousand *yojanas* from the circle of *nakshatras*. Ushanas⁴⁴⁹ is stationed two hundred thousand *yojanas* above Budha. Angaraka⁴⁵⁰ is stationed at a distance of two hundred thousand *yojanas* from Ushanas. The preceptor of the gods⁴⁵¹ is stationed at a distance of two hundred thousand *yojanas* from Bhouma. Souri⁴⁵² is stationed two hundred thousand *yojanas* above Brihaspati. O supreme among *brahmanas*! The circle of the *saptarshis* is at a distance of one hundred thousand *yojanas* from Brihaspati. One hundred thousand *yojanas* from the *rishis* is Dhruva, which is like a pivot for all the shining bodies. O supreme among *brahmanas*! I have briefly spoken about the three worlds. These are the places for sacrifices. These are the places for enjoying the fruits of sacrifices. Maharloka is one crore *yojanas* above Dhruva. Those destined to survive at the end of a *kalpa* reside in Maharloka. O *brahmanas*! Janaloka is two crore *yojanas* from Maharloka. Brahma’s sons with unblemished minds, Sananda and the others,⁴⁵³ live there. Tapoloka is

said to be eight crore *yojanas* above Maharloka. The gods known as Vairajas, who have no bodies, live there. The radiant Satyaloka is forty-eight crore *yojanas* from Tapoloka. One is freed from death there and that place is also known as Brahma's world. If there is any place on earth where one can travel on one's feet, that region is said to be Bhuloka. I have spoken about it in detail. The region between the earth and the sun is frequented by *siddhas* and sages. O supreme among sages! This is the second region and is known as Bhuvvarloka. The space between Dhruva and the sun is one million and four hundred thousand *yojanas*. Those who have thought about the location of the worlds have spoken of this as Svarloka. *Brahmanas* speak of these three worlds ⁴⁵⁴ as created. ⁴⁵⁵ Janaloka, Tapoloka and Satyaloka are the three that have not been created. ⁴⁵⁶ Maharloka is in between the created and the uncreated. At the end of a *kalpa*, it becomes empty, but is not destroyed. O *brahmanas*! I have spoken about the seven upper regions, Maharloka and the others. I have also spoken about the seven nether regions. These are the dimensions of the cosmic egg. ⁴⁵⁷

‘This egg is surrounded by a shell above, below and diagonally, just as the seed of a wood-apple is surrounded on all sides. O *brahmanas*! The egg is surrounded by water that is ten times in size. The water which surrounds, is in turn surrounded by fire. O *brahmanas*! The fire is surrounded by wind and the wind is surrounded by space. O best among sages! The space is surrounded by Mahat. O *brahmanas*! Each of these seven is such that it is ten times the preceding one. ⁴⁵⁸ Pradhana is established, surrounding Mahat. It is infinite and has no end. Its dimensions cannot be measured. It is infinite and cannot be subjected to any kind of measurement. O *brahmanas*! This is supreme Prakriti, the cause behind creation. There are thousands and tens of thousands of such cosmic eggs. There are crores and hundreds of crores of such cosmic eggs. Fire is hidden inside wood and oil is hidden inside a seed of sesamum. Like that, Purusha is hidden inside Pradhana, and pervades it. This is known as the conscious *atman*. O best among *brahmanas*! Vishnu's energy sustains them. ⁴⁵⁹ Their *dharma* is to come together. His energy is the reason behind their existing separately and coming together. O supreme among *brahmanas*! At the time of creation, his

energy is the cause of agitation. Just as the wind blows and chills every drop of water, Vishnu's universal energy is behind Pradhana and Purusha. A tree with a trunk, major branches and minor branches, grows out of an original seed and gives rise to other seeds. From those seeds, other trees grow, and they are said to possess the same characteristics, constituents and causes as the original. In this way, Mahat and the others evolve from what was not created. From this, specific elements of creation, gods and others, result. They have sons, and those sons have other sons. The original tree does not suffer because another tree has grown from its seed. Like that, creatures do not suffer when other categories of creatures result from them. The mere presence of time may appear to be the visible cause behind the original tree. In that way, the universe is a consequence of the illustrious Hari's presence. The root, the stalk, the sprout, the leaf, the stem, the bud, the flower, the milk, the husk, the rice, the chaff and the ear latently exist inside a seed of paddy. O supreme among sages! All the ingredients for growth already exist. In the same way, the bodies of gods and others already exist within their own *karma*. Growth results after coming into contact with Vishnu's energy. Vishnu is the supreme *brahman* and everything in the universe flows from him. The universe exists within him and it is into him that it is dissolved. The *brahman* is the supreme refuge, the supreme state that is beyond cause and effect. The universe, with all its divisions and mobile and immobile objects, exists within him. He is the foundation of Prakriti. He is the manifested form of the universe. At the time of destruction, everything enters into him. He is the agent behind sacrifices. He is worshipped through sacrifices. He is the fruits of those sacrifices. He is the means for undertaking sacrifices. Other than Hari, what else exists? What is distinct from him?'

Chapter 1(22) (Dhruva's place)

Lomaharshana said, 'In the world of the stars, the illustrious lord exists in the form of Shishumara. ⁴⁶⁰ This is Hari's form in the firmament, and Dhruva is located on the tail. He revolves and makes the moon, the sun, the planets and the *nakshatras* revolve in circular orbits around him. The sun, the moon, the stars, the *nakshatras* and the planets follow him in arrays, seemingly tied to Dhruva in ropes made out of wind. Narayana is the supreme refuge. He is himself the foundation and the heart of that stellar form in the sky that is spoken of as Shishumara. Uttanapada's son ⁴⁶¹ worshipped Prajapati and became the star Dhruva, on Shishumara's tail. Janardana, who controls everything, is the support for Shishumara. Dhruva is supported by Shishumara and Bhanu ⁴⁶² is supported by Dhruva. The sun is the support for everything in the universe—the gods, the *asuras* and humans. O *brahmanas*! For eight months, Vivasvat sucks up the juice in the water and then showers it down as rain. The entire universe obtains food from this. Having sucked up the water from the universe with his fierce rays, Vivasvat nourishes Soma. The wind is like the veins of the moon in the firmament. That water is, thus, circulated amongst the clouds, which are the embodied forms of smoke, fire and wind. Since the clouds do not shower down the waters, but hold them, clouds are *abhra*. ⁴⁶³ Water showers down from clouds only when they are urged by the wind. O *brahmanas*! When time cleanses them in this way, they become purified. The illustrious Savitar ⁴⁶⁴ accepts four types of water—from rivers, from oceans, from the earth and from living beings. In a similar way, the one with the rays uses his rays to also absorb water from the celestial Ganga. However, without allowing this to enter the clouds, he immediately showers it down on earth. O supreme among *brahmanas*! If a mortal comes into contact with this by

looking at the sun, his mire of sins is cleansed and he does not go to hell. This is the water from the celestial Ganga that Ravi uses his rays to shower down, without entering the clouds. This is said to be a divine bath. When one looks at the sun at the time of ascendance of Krittika and other odd-numbered *nakshatras*,⁴⁶⁵ the water that falls down from the firmament is known as water from the Ganga, poured by *diggajas*.⁴⁶⁶ When even-numbered *nakshatras* are in the ascendance, the water that falls down from the firmament is instantly dispersed by Surya's rays.⁴⁶⁷ O *brahmanas*! Both are exceedingly sacred and destroy the sins of men. O supreme among *brahmanas*! The water from the celestial Ganga constitutes a divine bath. O *brahmanas*! The water that is showered by clouds nourishes living beings and nourishes herbs. It is like the *amrita* of life. All the different types of herbs grow because of this. They ensure the success of the ripening of crops, and subjects can have offspring. Men who possess the insight of the sacred texts say that these are used to undertake sacrifices during night and day, so as to nourish the gods. Thus, rains sustain everything in the universe—mobile and immobile objects, sacrifices, the Vedas, the *varnas*, with *brahmanas* as the first, all the forms of the gods, and large numbers of animals and other beings. O supreme among sages! Rain occurs because of Savitar. O supreme among the best of sages! Dhruva is like a support for Savitar. Shishumara is Dhruva's support and Shishumara's support is Narayana. Narayana is established in Shishumara's heart. He is the original and eternal being who is the creator and cause behind all living beings. O best among sages! I have thus spoken to you about the cosmic egg, along with the earth and the oceans. What else do you wish to hear?'

Chapter 1(23) (Greatness of *tirthas*)

The sages asked, ‘O one who knows about *dharma*! What are the blessed *tirthas* and other sacred places on earth? Our minds wish to hear about that. You should tell us.’

Lomaharshana replied, ‘If a person controls his hands, feet and mind, and if he possesses learning, austerities and fame, he obtains fruits from visiting *tirthas*.⁴⁶⁸ For a man, a pure mind is a *tirtha*. Control of speech and the senses is also like that. Hence, there are *tirthas* inside the body and they make one understand about paths to heaven. If the mind inside is wicked, it is not purified by bathing in a *tirtha*. Even if it is washed one hundred times in water, a vessel filled with liquor does not become pure. If a man is wicked inside, if he is prone to insolence and if he has not been able to conquer his senses, *tirthas*, donations and vows do not help. If a man is able to conquer his senses, wherever he resides, is like Kurukshetra, Prayaga or Pushkara. Hence, I will tell you about *tirthas* and other sacred places. Listen. O best among sages! I will briefly tell you about where they are on earth. Even if I speak for one hundred years, I will not be able to tell you about them in detail.’

‘O supreme among *brahmanas*! I will first mention Pushkara *tirtha*, Naimisharanya, Prayaga and Dharmaranya. There is Dhenuka, Champaka forest and Saindhava forest. There is the sacred Sagara forest, Dandakaranya, Gaya, Prabhasa, Shritirtha and the divine Kanakhala. There is Bhrigutunga, Hiranyaksha, Bhimaranya, Kushasthali, Lohargala, Kedara and the forest of Mandara. There is Mahalaya, Kotitirtha, where all sins are destroyed, Rupatirtha, Shukara and Chakratirtha, where great fruits are obtained. There is Vyasatirtha, Somatirtha, the *tirtha* of Shakhotaka, the *tirtha* of Kokamukha and the sacred Badari mountain. There is Somatirtha,

the *tirtha* of Tungakuta, Skandashrama, Suryaprabha, Dhenusara, Saptayushmika, Dharmodhbhava, Kotitirtha, ⁴⁶⁹ Sarvakamika, Suryaprabha, ⁴⁷⁰ Mahakunda and the *tirtha* of Somabhishechana. There is Mahakshotra, Koraka, Panchadhara, Tridharaka, Saptadhara, Ekadhara and the *tirtha* of Amarakantaka. There is Shalagrama, Chakratirtha, the wonderful Kadalihrada, Vidyutprabha, Devahrada and the *tirtha* of Vishnuprabha. There is Shankhaprabha, Devakunda and the *tirtha* of Vajrayudha. There is Vastrapada, Barhapada, Lokarohana, Svayamvata, Bhadrabala, Koushamba, Divakara, the *dvipa* of the divinity Sarasvata, Vijaya, Kamaja, Sollayangopachara, Varambana, Purnavat, Snanakunda, Prayaga, ⁴⁷¹ the cave of Vishnupada, Kanyakunda, Vayukunda, the supreme Jambumarga, the *tirtha* of Gabhasti and the pure Yayatipattana. There is Kotitirtha, ⁴⁷² Bhadravata, the forest of Mahakala, the supreme *tirtha* of Narmada, Tirthabija, Arbuda, Panchatirtha, the *tirtha* of Vasishtha, Priyasamjaka, the *tirtha* known as Varshika, the auspicious Panjiraka, Sutirtha, Brahmarudra, the *tirtha* of Kanyakumarika, Shakratirtha, Panchanada and Renukatirtha. There is the sparkling Paitamaha, the excellent Roudrapada, Manimanta, Kamakhya, Krishnatirtha, Kulingaka, Shrishakrayajana, Brahmavaluka, the sacred Vyasa, Pundarika, the excellent Manimantha, Dirghamanta, Hamsampada, the *tirtha* of Shayana, Dashashvamedha, Kedara, Tamasodbheda, Rudrakupa, the *tirtha* of Samyamani, Samtravanasika, the *tirtha* of Syamantapanchaka, the perpetually beautiful Brahmatirtha, Prithivitirtha, Pariplava, Prithudaka, the *tirtha* of Dashashvamedhika, Sakshida, Vijaya, ⁴⁷³ Kotitirtha, ⁴⁷⁴ Panchanada, ⁴⁷⁵ Varaha, Yakshinihrada, Pundarika, Somatirtha ⁴⁷⁶ and the excellent Munjavata. There is the forest of Badari, the forest of Babura, the *tirtha* of Svarlokadvaraka, the *tirtha* of Kapila, Suryatirtha, Varusthana, Bhavabhavana, the *tirtha* of Yaksharakshasa and the excellent *tirtha* of Brahmatirtha. ⁴⁷⁷ There is Kameshvara, Matritirtha, the *tirtha* of Shatavana, Hamsasthana on earth, the lake of Sarasa, Dashashvamedha, ⁴⁷⁸ Kedara, ⁴⁷⁹ the beautiful Brahmajna, Saptarshikunda, the well-maintained *tirtha* of the goddess, Ihaspada, Kotikrita, Kivana, Kimjaya, Karandava, Vishva, Trivishtapa, Panikhata, Mishraka, Madhukanta, Manomaya, Koushiki, Devatirtha, the excellent

Kanyatirtha, Brahmatirtha,⁴⁸⁰ the purifying *tirtha* of Manasatirtha, the forest of Sougandhika, Manitirtha, Sarasvati, the excellent and purifying Ishanatirtha, Panchayajnaka, Trishualadhara, Mahendra, the divine abode of Mahalaya, Shakambhari, the divine *tirtha* known as Suvarna, Kapimada, Kshiresvara, Virupaksha, Bhrgutirtha and Kushodbhava. There is Brahmavarta, Brahmayoni, the mountain Nila, the lake of Bhadrakarna, the lake of Shakrakarna, Saptasarsvata, the *tirtha* Oushanas, Kapalamochana, Avakirna, Panchaka, Chatuhsamudrika, Satkanchana, Sahasrika, Renuka, Panchakataka, Vimochana, Anasa, Sthanutirtha, the *tirtha* of Kuru, Svargadvara, Kushadhvaja, Vishveshvara, Vamakara, the hermitage of Narayana, Gangahrada, Vata, the pure Badari,⁴⁸¹ Indramargana *kshetra* and Jirikavasa. O *brahmanas*! There is Somatirtha,⁴⁸² the extremely sacred Kotitirtha,⁴⁸³ Kotitirthasthali, the lake of Bhadrakali, the forest of Arundhati, the excellent Brahmavarta, Ashvadevi, Kubjavana, Yamunaprabhava, Virapramoksha, Siddhartha, Mayavidyodbhava, Mahahrada, Vetasikarupa, the hermitage of Sundarika, the extremely great *tirtha* of Brahmani, Gangodbhava, Sarasvati, the *tirtha* named Bahuka, Vimalashoka, the *tirtha* of Goutamairavati, the *tirtha* of Shatasahasrika, Bhartisthana, Kotitirtha, the supreme Kapili, the *tirtha* of the intelligent Markandeya in Panchanada, Somatirtha,⁴⁸⁴ Shivoda, the *tirtha* of Matsyodari, Suryatirtha,⁴⁸⁵ as radiant as the sun, the forest of Somaka, Arunaspada, Vamanaka, the sandy Suryatirtha,⁴⁸⁶ the *tirtha* known as Avimukta, the lake of Nilakantha, Pishachamochana, the lake of Subhadra, Vimalakunda, the *tirtha* of Chandishvara, the lake of Shreshthasthana, Samudrakupa, the forest of Jaigisha, the forest of Harikesha, Ajamukharasa, the lake of Ghantakarna, the lake of Pundarika, the tank of Kashthaka, Shmashanastambha, Kumbha, the lake of Vinayaka, the well of Siddhodbhava, the sacred Brahmasara, the *tirtha* of Bhadravasa, Nagatirtha, Somaka,⁴⁸⁷ Bhaktahrada, Kshirasara, Pretadhara, Kumaraka, Brahmavarta,⁴⁸⁸ Kushavarta, Dadhikarnodaya, the great *tirtha* of Shringatirtha, Mahanadi, best among *tirthas*, the divine Brahmasara,⁴⁸⁹ the sacred Akshayavata in Gayashirsha, Gomaya in the south, Hayashantika in the north, the lake of Kapila,⁴⁹⁰ Gridhrakuta, the lake of Savitri, Aghanashana, Gitavana,

Yonidvara, Dhainuka, Dhanvaka, Lohika, the lake of Matanga, Pitrikupa, Rudrakupa, Matitirtha, Sumali, Brahmasthana, Saptakunda, the lake of Maniratna, the hermitage of Mudgala, the lake of Mudgala, the *tirtha* known as Janakakupa, the sacred Vinashana, Shoka, the *tirtha* known as Bharata, Jyeshthalika, Vishveshvara, ⁴⁹¹ sacred a hundred times over, Kanyasamvedha, Nidhiramabhava, the hermitage of Vasishtha, the well in Devakuta, the hermitage of Koushika, the lake of Kulakarna, the tree Koushiki, Dharmatirtha, Kanchana, the *tirtha* of Uddalaka, Dandatma, the *tirtha* of Malini, the *tirtha* of Vanachandika, Sandhyatirtha, Kalatirtha, the ocean of Kapilalohita, Shonodbhava, Vamsagulma, the *tirtha* of Ramabhangika, the lake of Punyavata, the *tirtha* of Shrimati, the hermitage of Badarika, ⁴⁹² Ramatirtha, Vitasta, Merujatiya, the well of Rohini, the lake of Indradyumna, Avasarga, Mahendra, Shritirtha, ⁴⁹³ Shrinadi, Ishutirtha, Varshika, the lake of Kubera, Kanyatirtha, ⁴⁹⁴ Gokarna, Gopatisthana, Samvarta, Vishvasa, the lake of Saptagodavari, the second lake of Badari, Brahmasthanavivardhana, Jatihrada, Devahrada, Kushaprathana, Sarvadevavrata, the lake of Kanyashrama, the lake of Maharaja, the sacred Shakratirtha, ⁴⁹⁵ Kundaka, Angaratirtha, the forest of Rudra, Medhavina, Devahrada, ⁴⁹⁶ the *tirtha* of Amaravartana, the lake of Mandakini, the sacred Kshamamaheshvara, Gangatirtha, Tripurusha, Bhimatandavamukha, Prithukuta, Shalvakuta, Shonitaka, a second Rohitaka, the lake of Kapila, ⁴⁹⁷ Malya, the lake of Kapila that belonged to Vasishtha, the lake of the *valakhilyas*, ⁴⁹⁸ the lake of the *saptarshis*, the lake of the *maharshis* and the lake Akhandita. A mortal man must be full of faith and properly observing the rites, must bathe in these *tirthas*, after fasting and controlling his senses. In due order, he must satisfy gods, *rishis*, humans and ancestors. He should worship the gods and reside there for three nights. O *brahmanas*! Each of these *tirthas* yields different fruits. From visting these, there is no doubt that a man obtains the fruits obtained through a horse sacrifice. If a person constantly listens to the excellent account about the greatness of the *tirthas*, reads it or hears it, he is cleansed of all sins.'

Chapter 1(24) (Svayambhu and the sages)

The sages said, ‘Since it can yield *dharma*, *artha*, *kama* and *moksha*, the earth is an excellent place. It is supreme among *tirthas*. O supreme among eloquent ones! Tell us about this *tirtha*.’

Lomaharshana replied, ‘In ancient times, the sages asked my preceptor this question. O supreme among *brahmanas*! I will tell you what you have asked me about. Vyasa, supreme among intelligent ones, was seated in Kurukshetra. He was in his extremely sacred hermitage, adorned with many kinds of flowers. It was full of many kinds of trees and creepers. There were hordes of different kinds of minor animals. There were *punnaga*, *karnikara*, *sarala*, *devadaru*, *shala*, *tala*, *tamala*, *panasa*, *dhava*, *khadira*, *patala*, *ashoka*, *bakula*, *karavira*, *champaka* and many other kinds of trees, blossoming with diverse kinds of flowers. ⁴⁹⁹ He was the composer of the Mahabharata and was accomplished in the sacred texts. He was devoted to *adhyatma* ⁵⁰⁰ and knew about everything. He was engaged in the welfare of all creatures. He was the one who spoke about the Puranas and the *agama* texts. ⁵⁰¹ He was knowledgeable about the Vedas and the Vedangas. He was Parashara’s tranquil son, with large eyes that were like lotus petals. Firm in their vows, the sages happily came to meet him—Kashyapa, Jamadagni, Bharadvaja, Goutama, Vasishtha, Jaimini, Dhoumya, Markandeya, Valmiki, Vishvamitra, Shatananda, Vatsya, Garga, Asuri, Sumantu, the one named Bhargava, Kanva, the preceptor Medhatithi, Mandavya, Chyavana, Dhumra, Asita, Devala, Moudgalya, Trinabahu, Pippalada, Akrtiavrana, Samvarta, Koushika, Raibhya, Maitreya, Harita, Shandilya, Agastya, Durvasa, Lomasha, Narada, Parvata, Vaishampayana, Galava, Bhaskari, Purani, Suta, Pulastya, Kapila, Ulaka, Pulaha, Vayu, Devasthana, Tumburu, Sanatkumara, Paila, Krishna and Krishnanubhoutika. These excellent sages

surrounded Satyavati's son.⁵⁰² The intelligent sage was radiant, like the moon surrounded by the *nakshatras*. The one who knew about the Vedas honoured all the sages who had arrived. They too honoured him, and they conversed amongst themselves. When the conversation was over, all the best among sages, residents of hermitages in the forests, asked Krishna, Satyavati's son, about a doubt they had.'

The sages said, 'O sage! O eloquent one! You know the Vedas, the sacred texts, the Puranas, the *agamas*, the Mahabharata and everything about the past, the present and the future. This world of *samsara* is without any substance. It is full of misery and hardships. It is as if this region is submerged in a flood, with attachment resembling fierce crocodiles. It is seen that the senses are like hundreds of whirlpools. There is the mire of delusion. It is deep with avarice. It is impassable and is impossible to cross. We can see the world submerged, unconscious and without support. O immensely fortunate one! O supreme among sages! This terrible *samsara* gives us goosebumps. Therefore, we are asking you. Through your instructions, you should tell us about the supreme worlds that are extremely difficult to obtain. You should tell us about the *kshetras* that grant emancipation on this earth, which is a *karma bhumi*. We wish to hear about this. Indeed, if a man performs his instructed *karma* on earth properly, he obtains supreme success. If he performs the wrong *karma*, he goes to hell. The supremely intelligent obtains *moksha* in the *kshetras* that grant *moksha*. O immensely wise one! Therefore, answer what the best among *brahmanas* are asking you.'

Lomaharshana continued, 'Vyasa, the intelligent one who knew about the past, the present and the future, heard the words spoken by the sages who had cleansed their souls.'

Vyasa replied, 'O sages! I will tell you what all of you have asked me about. Listen. Earlier, this is a conversation that Brahma had with the *rishis* on the extensive slopes of Meru, which is decorated with many jewels. It is full of many kinds of trees and creepers and is decorated with many kinds of flowers. It is beautiful with the calls of many kinds of birds and it is full of many springs. Many kinds of beings live there and there are many kinds

of wonders. It is strewn with many kinds of rocks of diverse colours and ornamented with many kinds of minerals. It is full of many kinds of sages and decorated with many hermitages. The protector of the universe, the creator of the universe, the four-faced lord of the universe was seated there. He is worshipped by the universe, and he is the lord who is the foundation of the universe. He was surrounded by gods, *danavas*, *yakshas*, *vidyadhara*s, ⁵⁰³ *uragas*, sages, *siddhas*, *apsaras* and other residents of heaven. Some were praising the god, and some were singing in front of him. Some were playing on musical instruments, others were dancing. With all the creatures assembled there, it was a time for rejoicing. The breeze that blew from the south carried the fragrances of many flowers. Bhrigu and the other sages bowed down before the god, the grandfather. O *brahmanas*! Those supreme *rishis* asked the grandfather exactly the same question. The *rishis* said, ‘O illustrious one! We wish to hear about the *karma bhumi* on earth. O lord of the gods! You should tell us about the *kshetra* that grants *moksha*, which is so very difficult to obtain.’ Brahma, the lord of the gods, heard their words and the question that was asked of him by all the excellent sages. And he replied.’

Chapter 1(25) (Description of Bharatavarsha)

Brahma said, ‘O sages! All of you listen to what I will tell you now. This is an ancient account, connected with the Vedas. It is auspicious and grants objects of pleasure and emancipation. On earth, Bharatavarsha is said to be *karma bhumi*. It is a land where the fruits of *karma* give rise to heaven or hell. O *brahmanas*! In this *varsha*, depending on whether a man acts in accordance with *dharma* or is a sinner, he certainly reaps the fruits, good or bad. In this *varsha*, if *brahmanas* and others control themselves and properly perform their respective tasks, there is no doubt that they obtain supreme success. O supreme among *brahmanas*! In this *varsha*, a self-controlled man obtains everything—*dharma*, *artha*, *kama* or *moksha*. O supreme among *brahmanas*! In this *varsha*, if Indra and the other gods undertake their tasks properly, they obtain the status of being gods. There are other men who have controlled their senses and have obtained *moksha*. In this *varsha*, there were learned people who were serene, devoid of attachment and devoid of jealousy. They have gone to heaven on *vimanas* and remained there, devoid of anxiety. They performed auspicious deeds in this *varsha* and went to heaven. Therefore, the gods always hanker after residence in Bharatavarsha. ‘When will we be able to see the place where one obtains the fruits of heaven and emancipation?’ ⁵⁰⁴

The sages said, ‘O best among gods! You have said that with the exception of Bharata, there is no other place where one obtains the fruits of auspicious and evil *karma*. Depending on whether the deeds are superior or middle, one obtains *moksha* or goes to heaven. There is no other place that is *karma bhumi* for mortals. O Brahma! Therefore, show us your compassion. Tell us about Bharata in detail, about its location. O protector!

What is this *varsha* like and what are the mountains in this *varsha*? What are the divisions of this *varsha*! Tell us everything completely.’

Brahma replied, ‘O *brahmanas*! Hear about the nine divisions of Bharatavarsha. Know that they are equal in size and are separated from each other by oceans. Indradvipa, Kasheru, Tamravarna, Gabhastimat, Nagadvipa, Soumya, Gandharva and Varuna—and there is a ninth *dvipa* that is surrounded by the ocean. ⁵⁰⁵ From south to north, the *dvipa* extends for one thousand *yojanas*. The Kiratas reside to the east and the Yavanas to the west. O *brahmanas*! *Brahmanas*, *kshatriyas*, *vaishyas* and *shudras* reside in it and purify themselves through tasks like performing sacrifices, fighting and trading. These tasks are said to constitute good behaviour for them. In this *varsha*, these are the good or bad deeds that cause ascendance to heaven. Mahendra, Malaya, Sahya, Shuktimat, Mount Riksha, Vindhya and Pariyatra—these are the seven *kulachalas* here. Other than these, there are thousand of other mountains that are near them. They are extensive, tall and beautiful. Their summits are large and colourful. They are Kolahola, Vaibhraj, Mandara, Mount Dardala, Vatadhvaga, Daivata, Mainaka, Surasa, Tungaprastha, Naga, Mount Godhana, Mount Pandura, Mount Pushpa, Vijayanta, Raivata, Arbuda, Rishyamuka, Gomantha, Kritashaila, Mount Krita, Shripurvata, Chakora and hundreds of other mountains. In the midst of these mountains, there are habitations, and *mlecchas*, ⁵⁰⁶ and others live in those divisions. O supreme among *brahmanas*! Know that they drink the waters from the best of rivers. The rivers that flow from the feet of the Himalayas are Ganga, Sarasvati, Sindhu, Chandrabhaga, Yamuna, Shatadru, Vipasha, Vitasta, Iravati, Kuhu, Gomati, Dhutapapa, Bahuda, Drishadvati, Vipasha, ⁵⁰⁷ Devika, Chakshu, Nishthiva, Gandaki and Koushiki. The rivers that flow from Pariyatra are said to be Devasmriti, Devavati, Vataghni, Sindhu, ⁵⁰⁸ Venya, Chandana, Sadanira, Mahi, Charmanvati, Vrishi, Vidisha, Vetravati, Shipra and Dravanti. The rivers that flow from the feet of Riksha are Shona, Mahanadi, Narmada, Suratha, Kriya, Mandakini, Dasharna, Chitrakuta, Chitrotpala, Vetravati, ⁵⁰⁹ Karamoda, Pishachika, Atilaghushroni, Vipasha, ⁵¹⁰ the river Shaivala, Sameru, Shuktimati, Shakuni, Tridiva, Kramu and other swift-flowing rivers. The auspicious

rivers with sacred waters that flow from the feet of Vindhya are Shipra, Payoshni, Nirvindhya, Tapi, best among rivers, Vena, Vaitarani, Sinivali, Kumudvati, Toya, Mahagouri, Durga and Antahshila. The best among rivers that flow from the feet of Sahya are Godavari, Bhimarathi, Krishnavena, the river Tungabhadra, Suprayoga and Papanashini. The sacred rivers with cool waters that flow from Mount Malaya are Kritamala, Tamraparni, Pushpavati and Upalavati. Those that flow from Mahendra are said to be Pitrisoma, Rishikulya, Vanjula, Tridiva,⁵¹¹ Langalini and Vamshakara. Those that flow from Shukti are said to be Suvikala, Kumari, Manuga, Mandagamini, Kshaya and Palashini. All of these rivers are as sacred as the Sarasvati and the Ganga, and all of them flow towards the ocean. All of them are like mothers to the world. All of them are said to cleanse all sins. O supreme *brahmanas*! There are thousands of other minor rivers. Some of them flow during the rainy season. Others flow at all times of the year.’

‘The habitations in the middle region that are generally spoken about are Matsya, Kumudamalya, Kratula, Kashi, Koshala, Andhraka, Kalinga, Mashaka and Vrika. River Godavari flows to the north of Sahya, and this is the most pleasant region in the entire earth. The city of the great-souled Bhargava is the beautiful Govardhana.⁵¹² Families of *kshatriyas*, *vaishyas* and shudras live in Vahika, Ratadhana, Sutira, Kalatoyada, Aparanta, Shudra, Bahlika, Kerala, Gandhara, Yavana, Sindhu, Souvira, Madraka, Shatadruha, Kalinga, Parada, Haribhushika, Mathara, Kanaka, Kaikeya and Dambhamalika. O Indras among *brahmanas*! The lands in the northern regions are Kamboja, Barbara, Loukika, Vira, Tushara, Pahlava, with men from Dhayata, Atreya, Bharadvaja, Pushkala, Dasheraka, Lampaka, Shunashoka, Kulika, Jangala, Oushadhi, Chalachandra, that is populated by the Kirata species, Tomara, Hamsamarga, Kashmira, Karuna, Shulika, Kuhaka and Magadha. Now hear about the eastern lands. Andha, Vamankuraka, Vallaka, Makhantaka, Anga, Vanga, Malada, Malavartika, Bhadratunga, Pratijaya, Bharyanga, Apamardaka, Pragjyotisha, Madra, Videha, Tamraliptaka, Malla, Magadhaka, and Nanda—these are the habitations to the east. There are other habitations of those who reside in *dakshinapatha*.⁵¹³ Purna, Kevala, Golangula, Rishika, Mushika, Kumara,

Ramatha, Shaka, Maharashtra, Mahishaka, the entire Kalinga, Abhira, Vaishikya, Atavya, Sarava, Pulinda, Mouleya, Vaidarbha, Dandaka, Poulika, Moulika, Ashmaka, Bhojavardhana, Koulika, Kuntala, Dambhaka, Nilakalaka—these are the lands in the southern region. Now hear about those that are to the west. Shurparaka, Kalidhana, Lola and Talakata—these are the regions to the west. Now hear about those who reside in the Vindhya. Malaja, Karkasha, Melaka, Cholaka, Uttamarna, Dasharna, Bhoja, Kishkindhaka, Toshala, Koshala,⁵¹⁴ Traipura, Vaidisha, Tumbura, Chara, Yavana, Pavana, Abhaya, Rundikera, Charchara, Hotradharti—all these are the habitations of those who live in the Vindhya region. I will now tell you about the lands that are there in the mountains. These are Nihara, Tushamarga, Kuru, Tungana, Khasa, Karnapravarana, Urna, Dargha, Kunchaka, Chitramarga, Malava, Kirata and Tomara. The norms of the four yugas, *krita*, *treta* and the others, are followed here.’

‘Such is Bharatavarsha, with its nine sub-divisions. The great ocean exists towards its south, west and east. Like the bowstring of a bow, the Himalayas stretch towards the north. O supreme *brahmanas*! Bharatavarsha is the seed of everything. O *brahmanas*! Depending on the good or bad deeds one has performed, one obtains the state of Brahma, the state of the lord of the immortals, the state of a god, the state of a Marut, birth as an animal, *yaksha* or *apsara*, birth as a serpent or reptile, and birth as an immobile object. O *brahmanas*! Depending on the *karma* one has undertaken, one can obtain different worlds. O *brahmanas*! The gods always have this wish—‘When we are dislodged from the state of being a god, may we be born on earth in Bharata.’ The gods and the *asuras* are incapable of doing what humans do. Men can devote themselves to *karma*, whereas they are always anxious to exhaust the results of their *karma*. O *brahmanas*! On earth, there is no other place like Bharatavarsha. Here, *brahmanas* and the other *varnas* obtain what they desire. The best among men, who are born in Bharatavarsha, are blessed. They obtain the great fruits of *dharma*, *artha*, *kama* and *moksha*. They obtain the fruits of austerity, which are extremely difficult to obtain. All the fruits of donations are obtained, as well as the fruits of sacrifices. All the fruits of visiting the

tirthas properly are obtained, as are the fruits of serving the *guru*. There are the fruits of worshipping the gods and the fruits of *garhasthya*.⁵¹⁵ The gods always desire a wonderful birth here. There are the fruits of many kinds of vows, and the fruits of many sacred texts. There are the proper fruits of non-violence, as there are the fruits of everything else that is wished for. There are the fruits of *brahmacharya*, and there are the fruits of self-study. There are the fruits of residing in the forest⁵¹⁶, and there are the fruits of *sannyasa*. There are the fruits of *ishta* and *purta*,⁵¹⁷ as there are the fruits of other auspicious deeds. O best among *brahmanas*! What can be obtained in Bharatavarsha cannot be obtained elsewhere. O *brahmanas*! Who is capable of speaking about all the good qualities of Bharata? Thus, I have accurately spoken about the excellent Bharatavarsha. This account destroys all sins. It is sacred and blessed and improves the intelligence. If a person constantly hears this, controls his senses and meditates on it, he is freed from all sins and goes to Vishnu's world.'

Chapter 1(26) (Greatness of Konaditya)

Brahma said, ‘In Bharatavarsha, on the shores of the southern region, there is a land known as Onda. It grants heaven and *moksha*. There is a beautiful and circular dust-free region just to the north of the ocean. This land is populated by those who possess all the qualities and they are ornamented by their own qualities. The *brahmanas* who are born in that region have control over their senses. They are engaged in austerity and self-study. They are always revered and worshipped. Those men originated from the gods and are praised for all kinds of rites—funerals, donations, marriages, sacrifices and teaching. The *brahmanas* from that region are accomplished in the Vedas and are engaged in the six tasks.⁵¹⁸ They know about *itihasa* and are accomplished in the purport of the Puranas. They are knowledgeable about the meanings of all the sacred texts. They undertake sacrifices and are devoid of envy. Some perform *agnihotra*.⁵¹⁹ Some maintain the fire decreed in the *smriti* texts. They possess sons, wives and wealth. They are the ones who offer oblations. They are truthful in speech. They reside in the sacred region of Utkala, which is ornamented with sacrifices and festivals. The other three *varnas* there, *kshatriyas* and others, are also restrained. They are engaged in their own tasks, and are tranquil. Everyone who resides there is devoted to *dharma*. The god Divakara⁵²⁰ is famous there as Konaditya.⁵²¹ If a mortal person sees Bhaskara there, he is freed from all sins.’

The sages said, ‘We now wish to hear about Surya’s *kshetra*. O best among gods! Tell us about the region where Divakara exists.’

Brahma replied, ‘This sacred and extremely beautiful place is on the shores of the salty ocean. The region is full of sand everywhere and possesses all the qualities. In every direction, the place is ornamented with

*chompaka, ashoka, bakula, karavira, patala, punnaga, karnikara, bakula,*⁵²² *nagakeshara, tagara, dhava, bana, atimukta, kubjaka, malati,* the kunda flower, *mallika,* groves with clumps of *ketaki, kadamba, lakucha, shala, panasa, devadaru, sarala, muchukunda,* white and other kinds of *chandana, ashvattha, saptaparna, amra, amrataka, tala, puga* fruit, *narikela, kapitthaka* and many other kinds of trees.⁵²³ In every direction, it is radiant with flowers. Ravi's sacred *kshetra* there is famous in the world. For one *yojana* in every direction, the place grants objects of pleasure and emancipation. The god Divakara, with the one thousand rays, is himself there. The place is famous as Konaditya. It grants objects of pleasure and emancipation.

'On the seventh day of *shukla paksha* in the month of Magha,⁵²⁴ a person should control his senses and fast there. He must bathe in that abode of *makaras*.⁵²⁵ Having purified himself and having purified his *atman*, he should remember the god Divakara. In the presence of the sun, he must follow the norms, bathe in the ocean and control himself. O *brahmanas*! He must satisfy the gods, the *rishis*, humans and the ancestors. He must wear a clean upper garment that is absolutely clean. Controlling himself, he must then rinse his mouth on the shores of the great ocean. When the sun rises, he must sit down, facing the sun. Using red sandalwood mixed with water, an intelligent person must then draw the mark of a lotus. It should be circular, with eight petals and a firm filament, with the pericarp facing upwards. In a copper vessel, he must place sesamum, rice, water, red sandalwood, a red flower and *darbha* grass. If a copper vessel is not available, the sesamum and other things can be placed on a leaf of the sun-plant. O best among sages! This vessel must then be covered with another vessel and placed down. After this, *kara-nyasa* and *anga-nyasa* must be performed.⁵²⁶ Properly and faithfully, he must meditate on Bhaskara being stationed in his limbs, his heart and his *atman*. An intelligent person must worship him in the middle of the petals and to the south-east, south-west, north-west and north-east of the petals. After this, he must again worship him in the middle. He must worship the god who is extremely radiant and represents supreme bliss. He must worship the lotus and invoke Bhaskara

from the sky into the lotus. Placing him atop the pericarp, he must display the *mudras*.⁵²⁷ After having bathed and done the other things, he must control himself and meditate. 'Ravi is established like a drop of energy on top of the white lotus. He has two arms and his eyes are red. His complexion is red, and his garments have the hue of a red lotus. He possesses all the signs and he is adorned with all the ornaments. He is extremely handsome and serene. The granter of boons is adorned with a halo of radiance.' The rising Bhaskara is like a thick mark of vermilion. Having seen him, he must kneel down on the ground. He must pick up the vessel and place it on his head. He must silently use the *mantras* with the three *aksharas*, to worship him by offering him *arghya* in that vessel. A person who has not been initiated should not address the sun-god by name while offering the *arghya*. Ravi can be reached if the sentiments are full of faith and devotion. Beginning with the east, Ravi must be worshipped in the heart, the head, the tuft of hair, the armour, the eyes and the weapon.⁵²⁸ After the *arghya* has been given, fragrances, incense, a lamp and eatables must be offered. After chanting,⁵²⁹ praising and bowing down, he must display the proper *mudras* and allow the deity to leave. If *brahmanas*, *kshatriyas*, *vaishyas*, women or shudras restrain themselves, and by controlling their senses, offer *arghya* to Surya, always pure in their inner cores and filled with faithful sentiments, they enjoy all the desired objects of pleasure and attain the supreme end. Bhaskara, the divinity who travels in the firmament, is a lamp to the three worlds. A man who remembers him obtains happiness. Until *arghya* has been offered to Bhaskara in the proper way, Vishnu, Shankara or the lord of the gods must not be worshipped. Therefore, with care, the *arghya* must be offered every day. After purifying and controlling himself, if a person offers flowers, excellent fragrances and *arghya* to Aditya in this way, or if he bathes, purifies himself and offers these to Aditya on the seventh lunar day, he obtains the desired fruits. A diseased person is freed from disease. A poor person obtains wealth. A person who desires learning obtains knowledge. A person who desires sons obtains sons. By offering *arghya* to Surya, a person obtains whatever he desires. A learned man instantly obtains all these fruits. If a man or a

woman bathes in the ocean and, bowing down, offers *arghya* to Surya, the person obtains all the fruits that are wished for. If a man bathes in the waters of the Ganga and uses a blade of *kusha* grass to sprinkle water on his head, thereafter worshipping Surya, he is freed from all sins and goes to heaven. Thus, he must silently gather flowers and go to Surya's temple. Having entered, he must perform *pradakshina* thrice and worship Bhanu. O supreme among sages! With *mantras* from the Vedas and the *tantra* texts, he must worship God Bhanu, in Konarka, with supreme devotion. He must offer fragrances, flowers, lamps, incense and food. He must prostrate himself like a staff on the ground and praise him, uttering exclamations of 'victory'. If a man worships the god, the lord of the universe, the one with one thousand rays, in this way, he obtains the fruits of ten horse sacrifices. He is cleansed of all sins. He becomes young and becomes the possessor of a divine body. O *brahmanas*! He saves seven generations of ancestors and seven generations of descendants. On a *vimana* that possesses the complexion of the sun and can go wherever it wishes, he is praised by the *gandharvas* and goes to Surya's world. Until the time of the deluge, when all creatures are destroyed, he enjoys the supreme objects of pleasure there. When his store of good merits is exhausted, he is born on earth, but in a family of foremost yogis. He becomes a brahmana who knows about the four vedas. He is pure and is engaged in his own *dharma*. When he is united with Vivasvat, he obtains emancipation. In *shukla paksha* in the month of Chaitra, ⁵³⁰ if a man goes to *damana bhanjika*, ⁵³¹ he obtains the fruits that have been mentioned earlier. If a man controls his senses and undertakes this *yatra* before going to bed, before the sun rises, at the end of *uttarayana*, at the end of *dakshinayana*, on Sunday, or on special *parva* days, he goes to Surya's world on a *vimana* that has the complexion of the sun. ⁵³²

'Mahadeva also exists there, on the shore of the lord of the rivers. That place yields all the fruits of desire, and he is known as Rameshvara there. Having properly bathed in the great ocean, if a person goes and sees Kama's enemy ⁵³³ there, bows down and worships him with fragrances, flowers, incense, lamps, food, hymns, songs and enchanting musical instruments, he obtains the fruits of a properly performed royal sacrifice or

horse sacrifice. Such a person becomes great-souled and obtains supreme success. On a *vimana* that is decorated with nets of bells and can go wherever it wants, he is praised by *gandharvas* and goes to Shiva's world. Until the time of the deluge, he enjoys all the wonderful objects of pleasure there. When his store of good merits is exhausted, he is born on earth as someone who knows the four Vedas. When he is united with Shankara, he obtains emancipation.

‘If a man gives up his life in Savitar's *kshetra*, he ascends to Surya's world and amuses himself with the gods in heaven. When he is again born as a human, he becomes a king who is devoted to *dharma*. When he is united with Ravi, he obtains emancipation. O best among sages! Thus, I have spoken to you about the best of *kshetras*, which is so very difficult to obtain. This is Konarka, on the shores of the ocean. It yields the fruits of objects of pleasure and emancipation.’

Chapter 1(27) (Greatness of Surya's worship)

The sages said, 'O best among the gods! We have heard what you have said about Bhaskara's supreme *kshetra*, which grants obtains of pleasure and emancipation. However, we are not satisfied after hearing about this sacred and pleasing account, that has flowed from your mouth, about Aditya's place which destroys sins. O best among the gods! O supreme among eloquent ones! After this, tell us about the fruits of worshipping the god, the fruits of donations, the fruits of prostrating oneself and worshipping him, the fruits of *pradakshina*, the fruits of offering lamps and incense, the modes of cleaning oneself, the merits of fasting and the merits of eating only in the night. What has been said about offering *arghya*? Where must it be given? How does one ensure devotion? How is the god pleased? O best among the gods! We desire to hear all this.'

Brahma replied, 'O supreme among *brahmanas*! I will tell you everything about offering *arghya* to Bhaskara and worshipping him, about faith, devotion and *samadhi*. Listen. Faith is a state of mind and it is also spoken of as devotion. ⁵³⁴ *Samadhi* is said to be concentrated *dhyana*. Listen attentively. If a man faithfully recounts this, if a man worships that reciter, or if a person tends to the sacrificial fire, such a person is said to be an eternal devotee. His mind and consciousness are always fixed on worshipping the god. If he is engaged in the god's tasks, such a person is an eternal devotee. O *brahmanas*! If a man chants about the god, he is thought to be a superior devotee than the man who only undertakes rites for the sake of the Vedas. Such a man is the supreme devotee. He bears no malice towards the devotees of other gods, nor does he criticize them. If a man follows Aditya's vows, he is a superior devotee. If a man always remembers Bhaskara, whether he is walking, standing, sleeping, smelling, opening his

eyes or closing his eyes, he is a superior devotee. A person who knows must always exhibit devotion in this way. With faith, one must use *samadhi* to perceive the truth in one's mind. One must observe *niyama*, and give donations to *brahmanas*. When men give these, it is actually the gods and the ancestors who receive them. Gods accept whatever is properly offered through devotion—leaves, flowers, fruits and waters. However, they avoid non-believers. ⁵³⁵ Whatever one does, one must be pure in sentiments and observe the norms of *niyama*. If one acts so as to ensure purity of sentiments, all the fruits are obtained. If one faithfully worships Vivasvat through praise, *japa*, gifts and fasting, one is freed from all sins. If a person touches his head down on the ground, prostrates himself and bows down to him, he is instantly freed from all sins. There is no doubt about this. If a man is filled with devotion and performs *pradakshina* of Ravi, it is as if he has done a *pradakshina* of the earth, with its seven *dvipas*. If a man has Surya in his mind and does a *pradakshina* of Surya's temple, ⁵³⁶ it is as if he has undertaken *pradakshina* of all the gods.

‘On the sixth lunar day, if a man eats once a day and worships Ravi, following vows and *niyama*, he is regarded as someone who is full of faith towards Ravi. If an immensely fortunate person fasts for a night and a day and then worships Bhaskara on the seventh lunar day, he obtains the fruits of a horse sacrifice. If a person performs the worship on the sixth lunar day and the seventh lunar day, he obtains the supreme destination and goes to Surya's world on a vehicle that has the complexion of the fire. If a person controls his senses, fasts and uses a gift of all the jewels to worship Bhaskara on the seventh lunar day of *krishna paksha*, he goes to Surya's world on a vehicle that has the complexion of a lotus. If a man fasts and uses all kinds of white gifts to worship Bhaskara on the seventh lunar day of *shukla paksha*, he is freed from all sins and goes to Surya's world. There is a praised rite known as *arka saptami*. ⁵³⁷ On the first day of the vow, the devotee must drink as much of water as can be held in a cup made out a leaf of the *arka* plant. This must be gradually increased by one more portion every day for twenty four days and then decreased by one portion every day for twenty four days. The vow is completed when it has been followed for

two years. If the seventh lunar day of *shukla paksha* happens to be a Sunday, it is known as *saptami vijaya* and brings great fruits. Bathing, donations, austerities, oblations and fasting on *saptami vijaya* destroy major sins. If a man performs a funeral ceremony on Sunday and undertakes a sacrifice to Mahashveta,⁵³⁸ he obtains great fruits. His rites of *dharma*, directed towards Bhaskara, are always successful. No poor or diseased person is born in his family. If a man plasters his house with white, red or yellow clay, fasts and worships Chitrabhanu⁵³⁹ with diverse fragrant flowers, he obtains all the fruits he can think of. He obtains everything that he desires. If he performs this worship after lighting a lamp filled with *ghee* or sesamum oil, he remains young and has a long lifespan. His eyesight does not weaken. If a person is devoted to donating lamps, his lamp of knowledge always remains ignited. With clear intelligence and senses, he may sometimes be emancipated. Sesamum seeds are extremely sacred, and a gift of sesamum seeds is an excellent gift. If it is used in a lamp to light a fire, it destroys great sins. If a person constantly donates lamps in temples of the gods, squares or roads, he remains handsome and is extremely fortunate. In a lamp, the first preference is to use *ghee*. The second preference is to use juices from herbs. Fat, marrow and bones must never be used. The flame of the lamp must always rise upwards, never downwards. If a person donates a lamp, he is radiant and is never born as inferior species. A burning lamp must never be taken away or destroyed. If a man steals a lamp, he faces bondage, killing, rage and darkness. A person who donates a lamp is as radiant in heaven as a garland of lamps. If a man constantly decorates lamps with aloe and sandalwood, he is the best among men and obtains wealth, fame and prosperity. If a man wakes up in the morning, and purifying himself, always offers an *arghya* of red flowers mixed with red sandalwood, he obtains success at the end of a year. There is a vow named after Aditya and it destroys great sins. As the sun circles from sunrise to sunset, one must be fixed in one place, facing the sun, performing *japa* with a *mantra* or a hymn. If a person faithfully offers *arghya* and everything else at the time of sunrise, he is freed from all sins. If the person who offers the *arghya* adds gold, a cow, a bull, a bit of land or a garment along with it, he

obtains the appropriate fruits for seven births. The offering of *pinda* ⁵⁴⁰ must carefully be offered to the fire, water, space, clean ground and the image of the deity. It must not be offered to the left or the right, but straight ahead. Filled with devotion, it must be offered to Ravi, along with *ghee* and *guggula*. ⁵⁴¹ The man must faithfully offer all the worship in Ravi's direction. There is no doubt that he will be instantly freed from all sins. If a person offers turpentine, ⁵⁴² the oil of a *devadaru* tree, the oil of a *shala* tree, camphor, aloe or incense, he goes to heaven. In particular, if a person worships Surya during *uttarayana* or *dakshinayana*, he is freed from all sins. ⁵⁴³ In particular, if a person performs this worship during these transits or at the time of *shadashiti*, ⁵⁴⁴ he is freed from all sins. If a man faithfully worships Arka, whether it is along the shore or not along the shore, he obtains greatness in Arka's world. If a person offers *krisara*, *payasam*, sweet cakes, fruits, roots, *ghee*, rice and other offerings to Surya, he obtains all the objects of desire. ⁵⁴⁵ With offerings of *ghee*, a person becomes the best among men. With offerings of milk, one never suffers from mental distress. With offerings of curds, a man obtains success in his tasks. If a person controls and purifies himself, and brings water for bathing Bhanu from a *tirtha*, he obtains the supreme destination. If a person faithfully offers Bhanu an umbrella, a standard, a canopy, a flag or a whisk, he obtains the desired destination. When a man faithfully offers an object to Aditya, Bhaskara returns it back to him one hundred thousand times. Through prostrating oneself to Surya, all evil deeds, in the form of thought, speech and deeds are destroyed. The fruits that are obtained through a single day's worship of Bhanu are more than those obtained through one hundred sacrifices with appropriate *dakshina*.'

Chapter 1(28) (Aditya's greatness)

The sages said, 'O lord of the universe! We have heard about god Bhaskara's greatness. O best among the gods! You have spoken about it and it is extremely rare to hear this. O lord of the universe! Please tell us what we are asking you about again. O Brahma! We have great curiosity and wish to hear about it. If a person in a state of *brahmacharya*, *garhasthya*, *vanaprastha* or *sannyasa* ⁵⁴⁶ desires *moksha*, which divinity should he worship? How can one certainly obtain heaven? How can one obtain supreme benefit? What does one do if one is again dislodged from heaven? Who is the god among the gods? Who is the ancestor among the ancestors? O lord of the gods! Who is the one who has no one superior to him? Tell us about this. O Brahma! What was this universe, with its mobile and immobile objects, created from? Where does it go at the time of destruction? You should tell us about this.'

Brahma replied, 'O supreme among *brahmanas*! When he rises, he dispels the darkness of the universe with his rays. There is no god who is superior to him. He has no beginning and no end. He is the eternal and undecaying being. As he revolves, he uses his rays to scorch the three worlds. All the gods are in this scorcher. He is supreme amongst those who scorch. He is the lord of everything in the universe. He is a witness to everything in the universe, good or bad. He is the one who draws in creatures and he is the one who creates them again. He uses his rays to illuminate, scorch and preserve. He is the creator and the ordainer. He is the original cause behind the creation of all beings. He never decays. Nor does his disc ever decay. He is the ancestor among the ancestors. He is the god among the gods. His position is said to be the eternal one and if one attains that, one is never dislodged again. It is said that at the time of creation,

everything in the universe originated from Aditya. At the time of destruction, everything enters into Bhaskara's blazing energy. When they cast aside this abode in the physical body, innumerable yogis enter the air and then merge into the mass of energy that is Divakara. Just as birds perch on branches, sages, *siddhas* and gods reside in his one thousand rays. There were kings, Janaka⁵⁴⁷ and the others, who were in a stage of *garhasthya* and were devoted to yoga. There were *rishis* who knew about the *brahman*, *valakhilyas* and others. There were those in *vanaprastha*, Vyasa and others. There were *bhikshukas*. All of them resorted to yoga and entered the solar disc. The handsome Shuka, Vyasa's son, resorted to yoga. He entered Aditya's rays and was united with him. Brahma, Vishnu and Shiva are mentioned in the sacred texts as those who grant happiness. But they are mere words in those texts. Surya, the supreme god who destroys darkness, is directly visible. Therefore, if a person desires what is good for himself, he should not be devoted to anyone else. What is visible is always better than what cannot be seen. Therefore, you must always worship the illustrious Ravi. He is the mother and the father. He is the preceptor of the entire universe. He is without a beginning. He is the protector of the worlds. He is the one with a garland of rays. He is the lord of the universe. O supreme among *brahmanas*! It is Mitra⁵⁴⁸ who is the scorcher. Brahma is without a beginning and an end. He is always without decay. For the welfare of the worlds, while standing on the banks of the river Chandrasarit,⁵⁴⁹ he created the oceans, the *dvipas* and the fourteen worlds. He created all the Prajapatis, and he created diverse kinds of subjects.

‘The one with hundreds and thousands of rays is not manifest. However, he then manifested himself in the form of the twelve Adityas—Indra, Dhatri, Parjanya, Tvashta, Pusha, Aryama, Bhaga, Vivasvat, Vishnu, Amsha, Varuna and Mitra. O supreme among *brahmanas*! The *paramatman* was embodied in these twelve forms of Surya and pervaded the entire universe. Aditya's first embodied form is known as Indra. He is established as the king of the gods and destroys the enemies of the gods. The second embodied form is known by the name of Dhatri. He is established as Prajapati and creates diverse kinds of subjects. His third embodied form is

known as Parjanya. He is established in the clouds and uses his rays to shower down. His fourth embodied form is famous by the name of Tvashta. He is established everywhere, in the trees and in the herbs. His fifth embodied form is famous by the name of Pusha. He is established in food and always nourishes subjects. Ravi's sixth embodied form is famous as Aryama. He is in the gods, in the form of covering known as Vayu. Bhanu's seventh embodied form is famous by the name of Bhaga. He is established in the bodies of those with bodies in the form of elements. His eighth embodied form is famous as Vivasvat. He is established in fire and cooks the food in those with bodies. Chitrabhanu's ninth embodied form is named Vishnu. He always manifests himself to destroy the enemies of the gods. His tenth embodied form is famous as Anshuman.⁵⁵⁰ Established in the wind, he brings delight to subjects. Bhanu's eleventh embodied form is known by the name of Varuna. Established in water, he always protects subjects. Bhanu's twelfth embodied form is known by the name of Mitra. For the welfare of the worlds, he is stationed on the banks of Chandrasarit. Mitra stationed himself there, tormenting himself in austerity and subsisting only on air. His glances always favour his devotees by granting them many kinds of boons. This was his original location, later re-established by Samba. Since Mitra stayed there, it is known as Mitravana.⁵⁵¹ O supreme among *brahmanas*! Through these twelve embodied forms of Savitar, the *paramatman* pervades the entire universe. Therefore, with faith in their hearts, men must always worship these twelve embodied forms. If a man thus worships these twelve forms of Aditya, or constantly hears about them or reads about them, he obtains greatness in Surya's world.'

The sages asked, 'If Surya is the original and eternal god, why did he torment himself in austerity and ask for a boon, like an ordinary being?'

Brahma replied, 'I will tell you about this extremely secret account of Vibhvasu. Earlier, the great-souled Narada had asked Mitra about this. I have already told you about Ravi's twelve embodied forms. Two of them, Mitra and Varuna, resorted to austerities. Of the two, Varuna stationed himself on the shores of the western ocean and subsisted on water. Mitra resorted to austerity in Mitravana, subsisting only on air. Narada is a great

yogi who is capable of travelling in all the worlds. He descended from the summit of Mount Meru and went to Gandhamadana. He went to the place where Mitra was performing austerities. He was extremely curious at these supreme austerities being undertaken. ‘He is without destruction and without decay.’⁵⁵² He is manifest, and he is not manifest. He is the eternal one. He is the extremely great-souled one. He alone holds up the three worlds. He is the father of all the gods. He is greater than the greatest. Which god is he worshipping? Which ancestor is he worshipping?’ With these thoughts in his mind, Narada spoke to the divinity. Narada said, ‘The Vedas, the Puranas, the Vedangas and the accompanying texts chant about you as the one without birth. You are the eternal one. You are the creator. You are the possessor of this great and excellent form. The past, the present and the future—everything is established in you. O god! The four *ashramas*, *garhasthya* and the others, worship you every day. You are the one who has many different kinds of forms. You are the father and the mother for everyone. You are the eternal divinity. We do not know which god or ancestor you are worshipping.’ Mitra replied, ‘This is an eternal and supreme secret and should not be spoken about. O brahmana! However, you are full of devotion. I will tell you the truth about this. He is subtle and cannot be comprehended. He is not manifest. He does not move. He is eternal. He does not possess the senses and is impervious to the objects of the senses. He is beyond the elements. He is in the atmans of all creatures and is spoken of as *kshetrajna*. He is thought of as Purusha, who is beyond the three *gunas*. He is the illustrious Hiranyagarbha, who is spoken of as supreme intelligence. In yoga, he is spoken of as Mahat and Pradhana. Though he is one, in *samkhya* and yoga, he is spoken of with many different kinds of names. He has three forms.’⁵⁵³ He is the *atman* of the universe. He is alone the one without decay. Within himself, he holds up the three worlds. He is without a body, but always resides in all bodies. Though he resides in bodies, he is not touched by the acts of *karma*. He is in my inner core and also inside others who have bodies. He is a witness to everything. But no one is ever able to comprehend him. He is with *gunas* and without *gunas*. He is the universe. It has been said that he can be perceived through

jnana. The ends of his hands and feet are everywhere. His eyes, heads and mouths are in every direction. His ears are in every direction. He stands there, pervading everything. The universe is his head. The universe is his arms. The universe is his feet, eyes and noses. As he wills, he happily moves around in the bodies. The bodies are *kshetras* ⁵⁵⁴ and he cheerfully moves around in them. Therefore, those who have yoga in their atmans speak of him as *kshetrajna*. Earlier, when he lay down in his unmanifest form, he was spoken of as Purusha. In the universe, he is known in many different kinds of forms. It is said that he is everywhere. Therefore, since he possesses many different kinds of forms, he is spoken of as Vishvarupa. ⁵⁵⁵ Since he is alone in his greatness, he is spoken of as the absolute Purusha. He alone is radiant and eternal and is known as Mahapurusha. ⁵⁵⁶ With an intelligence full of *sattva*, he acts so as to create himself out of his own self—hundreds, thousands, hundreds of thousands and crores of time. He, thus, creates forms out of his own self. The water that falls down from the sky acquires a specific taste because of the juices in the earth. Like that, he imbibes the juices of the *gunas*. Though the wind is one, it has five forms in the body. ⁵⁵⁷ There is no doubt that he possesses one and many forms. Just as the fire acquires different kinds of names depending on where it is located, he also has different names—Dhruva, Brahma, I and others. Thousands of lamps can be ignited from a single lamp. Like that, thousands of forms are created from a single source. At the time of destruction, he realizes himself only in a single form. Thereafter, many forms are created. No entity in the universe, mobile or immobile, is permanent. He alone is without decay. He is immeasurable and is spoken of as someone who can go everywhere. O supreme among sages! The unmanifest, with the three *gunas*, evolved out of him. ⁵⁵⁸ This unmanifest form, whose nature is also not manifest, is spoken of as Prakriti. Know that this is Brahma's womb. Cause and effect exist inside this. ⁵⁵⁹ In the worlds, in the forms of rites to gods and ancestors, it is he who is worshipped. O *brahmanas*! ⁵⁶⁰ No one, god or ancestor, exists who is superior to him. He can be comprehended through the *atman*. It is he that I am worshipping. All the embodied beings who are in heaven bow down to him. O *devarshi*! They obtain the fruits that

they desire and the intended destination. Resorting to many different kinds of forms, the gods have their own *ashramas*. When they worship him faithfully, he grants them their original and ultimate destinations. He is spoken of as the one without *gunas*, someone who is omnipresent. Having heard this and having understood this, I am worshipping Divakara. In this world, those who think about him resort to him alone. Beyond this, they obtain union with that single one. O Narada! I have thus instructed you about something that is supremely secret. O *devarshi*! I have told you because you are extremely devoted to me. All the sages who are learned in the Puranas, worship the *paramatman* in the form of Divakara.’ In earlier times, this is what Bhanu told Narada. O supreme among *brahmanas*! I have told you what Bhanu recounted. O supreme among *brahmanas*! I have spoken about this account to you. However, this account should never be revealed to those who are not devoted to Aditya. If a man constantly hears this, or having heard, recounts it to another, there is no doubt that he enters the god with the one thousand rays. If one hears this account right from the beginning, an afflicted person is freed from disease, and the curious obtain knowledge and the desired end. O sage! ⁵⁶¹ A person who reads this is instantly liberated. There is no doubt that such a person obtains what he desires. Therefore, all of you must always worship the illustrious Ravi. He is the creator and the ordainer. He is the preceptor of the entire universe.’

Chapter 1(29) (Martanda's names)

Brahma continued, 'O supreme among sages! Aditya is the origin of everything in the three worlds. O Indras among *brahmanas*! Everything in the universe originates with him, the gods, the *asuras* and humans, the great radiance of Rudra, Upendra, ⁵⁶² the great Indra and those who reside in heaven, and the energy in all the worlds. He is in all atmans. He is the lord of the worlds. He is the god of the gods. He is Prajapati. Surya is the root behind the three worlds. He is the supreme divinity. The oblations that are properly offered to Agni reach Aditya. Rain results from Aditya. The rain leads to food for subjects. Everything originates in Surya. Everything is dissolved into him. In ancient times, the existence and non-existence of everything in the worlds flowed from Aditya. For those who meditate, he is *dhyana*. For those who seek *moksha*, he is *moksha*. Those who are liberated enter into him. It is from him that they are repeatedly born. Without Aditya's existence, the measurement of time, *kshana*, *muhurta*, day, night, fortnight, month, year, season and yuga would not have been possible. ⁵⁶³ Without measurement of time, there would have been no *niyama*, no indication of when rites were to be performed. Without division into seasons, how could there have been flowers and fruits? How would crops have grown? Where would grass and herbs have come from? In their absence, there would have been no sustenance of creatures, on earth and in heaven. These things exist in the universe because of Bhaskara's powers and because of what he does. In the absence of rain, Surya does not scorch. If there is no rain, everything dries up. If there is no rain, Ravi's disc is dimmed. It is because of the rains that he shines. Surya is tawny in the spring and has a complexion of gold in the summer. Bhaskara is white during the rainy season and pale in autumn. In late autumn, Ravi has the

complexion of copper. In winter, he is red. ⁵⁶⁴ Surya's complexions that result from the seasons have been described. These natural hues of Surya in different seasons bring welfare and happiness. That is the reason, in this world, Aditya generally has twelve names. I will separately tell you all these twelve names—Aditya, Savitar, Surya, Mihira, Arka, Prabhakara, Martanda, Bhaskara, Bhanu, Chitrabhanu, Divakara and Ravi. ⁵⁶⁵ In general, these are known as Ravi's twelve names—Vishnu, Dhatri, Bhaga, Pusha, Mitra, Indra, Varuna, Aryama, Vivasvat, Amshuman, Tvashta and Parjanya. These twelve forms of Aditya are separately established. They always rise in the respective twelve months. Vishnu heats in Chaitra, Aryama in Vaishakha, Vivasvat in the month of Jyeshtha, Amshuman is said to be in Ashadha, Parjanya in the month of Shravana, Varuna in what is known as Proushtha, Indra in the month of Ashvayuja, Dhatri heats in Kartika, Mitra in Margashirsha, Pusha is the sun in Pousha, Bhaga is said to be the sun in Magha and Tvashta heats in Phalguna. ⁵⁶⁶ Vishnu always blazes with one thousand and two hundred rays, Aryama heats with one thousand and three hundred rays, Vivasvat with one thousand and four hundred, Amshuman with one thousand and five hundred, Parjanya with one thousand and four hundred like Vivasvat, Varuna with one thousand and three hundred like Aryama, Indra is said to have one thousand and two hundred, Dhatri with one thousand and one hundred, Mitra with one thousand, Pusha with nine hundred, and Mitra, Bhaga and Tvashta with one thousand each. During *uttarayana*, Arka's rays progressively increase. During *dakshinayana*, Surya's rays progressively decrease. Thus, Surya sustains the worlds through thousands of rays. These nurture the different seasons in many kinds of ways. Thus, the twenty-four names have been spoken about. There are also one thousand names that have been described.'

The sages said, 'O Prajapati! O supreme lord! If a person praises Arka with those one thousand names, what is the auspicious end that he obtains?'

Brahma replied, 'O tigers among sages! this eternal essence. These one thousand auspicious names must be recited and praised. These names are sacred, auspicious and secret. I will recount Bhaskara's names to you. Listen. Vikartana, Vivasvat, Martanda, Bhaskara, Ravi, Lokaprakashaka,

Shriman, Lokachakshu, Maheshvara, Lokasakshi, Trilokesha, Karta, Harta, Tamisraha, Tapanana, Taapana, Shuchi, Saptashvavahana, Gabhastihasta, Brahmanya and Sarvadevanamaskrita—these twenty-one names of Ravi are always praised and delight him. They destroy diseases of the body. They ensure an increase in wealth and fame. In the three worlds, these names are famous as *stavaraja*.⁵⁶⁷ O best among *brahmanas*! If a person purifies himself and uses this to praise to Surya at the time of the two *sandhyas*, dawn and dusk, he is cleansed of all sins. If one performs this *japa* once, in Arka's presence, all ailments of mind, speech, body and deeds are destroyed. One such single *japa* is used at the time of offering oblations, at the time of the *sandhya* worship, as part of the *mantra* when incense and *arghya* are offered, as part of the *mantra* when offerings are rendered, and as part of the *mantra* when food or other donations are given, or when one prostrates oneself or performs *pradakshina*. This is a great *mantra* and is worshipped. It is auspicious and destroys all sins. O *brahmanas*! Therefore, you should carefully use it in your praises. When he is praised, he is the divinity who confers boons that yield all the fruits of desire.'

Chapter 1(30) (Martanda's birth and paring)

The sages said, 'You have said that the eternal God, Divakara is devoid of *gunas*. However, we have also heard from you that he was again born in twelve different forms. How was Bhaskara, that immensely radiant one, a mass of energy, born from the womb of a woman? O god! We have a great doubt about this.'

Brahma replied, 'Daksha had sixty beautiful and excellent daughters, Diti, Aditi, Danu, Vinata and others. He bestowed thirteen of those daughters on Kashyapa. Aditi gave birth to the gods, the lords of the three worlds. Diti gave birth to *daityas* and Danu gave birth to *danavas*, who were fierce and intoxicated on account of their strength. Vinata and the others gave birth to various mobile and immobile entities. O sage! ⁵⁶⁸ The entire universe was pervaded with these sons, daughters, paternal grandsons and maternal grandsons. Amongst Kashyapa's sons, the foremost were the categories of the gods. They were full of *sattva*. The other categories are said to have been full of *rajas* and *tamas*. Parameshthi Prajapati, supreme among those who know about the *brahman*, created the gods as those who would be the lords of the three worlds and would have a share in the sacrifices. Their rivals, the *daityas* and the *danavas*, were their enemies and obstructed them in this. There was an extremely terrible battle that lasted for one thousand divine years, with the *rakshasas* also tormenting the gods. The powerful *daityas* and *danavas* were victorious in the battle. O supreme among sages! Aditi saw that the *daityas* and the *danavas* had repulsed her sons and had taken away the three worlds from them. Since their shares in sacrifices had been taken away from them, they were hungry. She was greatly afflicted. With a great deal of care, she worshipped Savitar. She was

attentive and controlled her intake of food. She observed supreme *niyama*. Divakara, the mass of energy in the sky, was satisfied.'

Aditi said, 'I bow down to the supremely subtle one. I prostrate myself before the unmatched radiance. You are the refuge. You are the lord of all those who are refugees. You are the one who supports refugees. You are the eternal one. O lord of the rays! For the benefit of the universe, I am bowing down before you. I bow down before the fierce form through which you suck up and accept the juices from the water for a period of eight months. I bow down before that fierce and radiant form. I bow down before the form that has *rajas* ⁵⁶⁹ during the two *sandhyas*. O one who has the *gunas* in his *atman*. Please grant me my wish. You scorch in a form that unites the *Rig*, *Yajur* and *Sama*. In this universe, you are the one who represents these three. I bow down before the radiant one. You are the supreme form that is spoken about in 'Oum'. You are the one who is addressed. You are the gross and the subtle. You are eternal and pure. I bow down before you.'

Brahma continued, 'O *brahmanas*! Desiring to worship Vivasvat, the queen controlled herself and fasted, using this *stotram* day and night. O *brahmanas*! After a long period of time, the illustrious Tapanas manifested himself before Daksha's daughter. O supreme among *brahmanas*! Though Bhanu was standing on the ground, she saw a lofty mass of energy that covered the sky. His blazing garland made it extremely difficult to look at him. On seeing him, the goddess was filled with great fear. Aditi said, 'O origin of the universe! Please be pacified. O lord of the rays! I cannot look at you. Show me your favours. O Divakara! Show me a form I can behold. O lord! Show compassion towards a devotee. I am devoted to you. Save my sons.' At this, Vibhavasu revealed himself from behind that mass of energy. Lord Aditya could then be seen in a form that resembled molten copper. O *brahmanas*! He spoke to the goddess, who had prostrated herself on seeing him. The radiant one said, 'Ask me for whatever boon you desire.' She sank on her knees on the ground and lowered her head. She replied to Vivasvat, the granter of boons, who had manifested himself. Aditi said, 'O god! Show me your favours. The three worlds have been taken away from my sons and so have the shares in sacrifices. The *daityas* and the *danavas* are stronger

than them. O lord of the rays! For that reason, show me your favours. Use your portion to be born as their brother, so that the enemies can be destroyed. O lord! Let my sons again regain their shares in sacrifices and become lords of the three worlds again. O Divakara! O Ravi! Be pleased with me and also show compassion towards my sons. O afflicter of distress for those who seek refuge in you! You are the one who can act so as to ensure this.’ O *brahmanas*! The lord, illustrious Bhaskara, the possessor of a pleasant face, the one who steals the waters, spoke to Aditi, who was prostrate in front of him. ‘I will use a thousandth bit of my portion to be born in your womb. I will become your son and swiftly burn down the enemy.’ Having said this, the illustrious and radiant one vanished. With all her wishes having been accomplished, she too refrained from austerity.’

‘After one year was over, Ravi used one of his thousand rays, known as *sushumna*, to fulfil her wishes. Savitar resided in the womb of the mother of the gods. Controlling herself well, she observed *kriccha*, *chandrayana* and other vows.⁵⁷⁰ O *brahmanas*! She purified herself and nurtured this divine fetus. At this, Kashyapa addressed her in words that had a slight tinge of rage. ‘By constantly fasting, do you wish to destroy the egg that is in your womb?’ On being thus addressed, she was filled with anger and replied, ‘See for yourself. The egg in the womb is incapable of being killed by the enemy. Instead, it will be like their death.’ Having said this, angry at her husband’s words, she discharged that extremely terrible fetus, which blazed in its energy. Kashyapa saw that the fetus possessed the resplendence of the rising sun. He bowed down and praised it in generous and eloquent words. Thus praised, the egg in the womb manifested himself. His complexion was like that of lotus petals and his energy enveloped the directions. From the firmament, an invisible voice addressed Kashyapa, the supreme sage, and his wife in words that rumbled like the clouds. The voice said, ‘Aditi’s egg was spoken of as dead. O sage! Therefore, your son will be known as Martanda.⁵⁷¹ He will slay the enemy *asuras*, those who have stolen the shares in sacrifices.’ Hearing the voice that spoke from the firmament, the gods were filled with unmatched joy. Thinking that the *danavas* had been robbed of their energy, Shatakratu challenged the *daityas* to a battle. Along

with the gods, he cheerfully fought against the *danavas* too. There was an extremely terrible battle between the gods and the *asuras*. The shower of blazing *astras* and *shastras* covered all the space between the worlds.⁵⁷² In that battle, the illustrious Martanda glanced at the great *asuras* and used his energy to burn and reduce them to ashes. At this, all the residents of heaven were filled with unmatched delight. They praised Martanda and Aditi, the womb of that energy. As was the case earlier, they got back their positions and their shares in sacrifices. The illustrious Martanda also arranged for his own rights. His form could clearly be seen, as radiant as a ball of fire, surrounded by his rays above and below, shining like the flower of a *kadamba* tree.'

The sages asked, 'Later, how did Ravi obtain a more handsome form, resembling the flower of a *kadamba* tree? O lord of the universe! Please tell us that.'

Brahma replied, 'Tvashta, Prajapati Vishvakarma, bestowed his daughter, named Samjna, on Vivasvat, after bowing down before him and pleasing him. The lord of the rays had three children through her. There were two extremely fortunate sons and there was later a daughter, Yamuna. Martanda Vivasvat's energy was excessive. All the mobile and immobile objects in the three worlds were excessively scorched because of this. Vivasvat's form was like a ball. When she looked at his great energy, Samjna could not tolerate it. She spoke to her own shadow.⁵⁷³ Samjna said, 'O fortunate one! I am going to my own father's house. O auspicious one! Without being disturbed, obey my command and remain here in my place. O one with the beautiful complexion! O fortunate one! I have these two sons and a daughter. Rear them as your own and don't reveal this.' Chhaya replied, 'Go where you wish. However, if I am seized by the hair or cursed, I will reveal everything.' Thus addressed, somewhat ashamed, Samjna went to her father's house.⁵⁷⁴ She resided in her father's house for one thousand years. Her father repeatedly told her, 'Go to your husband's presence.' She then assumed the form of a mare and went to Uttara Kuru. O supreme among *brahmanas*! Fasting, the virtuous lady tormented herself in austerity there. When Samjna went off to her father's house, Chhaya followed her words.

She assumed her form and presented herself before Bhaskara. The illustrious Surya thought that she was Samjna. Through her, he had two sons and a daughter. Like an ordinary woman, Chhaya was no longer as affectionate towards the children who had been born earlier. Manu forgave her, but Yama was unable to do so. ⁵⁷⁵ He was extremely unhappy that his father's wife made him suffer in many kinds of ways. Perhaps it was because of anger, perhaps it was because he was a child or perhaps because of destiny, he raised his foot to kick her, though he did not actually bring it down on her body. Chhaya said, 'You have raised a foot to kick your father's wife, who is your senior. Therefore, there is no doubt that your foot will fall down.' Yama's mind suffered a great deal because of this curse. Along with Manu, who had *dharma* in his soul, he went to his father and reported everything. Yama said, 'O god! Our mother is not equal in affection towards us. She ignores the elder children and is more devoted to the younger ones. I raised my foot, but I did not actually bring it down on her body. If I have done this out of childishness or delusion, you should pardon me. O father! I am a son and my mother has angrily cursed me. O supreme among those who scorch! I do not think that she is our mother. O illustrious one! Show me your favours and ensure that my foot does not fall down because of my mother's curse. O god! O lord of the rays! Please think of a means.' Ravi replied, 'O son! O one who knows about *dharma*! You follow *dharma*. There must have been a grave reason behind this. Otherwise, why must you succumb to rage? There are ways to counter every curse. However, there is no means to counter a mother's curse. I am incapable of acting in a way that is contrary to your mother's words. However, I can do something to reduce the impact of the curse. Worms will tear flesh from your foot and enter the earth. That way, her words will come true and you will also be saved.' Aditya then told Chhaya, 'One should be equally affectionate towards all the sons. Why are you partial towards one? ⁵⁷⁶ You are certainly not their mother, known by the name of Samjna. Even if offspring do not possess any qualities, mothers do not curse them.' Scared of being cursed by Ravi, she revealed what she had avoided thus far.'

‘Hearing the account, he went to his father-in-law, who honoured Vibhavasū in the proper way. Since he wished to burn him down in his rage, the one who was excellent in his vows, pacified him. Vishvakarma said, ‘Everything is pervaded by your form, which is excessive in its energy. It is extremely difficult to tolerate. Unable to bear it, Samjñā is performing austerity in the forest. She is auspicious in her deeds and you will see your own wife today. She is performing extremely great austerity in the forest so that you have a handsome form. O god! I have heard Brahma’s words. O lord of the day! If it appeals to you, I will shave off your form and make it more handsome now.’ The illustrious Ravi agreed to what Tvashta had said. Earlier, Vivasvat’s form had been like a ball. With Vivasvat’s permission, in Shakadvīpa, Vishvakarma mounted him on his wheel and gradually started to shave off the energy. The sun is like the navel of the world. As he was whirled around, the earth, the oceans, the mountains and the forests rose up into the sky. O *brahmanas*! O immensely fortunate ones! The entire firmament, with the moon, the planets and the stars, moved downwards and was anxious and agitated. All the waters in the oceans were hurled around. Giant mountains shattered. Their summits broke off and were fragmented. O supreme among sages! Everything that found a support in Dhruva was torn apart. It was as if the bonds snapped and without the rays, which were like bonds, they headed downwards. Agitated by the wind, thousands of clouds were whirled around. Uttering fierce and terrible roars, those giant clouds were scattered. As the sun was whirled around, the earth, the sky and the nether regions were confused. O supreme among sages! At that time, the entire universe was extremely anxious. Seeing that the three worlds were being whirled around, the divine *rishis* and gods, along with Brahma, praised the radiant one. ‘Among the gods, you are the original god. You have originated for the prosperity of the world. At the time of creation, preservation and destruction, you are established in three distinct forms. O lord of the universe! O one who showers down during the summer! O Divakara! May all be well with you.’ As he was being pared down, Indra and the other gods praised him in the following way. ‘O god! Victory to you. O lord of everything in the universe! O lord of the rays! Victory to

you.’ The seven *rishis*, with Vasishtha and Atri at the forefront, praised him with many different *stotrams* and pronounced benedictions. The *valakhilyas* praised him with choice words from the Vedas. As the sun was being pared down, Angiras and others rejoiced and said, ‘O lord! You grant *moksha* to those who desire *moksha*. You are the supreme object of *dhyana* for those who meditate. You are the destination for all creatures who are engaged in *karmakanda*.⁵⁷⁷ O lord of the gods! O lord of the universe! You are the one who deserves to be worshipped. May everything be beneficial for bipeds. May everything be beneficial for quadrupeds.’ All the large numbers of *vidyadharas*, *yakshas*, *rakshasas* and *pannagas* joined their hands in salutation and bowing their heads down, prostrated themselves before Ravi. They uttered diverse kinds of words and *stotrams* that brought pleasure to the mind. ‘O creator of beings! May beings be able to tolerate your energy.’ Accomplished *gandharvas* like Haha, Huhu, Narada⁵⁷⁸ and Tumburu started to sing songs in Ravi’s praise. They were accomplished in the three notes of *shadaja*, *madhyama* and *gandhara* and used *murchhana* and *tala* that was pleasant to hear.⁵⁷⁹ As Vibhavasu, the lord of the universe, was being pared down, Vishvachi, Ghritachi, Urvashi, Tilottama, Menaka, Sahajanya, Rambha and other supreme *apsaras* danced. They exhibited many kinds of dramatic gestures and glances. Flutes, *veenas*, *jharjharas*,⁵⁸⁰ drums, kettledrums, tambourines, double-sided drums, larger drums, the drums of the gods and conch-shells were sounded, in hundreds and thousands. The *gandharvas* sang and large numbers of *apsaras* danced. All the trumpets and the sound of musical instruments generated a tumultuous sound. Their hands were joined in salutation and their forms were lowered, full of devotion. As the one with the one thousand rays was pared down, all the gods bowed down to him. Because all the creatures had assembled, there was a great uproar. Placing him on the wheel, Vishvakarma gradually pared down his energy. The accomplished Vishvakarma pared him down, right up to his knees. He did not like the idea of paring down anymore. The intolerable energy was pared down and his form became even more beautiful. Because of his great beauty, he was radiant. During winter, the rainy season or summer, if a person listens to his account of Bhanu, praised

by Hara, the one seated on the lotus, ⁵⁸¹ and Vishnu, being pared down, at the end of his life, he goes to Divakara's world. O supreme among sages! This is how Ravi was born in earlier times. I have also described his supreme form.'

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Chapter 1(31) (Surya's one hundred and eight names)

The sages said, 'Please again tell us accounts about Surya. We are not yet satisfied from hearing about these pleasant subjects. The greatly energetic one blazes, with a complexion like that of a mass of flames. O lord! We wish to hear how he came by these powers.'

Brahma replied, 'The worlds were enveloped in darkness and all mobile and immobile objects were destroyed. In those earlier times, because of Prakriti's *gunas*, intelligence was created. Ahamkara resulted from this and led to the creation of the great elements—wind, fire, water, earth and space. The cosmic egg resulted from this. The seven worlds were inside that egg and so was the earth, with its seven *dvipas* and seven oceans. I, Vishnu and Maheshvara were also established there. All of us were confounded by the *tamas* and meditated on the lord. The destroyer of darkness, the extremely energetic one manifested himself. Through our powers of *dhyana* and yoga, we recognized him as Savitar, the *paramatman*. All of us separately praised the divinity, the lord, through divine hymns. 'You are the original god among all the gods. Because of your powers, you are the one who is Ishvara. O god of the gods! O Divakara! You are the original creator of beings. You are life for all beings, gods, *gandharvas*, *rakshasas*, sages, *kinnaras*, *siddhas*, *uragas* and birds. You are Brahma. You are Mahadeva. You are Prajapati. You are Vayu. You are Indra. You are Soma. You are Vivasvat. You are Varuna. You are time. You are the lord who is the creator, preserver and destroyer. You are rivers, oceans, mountains, lightning and Indra's bow. ⁵⁸² You are creation and destruction. You are the eternal manifest and unmanifest. Knowledge is superior to lordship. Shiva is superior to knowledge. You are the divinity who is superior to Shiva. You

are Parameshvara. The ends of your hands and feet are in all directions. Your eyes, heads and mouths are in all directions. You are the one with one thousand rays. You are the one with one thousand faces. You are the one with one thousand feet and eyes. You existed before the elements. You are the worlds of Bhuloka, Bhuhvarloka, Svarloka, Maharloka, Satyaloka, Tapoloka and Janaloka. You are the one who blazes. You are the one who illuminates. You are divine. You are the one who illuminates all the worlds. The Indras among the gods find it impossible to look at your form and we bow down before that. Your supreme form is not manifest, and large numbers of divine *siddhas*, Bhrigu, Atri, Pulaha and others praise it. We bow down before that form. You are always known by those who know the Vedas. You are full of all kinds of *jnana*. Among all the gods, you are the supreme god. We bow down before that form. You created the universe. You are the universe. You are worshipped by Vaishvanara⁵⁸³ and other gods. Your form is everywhere in the universe but cannot be perceived. We bow down before that form. You are superior to sacrifices. You are superior to the Vedas. You are superior to the worlds. You are superior to heaven. Your form is described as supreme. We bow down before that form. You cannot be perceived. You cannot be discerned. You are beyond meditation. You do not decay. You are without a beginning and without an end. We bow down before that form. We bow down before you. We bow down before the cause behind all causes. We bow down before the one who frees from sins. We bow down. We bow down to you, the one who was worshipped by Aditi. We bow down. We bow down to you, the destroyer of disease. We bow down. We bow down to you, the granter of all kinds of boons. We bow down. We bow down to you, the bestower of all kinds of happiness. We bow down. We bow down to you, the granter of all kinds of wealth. We bow down. We bow down to you, the bestower of all kinds of intelligence.’ Thus addressed, the illustrious one assumed his energetic form. He spoke these auspicious words. ‘What boon shall I grant you?’ The gods replied, ‘No one will be able to tolerate your excessively energetic form. O lord! For the sake of the welfare of the worlds, become tolerable.’ The illustrious one, the lord who was the original creator, agreed to this. For accomplishing the tasks of

the worlds, he started to grant heat, rain and cold. Those who resort to *samkhyā* and yoga, and others who desire *moksha*, meditate on the god who should be meditated about. Divakara, the divinity, is inside the heart. Even if a person lacks all the qualities and even if he has committed all the sins, if he seeks refuge with God Arka, he can overcome all the sins. The *agnihotra* sacrifice, the Vedas and sacrifices with copious quantities of *dakshina* do not yield one sixteenth of what devotion towards Bhanu yields. The worship of Divakara is a supreme *tirtha* among the *tirthas*, the most auspicious of all things auspicious and the most sacred of all things sacred. Those who bow down to God Bhaskara are praised by Shakra and the other gods. They are cleansed of all sins and go to Surya's world.'

The sages said, 'O Brahma! Earlier, you mentioned Ravi's one hundred and eight names. For a very long time, we have desired to hear those.'

Brahma replied, 'I will tell you about Bhaskara's one hundred and eight names. Listen. O *brahmanas*! They are extremely secret and yield heaven and *moksha*. Oum. They are: ⁵⁸⁴ (1) Surya; (2) Aryama; (3) Bhaga; ⁵⁸⁵ (4) Tvashta; (5) Pusha; ⁵⁸⁶ (6) Arka; (7) Savitar; (8) Ravi; (9) Gabhastiman; ⁵⁸⁷ (10) Aja; ⁵⁸⁸ (11) Kala; (12) Mrityu; (13) Dhatri; (14) Prabhakara; ⁵⁸⁹ (15) Prithivi; ⁵⁹⁰ (16) Apa; ⁵⁹¹ (17) Teja; ⁵⁹² (18) Kha; ⁵⁹³ (19) Vayu; (20) Parayana; ⁵⁹⁴ (21) Soma; (22) Brihaspati; (23) Shukra; (24) Budha; (25) Angaraka; (26) Indra; (27) Vivasvat; (28) Diptamshu; ⁵⁹⁵ (29) Shuchi; ⁵⁹⁶ (30) Shouri; ⁵⁹⁷ (31) Shanaishchara; (32) Brahma; (33) Vishnu; (34) Rudra; (35) Skanda; (36) Vaishravana; (37) Yama; (38) Vaidyuta; ⁵⁹⁸ (39) Jatharagni; ⁵⁹⁹ (40) Aindhana; ⁶⁰⁰ (41) Tejaspati; ⁶⁰¹ (42) Dharmadhva; ⁶⁰² (43) Vedakarta; ⁶⁰³ (44) Vedanga; (45) Vedavahana; ⁶⁰⁴ (46) Krita; (47) Trata; (48) Treta; (49) Kali; (50) Sarvamarashraya; ⁶⁰⁵ (51) Kala-kashtha-muhurta-kshapa-yama-kshana; ⁶⁰⁶ (52) Samvatsarakara; ⁶⁰⁷ (53) Ashvattha; (54) Kalachakra; ⁶⁰⁸ (55) Vibhavas; (56) Shashvatapurusha; ⁶⁰⁹ (57) Yogi; (58) Vyaktavyakta; ⁶¹⁰ (59) Sanatana; ⁶¹¹ (60) Kaladhyaksha; ⁶¹² (61) Prajadyaksha; ⁶¹³ (62) Vishvakarma; (63) Tamonuda; ⁶¹⁴ (64) Varuna; (65) Sagaramsha; ⁶¹⁵ (66) Jimuta; ⁶¹⁶ (67) Jivana; ⁶¹⁷ (68) Ariha; ⁶¹⁸ (69) Bhutashraya; ⁶¹⁹ (70) Bhutapati; ⁶²⁰ (71) Sarvalokanamaskrita; ⁶²¹ (72) Srashtri; ⁶²² (73) Vivartaka; ⁶²³ (74) Yajni; ⁶²⁴ (75) Sarvasyadi; ⁶²⁵ (76)

Alolupa; ⁶²⁶ (77) Ananta; ⁶²⁷ (78) Kapila; (79) Bhanu; (80) Kamada; ⁶²⁸ (81) Sarvatomukha; ⁶²⁹ (82) Jaya; (83) Vishala; (84) Varada; ⁶³⁰ (85) Sarvabhutahiterata; ⁶³¹ (86) Manah; ⁶³² (87) Suparana; (88) Bhutadi; ⁶³³ (89) Shighraga; ⁶³⁴ (90) Pranadharana; ⁶³⁵ (91) Dhanvantari; (92) Dhumaketu; ⁶³⁶ (93) Adideva; ⁶³⁷ (94) Aditi-suta; ⁶³⁸ (95) Dvadashatma; ⁶³⁹ (96) Ravi; (97) Daksha; ⁶⁴⁰ (98) Pita-mata-pitamaha; ⁶⁴¹ (99) Svargadvara; ⁶⁴² (100) Prajadvara; ⁶⁴³ (101) Mokshadvara; ⁶⁴⁴ (102) Trivishtapa; ⁶⁴⁵ (103) Dehakarta; ⁶⁴⁶ (104) Prashantatman; ⁶⁴⁷ (105) Vishvatman; ⁶⁴⁸ (106) Vishvatomukha; ⁶⁴⁹ (107) Characharatman; ⁶⁵⁰ (108) Sukshataman; ⁶⁵¹ (109) Maitreya; ⁶⁵² and (110) Karunanvita. ⁶⁵³ O supreme sages! I have thus recited the one hundred and eight beautiful names of the infinitely energetic Surya. He is served by large numbers of gods, ancestors and *yakshas* and worshipped by *asuras*, roamers in the night ⁶⁵⁴ and *siddhas*. He possesses the complexion of excellent gold or the fire. For the sake of welfare, I prostrate myself before Bhaskara. If a man controls himself and reads this at the time of sunrise, he obtains sons, wives, wealth and stores of jewels. He remembers his past lives and always possesses memory and intelligence. He obtains a supreme end. If a man controls himself, purifies his mind and chants this hymn to the supreme god, he is freed from conflagrations and oceans of grief. He obtains all his mental desires.'

Chapter 1(32) (Uma's austerity)

Brahma said, 'Rudra is the three-eyed god who is the destroyer of Tripura.

⁶⁵⁵ He can go everywhere and bears the half-moon on his head. He does what brings Uma pleasure. Earlier, when Yaksha had performed a sacrifice on earth, he had destroyed all the gods, *siddhas*, *vidyadharas*, *rishis*, *gandharvas*, *yakshas*, *nagas* and others who had assembled there. It was a prosperous sacrifice, with expensive jewels. All the required objects had been gathered. O *brahmanas*! Shakra and the other residents of heaven were scared of his powers. They were unable to find peace and again sought refuge with him. O best among sages! The wielder of the trident, with a bull on his standard, is a granter of boons. The illustrious one holds a *pinaka* in his hand. He is the one who destroyed Daksha's sacrifice. Mahadeva Krittivasa Vrishadhvaaja resides in the land of Utkala. ⁶⁵⁶ Hara is the one who grants all objects of desire and he is there in Ekamraka.' ⁶⁵⁷

The sages asked, 'God Bhava is engaged in the welfare of all beings. Daksha's sacrifice was ornamented by the best of gods. Why did he destroy it? O lord! We do not think that it could have been a trifling reason. Please tell us. We wish to hear about this. We are greatly curious.'

Brahma replied, 'Daksha had eight daughters who resided with their husbands. Once, the father brought them to his house and honoured them in that house. O *brahmanas*! Thus, honoured by him, they resided in their father's house. The eldest among them was named Sati and she was Tryambaka's ⁶⁵⁸ wife. However, since Daksha hated Rudra, he had not invited this daughter. This was because Maheshvara never bowed down before Daksha. The son-in-law naturally possessed more energy than the father-in-law. Sati got to know that all of them had gone to their father's house. Though she had not been invited, Sati went to her own father's

house. The honour her father exhibited towards Sati was inferior to what he had shown to the others. At this, the goddess was filled with anger and intolerance, and spoke to her father. Sati said, 'O lord! I am superior to my younger sisters. Why are you not worshipping me? You have dishonoured me and slighted me. You have done what should be reprimanded. I am the eldest and the best. That being the case, you should have honoured me.' Thus addressed, Daksha's eyes became red with rage and he spoke to her. Daksha replied, 'O Sati! My younger daughters are the best and superior to you. They are the ones to be honoured. Their husbands are greatly revered by me. They are great *yogis* who have immersed themselves in the *brahman*. They observe vows and are extremely devoted to *dharma*. O Sati! All of them possess praiseworthy qualities and are superior to Tryambaka. My best sons-in-law are Vasishtha, Atri, Pulastya, Angiras, Pulaha, Kratu, Bhrigu and Marichi. Sharva always tries to rival them and they also seek to rival him. However, Bhava is antagonistic towards me. That is the reason I do not honour you.' His intelligence confounded, Daksha addressed her in this way. That is the reason she got ready to curse him and the *maharshis*. Thus addressed, the goddess angrily replied to her father. Sati said, 'O father! He should not be censured in words, thoughts and deeds. But since you have done so, I am casting aside this body, which I have obtained from you as your daughter.' Sati was miserable and intolerant at the insult. She bowed down to Svayambhu and spoke these words. Sati said, 'Wherever I am born again with a radiant body, let me be born again in a form that is not deluded and is devoted to *dharma*. Let me again be the wife of the intelligent Tryambaka.' The enraged one sat down there and immersed herself in her *atman*. She raised the fire within herself and performed the act of *dharana* within herself. She raised up the breath of life within herself and it emerged through all her limbs. After this, the fire reduced her to ashes.'

'Hearing about the death of goddess Sati and learning about the reason that led to this, Shankara, the illustrious lord who holds the trident, became angry and decided to destroy Daksha. Shankara said, 'Sati went and was violently abused by Daksha, who praised all his other daughters and their

husbands. Therefore, when Vaivasvata *manvantara* arrives, along with the *maharshis*, you will be born as an entity not born from a womb, and undergo your second sacrifice. In Chakshusha *manvantara*, Manu will offer you as an oblation in a sacrifice dedicated to Brahma. ⁶⁵⁹ ‘Having addressed the *saptarshis* in this way, he again cursed Daksha. ‘At the time of Chakshusha Manu’s *manvantara*, you will be a human king. You will be the grandson of Prachinabarhi and the son of Prachetas. Your name will be Daksha and you will be the son of Marisha, the daughter of the trees. O one who is excellent in his vows! At that time, during Chakshusha *manvantara*, I will continue to obstruct you repeatedly, when you undertake tasks for *dharma*, *artha* and *kama*.’ Thus, addressed by Rudra again, Daksha also cursed him back. Daksha said, ‘O cruel one! Because of what I have done, you have not even spared the *rishis*. Therefore, when *brahmanas* perform sacrifices to the gods, they will not worship you along with them. O cruel one! After performing the rites of offering oblations, they will touch water. ⁶⁶⁰ Until that yuga comes to an end, you will abandon heaven and dwell in this world. Along with the gods, you will not be worshipped on the surface of the earth.’ Rudra replied, ‘The four *varnas* are for the gods and I will not eat where they eat, along with them. I will eat separately. Among all the worlds, earth is said to be foremost. I will single-handedly maintain it, not because of your slight, but because of my own wishes. When it is held up, all the other worlds are eternally established. That is the reason I will always reside there, not because of your slight.’ Daksha was thus addressed by the infinitely energetic Rudra. He gave up the body he had obtained from Svayambhu and was born as a human. In that form, as a householder, lord and god, Daksha performed all the sacrifices. He worshipped all the gods through sacrifices. When Vaivasvata *manvantara* arrived, Goddess Sati was born as Goddess Uma, the daughter of the king of the mountains ⁶⁶¹ and Mena. Earlier, the goddess used to be Sati. Later, she became Uma. She follows the same vows as Bhava. As long as lord Bhava desires to reside in this *manvantara*, he is unable to free himself of her. Just as Goddess Aditi follows Kashyapa, Marichi’s son, Shri is always with Narayana, Shachi is with Maghavan, Kirti is with Vishnu, Usha is with Surya and Arundhati is

with Vasishtha. Those goddesses never cease to follow the leads of their husbands. In this way, in Chakshusha *manvantara*, Daksha was born as the son of Prachetas. He was the son of Prachetas and the grandson of Prachinabarhi. He was born as the son of the ten Prachetas and Marisha, and became a king. We have heard that he had this second birth because of Rudra's curse. Bhrigu and the other *maharshis* were first born during the time of Vaisvasvata Manu in *treta* yuga. They obtained radiant bodies at a great sacrifice undertaken by god Varuna. Having been thus born in the course of that *manvantara*, they repented the curses that Daksha and the intelligent Tryambaka had invoked on each other. Therefore, undoubtedly, one should never indulge in enmity. Even when one is born again, one is subject to the good and bad deeds one has performed. Even when one adopts a different body, the new body is not freed from one's nature. Even when one adopts a different body, desire is not cast aside. This leads to misery and repentance and it is a man's task to understand this. This leads to prosperity and fame for a creature. Hence, one should never be ignorant of this.'

The sages asked, 'Sati, Daksha's daughter, gave up her body in rage. O lord! How was she again born in the house of the king of the mountains? After she cast aside her body, how did she again obtain a body? How did the union with Bhava take place? How did they converse with each other? In this great birth, how did the *svayamvara* take place?' ⁶⁶² O lord of the universe! That marriage must have been full of great wonders. O Brahma! You should now tell us all of that in detail. We wish to hear this extremely pleasant and sacred account.'

Brahma replied, 'O tigers among sages! Listen to this account. It destroys all sins. This is the sacred account of Uma and Shankara and it yields all the fruits that one desires. On one occasion, Kashyapa, supreme among bipeds, went to the house of the Himalayas and the Himalayas asked him about this account, which brings welfare and fame in this world. 'O sage! How can worlds without decay and great fame be obtained? How does one ensure that one is worshipped by the virtuous? Please tell me this.' Kashyapa replied, 'O mighty-armed one! Everything can be obtained through

offspring. My fame is because of my offspring. This is also true of Brahma and the *rishis*. O Indra among mountains! Since you are asking me, can you not see this for yourself? O mountain! I will tell you what transpired earlier. I saw it. While I was going to Varanasi, I saw a new *vimana* stationed in the sky. It was large and divine and was unmatched. From a hole located under it, I heard a scream. Through my austerity, I understood what was happening and remained hidden. O Indra among mountains! Along came a pure brahmana who observed all the rituals. Having purified himself by touching the waters of *tirthas*, he was engaged in supreme austerity. As he was travelling, the brahmana became terrified of a tiger. Having arrived at the spot, he entered the hole that was in the ground. Inside it, he saw his ancestors hanging from a creeper, with their heads facing downwards. The brahmana saw that they were afflicted, suffering and miserable. The brahmana asked them, ‘Who are you, hanging from this creeper, with your heads facing downwards? O unblemished ones! Why are you miserable? How can you be liberated?’ The ancestors replied, ‘You have performed many auspicious deeds. But we are your fathers, grandfathers and great grandfathers. We are suffering in this way because of your wicked deed. O immensely fortunate one! In the form of this hole, this is hell for us. You are the creeper that is hanging here, and we are clinging onto it. O brahmana! We will remain here as long as you are alive. Once you are dead, we will go to hell. Our intelligence has been wicked. If you marry and have a son who is superior in qualities, we will be liberated from this place. O son! This cannot be achieved through austerities, or from the fruits of visiting *tirthas*. O immensely intelligent one! Act so that your ancestors can be freed from this fear.’ Having pledged to do this, he worshipped Vrishadhvaja. He saved his ancestors from this fear and attained the status of becoming a *gana*. ⁶⁶³ He was loved by Rudra himself and his name became Suvesha. He became a leader of Rudra’s *ganas* and was sparkling and revered. O Indra among mountains! Therefore, you should perform severe austerities so that you obtain an offspring who possesses the qualities. Have a daughter who will be beautiful in complexion.’ Having been thus addressed by the *rishi*, the Indra among mountains observed the rituals. He undertook such unmatched

austerity that I was pleased. I went to him and told him, ‘I am a granter of boons. O Indra among mountains! O one who is excellent in vows! I am satisfied with your austerity.’ The Himalayas replied, ‘O illustrious one! I desire a son who will be ornamented with all the qualities. O lord! If you are pleased with me, grant me such a boon.’ O *brahmanas*! I heard the words spoken by the king of the mountains. I told him, ‘I will grant you the boon that you desire. O Indra among mountains! O one who is excellent in vows! Because of your austerity, you will have a daughter. Through the favours of that auspicious one, you will obtain fame everywhere. You will be worshipped by all the gods, and be surrounded by crores of *tirthas* that will be sacred and will even purify all the gods. She will be your eldest daughter and will be followed by other auspicious daughters.’ Having told him this, I vanished from the spot.’

‘In the course of time, through Mena, the Indra among mountains had the daughters Aparna, Ekaparna and Ekapatala. For one thousand years, Ekapatala performed fierce austerity and only ate a single leaf of the *patala* tree.⁶⁶⁴ Without a fixed abode, Ekaparna performed austerity for a thousand years and only ate a single leaf of the *ashvattha* tree.⁶⁶⁵ Such austerities are extremely difficult for even the gods and the *danavas* to perform. Ekaparna only ate a single leaf. Likewise, Ekapatala only ate a single leaf of the *patala* tree. They ate only after a thousand years were over. Though her mother tried to restrain her, Aparna did not eat at all.⁶⁶⁶ Sorry and driven by maternal love, she restrained her, ‘*U ma*’.⁶⁶⁷ The mother spoke in this way to the goddess, who was performing these extremely difficult austerities. Since then, she has been famous in the worlds by the name of Uma and is worshipped by the gods. In this way, as long as the earth exists, the universe, with its mobile and immobile objects, will be surrounded by the austerities of these three maidens. In the course of those austerities, the bodies of all three resorted to yoga. Thus, all those immensely fortunate ones were perpetually young. They are like *brahmacharinis*⁶⁶⁸ and like mothers of the worlds. Through their own austerities, they always show their favours to the worlds. Among them, Uma, beautiful in complexion, was the eldest and the best. She possessed great strength of yoga and

presented herself before Mahadeva. Dattaka was the son of Ushanas and was therefore, from the Bhrigu lineage. Through Ekaparna, he had a son named Asita-Devala. ⁶⁶⁹ The third of these daughters, Ekapatala approached Jaigishavya, Alarka's son. Through him, she had two sons Shankha and Likhita, but they were not born from the womb. I have spoken to you about the deeds of Uma, the one with the beautiful complexion. She sustained all the three worlds through her austerity and yoga and purified them. Witnessing this, I addressed her in these words. 'O goddess! O beautiful one! Why are you scorching the worlds through your austerity? You are the one who created everything. You should not act so as to destroy it. Through your energy, you are the one who sustains all the worlds. O mother of the universe! Show us your favours and tell me what you wish for.' The goddess replied, 'O grandfather! You know the reason why I am engaged in austerity. Why are you asking me then?' At this, I told her, 'O auspicious one! You are tormenting yourself for the sake of a person. He will himself come here and accept you. Sharva is the lord of all the lords in the worlds and he is the best possible husband. O auspicious one! We are always under his control and are his servants. He is Parameshvara, the god of the gods. O goddess! That Svayambhu will himself come to your presence. He may seem to be malformed, but his form is exalted. There is no one else who has a form like his. Maheshvara resides in the world of the mountains. He is the lord of mobile and immobile objects. He cannot be measured. He is the first. The moon gives him a radiance that is like that of Indra. However, his form is terrible.'

Chapter 1(33) (Parvati's test)

Brahma said, 'The gods swiftly went to her and said, 'O goddess! O Shiva! ⁶⁷⁰ Do not unnecessarily engage in these austerities. The lord of the gods cannot create without you. He will become your husband.' O *brahmanas*! The gods circumambulated the mountain's daughter and disappeared. The auspicious goddess ceased chanting the hymns. There was an *ashoka* tree that had grown at the entrance to her hermitage. She remained there. Hara is the one who removes the afflictions of the gods. He wears the moon as a *tilaka*. ⁶⁷¹ He resorted to a malformed structure, a dwarf who resembled a monkey. ⁶⁷² His nose was split into two and he was hunch-backed. The tips of his hair were tawny. With a malformed face, he said, 'O goddess! I will marry you.' With her powers of yoga, Uma knew that it was Shankara who had come. Her inner feelings were determined by the purity of her *atman* and she wished to act so that she would obtain his favours. She offered him *arghya*, *padya* and *madhuparka* and spoke to him. ⁶⁷³ Since she loved *brahmanas*, she worshipped the brahmana with flowers. The goddess said, 'O illustrious one! O bull among *brahmanas*! O lord! I am not independent. My father and mother will decide who they will bestow their daughter on. Go and ask my father, the undecaying Indra among mountains. O brahmana! If he bestows me on you, I will regard that as appropriate.' The illustrious lord and god went in that malformed figure to the king of the mountains and said, 'O king of the mountains! Bestow your daughter on me.' Despite the malformed figure, he knew that this was the undecaying Rudra. He was scared of being cursed. Therefore, distressed in his mind, he addressed him in these words. The Indra among mountains said, 'O illustrious one! I think that *brahmanas* are like divinities on earth. O immensely intelligent one! However, hear what we had thought of earlier

and this decision is respected by *brahmanas*. My daughter will go through a *svayamvara*. Whoever she chooses there will become her husband.’ Hearing the mountain’s words, the illustrious Vrishadhvaja went to the goddess. The great-minded one addressed her in these words. Shiva said, ‘O goddess! I have heard that your father approves of the idea of your *svayamvara*. O unblemished one! Indeed, whoever you choose there will become your husband. O one with the beautiful complexion! You are difficult to obtain. Therefore, with your permission, I shall leave. Ignoring a handsome person, how can you possibly choose someone like me?’ Having been thus addressed, she thought about what he had said. Her mind was fixed on Rudra and she thought about obtaining his favours. Having arrived at a decision, she said, ‘O lord of the gods! Do not interpret what I have said in a contrary way. I will choose you and there is nothing extraordinary in this. O brahmana! Therefore, you should never harbor doubts about me. O immensely fortunate one! I will choose you right now. That is what is in my mind.’ In her hands, she seized a bunch of flowers that were growing there. Placing this on Shambhu’s shoulder, the goddess said, ‘I have chosen you.’ The illustrious god was chosen by the goddess in this way. He spoke to her, as if he was injecting new life into the *ashoka* tree. Shiva said, ‘You have chosen me with an extremely sacred bunch of flowers. Therefore, old age will abandon you and you will become immortal. These flowers are lovely, and your form will be lovely. You will be loved by me, and you will be the one who will grant objects of desire. Excellent flowers will always provide you with every kind of ornament. You will always be served by every kind of flower and fruit. Everything that you eat will have the taste of *amrita*. You will possess every kind of fragrance and the gods will be firm in their affection towards you. Without any fear, you will roam around in all the worlds. This hermitage of yours will be surrounded by sages. Henceforth, it will be known by the name of Chitrakuta. ⁶⁷⁴ If a person goes there in search of good merits, he will obtain the fruits of a horse sacrifice. If a person dies there, he will go to Brahma’s world. O goddess! If a person follows *niyama* properly and gives up his life there, because of your austerity, he will become a leader of the *ganas*.’ ⁶⁷⁵ Having said this, the god Maheshvara, the

creator of all beings in the universe, took his leave from the daughter of the Himalayas and disappeared.'

'The soul of the goddess was immersed in the illustrious one. When he left, she sat on a rock, facing the direction in which the lord of the universe had gone. She faced the direction where Bhava Mahesha had been. Her mind was distressed, like the night without the moon. At this time, Shailaja⁶⁷⁶ heard a child's voice. It came from a lake full of water that was near her hermitage. Shiva, the god of the gods, had assumed the form of a child. He was playing in the middle of the lake and had been seized by a crocodile. Using his powers of yoga and *maya*, the creator of the visible universe had assumed this form. Having assumed this form, he spoke from the middle of the lake. The child said, 'Let someone save me. I have been seized by a crocodile and have lost my senses. Shame on this misery. I am a child and have not yet accomplished everything that I wish for. Seized by this evil-minded and crooked crocodile, I am heading towards my death. I am not sad, nor am I greatly miserable at my own body having been seized by the crocodile. But I am grieving because of my father and my ascetic mother. On hearing that I have been seized by the crocodile and have died, they will be anxious. I am their only son and am loved by them. They will certainly give up their lives. Alas! This is a great misery. I am a child and have not gone through the stages of life. Having been seized by the crocodile, I am heading towards my death.' The beautiful goddess heard the shrieks of this afflicted brahmana. She got up and went to the place where the brahmana was. The one with a face like a moon saw the boy, beautiful in form, there. Having been seized by the crocodile in its mouth, he was trembling. The handsome crocodile also saw that the goddess had arrived. Seizing him, it quickly went to the middle of the lake. Dragged away in this fashion, he suffered and wailed loudly. The goddess, great in her vows, was extremely miserable at seeing the child. Parvati said, 'O king of crocodiles! O one who is great in spirit! This child is an only son. O one with the great fangs! O one who is terrible in valour! Please release him quickly.' The crocodile replied, 'O goddess! In ancient times, the creator of the world has decreed that whoever comes before me on the sixth day will be my food. O

immensely fortunate one! O daughter of Indra among the mountains! He came to me on the sixth day. He has certainly been sent by Brahma. Hence, he can never be released.' The goddess said, 'I have performed excellent austerity on the summit of the Himalayas. O king of the crocodiles! I bow down before you. Accept those fruits and release this boy.' The crocodile replied, 'O goddess! O one with the beautiful face! Let your austerity not be exchanged for a small child. O supreme one! I will do what you have asked me to. He will be freed.' The goddess said, 'O lord of the crocodiles! Quickly do what you have promised, so that you are not censured.⁶⁷⁷ There shouldn't be any doubt about this. *Brahmanas* are especially loved by me.' The crocodile replied, 'You have performed austerity. Give me a little of it, or perhaps a great deal. Perhaps you should give me all of it. He will be swiftly released.' The goddess said, 'O great crocodile! I am giving you all the good deeds I have performed since birth. O great crocodile! Release the child.' Surrounded by the austerity, the crocodile blazed. It looked like the sun at midday and it was impossible to look at it. Pleased in its mind, it spoke to the goddess who holds up the worlds. The crocodile said, 'O goddess! O one who is great in her vows! Has this been done without thinking about it? Austerities are accumulated after a lot of hardship. Renouncing their fruits is not praised. O slender-waisted one! Take back your austerity. Take the child too. I am pleased with your devotion towards *brahmanas*. Therefore, I am granting you this boon.' Thus, addressed by the crocodile, the one who was great in her vows replied in these words. The goddess replied, 'O crocodile! Even with my body, I must attempt to save this brahmana. I can get my austerity back. I will not be able to get back this brahmana again. O mighty crocodile! Therefore, when I acted about releasing this child, I did think about the matter. Austerities are not superior to *brahmanas*. It is my view that *brahmanas* are superior. O Indra among crocodiles! I do not take back what I have given. That was meant for you. O crocodile! Let no man take back what he has given. I have given it to you. It cannot be given again. Let it bring you pleasure. Release the child.' Thus addressed, the crocodile praised her and bowed down before her. It released the boy. After taking leave of the goddess, the crocodile instantly vanished

from the spot. The child had been released by the crocodile on the shores of the lake. Like something that has been seen in a dream, he too instantly vanished from the spot. The goddess, the daughter of the Himalayas, Indra among mountains, thought that her austerity had been exhausted. She again started to observe *niyama* and perform austerity. O *brahmanas*! Knowing that she wished to perform austerity again, Shankara himself appeared before her and spoke to her in these words. ‘Do not unnecessarily engage in austerity. O goddess! O one who is great in her vows! You have given your austerity to me. Therefore, they can never be exhausted and will be returned to you a thousand-fold.’ The goddess thus obtained the boon of her excellent austerity remaining inexhaustible. She was filled with great delight and consecrated herself for the *svayamvara*.⁶⁷⁸ If a man properly and constantly reads this account about the way the daughter of the Indra among mountains acted, he will be purified after the destruction of his body. He will become like Ganesha or Kumara.’

Chapter 1(34) (Uma and Maheshvara's marriage)

Brahma said, 'Hundreds of *vimanas* assembled on the extensive slopes of the Himalayas at the time when the *svayamvara* of the daughter of the mountains took place. The Himalayas, the king of the mountains, was accomplished in meditation and got to know of the conversation between his daughter and the god of the gods. Though he knew about it, the great mountain decided to adhere to his pledge. Therefore, he announced to all the worlds that the *svayamvara* of the goddess would take place. The Indra among the mountains thought, 'If my daughter chooses Mahadeva in the presence of the gods, the *danavas*, the *siddhas* and the residents of all the worlds, it will be a good and praiseworthy deed, befitting of my honour.' With Maheshvara in his heart, the excellent Indra among mountains arranged for the *svayamvara* and invited all the gods, beginning with Brahma. The announcement was made that the *svayamvara* of the daughter of the Indra among mountains would take place there and the region was strewn with jewels. The gods and all the other residents of the universe assembled there, attiring themselves in divine garments. I was seated on my seat, a blooming lotus, and was surrounded by *siddhas* and immeasurable yogis. Knowing about the announcement made by the king of the mountains, the gods arrived there. The thousand-eyed king of the gods arrived there, radiant with divine necklaces and garlands decorating his exalted form. He was astride Airavata, foremost all the Indras among elephants, exuding profuse flows of musth. Radiant astride it, the king of all the immortals arrived ahead of all the gods. Vivasvat was equal or superior to him in power and energy and illuminated all the directions. He swiftly arrived astride a golden *vimana* with fluttering flags. Kashyapa's son,

Aditya, arrived along with him, wearing shining jewels and dazzling ornaments. He resembled the midday sun, and was on a *vimana* that was like the fire or the sun in its splendour. Holding his staff, Kritanta ⁶⁷⁹ swiftly arrived, astride his terrible buffalo. His limbs were well-formed and firm. His complexion was yellow, and he wore necklaces. His energy, strength and power of commanding were unmatched. Vayu, the one who nurtures the worlds, was astride an excellent *vimana*. His body was stout, and as tall as a lofty mountain. He wore beautiful garments, decorated with gold and jewels. Amidst all those Indras among the gods, Vahni ⁶⁸⁰ arrived. He blazed and was dressed in excellent garments. His energy was superior to the energy of everyone else and he scorched all the gods and *asuras*. Rajaraja, ⁶⁸¹ the master of the lords of all riches, arrived, astride an excellent and divine *vimana*. His excellent form was as upright as a rod and was resplendent with many jewels. Shashi ⁶⁸² arrived astride a *vimana* that was wonderful in form, blazing with many expensive gems. He was more handsome than all the lords among the gods and the *asuras*, and his form and attire were wonderful. The holder of a mace that was like a mountain ⁶⁸³ arrived quickly, astride Tarkshya. His complexion was dark, and his limbs were firm. His garments were extremely wonderful, and all his limbs were decorated with fragrances and garlands. The two Ashvins, the excellent physicians, quickly arrived on two *vimanas*. Those two excellent gods were patient and were attired in pleasant, dazzling and beautiful garments. Sahasranaga ⁶⁸⁴ dazzled. His complexion was like that of a sparkling fire and his energy was like that of the blazing sun. The great-souled one was with other *nagas* and was astride an excellent *vimana*. Diti's sons and the great *asuras* were like Vahni, Arka, Shakra and Anila in their lustre. Supreme in their forms and garments, they collectively arrived ahead of the gods. Following Shakra's command, the king of the *gandharvas* arrived, along with large numbers of *gandharvas* and *apsaras*. His form was beautiful, his limbs were divine and he rode on a celestial *vimana*. There were many other gods, residents of heaven, *gandharvas*, *yakshas*, *uragas* and *kinnaras*. They arrived astride their own separate *vimanas*, wearing their own beautiful attires. Among all those Indras among the gods, the king

of the mountains was resplendent. His form was equal to some of them and superior to those of others. His powers of commanding, strength and prosperity caused great joy and ornamented the *svayamvara*. This was the reason why the mother of the universe, the three worlds and of all the gods and the *asuras* had been born. She was the wife of the intelligent Purusha Shambhu. She is the one the Puranas have chanted about, as the supreme Prakriti. Enraged at Daksha, and to accomplish the tasks of the gods, she had been born in Himalayas' house. She was astride a *vimana* that was decorated with gold and jewels. Whisks made out of yak hair⁶⁸⁵ were being used to fan her. The goddess held an extremely fragrant garland made out of flowers and was ready.'

'Holding the garland, the goddess stood, amidst that assembly of gods. Shakra and the other gods had arrived at the *svayamvara*. To test the goddess, Shambhu assumed the form of an infant with five tufts of hair. In that form, the immensely radiant one went to sleep on her lap. The goddess saw that infant, with the five tufts of hair, lying there. Because of her powers of meditation, she knew who this was. Filled with delight, she picked him up. Pure in her resolution, she had obtained her desired virtuous husband. She clasped the lord to her bosom and turned around. The gods saw the infant lying down on the lap of the goddess. Extremely confused, they talked to each other and shouted. 'Who is this?' The slayer of Vritra⁶⁸⁶ raised his arm to strike him with the *vajra*. However, in the form of the infant, Shambhu, god of the gods, paralysed him and the arm remained in that position, raised up. The slayer of Vritra could not hurl the *vajra*. Nor could he move. The powerful Aditya named Bhaga was Kashyapa's son. Wishing to sever the infant, he too raised his blazing weapon, but was confounded. In a similar way, the illustrious lord paralysed his hand too. Despite possessing strength, energy and yoga, the lord was numbed. Vishnu saw that Shankara was shaking his head. The enraged gods stood there, and I was filled with great anxiety. Resorting to meditation, I understood that it was Shankara, the god who was the lord of all the gods, who was lying on Uma's lap. Realizing that this was the supreme Ishana, I quickly stood up and lovingly worshipped his feet. O *brahmanas*! I praised him, using

ancient hymns and songs and the sacred and secret names that have been spoken about. ‘You are without birth. You are the god who does not decay. You are the god who has created the superior and the inferior. You are Pradhana⁶⁸⁷ and Purusha. You are the *brahman* one meditates on. You are the immortal *paramatman*. You are Ishvara, the supreme cause. You are the one who created Brahma and Prakriti. You are the one who created everything. You are superior to Prakriti. This is Goddess Prakriti. She is the one who always creates. The cause behind the universe has come to you in the form of a wife. O Mahadeva! I bow down to you and to the goddess. O lord of the gods! Show me your favours. It is because you urged me that I created these subjects, the gods and others. They are confounded by your yoga and your *maya*.⁶⁸⁸ Please show them your favours, so that they regain the states they were in.’ O *brahmanas*! I got to know that this was Parameshvara. Thereafter, I addressed all the benumbed gods in these words. ‘O foolish gods! None of you have comprehended that this is Shankara. All of you swiftly seek refuge with Maheshvara and Bhavani.⁶⁸⁹ He is the *paramatman*. He is without transformations.’ At this, all the numbed residents of heaven prostrated themselves before Sharva. Their minds and intelligence had been purified. Maheshvara, the god of the gods, was pleased with them. He quickly made the forms of the gods return to the states they were in earlier. While the forms of all the gods were returning to their original states, the lord of the gods assumed a supremely wonderful and three-eyed form. They could not tolerate this energy and all of them closed their eyes. So that they could see his form, he gave them supreme eyesight. Having got these, they could see the supreme divinity, the lord of all the gods. They saw the supreme Ishana, with his third eye. Shakra and all the other lords among the gods realized that it was indeed him. The goddess saw him too. While all the residents of heaven looked on, she placed the garland on the feet of the extremely radiant one. Uttering words of praise, all the gods again lowered their heads on the ground and bowed down to the lord and the goddess. O *brahmanas*! Meanwhile, along with the gods, I spoke to the immensely radiant and giant mountain, the Himalayas. ‘You are praiseworthy and great. You deserve to be worshipped and revered

by everyone. You now have a great alliance with Sharva. Arrange for a wonderful marriage ceremony. What are you waiting for?' The Himalayas bowed down and replied to me. The Himalayas said, 'O god! You are the reason behind my enhancement in prosperity. It has happened suddenly and your favours are the cause. O grandfather! Please arrange for whatever must be done for the marriage.' O *brahmanas*! Hearing the words of the king of the mountains, I addressed the lord. 'O god! Let arrangements be made for the marriage rites.' The god Shankara, the lord of the worlds, replied in words of assent.'

'O *brahmanas*! For the sake of Mahesha's marriage, I instantly created a city that was decorated with all kinds of jewels. It was colourful with gems, jewels, gold and pearls. These arrived in embodied forms and ornamented that excellent city. The ground was paved with colourful emeralds and the pillars were decorated with gold. The walls were made out of sparkling crystal, with strings of pearls suspended from them. For the sake of the marriage, the city was adorned with beautiful gates. The great-souled Mahesha, god of the gods, was resplendent. Som and Aditya assumed the forms of two gems and heated the place. The wind-god brought pleasant and agreeable fragrances. Exhibiting devotion towards Bhava, the wind that blew was pleasant to the touch. The four oceans, Shakra and other excellent gods, celestial rivers, great rivers, *siddhas*, sages, *gandharvas*, *apsaras*, all the *nagas*, *yakshas*, *rakshasas*, aquatic creatures, creatures that roamed in the air, *kinnaras*, celestial *charanas*, Tumburu, Narada, Hahu, Huhu and the singers of Sama hymns arrived in the city. They brought many kinds of jewels. There were *rishis*, stores of austerities, who were accomplished in singing chants from the Vedas. Cheerful in their minds, they chanted the sacred wedding *mantras*. On the occasion of Parameshthi's marriage, all the mothers of the gods and all the celestial maidens happily sang. The six seasons were all present, bearing many kinds of pleasant scents.'

'On the occasion of Shankara's marriage, they manifested themselves in embodied forms. ⁶⁹⁰ Delighted at the sounds of the *mantras* and the gathering of dark clouds, all the peacocks called and danced. There were clear and tawny streaks of flickering lightning. The place was adorned with

white cranes that had lotuses on their crests. There were mushrooms that had just sprouted, plantain trees, and beautiful trees and creepers with new sprouts. Large numbers of frogs called, awoken and intoxicated by their love for the fresh downpours of rain. The spirited ladies were displaying mock anger ⁶⁹¹ towards their loved ones. But, in an instant, that mock anger was dissipated by the pleasant calls of the peacocks, and they forgot the reason why they were angry. The curved form of the great Indra's bow ⁶⁹² was everywhere, radiant near the mass of clouds. Its fieriness was a bit faded, so that it assumed a pleasant form and spread a golden hue everywhere. Having touched the cool waters from the clouds, many kinds of flowers, with many kinds of fragrances, bloomed. The cool and pleasant breeze made the auspicious locks of the celestial women tremble. The moon's disc was hidden behind the thundering clouds. The beautiful *durva* grass was sprinkled with the fresh water. The wives of travellers were eager because of their love and their sighs filled the air with smoke. ⁶⁹³ On the occasion of the marriage of the mountain's daughter, the rainy season arrived. ⁶⁹⁴ The calls of the swans were like the tinkling of anklets. The clouds were like uplifted breasts. The flickering lightning was like a necklace. The sparkling lotuses were like eyes. The flow of dark water nourished the colourful swans. The flowers of waters made the lotuses bend down, which resembled eyes, and they seemed to be even more beautiful all over, since the fragrant pollen from flowers was scattered over them.

'The extremely radiant seasons of *hemanta* and *shishira* arrived. The breasts emerged from the bodice of the clouds and the lotus buds were like nipples. The swans called in different directions, and this was like the tinkling of anklets. The extensive banks of the rivers were like hips, and the calling cranes formed a girdle. The blue lotuses that bloomed were like beautiful eyes. The ripe *bimba* fruit was like a lower lip. The *kunda* flowers were like the teeth of a smiling lady. The new and dark creepers were like the dark hair on the body. The moonbeams were like an excellent necklace dangling from her neck. Like a woman, she delighted all the residents of heaven. The humming and harmonious buzzing of bees was like a sweet and melodious song that she was singing. The movement of the lotuses was

like the movement of earrings when the beautiful lady moved. The branches of *ashoka* trees were like her fingers and the red flowers were like her nails. Those collections of flowers were like her garments and ornaments. The red lotuses were the tips of her feet and the blossoming flowers were the nails on her feet. The plantain trees were her thighs and the moon was like her face. She possessed all the signs and was adorned with all the ornaments. Full of affection, it was as if a beautiful lady was desiring her beloved. Her breasts emerged from the bodice of black clouds. ⁶⁹⁵ The full moon was her face. The blue lotuses were her eyes. The lotuses, woken up by the rays of the sun, were her breasts. The mind was delighted by the breeze carrying the pollen and fragrances from many flowers. The calling of swans was like the tinkling sound of anklets. On the occasion of the marriage of the goddess, *sharad* was present. The extremely radiant seasons of *hemanta* and *shishira* arrived there and the directions were flooded with exceedingly cold water. Those two seasons approached the Himalayas, supreme among mountains. Both of them quickly showered down flakes of snow. The Himalayas were covered by a shower of snow and resembled a cloud. It was so shiny and deep that the Himalayas seemed like an ocean of milk. In this way, the great mountain was progressively approached by the seasons. It was as if a wicked person had been gratified because the virtuous were turning up with gifts. Enveloped by that covering of snow, the mountain's summit was resplendent. It was if an umbrella made out of white and large serpents was being held up above the head of a lord of the earth. A breeze that excited the minds of the gods and the celestial women repeatedly blew. The ponds of lotuses were full of sparkling water and there was an abundance of lotuses and water lilies.'

'*Vasanta* arrived at the wedding of the senior's daughter. She appeared even more beautiful, like the nipples on the slightly raised breasts of women. The water in the lakes was not too hot, nor too cold, and seemed tawny because of the particles of pollen. Ruddy geese couples called and caused delight to the best of celestial elephants. Sometimes, *priyangu* creepers seemed better than the mango trees. Sometimes, the mango trees seemed superior to the *priyangu* creepers. With their respective bunches of

flowers, they seemed to challenge each other. The flowers were like white *tilakas* on the summit of the Himalayas, suggesting that elderly people had arrived at a task meant for the young. The resplendent and blossoming *ashoka* creepers embraced the *shala* trees, like women using their arms to cling onto the necks of their lovers. Mango, *kadamba*, *nipa*, ⁶⁹⁶ *tala*, *tamala*, *sarala*, *kapittha*, *ashoka*, *sarja*, *arjuna*, *kovidara*, *punnaga*, *nageshvara*, *karnikara*, *lavanga*, *kalaguru*, *saptaparni*, *nyagrodha*, *shobhanjana*, *narikela* and other trees could be seen everywhere—full of pleasant flowers and fruit decorating their limbs. The water bodies were full of golden water and there were ruddy geese, *karandava* ducks and swans in them.

Koyashtis, *datyuhas* and cranes could be seen. ⁶⁹⁷ The water was full of blue lotuses and fish. Many kinds of birds, with excellent plumage and feathers on their bodies, could be seen on the trees. Their bodies were in the throes of passion and they played, calling and challenging each other. In that marriage of the daughter of the king of the mountains, the breeze that blew was cool and pleasant on the limbs. The wind that was created from Mount Malaya made white flowers gently fall down on the mountain. There were flowers from all the seasons, and they got mixed with one another. The signs of the seasons have been described, and they assumed most beautiful forms there. Swarms of bees buzzed on the creepers and bunches of flowers. As they challenged each other, the *malati* creepers looked ferocious. The blue lotuses made the water blue. The stalks of white lotuses made the water white. The red lotuses made the water exceedingly red. The petals were full of intoxicated swarms of bees. In some places on the extensive expanse of water, golden hues from lotuses rendered it even more beautiful. In some lakes, the stalks of lotuses were like lapis lazuli. There were clumps of lotuses everywhere. Decorated with lotuses and lilies, the water there was beautiful. There were many kinds of birds and arrays of golden steps led down into the water. The mountain's lofty summit was covered with blossoming *karnikara* trees, which made it seem golden. O *brahmanas*! Because of the *patala* trees, there was a slight tinge of brown. This is what happened in every direction and the breeze made the flowers tremble. There were dark *arjuna* trees on the mountain, but the dark *ashoka*

trees were ten times that number. They grew and bloomed on that mountain, challenging each other. Everywhere on the buttocks of that mountain, there were forests of *kimshuka* trees ⁶⁹⁸ that made a melodious sound. With the clumps of *tamala* trees, the Himalayas looked lovely. The masses of dark clouds seemed to be hidden in the joints of its body. The tall *chandana* and *champak* trees rose up and there were desirable flowers on their extensive branches. The Himalayas were extremely radiant because of the calling of intoxicated male cuckoos. The sweet and intoxicating sounds of cuckoos could be heard everywhere. Hearing this, the peacocks fluttered their wings and called in soft and sweeter tones. These sounds enhanced Ananga's strength and he stood ready with the bow made out of flowers in his hand, to pierce the limbs of the celestial women.' ⁶⁹⁹

‘At the time of the wedding of the goddess, *grishma* arrived in the mountain. As the skilled Surya heated, there was very little water left in the water bodies. Nevertheless, there were many kinds of flowers on the trees and the summit of the mountain, covered with ice everywhere, looking beautiful. Even in that season, the breeze that blew was extremely pleasant. As it blew, it carried the fragrance of *patala*, *kadamba* and *arjuna* trees the mountain was covered with. The colour of the lakes turned red because of the pollen dust from blossoming lotuses. The shores and the *kadamba* trees were filled with the sounds of flocks of swans calling. The *kurubaka* trees ⁷⁰⁰ covered the entire summit of the mountain with flowers, and there were swarms of bees there. The extensive buttocks of the mountain were covered with *bakula* trees and they showered delightful flowers everywhere. All the trees were thus covered with colourful flowers. The region was delightful because of the sounds of many kinds of birds. All the seasons manifested themselves at the wedding of the daughter of Mount Himalayas. The foremost sages arrived. In that way, different kinds of beings also assembled. Hundreds of different kinds of musical instruments were being played. Along with the *brahmanas*, I too went there and had the mountain's daughter adorned with the appropriate expensive ornaments. O *brahmanas*! I myself took her with me and entered the city. After this, I spoke to lord Isha again. ‘I, Brahma, am stationed here in the form of your preceptor and

will pour oblations into the fire. If you grant me the permission, one can commence with the rites and rituals.’ Shankara, the lord of the universe and the god of the gods, spoke to me. Shiva said, ‘O lord of the gods! O Brahma! Do whatever has been instructed and whatever is desired. O lord of the universe! I will act in accordance with all your words.’ Delighted in my mind at this, I quickly took some *kusha* grass and tied the hands of the god and the goddess together in the bond of yoga. Agni was himself present there, joining his hands in salutation. The chants and the great *mantras* from the sacred texts were present there in embodied form. Following the prescribed rites, oblations of *ghee* were offered and the oblations were like *amrita*. Thereafter, I made the god ⁷⁰¹ do a *pradakshina* of the fire and united their hands. Along with all the gods, my sons who were born through mental powers and the *siddhas*, I was delighted within myself. When the wedding rites were over, I bowed down to Vrishadhvaja. O *brahmanas*! It was because of the powers of yoga of those two supreme ones, whose conduct the gods are never able to understand, that this was performed. I have thus, told you everything about that auspicious *svayamvara*. Now hear about the god’s extremely wonderful marriage.’

Chapter 1(35) (Praise of Shiva)

Brahma said, ‘The wedding of the infinitely energetic Bhava was completed in this way. Filled with supreme joy, the gods, with Shakra at the forefront, bowed down before Maheshvara and praised him in eloquent and excellent words. The gods said, ‘I bow down to Parvatalinga. ⁷⁰² I bow down to Parvatesha. ⁷⁰³ I bow down to Pavanavega. ⁷⁰⁴ I bow down to Virupa. ⁷⁰⁵ I bow down to Ajita. ⁷⁰⁶ I bow down to Kleshavinasha. ⁷⁰⁷ I bow down to Datre-shubhasampadam. ⁷⁰⁸ I bow down to Nilashikhanda. ⁷⁰⁹ I bow down to Ambikapati. ⁷¹⁰ I bow down to Pavanarupa. ⁷¹¹ I bow down to Shatarupa. ⁷¹² I bow down to Bhairavarupa. ⁷¹³ I bow down to Virupanayana. ⁷¹⁴ I bow down to Sahasranetra. ⁷¹⁵ I bow down to Sahasracharana. ⁷¹⁶ I bow down to Devasvarupa. ⁷¹⁷ I bow down to Vedanga. I bow down to Vishtambhana-Shakra-Bahu. ⁷¹⁸ I bow down to Vedankura. ⁷¹⁹ I bow down to Characharadhipati. ⁷²⁰ I bow down to Shamana. ⁷²¹ I bow down to Salilashaya-linga. ⁷²² I bow down to Yuganta. ⁷²³ I bow down to Kapalamala. ⁷²⁴ I bow down to Kapalasutradhari. ⁷²⁵ I bow down to Kapalahasta. ⁷²⁶ I bow down to Dandina. ⁷²⁷ I bow down to Gadina. ⁷²⁸ I bow down to Trailokyanatha. ⁷²⁹ I bow down to Pashulokarota. ⁷³⁰ I bow down to Khatvangahasta. ⁷³¹ I bow down to Pranatartihara. ⁷³² I bow down to Yajnachirahantri. ⁷³³ I bow down to Krishnakeshahara. ⁷³⁴ I bow down to Bhaganetranipata. ⁷³⁵ I bow down to Pushodantahara. ⁷³⁶ I bow down to Pinaka-shula-asi-khadga-mudgara-dharina. ⁷³⁷ I bow down to Kalakala. ⁷³⁸ I bow down to Tritiyanayana. ⁷³⁹ I bow down to Antakantakriti. ⁷⁴⁰ I bow down to Parvatavasina. ⁷⁴¹ I bow down to Suvarnaretasa. ⁷⁴² I bow down to Kundaladharina. ⁷⁴³ I bow down to Daityanam-yoganasha. ⁷⁴⁴ I bow down to the yogi. I bow down to the guru. I bow down to Shashankaditya-netra. ⁷⁴⁵ I bow down to Lalatanetra. ⁷⁴⁶ I bow down to Shmashanarata. ⁷⁴⁷ I bow down

to Avinitanasha. ⁷⁴⁸ I bow down to Vyamshakaya. ⁷⁴⁹ I bow down to Ashanishatahasa. ⁷⁵⁰ I bow down to Parvatesha. ⁷⁵¹ I bow down to Grihasthasadhu. ⁷⁵² I bow down to Nityajatina. ⁷⁵³ I bow down to Brahmachari. I bow down to Mundardhamunda. ⁷⁵⁴ I bow down to Pashupati. ⁷⁵⁵ I bow down to Salile-tapyamana. ⁷⁵⁶ I bow down to Yogaisharyaprada. ⁷⁵⁷ I bow down to Shanta. ⁷⁵⁸ I bow down to Danta. ⁷⁵⁹ I bow down to Pralayotpattikarina. ⁷⁶⁰ I bow down to Anugrahakartri. ⁷⁶¹ I bow down to Sthitikartri. ⁷⁶² I bow down to Rudra. I bow down to Vasu. I bow down to Aditya. I bow down to the Ashvins. I bow down to Pitri. ⁷⁶³ I bow down to Samkhya. I bow down to Vishvadeva. I bow down to Sharva. ⁷⁶⁴ I bow down to Ugra. ⁷⁶⁵ I bow down to Shiva. ⁷⁶⁶ I bow down to Varada. ⁷⁶⁷ I bow down to Bhima. ⁷⁶⁸ I bow down to Senani. ⁷⁶⁹ I bow down to Pashupati. ⁷⁷⁰ I bow down to Shuchi. ⁷⁷¹ I bow down to Vairihana. ⁷⁷² I bow down to Sadyojata. ⁷⁷³ I bow down to Mahadeva. ⁷⁷⁴ I bow down to Chitra. ⁷⁷⁵ I bow down to Shulina. ⁷⁷⁶ I bow down to Pradhana. I bow down to Aprameya. ⁷⁷⁷ I bow down to Karya. ⁷⁷⁸ I bow down to Karana. ⁷⁷⁹ I bow down to Purusha. I bow down to Purushechchakara. ⁷⁸⁰ I bow down to Purusha-samyoga-pradhana-guna-karina. ⁷⁸¹ I bow down to Pravartaka-Prakrite-Purushasya-sarvasa. ⁷⁸² I bow down to Kritakrita-samkartri. ⁷⁸³ I bow down to Phalasamyogada. ⁷⁸⁴ I bow down to Kalajna. ⁷⁸⁵ I bow down to Sarvesham-niyama-karina. ⁷⁸⁶ I bow down to Vaishamyakartri-gunanam. ⁷⁸⁷ I bow down to Vrittida. ⁷⁸⁸ I bow down to Devadevesha. ⁷⁸⁹ I bow down to Bhutabhavana. ⁷⁹⁰ O Shiva! Glance towards us with an amiable face. O lord! Be pleasant towards us.' In this way, the illustrious god, the lord of the universe, Uma's consort, was praised by all the gods. He spoke to the immortals in these words. Rudra said, 'O gods! So far as gods are concerned, I have a fanged face, as well as a pleasant face. Tell me the boons that you wish for. There is no doubt that I will grant them.' At this, all the gods prostrated themselves and told the three-eyed one, 'O illustrious one! Let this be the boon you grant. Whenever there is a task that needs to be done for us, you will grant us the desired boon.' Agreeing to this, Hara granted the gods and the others leave. Along with the *pramathas*, ⁷⁹¹ he entered his residence. In the presence of gods and *brahmanas*, if a man

chants about this extraordinary festivity of Hara's, in every possible way, he becomes Ganesha's equal. When his body is destroyed, he obtains happiness. O noble *brahmanas*! If a person hears it or reads it, he goes to all the worlds and is worshipped by the gods, the *asuras* and others.'

Chapter 1(36) (Uma and Shankara leave the Himalayas)

Brahma said, ‘Having entered his house, the god was seated on an excellent seat, along with his wife. The cruel Manmatha ⁷⁹² wished to pierce the god. The evil-souled one was the worst of his lineage and was addicted to wicked conduct. Hiding all his limbs, he tormented everyone. He thus caused impediments in the *niyama* and vows of the *rishis*. He assumed the form of a ruddy goose and came there, along with Rati. ⁷⁹³ O *brahmanas*! He arrived there, wishing to pierce him. However, the lord of the gods slightly glanced at him with his third eye. The fire that originated from the eye was garlanded in thousands of flames. Along with all his paraphernalia, Rati’s husband was suddenly burnt down. Being burnt in this way, he shrieked piteously, in a garbled tone. Seeking the god’s favours, he fell down on the ground. The limbs of Manmatha, the one who scorched the worlds, were engulfed in flames. In an instant, he suddenly fell down, losing consciousness. Extremely miserable, his wife lamented piteously. Suffering from sorrow, she begged pity from the god and the goddess. The god and the goddess were full of compassion and realized that she was in this piteous state. They glanced at the miserable one and comforted her in these words. Uma and Maheshvara said, ‘O fortunate one! He has certainly been burnt down and his revival is not possible. O fortunate one! However, despite being without a body, he will carry out all the tasks. O auspicious one! When the illustrious one becomes the son of Vasudeva, your husband will be born as his son.’ ⁷⁹⁴ Kama’s wife, the one with the auspicious face, obtained this boon. Filled with joy and freed from her distress, she went wherever she wished to.’

‘O *brahmanas*! Having burnt down Kama, the god Vrishadhvaja happily sported with Uma in the Himalayas. With the goddess, the three-eyed one sported in beautiful caves, ponds filled with lotuses, beautiful and secluded groves of *karnikara* trees, the delightful banks of rivers frequented by *kinnaras*, the peaks of the king of mountains, lakes, ponds, groves of *champa* ⁷⁹⁵ trees that were filled with the sounds of many birds, *tirthas* filled with sacred water and decorated with jewels, and sacred and agreeable regions that were full of *vidyadharas*, *gandharvas*, *yakshas* and immortals. Surrounded by Indra and the gods, sages, *yakshas*, *siddhas*, *gandharvas*, *vidyadharas*, foremost *daityas* and many others, Shambhu found delight on that mountain. The *apsaras* danced there. The lords among the gods and large numbers of *gandharvas* were happy and sang. The *brahmanas* meditated. Some played on musical instruments. Some praised the supreme god. To please the goddess, the great-souled god, who was the one who plucked out Bhaga’s eyes, did not abandon that mountain. He was with his own immensely strong *ganas*, the equals of Shakra, Yama and Agni.’

The *rishis* said, ‘The illustrious one, the one who destroyed Kama, remained there with the goddess. We wish to know what Mahadeva did.’

Brahma replied, ‘The illustrious one wished to bring the goddess pleasure on the summit of the Himalayas. With the young moon like a *tilaka* on his head, he amused himself and caused the goddess pleasure. The leaders of the *ganas* had many different kinds of forms. They were extremely great and omniscient. They were auspicious and could assume any form at will. With them, he repeatedly devised many forms of amusement. Once, the goddess, the Parameshvari went to meet her mother alone. The auspicious one was seated on a golden and extremely wonderful seat. She saw that the virtuous goddess had come, assuming a divine form. She offered the unblemished one an extremely expensive seat. When the goddess had sat down, the lotus-eyed Mena, the beloved of the Himalayas, who was also seated, spoke to her. Mena said, ‘O daughter! O one with the auspicious eyes! You have come after a long time. Tell me this. When you sport with your husband, why do these poor people also participate in the sport? O

auspicious one! O Uma! Those who are poor and without refuges also sport, just as your husband does.’ Addressed by her mother in this way, she was not at all pleased. However, since she possessed a great sense of forgiveness, she did not say anything to her mother. Having taken leave of her mother, she went to the god and spoke to him. Parvati said, ‘O illustrious god! O lord of the gods! I will not reside on this mountain. O immensely radiant one! Please construct a residence for me somewhere else.’ Mahadeva replied, ‘O Ishvari! I have always spoken to you about another residence. O goddess! However, the idea of living somewhere else never appealed to you. O beautiful one! Why are you yourself now speaking about a residence somewhere else? O goddess! O one with the beautiful smiles! Why are you looking for that? Tell me.’ The goddess said, ‘O lord of the gods! Today, I went to the residence of my great-souled father. O creator of the worlds! There, I met my mother in private. She honoured me with a seat and other objects, and spoke to me. ‘O Uma! O auspicious one! Your husband is always sporting with those who are poor. The gods do not find pleasure in the way you are sporting.’ O Mahadeva! O Vrishadhvaja! This is because you sport with many kinds of *ganas* and my mother does not like this.’ The god laughed. The lord also tried to make the goddess laugh. The god said, ‘There is no doubt about this. Why are you angry? I wear hides. Sometimes, I do not even have a garment. The cremation ground is my residence. I do not have a residence and live in forests and caves in mountains. O lotus-eyed one! I roam around naked, surrounded by the *ganas*. O goddess! Do not be angry at your mother. Your mother has spoken the truth. Among creatures on earth, there is no relative who is the equal of one’s mother.’ The goddess replied, ‘O destroyer of Tripura! I have nothing to do with my relatives. O Mahadeva! Act so that I can obtain happiness.’ Having heard the words of the goddess, with a desire to cause her pleasure, the lord of the gods left his father-in-law’s region. With his wife and with his own *ganas*, he went to Meru, frequented by the gods and the *siddhas*.’

Chapter 1(37) (Destruction of Daksha's sacrifice)

The *rishis* asked, 'O Brahma! During Vaivasvata *manvantara*, how was the horse sacrifice of Prajapati Daksha, the son of Prachetas, destroyed? On knowing that the goddess had been enraged, how was the lord, who is in all atmans, filled with anger? How was the sacrifice of the infinitely energetic Daksha destroyed by Mahadeva's anger? Tell us all this in detail.'

Brahma replied, 'O *brahmanas*! I will tell you how Mahadeva was filled with anger and destroyed the sacrifice, in an attempt to cause pleasure to the goddess. O best among *brahmanas*! In those ancient times, the colourful peak of Meru was known by the name of Jyotihsthala and was worshipped by the three worlds. It was decorated with all the jewels. It was immeasurable and could not be assailed. It was worshipped by all the worlds. It was adorned with all the minerals. The god was seated on the slope of the mountain, as if it was a couch, and was radiant. The daughter of the king of the mountains ⁷⁹⁶ is always by his side, and was there. The great-souled Adityas; the immensely energetic Vasus; the two great-souled Ashvins, supreme physicians, King Vaishravana, ⁷⁹⁷ the prosperous god who is the lord of the *yakshas* and dwells in Kailasa, surrounded by the *guhyakas*; the great-souled Ushanas, the great sage; the supreme *rishis*, with Sanatkumara at the forefront; the *devarshis*, with Angiras at the forefront; and the *gandharvas*, Vishvavasu, Narada and Parvata worshipped him. Many types and groups of *apsaras* assembled there. A pleasant, auspicious and pure breeze blew, bearing many kinds of scents. The forests were full of blossoming trees that had every possible kind of flower. The *vidyadharas*, *sadhyas*, *siddhas* and stores of austerities worshipped Mahadeva Pashupati there. There were many other creatures there, who had assumed diverse

kinds of forms. There were extremely terrible *rakshasas* and immensely strong *pishachas*. They were insolent and had many different kinds of forms, wielding weapons and other means of striking. The companions of the god were there, and they were the equals of Vaishvanara.⁷⁹⁸ With the illustrious god's permission, Nandishvara was there, holding a blazing trident that shone because of its own energy. O supreme among *brahmanas*! Ganga, best among rivers and the source of waters of all the *tirthas*, tended to the god in embodied form. In this way, the illustrious Mahadeva was worshipped by the divine *rishis* and the extremely fortunate gods.'

'After some time, the Prajapati named Daksha wished to perform a sacrifice, following the rites mentioned earlier. With Shakra at the forefront, all the great-souled gods left their abodes in heaven and went to Daksha's house in radiant *vimanas* that had the complexion of fire. With the god's⁷⁹⁹ permission, they went to the place that is known as Gangadvara.⁸⁰⁰ It was full of *gandharvas* and *apsaras* and was covered with many kinds of trees and creepers. Large numbers of *rishis* surrounded Daksha, supreme among those who upheld *dharma*. All those who resided on earth, in the sky and in heaven joined their hands in salutation and presented themselves before Prajapati. Along with Vishnu, all the Adityas, Vasus, Rudras, Sadhyas and groups of Maruts arrived there for their shares in the sacrifice. The best of gods, the Apyapas and Somapas,⁸⁰¹ arrived there. Along with large numbers of different gods, the two Ashvins and the Maruts were also there. There were also many other categories of creatures—those born from wombs, those born from eggs, those born from sweat,⁸⁰² and plants. All the gods and *rishis* were invited, along with their wives. They were radiant astride their *vimanas*, blazing like the fire. On seeing that the sacrificial arena was bereft of Rudra, the great *rishi*, Dadhichi addressed the other *rishis* in these words. 'O *rishis*! The great leader, Shankara cannot be seen in this sacrifice. Without him, this sacrifice is not radiant. By worshipping those who should not be worshipped and by not worshipping those who should be worshipped, there is no doubt that a man commits a great sin.' Having said this, the brahmana *rishi* again spoke to Daksha. Dadhichi asked, 'O lord! Why are you not worshipping the lord of animals?' Daksha replied, 'I have

many Rudras here. They have matted hair and wield tridents. Eleven of them have come here. I do not know of any other Maheshvara.’ Dadhichi said, ‘Everyone has been invited, but my lord has not been invited. I do not see any divinity who is superior to Shankara. Therefore, Daksha’s great sacrifice will not take place.’ Daksha replied, ‘In this sacrifice, the oblations in the golden vessels have all been purified according to the proper *mantras*. O *brahmanas*! I will give Vishnu two unmatched shares in the sacrifice, but I will not give it to Shankara.’⁸⁰³ O Dadhichi! Following the rites, this share of the sacrifice will always be offered to Vishnu, the lord of the universe. Thus, I will give a share of the sacrifice to that god, but I will not give it to Shankara.’ The daughter of the king of the mountains got to know that the gods had gone.

‘The virtuous lady spoke to the god, her husband Pashupati. Uma asked, ‘O illustrious one! With Shakra leading the way, where are the gods going? O one who knows about the truth! Tell me the truth. I have a great doubt about this.’ Maheshvara replied, ‘The excellent and immensely fortunate Prajapati is named Daksha. He is performing a horse sacrifice and the residents of heaven are going there.’ The goddess asked, ‘O immensely fortunate one! Why are you not going to this sacrifice? Who has prevented you from going?’ Maheshvara replied, ‘O immensely fortunate one! All of this has been arranged by the gods. None of them wish to give me a share in the sacrifice. O one with the beautiful complexion! The gods do not desire to follow *dharma* and give me a share in the sacrifice. Instead, they follow the earlier path in shares in the sacrifice.’⁸⁰⁴ Uma said, ‘O illustrious one! You are superior to all the gods in power and qualities. In energy, fame and prosperity, you cannot be vanquished and cannot be assailed. O immensely fortunate one! Therefore, I am extremely sad at this extremely wrong policy of denying you your share. I am trembling. What donations, *niyama* and austerities can I undertake so that my illustrious and infinite husband can now obtain at least a one-third share in the sacrifice?’⁸⁰⁵ Though the illustrious one was delighted at this, he also thought that his wife was agitated. Therefore, he said, ‘O goddess! O slender-waisted one! Why are you speaking in this way? Do you not know me? O large-eyed one!

Through my *dhyana*, I know all those who are virtuous. Because of your rage, all the gods and the three worlds have now been destroyed in every possible way. I am always praised as the lord of sacrifices. The *rathantara* hymn from the Sama Veda is chanted for me. The *brahmanas* worship me through a sacrifice. The *adhvaryu* devises a share for me.’⁸⁰⁶ The goddess replied, ‘O illustrious one! In an assembly of people, even an ordinary person seems to be spirited. In particular, in the presence of a woman, he is proud and praises himself.’ The illustrious one said, ‘O goddess! You seem to have understood this as me praising myself. That is not true. O beautiful lady! O one with the beautiful complexion! I will protect my share.’ The illustrious one spoke in this way to his beloved wife Uma, whom he loved more than his own life.

‘Having said this, using the fire of his rage, the illustrious one created a being through his mouth. Maheshvara told him, ‘Destroy Daksha’s sacrifice. With my permission, go and quickly destroy Daksha’s vow. He was thus urged by Rudra and knew the reason why the goddess was angry. Therefore, assuming the garb of a lion, he playfully destroyed Daksha’s sacrifice. The extremely terrible Bhadrakali Maheshvari was created from the rage. So that she could herself witness what was going to be done, she followed him.’⁸⁰⁷ The demon was none other than the illustrious one himself, who created a habitation within his own rage. He was known as Virabhadra and would cleanse the goddess of her anger. From the pores of his own body, he created the lords of *ganas*. These *ganas* were as terrible as Rudra in their prowess and valour and they followed him. All of them were Rudra’s followers and all of them were terrible in their prowess. Hundreds and thousands of them swiftly descended. They filled the sky with their tumultuous sounds. O *brahmanas*! The large number of Rudra’s *ganas* created a mighty roar and all the residents of heaven were terrified. The mountains were shattered and the earth quaked. Cruel winds blew and Varuna’s abode⁸⁰⁸ was agitated. The fire did not shine, and the sun lost its radiance. The planets, *nakshatras* and stars could not be seen. The *rishis*, the gods and the *danavas* were no longer radiant. Everything was covered in darkness. They were all burnt down and dishonoured. Terrible winds

blew, bearing the scent of pus and excrement. Some roared, others did the crushing. They swiftly rushed around, with the speed of the wind and thought. They shattered the sacrificial vessels and the sacrificial arena. When they were shattered, they resembled stars that had fallen down from the firmament. There were heaps of divine rice, drinks and other food, as large as mountains. There were rivers of milk, with the *ghee* and *payasam* resembling the mire. There was honey and divine gruel resembling water. The lumps of sugar were like the sand. The beautiful flows of molasses seemed to bear along the six kinds of taste. ⁸⁰⁹ There were many kinds of meat that could be chewed, superior and inferior. There was divine *lehya* and *choshya*. ⁸¹⁰ With many different kinds of mouths, these beings ate those up, or seized them and threw them away. Born from Rudra's rage, they were gigantic in size and like the fire of destruction. They possessed the complexion of mountains and agitated and terrified everyone. In many different kinds of ways, they played with the celestial women and threw them around. The *ganas* were like this and the powerful Virabhadra was with them. The sacrifice was well protected by the all the gods, but he had been goaded by Rudra's rage. Therefore, in Bhadrakali's presence, he quickly burnt it down. The others roared loudly and caused terror to all creatures. Having thus severed the head of the sacrifice, ⁸¹¹ they roared in horrible voices.

‘At this, Shakra and the other gods, and Daksha Prajapati joined their hands in salutation and asked, ‘Who are you?’ Virabhadra replied, ‘I am not a god or a *daitya*. Nor have I come here to enjoy anything. Nor have I come here to see the Indra of the gods. I do not have any such curiosity. O supreme gods! I have come here to destroy Daksha's sacrifice. I am known as Virabhadra and I have been created from Rudra's rage. This goddess is known as Bhadrakali and she has also emerged from that anger. She has been sent by the god of the gods and has come to witness the end of the sacrifice. O king Indra! Seek refuge with the god of the gods, Uma's consort. Instead of facing the enmity of this attendant, it is better to face the god's anger.’ They uprooted the sacrificial posts and flung them away, here and there. Hankering after flesh, vultures were flying around and swooping

down. The beating of their wings created a storm. Hundreds of jackals howled. The *ganas* obstructed the sacrifice of the intoxicated king. ⁸¹² At this, assuming the form of a deer, the sacrifice leapt up into the sky and started to run away. The illustrious lord picked up his bow and arrows and pursued it. The infinitely energetic lord of the *ganas* ⁸¹³ was filled with anger. A terrible drop of sweat formed on his forehead. As soon as that drop of sweat fell down on the ground, it resulted in a gigantic fire that blazed like the fire of destruction. O best among *brahmanas*! A man was created from this. He was exceedingly short, and his eyes were red. His moustache and beard were tawny. He was horrible. His hair stood up and his body had excessive hair. His ears were like cones. He was dark in complexion and cruel. His garments were red. The great being burnt down the sacrifice as if it was dry wood. Terrified, all the gods fled in the ten directions. As he strode around in his valour, the earth, with its seven *dvipas*, trembled in every direction. That great being started to terrorize the world of the gods. At that time, I worshipped Mahadeva and spoke to him. ‘O lord! All the gods will give you your share. O lord of all the gods! Refrain from this destruction. O Mahadeva! Because of your anger, all these gods and the thousands of *rishis* cannot find any peace. O bull among the gods! O one who knows about *dharma*! The being born from your sweat will roam around in the worlds under the name of Jvara. ⁸¹⁴ O lord! If this energy is concentrated in a single entity, the entire earth will not be able to bear it. Therefore, let it be divided into many parts.’ Saying this, I arranged for a share for the god. The god of the gods, the wielder of *pinaka*, agreed to what I had said. The wielder of *pinaka* was himself filled with great delight. In his mind, Daksha also sought refuge with God Bhava. The conqueror of enemies ⁸¹⁵ made efforts and concentrated *prana* and *apana* in his eyes, thus opening his eyes completely. He looked around everywhere, smiled and spoke these words. ‘What can I do for you?’ The gods and the ancestors made him hear the great account. Prajapati Daksha joined his hands in salutation and spoke to the god. He was terrified and scared. He was so frightened that his face and eyes were covered with tears. Daksha said, ‘O illustrious one! O god! If you are pleased with me, if you love me, if I am

no longer a recipient of your rage and if I am to be granted a boon, let it be this. The food that was to be eaten has already been eaten. The drinks have already been drunk. Some of it has been destroyed. Some has been crushed and polluted. These objects needed for the sacrifice were gathered over a long period of time, after a great deal of effort. O Maheshvara! Through your favours, let these efforts of mine not be futile.’ The illustrious Hara, the one who had plucked out Bhaga’s eyes, signified his assent. Prajapati Daksha sank down on his knees on the ground and obtained this boon from Mahadeva Tryambaka, the one who controls *dharma*. Using one thousand and eight names, he praised Vrishadhvaja.’

Chapter 1(38) (Daksha's prayer)

Brahma said, 'O supreme among *brahmanas*! In this way, Daksha witnessed Shambhu's valour. He joined his hands in salutation, prostrated himself and started to praise him.'

Daksha said, 'O Devadevesha! ⁸¹⁶ I bow down to you. O Balasudana! ⁸¹⁷ I bow down to you. You are the Indra of the gods. You are the best in strength, worshipped by the gods and the *danavas*. O Sahasraksha! ⁸¹⁸ O Virupaksha! ⁸¹⁹ O Tryaksha! ⁸²⁰ O Yakshadhipapriya! ⁸²¹ Your hands and feet are everywhere. Your eyes, heads and mouths are in every direction. Your ears are everywhere. You are established, enveloping everything in the world. O Shankukarna! ⁸²² O Mahakarna! ⁸²³ O Kumbhakarna! ⁸²⁴ O Arnavalaya! ⁸²⁵ O Gajendrakarna! ⁸²⁶ O Gokarna! ⁸²⁷ O Shatakarna! ⁸²⁸ I bow down to you. O Shatodara! ⁸²⁹ O Shatavarta! ⁸³⁰ O Shatajihva! ⁸³¹ O Sanatana! ⁸³² Those who chant the *gayatri mantra* sing about you. Those who have abstained from *karma*, worship you. O Devadanavagopta! ⁸³³ O Brahma! O Shatakratu! You are Murtiman. ⁸³⁴ O Mahamurti! ⁸³⁵ O Samudra! ⁸³⁶ O store of lakes! Like the cows in a pen, all the gods are in you. In truth, I see in your body Soma, Agni, the lord of the waters, ⁸³⁷ Aditya, Vishnu, Brahma and Brihaspati. You are the act. You are cause and effect. You are the doer. You are the instrument. You are the existent. You are the non-existent. You are the origin of creation and destruction. I bow down to Bhava, Sharva, Rudra, Varada. ⁸³⁸ I bow down to Pashupati and Andhakaghatin. ⁸³⁹ I bow down to Trijata, Trishirsha, Trishulavaradharin, Tryambaka, Trinetra and Tripuraghna. ⁸⁴⁰ I bow down to Chanda, Manda and Vishvachandadhar. ⁸⁴¹ I bow down to Dandin, Shankukarna and Chandichanda. ⁸⁴² I bow down to Ardhadandikesha, Shushka and Vikrita. ⁸⁴³ I bow down to Vilohita, Dhumra and Nilagriva. ⁸⁴⁴ I bow down to

Apratirupa, Virupa and Shiva. ⁸⁴⁵ I bow down to Surya, Suryapati and Suryadhvajapatakin. ⁸⁴⁶ I bow down to Pramathanatha. ⁸⁴⁷ I bow down to Vrishaskandha. ⁸⁴⁸ I bow down to Hiranyavarna and Hiranyakavacha. ⁸⁴⁹ I bow down to Hiranyakritachuda and Hiranyapati. ⁸⁵⁰ I bow down to Shatrughata, Chanda, Parnasamghashaya, Stuta, Stuti, Stuyamana. ⁸⁵¹ I bow down to Sarva, Sarvabhaksha, Sarvabhutantaratman. ⁸⁵² I bow down to the one who is *homa*, the one who is *mantra*, to Shukladhvajapatakin. ⁸⁵³ I bow down to Anamya and Namya. ⁸⁵⁴ I bow down to Kilakila. ⁸⁵⁵ I bow down to Shayamana, Shayita and Utthita. ⁸⁵⁶ I bow down to Sthita, Dhavamana, Bhuta, Kutila. ⁸⁵⁷ I bow down to Nartanashila and Mukhavaditrakarini. ⁸⁵⁸ I bow down to Vadhapaha, Lubdha and Gitavaditrakarini. ⁸⁵⁹ I bow down to Jyeshtha, Shreshtha and Balapramathana. ⁸⁶⁰ I bow down to Kalpana, Kalpya, Kshama and Upakshama. ⁸⁶¹ I always bow down to Ugra. ⁸⁶² I bow down to Dashabahu. ⁸⁶³ I bow down to Kapalahasta, Sitabhasmapriya, Vibhishana, Bhima and Bhimavratadhara. ⁸⁶⁴ I bow down to Nanavikritavaktra, Khadgajihva and Ugradamshtin. ⁸⁶⁵ I bow down to Pakshamasalavadya and Tumbivinapriya. ⁸⁶⁶ I bow down to Aghoraghorarupa and Ghoraghoratara. ⁸⁶⁷ I bow down to Shiva. I bow down to Shanta and Shantatara. ⁸⁶⁸ I bow down to Buddha, Shuddha and Sambibhagapriya. ⁸⁶⁹ I bow down to Prapancha, Ugra and Samkhyapara. ⁸⁷⁰ I bow down to Chandaikaghanta, Ghantanada and Ghantin. ⁸⁷¹ I bow down to Sahasrashataghanta and Ghantamalapriya. ⁸⁷² I bow down to Pranadanda, Nitya and Lohita. ⁸⁷³ I bow down to Huhumkara, Rudra and Huhumkarapriya. ⁸⁷⁴

I bow down to Aparavan, Nitya, Girivrikshapriya, Margamamsashrigala, Taraka and Tara. ⁸⁷⁵ I bow down to Yajnadhipati, Krita and Prakrita. ⁸⁷⁶ I bow down to Yajnavaha, Danta, Tathya and Vitatha. ⁸⁷⁷ I bow down to Tata, Tatya and Tatinipati. ⁸⁷⁸ I bow down to Annada, Annapati and Annabhuj. ⁸⁷⁹ I bow down to Sahasrashirsha, Sahasracharana, Sahasrodyatashula and Sahasranayana. ⁸⁸⁰ I bow down to Balarkavarna and Balarupadhara. ⁸⁸¹ I bow down to Balarkarupadhara and Balakridanaka. ⁸⁸² I bow down to Shuddha, Buddha, Kshobhana and Kshaya. ⁸⁸³ I bow down to Tarangankitakesha and Muktakesha. ⁸⁸⁴ I bow down to Shatakarmatushta

and Trikarmanirata. ⁸⁸⁵ I bow down to Varnashrama-vidhivatprithagdharmapravartaka. ⁸⁸⁶ I bow down to Shreshtha, Jyeshtha and Kalakala. ⁸⁸⁷ I bow down to Shvetapingalanetra and Krishnaraktekshana. ⁸⁸⁸ I bow down to Dharmakamarthamoksha, Kratha, Krathana, Samkhya, Samkhyamukhya and Yogadhipati. ⁸⁸⁹ I bow down to Rathyadhirathya and Chatushpathapatha. ⁸⁹⁰ I bow down to Krishnajinottariya, Vyalayajnopavita, Ishana, Rudrasamghata and Hariksha. ⁸⁹¹ I bow down to Tryambaka, Ambikanatha, Vyakta and Avyakta. ⁸⁹² I bow down to Kala, Kamada, Kamaghna, Dushtodvrittanivarana, Sarvagarihita, Sarvaghna and Sadyojata. ⁸⁹³ I bow down to Unmadana, Shatavartagangatoyardramurdhaja, Chandrardhasamyugavarta and Meghavarta. ⁸⁹⁴ You are the one who sustains many kinds of *artha* and donations. You are also Arthada. ⁸⁹⁵ You are Annasrashta, Bhokta, Yajabhuk, Anala, Jarayuja, Andaja, Svedaja and Udbhija. ⁸⁹⁶ O Devadevesha! You are the four kinds of creatures. You are the creator of mobile and immobile objects. You are the one who withdraws. ⁸⁹⁷ You are Brahma. O Vishvesha! ⁸⁹⁸ You are spoken of as the Brahma who was in the water. You are the supreme womb of everything. You are Svadha. You are the store of the stellar bodies. Those who know about the *brahman* speak of you as *Rig*, *Sama* and *Omkara*. ⁸⁹⁹ When the best among the gods, those who know about the *brahman*, chant from the Sama Veda and offer oblations, they speak of you as ‘Hari, Hari’ and ‘Hara, Hara’. You are full of hymns from the Rig Veda, Sama Veda, Yajur Veda and Atharva Veda. Those who know about the *brahman*, the *kalpa sutras* and the collection of Upanishads, serve you. You are the *brahmana*, *kshatriya*, *vaishya* and *shudra varnas*, and the *ashramas*. You are the collection of *ashramas*. You are the sound of the lightning. You are the year, seasons, months, fortnights, *kala*, *kashtha*, *nimesha*, *nakshatras* and *yugas*. ⁹⁰⁰ You are the humps of bullocks. You are the peaks of mountains. You are the lion, the lord of animals, and Takshaka Ananta among the serpents. Among oceans, you are the ocean of milk. Among *mantras*, you are the *mantras* of the Yajur Veda. Among weapons, you are the *vajra*. Among vows, you are the vow of truthfulness. You are wishes, hatred, attachment, delusion, serenity, forgiveness, conduct, fortitude, greed, desire, anger,

victory and defeat. You are the one who has a mace, an arrow, a bow, a *khatvanga*, a standard and a chariot. You cut, pierce, strike and lead. We think that you are the one who thinks. You possess the ten auspicious signs.

⁹⁰¹ You are *dharma*, *artha* and *kama*. You are Indra, the oceans, the rivers, the puddles, the lakes, the creepers, the winding plants, grass, the herbs, domestic animals, wild animals and birds. You are the source of objects, tasks and qualities. You are the one who provides flowers and fruits at the right time. You are the beginning, the middle and the end. You are Gayatri and Omkara. You are green, red, black, blue, yellow, red, tawny, light brown, dark brown, pigeon-coloured and dark. You are known as the one with the golden seed. You are known to have a golden complexion. You are known as gold.

⁹⁰² You are the one who loves gold. You are Indu, Yama, Varuna, Dhanada and Anala.

⁹⁰³ You are Utphulla-Chitrabhanu, Svarbhanu and Bhanu.

⁹⁰⁴ You are the sacrifice, the person performing the sacrifice, the objects used in the sacrifice, and the oblations. You are the lord. You are the *brahman*. You are the *trisouparna* and *shatarudiya mantras* of the Yajur Veda.

⁹⁰⁵ You are the most sacred amongst everything that is sacred. You are the most auspicious amongst everything that is auspicious. You are the mountain that destroys sins. You are the tree, the *jivatman* and destruction.

⁹⁰⁶ You are the breath of life. You are *rajas*, *tamas* and *sattva*. You are *prana*, *apana*, *samana*, *udana* and *vyana*. You are the opening and closing of the eyes. You are time and *kalpa*. You are Lohitanga, Damshtin, Mahavaktra, Mahodara, Shuchiroman, Haricchmashru and Urddhvakesha.

⁹⁰⁷ You are the mobile and the immobile. Singing, dancing and the playing of musical instruments are your limbs. You love singing and the playing of musical instruments. You are the fish, the net and the water. You cannot be vanquished. You are the serpent in the water. You are a porpoise.

⁹⁰⁸ You are perverse time, you are good time, you are bad time and you are the destroyer of time. You are death. You are without decay. You are the end. You are the one who creates forgiveness and *maya*. You are the whirlpool. You are the one who creates the whirlpool. You are the clouds at the time of destruction. You are a shield with bells. You are the sound of the bell. You are the bell. You have tufts of hair. You are the salty ocean. You are Brahma.

The fire of destruction is in your mouth. You hold a staff. You have a shaven head and hold three staff tied together. You are the four yugas. You are the four Vedas. You are *chaturhotra*.⁹⁰⁹ You are four roads at a crossroads. You are the leader of the four *ashramas*. You are also the cause behind the four *varnas*. You are what perishes. You are what does not perish. You are loved. You are cunning. You are revered by the *ganas*. You are the lord of the *ganas*. You wear red garlands and garments. You are Girisha.⁹¹⁰ You love Girija.⁹¹¹ You are the lord of artisans. You are the best among artisans. You are the one who has created all kinds of artisanship. You are the fierce destroyer of Bhaga's eyes and the destroyer of Pusha's teeth. You are Svaha, Svadha, Vashatkara and Namaskara.⁹¹² I bow down to you. You are mysterious in your vows. You are mysterious. You are served by those whose vows are mysterious. You are the act of crossing over. You are the one who ensures the crossing over. You are the one who has spies in every place. You are the one who creates, ordains, brings together and establishes. You hold up the mountain. You are austerities. You are the *brahman*. You are the truth. You are *brahmacharya* and uprightness. You are the *atman* in beings. You are the one who manifested as the creator of beings. You are the origin behind the past, the present and the future. You are the one who surrounds Bhuloka, Bhuvarloka and Svarloka. You are Maheshvara. You are Rekshana.⁹¹³ You love the one with two eyes. You possess self-control. You destroy those who lack self-control. You are Brahmavarta, Suravarta and Kamavarta.⁹¹⁴ I bow down to you. You are the one who destroyed Kama's image. You are the one who loves a garland of *karnikara* flowers. You are the leader of cattle. You are the one who spreads the rays. You are the one who has an excellent bull as a mount. You are the protector of the three worlds. You are Govinda. You are Gupta.⁹¹⁵ You are Gogarga.⁹¹⁶ You face the complete moon. Your face is excellent. Your face is terrible. You do not have a face. You have four faces. You have many faces. You always face others in battles. You are Hiranyagarbha. You are Shakuni.⁹¹⁷ You are Dhanada. You are the lord of food. You are gigantic. You destroy *adharma*. You are extremely accomplished. You hold a staff. You love to fight. You stand steady. You are immobile.⁹¹⁸ You do not

tremble. You are extremely still. You are impossible to restrain. You are impossible to tolerate. You are extremely proud. You cannot be crossed. You are impossible to hold. You are always impossible to subjugate. You cannot be subdued. You are victory. You are the one who is victorious. You are a hare. The moon is your eye. You are heat, cold, hunger, thirst and old age. You are physical and mental ailments. You are the one who destroys ailments. You are the lord of ailments. You can be tolerated. You are the hunter who went after the sacrifice when it was in the form of a deer. You are a store of all the ailments. You are without hands. You have a tuft of hair. You are a lotus. Your eyes are like lotuses. You hold a *chakra* and a staff. You are the one who destroys all the terrible shares. You are the one who drinks poison. You are the one who drinks *amrita*. You are the one who drinks liquor. You are the one who drinks milk and *soma*. You are the one who drinks honey. You are the one who drinks water. You are the one who drinks everything. You are strong and weak. You are the one who is borne on the body of a bull. You are a bull. Your eyes are like those of a bull. You are famous as a leader of the worlds and are honoured by the worlds. The sun and the moon are your eyes. The grandfather is your heart. The *agnishtoma* sacrifice is your body and is nourished by acts of *dharma*. O Shiva! Brahma, Govinda and the ancient *rishis* are incapable of understanding your greatness and the truth about you. Your subtle and auspicious form protects me. Let it come into my line of vision. Like a father protects his son, always protect me with it. O unblemished one! I am worthy of being protected. Protect me. I bow down to you. O illustrious one! You are compassionate towards your devotees and I am always devoted to you. I am enveloped by the hardships faced by many thousands of men, and I am standing by the shore of an ocean. Always be my protector. Those who have conquered sleep, those who have controlled their breath of life, those who are established in *sattva*, and those who are impartial in vision can see that radiance and are united with it. I bow down to that *atman* of yoga. When the end of the yuga presents itself, you devour all beings. You are the one who lies down in the midst of the water. I seek refuge with the one who lies down in the water. In the form of Rahu, he

enters Soma's mouth and drinks up the night. In the form of Svarbhanu, he devours the sun. He is the fire in *soma* juice. In the form of a being that is the size of a finger, he is in the bodies of all those who possess bodies. Let him always protect me. Let him always nourish me. He is the one who created the gods. When they die, it is into him that they merge. He is the one who is praised through the exclamations of *svaha* and *svadha*. He is the one into whom those with bodies ascend. Those with life descend from him. They are delighted by him and are never made to suffer by him. I always bow down to him. I bow down to those who are in oceans, impassable rivers, mountains, caves, the roots of trees, cow-pens, desolate forests, crossroads, roads, jungles, assembly halls, stables of horses, elephants and chariots, dilapidated gardens and houses, the five elements, the directions, the sub-directions, in between Indra and Arka, the rays of the moon and the sun, in nether regions and in regions beyond all these. I bow down to them. I always bow down to them. O god! You go everywhere and you are identical with all these. You are Bhava and you are the lord of all creatures. You are in the atmans of all beings. That is the reason you have not been invited. O god! You are the one who is worshipped in sacrifices with many kinds of *dakshina*. You are the one who does everything. That is the reason you have not been invited. O god! Or perhaps I have been deluded by your subtle *maya*. That may be the reason why you have not been invited by me. O lord of the gods! Show me your favours. You are the one who is my refuge. You are the destination and the foundation. It is my view that there is no one else.'

Brahma continued, 'Having praised Mahadeva in this way, the extremely intelligent one stopped. Extremely pleased, the illustrious one again spoke to Daksha.'

The illustrious one said, 'O Daksha! O one who is excellent in vows! I am satisfied with your praises. What is the reason to speak a lot? You will come to my presence.'

Brahma continued, 'Bhava, the lord of the three worlds, spoke to him in this way. Having comforted him thus, the omniscient one addressed him in these controlled words. Shiva said, 'O Daksha! You should not grieve at the

destruction of the sacrifice. O unblemished one! In advance, I had seen that your sacrifice would be destroyed. O one excellent in vows! Accept a boon from me again. With a pleasant face, listen to me with single-minded attention. O Prajapati! Through my favours, you will obtain the fruits of one thousand horse sacrifices and one hundred *vajapeya* sacrifices. You will understand the Vedas, the six Vedangas and all the texts of *samkhya* and yoga. You have tormented yourself in extensive austerities that are extremely difficult for even the gods and *danavas* to perform. After doing that for twelve years, you have obtained a subtle wisdom, and no one can criticize your sacrifice. Sometimes, it follows the *dharma* of the *varnas* and the *ashramas* and in some respects, it does not. However, the time has come for you to practice my *pashupata* vow, appropriate for all *ashramas*. It frees all creatures from bondage. O Daksha! It is auspicious and it has been devised so that it can free one from all sins. Follow it properly, so that you can obtain all the fruits. O extremely fortunate one! Therefore, cast aside all the mental anxiety that you have.’ Having spoken in this way to Daksha, the infinitely energetic lord of the gods vanished, along with his wife and followers, having partaken of his share. O ones who know everything about *dharma*! Along with Uma, Bhava divided the fever ⁹¹⁹ into different categories. O *brahmanas*! He did this so that all creatures might find peace. Listen to this. For elephants, it is the hair on the head getting heated. For mountains, it is bitumen. For water, it is the indigo plant. For snakes, it is known to be the shedding of the skin. For bovine species, it is a hoof that causes limping. It is a barren spot on the surface of the earth. O those who know about *dharma*! For dogs, it is anything that impedes the eyesight. It is a hole in the ground for horses. For peacocks, it is the splitting of the feathers on the head. For cuckoos, it is the redness of the eye. For great-souled ones, fever is said to be all kinds of division among people. This is what we have heard. For all types of parrots, fever is said to be the hiccup. O *brahmanas*! Among tigers, exhaustion is said to be the fever. O those who know about *dharma*! Among humans, fever is said to be the anxiety at the time of birth, death, or in the middle. These are the extremely terrible forms of Maheshvara’s energy, known by the name of fever. The lord of all

creatures must be revered and bowed down to. If a man controls himself and constantly hears about this origin of fever, without any distress in his mind, that man will be freed from all disease. He will be happy and will obtain every desire that is there in his mind. If a person recites or hears the hymn uttered by Daksha, such a person will never face anything inauspicious and will have a long lifespan. Just as the illustrious Bhava is the most senior among all the gods, this hymn crafted by Daksha is the best among all hymns. If a person desires fame, heaven, divine prosperity, riches, victory, learning, or any other object he wishes for, he should faithfully chant this hymn. If a man is diseased, miserable, distressed or faces fear because the king has asked him to do something, he will be freed from that great fear. In this body and in this world, he obtains happiness from Maheshvara and becomes one of his *ganas*. He becomes a lord of the *ganas*. If Bhava is praised in this way, there are no impediments in that house from *yakshas*, *pishachas*, *nagas* or *vinayakas*.⁹²⁰ Thinking of Bhava, if a woman listens to this with faith in her mind, she is honoured in her father's house and her husband's house. If a person frequently chants or listens to it, all his tasks are successful and he does not face any obstructions. If one chants this hymn, everything one has thought of in the mind, or stated in words, is obtained. Observing *dama* and *niyama*, shares of offerings must be divided and offered in due order to the god, Guha,⁹²¹ the goddess and Nandishvara. Thus offered, they quickly accept it and the man obtains all the objects of desire he wishes for. After death, he goes to heaven and is surrounded by one thousand women. If a person reads this hymn composed by Daksha, he is freed from all sins, even if they are all the major sins associated with every kind of desire. When he dies, he is united with the *ganas*, and worshipped by gods and *asuras*. He is radiant on a *vimana* yoked to a bull. Until the deluge arrives, he becomes Rudra's companion. This has been uttered by the illustrious Vyasa, Parashara's son. This is extremely secret and the undeserving should not know about it or hear it. Through this, those born in wicked wombs, *vaishyas*, women and shudras, obtain Rudra's

world. If a brahmana makes *brahmanas* hear it on auspicious days, there is no doubt that he obtains Rudra's world.'

Chapter 1(39) (Greatness of Ekamra *kshetra*)

Lomasharshana said, ‘O *brahmanas*! The best among sages heard this auspicious account about Rudra’s anger, as stated by Vyasa. It destroys all sins. They heard about Parvati’s anger, Shambhu’s rage, impossible to withstand, and the origin of Virabhadra and Bhadrakali. They heard about the destruction of Daksha’s sacrifice and Shambhu’s extraordinary valour. They also heard about how the extremely great-souled Daksha obtained the god’s favours again, how he gave a share in the sacrifice to Daksha, and about the fruits obtained through Daksha’s sacrifice. The *brahmanas* were extremely happy and repeatedly astounded. They again asked Vyasa about the rest of the account. They again asked Vyasa about the *kshetra* Ekamraka.’

Vyasa said, ‘Hearing what Brahma had said, the bulls among the *rishis* praised him. They were delighted and they had goosebumps. The *rishis* said, ‘O best among the gods! How wonderful! You have described god Shambhu’s greatness and the destruction of Daksha’s sacrifice. You should now tell us about Ekamraka, supreme among *kshetras*. O Brahma! We have great curiosity and we wish to hear about it.’ The one with four faces, the protector of the worlds, heard their words. He spoke about Shambhu’s *kshetra* on earth, which confers all the objects of pleasure and emancipation.’

Brahma said, ‘O tigers among sages! Listen. I will briefly tell you about this auspicious *kshetra*. It is extremely difficult to reach. It is auspicious and destroys all sins. It has one crore *lingas* and is as auspicious as Varanasi. It is famous as Ekamraka and there are eight *tirthas* inside it. O best among *brahmanas*! In the earlier *kalpa*, there used to be a single mango tree there. It has been heard that this is the reason the *kshetra* came to have the name

of Ekamraka. ⁹²² It is full of happy and healthy people, men and women. There are large numbers of learned people and the place is full of wealth, grain and other things. There are houses with pens for cattle, and the place is ornamented with gates. The place has many traders and is decorated with many kinds of jewels. There are houses and mansions and the avenues are decorated. It is beautiful, with palaces that are as white as swans. It is decorated with white ramparts, and there are gates that are fastened thrice. ⁹²³ It is ornamented with moats, protected by innumerable weapons. It is ornamented with flags that are white, red, yellow, dark blue and black in colour and these flutter in the wind. There is always reason to be happy and many kinds of musical instruments are sounded—*veenas*, flutes and drums. It is ornamented with catapults. ⁹²⁴ There are divine temples to the gods, decorated with walls and gardens. Many wonderful kinds of worship decorate the place everywhere. Women can be seen, slender at the waist and happy. Necklaces adorn their necks, and their large eyes are like the petals of lotuses. Their breasts are heavy and upright. Their complexion is dark, and their faces are like the full moon. ⁹²⁵ Their hair does not move. ⁹²⁶ Their cheeks are excellent, and there is the tinkling of girdles and anklets. Their hair is excellent, and their hips are beautiful. Their large eyes extend all the way up to the ears. They possess all the auspicious signs and are decorated with all the ornaments. They wear divine and white garments, and some have the complexion of gold. Their heavy breasts make them bend down, and their gait is like that of swans and elephants. Their limbs are smeared with divine fragrances and unguents, and their ears are decorated with earrings. Their loins are excellent and their eyes are intoxicated. Their faces are always smiling. Their teeth are like flashes of lightning, and their lips are like *bimba* fruit. Their voices are sweet. Their mouths are coloured with betel leaves. They are learned and beautiful to behold. They are extremely fortunate and pleasant in speech. They are proud of their perpetual youth. All of them wear divine garments and are always full of good character. Those women, who are like *apsaras*, always sport there. In their own respective houses, those women are happy, during the day and in the night. The men who can be seen there are proud of their youth and beauty. They

possess all the auspicious signs and are adorned in all the ornaments. O supreme among sages! The *brahmanas*, *kshastriyas*, *vaishyas* and *shudras* are engaged in their own *dharma*, and reside there, extremely devoted to *dharma*. Courtesans also reside there, with beautiful eyes. They are the equals of *Ghritachi*, *Menaka*, *Rambha*, *Tilottama*, *Urvashi*, *Viprachitti*, *Vishvachi*, *Sahajanya* and *Pramlocha*.⁹²⁷ All of them are pleasant in speech, and all of them have smiling faces. All of them are accomplished in the arts, and all of them possess the qualities. Such are the women there, skilled in singing and dancing. O best among sages! All the women who dwell there are proud of their qualities. They are beautiful and agreeable to behold, skilled in sidelong glances and conversation. There is no one who is not beautiful. There is no one who is wicked in conduct. There is no one who causes injury to others. Men are confounded by their sidelong glances. There is no one there who is poor, foolish, hateful, diseased, dirty, wicked or deceptive. There is no one who is not beautiful. There is no one who is wicked in conduct. There is no one who causes injury to others.⁹²⁸ Such are the men who reside in the *kshetra* that is famous in the world. It is easy to travel everywhere there and everything brings pleasure to the beings who reside there. It is full of many kinds of people and every kind of crop grows there. There are *karnikara*, *panasa*, *champaka*, *nagakesara*, *patala*, *ashoka*, *bakula*, *kapittha*, *bahula*⁹²⁹, *dhava*, *chuta*⁹³⁰, *nimba*⁹³¹, *kadamba* and other kinds of flowers. *Nipaka*,⁹³² *dhava* and *khadira* trees are decorated with creepers. There are *shala*, *tala*, *tamala*, *narikela*, *shubhanjana*,⁹³³ *arjuna*, *saptaparna*, *kovidara*, *pippala*, *lakucha*, *sarala*, *lodhra*,⁹³⁴ *hintala*,⁹³⁵ *devadaru*, *muchukunda*, *parijata* and *kubjaka* trees. There are groves with clumps of plantain, *jambu* fruit and areca nut. There are *ketaki*, *karavira*, *atimukta*, *kimshuka*, *mandara*, *kunda* blossoms and other kinds of flowers. Frequented by many kinds of birds that call, it is like the garden of *Nandana*. The trees bend down because of the burden of fruit. There are all kinds of creatures there—*chakoras*, *shatapatras*, *bhringarajas*, *kokilas*, *kalavinkas*, *mayuras*, *priyaputras*, *shukas*, *jivanjivakas*, *haritas* and *chatakas*.⁹³⁶ They fill the forests. There are many other kinds of birds that call in melodious notes. There are long lakes, ponds, smaller ponds and

wells. There are many sacred water bodies, decorated with clumps of lotuses. The lakes delight the mind and are full of sparkling water. There are water lilies, white lotuses and blue lotuses. There are *kadambas*, *chakravakas*, waterfowl, *karandavas*, *plavas*, *hamsas* and many other aquatic creatures.⁹³⁷ In this way, there are diverse types of trees and many kinds of excellent flowers. There are many auspicious water bodies and it is beautiful in every direction.’

‘For the welfare of the worlds, god Krittivasa Vrishadhvaja is himself there. This is Shiva, who grants objects of pleasure and emancipation. O best among *brahmanas*! Along with the gods and the *rishis*, for the welfare of all the worlds, Rudra had earlier collected separate drops of water from all the *tirthas* on earth, rivers, lakes, ponds, tanks, other water bodies, wells and oceans and brought them together in a *tirtha* there, named Bindusara.⁹³⁸ This is known as Bindusara. O best among *brahmanas*! It was created on the eighth lunar day⁹³⁹ in *krishna paksha* in the month of Margashirsha. A person should control his senses and go there at the time of the vernal equinox. Full of faith, he must bathe in the proper way in Bindusara. He must carefully satisfy gods, *rishis*, humans and ancestors. He must follow the rites and stating his name and *gotra*, offer water and sesamum. If he bathes in the proper way, he obtains the fruits of a horse sacrifice. If he bathes there on auspicious occasions—eclipses, the change of one *ayana* into another, *vishuva sankranti* and conjunctions like *shadashiti*—and gives wealth and other donations to *brahmanas*, the fruits are one hundred times what is obtained from other *tirthas*.⁹⁴⁰ If a person offers *pinda*⁹⁴¹ to ancestors on the banks of the lake, there is no doubt that one gives the ancestors eternal satisfaction. A person should control his senses, control his speech and go to Shambhu’s temple there. Having entered, he should worship Sharva and perform *pradakshina* thrice. In a pure state, he should bathe Bhava with *ghee*, milk and other things. With sandalwood, fragrances, pastes and flowers, he should worship the god who has the moon on his crest and is Uma’s consort. He should use many kinds of holy flowers, like *bilva*,⁹⁴² *arka*, lotus and others to worship Shankara, using *mantras* spoken about in the *agamas* and the Vedas. A person who has not

been formally initiated will state his name and use the basic *mantra*. In this way, the god will be worshipped with excellent fragrances, flowers, incense, lamps, offerings, gifts, praises, prostrating oneself like a rod on the ground, songs, the agreeable playing of musical instruments, dancing, *japa*, bowing down, exclamations of victory and *pradakshina*. Worshipped properly in this way, Umapati, the god of the gods, grants freedom from all sins, and the devotee can be proud of his youth and beauty. He is adorned in divine garments and ornaments and saves twenty-one generations of his family. He performs sacrifices and is devoted to donating. He becomes a lord of the worlds. After having bathed in the waters of Bindusara, the devotee should go and see Mukdishvara, Siddhesha, Svarnajaleshvara, Parameshvara and the subtle and famous Ambratikeshvara, performing worship at these places. He then goes to Shiva's world on a golden and sparkling *vimana* decorated with bells, praised by ornamented *gandharvas* and *apsaras* and illuminating all the directions. O *brahmanas*! There, he enjoys happiness and all the objects that bring pleasure to the mind. Until the deluge arrives, he resides there. O supreme among *brahmanas*! When his store of good deeds is exhausted, he is again born on earth in a home of yogis and knows the four Vedas. When he achieves *pashupata yoga*, he obtains emancipation. If a person sees the excellent god, Krittivasa, before lying down, on rising, at the time of *sankranti*, when the *ayana* changes, at the time of the *ashtami* known as Ashoka,⁹⁴³ and during *pavitraropana*⁹⁴⁴, he goes to Shiva's world on a *vimana* that has the complexion of the sun. If an intelligent person sees the god, whatever be the time, he is freed from sins and goes to Shiva's world. The area two and a half *yojanas* to the west, east, south and north of the god is a *kshetra* and confers objects of pleasure and emancipation. The *lingam* that is there in that supreme *kshetra* is known as Bhaskareshvara. Earlier, the three-eyed god of the gods had been worshipped by Aditya there. If a person bathes in the pond there and sees the god Maheshvara, he is freed from all sins. Astride an excellent *vimana*, he is praised by the *gandharvas* and goes to Shiva's world. O supreme among *brahmanas*! Happy, he remains there for an entire *kalpa*. In Shiva's world, he enjoys agreeable and extensive objects of pleasure. When his

store of good deeds is exhausted, he is born on earth in an excellent family, or in a house of yogis. He becomes accomplished in the Vedas and the Vedangas. He is born as an excellent brahmana who is engaged in the welfare of all creatures. He becomes skilled in all the sacred texts about *moksha* and his intelligence becomes impartial. Having obtained Shambhu's excellent yoga, he proceeds towards emancipation. O *brahmanas*!

Wherever a *lingam* is seen, irrespective of whether it is fit to be worshipped or not, whether it is found in the forest, a road, at the crossroads or a cremation ground, as long as the *lingam* is not cracked, one must control oneself and bathe it with faith and devotion, worshipping it with fragrances, pleasant flowers, incense, lamps, offerings, bowing down, praises, prostrating like a rod on the ground, dancing, singing and other things.

Having worshipped in the proper way, a man goes to Shiva's world. O tigers among *brahmanas*! If a woman worships in this way, faithfully, she too obtains these fruits and there should be no doubt about the matter. O supreme among sages! With the exception of god Maheshvara himself, who is capable of describing all the qualities of that excellent *kshetra*? O

brahmanas! Whether the person possesses faith or does not possess faith, a man or a woman who goes to that supreme *kshetra* in Vaishakha or any such month and having bathed in the waters of Bindusara, sees God Virupaksha, the Goddess Shivaa, the granter of boons, the *gana* Chanda, Kartikeya, Ganesha, the bull, ⁹⁴⁵ the tree that grants all objects of desire ⁹⁴⁶

or Savitri, that person goes to Shiva's world. Following the norms, if a person bathes in Kapila *tirtha*, ⁹⁴⁷ which destroys all sins, that person obtains all the objects of desire and goes to Shiva's world. If a person controls his senses and performs the rituals in that *tirtha*, he saves twenty-one of his generations and goes to Shiva's world. If a person bathes in Ekamraka, Shiva's *kshetra*, which is as auspicious as Varanasi, it is certain that he will obtain emancipation.'

Chapter 1(40) (Description of Utkala *kshetra*)

Brahma said, ‘Mother Brahmani, is radiant and is established in Viraja. ⁹⁴⁸ On seeing her, a mortal person purifies seven generations of his lineage. If a man sees the goddess properly there and full of devotion, bows down and worships her, he saves his own lineage and goes to my world. There are other mothers of the world in Viraja too. Those goddesses destroy all sins. They bestow boons and are affectionate towards devotees. The river Vaitarani is there and it destroys all sins. Having bathed there, the best among men are freed from all sins. Svayambhu Hari is himself there, in the form of a boar. ⁹⁴⁹ If a man sees him and faithfully prostrates himself, he reaches Vishnu’s abode. There are eight *tirthas* in Viraja, known as—Kapila, Gograha, Somatirtha, Alabu, Mrityunjaya, Krodatirtha, Vasuka and Siddhakeshvara. An intelligent person should go there, control his senses and bathe in the proper way, bowing down to the gods. He will then be freed from all sins. Astride an excellent *vimana*, praised by *gandharvas*, he will obtain greatness in my world. If a person offers *pinda* in my *kshetra* of Viraja, there is no doubt that he gives eternal satisfaction to the ancestors. O best among sages! If a man gives up his life in my *kshetra* of Viraja, he obtains emancipation. If a mortal person bathes in the ocean and sees Kapila, Hari and the goddess Varahi, ⁹⁵⁰ he goes to the abode of the gods. O best among sages! There are other *tirthas* and sacred temples that should be known as equal to that. ⁹⁵¹ O supreme among *brahmanas*! In that region, on the northern shores of the ocean, there is a secret and supreme *tirtha* that destroys sins and grants emancipation. It is sacred and is covered with sand everywhere. It grants all the objects of desire. It extends for ten thousand *yojanas* and is an extremely rare *kshetra*. There are trees like *ashoka*, *arjuna*, *punnaga*, *bakula*, *sarala*, *panasa*, *narikela*, *shala*, *tala*, *kapitthaka*,

champaka, karnikara, chuta, bilva, patala, kadamba, kovidara, lakucha, nagakesara, shami, amalaka, lodhra, naranga, dhava, khadira, sarja, bhurja, ashvakarna, tamala, devadaru, mandara, parijata, nyagrodha, agaru, chandana, kharjura, amrataka, siddha, muchukunda, kimshuka, ashvattha, saptaparni, madhudhara, shubhanjna, shimshapa, amalaka, nipa, nimba, tindu and vibhitaka. ⁹⁵² The trees are full of the best fragrant fruits from all the seasons. They are radiant with flowers from all the seasons. The calls of many auspicious birds bring delight to the mind. Their intoxicated, loud and extremely melodious tones are pleasant to the ears. The sounds that come out of the mouths of birds are agreeable to the mind. The soft calls are also pleasant to the ears and cause delight. There are *chakoras, shatapatras, bhringarajas, kokilas, kalavinkas, haritas, jivajivakas, priyaputras, chatakas* and others with melodious voices. There are forests and clumps of *ketaki, atimukta, kubjaka, malati, kunda, bana,* black and other *karavira, jambira, aruna, kankola, dadima, bijapuraka, matulunga,* puga fruit, *hintala,* groves of plantain and other diverse trees filled with different kinds of agreeable flowers. ⁹⁵³ Creepers and lantanas are like canopies and there are many kinds of water bodies. There are long ponds, lakes, ponds full of lotuses and wells. There are many sacred water bodies, decorated with clumps of lotuses. There are ponds full of clear water and they bring joy to the mind, filled with water lilies, white lotuses, auspicious blue lotuses, white water lilies and other kinds of lotuses everywhere. There are *kadambas, chakravakas* and aquatic birds, *karandavas, plavas, hamsas, datyahas, sarasas, koyashtis, madgus* and *bakas.* ⁹⁵⁴ The water bodies are decorated with fish and tortoises. There are many other aquatic birds that call in every direction. Some fly in the sky, others swim in the water. There are flowers that grow in the water. There are many kinds of trees with flowers, some on the land, others growing in the water. The place is ornamented with elephants—terrestrial and those that roam in the water. It is ornamented with the *varnas* following their own *dharma*—those in *brahmacharya, garhasthya, vanaprastha, sannyasa* ⁹⁵⁵ and others. It is full of healthy and happy men and women. There are many houses of learning, sources of *dharma* with all the qualities. In this way, this

extremely rare *kshetra* possesses all the attributes. O best among sages! The famous Purushottama ⁹⁵⁶ resides there. Because of the favours of Krishna, the region of Utkala, right up to its boundaries, is famous and is the most sacred spot. Purushottama, the *atman* of the universe, resides there. He pervades the universe. He is the protector of the universe. Everything is established in him. O best among sages! We always dwell in that region—I, Rudra, Shakra and the gods, with Agni at the forefront. All the *gandharvas*, *apsaras*, gods, humans, *yakshas*, *vidyadharas*, *siddhas*, sages who are firm in their vows, *rishis*, *valakhilyas*, Kashyapa and the other lords of subjects, *suparnas*, ⁹⁵⁷ *kinnaras*, *nagas*, other residents of heaven, the four Vedas and their Vedangas, many kinds of sacred texts, *itihasa*, *puranas*, sacrifices with excellent *dakshina*, all the different rivers, sacred *tirthas* and temples, oceans and mountains are established in that region. This is the most sacred of spots, frequented by gods, *rishis* and ancestors. All the objects of pleasure are there. Who will not find it agreeable to dwell there? Which other region can be superior to it in qualities? The god Purushottama, the one who grants emancipation, is himself there. Men who live in Utkala are fortunate and are spoken of as gods. Mortals who bathe in the waters of the king among *tirthas* see Purushottama reside in heaven and do not go to Yama's abode. Those who live in Utkala and in Purushottama's auspicious *kshetra* have successful lives. Krishna is the best among the gods. His face is pleasant, with large eyes. His eyebrows, hair and diadem are beautiful. The ornaments in his ears are beautiful. His smile is beautiful, his teeth are beautiful. He is ornamented with beautiful earrings. His nose is excellent, his cheeks are excellent, and his forehead is excellent. He possesses all the excellent attributes. His face is like a lotus and he brings delight to the three worlds. Those who reside in Utkala and see him, are extremely intelligent.'

Chapter 1(41) (Description of Avantika)

Brahma said, ‘O *brahmanas*! In ancient times, in *krita yuga*, there was a prosperous king who was like Indra in his valour. He was known by the name of Indradyumna. He was truthful in speech, pure, accomplished and supreme among all those who wielded every kind of weapon. He was brave, handsome and extremely fortunate. He enjoyed objects of pleasure and was generous in giving. He was pleasant in speech. He performed all the sacrifices. He was devoted to *brahmanas* and to the truth. He was accomplished and learned in *dhanurveda*, the Vedas and the sacred texts. He was loved by men and women. He was like the moon on the night of a full moon. He was impossible to behold, like Aditya. Hordes of enemies found him to be terrible. He was devoted to Vishnu and was full of *sattva*. He had conquered anger. He had conquered his senses. He was devoted to the knowledge of *adhyatma*. He was devoted to the *dharma* of emancipation. The king was a store of all the qualities, and he ruled over the earth in this way. His mind turned to the subject of worshipping Hari. ‘How will I worship Janardana, god of the gods? In which *kshetra*, *tirtha*, bank of a river or hermitage?’ With this thought in his mind, he considered all the spots on earth. He considered all the ancient *tirthas* and *kshetras*. Having thought about all these in his mind, he again thought of Purushottama’s supreme and famous *tirtha*, the one that grants emancipation. With his many forces and mounts, the king went there. He performed a horse sacrifice where many kinds of expensive *dakshina* were given. After this, he had a large and famous mansion constructed there and in that, the valiant one instated Samkarshana,⁹⁵⁸ Krishna and Subhadra. Following the norms, the lord of the earth established five *tirthas* there—for bathing, donating, austerities, offering oblations and beholding the gods.⁹⁵⁹ Full of devotion,

he followed the ordinances and worshipped Purushottama every day. When the god of the gods was pleased, he attained emancipation. O *brahmanas*! If one sees Markandeya, the *vata* tree, Krishna and Rama, and bathes in the Indradyumna tank, there is no doubt that one attains emancipation.’ ⁹⁶⁰

The sages asked, ‘Earlier, why did Indradyumna, lord of the earth, go to Purushottama’s supreme *kshetra*, which grants emancipation? O best among the gods! Having gone there, as instructed, how did he worship Purushottama through a horse sacrifice? That rare *kshetra* grants all the fruits. How did he manage to construct an excellent mansion that is famous in the three worlds? O Prajapati! How did that tiger among kings construct images of Krishna, Rama and Subhadra, marked with all the auspicious signs? How did that intelligent lord of the earth instate them in the mansion, the supreme residence of Krishna that is worshipped by the gods? O best among the gods! You should tell us the truth about this in detail. Tell us everything about the intelligent one’s conduct. Your words are like *amrita* and we are not yet satisfied. We have great curiosity and we wish to hear about this.’

Brahma replied, ‘O best among *brahmanas*! This is praiseworthy. You have asked me about an ancient, sacred and auspicious account that destroys all sins. It grants objects of pleasure and emancipation. I will tell you about his conduct. This happened in *krita* yuga. O tigers among sages! Control your senses and listen attentively. There is a city named Avanti ⁹⁶¹ in the Malava region and it is famous on earth. It was a supreme place on earth and he used to be the king there. The city had firm walls and ramparts and was full of happy and healthy people. There were firm bolts on the gates and it was ornamented with moats. The place was full of many kinds of merchants and their excellent vessels had objects for sale. The beautiful roads were lined with shops, and triangular and quadrangular parks. There were mansions with many storeys and the city was properly divided with crossroads. There were homes, turrets and walls and the avenues were decorated. It was ornamented with hundreds and thousands of white and wonderful mansions that resembled the necks of swans. There were the joyous sounds of sacrifices and festivities, singing and the playing of

musical instruments. It was decorated with flags and standards of many colours. It was full of large numbers of elephants, horses, chariots and foot-soldiers, with many kinds of warriors. O best among sages! There were many prosperous habitations, ornamented with learned *dvijas*,⁹⁶² *brahmanas*, *kshatriyas*, *vaishyas* and *shudras*. There was no one who was filthy there, no one who was foolish or weak. There was no one who was diseased or maimed in a limb. There was no one who was addicted to gambling. The men and the women who could be seen there were always extremely happy in their minds. Cheerful, they separately sported, day and night. The men who were seen there wore excellent garments and polished earrings. They were handsome in form and excellent in qualities. They were adorned with divine ornaments. They possessed all the auspicious signs and resembled the god of love. Their hair was excellent. Their cheeks were excellent. Their faces were excellent and they sported beards. They knew all the sacred texts and could shatter the armies of enemies. They were generous in gifting all the jewels. They enjoyed every kind of prosperity. O best among sages! Extremely beautiful women could be seen there. Their gait was like that of swans or elephants. Their eyes extended all the way up to their ears. They were slender-waisted and possessed beautiful hips. Their breasts were heavy and upright. Their teeth were excellent and their faces were charming. Their cheeks were excellent and their hair did not move.⁹⁶³ Their teeth were like flashes of lightning. Their faces were like the full moon. In accordance with the sentiment expressed, they bent their necks. They were adorned with earrings. Their lips were like the *bimba* fruit. Their shining mouths were tinged with betel leaves. They were adorned with every kind of gold ornament. They were dark, with excellent loins. The sounds of girdles and anklets could be heard. They were adorned with divine garlands and garments. They were smeared with divine unguents. They were learned, with beautiful faces. They were charming to behold and attractive in all their limbs. All of them possessed youth and charm and had smiling faces. They sported in the assembly halls and quadrangles, mad and intoxicated. The women amused themselves through singing, conversation and the playing of musical instruments. Courtesans could be seen,

accomplished in singing and dancing. They were skilled in sidelong glances and conversation. The place was full of all kinds of women. Other noble women could be seen there, possessing excellent qualities. Those extremely fortunate ones were devoted to their husbands and were ornamented with all the qualities.’

‘There were forests and groves, sacred and pleasant gardens. There were temples to the gods, decorated with many kinds of divine flowers—*shala*, *tala*, *tamala*, *bakula*, *nagakesara*, *pippala*, *karnikara*, *chandana*, *aguru*, *champaka*, *punnaga*, *narikela*, *panasa*, *sarala* trees, *naranga*, *lakucha*, *lodhra*, *saptaparna*, *shubhanjana*, *chuta*, *bilva*, *kadamba*, *shimshapa*, *dhava*, *khadira*, *patala*, *ashoka*, *tagara*, dark and other kinds of *karavira*, yellow *arjuna*, *bhalla*,⁹⁶⁴ *siddha*, *amrataka*, *nyagrodha*, *ashvattha*, *kashmira*,⁹⁶⁵ *palasha*, *devadaru*, *mandara*, *parijata*, *tintidika*,⁹⁶⁶ *vibhitaka*, old *amalaka* trees, *plaksha*, *jambu*, *shirisha* trees, *kaleya*,⁹⁶⁷ *kanchanara*,⁹⁶⁸ *madhu*,⁹⁶⁹ *jambira*, *tinduka*, *kharjura*, *agastya*,⁹⁷⁰ *bakula*, *shakhotaka*,⁹⁷¹ *haritaka*,⁹⁷² *kankola*, *muchukunda*, *hintala*, *bijapuraka*, clumps of *ketaki* groves, *atimukta*, *kubjaka*, *mallika*, *kunda*, *bana*, clumps of plantain, *matulunga*, *puga* fruit, *karuna*,⁹⁷³ *sindhuvaraka*,⁹⁷⁴ *bahuvara*,⁹⁷⁵ *kovidara*, *badari*,⁹⁷⁶ *karanjaka*⁹⁷⁷ and many other kinds of beautiful and blossoming trees. There were canopies of creepers and shrubs, and gardens that were like Nandana. There was the constant fragrance of excellent flowers and the trees always bent down with the burden of fruit. It was surrounded with many kinds of animals and there were the beautiful sounds of many kinds of birds—*chakora*, *shatapatra*, *bhringara*,⁹⁷⁸ *priyaputra*, *kalavinka*, *mayura*, *shuka*,⁹⁷⁹ *kokila*, *kapota*,⁹⁸⁰ *khanjarita*,⁹⁸¹ *shyena*,⁹⁸² *paravata*⁹⁸³ and many other types of birds. Those calls were beautiful and agreeable to the ear. There were a large number of rivers, ponds and lakes. There were many other sacred bodies of water, decorated with water lilies, blue lotuses, dark lotuses and beautiful and fragrant white lotuses. There were many other types of extremely beautiful flowers growing in the water. The divine fragrances were intoxicating. It was radiant with flowers everywhere. The place was full of *hamsas*, *karandavas*, *chakravakas*, *sarasas*, *kadambas*, *plavas* and aquatic birds. There were tortoises, fish, crocodiles and others

that swam in the water with their feet. There were the sounds of many other types of aquatic birds. They had diverse hues. They were there in every direction and it cheered the mind. There were diverse kinds of flowers in the water bodies. There were many kinds of trees in the diverse sacred gardens. There were birds in the water and on land. That divine city was decorated with divine temples to the gods.'

'The illustrious and three-eyed god, the destroyer of Tripura, resides there. This is Shiva, who grants everything that one desires. He is famous there as Mahakala. A man should follow the norms and bathe in Shiva's *kunda*, which destroys all sins. He should follow the norms and satisfy the gods, *rishis* and ancestors. After this, he should go to Shiva's temple and perform *pradakshina* thrice. He should control himself, control his senses and wearing a washed garment, enter. He must devotedly worship Shankara through bathing, ⁹⁸⁴ flowers, fragrances, incense, lamps, food, gifts, singing, the playing of musical instruments, *pradakshina*, prostrating on the ground like a rod, dancing and hymns of praise. If a man follows the norms and devotedly worships Mahakala Shiva, he obtains the fruits of one thousand horse sacrifices. He is cleansed of all sins. He ascends a *vimana* that has all the objects of desire and goes to Shambhu's abode in heaven. He assumes a celestial and handsome form, adorned with divine ornaments. Until the deluge arrives, he enjoys all the objects of pleasure there. O best among sages! In Shiva's world, there is no old age or death. When his store of good merits is exhausted, he is reborn on earth in an excellent brahmana family. He becomes a brahmana who knows the four Vedas and is accomplished in all the sacred texts. United with *pashupata* yoga, he obtains emancipation. There is a sacred river there, known by the name of Kshipra. An excellent man who bathes there and following the norms, satisfies the gods and the ancestors, is cleansed of all sins. Astride an excellent *vimana*, he goes to the world of heaven, where he enjoys all kinds of objects of pleasure. The illustrious god of the gods, Janardana, also resides there. Hari bestows the objects of pleasure and emancipation and his name there is Govindasvami. Having seen him there, a person frees twenty-one generations of his family. He mounts a *vimana* that has the complexion of the sun and is decorated

with garlands of bells. This is endowed with all the objects of pleasure and can go or stay, as one wishes. Astride this, praised by the *gandharvas*, he goes to Vishnu's world and obtains greatness there. He enjoys all the varied objects of pleasure there and is freed from all fear and anxiety. Until the deluge arrives, he is extremely fortunate, handsome and happy. In the course of time, he will subsequently be born as a brahmana on earth, in a house that has excellent yogis. He will know the true purport of the Vedas and the sacred texts. Resorting to *vaishnava* yoga, he will obtain emancipation. O *brahmanas*! To obtain the fruits that have been mentioned earlier, a man or a woman should also go and see Vishnu there, present under the name of Vikramasvami. With Shakra as the foremost, other gods also reside there. O best among sages! There are the *matris*,⁹⁸⁵ who bestow all the fruits that one wishes for. If one follows the norms, devotedly worships them and prostrates himself before them, he is freed from all sins and goes to heaven. Such was that beautiful city, protected by the lion among kings. Like Indra's Amaravati, it constantly rejoiced with festivities. The city was laid out extremely well, with eighteen extensive squares. There was the sound of bows being twanged and it was adorned with assemblies of virtuous people. There were large numbers of learned people and there was the loud sound of the Vedas being chanted. O *brahmanas*! Day and night, recitals of *itihasa*, purana, many sacred texts, *kavya*⁹⁸⁶ and conversations on these could be heard. I have thus spoken about the excellent qualities of Avanti. Earlier, the immensely intelligent Indradyumna used to be the king there.'

Chapter 1(42) (Visiting the *kshetras*)

Brahma said, ‘Earlier, the king used to rule over that excellent kingdom. The intelligent one protected his subjects like a father protecting his sons. He was truthful in speech and immensely wise. He was brave and a reservoir of all the qualities. He was learned and full of *dharma*. He was supreme among all those who wielded weapons. He was truthful, good in conduct and generous. He was prosperous and victorious over enemy cities. He was like Aditya in his energy, like the two Ashvins in his beauty and like Shakra in his valour. He was endowed with qualities that increased. He was as radiant as the autumn moon. He was ornamented with all the auspicious signs. He accumulated objects and performed all the sacrifices, the horse sacrifice and others. In donations, sacrifices and austerities, the king had no equal. From one sacrifice to another sacrifice, the lord of the earth gave the best of *brahmanas* large quantities of wealth, gold, jewels, pearls, elephants and horses. There was no end to his possession of elephants, horses, excellent chariots, blankets, black antelope skins, garments, jewels, wealth and grain. He possessed all the different kinds of wealth and was ornamented with all the excellent qualities. He was prosperous with all the objects of desire. In this way, he ruled over that supreme kingdom.

His mind turned towards Hari, the lord of all kinds of yoga. ‘How will I worship the lord who grants objects of pleasure and emancipation?’ He thought in detail about all the sacred texts and *agama* texts, *itihasa*, *purana*, all the *Vedangas*, all the *dharmashastras*, the *niyama* that rishis had spoken about, the texts that are ancillaries to the Vedas, and all the texts that spoke about knowledge. He carefully served his gurus and *brahmanas* who were accomplished in the Vedas. He achieved the ultimate limit of knowledge and became successful. He learnt the supreme and undecaying truth, known

as Vasudeva. Having passed beyond false learning, he controlled his senses and wished to be emancipated. 'How will I worship the eternal god of the gods? He is four-armed and is attired in yellow garments. He wields a conch shell, a *chakra* and a mace. His chest is covered with a garland of wildflowers. His large eyes are like the petals of lotuses. His chest bears the *shrivatsa* mark.⁹⁸⁷ He is adorned with a diadem and armlets.' The lord of the earth left his own city of Ujjayini. There was a large army with him, with servants and the priest. All the charioteers followed him with weapons in their hands. The chariots were like *vimanas*, decorated with flags and standards. All the horse-riders had javelins and iron clubs in their hands. The horses were as swift as the wind and followed the king. The elephants had originated in the Himalayas and were like mountains. Their tusks were like the shafts of ploughs and they were always in musth. They were sixty years old. They had golden harnesses and were decorated with flags and bells that made a sound. All of them were skilled in ensuring victory in battles and they followed him. There were innumerable foot-soldiers, with javelins and swords in their hands. They wore divine garlands and garments. They were smeared with divine fragrances. All of them were young, with polished earrings, and they followed him. All of them were brave and skilled in the use of all weapons. They were always eager to fight. All the women who resided in the inner quarters were ornamented. They possessed youth and beauty, and were adorned with all the ornaments. All of them wore divine garments and were decorated with divine garlands. Their limbs were smeared with divine fragrances and their faces were like the autumn moon. They were slender-waisted, attired in beautiful garments. The locks of hair made their hair look beautiful. Their lips were like *bimba* fruit and their teeth were beautiful. Their eyes were as large as lotus petals. Their mouths were tinged with betel leaves and the guards protected them properly. There were superior and inferior vehicles, decorated with sparkling jewels and gold. All the bards sang and minstrels chanted praise. They followed the king, surrounded by those with weapons in their hands. There were courtesans who were beautiful in all their limbs, decorated with many kinds of ornaments. They were extremely beautiful and extremely

fortunate. They were beautiful and possessed all the feminine qualities. All of them were in many kinds of vehicles, decorated with all the different kinds of ornaments. This entire retinue surrounded the king and followed him. There were *brahmanas* who knew the Vedas and the Vedangas and were conversant with the purport of many sacred texts. There were *kshatriyas* and *vaishyas*. There were the eight different kinds of shudras.⁹⁸⁸ There were goldsmiths, ironsmiths, those who crushed stones, jewellers, potters, those who worked in leather, cooks, shopkeepers, those who worked in cane, artisans who made covers, barbers, those who worked with gourds,⁹⁸⁹ those who made arrows, those who were self-employed,⁹⁹⁰ goldsmiths,⁹⁹¹ sword-makers, those who prepared oblations, bearers, those who made sweetmeats, those who sold water, garland-makers, those who determined auspicious days,⁹⁹² those who sold everything, all the traders who resided in villages, all the traders who resided in cities, those who sold weapons, those who earned a living by selling betel leaf, the sellers of grass, the sellers of wood, those who made a living from the stage, meat-sellers, sellers of oil, garment-sellers, fruit-sellers, leaf-sellers, those who gathered fodder, thousands of washermen, cowherds, barbers,⁹⁹³ tailors, shepherds, those who herded goats, those who looked after deer, those who looked after swans, those who sold paddy, *saktu*⁹⁹⁴ sellers, sellers of molasses, those who earned a living from salt, singers, dancers, those who chanted auspicious songs, actors, raconteurs, those accomplished in the *puranas*, poets, those who had *kavya* composed, those accomplished in many kinds of *kavya*, those who countered poison, *garudas*,⁹⁹⁵ those who tested many kinds of jewels, those who worked with bellows,⁹⁹⁶ those who worked with copper, those who worked with bell-metal, *ruthakas*,⁹⁹⁷ makers of scabbards, painters, those who turned lathes, those who purified, the makers of rods, the makers of swords, those who earned a living from liquor and gambling, wrestlers, messengers, *kayasthas*,⁹⁹⁸ other kinds of artisans, weavers, beauticians, those who made wicks and oil for lamps, those who caught quails, those who caught partridges, those who earned a living from animals and birds, those who treated elephants, those who treated horses, those who treated men, those who treated trees, those who

treated cattle and those who were skilled in slashing and burning. There were other citizens who have not been mentioned. Along with their wealth, jewels, gold, wives and companions, all the residents of the city followed the king. In a village, when the father departs for another village, all the sons eagerly follow him. Like that, the citizens followed him and the prosperous king was surrounded by a large number of people. The elephants, horses, chariots and foot-soldiers advanced slowly.

‘In this way, after a long period of time, the lord, the king, reached the shores of the southern ocean, followed by his army. He saw the ocean there and it seemed to be dancing. It was turbulent because of hundreds of thousands of waves. It was the store of many kinds of jewels and was full of many kinds of creatures. It was full of great wonders and there were many billows and waves. It was the king of all *tirthas*. It roared loudly and the other shore could not be seen. It was extremely terrible. It was fathomless, resembling a large mass of clouds. It was the abode of *makaras*. This ocean of salt waters was full of fish, tortoises, conch shells, oysters, crocodiles, skate-fish, porpoises, crabs and extremely virulent snakes. It was the lord of the rivers and was the place where Hari lies down. It was sacred and destroyed all sins. It conferred all the fruits that one desired. There were many deep eddies that *danavas* resided in. It was the origin of the divine *amrita*. It was the lord of the waters and the source of the gods. Among everything that sustains the breath of life in creatures, it was the most special. Among everything sacred, it was the most sacred. Among everything auspicious, it was the most auspicious. It was the supreme *tirtha*. It was an undecaying *tirtha* that was the lord of all aquatic creatures. The foundation for measuring the waxing and waning of the moon is based on it. No creature could penetrate it. It was the store of the *amrita* of the gods. It was the eternal cause behind creation, preservation and destruction. It was the sacred source of life for everyone. It was the lord of the male and female rivers. On seeing it, the best among kings was filled with great wonder. Having reached the shores of the ocean, he set up a residence there, in that sacred and lovely region, where the ground possesses all the qualities. It was surrounded by *shala*, *kadamba*, *punnaga*, *sarala* trees,

panasa, narikela, bakula, nagakeshara, kharjura, pippala, tala, naranga, bijapuraka, shala, ⁹⁹⁹ *amrataka, lodhra, bakula,* ¹⁰⁰⁰ *bahuvaraka, kapittha, karnikara, patala, ashoka, champaka, dadima, tamala, parijata, arjuna, prachinamalaka,* ¹⁰⁰¹ *bilva, priyangu, vata, khadira, inguda,* ¹⁰⁰² *saptaparna, ashvattha, agastya, jambuka, madhuka, karnikara, bahuvara, tinduka, palasha, badari, nipa, siddha, nimba, shubhanjana, varaka,* ¹⁰⁰³ *kovidara, bhalla, amalaka, tala,* ¹⁰⁰⁴ *hintala, kankola, karanja, vibhitaka, sarja, madhuka,* ¹⁰⁰⁵ *kashmira, shalmali, devadaru, shakhotaka, nimbavata,* ¹⁰⁰⁶ *kumbhi,* ¹⁰⁰⁷ *koshtha,* ¹⁰⁰⁸ *haritaka, guggula, chandana trees, aguru, patala,* ¹⁰⁰⁹ *jambira, karuna trees, tintidika, red chandana and many other kinds of trees. There were trees that always granted every object of desire. They were full of flowers and fruits from all the seasons. There were the divine sounds of many intoxicated birds calling—kokilas, large numbers of mayuras, shukas, sarikas,* ¹⁰¹⁰ *haritas, bhringarajas, chatakas, bahuputras,* ¹⁰¹¹ *jivajivakas, kakolas,* ¹⁰¹² *kalavinkas, kapotas and many other birds that called in tones that were pleasant to the ear. They called, perched atop the tops of blossoming trees. There were clumps of ketaki, always full of white flowers. There were mallika and kunda flowers, yuthika,* ¹⁰¹³ *tagara, kutaja,* ¹⁰¹⁴ *bana flowers, atimukta, kubjaka, malati, karavira, golden plantain and many other kinds of flowers. They were very fragrant and beautiful to behold. There were forests, groves and gardens of many colours, extremely fragrant. They were full of large numbers of vidyadharas, frequented by siddhas, charanas, gandharvas, uragas, rakshasas, bhutas, apsaras, kinnaras, sages, large numbers of yakshas and many other kinds of creatures. The place was full of deer, monkeys, lions, boar and buffaloes. There were many other kinds of animals, like black antelopes. There were tigers, crazy elephants and others that roamed around in the forest. There were many kinds of trees in gardens that were like Nandana. There were canopies of creepers and shrubs and different types of water bodies, full of hamsas, karandavas, kadambas, plavas and chakravakas. Clumps of lotuses decorated the place. There were lotuses, lotuses with a hundred petals, water lilies, white lotuses and blue lotuses. There were other kinds of aquatic birds and flowers that grew in water and in the ocean. There were*

mountains with blazing summits, ornamented by beautiful valleys. They were covered with many kinds of trees and decorated with diverse kinds of ores. The auspicious summits were wonderful and were the abodes of many kinds of creatures. There were all the different herbs and the extensive peaks were colourful. The place was decorated in all these wonderful ways and was very pleasant to the mind. The king saw the region that was worshipped by the three worlds. It was ten *yojanas* in length and five *yojanas* wide. This *kshetra* was extremely rare and was full of great wonders.'

Chapter 1(43) (Earlier accounts)

The sages asked, ‘This was Purushottama’s sacred and excellent Vaishnava *kshetra*. O lord! Why had an image of Vishnu not been established there earlier? O one who grants everything auspicious! Having gone there with his army and his mounts, why did the king have to establish Krishna, Rama and Bhadra ¹⁰¹⁵ there? O lord of the universe! We have a great doubt about this and are surprised. We wish to hear the reason for this. Please tell us.’

Brahma replied, ‘Listen. I will tell you what happened earlier. This account destroys sins. I will tell you briefly. Earlier, Shri asked Hari about this. The golden summit of Sumeru ¹⁰¹⁶ is full of all kinds of wonders. It is beautiful and populated by *siddhas*, *vidyadharas*, *yakshas*, *kinnnaras*, gods, *danavas*, *gandharvas*, *nagas*, several *apsaras*, sages, *guhyakas*, *souparnas* ¹⁰¹⁷ and all the categories of Maruts. There are the abodes of many other gods, the Sadhyas, Kashyapa and the other lords of subjects, and *valakhilyas*, and others. It is lovely and extremely agreeable. There are divine *karnikara* blossoms everywhere, resembling gold in complexion and as radiant as the sun. There are many other kinds of trees—forests of *shala*, *tala*, *punnaga*, *ashoka*, *sarala*, *nyagrodha*, *amrataka*, *arjuna*, *parijata*, *amra*, *khadira*, *nipa*, *bilva*, *kadamba*, *dhava*, *khadira*, ¹⁰¹⁸ *palasha*, *shirshamala*, ¹⁰¹⁹ *tinduka*, *naranga*, *kola*, ¹⁰²⁰ *bakula*, *lodhra*, *dadima* trees, *sarja*, *karna*, ¹⁰²¹ *tagara*, *shishibhurja* ¹⁰²² and *nimba*. There were many other golden trees, which bent down because of the burden of the fruit. The gods and many kinds of excellent and fragrant flowers decorated the place—*malati*, *yuthika*, *mallika*, *kunda*, *bana*, *kuruntaka*, ¹⁰²³ *karavira*, *gupta*, ¹⁰²⁴ *ketaki*, *kubjaka*, *kimshuka*, *patala*, *agastya*, *kutaja* and *mandara* flowers. There were many other kinds of flowers that brought pleasure to the mind.

There were large numbers of different types of birds that called in melodious voices. Male cuckoos called, and there were the divine calls of intoxicated peacocks. There were many different kinds of trees, many different kinds of flowers and many different kinds of birds. It was a beautiful place, frequented by the gods. Jagannatha,¹⁰²⁵ the undecaying creator of the universe, was there. The one who ordains the worlds and is known by the name of the undecaying Vasudeva was there. For the sake of the welfare of the worlds, the goddess who was born from the lotus bowed her head down and asked the excellent one a great question. Shri said, ‘O lord of all the worlds! There is a doubt in my heart. Please tell me about it. The world of the mortals is an extremely wonderful *karma bhumi* and is extremely rare. It is a great ocean where one is seized by crocodiles like greed, confusion, desire and anger. O lord of the gods! I am bowing down before you. O lord of all the gods! How can one be liberated from this ocean of *samsara*? If it pleases you, please clear up this doubt. Other than you, there is no one who can answer.’ Janardana, god of the gods, heard her words and was greatly pleased. He spoke about the great essence and it was like *amrita*.’

The illustrious one said, ‘O goddess! The famous Purushottama is established in a supreme *tirtha*. He is easily worshipped. He can be easily reached and the charming one confers extremely great fruits. In the three worlds, there is no one who is his equal. By chanting about this god, one is freed from all sins. O one with the beautiful face! The immortals do not know about this place, nor do the *daityas* and the *danavas*. I have also kept it secret from the excellent sages, Marichi and the others. I will now tell you about this king among *tirthas*. O one with the excellent hips! O one with the excellent face! Listen with single-minded attention. When the earlier *kalpa* ended, all the mobile and immobile objects were destroyed. The gods, the *gandharvas*, the *daityas*, the *vidyadharas* and the *uragas* were destroyed. Everything was immersed in darkness and nothing could be discerned. The only one who was awake was the *paramatman* who is in the atmans of all beings, the preceptor of the universe. He is the prosperous one who created the three forms of the god,¹⁰²⁶ the creator of the universe¹⁰²⁷ and

Maheshvara. He is the lord Hari, famous as Vasudeva. He has yoga in his *atman*. When the slumber of his yoga was over, he created a lotus from his navel and the undecaying Brahma was created from the centre, which resembled the filament of a lotus. Brahma, the great lord of all the worlds, manifested himself in this fashion. Gradually, he created the five elements. The measures and origins of the gross elements were based on the subtle elements. Prajapati Brahma created mobile and immobile objects, and the four kinds of beings. ¹⁰²⁸ Having thought about it in his mind, he created many kinds of subjects. There were Marichi and all the other sages, *gandharvas*, *uragas* and *rakshasas*. There were the fourteen worlds, the seven including heaven, and the nether regions. He created *dvipas*, oceans, and Ganga and other rivers. He created *yakshas*, *vidyadharas* and others. ¹⁰²⁹ O goddess! He created men, *vanaras*, ¹⁰³⁰ many kinds of birds, those born from wombs, those born from eggs, those born from sweat, and trees, and plants. He created the four categories of brahmana, *kshatriya*, *vaishya* and shudra, and also the other categories of *antyaja* and *mleccha*. ¹⁰³¹ Brahma created everything in the universe that is described as living, grass, creeper or ant. He created mobile and immobile objects. Having thought about it, he created a man from the right side of his body and a woman from the left side. Thus, he created two types of beings. Since then, subjects have been born in the world through sexual intercourse. Having thought about it, in those ancient times, the god who originated in the water created superior, middling and inferior *kshetras*. He then meditated on Vasudeva's body. As soon as he had been meditated upon, at that very instant, Janardana manifested himself. He had one thousand eyes, one thousand feet and one thousand heads. He was the being with eyes like lotuses. His body had the complexion of clouds filled with water and his handsome form bore the *shrivatsa* mark. Brahma, the grandfather of the worlds, suddenly saw him. He honoured him with a seat, *arghya*, *padya* and *askhata*. ¹⁰³² Virinchi ¹⁰³³ controlled himself properly and praised him with an excellent hymn. At this, I spoke to God Brahma, who had been born from the lotus. 'O son! ¹⁰³⁴ You have been meditating on me now. Tell me the reason for this.' Brahma replied, 'O lord of the gods! In the world of mortals, there are paths that act

as roads to heaven—sacrifices, donations, vows, yoga, truth, austerities, faith and many kinds of *tirthas*. But these are extremely difficult to achieve. For the welfare of the world, with the exception of these, please tell me about something that can be achieved easily. O lord of the universe! Tell me about the best spot. O Purushottama! Tell me about the most excellent place.’ O beloved one! Hearing Vidhatri’s words, I spoke to him. ‘O Brahma! Listen. There is an extremely rare and sparkling place on earth. It is blessed and supreme among all *kshetras* and helps to cross *samsara*. It is sacred and ensures the welfare of cattle and *brahmanas*. It brings happiness to the four *varnas*. This is an extremely beautiful *kshetra* that confers objects of pleasure and emancipation on men. O great grandfather! It proves to be extremely auspicious for all those who reside there. This is the eternal king of *tirthas* and is a famous and supreme *kshetra* that originated there. In the four yugas, all the gods, *rishis*, *brahmacharis*, *daityas*, *danavas*, *siddhas*, *gandharvas*, *uragas*, *rakshasas*, *nagas*, *vidyadharas* and mobile and immobile objects resort to it. Since the excellent Purusha is there, it is known as Purushottama. ¹⁰³⁵ This is an extremely rare *kshetra* that is there on the shores of the southern ocean. It is ten *yojanas* in expanse and a *nyagrodha* tree stands there. When the end of the *kalpa* arrives and all the worlds are destroyed, the tree is not destroyed. It remains in that place. If one sees that fig tree and comes under the cover of its shadow, one is freed from the sin of killing a brahmana, not to speak of other sins. If creatures perform *pradakshina* around it and bow down to it, all their sins are cleansed and they go to Keshava’s abode. The spot that is to the south of the *nyagrodha* and slightly north of Keshava is a supreme place that is full of dharma and there is a palace there. The image that is there has been constructed by the divinity himself. Men who see it go easily to my world.’

‘O beloved one! Once, Dharmaraja ¹⁰³⁶ went there and saw it. He came to my presence, bowed his head down and spoke to me. Yama said, ‘O illustrious god! O protector of the worlds! O lord of the universe! I bow down to you. O god who resides in the ocean of milk! O one who lies down on the serpent known as Shesha! You are supreme among all those who bestow boons. You are the one who should be worshipped. You are the lord

and creator and you have not been created. O lord of the universe! O one without birth! O Vishnu! You are omniscient and are never vanquished. Your complexion is like that of a blue lotus. Your eyes are like lotus petals. You know everything. You are devoid of *gunas*. You are serene. You are the undecaying creator of the universe. You are the creator of all the worlds. You bring happiness to all the worlds. You are the ancient Purusha. You are the one who should be known. You are manifest and you are not manifest. You are eternal. You are the creator of everything superior and inferior. You are the protector of the worlds. You are the preceptor of the universe. Your chest has the *shrivatsa* mark. You are adorned in a garland of wildflowers. You wear yellow garments. You possess four arms. You hold a conch shell, a *chakra* and a mace. You wear necklaces, bracelets, a diadem and armlets. You possess all the auspicious signs. You are devoid of all the senses. You are deep and immobile. You are subtle. Your form is full of radiance. You are eternal. You are beyond existence and non-existence. You pervade everything. You are beyond Prakriti. O protector of the worlds! O lord! O one who bestows bliss! O lord! I bow down to you.’ In those ancient times, near the *nyagrodha* tree, Dharmaraja praised me, with many kinds of hymns and prostrated himself. O immensely fortunate one! I saw him standing there, bowed down, his hands joined in salutation. O goddess! I asked Death about the reason for this praise. ‘O Vaivasvata! O mighty-armed one! You are supreme among all the gods. Why are you praising me? Tell me briefly.’ Dharmaraja replied, ‘In this sacred and famous shrine of Purushottama, there is an excellent image that is completely made out of sapphire. ¹⁰³⁷ O Pundarikaksha! ¹⁰³⁸ It grants all the objects of desire. On seeing it, I was filled with devotion. Devoid of desire, if men see it, they go to the region known as Shveta. ¹⁰³⁹ O destroyer of enemies! Hence, I am unable to go about my work. ¹⁰⁴⁰ O extremely great god! O lord! Therefore, show me your favours and withdraw this image.’ Hearing Vaivasvata’s words, I replied to him. ‘O Yama! In every direction, I will hide it in sand. O goddess! I thus hid the image inside the earth, so that men who desired to go to heaven would no longer be able to see it. O goddess! I hid it inside the

ground and covered it up with a golden spread. ¹⁰⁴¹ After this, I asked Yama to leave for his own city in the southern direction.'

Brahma continued, 'O *brahmanas*! O Indras among *brahmanas*! In that supreme, sacred and famous *kshetra* of Purushottama, the image made out of sapphire disappeared in this way. O *brahmanas*! The illustrious Janardana, god of the gods, recounted everything that had happened in those ancient times to the illustrious one ¹⁰⁴²—Indradyumna's departure; his seeing the *kshetra*; the description of the *kshetra*; the building of the palace; the horse sacrifice; the vision in his dream; his seeing the wood on the shores of the salty ocean; his sight of Vasudeva, king among artisans; the making of the image, in particular, the colours; the instatement in a palace that was supreme in the world; the chanting about the *kalpa* at the time of the procession; ¹⁰⁴³ Markandeya's conduct; the instatement of Shankara; the greatness of the five *tirthas*; the sight of the one who holds a trident in his hand; the sight of the fig tree and its beneficial consequences; in particular, the sight of Baladeva, Krishna and Subhadra; the general greatness; the sight of Narasimha and chanting about the beneficial consequences; chanting about the auspicious sight of Ananta Vasudeva; the greatness of Shvetamadhava; the vision of the gate to heaven; the sight of the ocean and bathing and water rites there; the greatness of Indradyumna's bath in the ocean; the fruits of the five *tirthas* and Mahajyeshtha; ¹⁰⁴⁴ the abodes of Krishna and the wielder of the plough; ¹⁰⁴⁵ the fruits of all the processions; the description of Vishnu's world; and a description of the *kshetra* yet again. Purushottama told her all this.'

Chapter 1(44) (Description of *kshetras*)

The sages asked, ‘O god! What else did the lord of the earth do? We wish to hear the rest of the account. Having gone to that supreme *kshetra*, what did the lord of men do?’

Brahma replied, ‘O tigers among sages! Listen. I will tell you what the lord of the earth did after going there and seeing the *kshetra*. The lord of the earth went to the *kshetra* that is famous in the three worlds. He saw the beautiful spots and the rivers. There is an extremely sacred river there and it emerges from the feet of the Vindhya. It is famous as Vindhya-pala. It is auspicious and destroys all sins. It has a great flow and resembles the Ganga. It flows towards the southern ocean. That supreme river, full of sacred waters, is known by the name of Mahanadi. She is the beloved wife of the southern ocean and is adorned with hundreds of daughters. ¹⁰⁴⁶ O tigers among sages! Villages and cities can be seen on both banks of the river. They are beautiful and full of crops. They are populated by healthy and happy people, wearing garments and ornaments. There are separate categories of *brahmanas*, *kshatriyas*, *vaishyas* and *shudras*, engaged in their own *dharma*. They can be seen, auspicious and possessing the good signs. Their mouths are full of betel leaves and they are decorated with garlands and other things. The mouths of the *brahmanas* are full of lines from the Vedas and the six Vedangas. Some of them are engaged in *agnihotra* rites and some are engaged in other rites of worship. They are accomplished in all the sacred texts. They perform sacrifices with copious quantities of *dakshina*. At crossroads, along royal roads, in forests, groves, assembly halls, mansions and temples, those great people can hear *itihasa*, *puranas*, the Vedas, the Vedangas, *kavya* and sacred texts being recited in excellent ways. The women who reside in that region are proud of their youth and

beauty. They possess all the good signs and possess large hips. Their dark faces are like lotuses, or the autumn moon. Their breasts are peaked. All of them are prosperous and beautiful to behold. They wear golden bangles and are ornamented in divine garments. They are like the pith of plantain trees, ¹⁰⁴⁷ with complexions like the filaments of lotuses. Their lower lips are like *bimba* fruit. They are beautiful, with eyes that extend all the way up to the ears. Their faces are excellent and their hair is beautiful. They bend down because of the weight of the necklaces. Some have eyes like red lotuses, others have eyes like blue lotuses. Others are slender in their limbs, with teeth that are like flashes of lightning. They are radiant, with curly hair that is parted in the middle. Their necks are adorned with ornaments and are decorated with garlands. Their earrings are studded with jewels and their *karnapurās* are lovely. ¹⁰⁴⁸ They resemble celestial women and are seen to possess the auspicious signs. Those beautiful women sport with their fortunate husbands, singing divine songs. There are the agreeable sounds of *veenas*, flutes, two-sided drums, drums, tambourines, conch shells, large drums and many other kinds of musical instruments. They are always happy, playing with each other. They are accomplished in many songs and the playing of musical instruments. Those beautiful women are always happy, day and night and are intoxicated by desire. The place is also populated by *bhikshus*, *vaikhanasas*, ¹⁰⁴⁹ *siddhas*, *brahmacharis*, those who have obtained success through *mantras*, those who have obtained success through austerities, and those who have obtained success through sacrifices. The king saw this *kshetra*, which is extremely rare. He thought, ‘I will worship the illustrious and eternal one here. He is the preceptor of the universe. He is the supreme divinity. He is the supreme shore. He is the supreme destination. He is the lord of all the lords. He is Vishnu Ananta, the unvanquished one. My mind knows now that this is Purushottama *kshetra*. There is a giant *nyagrodha* tree here and it is like the tree that grants all the objects of desire. The god has himself hidden an image made out of sapphire here. No other auspicious image of Vishnu can be seen here. Vishnu, the god who is the lord of the universe, has truth as his valour and I will make efforts so that he manifests himself before me here. With single-

mindful attention, I will use sacrifices, donations, austerities, oblations, meditation, fasting, supreme vows and other decreed forms of worship. My mind will be on him. My mind will not be on anyone else. I will make efforts for the construction of Vishnu's temple.'

Chapter 1(45) (The king's horse sacrifice)

Brahma said, 'O best among *brahmanas*! The lord of the earth thought in this way and began arrangements for constructing Hari's palace there. He brought all the astrologers, and those who were accomplished in texts about the stellar bodies. The king sanctified the land and was filled with great delight. He discussed the matter with learned *brahmanas* who knew the purport of the Vedas and other sacred texts, the advisers, the ministers and those who were accomplished in the knowledge of *vastu*. An auspicious day and *muhurta* was chosen, when there was a good conjunction of the moon and the stars and the planets were favourable. There were auspicious pronouncements of 'victory', accompanied by the charming sound of many musical instruments. There were the extremely melodious tones of the Vedas being recited and sung. Controlling himself, the king faithfully offered *arghya* that consisted of pitchers filled with flowers, fried grain, unhusked grain and fragrances, along with lamps. The lord of the earth offered the *arghya* in the proper way. The king then spoke to the lord of Kalinga, the brave lord of Utkala and the lord of Koshala. The king said, 'All of you control yourselves and go together, for the sake of rocks. Take the best of artisans with you, those who are accomplished in the art of craftsmanship. Mount Vindhya is extremely large and is decorated with many caves. Examine all the summits and break off auspicious rocks. Use innumerable carts to bring them here. Do not delay.' In this way, the lord of the earth instructed those kings to leave. He then addressed the advisers and the priests in these words. The king said, 'Let messengers go everywhere extremely fast and proclaim my command to all the kings who exist on earth. Following Indradyumna's command, let all of them come here with their elephants, horses, chariots, foot-soldiers, advisers and priests.' The

great-souled king instructed the messengers in this way and they went and told the kings what the lord of the earth had said. Hearing the words of all the messengers, all the kings swiftly arrived, surrounding themselves with their own soldiers. There were those who resided in the eastern direction and those who resided in the southern direction. There were those who resided in the western direction and those from *uttarapatha*. There were those from the extremities of the kingdom and those who resided nearby. There were some who resided in mountains and some who resided in islands. O *brahmanas*! On hearing Indradyumna's command, many of them came, with large numbers of chariots, elephants, horses, foot-soldiers and riches. Seeing that all the kings had come, the king was happy in his mind and instructed the advisers and the priests about the great task that had to be performed. The king said, 'O tigers among kings! Listen to some things I have to say. This sacred and supreme *tirtha* is auspicious. It grants objects of pleasure and emancipation. How can a great horse sacrifice be performed here? How can a palace be built for Vishnu? My mind is thinking about this. With all of you assembled here, that is what we will do together. O supreme among kings! If you help me, it can be done.' When the intelligent king of kings said this, all of them were happy and rejoiced at his instruction. They showered wealth, jewels, gold, gems, pearls, blankets, deer-skins, auspicious spreads made out of the hides of *ranku* deer, diamonds, lapis lazuli, rubies, emeralds, sapphires, elephants, horses, chariots, female elephants and many other kinds of wealth. There were innumerable objects, superior and inferior. Hundreds and thousands of pitchers were filled with *shali*, *vrihi*, *yava*, *masha*, *mudga*, *tila*, *siddhartha*, *chanaka*, *godhuma*, *masura*, *shyama*, *madhuka*, *nivara*, *kulatthaka* and thousands of other kinds of paddy, from the village and from the forest. ¹⁰⁵⁰ There were thousands of kinds of paddy and heaps of rice. The pitchers were filled with *ghee*, many other kinds of objects to be enjoyed, food and pastes. The kings filled them with many kinds of articles.

'On seeing that all the objects required for the sacrifice had been accumulated and seeing the gathering of *brahmanas* learned in the Vedas and Vedangas, skilled in the rites of sacrifices, accomplished and adroit in

all the tasks, the *rishis*, the *maharshis*, the *devarshis*, the ascetics, the *brahmacharis*, those in *garhasthya* and *vanaprastha*, *brahmanas* who had just finished their studies,¹⁰⁵¹ those who always observed *agnihotra*, the best of *acharyas* and *upadhyayas*,¹⁰⁵² ascetics engaged in self-studying, assistant priests accomplished in the sacred texts and others who purified, the king spoke to his own priest. The king said, ‘Let the learned *brahmanas* who know about the Vedas go and search out a place for the sacrifice, so that the horse sacrifice can be successfully completed.’ Addressed by the king in these words, along with the ministers, the royal priest cheerfully left, along with wise architects. *Brahmanas*, who were accomplished in sacrificial tasks led the way. There was a spot where there was a fisherman’s village and it was laid out with roads. Following the norms, the brahmana¹⁰⁵³ had this made into a sacrificial arena. An array of hundreds of palaces was constructed, adorned with the best of jewels. They were beautiful, like Indra’s residence and decorated with gold and jewels. The wonderful pillars were made out of gold and there were large gates. For the sacrificial arena, only pure gold was given and used. Following the norms, the one with *dharma* in his soul¹⁰⁵⁴ had inner quarters constructed for the kings who were residents of different countries. In that way, following the norms, he had many comfortable residences constructed for the *brahmanas* and *vaishyas* who had come from different countries. To bring pleasure to the king, those excellent kings came to the festival along with their wives, bringing many jewels with them. All those great-souled ones were lodged in their different camps and that sound rose up and touched the firmament, like the roaring of the ocean. O best among sages! The king instructed that those assembled kings should be tended to with food, drinks, beds and whatever else was required. The king himself instructed that many kinds of excellent food made from rice, sugarcane, barley and milk, should be served. O supreme among *brahmanas*! There were many excellent *brahmanas* at that great sacrifice and they knew about the *brahman*. They arrived with their disciples and the king welcomed them happily. He followed all of them until they reached their residences. Although he was extremely energetic himself, the supreme among kings gave up all pride.

All the artisans and others displayed their own works of artisanship. Having completed everything required for the sacrifice, they informed the king. Hearing that everything had been done, the best of kings, who was attentive towards everything, was delighted. Along with those of his ministers, the undecaying king got goosebumps.’

‘When the sacrifice commenced, there were eloquent ones who were accomplished in logic and debating. There were many debates among them, as they wished to defeat each other. O *brahmanas*! The lion among kings arranged for everything, just as Indra of the gods might have. The gates that could be seen there were made out of molten gold. The different types of couches and seats were studded with many jewels. The houses were made out of crystal. The lord of the earth did not see any pots and vessels that were made out of gold. ¹⁰⁵⁵ Because the sacred texts had been studied, the sacrificial posts were also made out of wood, though they were decorated with gold. O *brahmanas*! At the right time, the extremely radiant one had some animals from the water and from the land, sacrificed. All the assembled kings saw the animals that had been brought there—cows and buffaloes, even old and female ones, aquatic creatures, predatory animals, birds of prey, those born from the womb, those born from the egg, and plants, and trees. They saw grain and creatures from the mountainous regions. All of them were delighted at the animals, wealth and grain. The kings saw the sacrificial arena and were filled with great wonder. The *brahmanas* and *vaishyas* received a lot of sweets and riches. One hundred thousand *brahmanas* ate there. The sounds of drums being repeatedly beaten could be heard. These were sounded as soon as every day was over. Thus, the intelligent king’s sacrifice prospered. O *brahmanas*! There was such a lot of rice that it was scattered around. Rivers of curds and lakes of milk could be seen. At the king’s great sacrifice, all the *brahmanas* from many habitations in Jambu-dvīpa could be seen. Thousands of men, wearing polished earrings studded with gems, carried vessels and served the many excellent *brahmanas*, announcing what was being served. Hundreds and thousands of *brahmanas* were served in this way. Other men followed, carrying many kinds of drinks. The *brahmanas* were served food eaten by

kings. The king welcomed those who knew about the Vedas and the lords of the earth who had assembled there, honouring them properly with copious quantities of *dakshina*. There were kings who had come from all the directions and they were accomplished in fighting great battles. There were actors and dancers and those who were accomplished in singing and dancing.’

‘The king had one thousand and one hundred beautiful wives. Their breasts were plump and uplifted. Their eyes were like the petals of blue lotuses and their faces were like the autumn moon. They had been born in noble lineages and possessed all the qualities. The large number of excellent wives also ornamented the place. The arena was covered with garlands of jewels and was adorned with divine standards and flags. There were divine necklaces made out of jewels, with a complexion that was like that of the moon. There were elephants that were as large as mountains, beautiful to see because of the musth they exuded. There were hundreds of crores of tuskers, bedecked in ornaments. They were beautiful horses, born in the Sindhu region and as fleet as the wind. There were many crores of such swift and white horses, with ears that were black. There were innumerable foot-soldiers, resembling the sons of the gods. They were armoured and wielded many kinds of weapons. The king saw all this in the extremely extensive sacrificial arena. The king was filled with great delight and spoke these words. O *brahmanas*! The king said, ‘Bring an excellent horse that is marked with all the auspicious signs. Accompanied by princes who are ready, let it roam around the entire earth. Let those who know about the rites of *dharma* offer oblations in the proper way. Let elephants that are sixty years old, black antelopes, bulls and cows be brought here, along with those who tend to animals.’ When these had been brought, along with golden vessels, the king followed the norms and faithfully gave these to *brahmanas*.¹⁰⁵⁶ Following the norms, the lord gave riches to all the kings who resided in different countries—elephants, horses, excellent garments and land. The *brahmanas* were given many kinds of jewels and food. Those who were distressed and without protectors were satisfied by being given whatever they desired. The *brahmanas*, kings, *vaishyas* and *shudras* were

satisfied by giving them whatever they wished for. Taking the permission of that excellent king, they then left for their own countries. He satisfied his own family, the male and female servants, by giving them whatever they wanted. He then felt satisfied because the horse sacrifice had been successfully completed.'

Chapter 1(46) (Prayer for compassion)

Brahma said, ‘Following the norms indicated in the Vedas, the great horse sacrifice was thus performed. ¹⁰⁵⁷ However, he ¹⁰⁵⁸ was still scared of the ocean that was *samsara* and wanted to purify his mind. Therefore, he sat down alone and praised the protector of the universe, the one who brings bliss to the universe. He wanted to obtain Vishnu, the supreme destination.’

The king said, ‘O foundation of the universe! O lord of the universe! O one who satisfies all the objects of desire! O one loved by Lakshmi! O ocean of compassion! O one who is affectionate towards his devotees! O one who likes the virtuous! O Vishnu! O great king! I am submerged in the ocean that is existence. Please save me. I bow down to the one who resembles the fire of universal destruction, the destroyer of Diti’s sons. ¹⁰⁵⁹ O Narasimha! O immensely valiant one! O one with the blazing eyes! Please save me. O great Varaha! In ancient times, when the earth had sunk into *rasatala*, you had raised her up with your tusks. ¹⁰⁶⁰ In that way, please save me from this ocean of misery. O Krishna! I have praised your images, which are the ones who bestow boons. You, Baladeva and the others are established in separate forms. O lord! O lord of the gods! Garuda and the others are nothing but your limbs. O Achyuta! So are the guardians of the worlds with their weapons, and so are Keshva and the others. O lord of the gods! The learned have said that all the others are also your different forms. O lord of the universe! O one with the large and delighted eyes! I have worshipped all of you and have prostrated myself before all of you. O one who confers *dharma*, *artha*, *kama* and *moksha*! Bestow a boon on me. Hara, Samkarshana and the others have been praised in different forms as you. They have been created for the purposes of worship and are all dependent on you. O lord of the gods! In terms of the supreme truth, there is

no difference between them. For the purposes of sacrifices and for the purposes of worship, there are these different forms. You are *advaita*, how can men speak of you as *dvaita*? ¹⁰⁶¹ O Hari! You are one. You exist as the consciousness that pervades. You are Niranjana. ¹⁰⁶² Your supreme form is beyond notions of existence and non-existence. You are not smeared by anything. You are pure. You are subtle. You are deep and immobile. You are certain. You are devoid of all kinds of sins. You alone are established in the form of life. O lord! The gods cannot comprehend you. How can I possibly know you? There is another of your forms that wears yellow garments and is four-armed. That holds a conch shell, a *chakra* and a mace and wears a diadem and armlets. There is the *shrivatsa* mark on the chest and this form is adorned with a garland of wildflowers. The learned and those who seek refuge with you worship this. O god of the gods! O best among the gods! O one who grants devotees freedom from fear! O one with eyes like lotus petals! I am submerged in an ocean of material objects. Please save me. O lord of the worlds! With the exception of you, I do not perceive anyone else with whom I can seek refuge. O one loved by Kamala! ¹⁰⁶³ O Madhusudana! Please be pleased. I am suffering from old age and hundreds of ailments. I am oppressed by many kinds of misery. I am overwhelmed by joy and sorrow. I am foolish and am bound by the nooses of *karma*. I have fallen down into this extremely fierce and terrible ocean that is *samsara*. The material objects are the water that is extremely difficult to cross. It is full of anger and hatred in the form of fish. The senses are the deep whirlpools, and thirst and sorrow constitute the waves. I am without a refuge. I am without a support. This ocean has no substance and is extremely fickle. O lord! Confounded by *maya*, I have been roaming around there for a very long time. I have repeatedly been born, thousands of times, as different species. O Janardana! In *samsara*, I have had births many thousands and tens of thousands of times and have gone through diverse experiences. I have studied the Vedas, the Vedangas and many types of sacred texts, *ithihasa*, purana and several texts on artisanship. O Jagannatha! I have gone through satisfaction, dissatisfaction, accumulation, dwindling away, expenditure, victory, prosperity, rise and fall. I have been united with, and

separated from, wives, enemies, friends and relatives. I have witnessed many kinds of fathers and mothers. I have experienced grief and many kinds of joy. I have obtained matrimonial allies, sons, brothers and kin. I have resided in the stomachs of women, amidst urine and excrement. O lord! While residing in the womb, I have experienced great miseries. O Hrishikesha! I have had to face innumerable miseries in childhood, youth and old age. I have also experienced miseries at the time of death, on the path to Yama, in Yama's abode and the hardships in hell. I have been born as worms, insects, trees, elephants, horses, deer, birds, buffaloes, camels, cattle, other residents of the forest, *brahmanas*, all the different types of shudras, wealthy *kshatriyas*, poor ascetics, kings, servants of kings and other embodied creatures. O god! I have repeatedly been born in their homes. O protector! I have been the servant of many prosperous men. I have experienced penury and lordship and have been a master. I have killed and I have been killed by others. I have struck others and been struck by them. I have given to others and on many occasions, others have given to me. O Janardana! For the sake of fathers, mothers, well-wishers, brothers, wives, the wealthy, the learned, the poor and ascetics, I have discarded shame and have gone through all these many kinds of distress. O lord! Among gods, inferior species, humans, mobile and immobile objects, I do not see a single abode that I have not been to. O lord of the universe! Sometimes, I have been in hell. Sometimes, I have been in heaven. Sometimes, I have been in the world of men. Sometimes, I have been in the water of *tirthas*. O best among the gods! A bucket used to raise water is tied to a rope and is sometimes raised, sometimes lowered and sometimes stationed in the middle. Like that, I have been tied to the rope of *karma*. Like that, tied to the rope of *karma*, I have roamed around—raised up, lowered or remained in the middle. I have been in this terrible cycle of *samsara*, which gives me the goosebumps. I have been whirled around for a very long time and have never been able to see an end to this. O Hari! My senses are afflicted and I do not know what I should do now. I am overwhelmed by grief and thirst. I am senseless and terrified. O god! Completely distracted, I have now sought refuge with you. O Krishna! I am

miserable and am submerged in this ocean of *samsara*. Please save me. O Jagannatha! If you think that I am your devotee, please show me your compassion. With the exception of you, I have no other friend. Therefore, think of me. O god! O protector! O lord! After seeking refuge with you, I no longer have any kind of fear, from life, from death, from *yoga*, from *kshema*.¹⁰⁶⁴ O god! Those who do not worship you in the proper way are the worst among men. In the bondage of *samsara*, how can they possibly obtain a desirable end? If they do not develop devotion towards Keshava, the creator of the universe, what purpose is served by their noble birth, good conduct, learning or even life? Those who are confounded and criticize you obtain *asura* natures. They descend into hell and are born again and again. They can never be saved from the ocean that is hell. O god! Those who slander you are wicked in conduct and are the worst among men. O Hari! Wherever I am born as a result of the bondage of *karma*, let my devotion towards you always be steadfast. O god! By worshipping you, gods, *daityas*, men and others who have controlled themselves obtain supreme success. Who will not worship you? O Hari! Brahma and the other gods are incapable of praising you. With the intelligence of a human, how can I possibly praise you? You are superior to Prakriti. O lord! Ignorant in my intelligence, I have praised you. If I have committed a transgression in the course of this, please show me your compassion and pardon me. O Hari! The virtuous pardon a crime that is committed against them. O lord of the gods! Therefore, be pleased and show affection towards a devotee who has sought refuge with you. O god! With my sentiments full of devotion, I have praised you. O Vasudeva! May all that be true.¹⁰⁶⁵ I bow down before you.'

Brahma continued, 'Thus praised, the one with Garuda on his banner was pleased. O best among sages! He granted him every desire he wanted. If a man praises Jagannatha and worships him every day, using this *stotram*, he becomes intelligent and is certainly liberated. If a man purifies himself and performs *japa* at the time of the three *sandhyas*,¹⁰⁶⁶ using this excellent *stotram*, he obtains *dharma*, *artha*, *kama* and *moksha*. If a person controls himself and reads it, hears it or makes others hear it, he is cleansed of all sins and obtains Vishnu's divine world. This is blessed and auspicious. It

destroys sins and grants objects of pleasure and emancipation. This is sacred, secret and extremely rare. It must never be revealed to non-believers, those who are foolish, ingrates or insolent, those who are evil in intelligence and those who are cunning in any way. It should be revealed to those who are full of faith, possessing qualities and good conduct, those who are tranquil and devoted to Vishnu, and those who are faithful in the performance of tasks. The *stotram* to Purushottama that I have spoken about is characterized by compassion and is the cause behind the destruction of all calamities. It confers happiness and emancipation. It is superior and confers all the fruits one wishes for. There are pure ones who meditate on the extremely subtle Murari, ¹⁰⁶⁷ the eternal and ancient Purusha. They enjoy emancipation and enter Vishnu, just as oblations of *ghee*, accompanied by *mantras*, enters the fire. He alone is the divinity who can destroy the miseries of this existence on earth. He is supreme and there is no one who is superior to him. Vishnu is the creator, the preserver and the destroyer. He is the essence of everything that exists. Krishna is the preceptor of the universe. He is the one who grants emancipation and bliss. For those who do not possess devotion towards him, what is the use of learning, owning qualities, sacrifices, donations and fierce austerities? In this world, if a person has devotion towards Purushottama, he is said to be blessed. He is pure. He is learned. Because of his sacrifices and austerities, he is superior in qualities. He knows. He is one who donates. He is the one who speaks the truth.'

Chapter 1(47) (Evolution of the images)

Brahma said, ‘O tigers among sages! The lord of the earth praised and bowed down to the eternal Vasudeva Jagannatha, who grants all the fruits of desire. He then spread some *kusha* grass on the ground and placing a piece of cloth over it, focused his mind, controlled his senses and went to sleep. ‘How will Janardana, the god of the gods, manifest himself before me? How will the god remove my hardships?’ As he went to sleep, this is what he thought. When the lord of men slept, Vasudeva, the preceptor of the universe, showed himself to him. He held a conch shell, a *chakra* and a mace. In his dreams, he saw the god of the gods, the preceptor of the universe. The god held a conch shell, a *chakra* and a fierce mace in his hands. He held the Sharnga bow, arrows and a sword. There was a disc of fierce and blazing energy around him. His complexion was like that of the sun at the end of a yuga. He resembled blue lapis lazuli. Seated on Suparna,¹⁰⁶⁸ he possessed eight auspicious arms. O patient ones! He said, ‘O immensely intelligent king! Well done. O protector of the earth! I am satisfied with your divine sacrifice, faith and devotion. Why are you grieving in vain? O king! The image that exists here is eternal and should be worshipped by the entire world. O lord of the earth! I will tell you the means whereby you will be able to get it. When the night passes and the sparkling sun rises, go to the place which is decorated by many trees, at the end of the waters of the ocean. O king! On that shoreline, the giant expanse of the water can be seen and the water of the salty ocean is full of waves. On that shore, there is a giant tree, partly standing on land and partly in the water. Though the waves strike against it, the tree does not tremble. With an axe in your hand, go to the place where the waves end. O king! Go alone, in a cheerful mood, and you will see the tree. You will see the *ashvattha* tree.

Without any hesitation, cut it down. When the tree is cut down in the morning, it will be wonderful to behold. O lord of the earth! When you have seen it, think about fashioning my divine image out of it. Give up all your confused thoughts.’ Having said this, the immensely fortunate Hari vanished. Having seen this dream, he was filled with great wonder. His mind only intent on this, he waited for the night to be over. His heart full of this, he chanted *mantras* and hymns to Vishnu.’

‘When night was over and it was morning, the lord of men arose. Following the decreed norms, he had a proper bath in the ocean. He offered gifts to *brahmanas*—in villages and cities. The supreme king performed the morning ablutions and proceeded. There were no chariots, foot-soldiers, elephants, horses or charioteers with him. The immensely intelligent one went to that giant shore alone. He saw that giant tree there. The giant tree was full of energy. It was extremely fierce, extremely terrible, sacred and extremely large. It was tall in height and gigantic in size. Near the water, it was protected exceedingly well. Its complexion was like that of thick red madder. ¹⁰⁶⁹ It didn’t have a name and didn’t belong to any species. ¹⁰⁷⁰ O *brahmanas*! Seeing that tree, the lord of men was delighted. Using his strong and sharp axe, he cut it down. Indrasakha ¹⁰⁷¹ was thinking of cutting it into two parts. As he looked at the wood, an extraordinary and wonderful event occurred. Assuming the garb of *brahmanas*, Vishvakarma and Vishnu arrived there. Those two immensely fortunate ones arrived there, resembling two born in excellent lineages. They blazed in their own energy and had divine garlands and pastes. They approached King Indrasakha and asked, ‘O great king! What are you doing here? O mighty-armed one! What is the reason behind you cutting down this tree? O mighty-armed one! This tree was helpless. It was standing in this secluded and desolate forest, on the shores of the great ocean. Why has this tree been cut down?’ O *brahmanas*! Hearing their words, the king was overjoyed. He spoke to those two handsome ones. It was as if Chandra and Surya had arrived. He bowed down to those two. It was as if Jagannatha had arrived in front of him. He addressed them in soft and sweet words. The king said, ‘I wish to worship the god of the gods, the one without a beginning and without an end, the

lord of the universe. I wished to construct his image. The great-souled supreme god of the gods appeared before me at the end of my dreams and instructed me to do this. I have told you what I heard.’ The king resembled Indra of the gods. Hearing his words, the lord of the universe laughed. He was satisfied and addressed him in these words.’

Vishnu said, ‘O immensely fortunate one! What you have done is excellent and your intentions are excellent. The ocean of *samsara* is terrible. Like the trunk of a plantain tree, it has no essence and is full of great miseries. It is full of objects of pleasure that are like crocodiles. The senses are like whirlpools. It makes the body-hair stand up and it is extremely difficult to cross. There are eddies made out of hundreds of different kinds of ailments. It is just like a bubble in the water. But your mind has turned towards worshipping Vishnu. O tiger among men! You are blessed and are ornamented with all the qualities. O tiger among kings! Since you are the lord who rules over the subjects, the subjects and the earth, with its mountains, forests, groves, fortifications, cities and villages adorned with the four *varnas*, is also blessed. O extremely fortunate one! Come. This tree is pleasant and cool. Sit here with us and let us talk about *dharma*. My companion, who has come here with me, is a great artisan. He is like Vishvakarma himself and is skilled in all the tasks. Instructed by me, he will fashion the image. Come away from the shore now.’ Hearing these words, the king listened to what the brahmana had said. He left the shore of the ocean and went near them. The best among kings stood under the extremely cool shade of the tree. O Indras among *brahmanas*! In the form of a brahmana, the *atman* of the universe instructed the king and the foremost artisan. ‘This is how you should make the image. The first and supreme one will be in Krishna’s form, serene, with eyes like lotus petals. He will wear *shrivatsa* and *koustubha*. He will hold a conchshell, a *chakra* and a mace. The second image will have the complexion of the moon or cow’s milk and will be marked with the *svastika* sign. He will wield the weapon of a plough. He is the immensely strong god, known by the name of Ananta. ¹⁰⁷² The gods, *danavas*, *gandharvas*, *yakshas*, *vidyadharas* and *uragas* have not been able to comprehend his end. Hence, he is known as

Ananta. The third will be Subhadra, Vasudeva's sister. She will be extremely beautiful and golden in complexion. She will possess all the auspicious signs.'

Brahma continued, 'Vishvakarma is the performer of excellent tasks. Hearing his words, he instantly created the images, with all the auspicious signs. There were wonderful and extremely radiant earrings on the ears. The *chakra* and the plough, revered by virtuous people, were in the hands. The first was white in complexion, like the autumn moon. The size was gigantic and the eyes were red. There was a terrible hood atop the head. He was clad in blue garments. This was the fierce Bala, full of strength and intoxication. He wore a single divine earring and wielded a mace and a bludgeon. The second was that of Pundarikaksha, resembling a dark-blue cloud. His complexion was like that of an *atasi* flower ¹⁰⁷³ and his eyes were like lotus petals. His garments were yellow and he was fierce and auspicious simultaneously. He has the *shrivatsa* mark and the full and divine *chakra* was in one hand. This was Hari, who destroys all sins. The third was golden in complexion, with eyes like lotus petals. She was clad in wonderful garments and adorned with necklaces and armlets. There were many kinds of wonderful ornaments and bejeweled necklaces dangled. The breasts were plump and upraised. Vishvakarma fashioned this beautiful image. The images were fashioned in an instant and the king witnessed this extraordinary event. Those wonderful images were beautiful and possessed all the auspicious signs. They were ornamented with many kinds of jewels and were clad in divine garments. Filled with great wonder, he spoke these words. Indradyumna said, 'Are you gods who have arrived in front of me in the guise of *brahmanas*? Both of you are wonderful in your deeds. This is the work of gods, not that of men. Are you gods or humans? Are you *yakshas* or *vidyadharas*? Are you Brahma and Hrishikesha? Are you Vasus? Are you the two Ashvins? I do not know whether you are really here, or is this a form of *maya*? I seek refuge with you. May your forms manifest themselves before me.'

Chapter 1(48) (Description of Purushottama)

The illustrious one said, ‘I am not a god or a *yaksha*. I am not a *daitya*, or the king of the gods. I am not Brahma or Rudra. Know me as Parameshvara. ¹⁰⁷⁴ I destroy the afflictions in all the worlds. All the strength and manliness is in me. I am worshipped by all creatures. I am Ananta and there is nothing that does not exist in me. I am read about in the three Vedas, Vedanta and the *nigama* texts. I am spoken about as the one who can be reached through *jnana*. I am Vasudeva of the yogis. I myself am Brahma. I am Vishnu. I am also Shiva. I am Indra, the king of the gods. I am Yama, who controls the world. I am earth and all the elements. O king! I am the three kinds of fire that devour the oblations. ¹⁰⁷⁵ I am Varuna, the lord of the waters. I am the earth. I am that which holds up the earth. Everything in the world that can be spoken about is me. I am the mobile and immobile objects in the universe. I am everything that moves, and does not move, in the universe. There is nothing other than me. O best among kings! O one who is excellent in his vows! I am pleased with you. Ask for a boon. Ask me for whatever wish exists in your heart and I will grant it to you. Those who are not auspicious cannot see me, not even at the end of a dream. Your devotion towards me is steadfast. That is the reason you have been able to see me directly.’

Brahma said, ‘O *brahmanas*! Hearing Vasudeva’s words, the king’s mind was filled with joy and he got goosebumps. He chanted this *stotram*. The king said, ‘O one loved by Shri! I bow down to you. O lord of Shri! O one attired in yellow garments! You are the one who grants prosperity. You are the lord of prosperity. You are the abode of prosperity. You are Shri’s refuge. I bow down to you. You are the original Purusha. You are Ishana. You are the lord of everything. Your faces are in every direction. You are

supreme and not sullied. I prostrate myself before the eternal divinity. You cannot be reached through words. You are beyond *gunas*. You are beyond notions of existence and non-existence. You are not touched in any way. You are *nirguna*. You are subtle. You are omniscient. You are the one who creates everything. You resemble a cloud during the rainy season. You are engaged in the welfare of cattle and *brahmanas*. You are the one who protects everything. You pervade everything that exists. You are the god who holds a conch shell and a *chakra*. You hold a mace and a bludgeon. I bow down to the god who confers boons. Your complexion resembles that of a blue lotus. You are the one who uses a serpent ¹⁰⁷⁶ as a couch when you lie down. You are the one who resides in the ocean of milk. I bow down to Hrishikesha Hari, the destroyer of all sins. I bow down again to the divinity who is the lord of all the gods. You are the lord who bestows boons. You are Vishnu, the lord of all the worlds. You are the undecaying cause behind *moksha*.' He praised the divinity in this way, joining his hands in salutation and prostrating himself. He prostrated himself on the ground and spoke again. The king said, 'O protector! If you are pleased with me, I am asking for an excellent boon. The gods, *asuras*, *gandharvas*, *yakshas*, *rakshasas*, giant *uragas*, *siddhas*, *vidyadharas*, *sadhyas*, *kinnaras*, *guhyakas*, immensely fortunate *rishis* who are accomplished in many sacred texts, mendicants engaged in yoga, those who think about the truth and purport of the Vedas, those conversant with the sacred texts of *moksha*, and others, meditate on the supreme destination that is *nirguna*, sparkling, serene, secret and extremely purifying. Through your favours, I wish to reach that destination, which is extremely difficult to reach.' The illustrious one replied, 'O fortunate one! Everything will be like that. You will obtain everything that you wish for. Through my favours, there is no doubt that it will be just as you desire. O best among kings! You will continuously rule over this great kingdom for ten thousand and nine hundred years. After that, you will leave for the divine destination, which is so very difficult for gods and *asuras* to reach. Your wishes will be satisfied. That destination is serene, secret, not manifest, without decay, greater than the greatest, subtle, without blemish, motionless and eternal. It is devoid of old age and grief. It

is devoid of action and causes. It is supreme and is described as that which must be known. I will show it to you. On reaching that supreme destination, you will obtain supreme bliss. O Indra among kings! As long as there are clouds, the sky, the sun, the moon and the stars, as long as the seven oceans and Meru and other mountains exist, and as long as the gods are there in heaven, your fame will remain everywhere on earth and will not diminish. The *tirtha* that resulted as part of the sacrifice will be known as Indradyumna's lake. Those who bathe in it even once will attain Shakra's world. If a person offers *pinda* on the shores of that auspicious lake, he will go to Shakra's world and save twenty-one generations of his family. Praised by the *apsaras* and accompanied by the loud songs of *gandharvas*, he will go there on a *vimana* and reside there for the duration of fourteen Indras. ¹⁰⁷⁷ To the south of the lake, near the south-west corner, there is a *nyagrodha* tree and a pavilion ¹⁰⁷⁸ near it. There are many trees there and it is covered by a grove of *ketaki* plants. There are innumerable *narikela* trees and the place is shrouded with *champaka*, *bakula*, *ashoka*, *karnikara*, *punnaga*, *nagakesara*, *patala*, *amrata*, ¹⁰⁷⁹ *sarala*, *chandana*, *devadaru*, *nyagrodha*, *ashvattha*, *khadira*, *parijata*, *arjuna*, *hintala*, *tala*, *shimshapa*, *badari*, *karanja*, *lakucha*, *plaksha*, *panasa*, *bilva* and *dhatuka*. ¹⁰⁸⁰ The place is ornamented with many other kinds of beautiful trees. In *shukla paksha* in the month of Ashadha, on the fifth lunar day, when the nakshatra is Magha, ¹⁰⁸¹ we ¹⁰⁸² should be taken there and kept there for seven days. With auspicious pronouncements, beautiful courtesans should place us in the pavilion. They should be accomplished in dancing and singing melodious songs. They should be especially skilled in sporting. They should fan us with fans and whisks made out of yak hair, studded with jewels and with golden handles. *Brahmacharis*, mendicants, *snatakas*, excellent *brahmanas*, those in *vanaprastha*, those in *garhasthya*, *siddhas* and other *brahmanas*, and those from different *varnas* and states should praise us, to the sounds of hymns from the *Rig*, *Yajur* and *Sama* Vedas. O king! They should repeatedly praise Rama ¹⁰⁸³ and Keshava. If a man sees the images, praises and faithfully prostrates himself, he resides in Hari's prosperous city for ten thousand divine years. Worshipped by *apsaras* and to the sound of songs

sung by *gandharvas*, he becomes Hari's companion there and sports with Keshava. Astride a *vimana* that has the complexion of the sun and radiant in a necklace made out of jewels, the immensely fortunate one goes to the best of worlds and enjoys all the objects of desire. He remains there until his austerities are exhausted. After that, he is born as a human and certainly becomes a brahmana who possesses crores of wealth, is handsome and is learned in the four Vedas.' Thus, Hari, the granter of boons, gave him these boons and this pledge. O *brahmanas*! Along with Vishvakarma, he vanished.'

'The king was delighted and his body hair stood up. Having been able to see Hari, he thought that he had been successful. The images of Krishna, Rama and Subhadra, the ones who bestowed boons, were placed on chariots that were like *vimanas*, colourful with jewels and gold. To sounds of victory and auspicious pronouncements, the king had them conveyed. Along with the advisers and the priest, the intelligent one had them brought. There were the sounds of many types of musical instruments and many auspicious sounds of the Vedas being chanted. They were established in that extremely beautiful, auspicious and sacred spot. Along with the *brahmanas*, he had them established on an auspicious *tithi* and time, when the *nakshatras* had all the traits of being auspicious and the *muhurta* was excellent. After taking the permission of the preceptor, the lord of the earth carried out all the tasks in accordance with what has been decreed, following all the indicated norms. Following the norms, he gave *dakshina* to the preceptor. Following the norms, he gave wealth to the officiating priests and others. Following the ordinances, they were instated in that excellent abode in the mansion. All the indicated tasks were performed in the course of this installation. Following the rituals, they were worshipped with many kinds of flowers and fragrances. As was appropriate, the king gave away gold, jewels, pearls, many kinds of beautiful garments, diverse divine gems, excellent seats, villages, habitations, parcels of land, fortifications, cities, even kingdoms and many other things. He performed many other sacrifices and gave away large quantities of donations at these sacrifices. Having performed all the required tasks, the king gave up all his possessions and went to the supreme

place, Vishnu's supreme destination. O best among sages! I have thus told you about that excellent king and about the greatness of that *kshetra*. What else do you wish to hear?'

Hearing the words of Brahma, whose birth is not manifest, the *brahmanas* thought that this was wonderful. ¹⁰⁸⁴ Rejoicing, they asked again.

The sages asked, 'O best among the gods! When should one go to Purushottama? O lord! What rituals must be performed at the five *tirthas*? Tell us separately the fruits of bathing and donating at each of these *tirthas*, and the fruits of seeing the divinity there.'

Brahma replied, 'A person obtains some fruits if he fasts, controls his senses, controls his anger and torments himself by standing on one leg in Kurukshetra for seventy thousand years. O best among *brahmanas*! However, he obtains greater fruits if he fasts and visits Purushottama once on the twelfth lunar day. O best among sages! If *brahmanas* and others desire the world of heaven, they should control themselves and make efforts to visit Purushottama in the month of Jyeshtha. Having visited the five *tirthas* in the proper way in the month of Jyeshtha, an excellent man will visit Purushottama on the twelfth lunar day in *shukla paksha*. If a person sees the god without decay in Purushottama on the twelfth lunar day, he obtains Vishnu's world and is never dislodged from there. O best among *brahmanas*! Therefore, one should endeavour to go there in the month of Jyeshtha. A man should see Purushottama after having visited the five *tirthas*. Even if a person is a great distance away, as long as he faithfully chants about Purushottama every day, with a pure soul, he too goes to Vishnu's city. If a man controls himself and is full of faith, and if he performs that pilgrimage to Krishna, he is freed from all sins and goes to Vishnu's world. The *chakra* is placed atop Hari's palace. Even if a person sees it from a distance and faithfully bows down before it, he is instantly freed from sins.'

Chapter 1(49) (Markandeya sees the *vata* tree)

Brahma said, ‘O best among sages! There was a great destruction at the end of the *kalpa*. The sun, the moon, and the wind were destroyed, and so were all mobile and immobile objects. The sun of destruction arose and terrible clouds thundered. There were flashes of lightning and thunder and the trees and mountains were shattered. As giant meteors showered down, everything in the world perished. All the water in the lakes and rivers dried up. O *brahmanas*! Resembling all the Adityas together, the *samvartaka* fire was fanned by the wind and entered the world. ¹⁰⁸⁵ Thereafter, it entered and shattered the earth, entering the nether regions next. There was great fear among the gods, *danavas* and *yakshas*. Everything in the world of the *nagas* and everything on earth was burnt down. O tigers among sages! Everything that was beneath was instantly destroyed. Aided by the swift wind, the *samvartaka* fire burnt down everything, for hundreds and thousands of *yojanas*. The lord of the universe ¹⁰⁸⁶ scorched and consumed everything, gods, *asuras*, *gandharvas*, *yakshas*, *uragas* and *rakshasas*. Known as the fire of the *kalpa*, it blazed and was extremely terrible. It was extremely resplendent, with large flames. It blazed with a loud roar. It flamed in its own energy, resembling one crore suns together. It quickly consumed the three worlds, with the gods, *asuras* and humans. Such was the extremely terrible and extremely fierce destruction.’

‘O *brahmanas*! There was a supreme *rishi* who had *dharma* in his soul. He was devoted to *dhyana* and yoga. He was known as Markandeya and he remained there alone. He was still bound in the noose of delusion, and his senses suffered because of the hunger and the thirst. O *brahmanas*! Witnessing that great fire, his throat, lips and palate dried up. Suffering from thirst, he stumbled and he was overwhelmed by fear. Losing control

over his senses and unable to distinguish the directions, he travelled everywhere on earth. Although he rushed around here and there, he could not find a saviour. O *brahmanas*! No matter where he tried to rest, he could not find peace. ‘I do not know what to do. I do not know where I will find refuge. How will I see the lord and divinity, the eternal Purusha?’ Thus, he single-mindedly thought about the eternal divinity and reached that supreme destination, the cause behind the great destruction. He reached the eternal lord and Purusha, in a form known as the king of *vata* trees. O best among sages! The sage quickly approached that *nyagrodha* tree. Having reached, he sat down on its root. The fire of destruction did not exist there, nor was there any showering down of burning coals. The *samvartaka* fire did not reach there, nor was there any thunder or lightning.’

Chapter 1(50) (Markandeya's view of destruction)

Brahma said, 'Great clouds rose up into the sky and they were extraordinary to behold. Some were like herds of elephants, decorated with garlands. Some were dark like blue lotuses, others resembled water lilies. Some clouds, full of water, were like filaments. Others were yellow. Some were green in complexion, others had the hue of a crow's egg. Some had the complexion of petals of lotuses, some had the hue of an *ingula* tree. ¹⁰⁸⁷ Some resembled giant cities, others resembled giant mountains. Some were like masses of collyrium, others had the radiance of emeralds. They were thick and dense and were garlanded with lightning. O immensely fortunate ones! Such large clouds arose and they were terrible in form. They thundered in terrible tones. All these clouds, full of water, covered the sky. They showered torrents of water and covered the earth everywhere, with its mountains, forests and mines. O supreme among sages! With terrible floods of water, the clouds enveloped all the directions. Urged by Parameshthi, everything was flooded everywhere. Great torrents of earth covered the earth. They extinguished the extremely fierce, extremely terrible and inauspicious fire. For twelve years, the clouds flooded everything. Urged by the great-souled one, the floods of water enveloped everything. O *brahmanas*! The oceans transgressed their shorelines. Mountains were shattered and the earth was submerged in water. Those gigantic clouds whirled around in the firmament and shrouded everything. However, though this dense mass gathered together, they were struck by the force of the wind and were dispersed. O supreme among sages! This was a fierce wind. O *brahmanas*! However, Vishnu, the original divinity, who was lying down in the abode of the lotus, ¹⁰⁸⁸ drank up the wind. Only a single ocean existed.

There was terrible darkness and no support existed. The gods, *asuras* and men were destroyed. There were no *yakshas* or *rakshasas*.’

‘The exhausted sage meditated on Purushottama. He opened his eyes and saw that the earth was covered in water. He could not see the *vata* tree. He could not see the earth. He could not discern the directions. Nor could he see the sun. There was no moon, sun, fire or wind. There were no gods, *asuras* or *pannagas*. In that fierce and single ocean, all mobile and immobile objects were destroyed. O *brahmanas*! As he was being drowned, he attempted to swim. But as he was being hurled around here and there in that flood, the sage suffered. O *brahmanas*! As he was being drowned, he could not see a saviour. Purushottama saw that he was suffering in this way and took pity on him. He was satisfied with the meditation of that tiger among sages and spoke to him. The illustrious one said, ‘O child! You are exhausted. You are only a child. O one who is excellent in his vows! You are my devotee. Come. O Markandeya! Quickly come near me. O best among sages! Do not be frightened. Come in front of me. O Markandeya! O one who is great in fortitude! You are but a child and are suffering from exhaustion.’ Hearing his words, the sage was filled with great rage. O *brahmanas*! Addressed repeatedly in this way, he was amazed and replied. Markandeya replied, ‘As if slighting my austerity, who is addressing me by name? My body is many thousand years old. Who is denigrating it in this way? ¹⁰⁸⁹ This cannot be described as good conduct. The gods, Brahma and the lord of all the gods have honoured me and have addressed me as someone who has lived for a long time. My head has borne fierce austerity. By addressing me as Markandeya now, who wants to give up his life now? Who desires to proceed towards death?’ O *brahmanas*! Having said this, the sage started to think. ‘Have I seen a dream? Have I been overwhelmed by delusion?’ Thinking in this way, he made up his mind to dispel this grief. ‘I will faithfully seek refuge with God Purushottama.’ Focused in his mind, the sage sought refuge with Vishnu. He again saw that large *vata* tree above the water. There was an extraordinary sight. On one of its extensive branches, there was a beautiful, divine and golden couch that had been constructed by Vishvakarma. It was studded with diamonds and lapis lazuli,

and decorated with gems and coral. There were rubies and many other kinds of precious stones ornamented it. There were many kinds of spreads and it was embellished with many kinds of jewels. It was full of wonderful objects and there was a disc of radiance around it. In the form of a child, God Krishna was lying down on the couch. He blazed in his extremely great radiance, resembling one crore suns. He was four-armed and his limbs were beautiful. His eyes were like lotus petals. The *shrivatsa* mark was on his chest and he held a conch shell, a *chakra* and a mace. There was a garland of wildflowers on his chest and he wore divine earrings. There were heavy necklaces around his neck and he was ornamented with divine jewels. When he saw this divinity, the sage's eyes dilated in wonder. He got goosebumps. He prostrated himself before the god and spoke to him. Markandeya said, 'This is wonderful. There is a single mass of water, and all mobile and immobile objects have been destroyed. How is the child here alone, without any sense of fear?' The great sage knew about the past, the present and the future. Nevertheless, confounded by *maya*, he did not comprehend the god. Unable to comprehend him, he spoke these words of dejection. Markandeya said, 'My austerity is in vain. My energy is in vain. My knowledge is in vain. My rites are in vain. My long life is in vain. My life as a human is in vain. I do not know who this divine child is, sleeping on the couch.' Thinking this, the brahmana, bereft of his senses, was submerged in that flood. Distracted, he found no way to save himself and was filled with a great sense of depression. In his own greatness, the child resembled the rising sun. O *brahmanas*! As he was stationed there, full of energy, he was incapable of looking at him. Seeing the sage advance towards him, the child seemed to smile. O tigers among sages! He spoke to him in a voice that rumbled like the clouds. The illustrious one said, 'O child! I know that you are exhausted. You have come to me for the sake of being saved. Swiftly enter my body. I have come here to save you from exhaustion.' Hearing these words, the sage was so confused that he could not say anything. He entered his gaping mouth.'

Chapter 1(51) (Markandeya inside the illustrious one's stomach)

Brahma said, ‘The excellent sage entered the child’s stomach. Inside, he saw the entire earth, with all the different habitations. O excellent sages! He saw the oceans of salt water, sugarcane juice, liquor, *ghee*, curds, milk and fresh water; Jambu-dvipa, Plaksha-dvipa, Shalmali-dvipa, Kusha-dvipa, Krouncha-dvipa, Shaka-dvipa and Pushkara-dvipa; Bharata and the other varshas; all the mountains; the golden mountain of Meru, with all the stores of jewels, its summit decorated with many gems and caves; *antyajas* and all the other categories; deer, monkeys, lions, boars, *srimaras*, ¹⁰⁹⁰ hares, elephants and other creatures; all the *tirthas*, villages and cities on earth; agriculture, animal husbandry, trade and all kinds of buying and selling; Shakra and other excellent gods and other residents of heaven; *gandharvas*, *apsaras*, *yakshas*, the eternal *rishis*, *daityas*, *danavas*, *sarpas* and *nagas*; the sons of Simhika and all the other enemies of the gods; and everything mobile and immobile that he had seen earlier on earth. ¹⁰⁹¹ He saw all these inside the stomach. O best among *brahmanas*! He saw everything inside the stomach. What is the point of stating this repeatedly? O best among *brahmanas*! Everything mobile and immobile, beginning with Brahma and ending with a blade of grass, Bhuloka, Bhuvarloka, Svarloka, Maharloka, Satyaloka, Tapoloka and Janaloka, Atala, Vitala, Nitala, Sutala, Talatala, Rasatala and Patala, ¹⁰⁹² and everything in the universe could be seen inside the stomach. O best among *brahmanas*! Because of the god’s favours, his progress was unimpeded and he did not lose his memory. O *brahmanas*! Inside the stomach, he roamed around in the entire universe. But he was unable to reach the end of Vishnu’s body. O *brahmanas*! When the sage could not find an end to the body, he sought refuge with the god who was

the granter of boons. O *brahmanas*! At this, with the speed of the wind, he was suddenly expelled from the gaping mouth of the great-souled Purusha.'

Chapter 1(52) (Prayer to the illustrious one)

Brahma said, ‘O supreme sages! He emerged from the child’s stomach and again saw the earth submerged in that single ocean of water, devoid of people. He again saw the god, as he had seen him before, in the form of the child. He was lying down on a couch, on a branch of the *vata* tree. The *shrivatsa* mark was on the god’s chest. He had four arms and was attired in yellow garments. He was stationed there, with eyes like lotus petals, having drawn in the universe. Now that he had emerged from the mouth, he saw the sage being borne along towards him in the flood, bereft of his senses. He seemed to laugh, as he spoke to him. The illustrious one said, ‘O child! While you resided inside my stomach, did you rest a bit? While you were roaming around there, did you see anything wonderful? O best among sages! You are my devotee. You are exhausted and sought refuge with me. Therefore, to do you a good turn, I am speaking to you. I am here. Look at me.’ Hearing these words, he was delighted and he got goosebumps. Though he was extremely difficult to behold, he looked at him, ornamented with divine jewels. O *brahmanas*! In an instant, his vision became clear and sparkling. Through the favours of the gods, he had a new pair of eyes. The soles of the feet and the toes were red and were worshipped by the gods. O *brahmanas*! He bowed his head down and prostrated himself before those feet. Because of his delight, his voice faltered. He was delighted and astounded and repeatedly looked at the *paramatman*. Joining his hands in salutation, he started to praise him.’

Markandeya said, ‘O god of the gods! O Jagannatha! O one who has assumed the form of a child through his *maya*! O one with beautiful eyes like lotus petals! Save me. I am miserable and have sought refuge with you. O best among the gods! I am tormented by the fire that is known as

samvartaka. I am terrified of the shower of burning coals. O Purushottama! Save me. The wind of the universe has become a terrible wind and is drying me up. I am confused. I am exhausted. O Purushottama! Please save me. I am tormented by the Adityas and the other whirlwinds of destruction. I cannot find peace anywhere. O Purushottama! Save me. O lord of the universe! I am hungry. I am thirsty. I am full of misery. I cannot see a savior. O Purushottama! Save me. In this terrible and single ocean, all mobile and immobile objects have been destroyed. I cannot find an end to this. O Purushottama! Please save me. O lord of the gods! I saw all the mobile and immobile objects inside your stomach. I was astounded. But I am also distressed. O Purushottama! Save me. This *samsara* is without any foundation. O Purushottama! Show me your favours. O best among the gods! Please be pleased. O one who loves the gods! Please be pleased. O one who is a protector of the gods! Please be pleased. O one who is a refuge of the gods! Please be pleased. O lord of all the worlds! O cause behind all the causes in the universe! Please be pleased. O lord of all the gods! Please be pleased. O one who holds up the earth! Please be pleased. O one who resides in the water! Please be pleased. O Madhusudana! Please be pleased. O one loved by Kamala! ¹⁰⁹³ Please be pleased. O lord of the gods! Please be pleased. O slayer of Kamsa and Keshi! ¹⁰⁹⁴ Please be pleased. O destroyer of Arishta! Please be pleased. O Krishna, slayer of *daityas*! Please be pleased. O destroyer of the descendants of Danu! Please be pleased. O one who resides in Mathura! Please be pleased. O one who is descended from the lineage of the Yadus! Please be pleased. O one who is Shakra's younger brother! ¹⁰⁹⁵ O undecaying one who grants boons! Please be pleased. O god! You are earth. You are water. You are fire. You are wind. You are space. You are mind. You are *ahamkara*. You are *buddhi*! ¹⁰⁹⁶ You are Prakriti. O lord of the universe. You are *sattva* and everything else. You are Purusha. You are the seed of the universe. You are superior to Purusha and everything else. O lord! You are all the senses. You are sound and the objects of the senses. You are the guardians of the worlds. You are *dharma*. You are the Vedas. You are *yajnas*. You are *dakshina*. O god! You are Indra. You are Shiva. You are oblations. You are the one who bears the oblations.

¹⁰⁹⁷ O god! You are Yama, the lord of the ancestors. You are yourself the lord of the *rakshasas*. You are Varuna, the lord of the waters. You are Vayu. You are the lord of riches. ¹⁰⁹⁸ You are Ishana. You are Ananta. You are Ganesha. You are the one with six faces. ¹⁰⁹⁹ You are the Vasus. You are the Rudras. You are the Adityas. You are the ones who roam around in the firmament. You are the *danavas*. You are the *yakshas*. You are the *daityas*. You are the large number of Maruts. You are the *siddhas*. You are the *apsaras*. You are the *nagas*. You are the *gandharvas*. You are the *charanas*. You are the ancestors. You are the *valakhilyas*. O Achyuta! You are the Prajapatis. You are the sages. You are the large number of *rishis*. You are the two Ashvins. You are the ones who roam around in the night. You are all the other species, everything that goes by the name of a living creature. What is the need to speak a lot? Beginning with Brahma and ending with a blade of grass, you are everything that can be perceived. You are the past, the present and the future. You are everything mobile and immobile in the universe. O god! You have a supreme form that is deep, steady, motionless and eternal. Brahma and the others do not know this. How can those with limited intelligence? O god! Your nature is pure. You are eternal. You are superior to Prakriti. You are not manifest. You are everlasting. You are Ananta. You are the great lord who pervades everything. You are beyond the sky. You are serene. You are without birth. You are the lord who is without decay. Since you are *nirguna* and without blemish, who is capable of praising you? O god! Nevertheless, imperfect and limited in my intelligence, I have praised you. O undecaying god! O lord of the gods! O one who is everything! You should pardon this transgression.'

Chapter 1(53) (Markandeya's vision)

Brahma said, 'O *brahmanas*! The illustrious one was praised by Markandeya in this way. He was pleased and spoke to him in a voice that rumbled like the clouds. The illustrious one said, 'O best among sages! Tell me the wish that is there in your mind. O brahmana *rishi*! I will grant you everything that you ask for.' O *brahmanas*! Hearing the words of the great-souled child, the sage's mind was filled with great delight. Markandeya replied, 'O god! O one who bestows *moksha*! I wish to know about your *maya*. O lord of the gods! Because of your favours, my memory has not suffered. I quickly roamed around inside your body. ¹¹⁰⁰ O Pundarikaksha! O one without decay! I desire to know you. Having drunk up the entire universe and having assumed the form of a child, why are you stationed here? You should explain all this to me. O unblemished you! Why is the entire universe located inside your body? O scorcher of enemies! How long will you remain here? O lord of the gods! I wish to know this. Please tell me everything in detail. O one with eyes like lotus petals! Tell me the exact truth about all this in detail. O lord! What I have seen is great and is unthinkable.' Thus addressed, the immensely radiant god of the gods comforted him. The one who is supreme among eloquent ones addressed him in these words.'

The illustrious one said, 'O brahmana! Even if they wish to, the gods do not know the truth about me. Since I am pleased with you, I will tell you how I create and withdraw this universe. O brahmana *rishi*! You are devoted to your father ¹¹⁰¹ and you have sought refuge with me alone. Your *brahmacharya* is great. Therefore, I have directly shown myself to you. Water is known by the name of *nara*. Because of what I did earlier, I am known by the name of Narayana. Water was my *ayana*. ¹¹⁰² Since I always

lie down there, my name is Narayana. I am the eternal and undecaying source of creation. O supreme among *brahmanas*! I am the one who ordains all creatures and destroys them. O supreme among *brahmanas*! I am Vishnu. I am Brahma. I am also Shakra. I am King Vaishravana. ¹¹⁰³ I am Yama, the lord of the ancestors. I am Shiva, Soma and Kashyapa Prajapati. O supreme among *brahmanas*! I am Dhatri and Vidhatri. I am sacrifices. Agni is my mouth. My feet are the earth. The sun and the moon are my eyes. Heaven is my head. Space and the directions are my ears. Water originates from my sweat. The sky and the directions are my body. The wind is established in my mind. I have performed hundreds of sacrifices and have given copious quantities of the appropriate *dakshina*. Those who are learned about the Vedas perform sacrifices to me. I am the divinity who is established in a sacrifice. On earth, Indras among *kshatriyas* and kings who desire heaven perform sacrifices to me. So do *vaishyas* who wish to go to the world of heaven. I alone am the one who assumes the form of Shesha and holds up the earth, ornamented by Meru and Mandara and extending right up to the four oceans. O brahmana! In ancient times, the earth was submerged in the water. I assumed the form of a boar and resorted to my energy to raise it up. O brahmana! O supreme among *brahmanas*! I assume the form of the subterranean fire and entering the water in this form, drink up the water and release it. ¹¹⁰⁴ *Brahmanas* are my face, *kshatriyas* are my arms, *vaishyas* are my thighs and shudras are my feet. In due order, that determines their valour. Rig Veda, Sama Veda, Yajur Veda and Atharva Veda originate from me and enter into me. Mendicants who try for, and hunger after, supreme peace, those who are free of desire, anger and enmity, those who are without attachment, those who are devoid of sins, those who are immersed in *sattva*, those who are devoid of *ahamkara* and those who know about *adhyatma* always worship me. *Brahmanas* always think of me. I am the energy known as *samvartaka*. I am the fire known as *samvartaka*. I am the *samvartaka* sun. I am the *samvartaka* wind. O supreme among *brahmanas*! Know that what can be seen in the firmament in the form of stars is nothing but my body hair. Know that all the oceans, stores of jewels and the four directions are my garments, my beds and my abodes. O

excellent one! Know that desire, rage, delight, fear and confusion are nothing but my forms. O *brahmanas*! Men who perform excellent deeds obtain me. They are those who are truthful, donate, perform fierce austerities, are non-violent towards all creatures, follow the indications I have ordained and think about my body. I am the one who suffuses them with *vijnana*. This cannot be obtained by trying for it or desiring it. *Brahmanas* who study the Vedas properly, perform many kinds of sacrifices, control themselves and conquer rage, are the ones who obtain me. Men who perform wicked deeds are incapable of obtaining me. Such are those who are overwhelmed by greed, are misers, those who are ignoble and those who have not cleansed their souls. Know that these are the great fruits obtained by men who have cleansed their souls. Foolish people and those who resort to deceitful yoga find it impossible to obtain me. O excellent one! Whenever *dharma* suffers and *adharma* arises, I create myself. ¹¹⁰⁵ There are times when *daityas* are addicted to violence and cannot be slain by the best of gods. Terrible *rakshasas* may also be born in this world. At such times, I create myself in the homes of those who undertake auspicious deeds. I enter a human body and pacify everything. Having created gods, humans, *gandharvas*, *uragas*, *rakshasas* and mobile and immobile entities, I use my own *maya* to destroy them. O supreme among sages! O Indra among *brahmanas*! Among all creatures, there is no one who is able to determine my nature properly. In all the worlds, my devotees worship me in every possible way. O brahmana! O unblemished one! If there were any hardships you experienced while you were inside me, all those were only for the sake of your benefit and happiness. Everything mobile and immobile that you have seen in the world has all been thought of by me. It is my *atman* that thinks of creating beings. My name is Narayana and I hold the conch shell, the *chakra* and the mace. O brahmana *rishi*! While one thousand yugas pass, I sleep. I am the *atman* of the universe and I confound the entire universe. O supreme among sages! I am everything. Though I am not a child, as long as Brahma does not wake up, I assume the form of a child. ¹¹⁰⁶ O Indra among *brahmanas*! Since large numbers of brahmana *rishis* have worshipped me properly, I am satisfied

and in the form of Brahma, have granted you a boon. All mobile and immobile objects were destroyed and everything was reduced to a single ocean. When you emerged, you were ignorant and did not recognize me. Therefore, when you entered inside my body, the entire universe was shown to you. Having seen all the worlds, you were astounded. But you still did not understand. O brahmana *rishi*! That is the reason I quickly expelled you through my mouth. I told you about my *atman*, which is impossible for even gods and *asuras* to comprehend. O brahmana *rishi*! Until the illustrious Brahma, great in his austerities, wakes up, be reassured and comfortably remain here. O supreme among *brahmanas*! When the grandfather of all the worlds wakes up, I alone will create the elements, the bodies, space, earth, fire, wind and water and all the mobile and immobile objects that exist in the worlds.'

Brahma continued, 'O *brahmanas*! Having spoken to him in this way, Madhava again spoke to him in a voice that rumbled like the clouds, after the period of one thousand yugas was over. The illustrious one said, 'O sage! Tell me the truth about why you praised me. What is the supreme objective you desire? Ask for the best boon you wish for. I will immediately bestow it on you. You have a lifespan that is longer than that of the gods. You are my devotee and are firm in your vows. O Indra among *brahmanas*! Hence, may you have an even longer lifespan.' Hearing these auspicious words, he glanced at him again. With his head lowered, he quickly prostrated himself. Having bowed down, he spoke again. Markandeya said, 'O supreme brahmana! ¹¹⁰⁷ O lord of the gods! O Hari! Since I have seen you, my delusion has gone away. This is the truth. O Jagannatha! However, through your favours, there is something that I do desire. This is for the welfare of all the worlds and for the sake of calming the many kinds of sentiments that are prevalent. This is to counter the debates that occur between the devotees of Shiva and Vishnu. This supreme and sacred *tirtha* of Purushottama is sparkling. O god! I will construct a supreme and large temple for Shiva here. Shankara will be instated in your place. That way, people will know that Hari and Hara are the same form.' Jagannatha spoke to the great sage again. The illustrious one said, 'The god Bhuvaneshvara

¹¹⁰⁸ is the supreme cause. For the sake of calming the many kinds of sentiments, the *lingam* must be worshipped. O Indra among *brahmanas*! Following my command, quickly construct a temple to Shiva. ¹¹⁰⁹ Through Shiva's powers, remain in that undecaying place. O brahmana! When Shiva is instated, I am also instated. There is no difference between us. We are one, but have been divided into two. Rudra himself is Vishnu and Vishnu himself is Maheshvara. There is no difference between them, just as there is no difference between the wind and space. It is only the foolish who do not know that Garudadhvaja is Vrishadhvaja, the three-eyed Tripuraghna. ¹¹¹⁰ O brahmana! Name that temple to Shiva after your name. ¹¹¹¹ Create this extremely beautiful *tirtha* just to the north of the god of the gods. ¹¹¹² Let it be famous in the world of men as Markandeya's lake. O best among *brahmanas*! It will destroy all sins.' O best among sages! Having spoken in this way to Markandeya, Janardana, who pervades everything, instantly vanished.'

Chapter 1(54) (Greatness of visiting Krishna)

Brahma said, ‘O *brahmanas*! After this, I will tell you about the norms for the five *tirthas* and the fruits from bathing, donations and beholding the divinities there. A man should go to Markandeya’s lake and face the north. He must purify himself by immersing himself thrice in the water and utter this *mantra*. ‘I am submerged in this ocean of *samsara* and seized by sin, have lost my senses. O destroyer of Bhaga’s eyes! O enemy of Tripura! Save me. I bow down to you. I bow down before the serene Shiva, the one who dispels all sins. O lord of the gods! I am bathing here. May my sins be destroyed.’ One must bathe in the water, immersing oneself only up to the navel. An intelligent person will then satisfy the gods, the *rishis* and the ancestors by offering sesamum and water. Having bathed and rinsed one’s mouth, one should go to Shiva’s temple. Having entered the god’s abode, one should perform *pradakshina* thrice. O *brahmanas*! Using the basic *aghora mantra*, one should prostrate oneself and worship and seek the favours of Markandeya’s lord. ‘O Trilochana! I bow down to you. O Shashibhushana! I bow down to you. O Virupaksha! Save me. O Mahadeva! I bow down to you.’ ¹¹¹³ If a man bathes in Markandeya’s lake and then sees Shankara, he obtains the fruits of ten horse sacrifices. He is freed from all sins and goes to Shiva’s world. There, until the deluge arrives, he enjoys supreme objects of pleasure. When he is born in this world, he becomes an extremely learned brahmana. After becoming united with Shankara, he obtains emancipation.

‘After this, one must go to the *vata* tree, which is like a tree that grants all the objects of desire. ¹¹¹⁴ Having performed *pradakshina* thrice, one must use this *mantra* to worship the tree with great devotion. ‘Oum! I bow down before the one who is not manifest in form, the one who is the cause of the

great destruction. I bow down before the *nyagrodha* tree that possesses this great juice. O *vata* tree! You are immortal and always survive the end of the *kalpa*. You are Hari's abode. O *nyagrodha*! Destroy my sins! O tree that grants all the objects of desire! I bow down before you.' A man must bow down and faithfully perform *pradakshina* of the *vata* tree that grants all the objects of desire. Like a snake shedding its skin, one is then instantly cleansed of sins. O *brahmanas*! Even if a man passes under the shade of the tree that grants all the objects of desire, he is freed from the sin of killing a brahmana, not to speak of other sins. O *brahmanas*! The *nyagrodha* has been created from Krishna's body, it is full of the supreme energy of the *brahman*. It is Vishnu in another form. By bowing down to it, one obtains fruits that are greater than those of a royal sacrifice or a horse sacrifice. Saving one's own lineage, one then goes to Vishnu's world.

'Vainateya is stationed in front of Krishna. ¹¹¹⁵ If a person bows down before him, he is freed from all sins and goes to Vishnu's city. After seeing the *vata* tree and Vainateya, if a person sees Purushottama, Samkarshana and Subhadra, he obtains the supreme destination. Having entered Vishnu's temple, one must perform *pradakshina* thrice. One must worship and please Samkarshana and Bhadra ¹¹¹⁶ by using their own respective *mantras*. 'I bow down before the Rama who holds a plough. I bow down before the one who uses a club as a weapon. I bow down before the one who is loved by Revati. ¹¹¹⁷ I bow down before the one who is affectionate towards his devotees. I bow down before the one who is supreme among those who are strong. I bow down before the one who holds up the earth. I bow down before the one who is Pralamba's enemy. ¹¹¹⁸ O Krishna's elder brother! Save me.' In this way, one must please the invincible divinity who is worshipped by the gods. His form is like the summit of Kailasa. His face is more beautiful than the moon. The god is attired in blue garments and a hideous hood is held aloft his head. He is extremely strong and wields the plough. He is ornamented with a single earring. If a man devotedly worships Rohini's son, he obtains the desired fruits. He is freed from all sins and goes to Vishnu's world. Until the onset of the deluge, such a man enjoys bliss there. When his store of good merits is exhausted, he is born on earth in a family

of supreme yogis. He becomes a foremost brahmana and is accomplished in the purport of all the sacred texts. Having achieved *jnana*, he then obtains emancipation, which is so very difficult to obtain.'

'Having worshipped the wielder of the plough in this way, a discriminating person will next control himself and use the *mantra* with the twelve *aksharas* to worship Krishna. ¹¹¹⁹ If a patient person always uses the *mantra* with twelve *aksharas* to devotedly worship Purushottama, he obtains emancipation. The gods cannot go there, or yogis, or those who chant from the Sama Veda. O *brahmanas*! Those who are devoted to the *mantra* with the twelve *aksharas* go there. Therefore, one must faithfully use this *mantra* to worship Krishna, the preceptor of the universe, with fragrances, flowers and other things. One must prostrate oneself and please him. 'Victory to Krishna Jagannatha. Victory to the one who destroys all sins. Victory to the slayer of Chanura ¹¹²⁰ and Keshi. Victory to the slayer of Kamsa. Victory to the one with eyes like the petals of lotuses. Victory to the one who holds a *chakra* and a mace. Victory to the one who has the complexion of a dark blue cloud. Victory to the one who grants all kinds of happiness. Victory to the god who should be worshipped by the universe. Victory to the one who destroys *samsara*. Victory to Vishnu, who deserves to be worshipped by the worlds. Victory to the one who bestows all the fruits that are desired. This terrible ocean of *samsara* is without any substance. The miseries are like its foam. In the form of anger, it is full of terrible crocodiles. The objects of the senses are like a flood of water. Many kinds of ailments are the turbulent waves. There are whirlpools of delusion and it is extremely difficult to cross. O best among the gods! O Purushottama! I am submerged in it. Please save me.' In this way, the one who bestows boons, the one who is affectionate towards his devotees, must be pleased. He is the lord of the gods and destroys all kinds of sins. He is the god who confers all the fruits that one desires. Krishna has two arms and broad shoulders. His eyes are like lotus petals. His chest is wide and he is mighty-armed. His face is auspicious and he is attired in yellow garments. He holds a conch shell, a *chakra* and a mace in his hands. He is adorned with a diadem and armlets. He possesses all the auspicious signs

and is ornamented with a garland of wildflowers. O *brahmanas*! On seeing him, if a man joins his hands in salutation and prostrates himself like a rod, he obtains the fruits of one thousand horse sacrifices. Fruits have been described for visiting all the *tirthas* and bathing and donating there. By seeing Krishna and prostrating himself before him, a man obtains all those fruits. Fruits have been described for performing sacrifices at which all kinds of jewels, a lot of gold and many other objects are given. By seeing Krishna and prostrating himself before him, a man obtains all those fruits. Fruits have been described for all the Vedas and all the different kinds of sacrifices. By prostrating himself before Krishna, a man obtains all those fruits. There are fruits from all kinds of donations, vows and rites. By seeing Krishna and prostrating himself before him, a man obtains all those fruits. Extremely great fruits have been described from many kinds of fierce austerities. By seeing Krishna and prostrating himself before him, a man obtains those fruits. When *brahmacharya* is properly followed, fruits have been described. By seeing Krishna and prostrating himself before him, a man obtains those fruits. There are fruits for good conduct in the *garhasthya* stage. By seeing Krishna and prostrating himself before him, a man obtains those fruits. Fruits have been described for observing *sannyasa* in the indicated way. By seeking Krishna and prostrating himself before him, a man obtains those fruits. O *brahmanas*! What is the need to speak a lot about his greatness? On faithfully seeing Krishna, a man obtains emancipation, which is so very difficult to obtain. He is freed from all sins that are accumulated over one crore *kalpas*. He possesses supreme prosperity and possesses all the qualities. Having saved twenty-one generations of his family, astride a *vimana* that is extremely radiant and is rich with all the objects of desire, such a man goes to Vishnu's city. Like the four-armed Vishnu, along with *gandharvas* and *apsaras*, he enjoys all the agreeable objects of pleasure for one hundred *kalpas*. When he is dislodged from there and arrives on earth, he is born in a family of supreme *brahmanas*. He knows about *dharma* and about all the Vedas and is devoid of malice. He is serene and is devoted to his own *dharma*. He is controlled

and is engaged in the welfare of all creatures. Having gained Vaishnava *jnana*, he obtains emancipation.'

'O *brahmanas*! Joining his hands in salutation and prostrating himself, a devotee must faithfully worship and please Subhadra with a *mantra*. 'O goddess who goes everywhere! I bow down before you. O auspicious one who grants happiness! I bow down before you. O one with eyes like lotus petals! I bow down before you. O Katyayani! I bow down before you.' For the welfare of the universe, the goddess who is the creator of the universe must be pleased in this way. Subhadra, the auspicious one, is one who bestows boons. She is Baladeva's sister. On a *vimana* that goes wherever one wills, having pleased her, a man goes to Vishnu's city. Until the deluge arrives, he sports there, like a god. When he becomes a human on earth, he is a brahmana who is learned about the Vedas. After being united with Hari, he certainly obtains emancipation.'

Chapter 1(55) (Greatness of Narasimha)

Brahma said, ‘Having seen and prostrated oneself before Bala, Krishna and Subhadra, one certainly obtains *dharma*, *artha*, *kama* and *moksha*. Having accomplished his objective, a man can emerge from divinity’s temple. He must control himself and depart only after he has bowed down to the temple. He should go to the spot where Vishnu’s image, made out of lapis lazuli, is hidden, covered in the sand. Bowing down at the spot where the god vanished, he then goes to Vishnu’s city. ¹¹²¹ All the gods are in him. He is the one who killed supreme *asuras*. O *brahmanas*! He is there in the form of an image that is half a lion. ¹¹²² If a mortal person sees the god Narasimha ¹¹²³ and faithfully prostrates himself before him, there is no doubt that he is freed from all sins. Men on earth who are devoted to Narasimha do not suffer from the fruits of any of their bad deeds. Instead, they obtain what they wish for. Making all efforts, one must seek refuge with Narasimha, so that he bestows the fruits of *dharma*, *artha*, *kama* and *moksha*.’

The sages said, ‘O god! You have spoken about Narasimha’s greatness and that he confers happiness, which is so very difficult to obtain on earth. We are greatly surprised at this. O lord of the universe! We wish to hear in detail about the god’s powers. We have great curiosity. Please tell us. How can the extremely strong Narasimha be pleased? How does he do good deeds towards his devotees? O god. We bow down to you. Please tell us. How does one become successful in pleasing Narasimha? O great grandfather! Please show us your favours and tell us that.’

Brahma replied, ‘O *brahmanas*! I will tell you about his powers. Listen. He cannot be vanquished and he is immeasurable. He is the one who bestows objects of pleasure and emancipation. O *brahmanas*! Who is

capable of speaking about all his qualities? Half of his body is like that of a lion. I will tell you briefly. It has been heard that gods and humans obtain *siddhis* through his favours. ¹¹²⁴ There is no doubt that all the *siddhis* can be obtained. Through the god's favours, one's progress in heaven, the mortal world, nether regions, in the directions, in water, in cities and in mountains is unimpeded. O *brahmanas*! In mobile and immobile objects, there is nothing that the god Narasimha cannot accomplish. He is always compassionate towards his devotees. I will tell you about the means whereby he does good deeds for his devotees and about how he, with half a body that is like a lion, is pleased. O tigers among sages! Hear about this royal and eternal ritual and the truth about Narasimha, not known to gods and *asuras*. O *brahmanas*! A person who wishes to worship the lord must subsist by eating vegetables, barley, roots, fruits, oilcakes, *saktu* and milk. He must be attired in a garment that is only a pure loincloth. He must conquer his senses and meditate in a forest, a desolate region, a mountain, a confluence of rivers, barren land, a *siddha kshetra* ¹¹²⁵ or Narasimha's hermitage. He must follow the norms, instate the image himself and perform worship. O bulls among sages! He must fast on the twelfth lunar day in *shukla paksha*. Controlling his senses, he must perform *japa* two million times. O *brahmanas*! Thus, there is no doubt that the person performing the worship will be liberated from major sins and minor sins. He must perform *pradakshina* of Narasimha and worship him with flowers, fragrances, incense and other things. He must bow his head down before the lord and apply jasmine flowers smeared with camphor and sandalwood paste on Narasimha's head. Success is achieved in this way. The illustrious one is never countered in any of his activities. Even Brahma, Rudra and the other gods are incapable of tolerating his energy. What can then be said about *danavas*, *siddhas*, *gandharvas*, humans, *vidyadharas*, *yakshas*, *kinnaras* and giant *uragas* in different worlds? There are worshippers who desire to perform *japa* with other kinds of *mantras*. ¹¹²⁶ When they see him, radiant like the fire or the sun, all of them are destroyed. When *japa* is performed properly, the *kavacha* ¹¹²⁷ constantly provides happiness. When *japa* is performed twice, the *kavacha* becomes divine and protects from

gods and *danavas*. *Gandharvas*, *kinnaras*, *yakshas*, *vidyadharas*, giant *uragas*, *bhutas*, *pishachas*, *rakshasas* and others cannot cause impediments. When *japa* is performed thrice, the *kavacha* becomes divine and gods and *asuras* cannot penetrate it. O supreme among *brahmanas*! The illustrious and immensely strong god, Narasimha, protects the devotee within a distance of twelve *yojanas*. After this, the devotee must go near the mouth of a cave ¹¹²⁸ and fast there for three nights. Using wood from a *palasha* tree, he must ignite the illustrious fire-god. As kindling, he must use *palasha* wood that has been soaked thrice in honey. O tigers among *brahmanas*! The devotee must utter *vashatkara* two hundred times. At this, the entry to the mouth of the cave will become instantly visible. Without any hesitation, the learned person must enter the hole, taking the *kavacha* with him. As he advances, his difficulties, darkness and confusion will be destroyed. An extremely broad royal road will be seen, with bees buzzing along the way. O *brahmanas*! Remembering Narasimha, he will enter the nether regions. Having gone there, he must perform *japa* for the undecaying Narasimha. O *brahmanas*! Thousands of women, playing *veenas* in their hands, will emerge from the city and speak words of welcome. They will hold this lord of devotees by the hand and make him enter. O supreme among *brahmanas*! They will make him drink a divine elixir. As soon as he drinks this, he will become extremely strong, with a divine body. Until the deluge arrives, he will sport with those maidens there. When he assumes a different body, there is no doubt that he will merge into Vasudeva. If the idea of residing there does not appeal to him, he can emerge again. O best among sages! A lord among devotees will always have with him a piece of cloth, a trident, a sword, some yellow pigment, a jewel, a drink that is an elixir, footwear, collyrium, black antelope-skin, a beautiful pearl, a water-pot, a string of *rudraksha*, successful knowledge of *sanjivani* and the sacred texts. ¹¹²⁹ The trident is surrounded with waves of blazing sparks. If it is placed against the heart even once, it destroys all the sins accumulated over one crore births. If it is placed in poison, it destroys the poison. If it is placed over the body, it cures leprosy. If one has committed the sin of killing a fetus, if this divine object is placed over one's body, one is

purified. If one is suffering on account of great and adverse planets, if one thinks of it blazing away in one's heart, those terrible planets are destroyed. If the *kavacha* is strung around a child's neck, the child is always protected. It is certain to cure boils and lumps and destroy spiders. If there are ailments, at the time of the three *sandhyas*, oblations of kindling smeared with *ghee* and milk must be offered for a month. Every kind of disease will be destroyed. I do not see anything in the world of mobile and immobile objects that cannot be accomplished. The devotee will certainly obtain every success he wishes for. There is another way of worshipping the lord of deer ¹¹³⁰ one hundred and eight times. The devotee must take seven bits of clay from termite hills, cremation grounds and crossroads. Mixing this with red sandalwood paste and milk, he will make a lump. Using this, he will make a lion's image that is six finger-lengths in size. A person who knows the *mantra* will then tie it in a leaf from a birch tree ¹¹³¹ and smear it with yellow ointment, hanging it around Narasimha's neck. He will next perform worship in a water body, performing *japa* with the *mantra* innumerable times. If one controls one's senses and performs the *japa* only for a week, in an instant, the entire earth will be covered with water. Alternatively, Narasimha can be worshipped on the top of a dry tree. If one performs the *japa* one hundred and eight times, all showers can be stopped. An excellent devotee can place the image inside a cage and whirl it around. There is no doubt that a giant storm will instantly arise. If one performs the *japa* seven times, that can quickly be countered with water. Or, the devotee can dig up the ground near someone's door and place the image inside it. The person's entire *gotra* will be destroyed. As soon as the image is taken out, there will be peace. O tigers among sages! Therefore, the king of deer must always be faithfully worshipped. He is immensely valiant and confers all the fruits one wishes for. A brahmana, a *kshatriya*, a *vaishya*, a shudra or an *antyaja* who worships him is freed from all sins and goes to Vishnu's world. If a person devotedly worships the best among the gods, who has assumed the form of a lion, he is freed from all inauspicious miseries that have been accumulated in one crore births. O *brahmanas*! If a person worships the best among the gods, a person obtains whatever he wishes for

—the status of a god, the status of becoming the lord of the immortals, becoming a *gandharva*, becoming a *vidyadhara*, or anything else that is desired. By seeing, praising, bowing down to and worshipping Narakesari, a man obtains the kingdom of heaven and emancipation, which is so very difficult to obtain. By seeing Narasimha, a man obtains the desired fruits. He is freed from all sins and goes to Vishnu's world. If one sees the god who has assumed the form of a lion even once, with devotion in one's heart, one is freed from inauspicious miseries that have accumulated in one crore births. If a man remembers him, he is freed from all calamities—in battle, in hardships, in impenetrable places, when suffering from thieves or tigers, in desolate places, when there is threat to life from poison, fire or water, when one is oppressed by kings or oceans, and when there are ailments or the planets are adverse. He is like the rising sun that dispels darkness, except that he is greater. As soon as one sees him, all calamities are destroyed. When Narasimha is pleased, one obtains a pearl, ¹¹³² collyrium, footwear that conveys a person to the nether regions, or anything else one desires. When a man worships Narakesari with some desire in his mind, there is no doubt that he obtains everything that he wishes for. When one sees the god, who is the lord of all the gods and prostrating oneself faithfully, worships him, the fruits that are obtained are ten times the fruits obtained from ten horse sacrifices. The devotee is freed from all sins and becomes ornamented with all the qualities. Such a man becomes prosperous, with all the objects of desire and is freed from old age and death. Praised by the *apsaras*, he goes to Vishnu's world astride a golden *vimana* that has garlands made out of nets of bells. It is extremely radiant and is like the youthful sun in complexion, with necklaces of pearls suspended from it. It has all the objects of desire and can travel as one wills. Astride this, with one hundred divine women and to the divine sounds of *gandharvas* singing, he saves twenty-one generations of his family and goes there, where he is as happy as the gods. O supreme *brahmanas*! In Vishnu's world, he enjoys the best of objects of pleasure. With excellent *gandharvas* and *apsaras*, he assumes a four-armed form that brings delight to the mind and enjoys happiness till the deluge arrives. When his store of good deeds is

exhausted, he returns to this world in a family of excellent yogis. He becomes a brahmana who knows the four Vedas and is accomplished in the Vedas and the Vedangas. When he unites with Vishnu, he obtains emancipation.'

Chapter 1(56) (Greatness of Shveta Madhava)

Brahma said, ‘Vasudeva is known as Ananta. On seeing him and faithfully prostrating himself before him, a man is freed from all sins and obtains the supreme destination. I have worshipped him and Shakra has worshipped him after that. He has been worshipped by Vibhishana and Rama. Which man will not want to worship him? After bathing in Shveta-Ganga, if a man sees Shveta-Madhava and Matsya-Madhava, he goes to Shveta-dvipa.’ ¹¹³³

The sages said, ‘You should tell us in detail about the greatness of Shveta-Madhava. You should tell us in detail about Hari Jagannatha’s instatement there, in that supreme and sacred *tirtha* that is famous on the surface of the earth. In ancient times, how was the divinity Shveta-Madhava established?’

Brahma replied, ‘O *brahmanas*! In *krita* yuga, there was a powerful king named Shveta. He was intelligent, brave and knowledgeable about *dharma*. He did not waver from the truth and was firm in his vows. In his kingdom, men lived for ten thousand years. They did not suffer from disease. No one suffered, not even children. O *brahmanas*! There was a *rishi* named Kapala-Goutama, who was extremely devoted to *dharma*. O *brahmanas*! When this kind of affairs had lasted in the kingdom for some time, the sage had a son, who succumbed to destiny and died as an infant, even before his milk teeth had grown. Taking the infant with him, the *rishi* came to the intelligent king. O *brahmanas*! The king saw the infant lying down, senseless and pledged that he would bring the infant back to life. The king said, ‘This infant has gone to Yama’s abode. If I do not bring him back within seven nights, I will ascend a blazing pyre.’ Saying this, the king used his knowledge and performed *japa* to Mahadeva with one thousand and one hundred black lotuses. The lord of the universe noticed the king’s great

devotion. He arrived, along with Uma, and said, ‘I am pleased.’ The king heard Girisha’s words and suddenly saw Hara. Virupaksha’s body was smeared with ashes and he was as radiant as the autumn moon. His garment was the hide of a tiger and the moon adorned his head. He quickly fell down on the ground, prostrated himself and spoke these words. Shveta said, ‘This infant, the brahmana’s son, has come under the subjugation of destiny. O lord! If you are compassionate towards me and if you are pleased to see me, let this infant come back to life again. This is my vow. O illustrious one! Following the rules that you yourself have set, this child has suddenly died. O Maheshvara! Please act so that he can find peace and a long life.’ Hearing Shveta’s words, Hara was delighted. He summoned Kala,¹¹³⁴ who causes fright to all creatures. O *brahmanas*! Kala follows Yama’s commands and is impossible to control, but he restrained him. The child was brought back from the jaws of death and lived again. O *brahmanas*! Having ensured the welfare of the world and having brought the sage’s son back to life, the god instantly vanished, along with goddess Uma. In this way, the excellent king brought the sage’s son back to life.’

The sages said, ‘O god of the gods! O protector of the universe! O creator of the three worlds! Now tell us the supreme truth about Shveta.’¹¹³⁵

Brahma replied, ‘O tigers among sages! For the welfare of all living beings, listen. O unblemished ones! I will tell you the truth about what you have asked me, about Madhava’s greatness. It destroys all sins. Hearing this, a man obtains all the objects that he desires. O *brahmanas*! Earlier, I heard about the one known as Madhava from the *rishis*. Hear about the divine account. It destroys fear, grief and affliction. With undivided attention, he¹¹³⁶ ruled over the kingdom for thousands of years. He reflected on the customary practices of *dharma* and the *niyama* prescribed in the Vedas. O *brahmanas*! He made up his mind to follow the vow of worshipping Keshava. He went to the supreme *kshetra* that is the shores of the southern ocean. On that shore, in the auspicious and beautiful region, and near Krishna, he had a palace constructed for Shveta.¹¹³⁷ It possessed all the auspicious signs and was one hundred bow lengths to the south of the god of the gods. O Indras among *brahmanas*! That abode of Shveta’s

resembled a white mountain. The temple to the illustrious Shveta-Madhava resembled a moon. As he had himself been instructed earlier, he followed the norms and had the instatement done. He gave donations to *brahmanas*, the distressed, those without protectors and ascetics. After this, the king went to Madhava's presence and quickly prostrated himself on the ground. For an entire month, he was immersed in *samadhi* and silently performed *japa*, uttering Omkara and the twelve *aksharas*.¹¹³⁸ The immensely fortunate one did not eat and was properly immersed only in Vishnu's feet. After the *japa* was over, he started to praise the lord of the gods.'

Shveta said, 'Oum! I bow down to Vasudeva. I bow down to Samkarshana. I bow down to Pradyumna, Aniruddha and Narayana. I bow down to Bahurupa, the creator who is Vishvarupa.¹¹³⁹ He is *nirguna*. He cannot be opposed. He is pure. He is pure in his deeds. Oum! I bow down to Padma-nabha, Padma-garba-bhava.¹¹⁴⁰ I bow down to Padma-varna, I bow down to Padma-hasta.¹¹⁴¹ Oum! I bow down to the lord who is Pushkaraksha and Sahasraksha.¹¹⁴² I bow down to Sahasra-pada and Sahasra-bhuja.¹¹⁴³ Oum! I bow down to Varaha, the extremely intelligent Varada, Varishtha, Varenya, Hiranya, Achyuta.¹¹⁴⁴ Oum! I bow down to Bala-rupa, Bala-padma-prabha, Balarka-soma-netra, the intelligent Munjakesha.¹¹⁴⁵ I bow down to Keshava, I always bow down to Narayana. I bow down to the supreme Madhava, I bow down to Govinda. I bow down. Oum. I bow down to Vishnu, the eternal god who is the origin of riches. I bow down to Madhusudana, the one who holds up pure rays. I bow down to the subtle Ananta. I bow down to the one who bears the *shrivatsa* mark. I bow down to Trivikrama, the divine one who is clad in yellow garments.¹¹⁴⁶ I bow down to you, the cause of creation. I bow down to the protector and the one who nurtures. I bow down. I bow down to the one who assumed the form of *vamana*. I bow down to the one who acted as *vamana*. I bow down to the one who had *vamana*'s eyes. I bow down to the one who had *vamana*'s mount. I bow down to the infinite one who is worthy of being worshipped. I bow down to the one whose form is not manifest. I bow down to the pure one who cannot be countered, the one who destroys fear. I bow down to the serene one who is like a boat in this ocean of *samsara*, the

one who is his own form. I bow down to the auspicious one who is gentle in form, to the one who assumes a terrible form. I bow down to the one who destroys the cycle of existence, the one who confers objects of pleasure in the cycle of existence. I bow down to the one who assumes the form of conflict in this cycle of existence, the one who creates this cycle of existence. Oum! I bow down to the one who is divine in form, the one who is Soma and pure Agni. I bow down to the one whose hair is the rays of Soma and Surya, to the one who ensures welfare of cattle and *brahmanas*. Oum! I bow down to the one who has the form of the Rig hymns, to the one who assumes the form of their lines and order. I bow down to you, the one who is praised through Rig hymns. I bow down to the one who can be reached through the Rig hymns. Oum! I bow down to the one who holds up the Yajur hymns, the one who assumes the form of the Yajur hymns. I bow down to the one who is worshipped through the Yajur hymns, the one who is the lord of the Yajur hymns. Oum! I bow down to the god who is Shripati, to the supreme Shridhara. ¹¹⁴⁷ I bow down to Shriyahkanta, Danta, Yogichintya, Yogi. ¹¹⁴⁸ Oum! I bow down to the one who assumes the form of the Sama hymns, the one who is the supreme chant of Sama hymns. Oum! I bow down to the one who is the gentle Sama hymns. I bow down to the one who knows about the yoga of Sama Veda. Oum! I bow down to the Sama hymns, to the one who is sung about in the Sama hymns, to the one who holds up the Sama hymns. I bow down to the one who knows about sacrifices associated with Sama Veda, to the one who has created Sama hymns. I bow down to the one whose head is the Atharva hymns, to the one who assumes the form of the Atharva hymns. I bow down to the one whose feet are the Atharva hymns. I bow down to the one who has created the Atharva hymns. Oum! I bow down to the one whose head is the *vajra*, to the one who killed Madhu and Kaitabha. I bow down to the one who stationed himself in the waters of the great ocean, so as to bring back the Vedas. I bow down to the one who blazes in his own radiance. I bow down to Hrishikesha. ¹¹⁴⁹ I bow down to the illustrious one. Vasudeva, I bow down to you. Narayana, I bow down to you. I bow down to the one who brings welfare to the worlds. I bow down to the one who destroys delusion. I bow

down to the one who breaks the cycle of existence. I bow down to the one who grants the destination. I bow down to the one who destroys bondage. I bow down to the one who creates all the energy in the three worlds, the one whose own form is that energy. I bow down to Yogishvara, Shuddha, Rama, Uttarana, Sukha, Sukhanetra, Sukritadharin. ¹¹⁵⁰ I bow down to Vasudeva, Vandyā ¹¹⁵¹ and Vamadeva. I bow down to the one who creates bodies for those who have bodies, the one who shatters all dissensions. I bow down to the one whose body is worshipped by the gods, the one with a celestial diadem. I bow down to the abode of fragrances, to the one who took objects away from Vasava. Oum! I bow down to the creator of riches, to the one who confers riches and abodes. I bow down to the one whose own form is in sacrifices, to the yogi who is the lord of sacrifices. I bow down to the one who is the lord of mendicants and yogis, to the one who upholds the different limbs of a sacrifice. I bow down to Samkarshana, the one who crushed Pralamba. ¹¹⁵² The sound of the plough is like the thundering of clouds and its speed is swift. I bow down to the one who holds it. I bow down to the one who is the *jnana* of the learned, to Narayana, who is the refuge. O lord! With your exception, there is no friend who can save me from descending into hell. O one who is affectionate towards those who bow down! Therefore, in every possible kind of way, I prostrate myself before you. O Keshava! O lord of the gods! O Achyuta! There are impurities in my body and in my mind. But with the exception of you, there is no one who can cleanse them. Casting aside every kind of attachment, I have presented myself before you. O Keshava! For the sake of my own *atman*, let my only attachment be with you. O Keshava! I know that *samsara* is full of miseries and calamities and is extremely difficult to cross. Suffering from three kinds of hardship, I have sought refuge with you. ¹¹⁵³ This entire universe is deluded by your *maya*. Tempted by avarice and other things, I am seeking refuge in you. O Vishnu! For those with bodies, there is no happiness in *samsara*. O lord of sacrifices! Whenever the consciousness turns towards you, one obtains ultimate happiness that is delinked from fruits. Without any sense of discrimination, I have been destroyed. I can see that the universe is afflicted. O Govinda! Save me from

samsara. You should raise me up. I am immersed in this ocean of worldly existence. There is no shore and there are waters of delusion. O Pundarikaksha! With the exception of you, there is no one else who can raise me up.’

Brahma continued, ‘O *brahmanas*! In that supreme, divine and famous *kshetra* of Purushottama, he was thus praised by King Shveta. The preceptor of the gods, the god of the gods, thought about his devotion. Surrounded by all the gods, Hari arrived in front of the king. His complexion was like that of dark blue clouds. His large eyes were like the petals of lotuses. He held the handsome Sudarshana *chakra*, with a blazing disc, on the tip of his hand. The immensely radiant Panchajanya ¹¹⁵⁴ was in his left hand, resplendent as the water from the ocean of milk or the sparkling moon. The king of the birds ¹¹⁵⁵ was on his standard and the handsome one held a mace, the Sharnga bow, a sword and the *chakra*. He said, ‘O king! This is praiseworthy and your intentions are excellent. O unblemished one! O fortunate one! I am pleased with you. What is the boon that you wish for?’ He heard the words of the god of the gods and they were superior to *amrita*. He prostrated his head in devotion and his mind was flooded with joy. Shveta said, ‘O illustrious one! Please grant me the excellent boon that I shall be in Vishnu’s undecaying abode, who is above everything else, starting with Brahma’s abode and including everything else. It is sparkling and is devoid of dust. It is pure and devoid of the attachments of *samsara*. O lord of the universe! Through your favours, that is the destination I wish to go to.’

‘The illustrious one replied, “That supreme destination is beautiful. It is without disease. All the gods, the sages and yogis who have succeeded are unable to go there. That is my world. It is my kingdom and a supreme place. Passing over all the other worlds, you will go there. O Shveta! O Indra among kings! You will go there, but your fame will remain in the three worlds. You will be in my presence. So far as this spot is concerned, everything will happen in the following way. All the gods and *danavas* will chant about Shveta-Ganga. O Indra among kings! If my devotees control themselves and touch the water of Shveta-Ganga with the tip of a blade of

kusha grass, they will go to heaven. This image is as radiant as the moon and will be known as Shveta-Madhava. It has the complexion of cow's milk and a conch shell and destroys all sins. The eyes are like the petals of lotus flowers. If a devotee visits it even once and devotedly prostrates himself, he will pass over all other worlds and obtain greatness in my world. For many manvantaras, he will be surrounded by celestial maidens there and will be tended to by skilled gandharvas, who will sing in sweet voices. With my followers, he will enjoy all the extensive objects of pleasure he wishes for. When he is dislodged from there and comes to earth, he will be human and a brahmana who knows about the Vedas and the Vedangas. He will be prosperous, possess all the objects of pleasure and live for a long time. He will possess elephants, horses, chariots and vehicles and will be surrounded with wealth and grain. He will be pure, handsome and extremely fortunate, with sons and grandsons. He will again come to Purushottama, at the root of the *vata* tree, near the ocean. Remembering Hari, he will give up his life there and go to a destination that is serene.”

Chapter 1(57) (Rituals for bathing in the ocean)

Brahma said, ‘After seeing Shveta-Madhava, one should go to Matsya-Madhava, which is nearby. This was the first *avatara* of Madhava, in the form of a fish. The Vedas had then gone down to *rasatala* and everything was submerged in a single mass of water. In those earlier times, thinking about raising the Vedas up and establishing the earth in its proper place, he had assumed the form of a *rohita* fish. ¹¹⁵⁶ If a person sees Matsya-Madhava and prostrates himself before him, he is freed from all miseries. He goes to the supreme spot, where God Hari is himself present. In the course of time, when he comes back to earth, he may be a king on the surface of the earth. By approaching Matsya-Madhava, a man becomes impossible to assail. He becomes generous, enjoys objects of pleasure, performs sacrifices to Vishnu and is devoted to the truth. After that, when he is united with Hari, he obtains emancipation. O tigers among sages! I have described the greatness of Matsya-Madhava. On seeing him, all the desired objects can be obtained.’

The sages said, ‘O illustrious one! We wish to hear how one cleanses oneself in Varuna’s abode. What are the rites for bathing and donating? Tell us about all the fruits.’

Brahma replied, ‘O tigers among sages! Hear the indicated norms for cleansing oneself. If the mind is filled with devotion, one obtains what is supremely auspicious. Bathing in Markandeya’s pond in the forenoon is praised. In particular, on the fourteenth lunar day, this destroys all sins. Bathing in the ocean is praised, regardless of the time. However, on the night of the full moon, one obtains the fruits of a horse sacrifice. The five *tirthas* are said to be Markandeya’s *vata*, Krishna’s temple, the temple of Rohini’s son, the great ocean and Indradyumna’s lake. In particular, one

should go to the supreme and auspicious king of *tirthas* on the night of the full moon in the month of Jyeshtha, when the *nakshatra* Jyeshtha is in the ascendant. One should be pure in one's sentiments, in deeds, words and thoughts, and should not think of anything else. One will then be free of the opposite pair of sentiments. One will be devoid of attachment and devoid of envy. The beautiful *vata* tree is like a tree that grants every object of desire. Having bathed there, one must control oneself and perform *pradakshina* of Janardana thrice. If one sees him, one is freed from sins that accumulate over seven births. O *brahmanas* ! One obtains extensive merits and the desired destination. O *brahmanas*! Though it has innumerable names, I will tell you about its names and dimensions in different yugas. O *brahmanas*! In due order, in *krita* and the other yugas, the tree is respectively known as Vata, Vateshvara, Purva and Puranapurusha. In *krita* and the other yugas, these are described as the names of the *vata* tree. In *krita* and the other yugas, the dimensions of the tree that grants all the objects of desire are respectively described as one *yojana*, three-fourths of a *yojana*, half a *yojana* and one-fourth of a *yojana*. Using the *mantra* mentioned earlier, one should bow down before the *vata* tree. After this, one should proceed south, for a distance of three hundred lengths of a bow. This is the beautiful gate to heaven and one can see Vishnu there. ¹¹⁵⁷ Any piece of wood that has been dragged by the waters of the ocean possesses all the qualities. One must prostrate oneself on the ground and repeatedly worship it. Thereby, one will be freed from all kinds of ailments, all sins and evil planets. After having first seen the gate to heaven near the ocean, one must go to Ugrasena. ¹¹⁵⁸ There, having rinsed one's mouth and purified oneself, one must meditate on the supreme Narayana. After this, one must use the *mantra* with the eight *aksharas* to perform *nyasa* on the hand and on the body. ¹¹⁵⁹ The learned have spoken of this *mantra* as '*Oum namo Narayanaya*.' What is the need for many *mantras*? They serve to cause confusion in the mind. The *mantra*, '*Oum namo Narayanaya*' achieves all the objectives. The water is the son of Nara and is thus known as Naara. ¹¹⁶⁰ Earlier, Vishnu lay down on it and is accordingly known as Narayana. In all the worlds, Narayana is supreme. Among all the gods, Narayana is supreme. Narayana is superior to the truth.

Narayana is the supreme destination. The earth is devoted to Narayana. Water is devoted to Narayana. Fire is devoted to Narayana. Space is devoted to Narayana. The wind is devoted to Narayana. The mind is devoted to Narayana. Both *ahamkara* and *buddhi* have Narayana as their essence. The past, the present and the future, everything that is described as living, the gross, the subtle and everything that is superior to these have Narayana as their essence. Sound and other objects of the senses, the ear and other sense organs, Prakriti, Purusha and everything have Narayana as their essence. Lord Narayana supports everything that is visible—water, land, nether regions, the world of heaven, the sky and mountains. What is the need to speak a lot? Beginning with Brahma and ending with a blade of grass, everything has Narayana as the essence. O *brahmanas*! I do not see anything that is superior to Narayana. Everything that can be seen and cannot be seen, everything that is mobile and is not mobile, is pervaded by him. Vishnu lies down in the water. He is the lord of the water. Therefore, in the water, one must always remember Narayana, who destroys all sins. Especially at the time of bathing and cleaning the genital organs with water, one must remember him. One must meditate on Narayana and perform *nyasa* on the hand and on the body. ‘Oum’ and ‘na’ are placed in the thumbs of the hands. In this way, *nyasa* is done with the other syllables, covering the palms of the hands and ending with the index fingers. ¹¹⁶¹ ‘Oum’ must be placed in the left foot and ‘na’ in the right foot. ‘Mo’ will be placed on the left flank and ‘na’ on the right flank. ‘Ra’ will be placed in the region of the navel and ‘ya’ on the left arm. After placing ‘na’ on the right arm, ‘ya’ will be placed on the head. A learned person must, thereafter, meditate on Narayana’s *kavacha* above, below, in the heart, on the flanks, at the back and in front. ‘May Govinda protect me in the east. May Madhusudana protect me in the south. May Shridhara protect me in the west. May god Keshava protect me in the north. May Vishnu protect me in the south-east. May the undecaying Madhava protect me in the south-west. May Hrishikesha protect me in the north-west. May Vamana protect me in the north-east. May Varaha protect me on the ground. May Trivikrama protect me from above.’ After having created the *kavacha* in this way, one must

next think about one's *atman*. 'I am God Narayana, who holds the conch shell, the *chakra* and the mace.' Having meditated on the *atman* in this way, he must utter the following *mantra*. 'O lord of bipeds! You are Agni. You are the one who provides them with semen, you are the one who ignites desire. You are supreme among all creatures. You are the undecaying lord of all those with life. You are the *arani* that is the source of *amrita*. You are the origin of the gods. You are the lord of the waters. O king of all the *tirthas*! I bow down before you. Take away all my sins.' Having uttered this in the proper way, one must then take a bath. O best among *brahmanas*! If this has not been done, taking a bath is not praised. Having uttered this *mantra* to the divinity, performed ablutions and cleansed oneself, one must stand in the water and use the *aghamarshana mantra* to perform *japa* thrice. ¹¹⁶² O *brahmanas*! The performance of a horse sacrifice destroys all sins. Like that, uttered here, the *aghamarshana sukta* destroys all sins. At the time of the two *sandhyas*, wearing clean and washed upper and lower garments, one should perform *pranayamana* and *achamana* and worship Bhaskara. Standing, one must raise up one's hands and tender an offering of flowers and water. As one raises up one's arms towards that image of Bhaskara, one must perform *japa* with the divine and purifying *gayatri mantra* one hundred and eight times. ¹¹⁶³ Controlling oneself, one must remain there, performing *japa* with other *mantras* to Surya. Having performed *pradakshina* and bowed down to Surya, one should sit down, facing the east, and study. *Tarpana* ¹¹⁶⁴ must be performed for gods, *rishis* and humans. A person who knows the *mantras* must control himself and following the norms, use water mixed with sesamum to perform *tarpana* for the ancestors, mentioning their names and *gotras*. A brahmana must control himself and first perform *tarpana* for the gods. It is only after this that he obtains the right to perform *tarpana* for the ancestors. At the time of *shraddha*, when a ball of rice is offered, this must only be done with one hand. *Tarpana* must be done with both hands. This is the eternal norm. Having stated the name and the *gotra*, one must join the left hand and the right hand and say, 'May you be satisfied'. Because of being distracted, if the *tarpana* to the ancestors is performed while the sesamum seed is still on

one's body, it is as if the *tarpana* to the ancestors has been performed with skin, flesh, blood and bones. *Tarpana* to the gods or the ancestors must not be performed with the sesamum seed sticking to one's limbs. The water is then mixed with blood, and a person who does this becomes a sinner. O tigers among sages! If the offering is placed on the ground or rendered when the person offering it is standing in the water, it is useless and brings benefit to nobody. If a man stands on the ground and offers water to the ancestors in the water, such offered water does not reach the ancestors and is useless. One must never stand in the water and offer water to the ancestors. He must climb out of the water and perform *tarpana* with water in a pure spot. The water must not be offered in the water, or in a vessel. It must not be offered when a person is angry, or with only one hand. Unless one is standing on the ground, the offered water does not reach them. O *brahmanas*! I have given the ancestors the earth as their eternal abode. Therefore, if one wishes to please the ancestors, this is where offerings to them have to be made. They were born on the surface of the earth. They were established on earth. When they died, it is into the earth that they merged. Therefore, the water must be offered on the ground. *Kusha* grass must be placed on the ground, the gods and the ancestors invoked with their own respective *mantras*. For the gods, the tips of the blades of grass must face the east. For the ancestors, they must face the south.'

Chapter 1(58) (Rituals of worship)

Brahma said, ‘O *brahmanas*! One must silently perform *tarpana* to the gods and the ancestors. After this, on the shores of the great ocean, he must draw the image of a city. It should have four corners and four gates and should be extremely beautiful. But in size, it should only be the length of one hand. Inside this city, one must then draw a lotus with eight petals, along with its pericarp. O *brahmanas*! Having drawn the *mandala*, ¹¹⁶⁵ one must follow the norms and worship Narayana, the lord without birth, using the *mantra* with the eight *aksharas*. After this, I will tell you about the excellent means of purifying the body. In the heart, one must think of Omkara, within a circle. It burns, with three flames, and burns down all sins. One must next think of ‘Ra’ on the head, inside the lunar disc. It is white in complexion and showers down *amrita*, flooding the earth. When one has destroyed sins in this way, one obtains a divine body. After this, a learned person will perform *nyasa* of the god within himself using the *mantra* with the eight *aksharas*. Beginning with the left foot, one should perform *nyasa* in the proper order. Using that root *mantra*, a devotee will purify his hands and his five limbs, using Vishnu’s four forms. ¹¹⁶⁶ Each of these complexions must be separately fixed on each finger. Omkara is the earth, white in complexion, and must be fixed on the left foot. ‘Na’ is Shambhu, dark in complexion, and must be fixed on the right foot. ‘Mo’ is said to be Kala and must be fixed on the left flank. ‘Na’ is the seed of everything and must be fixed on the right flank. ‘Ra’ is said to be energy and must be fixed in the region of the navel. ‘Ya’ is associated with the wind and is fixed on the left shoulder. ‘Na’ is known as something that goes everywhere and is fixed on the right shoulder. ‘Ya’ is where all the worlds are established and it is fixed on the head. ‘Oum! I bow down to Vishnu.’

¹¹⁶⁷ This is for the head. ‘Oum! I bow down to the blazing one.’ This is for the tuft of hair on the head. ‘Oum! I bow down to Vishnu.’ This is for the *kavacha*. ‘Oum! I bow down to Vishnu.’ This is for the throbbing of the limbs. ‘Oum! *Hum phat*.’ This is the weapon for binding down the directions. ‘Oum, white-complexioned Vasudeva!’ This is in the head. ‘Oum! *Am*, red-complexioned Samkarshana! Garuda is the essence of the fire, the energy and the sun.’ This is in the forehead. ‘*Am*, yellow-complexioned Pradyumna! You are the wind and the cloud.’ Thus. ‘Oum! *Am*, dark-complexioned Aniruddha! You are full of all kinds of powers.’ In this way, the devotee begins by using the four forms to arm himself with the *kavacha*. ‘Vishnu is stationed in front of me, Keshava is stationed behind me. Govinda is on the right flank and Madhusudana is on the left flank. Vaikuntha is above me and Varaha is on the surface of the earth. Madhava is in all the intermediary directions. Whether I am moving, standing, awake or asleep, I am protected by Narasimha. I am pervaded by Vasudeva.’ In this way, pervaded by Vishnu, one should start the rites. Just as it is done in the body, one should unite oneself with the divinity’s principles. ¹¹⁶⁸ After this, uttering Omkara, one should sprinkle water, ending with the sound ‘Phat’. This is auspicious and destroys everything that can cause harm. In between the wind and space, one must then think of Vishnu established in the middle of a lotus that is encircled by rings made of the sun, the moon and fire. In this way, one must think of Omkara, located within the heart in the form of resplendence. This is the eternal form of the radiance, as if it is located in the pericarp. Using the *mantra* with the eight *aksharas*, *nyasa* must progressively be performed. This complete instatement is said to be the supreme form of worship. The eternal god must next be worshipped with the *mantra* that has twelve *aksharas*. Internally, the divinity is established in the heart; externally, in the pericarp. One must think of the eternal divinity in the form of radiance, four-armed and great in spirit, great in yoga and like one crore suns in resplendence. The divinity must be thought of in the mind, with the *mantra* used to progressively instate him outside. ‘Oum! I bow down to Narayana, in the form of a fish, a boar, Narasimha and a dwarf. O god! O one who bestows boons! O Narayana! Come in front of

me.’ This is used to invoke him. At the feet of Mount Sumeru, the seat must be thought of in the form of a lotus. ‘O Madusudana! For the welfare of all living beings, may you be established here. Oum! Namō Narayanaya.’ This is used to establish him there. ‘Oum! O lord of the three worlds! O lord! O god of the gods! O Hrishikesha! O Vishnu! I bow down before you. Oum! Namō Narayanaya.’ This is used to offer the *arghya*. ‘Oum! O Padya used for the god’s feet! O Padmanabha! O eternal Vishnu! O one with eyes like lotus petals! O Madhusudana! Please accept this. Oum! Namō Narayanaya.’ This is used for the *padya*. ‘O great god! Brahma and the others have thought of this *madhuparka* for you. I am offering it with devotion. O Purushottama! Please accept it. Oum! Namō Narayanaya.’ This is used for the *madhuparka*. ‘This is the cool water from the Mandakini. It is auspicious and destroys all sins. I am offering it with devotion. Please accept this *achamaniya*. Oum! Namō Narayanaya.’ This is used for the *achamaniya*. ‘You are water, earth, fire and wind. O lord of the worlds! I am offering this water for your *snana*,¹¹⁶⁹ only as a matter of course. Oum! Namō Narayanaya.’ This is for the *snana*. ‘O god! You are full of the *tattvas*. Your complexion is that of the sacrifice. O god! O Keshava! These two pieces of garment are radiant and have the complexion of gold. They are for you. Oum! Namō Narayanaya.’ This is for the *vastra*.¹¹⁷⁰ ‘O Keshava! I do not know about your body. Nor do I know your activities. I am offering this *gandha*¹¹⁷¹ to you for smearing. Please accept it. Oum! Namō Narayanaya.’ This is for the *vilepana*.¹¹⁷² ‘The one born from the lotus¹¹⁷³ has used *mantras* from the Rig Veda, Yajur Veda and Sama Veda to fashion this *upavita*¹¹⁷⁴ with the three strands. The *savitri mantra* binds them together. This is for you. Oum! Namō Narayanaya.’ This is for the *upavita*. ‘O Madhava! These ornaments are embedded with divine jewels and have complexions like the fire or the sun. With these, your limbs will be beautiful. Oum! Namō Narayanaya.’ This is for the *alamkara*.¹¹⁷⁵ The words ‘Oum! Namō!’ can be used along with each *akshara* of the basic *mantra*. Alternatively, the worship can be performed with the basic *mantra* alone. ‘The divine juice of trees has been mixed with excellent fragrances to make this scent. Full of devotion, I am offering you this *dhupa*.¹¹⁷⁶ Please

accept it. Oum! Namō Narayanaya.’ This is for the *dhupa*. ‘O lord of all the stellar bodies! Your radiance is like that of the sun, the moon, lightning and the fire. Please accept this *dipa*.¹¹⁷⁷ Oum! Namō Narayanaya.’ This is for the *dipa*. ‘These are the four types of food, full of the six types of taste.¹¹⁷⁸ O Keshava! Full of devotion, I am offering this *naivedya*¹¹⁷⁹ to you. Oum! Namō Narayanaya.’ This is for the *naivedya*. The *nyasa* will be done with Vasudeva in the petal to the east, Samkarshana in the petal to the south, Pradyumna in the petal to the west, Aniruddha in the petal to the north, Varaha in the petal to the south-east, Narasimha in the petal to the south-west, Madhava in the petal to the north-west and Trivikrama in the petal to the north-east. The *nyasa* for Garuda will be in front of the god with eight *aksharas*. The *nyasa* for *chakra* on the left side and that for the conch shell on the right side. A learned person will perform *nyasa* for the giant club on the god’s right and that for the Sharnga bow on the god’s left. The *nyasa* for the divine quivers will be on the right and the sword will be on the left. Shri will be established in the rear and Pushti¹¹⁸⁰ in front. The garland of wildflowers, *shrivatsa* and Koustubha will be in front. The *nyasa* for the weapons of the god of the gods will be done in the four directions, east and others, and in the corners. Using *tantra* and *mantra*, Indra, Agni, Yama, Nairrita, Varuna, Vay, Dhanada,¹¹⁸¹ Ishana, Ananta and Brahma must be worshipped, above and below. In this way, Janardana, the lord of the gods, is worshipped, established in his *mandala*. If a man worships him in this way, there is no doubt that he obtains what he wishes for. If a person uses this mode to worship Janardana in the *mandala*, he enters Vishnu’s undecaying abode and sees him there. If a man follows this norm to worship Keshava even once, he passes over birth, death and old age and obtains a destination with Vishnu. If a person remembers Narayana, devotedly and single-mindedly, a residence for him has been thought of in Shveta-dvipa. The *mantra* that begins with ‘Om̐kara’ and ends with ‘Namō’ is said to be represent his name and has all the *tattvas* in it. This norm must be followed when offering fragrances and flowers. As has been indicated, each item must be offered in the due order. The *mudras*¹¹⁸² must be followed in the way that has been indicated. A person who knows the

mantra should use the basic *mantra* to perform *japa*, eight times, twenty-eight times or one hundred and eight times. Following what has been indicated, one controls oneself and does it according to one's capacity and according to one's wishes. The eight symbols are said to be the lotus, the conch shell, the *shrivatsa* mark, the mace, Garuda, the *chakra*, the sword and the Sharnga bow. 'O ancient Purushottama! Go! Go to the supreme destination, where Brahma and the other gods enjoy themselves. Oum! Namō Narayanaya.' This is how *visarjana* ¹¹⁸³ is done. Those who do not know the indicated *mantra* for worshipping Hari can always use the basic *mantra* to worship Achyuta.'

Chapter 1(59) (Greatness of bathing in the ocean)

Brahma said, ‘Following the norms, one must faithfully worship Purushottama in this way. After this, one must bow one’s head down and please the ocean. ‘O lord of the rivers! You are the life and the origin of all living beings. O king among *tirthas*! I bow down to you. O one loved by Achyuta! Please save me.’ O *brahmanas*! In that supreme *kshetra*, one must bathe in the ocean in the proper way. On the shores of the ocean, a man must follow the norms and worship Narayana, Rama, Krishna and Subhadra and bow down to the ocean. He then obtains the fruits of one hundred horse sacrifices and becomes free from disease. He is cleansed of all sins and is devoid of all kinds of misery. He becomes as prosperous as a god, proud of his beauty and youth. Astride a *vimana* that has the complexion of the sun, accompanied by the divine sound of *gandharvas* singing, he saves twenty-one generations of his family and goes to Vishnu’s world. He enjoys supreme objects of pleasure there, and sports with *apsaras*. For more than one hundred manvantaras, he does not suffer from old age or death. When his store of good merits is exhausted, he comes to earth in a lineage that possesses all the qualities. He is handsome, extremely fortunate, prosperous and truthful in speech, and conquers his senses. He becomes a brahmana who knows the purport of the Vedas and the sacred texts. He performs sacrifices to Vishnu. When he is united with Vishnu, he obtains emancipation. There, those who are extremely intelligent give donations to *brahmanas* when there is an eclipse of the planets, the change of one *ayana* into another, *vishuva sankranti*, conjunctions like *shadashiti*, at the time of *vyatipata*,¹¹⁸⁴ the end of the day, in the months of Ashadha, Kartika and Magha and other auspicious days.¹¹⁸⁵ The fruits that are then obtained are

one thousand times the fruits obtained at other *tirthas*. If a person follows the injunctions and offers *pinda* to the ancestors there, he provides his ancestors with inexhaustible satisfaction. O *brahmanas*! I have thus spoken about the fruits of bathing properly in the ocean there and about the fruits of donations and offering *pinda*. Men who do all this are blessed and obtain the fruits of *dharma*, *artha*, *moksha*, long lifespans, deeds and fame. There are the fruits of objects of pleasure and emancipation. Nightmares are destroyed. The fruits are everything one wishes for, and these are obtained. This ¹¹⁸⁶ is sacred and destroys all sins. This ancient account must not be spoken about to those who are non-believers. O *brahmanas*! As long as the greatness of this king among *tirthas* is not described, other *tirthas* boast about their own individual greatness. Pushkara and the other *tirthas* only confer their own respective fruits. However, the king among *tirthas* bestows the fruits of all the *tirthas*. All the *tirthas* on earth, rivers and water bodies eventually enter this *tirtha*. That is the reason for its superiority. The ocean, the lord of the rivers, is the king of all the *tirthas*. That is the reason it is superior to all the *tirthas* and grants all the objects of desire. O *brahmanas*! Just as darkness is destroyed when the sun rises, bathing in this king of *tirthas* destroys all impediments. There has been no *tirtha* that is equal to this king of *tirthas*, nor will there ever be. The Lord Narayana resides there. O *brahmanas*! Who is capable of describing the qualities of this king among *tirthas*? Ninety-nine crores of *tirthas* exist within it. O *brahmanas*! Whatever is done there, bathing, donations, oblations, *japa* and worship of the gods, leads to inexhaustible benefits.’

Chapter 1(60) (Greatness of the five *tirthas*)

Brahma said, ‘O best among *brahmanas*! One should go to the *tirtha* that resulted from a limb of the sacrifice. The purifying and auspicious lake of Indradyumna is located there. Having gone there, a person must perform *achamana* and meditate on Hari in his mind. Approaching the water, he must utter this *mantra*. ‘O *tirtha* that resulted from a limb of the horse sacrifice! O destroyer of all sins! I will now bathe in you. Please take away my sins. I bow down to you.’ Having uttered this, one must bathe in the indicated way. Thereafter, using sesamum mixed with water, one must satisfy the gods, the *rishis* and the ancestors. One must perform *achamana* and silently offer *pinda* to the ancestors and worship Purushottama. With these, a man obtains fruits and good merits that are equal to those obtained from ten horse sacrifices. He saves twenty-one generations of his ancestors and twenty-one generations of his descendants. Like a god, on a *vimana* that travels as it wills, he goes to Vishnu’s world. As long as the moon, the sun and the stars exist, he enjoys happiness and objects of pleasure there. When he is dislodged, he comes to earth and certainly obtains emancipation. Having done this in the five *tirthas*, he must fast on the eleventh day. If a person visits Purushottama on the fifteenth lunar day in *shukla paksha* in the month of Jyeshtha, he obtains the fruits mentioned earlier and sports in Achyuta’s abode. He then goes to the supreme destination and never returns from there.’ ¹¹⁸⁷

The sages asked, ‘O great grandfather! O lord! Ignoring Magha and the other months, why have you praised Jyeshtha? Please tell us that.’

Brahma replied, ‘O tigers among sages! Listen. I will briefly tell you why I have repeatedly praised Jyeshtha and not the others. There are *tirthas* on earth—rivers, lakes, ponds, tanks, water bodies, wells, reservoirs, many

rivers and oceans. Starting with the tenth lunar day in *shukla paksha* in the month of Jyeshtha, for a period of seven days, all of them always go to Purushottama. O *brahmanas*! Therefore, whatever is done there at the time—bathing, donations and seeing the gods, brings inexhaustible merits. O supreme among *brahmanas*! The tenth lunar day in *shukla paksha* in the month of Jyeshtha destroys ten sins. That is the reason it is known as Dashahara. ¹¹⁸⁸ If a man controls himself and goes there and sees the wielder of the plough, Krishna and Bhadra, he is freed from all sins and goes to Vishnu’s world. O *brahmanas*! If a man sees Purushottama, Rama and Subhadra at the beginning of *uttarayana* or *dakshinayana*, he goes to Vishnu’s world. If he controls himself and sees Govinda, supreme among the gods, seated on his *dola* in the month of Phalguna, he goes to Govinda’s city. ¹¹⁸⁹ O *brahmanas*! When Vishnu’s day arrives, he must observe the rites, visit the five *tirthas* and see Samkarshana, Krishna and Bhadra. If a man does this, he obtains the fruits of all sacrifices, which are extremely difficult to obtain. He is then freed from all sins and goes to Vishnu’s world. If he sees Krishna, smeared with sandalwood paste, on the third lunar day in *shukla paksha* in the month of Vaishakha, he goes to Achyuta’s mansion. If he sees Purushottama in the month of Jyeshtha, ¹¹⁹⁰ when the *nakshatra* Jyeshtha is in the ascendant, he saves twenty-one generations of his family and goes to Vishnu’s world.’

Chapter 1(61) (Praise of Mahajyeshthi)

Brahma said, ‘When Mahajyeshthi occurs because of a conjunction between the *rashi* and the *nakshatra*, a mortal person must make efforts to go to Purushottama. ¹¹⁹¹ O *brahmanas*! If a man sees Krishna, Rama and Bhadra at the time of Mahajyeshthi, he obtains fruits that are more than those obtained from twelve pilgrimages. O *brahmanas*! O best among *brahmanas*! If a man sees Krishna at the time of Mahajyeshthi, the fruits obtained are superior to the fruits obtained from bathing and donations, at a time when Rahu has devoured the sun, ¹¹⁹² in all the *tirthas*, temples, oceans, mountains, rivers and water bodies—Prayaga, Kurukshetra, Naimisha, Pushkara, Gaya, Gangadvara, Kushavarta, the confluence of the Ganga and the ocean, Kokamukha, Shukara, Mathura, Marusthala, Shalagrama, Vayutirtha, Mandara, the confluence of Sindhu and the ocean, Pindaraka, Chitrakuta, Prabhasa, Kanakhala, Shankhodvara, Dvaraka, Badarikashrama, Lohakunda, Ashvatirtha, which destroys all sins, Kamalaya, Kotitirtha, Amarakantaka, Lohargala, Jambumarga, Somatirtha, Prithudaka, Utpalavartaka, Prithutunga, Sukubjaka, Ekamraka, Kedara, Kashi, Viraja, Kalanjara, Gokarna, Shrishaila, Gandhamadana, Mahendra, Malaya, Vindhya, Pariyatra, Himalaya, Sahya, Shuktimat, Gomanta, Arbuda, all the *tirthas* along the Ganga, all the *tirthas* along the Yamuna, Sarasvati, Gomati, the seven along the Brahmaputra, ¹¹⁹³ Godavari, Bhimarathi, Tungabhadra, Narmada, Tapi, Payoshni, Kaveri, Kshipra, Charmanvati, Vitasta, Chandrabhaga, Shatadru, Bahuda, Rishikulya, Kumari, Vipasha, Drishadvati, Sarayu, Ganga, Gandaki, Mahanadi, Koushiki, Karatoya, Trisrota, Madhuvahini, the great river Vaitarani and others that have not been mentioned. O *brahmanas*! What is the need to speak a lot? O best among sages! A man who desires all the fruits of desire

can derive all those by making efforts to go to Purushottama at the time of Mahajyeshthi. If a man sees Rama, Krishna and Subhadra at the time of Mahajyeshthi, he saves his own lineage and goes to Vishnu's world. Until the deluge arrives, he enjoys the supreme objects of pleasure there. O *brahmanas*! When he returns to earth, he becomes a brahmana who knows the four Vedas, is devoted to his own *dharma*, is serene, is devoted to Krishna and is a person who has conquered his senses. When he unites with Vishnu, he obtains emancipation.'

Chapter 1(62) (Greatness of Krishna's bath)

The sages asked, 'O one who originated in a lotus! O supreme among those who know all the norms! At what time does Krishna's *snana* take place? What are the norms? Please tell us about it.'

Brahma replied, 'O sages! Listen. I will tell you about the *snana* for Krishna, Rama and Subhadra. This is auspicious and destroys all sins. O *brahmanas*! On the day of the full moon in Jyeshtha, when a conjunction happens between the moon and Jyeshtha *nakshatra*,¹¹⁹⁴ that is always time for Hari's *snana*. There is a well there, sparkling and pure, and all the *tirthas* are in it. O *brahmanas*! The river Bhogavati is manifested there.¹¹⁹⁵ O *brahmanas*! Therefore, in the month of Jyeshtha, excellent golden vessels were used to draw water, for bathing Krishna, Rama and Subhadra. A beautiful platform was constructed, decorated with flags. It was firm and easy to walk on. It was adorned with garments and flowers. It was large and was made fragrant with incense, so that Rama and Krishna could be bathed. It was enclosed with a cover of white garments, with necklaces of pearls hanging from them. O *brahmanas*! To the sound of many kinds of musical instruments and pronouncements of 'victory', Krishna and the one dressed in blue garments¹¹⁹⁶ were placed on the platform, with Subhadra in the middle. O *brahmanas*! *Brahmanas*, *kshatriyas*, *vaishyas*, *shudras*, other classes, surrounded by many hundreds of thousands of men and women, householders, *snatakas*,¹¹⁹⁷ mendicants and *brahmacharis* bathed Krishna and the wielder of the plough on that platform. O supreme among *brahmanas*! As has been stated earlier, all the *tirthas* are present there. With these respective waters and with flowers, they were bathed separately. After this, there were the sounds of small drums, conch shells, kettle-drums, tambourines, large drums, double-sided drums, cymbals, the clapping of

hands, bells and many other kinds of musical instruments. Women and large numbers of sages uttered agreeable and auspicious sounds. There were pronouncements of 'victory' and *stotras*. The sounds of *veenas* and flutes were heard. That tumultuous sound was like the roaring of the ocean. The sages recited the Vedas and chanted *mantras*. There were the sacred sounds of many kinds of *stotras* and the sounds of hymns from the Sama Veda were heard. Mendicants, *snatakas*, householders and *brahmacharis* were greatly delighted and praised the best among the gods on the occasion of the bath. There were dark-complexioned courtesans, bent down because of the weight of their breasts. They were clad in yellow and red garments and bent down because of the weight of their garlands. They were adorned with divine earrings studded with jewels and bunches of golden flowers. Using whisks made out of yak-hair, with handles encrusted with jewels, they fanned Rama and Keshava. They were surrounded by *yakshas*, *vidyadharas*, *siddhas*, *kinnaras* and large numbers of *apsaras*. Gods, *gandharvas* and *charanas* were stationed in the firmament. Adityas, Vasus, Rudras, Sadhyas, Vishvadevas, the categories of Maruts, and other guardians of the worlds, praised Purushottama. 'O lord of the lords among the gods! O eternal Purushottama! I bow down to you. O protector of the worlds! O lord of the universe! You are the cause behind creation, preservation and destruction. O god! You are the one who holds up the three worlds. You are the one who loves *brahmanas*. You are the cause behind emancipation. You are the one who grants all the objects of desire. Devotedly, we bow down before you.' O best among the sages! Stationed in the firmament, the gods praised Krishna, the immensely strong Rama and Subhadra in this way. The celestial *gandharvas* sang. The *apsaras* danced. The musical instruments of the gods were sounded and an extremely cool breeze started to blow. From the sky, clouds showered down water mixed with flowers. The sages, *siddhas* and *charanas* exclaimed 'Victory'. Shakra and other gods, all the *rishis*, the ancestors, the Prajapatis, the *nagas* and all the other residents of heaven brought all the auspicious objects required, to the chanting of *mantras*. Every object required for the bath was taken by the large number of gods. O supreme among *brahmanas*! The lord was surrounded by Indra,

the immensely valiant Vishnu, the sun, the moon, Dhatri, Vidhatri, Anila, Anala, Pusha, Bhaga, Aryama, Tvashta, Amshuman, Vivasvat and his two wives, the intelligent Mitra, Varuna, Rudra, the Vasus, the Adityas, the two Ashvins, the Vishvadevas, the Maruts, the Sadhyas, the ancestors, *gandharvas*, *apsaras*, *yakshas*, *rakshasas*, *nagas*, innumerable *devarshis*, excellent *maharshis*, *vaikhanasas*, *valakhilyas*, those who subsisted on wind, those who subsisted on rays, ¹¹⁹⁸ Bhrigu, Angiras, great-souled mendicants, *vidyadharas*, sacred ones who obtained success through yoga, the grandfather, ¹¹⁹⁹ Pulastya, the great ascetic Pulaha, those descended from Angiras, Kashyapa, Atri, Marichi, those descended from Bhrigu, Kratu, Hara, Prachetas, Manu, Daksha, the seasons, the planets, the stellar bodies, the rivers in embodied form, the eternal gods, the oceans, the lakes, many kinds of *tirthas*, the earth, the firmament, the directions, the trees, Aditi, the mother of the gods, Hri, ¹²⁰⁰ Shri, Svaha, Sarasvati, Uma, Shachi, Sinivali, Anumati, Kuhu, Raka, ¹²⁰¹ Dhishana, all the other wives of the residents of heaven, the Himalayas, Vindhya, the multi-peaked Meru, Airavata and his followers, Kala, Kashtha, the fortnights, the months, the seasons, ¹²⁰² the nights, the days, the excellent horse Uccaihsrava, the king of the elephants, Vamana, Aruna, Garuda, the trees and the herbs, the illustrious god Dharma, Kala, Yama, Mrityu and Yama's followers. O *brahmanas*! All of them assembled there. O *brahmanas*! There were many other categories of gods who have not been mentioned. All of them assembled there for the god's bath. O *brahmanas*! All the gods and the residents of heaven picked up the vessels and all the auspicious objects required for the bath. O *brahmanas*! There were all those divine objects and golden vessels. There were the divine and sacred waters from the Sarasvati and other rivers. The divine waters of the heavenly Ganga arrived for Rama and Krishna's bath and stood there, in the firmament, with flowers and golden vessels. The gods roamed around in the firmament in their *vimanas*. These *vimanas* were divine. They could roam around as they willed, above and below. Some were stationary. They were colourful, studded with celestial jewels, and were served by large numbers of *apsaras*. They were adorned with flags. In every direction, there were the sounds of singing and the playing of musical

instruments. O best among sages! In this way, they arrived. Full of delight, they bathed Krishna, Rama and Subhadra and uttered words of praise.'

'Victory! O protector of the worlds! Victory! O protector of devotees! Victory! O one who loves those who prostrate themselves! Victory! Victory! O refuge of creatures! Victory! Victory! O original god! Victory! O one who is the cause of many things! Victory! O Vasudeva! Victory! Victory! O destroyer of *asuras*! Victory! O divine fish! Victory! O supreme among the gods! Victory! Victory! O one who lies down in the ocean! Victory! O supreme among yogis! Victory! Victory! O one with the sun as an eye! Victory! Victory! O king of the gods! Victory! O enemy of Kaitabha! Victory! Victory! O supreme one in the Vedas! Victory! O one with the tortoise as a form! Victory! Victory! O one who is the supreme sacrifice! Victory! Victory! O one with the lotus in the navel! Victory! O one who roams around in the mountains! Victory! O one who lies down in yoga! Victory! O store of speed! Victory! Victory! O one whose embodiment is the universe! Victory! Victory! O one who holds a *chakra*! Victory! O protector of beings! Victory! Victory! O one who holds up the earth! Victory! Victory! O one who lies down on Shesha! Victory! O one who is attired in a yellow garment! Victory! Victory! O one who is as beautiful as the moon! Victory! O one who resides in yoga! Victory! Victory! O one who scorches through his mouth! Victory! Victory! O one who resides in *dharma*! Victory! O store of qualities! Victory! Victory! O residence of Shri! Victory! O one who travels on Garuda! Victory! Victory! O abode of bliss! Victory! Victory! O one who has *dharma* as a standard! Victory! Victory! O refuge of the earth! Victory! Victory! O one whose conduct is mysterious! Victory! Victory! O one to whom yogis go! Victory! Victory! O residence of sacrifices! Victory! O one who is known through the Vedas! Victory! O one who bestows peace! Victory! Victory! O one whom the yogis think about! Victory! Victory! O one who bestows nourishment! Victory! O one who is the embodiment of *jnana*! Victory! Victory! O one who is an assemblage of lotuses! Victory! Victory! O one who can only be known through emotions! Victory! Victory! O one who brings emancipation! Victory! Victory! O one with a spotless body!

Victory! Victory! O one who is the abode of *sattva*! Victory! Victory! O one who is extensive in *gunas*! Victory! Victory! O cause behind sacrifices! Victory! Victory! O one devoid of *gunas*! Victory! Victory! O one who bestows *moksha*! Victory! Victory! O refuge of the earth! Victory! Victory! O one who is full of radiance! Victory! Victory! O refuge of the worlds! Victory! Victory! O one who is full of prosperity! Victory! Victory! O lotus-eyed one! Victory! Victory! O cause of creation! Victory! Victory! O one who is full of yoga! Victory! Victory! O one with a body as dark blue as the *atasi* flower! Victory! Victory! O one with a body that enters the ocean! Victory! Victory! O one who is like a bee, with Lakshmi as the lotus! Victory! Victory! O one who is subjugated by devotees! Victory! Victory! O one loved by the worlds! Victory! Victory! O one who is extremely serene! Victory! Victory! O one who is the supreme essence! Victory! Victory! O one who holds the *chakra*! Victory! Victory! O one with the serpent! Victory! Victory! O one attired in blue garments! Victory! Victory! O one who confers peace! Victory! Victory! O one who bestows *moksha*! ¹²⁰³ Victory! Victory! O one who destroys sins! Victory! Victory! O Krishna! O Jagannatha! Victory! Victory! O Samkarshana's younger brother! Victory! Victory! O one with eyes like lotus petals! Victory! Victory! O one who grants the desired fruits! Victory! Victory! O one who wears a garland on his chest! Victory! Victory! O one who holds a *chakra* and a mace! Victory! Victory! O one loved by the one whose abode is a lotus! ¹²⁰⁴ Victory! Victory! O Vishnu! I bow down to you.'

Brahma continued, 'Happy in their minds, Shakra and the other gods praised him in this way. O best among sages! Stationed in the firmament, *siddhas*, large numbers of *charanas*, other residents of heaven, sages and *valakhilyas* prostrated themselves before Krishna, Rama and Subhadra. The residents of heaven saw, praised and bowed down to Krishna, Rama and Subhadra and left for their own respective abodes. The *vimanas* of the gods moved as they willed in the firmament, above and below, or remained stationary. They were studded with many divine and colourful jewels and served by large numbers of *apsaras*. There were beautiful flags in every direction and the sounds of singing and the playing of musical instruments.

At such a time, if mortals see Purushottama, Balabhadra and Subhadra, they obtain a destination without decay. If one sees Purushottama on the platform, along with Subhadra and Rama, there is no doubt that the person goes to a region where there is no disease. O best among sages! If a man sees Krishna on the platform, along with the wielder of the plough and Subhadra, he obtains what is auspicious. The fruits obtained are said to be the same as the fruits obtained from donating one hundred *kapila* ¹²⁰⁵ cows in Pushkara. If a man sees Krishna on the platform, the fruits obtained are said to be the same as the fruits obtained from donating one hundred maidens. If a man sees Krishna on the platform, the fruits obtained are said to be the same as the fruits obtained from donating one hundred gold coins. If a man sees Krishna on the platform, the fruits obtained are said to be the same as the many fruits obtained from donating land. If a man sees Krishna on the platform, the fruits obtained are described as equal to the fruits obtained from offering food and *arghya* to a guest. If a man sees Krishna on the platform, the fruits obtained are said to be the same as the fruits obtained from following the norms of *vrishotsarga*. ¹²⁰⁶ If a man sees Krishna on the platform, the fruits obtained are said to be the same as the fruits of donating water during the summer, or at any other time. If a man sees Krishna on the platform, the fruits obtained are said to be the same as the fruits obtained from donating a *tiladhenu*. ¹²⁰⁷ If a man sees Krishna on the platform, the fruits obtained are said to be the same as those obtained from donating elephants, horses and chariots. If a man sees Krishna on the platform, the fruits obtained are said to be the same as the fruits obtained from donating a cow with gold-plated horns. If a man sees Krishna on the platform, the fruits obtained are said to be the same as the fruits obtained from donating a *jaladhenu*. ¹²⁰⁸ If a man sees Krishna on the platform, the fruits obtained are said to be the same as the fruits obtained from donating a *ghritadhenu*. ¹²⁰⁹ If a man sees Krishna on the platform, the fruits obtained are said to be the same as the fruits obtained from observing *chandrayana*. If a man sees Krishna on the platform, the fruits obtained are said to be the same as the fruits obtained from observing the norms and fasting for a month. What is the need to repeatedly speak a lot about the greatness of the

god on the platform? O supreme among *brahmanas*! O best among sages! By seeing Krishna, along with the wielder of the plough and Subhadra, on the platform, a man obtains all the auspicious fruits—the fruits that are described for all the *tirthas*, vows and donations. Therefore, if a man or a woman sees Purushottama, the fruits from bathing and other rituals at all the *tirthas* are obtained. After bathing, ¹²¹⁰ the remainder of Krishna's water must be sprinkled on one's own self—especially if a woman is barren, her infant has died, she is unfortunate, suffers from adverse planets, has been seized by *rakshasas*, or is suffering from ailments. If one uses the water left from the bath to immediately sprinkle one's own self, one obtains all the objects of desire or anything else that one wishes for. A woman who desires a son obtains a son. A woman who seeks happiness obtains good fortune. A woman suffering from disease is freed from disease. A woman who desires riches obtains wealth. All the auspicious waters that exist on earth do not amount to one-sixteenth part of the water that is left after taking the bath. O *brahmanas*! Therefore, after bathing, the remaining part of Krishna's water must be sprinkled on one's own self. It yields all the objects of desire. If a man proceeds in a southern direction after seeing Krishna have his bath, there is no doubt that he is freed from sins like killing a brahmana. If a man sees Krishna and proceeds in a southern direction, he obtains all the fruits obtained, as described in the sacred texts, from circumambulating the earth thrice. If a man sees Krishna and proceeds in a southern direction, he obtains all the fruits that are described for all the *tirthas* on earth. If a man sees Krishna and proceeds in a southern direction, he obtains all the fruits described for seeing Nara and Narayana in Badarika. If a man sees Krishna and proceeds in a southern direction, he obtains all the fruits obtained from bathing and donating in Gangadvara and Kurukshetra. If a man sees Krishna and proceeds in a southern direction, he obtains all the fruits obtained from bathing in Prayaga on the day of the full moon in Magha. If a man sees Krishna and proceeds in a southern direction, he obtains all the fruits obtained from bathing in Shalagrama on the day of the full moon in Chaitra. If a man sees Krishna and proceeds in a southern direction, he obtains all the fruits described for bathing in Pushkara on the day of the full

moon in Kartika. If a man sees Krishna and proceeds in a southern direction, he obtains all the fruits obtained from bathing and donating at the confluence of the Ganga and the ocean. If a man sees Krishna and proceeds in a southern direction, he obtains all the fruits from bathing and donating in Kurukshetra at the time of a solar eclipse. O *brahmanas*! Fruits have been described for following the norms and bathing and donating at all the *tirthas* along the Ganga, the Yamuna and the Sarasvati, and at *tirthas* near other water bodies. If a man sees Krishna and proceeds in a southern direction, he obtains all these fruits. When the sun is devoured by Rahu, there are fruits from bathing and donating at *tirthas* like Pushkara, Gaya, Amarakantaka, Naimisha and other *tirthas*, *kshetras* and temples. If a man sees Krishna and proceeds in a southern direction, all these fruits are obtained. What is the need to repeatedly speak a lot? O best among *brahmanas*! For sacred deeds, fruits have been described in the Vedas, the sacred texts, the Puranas, the Mahabharata and all the other sacred texts of *dharma*. If a man or a woman sees Krishna, along with the wielder of the plough and Bhadra, and proceeds in a southern direction, all those fruits are obtained.'

Chapter 1(63) (Gundika yatra)

Brahma said, ‘Those who see Krishna, Bala and Subhadra seated on the chariot, while they are going to the *mandapa* known as Gundika, go to Hari’s abode. ¹²¹¹ Those who see Krishna, the wielder of the plough and Subhadra, while they are in that *mandapa* for a week, go to Vishnu’s world.’

The sages asked, ‘Who started this journey to the auspicious Gundika *mandapa*? Why did the king use men to build this temple in that sacred but desolate spot, on the banks of the lake? What are the fruits from the journey? Please tell us. Why do Krishna, the lord of the universe, Samkarshana and Subhadra give up their own places, and proceeding on a chariot, reside there for seven nights?’

Brahma replied, ‘O *brahmanas*! In earlier times, Indradyumna requested Hari, “Let there be a *yatra* to the shores of my lake. O lord of the gods! Let it be known as Gundika and let it grant objects of pleasure and emancipation.” Purushottama, the lord of the gods, granted him this boon. The illustrious one said, “O king! For one week, on the banks of your lake, there will be a *yatra* by the name of Gundika. As fruits, it will confer all the objects of desire. I, Samkarshana and Subhadra will be in that *mandapa*. *Brahmanas*, *kshatriyas*, *vaishyas*, women and shudras will control themselves, and following the norms, devotedly worship me there. They will use excellent flowers, fragrances, incense, lamps, *naivedya* and many different kinds of offerings. They will prostrate themselves and perform *pradakshina*. They will utter exclamations of victory and use pleasant *stotras*, songs and the playing of musical instruments. They will obtain the fruits that they desire and nothing will be impossible to obtain. O best among kings! Because of my favours, there is no doubt that this will

happen.” Having said this, the god vanished instantly from the spot. The prosperous king was successful in his objective. O supreme *brahmanas*! Therefore, in the course of Gundika, one must make every effort to go and see the god Purushottama. This yields all the objects one desires. A man without a son obtains a son. A person without riches obtains wealth. A diseased person is freed from his disease. A maiden obtains a good husband. A man obtains a long lifespan, deeds, fame, intelligence, strength, learning, fortitude, animals, beauty, youth and prosperity. Having seen Purushottama, irrespective of whether it is a man or a woman, there is no doubt that all the objects of desire are obtained. O best among *brahmanas*! In the course of the *yatra* known as Gundika, in *shukla paksha* in the month of Ashadha, if a man or a woman is controlled and following the norms, sees Krishna, Rama and Subhadra, the fruits obtained are more than those obtained through fifteen horse sacrifices. He saves himself and seven generations of his ancestors and seven generations of his descendants. Such a man is handsome, extremely fortunate and brave. On a *vimana* adorned with all kinds of jewels, that can travel as it wills and is served by *gandharvas* and *apsaras*, he goes to Vishnu’s city. There, until the deluge arrives, he enjoys excellent objects of pleasure. He is prosperous and has everything that he wishes for. He does not suffer from old age or death. When his store of good merits is exhausted, he returns to earth and becomes a brahmana who knows the four Vedas. When he unites with Vishnu, he obtains emancipation.’

Chapter 1(64) (Twelve pilgrimages)

The sages asked, ‘If men or women are self-controlled, what fruits do each of them receive individually from the *yatra*? Please tell us separately.’

Brahma replied, ‘O *brahmanas*! If a man controls himself and undertakes the *yatra* in that *kshetra*, hear about the fruits he obtains. Listen to my words. On the day of *vishuva sankranti* or *utthana* in the month of Phalguna, ¹²¹² if a man follows the norms and performs *gundika yatra*, seeing Krishna, Samkarshana and Subhadra and prostrating himself, he obtains separate fruits. As long as fourteen Indras rule, he remains in Vishnu’s world. If a man follows the norms and performs the *yatra* in the month of Jyeshtha, there is no doubt that he enjoys happiness in Vishnu’s world as long as the *kalpa* lasts. Purushottama is sacred and beautiful. It is supreme among *kshetras*. For men, it confers objects of pleasure and emancipation. For all beings, it brings happiness. A man or a woman must conquer the senses. Exercising control and following the norms, the person must undertake twelve such *yatras* and instate the images, bereft of deceit and insolence. Such a person will enjoy many objects of pleasure and at the end, obtain emancipation.’

The sages asked, ‘O god! We wish to hear from you about the mode for instatement. What are the norms for worshipping the lord of the universe there and performing donations? What are the fruits?’

Brahma replied, ‘O tigers among sages! Hear about the instructed norms for instatement. By performing this devotedly, a man or a woman obtains the fruits. O supreme among *brahmanas*! When twelve *yatras* have been performed, so that sins are destroyed, the norms must be followed and the images instated. On the eleventh lunar day in *shukla paksha* in the month of Jyeshtha, one must control oneself and go to the sacred water body.

Controlling oneself, one must perform *achamana* and purify oneself. He must invoke all the *tirthas* and meditate on Narayana. He must control himself, observe the norms and have a bath. The rite of having a bath must follow the norms that have been instructed by the *rishis*. It is recommended that the bath must follow those norms. Having followed the norms and bathed properly, one must mention one's name and *gotra*, and following the norms, satisfy gods, *rishis*, ancestors and others. He must then wear a clean and washed upper garment and lower garment. Having touched water, he must observe the norms and stand, facing the sun. In his mind, he must perform *japa* one hundred and eight times with the purifying *gayatri mantra*, the divine mother of the Vedas. This is sacred and destroys all sins. He must control himself and faithfully chant the sacred *mantras* to Surya. Having performed three *pradakshinas*, he must prostrate himself before Bhaskara. ¹²¹³ The three *varnas* will bathe and perform *japa* in accordance with what has been stated in the Vedas. Women and shudras must avoid bathing and *japa* in accordance with the norms stated in the Vedas. After this, he must remain silent and return to his own house. Having washed his hands and feet and touched water, as prescribed, he must worship Purushottama. The image of the god will be bathed with *ghee*, water, milk, honey, fragrant water and sacred water, mixed with sandalwood. Faithfully, the image must be dressed in a couple of excellent garments. The image must be smeared with sandalwood paste, aloe, camphor and *kumkuma*. With supreme devotion, Purushottama must be worshipped with lotus flowers and other flowers like *mallika* that are used to worship Vishnu. Hari Jagannatha bestows objects of pleasure and emancipation. Having worshipped him in this way, in front of the god, he must burn incense that has aloe in it. O best among sages! Fragrant *guggula* must also be burnt. Devotedly, depending on his capacity, he must use *ghee* to light a lamp. O best among sages! He must control himself and light twelve other lamps, using *ghee* or the oil of sesamum. As *naivedya*, he must offer *payasam*, *apupa*, *shashkuli*, *vataka*, *modaka*, *phanita*, or a small quantity of fruits. ¹²¹⁴ In this way, he must worship Purushottama with the five objects. ¹²¹⁵ With the words 'Oum! Namoh Purushottama!' he must then perform *japa* one

hundred and eight times. Full of devotion, he must please God Purushottama with the following words. ‘I bow down to the lord of all the worlds. O one who grants his devotees freedom from fear! I am immersed in this ocean of *samsara*. O Purushottama! Save me. O lord of the universe! I have undertaken twelve *yatras* for your sake. O Govinda! Through your favours, may I be able to complete them successfully.’ After pleasing the god in this way, he must prostrate himself like a rod. O supreme among sages! Thereafter, he must devotedly worship the *guru* with flowers, garments and unguents, since there is no difference between the two. ¹²¹⁶ O best among sages! Controlling himself and full of faith, he must use many kinds of colourful flowers to construct a canopy made out of flowers over the god’s head. Having created this canopy, he must resolve to remain awake at night. For this purpose, he will arrange for songs about Vasudeva’s account to be sung. Such a learned person will spend the night reading about the god, meditating on him and praising him. After twelve nights are over and the sparkling day dawns, he will invite twelve learned *brahmanas* who know about the Vedas, *itihasa* and the Puranas, having controlled their senses and having completed their studies. Following the norms, the devotee will have a bath. He will conquer his senses and wear washed clothes. First, he will devotedly bathe Purushottama. He will use many kinds of objects of worship—fragrances, flowers, gifts, *naivedya* and lamps. He will prostrate himself and perform *pradakshina*. He will perform *japa*, bow down and praise him, using agreeable songs and musical instruments. After worshipping Jagannatha, he will worship the *brahmanas*. Full of faith and devotion, he will give them twelve cows, gold, umbrellas and footwear. O *brahmanas*! Full of devotion, he will give them gold, garments and other objects. When they are worshipped in this way, with good sentiments, Govinda himself is satisfied. After this, he must devotedly give his preceptor a cow, garments, gold, an umbrella, footwear, grain and a vessel made out of copper. Starting with *payasam*, the *brahmanas* must be fed. There must be cooked food to eat and the food must be mixed with molasses and *ghee*. When the *brahmanas* are satisfied and their minds are content, they must be given twelve water-pots that have been filled with

modakas. Without any malice and according to his capacity, he must give them *dakshina*. He must also offer a pot and *dakshina* to his preceptor. O supreme among *brahmanas*! Thereafter, filled with great devotion and in a similar way, he must worship his *guru*.¹²¹⁷ He is the one who bestows *jnana*. He is Vishnu's equal. A learned person must bow down to him and worship him with gold, garments, cows, grain and other excellent objects. He will then utter this *mantra*. 'O Jagannatha! O one who pervades everything! O one who holds a conch shell, a *chakra* and a mace! O god who is without a beginning and an end! O Purushottama! May you be pleased with this.' Having said this, he will perform *pradakshina* around the *brahmanas* thrice. He will devotedly bend his head down before his preceptor and seek his permission to leave. Thereafter, full of devotion, he will follow the *brahmanas* right up to the boundaries. Following them there, he will take his leave from all of them. On return, he will silently eat with his kin and relatives, sharing the food with other devotees, those who are distressed, mendicants and others who desire food.'

'If a man or a woman undertakes this properly, the fruits obtained are the fruits of one thousand horse sacrifices and one hundred royal sacrifices. O *brahmanas*! Such an excellent man saves one hundred generations of his ancestors and one hundred generations of his descendants. He assumes a divine form and goes to heaven. He possesses all the auspicious signs and is adorned with all the ornaments. He is prosperous, with all the objects of desire. He is like a god and is devoid of all anxiety. He possesses beauty and youth and is ornamented with all the qualities. Thus adorned, he is praised by *apsaras* and *gandharvas*. He is stationed in a *vimana* that can travel, or remain stationary, as it wills. It has the complexion of the sun, is adorned with all kinds of jewels and has standards and flags. Without any exhaustion and illuminating all the directions, he ascends into the firmament in this. He is young, immensely strong and intelligent and goes to Vishnu's world in this. There, for one hundred *kalpas*, he enjoys all the objects of pleasure his mind can think of. He remains there, without any anxiety, and is praised by *siddhas*, *apsaras*, *gandharvas*, gods, *vidyadharas*, *uragas* and the best of sages. O *brahmanas*! Full of joy, he assumes a four-

armed form that is just like that of God Jagannatha, holding a conch shell, a *chakra* and a mace. He enjoys excellent objects of pleasure there and sports with the gods. After this, he goes to Brahma's residence, where all the objects of desire are obtained. *Siddhas*, *vidyadharas*, gods and *kinnaras* adorn that place. For a period of ninety *kalpas*, such a man enjoys happiness there. O Indras among *brahmanas*! After this, he goes to Rudra's world, where all the objects of desire are obtained. That region bestows happiness and emancipation and is frequented by large numbers of gods. It is adorned with many hundreds of thousands of *vimanas*. It is adorned with *siddhas*, *vidyadharas*, *yakshas*, *daityas* and *danavas*. For a period of eighty *kalpas*, such a man enjoys happiness there. After this, he goes to Goloka, which has all the objects of pleasure. It is extremely enchanting and is ornamented with gods, *siddhas* and *apsaras*. For a period of seventy *kalpas*, he enjoys excellent objects of pleasure there. This is a region that those in the three worlds find very difficult to reach. Like an immortal, his mind is completely comfortable there. After this, he goes to Prajapati's excellent world. That region is surrounded by *gandharvas*, *apsaras*, *siddhas*, sages and *vidyadharas*. For a period of sixty *kalpas*, he is happy and enjoys many kinds of objects of pleasure there. After this, he goes to Shakra's residence, which is full of many kinds of wonders. It is surrounded by *gandharvas*, *kinnaras*, *siddhas*, gods, *vidyadharas*, *uragas*, *guhyakas*, *apsaras*, *sadhyas* and many other excellent gods. Having arrived there, such a man enjoys happiness for fifty *kalpas*. After this, he goes to the world of the gods, adorned with *vimanas*. This is a purifying region that is difficult to reach and is ornamented by the gods. Such an intelligent person enjoys objects of pleasure that are extremely difficult to obtain and remains there for forty *kalpas*. He then goes to the region known as the world of the *nakshatras*, which is extremely difficult to reach. For a period of thirty *kalpas*, he enjoys excellent objects of pleasure that are wished for. O supreme among *brahmanas*! After this, he goes to Shashanka's ¹²¹⁸ world. Soma is there, decorated with all the gods. There, for twenty *kalpas*, he enjoys objects of pleasure that are extremely difficult to obtain. After this, he goes to Aditya's world, which is worshipped by the gods. It is divine and full of great

wonders, frequented by *gandharvas* and *apsaras*. O supreme among *brahmanas*! For a period of ten *kalpas*, he enjoys auspicious objects of pleasure there. After this, he goes to the abode of the *gandharvas*, which is extremely difficult to reach. For a period of one *kalpa*, he happily enjoys all the objects of pleasure there. After this, he returns to earth and becomes a king who is devoted to *dharma*. He becomes an immensely valiant *chakravarti*, who is adorned with all the excellent qualities. He rules his kingdom according to his own *dharma* and performs sacrifices with copious quantities of *dakshina*. When this is over, he goes to the world of the yogis, which is auspicious and grants emancipation. Until the deluge arrives, he enjoys excellent objects of pleasure there. After this, he returns to earth and is born in a family of yogis that is devoted to Vishnu. O *brahmanas*! Such a family, revered by the virtuous, is difficult to get. He becomes an excellent brahmana who knows the four Vedas. He officiates at sacrifices and obtains *dakshina*. When he is united with Vishnu, he obtains emancipation. O *brahmanas*! I have thus properly described to you the fruits of the *yatra*. This bestows objects of pleasure and emancipation on men. What else do you wish to hear?’

Chapter 1(65) (Vishnu's world)

The sages asked, 'O god! We wish to hear about Vishnu's world, where there is no disease. That is a beautiful world that confers bliss. It is full of great wonders. O lord! What are the dimensions of this world? What are the objects of pleasure there? What is its beauty? What are its powers? What is the *karma* through which a man who is devoted to *karma* can go there? Is it because of seeing, touching, or performing *snana* and other things at *tirthas*? Tell us the truth about this in detail. We have great curiosity.'

Brahma replied, 'O sages! All of you hear about that supreme spot. I will tell you about it. It is blessed and sacred and destroys *samsara*. It is desired by devotees. It is supreme among all the worlds and is named after Vishnu. Everything there is extraordinary. That auspicious place is revered by the three worlds. There are trees like *ashoka*, *parijata*, *mandara*, *champaka*, *malati*, *mallika*, *kunda*, *bakula*, *nagakesara*, *punnaga*, *atimukta*, *priyangu*, *tagara*, *arjuna*, *patala*, *chuta*, *khadira*, *karnikara*, which lights up forests, *naranga*, *panasa*, *lodhra*, *nimba*, *dadima*, *sarja*, *draksha*, ¹²¹⁹ *lakucha*, *kharjura*, *madhuka*, *indraphala*, ¹²²⁰ *kapittha*, *narikela*, *tala*, *shriphala*, ¹²²¹, innumerable *kalpavrikshas*, ¹²²² other wild and beautiful trees, *sarala*, *chandana*, *nipa*, *devadaru*, *shubhanjana*, *jati*, ¹²²³ *lavanga*, *kankola*, trees with the scent of camphor, clumps of betel leaves and trees laden with areca nut. There are many other kinds of trees, with fruits from all the seasons. There are many kinds of flowers. There are canopies made out of creepers. There are many sacred water bodies, with the sounds of many excellent birds. There are hundreds of ponds, filled with enchanting water. There are blossoming lilies, lotuses with one hundred petals and other excellent lotuses. There are red and blue lotuses. There are beautiful and fragrant white lotuses. There are many other beautiful flowers that grow in the

water, with many kinds of colours. The beautiful place is full of swans, *karandavas*, *chakravakas*, *koyashtis*, *datyuhās*, *chatakas*, *priyaputras* and *jivajivaka* type of birds. There are other divine aquatic birds. There are the beautiful sounds of birds that fly around in the air. In this way, the place is full of many divine wonders. There are sacred and agreeable trees and water bodies. Divine *vimanas* are there, decorated with diverse kinds of jewels. They are made of gold and can travel anywhere at will. They sparkle and resound with the divine sound of *gandharvas* singing. They resemble the midday sun and *apsaras* adorn them. The couches and seats are made out of gold and they are stocked with all kinds of objects of pleasure. With flags and decorated with strings of pearls, they fly in the sky. There are large numbers of these and they have many colours. The covers are made out of molten gold. There are the excellent scents of many kinds of flowers, mixed with sandalwood and aloe. The sounds of many kinds of musical instruments waft through passages that are easy to move along. Adorned with clumps of bells, these *vimanas* possess the speed of the wind and thought. That city of Vishnu is revered in the worlds and people find pleasure there, along with many types of women. *Gandharvas* and *apsaras* are always there. The beautiful faces of the charming women resemble the moon. Their breasts are full and peaked. Their waists are slender. Such women are everywhere. Some are dark in complexion, others are fair. Their gait is like that of crazy elephants. Those women surround the best among men and fan him. The whisks are made out of yak-hair, with golden handles that are studded with many kinds of jewels. They are intoxicated and delight him with singing, dancing and the playing of musical instruments. That excellent abode is ornamented with *yakshas*, *vidyadharas*, *siddhas*, *gandharvas*, large numbers of *apsaras*, groups of gods and *rishis*. When learned people reach there, they obtain extremely extensive objects of pleasure. The spot is on the shores of the southern ocean, near the king of *vata* trees. It is there that they see the illustrious and lotus-eyed Krishna, the lord of the universe. Having seen him, they sport with the *apsaras*, as long as the moon and the stars exist in the sky. They no longer suffer from old age and death, and their complexion is like that of heated gold. They do not

suffer from any kind of misery. They are devoid of thirst or any kind of suffering. They become immensely valiant and assume a four-armed form, adorned with a garland of wild flowers. ¹²²⁴ They are decorated with the *shrivatsa* mark and hold a conch shell, a *chakra* and a mace. Some are as dark as blue lotuses and some have the complexion of gold. Some are seen to have the complexion of emeralds and others resemble lapis lazuli. Some are dark in complexion and wear earrings. Others have the complexion of diamonds. O supreme among *brahmanas*! The worlds of all the gods do not shine as much as Hari's world shines. It is full of everything that is extraordinary. O *brahmanas*! Because of the god's powers, if a person goes there, he does not return and is not reborn until the deluge arrives.'

'They roam around in that divine city, proud of their youth and beauty. They behold Krishna, Rama and Subhadra in Purushottama. In the middle of the city, there is Hari's resplendent temple, adorned with jewels. It is like molten gold and resembles the midday sun. It is decorated with hundreds of thousands of flags. It is surrounded by a golden rampart and extends for ten thousand *yojanas*. There are colourful standards of many colours. Extremely charming because of these, the city is like the autumn moon, surrounded by *nakshatras*. There are four extensive gates, protected by guards. This large and charming city has seven separate divisions. O *brahmanas*! The first is made of gold, the second of emeralds, the third of sapphire, the fourth of dark blue sapphire, the fifth division is made out of blazing rubies, the sixth is full of diamonds and the seventh is made out of lapis lazuli. That great residence is adorned with pillars that are extraordinary to behold. They are encrusted with many kinds of jewels, gold and pointed pieces of coral. The *siddhas* are seen there, illuminating the ten directions. The illustrious Janardana is seated there, along with Lakshmi. He is as resplendent as the moon on a full moon night, surrounded by the *nakshatras*. He is dark and is attired in yellow garments. He has the *shrivatsa* mark. In his right hand, Hari, full of every kind of energy, holds the terrible and blazing Sudarshana *chakra*, which destroys all weapons. O best among sages! In his left hand, Keshava holds the conch shell known by the name of Panchajanya. It shines like the *kunda* flower, the moon or silver

and has the complexion of a necklace that is made out of milk. It is adorned with one thousand whorls and makes a sound that agitates the universe. In his right hand, he holds the Koumadaki mace. This is terrible and destroys those who are evil in their deeds. It brings an end to *daityas* and *danavas*. It resembles the flames of a blazing fire and is impossible for even the gods to withstand. The Sharnga bow shines in his left hand, with a radiance that resembles that of the sun. The arrows resemble the sun and seem to form a garland of flames that will destroy the gods, the three worlds and all mobile and immobile objects. He is the prosperous one who brings bliss to everyone. He is accomplished in all the sacred texts. This divinity is the *guru* of all the worlds, and all the gods bow down to him. The lord of the gods has one thousand heads, one thousand feet, one thousand eyes, one thousand names, one thousand limbs and one thousand arms. With eyes that resemble lotus petals, the divinity is seated on his throne. Jagannatha, the *guru* of the universe, shines like a flash of lightning. The dazzling lord is surrounded by gods, *siddhas*, *gandharvas*, large numbers of *apsaras*, *yakshas*, *vidyadharas*, *nagas*, sages, *charanas*, *suparnas*,¹²²⁵ *danavas*, *daityas*, *rakshasas*, *guhyakas*, *kinnaras* and many other categories of divine gods. They praise him. Kirti, Prajna, Medha, Sarasvati, Buddhi, Mati, Kshanti, Siddhi, Murti, Dyuti, Gayatri, Savitri, Mangala, Sarvamangala, Prabha, Kanti, Narayani, Shraddha, the goddess Koushiki, Vidyut, Soudamini, Nidra, Ratri, Maya and other immortal women are always present there.¹²²⁶ All of them are established in Vasudeva's abode. What is the need to speak a lot? All of them are present there¹²²⁷—Ghritachi, Menaka, Rambha, Sahajanya, Tilottama, Urvashi, Nimlocha, Vamana, Mandodari, Subhaga, Vishvachi, Vipulanana, Bhadrangi, Chitrasena, the extremely beautiful Pramlocha, Rama¹²²⁸ who confounds the sages, Chandramadhya with the charming face, Sukeshi, Nilakesha, Manmathadipini, Alambusha, Mishrakeshi, Punjikasthala, Kratusthala, Varangi, Purvachitti, Paravati, Maharupa, Shashilekha with the beautiful face, Hamsa-lilanugamini,¹²²⁹ Matta-varana-gamini,¹²³⁰ Vimboshti, Navagarbha and other famous celestial women. There are other *apsaras* who are proud of their youth and beauty. They are slender-waisted and their

faces are charming. They are adorned with every kind of ornament. They sing in sweet voices and possess every kind of attribute. These divine women, from the families of gods and *gandharvas*, are skilled in singing and the playing of musical instruments. All the time, they dance in Purushottama's abode. There is no disease there, nor any kind of suffering. There is no death there. It is not excessively hot or cold. There is no hunger or thirst. There is no old age, disfigurement, or any kind of unhappiness. It is a place that leads to supreme joy and yields every kind of desire. O *brahmanas*! I do not see any world that is superior to Vishnu's world. O *brahmanas*! We have heard of the world of heaven. Those who perform auspicious deeds go there. But even that does not amount to one sixteenth part of Vishnu's world. Such is Hari's supreme abode. It possesses every quality and every object of pleasure. O *brahmanas*! It is sacred and yields every kind of happiness. It has every kind of wonder. Non-believers ¹²³¹ cannot go there. Nor can men who are addicted to material objects. Those who are ungrateful, those who slander, and those who have not conquered their senses cannot go there. Those who always faithfully worship Vasudeva, the preceptor of the universe, go there. There is no doubt that those who are devoted to Vishnu go to Vishnu's world. This *kshetra* is on the shores of the southern ocean and is extremely rare. O supreme among *brahmanas*! If a man sees Krishna, Rama and Subhadra and gives up his body near the *kalpavriksha*, if he dies in Purushottama, if he remembers Purushottama in the spot between the *vata* tree and the ocean, he goes there. Those who die in Purushottama go to that supreme region. There is no doubt about this. O best among sages! I have thus spoken to you about Vishnu's eternal world. It yields every kind of happiness and bestows the fruits of objects of pleasure and emancipation.'

Chapter 1(66) (Purushottama's greatness)

The sages said, 'O lord of the universe! You have spoken about the great wonders in Vishnu's world. It is prosperous and always bestows happiness. It confers objects of pleasure and emancipation. You have spoken about Purushottama *kshetra*, which is extremely rare in this world. If a man gives up his body there, he goes to Hari's world. You have properly spoken about the greatness of this *kshetra*. You have also completely described to us how a man, if he gives up his own body there, goes to Vishnu's world. How wonderful! For the benefit of men, you have spoken about a path to *moksha* by giving up the body. O lord of the gods! There is no doubt that the best among them give up their body in the supreme *kshetra* known as Purushottama and easily go to Vishnu's abode, which is without any disease. Having heard about the *kshetra*'s greatness, we are greatly astounded and our body-hair is repeatedly standing up. O lord of the gods! We are content. O supreme among gods! There are other *kshetras*, all the *tirthas* on earth, rivers and water bodies, Prayaga, Pushkara and so on. But you do not praise them as much as you repeatedly praise the *kshetra* known as Purushottama. O grandfather! We have now understood your intention, why you praise Purushottama *kshetra*. It bestows emancipation. Indeed, on earth, there is no other *kshetra* that is the equal of the one known as Purushottama. O best among the gods! That is the reason you repeatedly praise it.'

Brahma replied, 'O best among sages! That is the truth. You have spoken the truth. Indeed, on earth, there is no other *kshetra* that is the equal of the one known as Purushottama. Indeed, there are sacred *tirthas* and temples. But they do not amount to a sixteenth part of the prosperous place known as Purushottama. Vishnu, the lord of everything, is supreme among all the

supreme ones who exist in the worlds. Like that, Purushottama is greatest among all the *tirthas*. Among all the Adityas, Vishnu is said to be the greatest. Like that, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the greatest. Soma is superior to the *nakshatras* and the ocean is superior to rivers. Like that, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the greatest. Pavaka is the best among the Vasus and Shankara is the best among the Rudras. Like that, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the greatest. *Brahmanas* are best among the *varnas* and Vainateya ¹²³² is best among birds. Like that, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the greatest. Meru is the best among peaks and the Himalayas are the best among mountains. Like that, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the greatest. Lakshmi is the best among women and Jahnavi ¹²³³ is the best among rivers. Like that, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the greatest. Airavata is the best among excellent elephants and Bhrigu is the best among *maharshis*. Like that, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the greatest. Skanda is the best among commanders and Kapila is the best among *siddhas*. Like that, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the greatest. Uchchaihshrava is the best among horses and Kavi Ushanas is the best among wise ones. ¹²³⁴ Like that, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the greatest. Vyasa is the best among sages and Kubera is the best among the *yakshas* and the *rakshasas*. ¹²³⁵ Like that, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the greatest. The mind is the best among the sense organs and the earth is the best among the elements. Like that, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the greatest. Ashvattha is the best among all trees and Pavana is the best among those which spread. Like that, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the greatest. O *brahmanas*! Chudamani ¹²³⁶ is the best among all ornaments. Like that, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the greatest. Chitraratha is the best among *gandharvas* and the *vajra* is the best among weapons. Like that, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the greatest. ‘A’ is the best among all letters of the alphabet and *gayatri* is the best among all metres. Like that, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the greatest. O supreme *brahmanas*! The head is the best among all the limbs. Like that, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the greatest. Arundhati is the best among all virtuous

women. Like that, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the greatest. The knowledge of attaining *moksha* is said to be supreme among all kinds of knowledge. Like that, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the greatest. The king is the best among men and the cow that yields all objects of desire is the best among all cows. Like that, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the greatest. Gold is the best among all jewels and Vasuki is the best among snakes. Like that, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the greatest. Prahlada is the best among all the *daityas* and Rama is best among all those who wield weapons. Like that, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the greatest. *Makara* is the best among fish and the king of animals is the best among animals. Like that, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the greatest. The ocean of milk, the lord of rivers, is the best among all oceans. Like that, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the greatest. Varuna is supreme among those who reside in the water and Yama is supreme among all those who control. Like that, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the greatest. O supreme sages! Narada is the best among *devarshis*. Like that, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the greatest. Gold is the best among metals and *dakshina* is the best among everything that is sacred. Like that, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the greatest. Daksha is the best among Prajapatis and Kashyapa is the best among *rishis*. Like that, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the greatest. Bhaskara is supreme among the planets and Pranava ¹²³⁷ is supreme among *mantras*. Like that, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the greatest. The horse sacrifice is said to be the best among sacrifices. Like that, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the greatest. Grain is said to be the best among plants and the king of grass is the best among grass species. ¹²³⁸ Like that, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the greatest. In all the *tirthas*, it is *dharma* which enables one to cross *samsara*. However, among all the *tirthas*, Purushottama is the best.’

Chapter 1(67) (Greatness of Ananta Vasudeva)

Brahma said, ‘O supreme *brahmanas*! There are the fruits of *japa*, oblations, vows, austerities and donations in all the *tirthas* and *kshetras*. O *brahmanas*! But I do not see any other place on earth that is equal to this. What is the need to speak a lot repeatedly? The truth is the truth. It is true that this *kshetra* is supreme and great. If one sees the place known as Purushottama even once, if one touches the waters of the ocean after this once, if one possesses knowledge about the *brahman* once—there is no need to reside in the womb. ¹²³⁹ Hari is present in the excellent region of Purushottama. If a person resides there for a year, or if he resides there only for a month, his *japa*, oblations and austerities truly become great. Hari, the lord of yoga, is present in that supreme region. If a person goes there, along with celestial women, he enjoys diverse kinds of objects of pleasure. At the end of a *kalpa*, that excellent man again returns to the mortal world. O *brahmanas*! He is born in a house of yogis and attempts to learn what should be known. When he unites with Vishnu, he easily goes to the place where Hari is. In due order, I have described to you everything that you wished to hear about—the greatness of the kalpavriksha, Rama, Krishna, Bhadra, Markandeya, Indradyumna and Madhava; ¹²⁴⁰ the greatness of Svargadvara; the due order for bathing in the ocean at the right time, at the place where there is a confluence with the Bhagirathi; and everything else. I have told you everything about Indradyumna’s greatness. ¹²⁴¹ I have told you all that is wonderful, secret, sacred and excellent. This is a supreme, secret, blessed and ancient account. It enables one to be released from *samsara*.’

The sages said, ‘We are not satisfied from hearing about the illustrious one’s account. You should again tell us in detail about the supreme and the

secret. You have still not told us properly about Ananta Vasudeva. O god! We wish to hear about this in detail. Please tell us.'

Brahma replied, 'O best among sages! I will tell you the supreme essence about the greatness of Ananta Vasudeva, which is rare in the three worlds. O *brahmanas*! In ancient times, in the first *kalpa*, I originated from the one who is not manifest. I summoned Vishvakarma, the best among all the great artisans of the gods and foremost in his deeds, and addressed him in these words. 'O Vishvakarma! Using stone from the earth, create an image of Vasudeva. On seeing this, Indra, men and others will devotedly worship it in the proper way.' However, learning about this, the *danavas* and the *rakshasas* were filled with great fear. ¹²⁴² They went to heaven and reached the eternal summit of Sumeru. Having worshipped Vasudeva, they resided without any fear. Hearing my words, Vishvakarma instantly created a pure image, holding a conch shell, a *chakra* and a mace. It possessed all the auspicious signs and the eyes were as large as lotus petals. There was the *shrivatsa* mark and the excellent image was also extremely fierce. There was a garland of wild flowers on the chest. The image wore a diadem and had armlets. It had a broad chest and was clad in yellow garments. It was adorned with two earrings. In ancient times, such was the divine image that I had myself got constructed. The time arrived for instating it, using secret *mantras*. At that time, surrounded by those who travel in the sky, Shakra, the king of the gods, arrived in Brahma's abode, astride his excellent elephant. Shakra propitiated the image through repeated acts of *snana* and donations. Taking the image with him, he returned to his own city. Controlling his words, deeds and thoughts, he worshipped it for a very long time. Thus, he managed to kill cruel *asuras* like Vritra and terrible *danavas* like Namuchi. He enjoyed the worlds of Bhuloka, Bhuvvarloka and Svarloka.

'When the second yuga of *treta* arrived, there was an extremely valiant lord of *rakshasas*. This was the powerful Dashagriva. He conquered his senses and fasted for ten thousand years. He practised extremely fierce austerities that are extremely difficult to perform. Satisfied because of these supreme austerities, I granted him a boon. All the gods, *daityas*, *uragas* and

rakshasas would be unable to kill him. The servants of Yama, with their powers of cursing and use of fierce weapons, would also be unable to kill him. Having received this boon, the *rakshasa* defeated all the different groups of *yakshas* and the lord of riches.¹²⁴³ He then attempted to conquer Shakra. There was an extremely terrible battle between the *rakshasa* and the gods. Having defeated the king of the gods, Meghanada, the *rakshasa*'s son, obtained the name of Indrajit.¹²⁴⁴ The powerful Ravana reached Amaravati and the auspicious residence of the king of the gods. He saw Vasudeva's image there, resembling a mass of collyrium with all the auspicious signs. There was the mark of *shrivatsa* and the eyes were as large as lotus petals. There was a garland of wild flowers on the chest. The image was adorned with a diadem and armlets. The four-armed form was clad in yellow garments and held a conch shell, a *chakra* and a mace in the hands. It was adorned in all the ornaments and it bestowed all the objects of desire. He ignored the masses of jewels. Instead, he took the image, with all the auspicious signs and on Pushpaka *vimana*, swiftly left for Lanka. Vibhishana was Ravana's younger brother. This prosperous one was a minister and was in charge of the city. He had *dharma* in his soul and was devoted to Narayana. He saw the divine image, taken away from the residence of Indra of the gods. He was filled with wonder and his body hair stood up. His inner core filled with delight and he bowed his head down before divinity. The one with *dharma* in his soul prostrated himself repeatedly and said, 'Today, my birth is successful. Today, all my austerities have been rendered successful.' Approaching his elder brother, he joined his hands in salutation and said, 'O king! You should show me a favour and give me this image. I will worship Jagannatha and cross the ocean of *samsara*.' Hearing his brother's words, Ravana replied, 'O brave one! Take the image. What will I do with it? I have worshipped Svayambhu and have conquered the three worlds. Mahadeva is full of great wonders and is the cause behind the origin of all living beings.'¹²⁴⁵ The immensely intelligent Vibhishana worshipped Janardana's auspicious image for one hundred and eight years. He obtained the boon of not suffering from old age or death. He

obtained *anima* and the other *siddhis* and lordship over the kingdom of Lanka, enjoying all the desired objects of pleasure.’

The sages said, ‘Wonderful. We are filled with amazement at hearing about this supreme and immortal account of Ananta Vasudeva’s extremely rare presence on earth. O god! We wish to hear about this in detail, exactly as it happened. You should tell us in detail about the divinity’s greatness.’

Brahma continued, ‘The cruel *rakshasa* was evil in his deeds. He defeated gods, *gandharvas*, *kinnaras*, guardians of the worlds, humans, sages and *siddhas* in battles. He abducted all the beautiful women and brought them to the city of Lanka. He then prepared to abduct Sita. In the form of a golden deer, ¹²⁴⁶ he deceived Raghava. Along with Soumitri, Rama sought to kill Ravana in a battle. As swift as thought, he killed Vali. He instated Sugriva as king and Angada became the heir apparent. Rama, with eyes like lotus petals, surrounded himself with extremely terrible and extremely strong *vanaras* ¹²⁴⁷—Hanuman, Nala, Nila, Jambavan, Panasa, Gavaya, Gavaksha and others who were pure and extremely energetic. Collecting all kinds of boulders from mountains, they constructed a bridge over the great ocean. With a large army, Rama crossed the great ocean. There was a tumultuous battle between him and large numbers of *rakshasas*. As if toying, the valiant Rama killed Yamahasta, Prahasta, Nikumbha, Kumbha, Narantaka, the extremely valiant Yamantaka, Maladhya, Malikadhya, Indrajit, Kumbhakarna and Ravana. After purifying Vaidehi through the fire, he gave the kingdom to Vibhishana. He took Vasudeva with him and ascended Pushpaka, returning to Ayodhya, where he had ruled earlier. ¹²⁴⁸ Affectionate towards his devotees, he lovingly instated his younger brothers, Bharata and Shatrughna. ¹²⁴⁹ He himself ruled, like an emperor, over all these kingdoms. He worshipped Hari, who was nothing but his own earlier form. Raghava enjoyed the earth, right up to the frontiers of the ocean, for eleven thousand years. He then obtained his own true kingdom, Vishnu’s supreme abode. Rama gave the image to the lord of the oceans and said, ‘You are blessed. Control yourself properly and protect this image, inside the waters.’ When dvapara yuga arrived, inclinations became lax and the divinity, the preceptor of the universe, was entreated by

the earth. Thereafter, so as to slay Kamsa and the others, aided by Samkarshana, the illustrious lord descended in Vasudeva's family. O *brahmanas*! That image bestows all the objects of desire. For the welfare of the worlds and for some other reasons, he himself raised that image from the waters of the ocean, the lord of the rivers. He instated it in the sacred, extremely rare and supreme *kshetra* of Purushottama. O *brahmanas*! Since then, the image, which bestows all the objects of desire, has been there. The divinity removes all the afflictions of the gods. Full of incessant devotion, if a person uses his words and deeds to seek refuge with Ananta, the lord of all the lords, he goes to the supreme destination. Full of devotion, if a person sees Ananta, worships and prostrates himself even once, he obtains fruits that are ten times the fruits obtained through royal and horse sacrifices. Such a man is prosperous, with all the objects of desire. He goes to Vishnu's city on a *vimana* that is extremely radiant and has the complexion of the sun. It can travel as it wills and is adorned with garlands and nets of bells. It is served by large numbers of celestial women. Accompanied by the singing of *gandharvas*, he saves twenty-one generations of his family and goes there. He is handsome and assumes a divine form. There is no old age or death there and he enjoys all the supreme objects of pleasure until the deluge arrives. When his store of good merits has been exhausted, he returns to earth as a brahmana who knows the four Vedas. When he is united with Vishnu, he obtains emancipation. O supreme among sages! I have thus described Ananta to you. Even if one has hundreds of years, who is capable of describing all the qualities?'

Chapter 1(68) (Greatness of Purushottama *kshetra*)

Brahma said, ‘I have thus spoken about Ananta’s greatness and that of Purushottama *kshetra*. It bestows objects of pleasure and emancipation on men and is very rare. Pundarikaksha, the one who holds the conch shell, the *chakra* and the mace, is there. He is handsome and is attired in yellow garments. He is the one who killed Kamsa and Keshi. Krishna is revered by the gods and the *asuras*. If a person sees him, Samkarshana and Subhadra there, there is no doubt that he is blessed. The divinity is the lord of the three worlds and confers all the objects of desire. If a person constantly meditates on Krishna, there is no doubt that he will be liberated. If a person is devoted to Krishna, remembers Krishna in the night and remembers Krishna on getting up, when he is separated from his body, he enters Krishna, just as oblations offered through *mantras* enter the fire. O best among sages! Therefore, if a person desires liberation, he must attempt to see the lotus-eyed Krishna in that *kshetra*. Learned people who see Krishna, the wielder of the plough and Subhadra when they are laid down to sleep, go to Hari’s abode. Whatever be the time, if a person devotedly sees Purushottama, Rohini’s son and Subhadra, he goes to Vishnu’s world. If a person resides in Purushottama for four months ¹²⁵⁰ or for an entire year, he obtains fruits that are greater than the fruits obtained by visiting all the *tirthas* on earth. If learned people conquer their senses and conquer their rage and reside there all the time, they obtain the fruits of austerity. If a man torments himself in austerity in Purushottama for a month, he obtains the fruits of performing austerity in other *tirthas* for ten thousand years. Fruits are obtained through austerity, *brahmacharya* and the giving up of attachment. Learned people always obtain those fruits there. Fruits have

been derived from bathing and donations at all the sacred *tirthas*. Learned people always obtain all those fruits there. Fruits from properly undertaking vows and following *niyama* at *tirthas* have been spoken about. Every day, a pure man obtains all those fruits there. There are many kinds of fruits that are obtained by performing rites and sacrifices. Every day, a man who controls his senses obtains those fruits there. If a man approaches the *kalpavriksha* ¹²⁵¹ in Purushottama and gives up his body there, there is no doubt that he obtains emancipation. If he gives up his body in the space between the *vata* tree and the ocean, there is no doubt that he obtains the supreme objective of emancipation, which is so very difficult to get. Even if a man gives up his body there unwillingly, he is freed from all misery and obtains emancipation, which is so very difficult to get. Even if worms, insects, flying insects and other inferior species give up their bodies there, they too obtain the supreme destination. O *brahmanas*! Look at people wandering around in other *tirthas* in the world. The fruits obtained from the *tirtha* known as Purushottama are superior to all those. Even if a mortal man faithfully sees Purushottama even once, he becomes supreme among one thousand men. In the Vedas and the Puranas, the excellent Purusha is superior to Prakriti. In this world, it is the same with Purushottama. In Vedanta and in the Puranas, he is spoken of as the *paramatman*. For the welfare of the universe, he is the one who exists in the form of Purushottama. O supreme among *brahmanas*! In this *kshetra*, if a man gives up his body willingly or unwillingly, on the road, in a cremation ground, within the house, at a place along the road, or anywhere else, he obtains emancipation. Therefore, a man who desires emancipation must properly attempt to give up his life there. Which man is capable of describing the greatness of the place known as Purushottama? If a man sees the *vata* tree there, even the sin of killing a brahmana is dispelled. I have described some of the qualities of that *kshetra*. Even if one has hundreds of years, who is capable of speaking about all the qualities? O best among sages! If you desire eternal emancipation, reside attentively in that supreme and sacred *tirtha*.’

Vyasa continued, ‘They heard the words of Brahma, whose birth is not manifest, and dwelt there, thus obtaining the supreme destination. O supreme *brahmanas*! Therefore, if you desire emancipation, you must make efforts to reside in the supreme *kshetra* known as Purushottama.’

Chapter 1(69) (Kandu's story)

Vyasa said, 'O best among sages! That *kshetra* of Purushottama brings happiness to all living beings. It bestows the fruits of *dharma*, *artha*, *kama* and *moksha*. There was an extremely energetic *rishi* named Kandu. He was extremely devoted to *dharma*. He was pure, self-controlled and truthful in speech. He was engaged in the welfare of all creatures. He had conquered his senses and had conquered his anger. He was accomplished in the Vedas and the Vedangas. Having worshipped Purushottama, he obtained supreme success. There were other sages who were firm in their vows and had obtained success. They were engaged in the welfare of all creatures. They were self-controlled and had conquered their rage. They were devoid of malice.'

The sages asked, 'Who was this Kandu? How did he achieve the supreme objective? O excellent one! We wish to hear about his conduct. Please tell us.'

Vyasa replied, 'O tigers among sages! Listen to this agreeable account. I will briefly tell you about that sage's activities. O supreme sages! The sacred banks of the Gomati are secluded and extremely beautiful. The place is full of tubers, roots, fruits, kindling, flowers and *kusha* grass. There are many trees and creepers, and the place is adorned with many kinds of flowers. There are the beautiful sounds of many kinds of birds calling. There are herds of many kinds of animals. That is where Kandu had his hermitage. It was surrounded by clumps of plantain trees and possessed excellent flowers and fruits from all the seasons. There, the sage tormented himself in extraordinary, supreme and great austerity. He observed vows, fasts, *niyama*, bathing, silence and restraint of the senses. In the summer, he scorched himself through five fires. ¹²⁵² During the monsoon season, he

slept on the bare ground. In the winter, he tormented himself by remaining submerged in the water, up to his neck. Such were the extremely great austerities. On witnessing the valour of the sage's austerity, the gods, the *gandharvas*, the *siddhas* and the *vidyadharas* were greatly surprised. O supreme sages! Through the strength of his austerity, Kandu scorched the earth, the firmament, heaven and the three worlds. 'How wonderful is his great fortitude! How wonderful is his great austerity!' On seeing him established in these austerities, this is what the gods said. Along with Shakra, the gods were anxious and consulted among themselves. ¹²⁵³ They were scared and greatly anxious and desired to create impediments to such austerity.'

'Discerning their intention, Shakra, the lord of the three worlds, spoke to Pramlocha. ¹²⁵⁴ Her hips were beautiful and she was proud of her youth and beauty. She was slender at the waist and her teeth were beautiful. Her hips were wide and her breasts were full. She possessed all the auspicious signs and Bala's destroyer ¹²⁵⁵ spoke to her. 'O Pramlocha! Quickly go to the spot where the sage is tormenting himself. O auspicious one! And so that an impediment is created in the path of his austerity, and agitate his mind.' Pramlocha replied, 'O lord! O best among the gods! I always act in accordance with your words. However, in this particular case, I have a doubt about whether I will remain alive. I am scared of the supreme sage. He is established in *brahmacharya*. His austerities blaze in their great ferocity and he is as resplendent as the sun or the fire. When he knows that I have approached to create an obstruction, the sage will be angry. Kandu is extremely energetic and he will invoke a curse on me. It will be very difficult to withstand. There are other *apsaras* who are proud of their youth and beauty—Urvashi, Menaka, Rambha, Ghritachi, Punjikasthala, Vishvachi, Sahajanya, Purvachitti, Tilottama, Alambusha, Mishrakeshi, Shashilekha and Vamana. They are slender at the waist and their faces are beautiful. Their breasts are upraised and full. They are skilled in spreading desire. Engage one of them.'"

Brahma continued, ¹²⁵⁶ 'Hearing her words, Shachi's consort spoke to her again. "O auspicious one! Let the others you have named remain here. You

are skilled. To help you, I will give you Kama, Vasanta and Vayu. ¹²⁵⁷ O one with the excellent hips! With you, they will go to the spot where the great sage is.” Hearing Shakra’s words, the beautiful lady with the beautiful eyes travelled through the sky. She went and saw the superb and lovely forest and the unblemished sage, blazing in his austerity, seated in his hermitage. Along with them, she saw the lovely forest, which was like Nandana. There were superb and excellent flowers from all the seasons and the place was full of groups of monkeys. There were sacred clumps of lotuses. The forest was full of many sprouts. The beautiful and sweet sounds of birds calling were agreeable to the ears. She saw the trees, laden with excellent fruits from all the seasons. There were resplendent flowers from all the seasons. The sounds of birds calling could be heard. The large-eyes one saw *amra*, *amrataka*, *bhavya*, ¹²⁵⁸ *narikela*, *tinduka*, *bilva*, *jiva*, ¹²⁵⁹ *dadima*, *bijapuraka*, *panasa*, *lakucha*, *nipa*, beautiful *shirisha*, *paravata*, ¹²⁶⁰ *kola*, ¹²⁶¹ *arimeda* ¹²⁶², *amlavetasa*, ¹²⁶³ *bhallataka*, *amalaka*, *shataparna*, ¹²⁶⁴ *inguda*, *karavira*, *haritaka*, *vibhitaka* and many other trees. She saw many other excellent trees that were full of flowers and fruit—*ashoka*, *punnaga*, *ketaki*, *bakula*, *parijata*, *kovidara*, *mandara*, *indivara*, ¹²⁶⁵ blossoming *patala*, beautiful *devadaru* trees, *shala*, *tala*, *tamala*, *nichula* ¹²⁶⁶ and *lomaka*. ¹²⁶⁷ There were *chakoras*, *shatapatras*, *bhringarajas*, *shukas*, *kokilas*, *kalavinkas*, *haritas*, *jivajivakas*, *priyaputras*, *chatakas* and many other kinds of birds. Their lovely and sweet calls were agreeable to the ears. The ponds were full of sparkling water and pleased the mind. There were lilies, lotuses, auspicious blue lotuses, white lotuses and red lotuses in every direction. There were aquatic birds like *kadamba*, *chakravaka*, waterfowl, *karandava*, cranes and swans. The place was full of tortoises, dolphins and many other aquatic creatures. Along with them, she gradually roamed around the forest. Along with them, she saw the forest, which was full of great wonders. The eyes of the beautiful lady dilated in wonder. O supreme among *brahmanas*! She spoke to Vayu, Kama and Vasanta. Pramlocha said, “All of you prepare yourselves separately and help me.” Proud of her powers of being able to agitate, she spoke to them in this way. She again said, “I will go to the spot where the sage is. He is like a charioteer. His body is like a chariot and he is

controlling his senses, which are like horses. Using the weapons of love, I will make him a bad charioteer who has to drop his reins. Whether he is Brahma, Janardana or Nilalohita, I will use the arrows of love to pierce his inner organs.” Having said this, she went to the spot where the sage was. Because of the power of the sage’s austerity, the predatory beasts in the hermitage had been calmed. The beautiful *apsara* stood on the banks of the river, a short distance away. With the sweet voice of a male cuckoo, she started to sing. At this, Vasanta suddenly exhibited his strength. Though it was not the right time, the agreeable and sweet calls of cuckoos could be heard. A fragrant breeze began to blow from its abode in the Malaya mountains. This made the flowers gently fall down, in large and small heaps. Desiring to agitate the sage’s mind, Kama approached him, holding his arrows made out of flowers. The sage’s mind was astounded at hearing the sound of the singing. Suffering from Kama’s arrows, he went to the spot where the one with the excellent eyebrows was standing. On seeing her, he was amazed and his eyes dilated in wonder. His body hair stood up. He lost himself and his upper garment was dislodged. He spoke to her. The *rishi* asked, ‘O one with the excellent hips! O extremely fortunate one! O one with the beautiful smiles! Who are you? Who do you belong to? O one with the excellent eyebrows! O one with the slender waist! You have stolen my mind. Tell me the truth.’ Pramlocha replied, ‘I have come here to collect flowers and I will do whatever you ask me to do. Instruct me quickly. Following your command, what shall I do?’ Hearing her words, he was confounded and lost his fortitude. Taking the maiden by the hand, he entered his own hermitage. O supreme *brahmanas*! Having accomplished the tasks of the gods, Kama, Vayu and Vasanta returned to where they had come from. They went to Hari ¹²⁶⁸ and told him that they had done what he wished for. Hearing this, Shakra and the other gods were pleased and delighted in their minds.’

‘Along with her, Kandu entered the hermitage. He himself assumed a supreme form that was like that of Madana. He was full of youth and beauty and was extremely handsome. He was adorned with divine ornaments and he was like a person who was sixteen years of age. He wore celestial

garments. He was beautiful and was adorned with divine garlands and unguents. Through the power of his austerity, he instantly assumed a form that was capable of enjoying all the objects of pleasure. On witnessing his supreme energy, she was filled with wonder. Delighted, she exclaimed, ‘How wonderful is the valour of austerity.’ O supreme sages! Along with her, night and day, he happily enjoyed himself, forsaking bathing, *sandhya* rites, *japa*, oblations, self-studying, worshipping the gods, vows, fasting, *niyama* and *dhyana*. Manmatha ¹²⁶⁹ entered his heart and he did not understand that his austerity was getting exhausted. With his mind addicted to the material, he did not comprehend that time was passing—evenings, nights, days, fortnights, months, seasons and years. O *brahmanas*! The one with the excellent hips was accomplished in secret expressions of desire. She was skilled in conversing and amused herself with him. In this way, along with her, in the valley of Mandara, the sage engaged in the *dharma* of vulgar pleasures for more than a hundred years. Then she told the immensely fortunate one, ‘O brahmana! I wish to go to heaven. With a cheerful face, you should show me your favours and grant me permission.’ Though she spoke in this way, the sage’s mind was attached to her and he said, ‘O fortunate one! You should remain for a few days more.’ Thus addressed, the slender-limbed one remained there for more than another one hundred years, enjoying material pursuits with the great-souled one. She told him, ‘O illustrious one! Please grant me permission to go to the abode of the gods.’ However, thus addressed, he again asked her to stay. The one with the beautiful face remained there for more than another one hundred years. With a smile of love on her face, she said, ‘O brahmana! I will go to heaven.’ However, the sage again told the large-eyed one, ‘O one with the excellent eyebrows! Remain with me for a very long time and go later.’ Scared of being cursed by the *rishi*, the one with the excellent hips again remained there for a little less than two hundred years. Whenever she told the immensely fortunate one about going to the abode of the king of the gods, he repeatedly asked her to stay. The timid one was scared of being cursed and his kindness made her amiable. She also knew quite well about being separated in love. Therefore, when requested, she did not abandon the

sage. Night and day, the supreme *rishi* found pleasure with her. His senses overcome by Manmatha, he found newer and newer ways of expressing love. On one occasion, the sage was swiftly emerging from his cottage. As he was emerging, the auspicious one asked him, 'Where are you going?' Thus addressed, he replied, 'O auspicious one! The day is about to end and I must perform the *sandhya* rites. Otherwise, there will be a violation of the rituals.' Delighted, she laughed and told the great sage, 'O one who knows everything about *dharma*! Is it only today that the day is about to end? When days passed earlier, you did not perform the rites. I am surprised at what you have said.' The sage said, 'O fortunate one! This morning, you came to me on the auspicious banks of the river. O one with the excellent hips! That is when I saw you and you entered my hermitage. It is now evening and the day has come to an end. Why are you laughing at me now? Tell me truthfully.' Pramlocha replied, 'O brahmana! It is true that I arrived in the morning. That statement is not false. But it was not today. Hundreds of years have passed since that time.' At this, the alarmed brahmana asked the large-eyed one, 'O timid one! Please tell me. While I was amusing myself with you, how much time has elapsed?' Pramlocha replied, 'Since the time I arrived before you, nine hundred and seven years, six months and three days have elapsed.' The *rishi* asked, 'O timid one! O auspicious one! Is that the truth or are you saying this in jest? It seems to me that I have been with you only for a single day.' Pramlocha replied, 'O brahmana! How can I possibly utter a lie in your presence, especially when I have been asked by someone like you, whose path I always follow?' O supreme among *brahmanas*! Hearing her words, the sage reprimanded himself. The sage said, 'Shame on me and my wicked conduct. My austerities have been destroyed. My store of knowledge about the *brahman* has been destroyed. My sense of discrimination has been taken away by a woman, who has been created for the sake of delusion. The *brahman* is beyond the six waves. ¹²⁷⁰ Since I have conquered my *atman*, this should have been known to me. Shame on the great crocodile in the form of *kama*, which has led to this end. Because of *kama*, I have today destroyed the vows, all the Vedas and all the other various methods. I have followed a vulgar path that leads to hell.' He

knew about *dharma* and he reprimanded himself in this way. He then addressed the *apsara*, who was seated there, in the following words. The *rishi* said, ‘O wicked one! Go wherever you wish to. Through your expressions, you have agitated me and have accomplished the task of the king of the gods. I will not reduce you to ashes with the terrible flames of my anger. Among the virtuous, friendship results through seven steps and I have lived with you. ¹²⁷¹ Alternatively, whose fault is it and what should I do to you? Since I have not been able to conquer my senses, it is entirely my fault. However, to do what brings Shakra pleasure, you have destroyed my austerity. Therefore, shame on you. You are the cause behind this great delusion.’ When the brahmana *rishi* spoke in this way to the slender-waisted one, she trembled and perspired a lot. The virtuous lady trembled in her limbs, like a creeper. Angry, the excellent sage told her, ‘Go. Go away.’ Having been reprimanded in this way, she emerged from the hermitage. As she travelled through the air, she used the sprouts in the trees to wipe off the sweat. The maiden moved from tree to tree and used the tender sprouts to wipe off the drops of sweat that exuded from her limbs. The *rishi* had planted a fetus in her womb. In the form of drops of perspiration, this emerged through the pores in her body. The trees gathered these drops and assembled them together in the form of a single fetus. Nourished by the beams of the moon, this fetus gradually developed and became the one named Marisha, the lovely-eyed daughter of the trees. O *brahmanas*! She was the wife of Prachetas and Daksha’s mother.’

Vyasa said, ‘O *brahmanas*! The illustrious Kandu’s austerity had diminished. The excellent one went to Vishnu’s temple, in the place known as Purushottama. He saw that supreme *kshetra*. It was extremely rare on earth and conferred emancipation. It was located on the shores of the southern ocean and bestowed every object of desire. It was extremely beautiful and was covered with sand. It was adorned with groves of *ketaki* flowers. There were many kinds of trees and creepers. There were the auspicious calls of many kinds of birds. Every place in the region was easy to traverse. There were flowers from all the seasons. It gave men every kind of happiness. It was blessed and there was a store of every kind of quality.

Earlier, Bhṛigu and other excellent sages and *siddhas* had frequented the place. There were *gandharvas*, *kinnaras*, *yakshas* and others who desired emancipation. He saw Hari there, ornamented by all the gods who surrounded him. There were *brahmanas* and other *varnas*, from all the different stages of life. The excellent sage saw the *kshetra* and the divine Purushottama there and thought that he had become successful in his objective. With single-minded focus, he started to worship Hari. With a concentrated mind, he performed *japa* using *brahmapara*. The excellent sage, the great yogi, stood with his arms raised upwards.’

The sages said, ‘O sage! We wish to hear about the supreme and auspicious *brahmapara*, which Kandu used to perform *japa* and worship the divinity Keshava.’

Vyasa continued, ‘Vishnu is supreme among those who enable one to cross over. He is the shore. He can himself not be crossed. He is beyond all those who are supreme. The *paramatman* is his form. He is *brahmapara*.¹²⁷² He is the origin of the distant shore. He is superior to all those who are supreme. He is the one who enables the crossing. He is also the one who cannot be crossed.¹²⁷³ He is the cause. He is the one who resorts to the cause and he is the cause of the cause too. He is supreme among everything that is a cause of the cause. He is what needs to be done. He is the action and the agent. In many different forms, he is the one who protects everything. The lord is the *brahman*. He exists in everything. The *brahman* is Prajapati. He is Achyuta. Vishnu is the *brahman*, without decay, eternal and without birth. He is the impartial and original one, free of every kind of attachment. Purushottama is the everlasting and imperishable *brahman*, without birth. Like the *brahman*, let my taints of attachment go away and be pacified.’ O excellent *brahmanas*! Purushottama heard the sage perform *japa* with *brahmapara* and knew that his devotion was supreme and extremely firm. The divinity is affectionate towards his devotees and was filled with great delight. O *brahmanas*! Astride Garuda, the joy of Vinata’s lineage, Madhusudana approached him. He addressed him in words that rumbled like the clouds and made the directions resound. The illustrious one said, ‘O sage! Tell me about the supreme task that is in your mind. I am

the one who bestows boons and I have come before you. O one who is excellent in vows! Ask for a boon.’ He heard the words of the lord of the gods, the one who holds the *chakra*. He opened his eyes and suddenly saw Hari in front of him. He was like an *atasi* flower and his large eyes were like the petals of lotuses. He held a conch shell, a *chakra* and a mace in his hands. He wore a diadem and armlets. The lord had extensive limbs and was four-armed, clad in yellow garments. He bore the *shrivatsa* mark and was adorned with a garland of wildflowers. ¹²⁷⁴ At this, he was filled with wonder and his body hair stood up. Like a rod, he prostrated himself on the ground and bowed down. ‘Today, my birth has been rendered successful. Today, my austerities have met with success.’ Saying this, the tiger among sages started to praise him.’

Kandu said, ‘O Narayana! O Hari! O Krishna! O one with the *shrivatsa* mark! O lord of the universe! O seed of the universe! O refuge of the universe! O witness of the universe! I bow down to you. O one who is not manifest! O Jishnu! ¹²⁷⁵ O one who is the origin! O Pradhana! O Purushottama! O Pundarikaksha! O Govinda! O protector of the worlds! I bow down to you. O Hiranyagarbha! ¹²⁷⁶ O Shri’s abode! O Padmanabha! ¹²⁷⁷ O eternal one! O one who has the earth in his womb! O permanent one! O Ishana! O Hrishikesha! I bow down to you. O one without a beginning! O one without an end! O Amrita! O one who cannot be vanquished! O supreme among those who are victorious! Victory to you. O one who has not been conquered! O Akhandala! ¹²⁷⁸ O Krishna! O Shrinivasa! ¹²⁷⁹ I bow down to you. O one who has yoga in his *atman*! O one whose *atman* cannot be measured! O *atman* of the worlds! O eternal one! O one who is at the summit! O immovable one! O one who cannot be comprehended! O water! ¹²⁸⁰ I bow down to you. O one who should be worshipped! O one who bestows boons! O Ananta! O origin of Brahma! O store of qualities! O lord of creation, union and destruction! O Vasudeva! I bow down to you. O Parjanya! O one who propagates *dharma*! O one who is impossible to cross! O one who is established far away! O destroyer of misery and affliction! O Hari! O one who lies down in the waters! I bow down to you. O lord of creation! O one who is not manifest! O lord of subjects! O one

who is not affected by the nature of the elements! O refuge of the elements! O *atman* of the elements! O origin of the elements! I bow down to you. O sacrifice! O performer of the sacrifice! O one who holds up the sacrifice! O one who ordains the sacrifice! O one who grants freedom from fear! O origin of the sacrifice! O one with the golden limbs! O one born from Prishni's womb! ¹²⁸¹ I bow down to you. O *kshetrajna*! ¹²⁸² O one who holds up the *kshetra*! O one who possesses the *kshetra*! O one who destroys the *kshetra*! O one who makes the *kshetra* act and subjugates it! O *atman* of the *kshetra*! O one who is delinked from the *kshetra*! O creator of the *kshetra*! I bow down to you. O store of *gunas*! O abode of *gunas*! O refuge of *gunas*! O one who makes the *gunas* flow! O enjoyer of *gunas*! O one who takes pleasure in the *gunas*! O one who renounces the *gunas*! I bow down to you. You are Vishnu. You are Hari. You are the one who holds the *chakra*. You are Jishnu. You are Janardana. You are the elements. You are *vashatkara*. You are the future. You are the lord of the present. You are the one who created subjects. You are not manifest. You are the creator. You are the one who nurtures the subjects. You are the one who thinks of creating subjects. You are spoken of as the lord and divinity who is without origin. You are infinite. You know what has been done. You are Prakriti. You are Vrishakapi. ¹²⁸³ You are Rudra. You are impossible to assail. You never fail. You are the lord. You are Vishvakarma. You are Jishnu. You are Shambhu. You are the one who assumes the form of a bull. You are Shankara. You are Ushanas. You are truth. You are the austerities of people. You are the conqueror of the universe. You are blessing. You are the one in whom refuge is sought. You are imperishable. You are Shambhu. You are Svayambhu. You are the oldest. You are the one on whom one depends. You are Aditya. You are Omkara. You are Prana. You are the one who destroys darkness. You are Parjanya. You are the famous one. You are the creator. You are the lord of the gods. You are the Rig hymns. You are the Yajur hymns. You are the Sama hymns. You are the *atman*. You are the revered one. You are Agni. You are Pavana. You are Kubera. You are the oblations. You are the creator. You are the enjoyer. You are the one who offers oblations. You are the oblations. You are the sacrifice. You are the wise one.

You are Hari. You are the best. You are the lord of the worlds. You are Achyuta. You are the one who sees everything. You are the prosperous one. You are the one who crushes everyone. You are the destroyer of enemies. You are the day. You are the night. The learned speak of you as the year. You are time. You are *kala* and *kashtha*. You are *muhurta*, *kshana* and *lava*.¹²⁸⁴ You are a child. You are aged. You are a man. You are a woman. You are a eunuch. You are the origin of the universe. You are the eye. You are Sthanu.¹²⁸⁵ You are the pure one. You are the ears. You are eternal. You are unconquered. You are Upendra. You are the excellent one. You confer bliss on the entire universe. You are Vedanga. You are the one to be studied. You are the Vedas. You are the one to be known. You are Dhatri. You are Vidhatri. You are the controlled one. You are the cause behind the origin of the universe. You are Dhatri. You are Punarvasu. You are the one who knows. You are the one who holds up all atmans. You are beyond the grasp of the senses. You are foremost. You are foremost among groups. You are Suparna. You are without a beginning. You are the aggregate. You are extremely great. You are the one who holds up the *atman*. You are Achyuta. You are *yama*. You are *niyama*. You are the lofty one. You possess four arms. You are food. You are inside the *atman*. You are spoken of as the *paramatman*. You are the *guru*. You are the weighty one. You are the left. You are the right. You are the *pippala* tree. You do not go. You are manifest. You are Prajapati. You possess a golden navel. You are god. You are the moon. You are Prajapati. Your form cannot be indicated. You are Yama. You are the one who destroys the enemies of the gods. You are Samkarshana. You are the divinity. You are the doer. You are eternal. You are Vasudeva. Your *atman* cannot be measured. You are devoid of *gunas*. You are the eldest. You are the greatest. You are the one who endures. You are Madhava. You possess one thousand heads. You are the divinity who is not manifest. You possess a thousand eyes. You possess a thousand feet. You are the divinity who is Virat. You are the lord of the gods. You are the god of the gods. You are the one who stands ten *angulas*¹²⁸⁶ above the others. You are spoken of as the past. You are Purusha. You are Shakra. You are the excellent one. You are what will occur in the future. You are Ishana. You are

rita.¹²⁸⁷ You are *amrita*. This world sprouts from you. You are the greatest. You are the excellent one. You are the most superior Purusha. You are the divinity who is established in ten forms. Four of your parts are manifested in the universe. Nine immortal parts are in heaven. Nine parts are in the firmament and there is also the eternal Purusha. Two parts are on earth and four parts used to be here.¹²⁸⁸ The sacrifices emanated from your essence. You are the cause of rain in the universe. Virat originated from your essence. You are the Purusha who is in the heart of the universe. In your energy, fame and prosperity, you are the one who transcends the elements. It is from your essence that *prishadajya*,¹²⁸⁹ the food of the gods, originated. Your essence is the origin of villages, forests, herbs, domestic animals and wild animals. You are the one who should be meditated on. You are meditation. You are the supreme one who created the herbs. You are the gods of the gods. With seven faces, you are spoken of as time.¹²⁹⁰ You have a blazing image. You are the mobile and immobile objects. You are everything in the universe, that which moves and that which does not move. Everything originates in your essence. Everything is established in you. You are Aniruddha. You are Madhava. You are Pradyumna. You are the one who destroys the enemies of the gods. You are the divinity who is best among all the gods. You are the refuge of all the worlds. O lotus-eyed one! Save me. O Narayana! I bow down to you. O illustrious Vishnu! I bow down to you. O Purushottama! I bow down to you. O lord of all the worlds! I bow down to you. O Kamala's abode!¹²⁹¹ I bow down to you. O abode of *gunas*! I bow down to you. O Vasudeva! I bow down to you. O best among the gods! I bow down to you. O Janardana! I bow down to you. O eternal one! I bow down to you. O one whom yogis cannot comprehend! I bow down to you. O abode of yoga! I bow down to you. O Rama's consort!¹²⁹² O Shri's consort! O lord of the universe! I always bow down to you. O lord of the universe! O origin of the universe! O lord of the learned! I bow down to you. O lord of heaven! I bow down to you. O lord of the earth! I bow down to you. O slayer of Madhu! I bow down to you. O lotus-eyed one! I bow down to you. O slayer of Kaitabha! I bow down to you. O Subrahmanya! I bow down to you. O great fish! I bow down to you. O Achyuta, who held

the *shruti* texts on your back! O one who agitated the waters of the ocean and delighted Padmaja! ¹²⁹³ O horse-headed one! O extremely terrible one! O one who assumed the form of the great being! O slayer of Madhu and Kaitabha! O one with the face of a horse! I bow down to you. O one who assumed the form of a giant tortoise to sustain and enjoy the earth! O one who assumed the form of a giant tortoise to hold up the mountain! I bow down to you. O one who assumed the form of a giant boar to save the earth! I bow down to you. O original boar! O one whose form is the universe! O creator! I bow down to you. O infinite one! O subtle one! O foremost one! O supreme one! I bow down to you. O one whose nature is in the form of a *paramanu*! ¹²⁹⁴ O one who cannot be comprehended by the yogis! I bow down to you. I bow down to the supreme cause behind all causes, to the one who is an abode surrounded by the Indras among the yogis, to the one who is extremely difficult to know. You are the one who lies down in the ocean of milk, with the great serpent as your couch. You are the one with golden earrings, studded with jewels. I bow down to you.'

Vyasa continued, 'Thus praised, Madhava was pleased and replied, "O best among sages! Quickly tell me what you desire from me." Kandu said, "O Jagannatha! This *samsara* is extremely difficult to cross and makes the body hair stand up. It is not permanent and has many kinds of miseries. It resembles a clump of plantain trees. ¹²⁹⁵ It has no refuge. It has no foundation. It is as fickle as a bubble in the water. It is full of many kinds of calamities and is impossible to cross. It is extremely terrible. Confounded by your *maya*, I have been wandering around in it for a very long time. With my mind attached to material objects, I am unable to reach the end. I am afflicted by the fear of *samsara*. O lord of the gods! Therefore, I am now seeking refuge with you. O Krishna! Save me from the ocean that is *samsara*. O lord of the *daityas*, *danavas* and gods! I wish to reach your supreme and eternal destination, from which, it is extremely difficult to return." The illustrious one replied, "O best among sages! You are my devotee. Always worship me. Through my favours, you will certainly obtain the liberation that you wish for. O supreme among *brahmanas*! My devotees, *kshatriyas*, *vaishyas*, women, shudras and *antyajas* obtain

supreme success, not to speak of someone like you. Even if a *shvapaka* devotee has proper faith towards me, he obtains the desired success, not to speak of others.” O *brahmanas*! The divinity, who is affectionate towards his devotees, said this. Vishnu’s movements are impossible to understand and he vanished from the spot. O best among sages! When he had left, Kandu was pleased in his mind. He gave up every kind of desire and regained his composure again. He controlled all his senses and no longer had any sense of ‘mine’. He was free of *ahamkara*. With single-minded attention, he meditated on Purushottama. He was no longer smeared by attachment. He was not attached to the *gunas* and was serene. He was only established in the truth. He obtained supreme emancipation, which is so very difficult for even the gods to obtain. If a person reads or hears the account of the great-souled Kandu, he is freed from all sins and goes to the world of heaven. O best among sages! I have thus spoken about this *karma bhumi*. This is a *kshetra* for emancipation and is identified with supreme divinity, Purushottama. The lord is the one who bestows boons, he is the one who confers emancipation. If a person sees him and devotedly meditates on him in the place known as Shri Purushottama, he does not suffer from old age and all his hardships of *samsara* are destroyed. Such a person enjoys objects of pleasure enjoyed by Indras among men. Subsequently, devoid of blemishes, he enjoys divine happiness in heaven. Later still, devoid of taints, he goes to Hari’s undecaying region.’

Chapter 1(70) (Doubts of the sages)

Lomaharshana said, ‘Hearing Vyasa’s words, the sages, controlled in their senses, were astounded. They were pleased and happy and were repeatedly surprised.’

The sages said, ‘This is wonderful. You have described the qualities of Bharatavarsha and those of Purushottama *kshetra*, known as Shri Purusha. O supreme among eloquent ones! We are amazed and delighted to hear about the greatness of that excellent place, known as Purusha *kshetra*. For a long time, we have harboured a doubt in our hearts. With your exception, there is no one else on earth who can sever that doubt. O great sage! We are asking you everything about the origin of Baladeva, Krishna and Subhadra on earth. O sage! For what purpose were the valiant Krishna and Samkarshana born in Vasudeva’s house? ¹²⁹⁶ Was she also born in the same house? This world of mortals is without any substance. It is generally full of miseries and is exceedingly fickle. It resembles a bubble in the water. It is terrible and makes the Body hair stand up. Residence in the womb is even more terrible. It is slippery with urine and excrement. It is hard, difficult and full of miseries. Why did this appeal to them? For what task were they born on earth? O sage! O supreme among eloquent ones! Tell us about this in detail. Tell us about their wonderful and superhuman conduct. The illustrious divinity is the lord of the gods and is supreme among the gods. Why did the intelligent one become Vaasudeva in Vasudeva’s house? The auspicious one is surrounded by the immortals, ornamented by those who have performed auspicious deeds. Why did he abandon the world of the gods and come here, to the world of the mortals? He is the powerful and undecaying one who leads to the creation of divine and human species. Why did he invoke his divine *atman* in a human body? He is the one who

makes the wheel of humans whirl around, without any ailments. He is the wielder of the *chakra* and the mace. Why did he decide to become a human? He is the one who lords over the entire universe. Yet, he followed the conduct of a *gopa*.¹²⁹⁷ The lord Vishnu is the one who protects everyone. Why did he decide to do this? His *atman* is in the elements. He is the one who creates and nurtures the great elements. He is the origin of prosperity. How was he born in the womb of a woman who wanders around on earth? Entreated by the gods, he conquered the three worlds in three of his strides and swiftly established the three categories and the three excellent paths.¹²⁹⁸ At the time of destruction, he drinks up the entire universe and assumes a form that is only made out of water. Everything in the worlds, visible and invisible, are in his *atman*, in the form of a single ocean of water. He is ancient. His *atman* is ancient. He is the one who assumed the form of a boar. Using the tips of his tusks, the destroyer of enemies raised up the earth. In ancient times, for Puruhuta's¹²⁹⁹ sake, the supreme among gods conquered the undecaying three worlds and gave them and the earth to the gods. In ancient times, having assumed the form of a lion, he tore the immensely valorous *daitya* Hiranyakashipu's body into two parts and killed him.¹³⁰⁰ In ancient times, the lord assumed the form of the subterranean fires known as *samvartaka* and *ourva*. In the nether regions, Hari is in the form of water and drinks up the juices of the ocean. He is the *brahman*, with one thousand feet, one thousand rays and one thousand manifestations. From one yuga to another yuga, he has been invoked as the god with one thousand heads. The grandfather's¹³⁰¹ abode arose from his navel when the entire universe was like a single ocean. The lotus was like molten gold and was in the world of the *nagas*.¹³⁰² He killed the *daityas* in the *tarakamaya* battle.¹³⁰³ He assumed a form that was of all the gods, wielding all the various weapons. With Garuda holding him aloft, he brought down Kalanemi.¹³⁰⁴ He obtained *amrita* from the northern shores of the ocean. When there is great darkness, he lies down in eternal yoga. In ancient times, resorting to divine austerity, he gave birth to the gods through Aditi.¹³⁰⁵ When Shakra was in the womb and was assailed by large numbers of *daityas*, he nurtured him there. Using his powers of yoga,

he created regions and made the *daityas* reside in the water. He created the gods and the lords of the gods and made Puruhuta the lord of the gods. He devised the rites for *garhapatya* and the *anvaharya* ordinances. ¹³⁰⁶ He devised techniques for the *ahavaniya* fire, ¹³⁰⁷ the Vedas, the initiation for the sacrifice, the kindling, the consecration by sprinkling with water, the sacrificial ladle and *avabhritha*. With the lower portion of his hand, he created the *havya* shares of sacrifices. *Havya* is earmarked for the gods and *kavya* for the ancestors. He decreed the rites for determining shares at sacrifices and the rituals to be practised during a sacrifice. He is the one who knows yoga. He is the one who determined sacrificial vessels, *dakshina*, consecration, charu offerings, mortar and pestles, sacrificial altars, kindling, *soma*, strainers for the *soma*, the sacred frame around the fire, the objects required at a sacrifice, spoons and everything else. For the best of sacrifices, he framed the rules for assisting priests, performers of sacrifices and sacrificial animals. Through his own deeds, the supreme lord classified this in ancient times. Depending on the yuga, he assumes a corresponding form and roams around the worlds. He created *kshana*, *nimesha*, *kashtha*, *kala*, past, present, future, *muhurta*, lunar day, month, solar day, year, season and the three different kinds of measurements prevalent in the three worlds. ¹³⁰⁸ He laid down the principles for the development of lifespans and the signs associated with bodily beauty. He is responsible for the three worlds, the three gods, ¹³⁰⁹ the three kinds of knowledge, ¹³¹⁰ the three kinds of fire, ¹³¹¹ the three kinds of time, ¹³¹² the three kinds of deeds, ¹³¹³ the three *varnas* and the three *gunas*. ¹³¹⁴ In ancient times, through his infinite deeds, he created all the worlds. He is the creator who is in all beings. His *atman* pervades all creatures and qualities. Through his *yoga*, he is the one who finds pleasure in the senses of men. He is the lord of what is past and what is in the future. Therefore, he is the lord of destiny. He is the refuge for those who observe *dharma*. He takes away the refuge of those who perform evil deeds. He created the four *varnas* and he is the one who protects these four *varnas*. He is the one who knows about the four kinds of knowledge. ¹³¹⁵ He is the one who resorts to the four *ashramas*. ¹³¹⁶ He is the one who is in the firmament, beyond the directions.

He is the intervening space between the earth, the wind and the fire. He is the light of both the sun and the moon. He is the lord of yoga. He is the one who roams around in the night. He is said to be supreme radiance. He is said to be supreme austerity. He is said to be supreme among the supreme. He is the supreme *paramatman*. He is the god of the Adityas. He is the lord who is the destruction of the *daityas*. He is the destruction that comes at the end of a yuga. He is the destruction that brings an end to the worlds. He is the bridge that acts like a bridge to the worlds. He is the sacrifice and the rituals of the sacrifice. He is what is known by those who know about the Vedas. The lord is the power in the *atman*. Among those who are amiable, he is Soma. Among those who are fiery, he is as radiant as the fire. Among all those who are like Shakra, he is their lord. He is in all ascetics in the form of austerities. He is humility in those who follow good policy. He is energy in those who are energetic. He is the image for those who want to revere the image. He is mobility amidst those who are mobile. The wind was created from space. *Prana* was created from the wind. Fire is *prana* for the gods. Madhusudana is *prana* for the fire. Blood results from juices. ¹³¹⁷ It is said that flesh results from blood. Fat is born from flesh and bones are said to result from fat. Marrow results from bones and semen is born from marrow. Semen penetrates the womb. Thus, juices are the foundation of all action. Therefore, water possesses a primary role in the first creation that results from Soma. Know that what happens in the womb is the second creation. Semen is the essence of Soma. The menstrual blood has fire as its essence. Creation results from these juices and semen, that is, a combination of the moon and fire. Semen results from phlegm and blood results from bile. ¹³¹⁸ The heart is the place for phlegm and the navel is the place for bile. In the middle of the body, the heart is said to be the place for the mind. The fire-god resides between the navel and the throat. Know that the mind is Prajapati. Soma should be thought of as phlegm. Bile is said to be the fire. Therefore, the entire universe is a combination of fire and Soma. The fetus grows and develops, resembling a lump of flesh. The wind enters it and unites with the *paramatman*. Inside the body, it grows and is again divided into five types—*prana*, *apana*, *samana*, *udana* and *vyana*. ¹³¹⁹

Prana circles around and ensures growth of the *paramatman*. *Apana* is towards the bottom of the body and *udana* is towards the top of the body. *Vyana* distributes it and *samana* withdraws it. The creature is pervaded by these and the senses come into being and can be perceived. Earth, wind, space, water and energy as the fifth—using their own respective combinations, these lead to the manifestation of the senses. The body is said to be a manifestation of earth. *Prana* is a manifestation of wind. The gaps inside the body are a manifestation of space. The juices flowing out of the body are a manifestation of water. The light in the eyes is a manifestation of energy. The mind is said to be that which controls everything. This includes carnal pleasures and material objects. Semen originates because of this. This is how Purusha created all the eternal worlds. How did the imperishable Vishnu come to arrive in the human world? O brahmana! We have a doubt about this and we are struck with great wonder. How did the one who is the supreme among destinations come to assume a human form? The gods and the *daityas* have said that Vishnu is a great wonder. O great sage! Tell us about the extraordinary incident of Vishnu's origin. ¹³²⁰ The infinitely energetic Vishnu is famous for his strength and his valour. Vishnu's deeds on earth have made the creatures marvel. How did the divinity, Purushottama, remove the afflictions of the gods? Jagannatha pervades everything. He is the great lord of all the worlds. He is the divinity behind creation, preservation and destruction. He brings pleasure to all the worlds. He is inexhaustible. He is eternal and infinite. He is devoid of increase and decrease. He is not touched. He is devoid of *gunas*. He is subtle. He is without transformation. He is without blemish. He is free of every kind of appellation. He is only established in the truth. The lord is without transformation and is eternal. He is the everlasting *paramatman*. He does not move. He is not sullied. He is the one who pervades. He is always content. He has no need for a support. In *krita* yuga, the state of being Vishnu and the state of being Hari have been heard about. For the gods, he is Vaikuntha. For humans, he is Krishna. The lord's progress and action is always mysterious. Nevertheless, we wish to hear about what he did, what he is doing and what he will do. He is not manifest and only manifests

himself through his signs. Such is the illustrious lord Narayana. The powers of his *atman* are infinite and they do not decay. The eternal Hari became Narayana, Brahma, Shakra, Rudra, Dharma, Shukra and Brihaspati. In ancient times, his *atman* was Pradhana and the lord created Brahma. In those ancient times, in that ancient *kalpa*, Purusha created the Prajapatis. Such is the illustrious Vishnu, the lord of all the lords of the worlds. Why did Hari go to the lineage of the Yadus in the world of the mortals?’

Chapter 1(71) (Incarnation in the Yadu lineage)

Vyasa said, ‘I bow down to lord Vishnu, the Vishnu who is the lord of the gods, the ancient Purusha who is eternal and without decay. I bow down to the one whose *atman* has four *vyuhas*, the one who is with *gunas* and without *gunas*. I bow down to the one who is the best and the greatest, the one who should be worshipped, the one who is infinite. I bow down to the one who constitutes all the different parts of the sacrifice, to the one a person seeks to know through the Vedas. There is nothing superior to him. There is nothing greater than him. He is the unborn one who pervades everything in the universe, mobile and immobile. It is said that he is the creator of this universe, who appears and disappears, is visible and invisible. It is into him that it is withdrawn. I control myself and bow down to Brahma, the original god. I bow down to Vishnu, who always possesses a single form. He is without transformations and triumphs over everyone. He is the pure and eternal *paramatman*. I bow down to Hiranyagarbha,¹³²¹ Hari and Shankara. I bow down to Vasudeva, who has the essence of creation, preservation and destruction within him. Vishnu’s nature has but a single form. He is gross and he is subtle. His forms are manifest and unmanifest. I bow down to him. He is the cause behind emancipation. Vishnu is everywhere in the universe. He is the root cause behind the creation, preservation and destruction of the universe. He is the *paramatman*. I bow down to him. Achyuta Purushottama is the foundation of the universe. He is smaller than the smallest of particles and exists in all beings. I prostrate myself before him. His form is pure *jnana*. He is without blemish and is the supreme objective. Those with confused vision see him established in material objects. Vishnu is the one who devours the universe. He is the lord of creation and preservation. The lord of the universe is without a

beginning. He is without birth, without decay and without destruction. The illustrious grandfather, born from the lotus, was earlier asked by Daksha and excellent sages. I will describe his reply. He is the one who purifies the three worlds by uttering the *Rig*, *Sama* and *Yajur* hymns through his lips. I will bow down to that lord, ¹³²² who emerged from the single ocean. The large number of *asuras* and humans certainly follow his instructions. I will describe completely the views of Brahma, whose birth is not manifest. The illustrious divinity, Narayana, is the one who initiated creation by causing Dharma and the others to manifest themselves. The sages who know about the truth speak of water as Nara. Since that is where he was lying down earlier, he is known as Narayana. The lord pervades everything. This divinity has a *saguna* and a *nirguna* form. He is the *brahman* and is established in four forms. One image cannot be discerned. The learned see it as white, with a blazing garland of flames encircling the image. This is the form supreme yogis are devoted to. This form is both distant and near and should be known as one that is beyond the *gunas*. This is known as Vasudeva and can be seen if one no longer has a sense of ownership. This form does not have appearance, colour or any other kind of expression. It is only based on what is conceived and is always pure and well-established, with but a single form. The second form, known as Shesha, is in the nether regions and holds up the earth on his head. It is said to be *tamas* in nature, since it has assumed the form of an inferior species. The third form undertakes tasks, the protection of the subjects and other such things. This form, which establishes *dharma*, should be known as one that has an excess of *sattva*. The fourth form lies down in the water, on a couch that is a serpent. This form has the *guna* of *rajas* and always creates. Hari's third form is always devoted to protecting the subjects. This form always establishes *dharma* on earth. This form destroys insolent *asuras* who cause obstructions in the path of *dharma*. This form saves gods, *gandharvas* and all those who are devoted to protecting *dharma*. Whenever there is a decline in *dharma* and *adharma* arises, this form creates itself. ¹³²³ In earlier times, this assumed the form of a *varaha*. On a single tusk on its snout, it raised up the earth, as if it was a lotus, from inside the water. He assumed the form of

Nrisimha and killed Hiranyakashipu. He brought down other *danavas*, Viprachitti being the foremost. Assuming the form of a *vamana*, he used his *maya* to restrain Bali. He strode over the three worlds and defeated Diti's sons. The powerful one was born in Bhrigu's lineage as Jamadagni's son. Remembering his father's death, Rama ¹³²⁴ killed *kshatriyas*. He became the powerful Dattatreya, Atri's son, and taught *ashtanga* yoga to the great-souled one who was known as Alarka. The divinity became the powerful Rama, Dasharatha's son. In a battle, he killed Ravana, who causes terror in the three worlds. The lord of the gods, the lord of the universe, slept in that single ocean of water for one thousand yugas. The lord's couch was a serpent. He was asleep in yoga and was established in his own greatness. The three worlds and the universe, with its mobile and immobile objects, was inside his stomach. The *siddhas* and *maharshis* who were in Janaloka praised him. A lotus manifested itself from his navel and its ornamented petals were the directions. It blazed like the sun or the fire and its filaments were like mountains. The filaments on the flower were the grandfather's excellent abode. The four-faced god of the gods, Brahma, originated there. At that time, two *danavas*, Madhu and Kaitabha, manifested themselves from the wax in his ¹³²⁵ ears. They were immensely strong and immensely valiant and tried to kill Brahma. They were impossible to assail. He arose from his sleep in the ocean and killed them. I am not interested in describing these and other innumerable acts. However, the one without birth has now assumed an *avatara* in Mathura. In this way, the form that is full of *sattva* assumes different *avatars*. This is known as Pradyumna and is engaged in protecting tasks. It is established as a god, as a human, or as an inferior species, and depending on Vasudeva's wishes, always assumes that respective nature. When it is worshipped, it bestows the desired boons. O supreme *brahmanas*! I have, thus, described what the lord has already done. Vishnu has now become a man. Listen to what happened next.'

Chapter 1(72) (Hari's incarnations)

Vyasa said, 'O tigers among sages! Listen. I will briefly tell you about the *avatars* Hari assumed, with a desire to remove the burden here. O *brahmanas*! Whenever there is an increase in *adharma* and a decline in *dharma*,¹³²⁶ God Janardana assumes an *avatara* here, by dividing his own body into two parts.¹³²⁷ He does this to protect the virtuous and establish *dharma* and to chastise the wicked and others who hate the gods. To protect the subjects, he is born from one yuga to another yuga. O *brahmanas*! Earlier, the earth suffered from a great burden. The earth went to the assembly of the gods on Meru. The earth prostrated herself before Brahma and all the other gods and in piteous words, told them everything about her miseries. The earth said, 'For those who are of good *varnas*, fire is the preceptor. The sun is the preceptor for cows. Narayana is the preceptor who is worshipped by me and all the worlds. The *daityas*, with Kalanemi at the forefront, have now arrived. They have arrived in the world of the mortals and day and night, are oppressing the subjects. Using Vishnu's powers, Vishnu had killed Kalanemi. However, that great *asura* has now been reborn as Ugrasena's son, Kamsa. There are other fierce *asuras* too—Arishta, Dhenuka, Keshi, Pralamba, Naraka, Sunda and Bana, Bali's son. Other extremely valiant ones have been born in the homes of kings. These evil-souled ones have been born and I am not interested in enumerating all of them. O gods! Those extremely strong Indras among *daityas* are insolent and are using many divine *akshouhinis* and divine forms to attack me. O lords among the immortals! I am suffering and am unable to bear this great burden. I am terrified and I am informing you about this. O immensely fortunate ones! Please act so as to remove me of this burden. I am so agitated that I might end up going to Rasatala.' It is said that all the gods

heard the words spoken by the earth. For the sake of removing the earth's burden, they spoke to Brahma and urged him. Brahma said, 'O residents of heaven! Everything that the earth has said is true. I, Bhava and you—all of us derive our powers from Narayana. Depending on whether one is hindered, or does the hindering, there are superior powers and inferior powers. He is superior to us. Therefore, let us go to the excellent shores of the ocean of milk. There, we will worship Hari and tell him everything. All the gods are in him. The universe is in him. He pervades the universe. He is in all atmans. Using a small portion of his own self, he will descend and act so as to establish *dharma*.' Having said this, along with the gods, the grandfather left for that spot. He controlled his mind and praised the one who has Garuda on his standard.'

Brahma said, 'I bow down to you. I bow down to the one who has one thousand forms, one thousand arms and many faces and feet. I bow down to you. You are engaged in the creation, preservation and destruction of the universe. I bow down to you. You are supreme and beyond measure. You are more subtle than the most subtle. You are larger than the largest in size. You are heavier than the heaviest. You are Pradhana. You are the one with many senses. You are the Pradhana who is in the atmans of all the worlds. O illustrious one! Be pleased. O god! This earth, bound by the mountains, is suffering. The great *asuras* have been born on earth. You are the refuge and for the sake of relieving her burden, she has approached you. You are the one who enables the crossing over to the other shore. O protector of the gods! Instruct us. All of us gods will carry out your task—Vritra's enemy, ¹³²⁸ Nasatya, Dasra, Varuna, the Rudras, the Vasus, the Suryas, the wind-god, the fire-god and all the other foremost ones. Instruct us about your command. Removing our taints, we are always ready to carry out what you want.'

Vyasa continued, 'The illustrious and supreme lord was praised in this way. O supreme among *brahmanas*! He plucked out two strands of his hair, one white, the other black. He told the gods, 'These two strands of my hair will be incarnated on earth, for the purpose of removing the earth's burden. All the gods should also use their own respective portions to be born on

earth. Let them fight with the maddened large *asuras*, who have already been born. In this way, all the *daityas* on earth will be exterminated. There is no doubt that they will be crushed by many kinds of weapons. Devaki, Vasudeva's wife, is like a goddess. O immortals! This strand of my hair will be born as the eighth child in her womb. Having thus descended on earth, it will kill Kamsa, who is Kalanemi who has again been born, there.' Saying this, Hari vanished. Though he had vanished, they prostrated themselves before the great-souled one. The gods went to the slope of Meru and then descended on earth. The illustrious sage, Narada, told Kamsa, 'The eighth child in Devaki's womb will be born on earth and slay you.' Hearing this from Narada, Kamsa became angry. He imprisoned Devaki and Vasudeva in their house. O *brahmanas*! Whenever a son was born, as he had himself promised him earlier, Vasudeva handed him over to Kamsa.' ¹³²⁹

'The six sons in the womb are famous as Hiranyakashipu's sons. ¹³³⁰ Urged by Vishnu, Nidra progressively conveyed them to the womb. The illustrious Hari's *maya* confounds the entire universe in the form of ignorance. This *maya* of Vishnu's is known as Yoganidra or Mahamaya. Vishnu said, "O Nidra! Follow my instructions and go to Patala. These six are there. One by one, convey them to Devaki's womb. They will be killed by Kamsa. My unblemished portion is known as Shesha. A small part of this will become the seventh fetus in her womb. Vasudeva's wife, Rohini, is in Gokula. When it is time for delivery, convey this fetus to her womb. ¹³³¹ People will say that because she is scared of the king of Bhoja, ¹³³² and because she has been imprisoned, Devaki has miscarried her seventh child. Since this fetus has been dragged away, it will be known in the world as Samkarshana. ¹³³³ The valiant one will be like the peak of a white mountain. O auspicious one! After this, I will be born in Devaki's womb. Without any delay, you must go to Yashoda's womb. I will be born on the eighth lunar day in *krishna paksha* in the month of Shravana, during the rainy season. You will be born on the ninth lunar day. O unblemished one! Urged by my powers, Vasudeva will take me to Yashoda's bed and will take you to Devaki's bed. O goddess! Kamsa will seize you and hurl you on a slab made of stone. Flung in this way, you will obtain a place in the firmament.

Out of deference towards me, Shakra will prostrate himself before you one hundred times. Having bowed his head down, he will accept you as his sister. After this, you will kill Shumbha and Nishumbha and thousands of *daityas*. In many places, temples to you will ornament the entire earth. You are Bhuti, Sannati, Kirti, Kanti, Prithivi, Dhriti, Lajja, Pushti, Uma and every other goddess. ¹³³⁴ In the morning and in the evening, people will bend their bodies down and praise you as Arya, Durga, Vedagarbha, Ambika, Bhadra, Bhadrakali, Kshemya and Kshemakari. Through my favours, they will obtain whatever they desire. When you are worshipped with liquor, flesh, gifts, food and objects of pleasure and are pleased, you will satisfy all the desires of men. Through my favours, there is no doubt that they will always be fortunate. O goddess! Without any hesitation, go in the way you have been told.”

Chapter 1(73) (Krishna's birth)

Vyasa said, 'As she had been instructed by the god of the gods earlier, one by one, Jagaddhatri ¹³³⁵ conveyed the six fetuses. When the seventh was conveyed to Rohini's womb, to bring welfare to the three worlds, Hari entered Devaki's womb. As Parameshthi had said earlier, on that same day, Yoganidra appeared in Yashoda's womb. O *brahmanas*! When Vishnu's portion appeared on earth, the seasons became auspicious and the movements of the planets in the sky were propitious. Such was Devaki's great energy that no one was capable of looking at her. On witnessing the resplendence of her body, the minds of men and women were agitated and they couldn't look at her. Night and day, large numbers of gods praised Devaki, with Vishnu inside her. The gods said, 'You are Svaha. You are Svadha. You are Vidya. ¹³³⁶ You are Sudha. ¹³³⁷ You are Resplendence. To protect all the worlds, you have been incarnated on earth. ¹³³⁸ O goddess! Show us your favours. Do what will bring welfare to the entire universe. To ensure what is agreeable, bear the lord who holds up the entire universe.' Thus, praised by the gods, she bore the divinity Pundarikaksha, the one who saves the universe, in her womb. To make the entire universe bloom like a lotus, the great-souled Achyuta manifested himself like the sun and Devaki bore him, like the morning *sandhya*. ¹³³⁹ At midnight, Janardana, who holds everything up, was born. The clouds rumbled gently and the gods showered down flowers. His complexion was like that of a blossoming blue lotus and he had four arms. He was born with the *shrivatsa* mark on his chest. On seeing him, Anakadundubhi praised him. O supreme among *brahmanas*! The immensely wise one praised him with pleasant words. However, scared of Kamsa, he also told him the following. Vasudeva said, 'O divinity! O lord of the gods! O one who holds the conch shell, *chakra* and mace! I

know who you are. O divinity! But please show us your favours and withdraw this divine form. O god! Otherwise, on getting to know that you have descended in my house, Kamsa will torture me today.' Devaki said, 'O one whose form is infinite! O one whose form is the entire universe! O radiant one! O one who holds the worlds in your womb! O god of the gods! Show us your favours. Through your own *maya*, you have revealed this form as a child. O one who is the *atman* of everything! Please withdraw this four-armed form. O slayer of Diti's sons! Let Kamsa not know that you have descended.' The illustrious one replied, 'O goddess! Desiring a son, you had eulogized me earlier. Since I have now been born from your womb, your wish has met with success.' O supreme among sages! Having said this, the illustrious one was silent. That very night, Vasudeva took him and ventured out. The guards were confounded by Yoganidra and fell asleep, as were the guards to the gates of Mathura. Anakadundubhi went out. Throughout the night, the clouds incessantly showered down rain. However, Shesha raised up his hoods and shielded Anakadundubhi. The Yamuna was exceedingly deep and was full of hundreds of eddies. However, when Vasudeva bore Vishnu, the water only reached up to his knees. As he approached the other bank of the Yamuna, he saw Nanda and the other elderly *gopas*, who paid taxes to Kamsa. O sages! At that time, Yashoda was also confounded by Yoganidra and was asleep. While all the people were confounded, she gave birth to a daughter. The infinitely radiant Vasudeva placed his son on Yashoda's bed. Picking up the daughter, he quickly returned. When she woke up, Yashoda saw her newborn son and was filled with great delight. His complexion was as dark as a blue lotus. Vasudeva picked up the daughter and returning to his own house, placed her on Devaki's bed. He then remained wherever he had been before. The guards heard the sounds of an infant wailing and immediately woke up. O *brahmanas*! They went and informed Kamsa that Devaki had delivered. Kamsa rushed there and seized the daughter. In a choking voice, Devaki tried to restrain him and exclaimed, 'Free her. Let her be.' But he flung her against a slab of stone. Hurling in this way, she rose up and remained stationed in the air. She assumed a great and eight-armed form. She laughed

at Kamsa and addressed him in these angry words. Yogamaya said, ‘O Kamsa! What will you achieve by hurling me in this way? The one who will kill you has been born. He is everything for the gods. For you, he has been death earlier. Reflecting on this, quickly do something that is good for your own self.’ Having said this, the goddess, adorned with divine garlands and ornaments and praised by the *siddhas*, left through the sky, while the king of Bhoja looked on.’

Chapter 1(74) (Kamsa's moves)

Vyasa said, 'At this, Kamsa's mind was filled with anxiety. He summoned the bulls among the *asuras*, with Pralamba and Keshi as the foremost. He spoke to all the great *asuras*. Kamsa said, 'O Pralamba! O mighty-armed one! O Keshi! O Dhenuka! O Putana! O Arishta and all the others! Listen to my words. Evil-souled ones are making efforts to kill me. They are tormented by my valour and I do not reckon them as brave. ¹³⁴⁰ O bulls among *daityas*! I am filled with wonder at what the girl said. O brave ones! Because of the efforts the enemies are making, I can only laugh. O Indras among *daityas*! Nevertheless, because those evil-souled ones are making efforts to harm me, I must make efforts that are superior to what those wicked ones do. 'The lord of the past, the present and the future has been born to bring about my death.' The girl who was born from Devaki's womb said this. Therefore, we must make great efforts for all the children on earth. If any child has extraordinary strength, we must make efforts to kill him.' Having instructed the *asuras* in this way, Kamsa entered his house. Without any antagonism towards Vasudeva and Devaki, he spoke to them. Kamsa said, 'My attempt to kill your offspring has been futile. So as to kill me, some other child seems to have been born now. You should not grieve about what is inevitable. Who can kill your sons if they possess lifespans?' O best among *brahmanas*! Reassuring and comforting them in this way, Kamsa released them. Thereafter, he again entered the inner quarters of his house.'

Chapter 1(75) (Putana and the cart)

Vyasa said, ‘Released, Vasudeva used a cart to go to Nanda and saw that Nanda was delighted that a son had been born to him, though he knew that this was his own son. Vasudeva affectionately told him, ‘This is good fortune. It is good fortune that a son has now been born to you in your old age. All of you pay your annual taxes to the king. The purpose for which you came here has been achieved. O great-souled ones! You should not remain here. ¹³⁴¹ O Nanda! You should quickly return to your own Gokula. Rohini has delivered my son. ¹³⁴² You should protect him, just as you protect your own son.’ Thus addressed, with Nandagopa leading the way, the immensely strong *gopas* departed, after having paid their taxes and loading all the vessels on their carts.’

‘Putana used to slay young children. While they resided in Gokula, in the night, she picked up Krishna when he was asleep and offered him her breast. During the night, whenever Putana offered her breast to a child, that son instantly died. With great force, Krishna seized her breasts with his hands and crushed her. Full of rage, he drank and sucked out her life. Released of her breath of life and with the bonds of her sinews severed, Putana uttered a mighty roar. She fell down on the ground and as she lay dying, she was extremely terrible. All the residents of Vraja ¹³⁴³ heard that terrifying roar and woke up. They saw Putana, who had fallen down, with Krishna on her lap. O *brahmanas*! Scared, Yashoda gathered Krishna up. Whirling a cow’s tail above the child, she removed any taints that might have got associated with him. Nandagopa brought some cow-dung and applied it to Krishna’s head, so that he might be protected. For protection, he uttered the following. Nanda said, ‘May Keshava, the origin of all living beings, protect you. The creator of the entire universe was generated from a

lotus in his navel. God Keshava assumed the form of a boar and raised up the entire world on the tip of his tusk. He is the one who held the earth. May he protect you. Keshava assumed the form of Nrisimha and used his nails to rip apart his enemy's chest. May the lord protect you everywhere. May Vishnu protect your genital organs and your stomach. May Janardana protect your calves and feet. In an instant, Vamana assumed an extraordinary form and covered the three worlds in three of his strides. May the one with the flashing weapons always protect you. May Govinda protect your head. May Keshava protect your neck. May the undecaying Narayana, whose marvelous powers can never be obstructed, protect your face, arms, forearms, mind and all your senses. May Govinda protect you in the directions. May Madusudana protect you in the sub-directions. May Hrishikesha protect you in the sky. May Mahidhara ¹³⁴⁴ protect you on the ground.' In this way, Nandagopa performed the rites of benediction for the child. The boy, who was asleep on his bed, was placed underneath a cart. On seeing Putana's gigantic body, the *gopas* were astounded. Though she was dead, they were extremely frightened and filled with great wonder.'

'On one occasion, Madhusudana was lying down under a cart. Weeping and searching for a breast, he kicked his legs upwards. As a consequence of being struck by his legs, the cart was overturned. All the vessels and pots tumbled down and were shattered. O *brahmanas*! There were sounds of lamentation among all the people, the *gopas* and the *gopis*. They arrived there and saw that the child was lying down, on his back. The *gopas* asked, 'Who turned the cart over?' The children present replied, 'This infant brought it down. We saw him weep and fling his feet around. He is the one who overturned the cart. No one else has done this.' At this, the minds of the *gopas* were greatly amazed, yet again. Greatly surprised, Nandagopa clasped the child. Yashoda was filled with wonder and used curds, flowers, fruits and *akshata* ¹³⁴⁵ to worship the overturned cart and the broken vessels.'

Chapter 1(76) (The move to Vrindavana)

Vyasa said, ‘Urged by Vasudeva, Garga went to Gokula, hiding who he was from the *gopas*. He performed samskaras for the two of them. ¹³⁴⁶ The immensely intelligent Garga, supreme among intelligent ones, gave the name of Rama to the elder one and Krishna to the younger one. O *brahmanas*! In a short while, the two of them came to be known as immensely strong. They started to boldly crawl around on their knees. As they roamed around here and there, their limbs became smeared with dry cow dung. But Yashoda or Rohini were not interested in restraining them. They played around in the pens made for cows, or in the pens meant for calves. They eagerly tugged at the tails of calves that had just been born. The children wandered around and did not remain in the same place. They were extremely restless and when they played, Yashoda was incapable of restraining them. Krishna’s deeds could never be restrained. However, she tied a rope around his middle and bound him to a mortar. ¹³⁴⁷ She spoke to him angrily. Yashoda said, ‘O restless one! Try and move now, if you are capable of doing it.’ Having said this, she became engaged in household work. The lotus-eyed one eagerly tugged at the mortar and dragged it between two *arjuna* trees. When he dragged it between the trees, the mortar got stuck sideways. The two *arjuna* trees, with lofty branches, broke. The shattering sound penetrated the ears of the residents of Vraja and made them suffer. They arrived there and saw those two large trees. Their trunks were shattered and with their branches broken, they had fallen down on the ground. They saw the child, who could only crawl a little on his knees, smiling there. He was stuck between them, with the rope tied to his stomach. Since he had been tied with a rope, he was, thereafter, known as Damodara. With Nandagopa at the forefront, all the aged *gopas* consulted

among themselves. They were extremely anxious and scared of these evil portents. ‘We should not remain here. We should leave and find another great forest. Many kinds of evil portents are witnessed here and they indicate destruction. Putana was destroyed. There was a calamity with the cart. The two trees have fallen down, in the absence of a strong wind. Without any delay, we should leave and go to Vrindavana,¹³⁴⁸ before the taints associated with these great and evil portents prevent us from moving at all.’ Having made up their minds to leave, all the residents of Vraja spoke to their own respective families. ‘Make haste. Let us go without any delay.’ They left immediately, with their carts and wealth of cattle. The residents of Vraja departed, along with the leaders of the herds and the cowherds who looked after the calves. O *brahmanas*! Within a short period of time, that part of Vraja was only infested by male and female crows, with various objects scattered and strewn around.’

‘The illustrious Krishna, unrestricted in his deeds, mentally thought about Vrindavana’s welfare. He desired that the cattle should increase. O supreme *brahmanas*! This was the summer season and the place was exceedingly dry. Nevertheless, there were fresh shoots of grass everywhere, as if it was the rainy season. All the residents of Vraja started to live in Vrindavana. They placed their carts and pens in a semicircle around them. Rama and Damodara started to herd the calves. They remained in that pastureland and indulged in their childish pastimes. The feathers of peacocks adorned their heads. They wore garlands of wild flowers. They created musical sounds with flutes made of bamboo and whistles made of leaves. The two boys had sidelocks like a crow’s wings.¹³⁴⁹ The two young boys resembled fires. They laughed, played and roamed around in the large forest. They laughed and played with each other and sometimes, also did this with the others. The sons of the *gopas* were just like them. They herded the calves and wandered around. After some time had passed, they attained seven years of age. In that great place of Vraja, the protectors of everything in the universe became the protectors of calves. The monsoon season arrived and there were extremely dense clouds in the sky. Torrents of rain poured down and all the directions seemed to have been reduced to one. The earth was

covered with fresh and excellent flowers and *shakragopas*.¹³⁵⁰ It was as if it was adorned with emeralds and rubies. In every direction, the waters of the rivers flooded the banks and didn't follow the usual course, like the mind of an undisciplined person who has just obtained some wealth. In the evening, as they wished, those two extremely strong ones would return to Vraja and, like immortals, play with the *gopa* boys, who were just like them.'

Chapter 1(77) (Subjugation of Kaliya)

Vyasa said, ‘On one occasion, Krishna went to Vrindavana without Rama. ¹³⁵¹ He roamed around, surrounded by the *gopas*. With garlands made out of wild flowers, he was resplendent. He went to the Kalindi, ¹³⁵² full of turbulent waves. As the foam struck the banks, she seemed to be smiling in every direction. But within the river, he saw an extremely terrible pool that belonged to Kaliya *naga*. It was extremely horrible and was polluted by fire and poison. As the poisonous fire spread, it scorched the large trees along the banks. The wind hurled the spray up and if a bird happened to touch this, it was burnt. It was extremely fierce in this way. It was like a second mouth of Death. The illustrious Madhusudana saw this and thought. ‘The evil-souled Kaliya resides here and poison is his weapon. Earlier, when the wicked one had been defeated by me, he had vanished into the ocean. He is the one who has polluted the entire Yamuna, as she heads towards the ocean. When they are thirsty, men cannot drink this water. Nor can our wealth of cattle. Therefore, it is my task to chastise the king of the *nagas*. In this place, the residents of Vraja are always terrified. They should be able to move around happily. It is for this reason that I have incarnated myself in the world of men. It is my task to punish evil-souled ones who resort to contrary paths. I will climb onto the branches of that *kadamba* tree, which is not very far away. From there, I will leap into the pool which belongs to the one who destroys life.’ Having thought in this way, he firmly girded his loins. With great force, he leapt into the pool that belonged to the king of the serpents. When he descended there, the waters of that great lake were agitated and had drenched even the large trees that were some distance away. The water was hot and polluted from the serpent’s poisonous flames and thus hurled up, immediately made the trees blaze. Those flames

enveloped the directions. Using his arms, Krishna slapped on the waters of the serpent's lake. Hearing that sound, the king of the *nagas* arrived. Because of his rage, his eyes turned coppery-red. His hoods were full of the blazing poison. He was surrounded by many other serpents that were full of great poison. ¹³⁵³ There were hundreds of wives of the *nagas*, adorned with beautiful necklaces. As those lovely ones moved, their earrings trembled because of the movements. Krishna entered that circle of serpents and they bound him in their coils. Their mouths were foul with poisonous flames and they bit Krishna. The *gopas* saw him fall down there, suffering from the coils of the serpents. Suffering in their grief and shrieking and lamenting, they rushed to Vraja.

The *gopas* said, 'In his delusion, Krishna has got submerged in Kaliya's lake. The king of the serpents will devour him. Without any delay, go there.' Hearing this, it was as if the *gopas* were struck by a bolt of lightning. With the *gopis*, and Yashoda leading the way, they rushed to the lake. 'Alas! What is this? Alas!' The people, and the *gopis*, were distracted. They were just as confused as Yashoda was, and as they hurried, their steps faltered. Eager to see Krishna, Nandagopa and the other *gopas* and Rama, extraordinary in his valour, quickly rushed to the Yamuna. They saw him, under the subjugation of the king of the serpents. Since he was encircled in the serpent's coils, Krishna's efforts were futile. O supreme among sages! Looking at his son's face, Nandagopa was extremely motionless. The immensely fortunate Yashoda was also exactly in that state. Seeing this, the other *gopis* were afflicted by grief and wept. Because of their love for Keshava and because their minds were afflicted by fear, they said, 'Along with Yashoda, all of us will enter this giant lake of the king of the *nagas*. It is not appropriate for us to return to Vraja. What is the day without the sun? What is the night without the moon? What are cows without milk? What is Vraja without Krishna? Without Krishna, we will not go to Gokula.' Hearing the words of the *gopis*, Rohini's immensely strong son looked at the miserable *gopas* with unruffled eyes. He saw that Nanda's glance was fixed on his son and that he was suffering greatly. Without being aware of Krishna's greatness, Yashoda was senseless. Balarama said, 'O lord of the

lords of the gods! Why are you behaving excessively like a human? Do you not know your own self? You are the nave of the universe. You are the refuge of even the gods. You are the creator, preserver and destroyer of the three worlds. The three are in you. ¹³⁵⁴ O Krishna! Both of us have assumed *avatars* here and the *gopas* are our kin. The *gopis* are suffering. Why are you indifferent towards your relatives? You have exhibited human nature. You have exhibited childish fickleness. O Krishna! Now chastise this evil-souled one who uses poison as a weapon.’ When he was reminded in this way, there was a gentle smile on Krishna’s lips. He slapped his arms and freed his body from the serpent’s coils. Using both his hands, he made the serpent’s middle hood bend down. When the head was lowered down, the valiant one climbed up and danced on the hood.

The blows from Krishna’s feet wounded the hood. Whenever he tried to raise his head, it was forced to bend down. As a result of Krishna’s kicks, the serpent was confused and completely lost his senses. As a result of those fierce blows, he vomited a lot of blood. The head and the neck were lowered and blood flowed from the mouth. Seeing this, his wives sought refuge with Madhusudana. The *naga*’s wives said, ‘O lord of the lords of the gods! You have been known. You are the excellent and supreme lord. You are the supreme light. You are unthinkable and Parameshavara is only one of your portions. The gods are incapable of praising you. You are the lord who has not been born from anyone else. How can women describe your own nature? The entire earth, sky, water, fire and wind are part of the cosmic egg and that is only a small portion of you. How can we praise you? O lord of the universe! He is suffering. Please show him your favours. The *naga* will give up his life. Please grant us our husband’s life.’ The *naga*’s body was exhausted and his eyes were miserable. When they said this, he spoke in faltering words. ‘O god of the gods! Show me your favours. O protector! You naturally possess the eight kinds of prosperity ¹³⁵⁵ and are supreme. Since you have no one who can surpass you, how can I possibly praise you? You are supreme. You are greater than the greatest. Your *atman* is supreme. Since you are greater than the greatest, how can I possibly praise you? O lord! You have created me in a certain kind of form.

Everything that I have done is in conformity with my own nature and in accordance with your instruction. O god of the gods! Had I acted contrary to that, it would have been proper for the rod of chastisement to be imposed on me. O master of the universe! Nevertheless, since you have brought the rod of chastisement down on me, this is an excellent boon. In truth, this is not punishment for me, but a boon. O Achyuta! I have been robbed of my valour. I have been deprived of my poison. I have been chastised. Grant me my life. Command me about what I should do.’ The illustrious one replied, ‘O serpent! You should never reside here, in the waters of the Yamuna. With your sons and companions, go to the waters of the ocean. O serpent! When he sees the mark of my feet on your head, Garuda, the enemy of the *nagas*, will not strike you.’ Having said this, the illustrious Hari released the king of the serpents. Bowing down before Krishna, he left for the store of waters. While all the creatures looked on, along with his servants, offspring, relatives and all his wives, he left his own lake. When the serpent had departed, the *gopas* embraced Govinda, as if he had returned from the world of the dead. They sprinkled his head with tears that flowed from their eyes. The minds of others were astounded at Krishna’s unblemished deeds. Happy to see that the waters of the river were now pure, the *gopas* praised him. The *gopis* sang about his conduct and beautiful deeds. Praised by the cowherds, Krishna reached Vraja.

Chapter 1(78) (Death of Dhenuka and Pralamba)

Vyasa said, ‘Together, Bala and Keshava started tending to the cows again. Roaming around in the forest, they reached a beautiful grove of palm trees. In that grove of palm trees, there was a *danava* named Dhenuka, in the form of a donkey. It always fed on the flesh of humans and cattle. That beautiful grove of palm trees was full of fruit. On seeing this, the *gopas* wished to gather some fruit and spoke these words. The *gopas* said, ‘O Rama! O Krishna! This bit of land is always protected by Dhenuka. That is the reason we have always avoided the palm fruit. Behold. The fragrance causes delight. If it so pleases you, we wish to bring down some fruit.’ Hearing the words of the *gopa* boys, Samkarshana and Krishna brought some palm fruit down on the ground. The king of the *asuras* heard the sound of the palm fruit falling down. Diti’s son, the evil-souled donkey, arrived, full of rage. The powerful one forcibly struck him in the chest with its hind legs. But he ¹³⁵⁶ seized it by those legs and whirled it around in the sky. When it had lost its life, he powerfully flung it on the top of a large tree. As it fell on top of the palm tree, the donkey brought down many fruits on the ground, like a strong wind acting against clouds. It had other relatives who were *daityas*, in the form of donkeys. When they arrived, Krishna and Balabhadra playfully flung them on the tops of palm trees. O sages! In a short while, the earth was ornamented with ripe palm fruit. It looked even more resplendent because of the bodies of the *daityas*, in the form of donkeys. O *brahmanas*! Thereafter, cattle no longer faced any obstructions in that grove of palm trees. They happily grazed on the fresh grass in a spot where they had been unable to graze earlier. The *daitya* and

his younger brothers, in the form of donkeys, were brought down and all the *gopa* boys and *gopis* found that the grove of palm trees was beautiful.’

‘Vasudeva’s two sons were filled with joy. Having killed Dhenuka *daitya*, they went to the forest of Bhandira. ¹³⁵⁷ They sought out the trees and played and sang. Those two great-souled ones were radiant, like young bulls with budding horns. They herded the cows. When these ventured too far away, they called them back by their names. They carried ropes for tethering on their shoulders. They were adorned with garlands of wildflowers. They were attired in garments that had the complexion of gold and collyrium. ¹³⁵⁸ They were like the weapon of the great Indra. ¹³⁵⁹ They were like white and dark clouds. ¹³⁶⁰ Like ordinary people, they wandered around and played. The protectors of all the worlds, the protectors of creatures, had come to earth. Therefore, they followed the *dharma* of humans and respected human qualities. They wandered around and played in the forest in accordance with the attributes of that species. Those two extremely strong ones swung from swings, wrestled, exercised and flung huge stones there. There was an *asura* known by the name of Pralamba. While they were amusing themselves, he arrived there, wishing to seize them. He disguised himself in the garb of a *gopa*. Without any hesitation, he entered amidst those humans. Pralamba, supreme among *danavas*, assumed a human form. He thought that he would quickly find a weakness in them. His wish was to kill Krishna and Rohini’s son. There is a children’s game known as *harina kridana*. ¹³⁶¹ In this game, all of them played in pairs, leaping up and jumping down. Govinda played with Shridama and Pralamba with Bala. A cowherd played with another cowherd and jumped over him. Krishna defeated Shridama and Rohini’s son defeated Pralamba. Thus, those on Krishna’s side were victorious and defeated the other side. They carried each other. Those defeated carried the victorious ones, on their shoulders, up to the *bhandira* tree and returned. The *danava* swiftly bore Samkarshana on his shoulders. But having reached, he did not return. It was as if a cloud was carrying the moon away. However, the supreme *danava* found it impossible to bear the load of Rohini’s son. Therefore, he increased in size and assumed a gigantic form, like a cloud during the rainy season.

Samkarshana saw his form, which was like that of a scorched mountain. Unblemished garlands and ornaments hung around his neck and there was a diadem on his head. ¹³⁶² He was fierce and his eyes were like the wheels of a cart. As he moved his feet, the earth trembled. Being borne away in this way, he addressed Krishna in these words. Balarama said, ‘O Krishna! Look at this *daitya*, who assumed the disguise of a cowherd. O Krishna! His fierce form is like a mountain and I am being abducted by him. O slayer of Madhu! What should I do now? Please tell me. This evil-souled one is proceeding at a fast pace.’ With a smile on his lips, Govinda spoke to Rama. He knew about the greatness of Rohini’s son and about the extent of his strength and valour. Krishna replied, ‘Why are you resorting to a human sentiment that has become manifest in you? You are the *atman* of everything. You are more mysterious than everything mysterious. Your *atman* is mysterious. O lord of the entire universe! O elder brother! O cause behind all causes! Remember. When the entire universe is reduced to a single ocean of water, the *atman* alone exists. You and I are that. We are the *atman* of the universe, we are its cause. For the universe, for the welfare of the universe, we are established as separate entities. Remember your immeasurable *atman*. Resort to your *atman* and slay the *danava*. However, do what is good for our relatives using human attributes alone.’ O *brahmanas*! Reminded by the extremely great-souled Krishna in this way, Bala laughed and used his strength to make Pralamba suffer. His eyes red with rage, he struck him on the head with his fist. Because of these blows, his eyes popped out of their sockets. His brains came out and he vomited blood from his mouth. The noble *daitya* died and fell down on the ground. On seeing that Pralamba had been killed by Bala, whose deeds are extraordinary, the *gopas* were delighted. They applauded him in words of praise. When the *daitya* Pralamba was brought down, Rama was praised by the *gopas* and along with Krishna, he returned to Gokula.’

Chapter 1(79) (Worship of Govardhana)

Vyasa said, ‘While Rama and Keshava amused themselves in Vraja, the monsoon season passed. Autumn arrived and lotuses bloomed. This was the time when *nakshatras* sparkled in the clear sky and this season arrived in Vraja. Krishna saw that the residents of Vraja were making preparations for Indra’s festival. He saw that the *gopas* were eager and anxious to do this. Curious, the immensely intelligent one addressed the elders in these words. Krishna said, ‘Who is this Shakra? His name is bringing you this delight.’ When he asked with great affection, Nandagopa replied. Nanda said, ‘Shatakratu, the king of the gods, is the lord of water and the clouds. Urged by him, the clouds shower down juices in the form of rain. We and other embodied beings nourish ourselves on the resultant grain. Since we sustain ourselves on that food, we satisfy the gods. Crops grow through these and nourish and nurture the cows, which yield milk and calves. When clouds shower down rain, the land is not seen to be devoid of crops or men. Nor are there people afflicted by hunger. Parjanya heats the ground through the rays of the sun and sucks up the water. For the creation of all the worlds, it is then showered down on the ground as rain. Therefore, when it is the rainy season, all the kings, we and all embodied beings on earth are delighted and worship the lord of the gods.’ Damodara heard Nandagopa’s words about the reason behind Shakra’s worship.

To enrage Indra of the gods, he spoke these words. Krishna said, ‘We are not farmers. Nor do we earn our living through trading. O father! Since we are those who roam around in the forest, the cows are our deities. There are four kinds of learning—*anvikshiki*, *trayi*, *varta* and *dandaniti*.¹³⁶³ Of these, hear about *varta* from me. O immensely fortunate one! Specifically, for knowledge about *varta*, there are three kinds of means of subsistence—

agriculture, trading and animal husbandry as the third. Tilling the land is the means of subsistence for those who are farmers. Trading is the means of subsistence for those who are merchants. For us, cattle represent the supreme means of subsistence. These are the three methods of earning a living. Whatever be the mode that one is engaged with, that should constitute the greatest divinity. That is what should be venerated and worshipped. This is the means to ensure welfare. O father! If a man obtains fruits from one source but worships another, then in this world and in the next world, he does not obtain what is good for him. We should worship what is known as our boundaries. Beyond the boundaries, there are the forests. Beyond the forests, there are the mountains and those are our supreme objective. Therefore, we should perform a *giriyaajna* and a *goyajna*.

¹³⁶⁴ Since our divinities are cattle and mountains, what do we have to do with the great Indra? *Brahmanas* utter *mantras* and perform sacrifices. Farmers use their ploughs to perform sacrifices. Since we depend on mountains and forests, we should perform sacrifices to mountains and cattle. Let all kinds of offerings be tendered to Mount Govardhana as worship. Let us follow the norms and kill and offer in worship sacrificial animals. Let milk and milk products be taken from the entire settlement of cowherds. There is no need to think about this. Let *brahmanas* and others, who so wish to, be fed. After the worship has been completed and oblations have been offered, let *brahmanas* be fed. Let herds of cattle be taken there, ¹³⁶⁵ with autumn flowers decorating their heads. O *gopas*! This is my view. If this appeals to you, act accordingly. If you act accordingly, the cattle, the mountain and I will be pleased.’ O *brahmanas*! Hearing these words, Nanda and the other residents of Vraja applauded these words. Their faces beamed with joy. ‘O child! What you have said is appropriate. Therefore, let all of us prepare for the *giriyaajna*.’ ¹³⁶⁶ Thus, the residents of Vraja performed a sacrifice to the mountain. They offered curds, *payasam*, flesh and other offerings to the mountain. They fed hundreds and thousands of *brahmanas*. The cows were worshipped and made to perform *pradakshina* around the mountain. The bulls bellowed, like clouds full of rain. O *brahmanas*! Govinda embodied himself on the summit of the mountain and said, ‘I am

the mountain.' He ate all the different kinds of food that the *gopas* offered. Along with the *gopas*, in the form of Krishna, he climbed to the summit of the mountain. Having ascended, he worshipped his own second form. ¹³⁶⁷ When this ceremony of 'I am the mountain' was over, this second form vanished. Having obtained their boons, the *gopas* returned to their own settlement.

Chapter 1(80) (Govinda's coronation)

Vyasa said, 'When his sacrifice was stopped, Shakra became extremely angry. He spoke to the category of clouds that are known by the name of *samvartaka*.¹³⁶⁸ Indra said, 'O clouds! Listen to my words. Without thinking about it, swiftly act in accordance with my commands. Nandagopa is extremely evil-minded and the other *gopas* have helped him. Depending on Krishna's strength, he has broken the agreement about my sacrifice. Act according to my instructions. Shower down rain and make the cows suffer. They are the supreme reason behind the *gopas* being able to manage a means of sustenance. I will myself be astride the elephant that resembles the summit of a mountain. I will help you and the winds will also be with you.' Having instructed them in this way, Indra of the gods released the clouds. O *brahmanas*! To destroy the cows, they showered down an extremely terrible downpour of wind and rain. O *brahmanas*! As a result of the great downpour that encompassed everything, in an instant, the earth, the directions and the sky appeared as one. Trembling because of the wind and the rain, the cows fell down. With their heads and faces pointed in abnormal directions, all of them lost their lives. O supreme *brahmanas*! Other cows stood there, sheltering the calves under their bodies. Because of the shower of rain, other cows were separated from their calves. The faces of the calves were miserable. Because of the wind, their heads quivered. Suffering, they seemed to be uttering the sounds, 'Save us! O Krishna! Save us!' In this way, Gokula, with all the cattle, *gopas* and *gopis*, suffered greatly. Hari looked at them and thought of a means of saving them. 'Since his sacrifice has been stopped, the great Indra has done this. Therefore, I must now save this entire cowherd settlement. I will use my valour to uproot this mountain. Like a large umbrella, I will hold up the flat part of the mountain above the

cowherd settlement.’ Having made up his mind about this, Krishna playfully used one of his hands to uproot Mount Govardhana. Uprooting the mountain and holding it up, Jagannatha told the *gopas*, ‘To counter the rain, collectively enter the space under this. There is no wind here. Find an appropriate spot here and rest. Enter here, there is no reason to be afraid. There is no need to be scared that the mountain will fall down.’ Thus addressed, along with their wealth of cattle, the *gopas* entered, placing their vessels on their carts. So did the *gopis*, who had suffered on account of the rain. Krishna held up the mountain, completely steady. Delighted and amazed, the residents of Vraja looked on. The *gopas* and *gopis* were happy and overjoyed and their eyes dilated in wonder. As Krishna held the mountain up, they praised his conduct. For seven nights, the large clouds showered down on Nanda’s Gokula. Wishing to destroy the *gopas*, Indra had urged the clouds. Thus, the great mountain was held up and Gokula saved. The wealth of cattle was saved. The pledge made by Indra of the gods became unsuccessful. The clouds invited by Shakra were dispelled. Emerging happily, they re-established the settlement in its proper place. While all the residents of Vraja looked on with wonder on their faces, Krishna released Mount Govardhana and placed it back in its own place.’

‘Mount Govardhana was held up and Gokula was saved. After this, the chastiser of Paka wished to see Krishna. Astride his giant elephant, Airavata, the slayer of enemies, the lord of the gods, came to see Krishna on Mount Govardhana. The immensely valiant one had assumed the form of a *gopa* and was herding the cows. The protector of the entire universe was surrounded by *gopa* boys. O *brahmanas*! Though others couldn’t see him, he saw Garuda. ¹³⁶⁹ Using his wings, the leader of birds cast a shade over Hari’s head. Shakra descended from the Indra among elephants and approached Madhusudana. His eyes widened in wonder. He smiled and spoke. Indra said, ‘O Krishna! Listen to the reason why I have come here, to you. O Krishna! O mighty-armed one! You should not think otherwise. You are the supreme lord who holds everything up. You have incarnated yourself on earth so as to remove the earth’s burden. Since my sacrifice was stopped, I desired to destroy Gokula. I instructed the giant clouds to

implement this catastrophe. To save the cattle who were tormented, you uprooted the great mountain. O valiant one! I am satisfied with your extraordinary deed. O Krishna! I now think that the objective of the gods will be accomplished. You managed to hold up that excellent mountain on a single hand. O Krishna! The cows have urged me to approach you. You saved them. You are the cause behind all the causes. O Krishna! Hence, urged by the words of the cows, I will instate you as Upendra. As the Indra of the cows, you will become Govinda.’ ¹³⁷⁰ He brought the bell that was on the elephant Airavata. He filled it with sacred water and performed the consecration. ¹³⁷¹ As soon as Krishna’s consecration was done, milk flowed from the udders of the cows and immediately moistened the earth. Urged by the words of the cows, Indra of the gods consecrated Janardana. Happy, Shachi’s consort again addressed Krishna in affectionate words. Indra said, ‘I have done this because of the words of the cows. But listen to something else. O immensely fortunate one! I am telling you this because I want the earth’s burden to be removed. O one who holds up the earth! My portion, a tiger among men, has been born on earth as Arjuna. You should always protect me. In removing the burden, that valiant one will be your friend. O Madhusudana! Please protect him as you protect your own self.’ The illustrious one replied, ‘I know that your portion, Partha, has been born in the lineage of Bharata. As long as I am on earth, I will protect him. O Shakra! O scorcher of enemies! O Indra of the gods! As long as I am on earth, Arjuna will be victorious in battles. There is a mighty-armed *daitya* named Kamsa. There are others—Arishta, Keshi, Kuvalayapida, Naraka and others. When they have been killed, there will be a great battle. O one with a thousand eyes! Know that the burden of the earth will be removed there. Go. You should not lament on account of your son. No enemy of Arjuna’s will be able to stand in front of me. For Arjuna’s sake, in the course of the Bharata battle, I will protect the others, Yudhishtira being the foremost, and return them unharmed to Kunti.’ Thus addressed, the king of the gods embraced Janardana. He mounted the Airavata elephant and left for heaven. With the cows and the cowherds, Krishna again returned to Vraja, with his path purified by the glances of the *gopis*.’

Chapter 1(81) (Arishta's death)

Vyasa said, 'Shakra left. The cowherds had seen Krishna, the performer of unblemished deeds, hold up Mount Govardhana. Delighted, they spoke. The *gopas* said, 'O immensely fortunate one! You have saved us and the cows from this great fear, through this feat of holding up the mountain, as if in childish sport. The state of being a cowherd is condemned. O son! But your feat is divine. How is this possible? In the water, you subjugated Kaliya. Pralamba was brought down. You held up Govardhana. Our minds are scared. ¹³⁷² This is the truth. We swear on Hari's feet that this is the truth. O infinitely valiant one! When we witness your valour, we do not think that you are human. Whether you are a god, a *danava*, a *yaksha* or a *gandharva*, we think that you are our relative. We bow down to you. O Keshava! We from Vraja, along with our wives and our sons, love you. But these feats are impossible for even the gods to accomplish. Your excessive birth in childhood and your birth amidst us is not natural. O Krishna! O one whose *atman* is immeasurable! As we think, we are filled with doubts.' O supreme *brahmanas*! Out of his affection, when he was addressed by the *gopas* in this way, Krishna was silent for a while. But he pretended to be angry and spoke to them. Shrikrishna replied, 'O *gopas*! If you are not ashamed of your relationship with me and if you think that I should be praised, what is the need to think about this? O kin! If you love me and if you think that I should be praised, then you should behave towards me as you would towards kin. I am not a god, a *gandharva*, a *yaksha* or a *danava*. I have been born as your kin. There is no need to think of me in any other way.' They heard Hari's words and Bala remained silent. The *gopas* realized that those two immensely fortunate ones loved them, though they had pretended to be angry.

‘Krishna saw the sparkling sky and the beams of the autumn moon. ¹³⁷³ The night-lotuses bloomed and made the directions fragrant. The buzzing of bees made the region of the forest pleasant. On seeing this, he made up his mind to find pleasure with the *gopis*. Along with Rama, he sang songs that women loved. He observed the *vrata* known as *kamalapada*. ¹³⁷⁴ Hearing the notes of the lovely song, the *gopis* abandoned their homes and swiftly came to the place where Madhusudana was. A *gopi* followed his footsteps and sang slowly. Another one listened attentively. Yet another remembered him in her mind. A *gopi* exclaimed ‘O Krishna! O Krishna!’ and was embarrassed. Another one was blind with love and went to his side, without any sense of shame. Another one saw her senior standing outside the house. ¹³⁷⁵ She closed her eyes and immersed herself completely in Govinda. With the autumn moon, the night was charming. Surrounded by the *gopis*, Govinda was eager to start the dance of *rasa*. The groups of *gopis* were completely engrossed in what Krishna was doing. When Krishna went to another spot, they roamed around Vrindavana in groups. O *brahmanas*! Anxious to see Krishna, the *gopis* followed Krishna’s footprints in Vrindavana through the night. In this way, there were many kinds of things Krishna did with them. Eager to act like him, the *gopis* roamed around the beautiful forest of Vrindavana. When they were unable to see Krishna, the *gopis* retreated in despair. They went to the banks of the Yamuna and sang about his conduct. Krishna’s deeds were unblemished and he was the protector of the three worlds. They would then see him approach, his lotus face blooming. A *gopi* saw Govinda approach and was extremely happy. Her eyes dilated in joy, she exclaimed, ‘Krishna! Krishna! Krishna!’ Another knit her eyebrows and looked at Hari. With eyes that were like bees, she drank the nectar from his lotus face. Another saw Govinda and closed her eyes. Immersed in yoga, she meditated on him. With some, Madhava had charming conversations. He assured some with sidelong glances and others, by touching them with his hands. Happy in his mind, Hari lovingly amused himself with the *gopis*. Extensive in his conduct, the *rasa* dance was performed in groups. ¹³⁷⁶ As they danced, there were lovely sounds from the movements in the bangles. These were progressively

mixed with poems and songs about the autumn. Krishna sang about the autumn moon, the moon beams and the ponds full of lotuses. However, the *gopis* repeatedly only sang about Krishna's name. A *gopi* became exhausted from dancing round and round and her moving bangles made her hands warm. She placed her hands, which were like creepers, on the shoulders of Madhu's slayer. Another *gopi* was skilled in singing, praising and artifices. She embraced him with her graceful arms and lovingly kissed him. Hari's desired arms touched a *gopi*'s cheeks. Just as rain from a cloud leads to crops growing, the resultant drops of sweat made her body hair stand up. Krishna sang the songs of *rasa* and as the pitch of his voice rose, they exclaimed 'O Krishna! Well done, Krishna!' in a pitch that was double his. When he advanced, they followed him. When he moved in a circle, they proceeded ahead of him. The *gopis* proceeded ahead of Hari and followed him. At that time, Madhusudana amused himself with the *gopis*. Even if he was away for an instance, it seemed like crores of years. The *gopis* could not be restrained by their fathers, husbands or brothers. Full of desire, they amused themselves with Krishna during the nights. Though he was a youth, Madhusudana was wise and showed them respect, amusing himself with them. ¹³⁷⁷ Immeasurable in his *atman*, he spent the nights with them. He pervaded them and their husbands. He was the lord who was in all beings. His own form was in their atmans. He pervaded everything and was established in everything. Space, fire, earth, water and wind are in all beings. Just like that, he was in everything. He pervaded everything and was established in everything.

'There was an occasion in the evening when Janardana was engaged in *rasa*. The insolent Arishta arrived in the settlement, causing terror. His form was that of a bull and he resembled a monsoon cloud full of water. His horns were sharp and his eyes were like the sun. He kicked the ground with his hooves and tore it up. He repeatedly licked his lips with his tongue and bit them. Full of rage, he raised up his tail. The muscles of his shoulder were tough. His hump was large and fierce. His size was unsurpassed. His hind quarters were smeared with urine and excrement. He caused great anxiety among the cows. Loose skin hung down from his neck. As a result

of butting against trees, his face was marked. This was a *daitya* in the form of a bull and he made the cows have miscarriages. He swiftly struck everything that caused him an obstruction. On seeing the one with the terrible eyes, the *gopas* and *gopis* were afflicted by fear. They rushed around here and there, shrieking, ‘O Krishna! O Krishna!’ Keshava roared like a lion and slapped the palms of his hands. Hearing that sound, he rushed in Damodara’s direction. With the tips of his eyes fixed towards Krishna’s side, the tips of his horns were pointed in a forward direction. The evil-souled *daitya*, in the form of a bull, rushed forward. The immensely strong Krishna saw that the *daitya*, in the form of a bull, was advancing. He did not move from his spot, but ignored him. He seemed to smile, in sport. When he approached, without moving, Madhusudana seized him by the tips of his horns, like a crocodile seizes. He then struck him in the sides with his knees. Seized by the horns, all his insolence and strength disappeared. He seized Arishta’s throat and wrung it, as if it was a wet garment. He uprooted one of the horns and struck him with that. Vomiting blood from his mouth, the great *daitya* died. When the *daitya* was killed, the *gopas* praised Janardana, just as in ancient times, the gods had praised the one with one thousand eyes when Vritra was slain.’

Chapter 1(82) (Keshi's death)

Vyasa said, 'Arishta was killed in this way. Dhenuka was brought down. Pralamba was conveyed to his destruction. Mount Govardhana was held up. Kaliya *naga* was subjugated. The two lofty trees were shattered. Putana was killed. The cart was overturned. In due order, Narada told Kamsa everything that had happened. He also described the details about how Devaki and Yashoda's infants had been exchanged. Kamsa heard everything from Narada, who possessed divine vision. The evil-minded one became angry towards Vasudeva. ¹³⁷⁸ Because of his excessive rage, he censured him in an assembly of Yadavas. Having reprimanded the Yadavas, he thought about what should be done next. 'Bala and Krishna are still extremely young. They must be killed by me before they become extremely strong. When they become full-grown, it will be impossible to kill them. Chanura is extremely valiant and Mushtika is extremely strong. Using them, I will have those two indomitable ones killing in a wrestling match. Let a great festival of the bow be organized and let them be brought from Vraja. I will then make efforts so that they are destroyed.' The evil-souled Kamsa reflected in this way and made up his mind to kill Rama and Janardana. He addressed the brave Akrura in these words. Kamsa said, 'O Danapati! ¹³⁷⁹ To cause me pleasure, act in accordance with my words. Ascend a chariot and leave this place. Go to Nanda's Gokula. Born from Vishnu's portions to bring about my destruction, two of Vasudeva's sons are there. The two wicked ones are growing. On the fourteenth lunar day, a great festival of the bow will take place. For the sake of a wrestling match, bring the two of them here. Chanura and Mushtika are my wrestlers and they are skilled in wrestling. Let all the worlds witness a wrestling match between the two sides. Let the elephant Kuvalayapida be urged by its

keeper. ¹³⁸⁰ Let it kill Vasudeva's wicked sons, who are still children. When they have been killed, I will kill Vasudeva and the evil-minded Nandagopa. I will also kill my father, the evil-minded Ugrasena. The wicked *gopas* desire to kill me. After this, I will seize all their wealth of cattle and other riches. O Danapati! With your exception, it is my view that all these Yadavas are wicked. ¹³⁸¹ I will make efforts to progressively kill them. After this, without any Yadavas, the entire kingdom will be bereft of thorns. O brave one! Therefore, out of affection towards me, make efforts to go. Address words to the *gopas* so that they quickly supply me with *ghee* and curds made from the milk of buffaloes.' O *brahmanas*! When he was instructed in this way, Akrura, the great devotee, ¹³⁸² was delighted, because he would quickly be able to see Krishna, the next day. He agreed to what the king had said and swiftly mounted a chariot. Madhupriya emerged from the city of Mathura.' ¹³⁸³

'Keshi was fierce in his valour. Kamsa urged him on as a messenger. Desiring to kill Krishna, he reached Vrindavana. He struck the ground with his hooves and tore it up. He shook his manes and dispelled the clouds. He displayed his valour and travelled along the paths of the sun and the moon. ¹³⁸⁴ In this way, he approached the *gopas*. The *daitya* was in the form of a horse. Terrified and anxious at the sound of his neighing, the cowherds and *gopis* sought refuge with Govinda. 'Save us! Save us!' Govinda heard their words. He addressed them in a deep voice that rumbled like clouds full of rain. Govinda said, 'O cowherds! Enough of this fright. Because of Keshi, why are you afflicted by fear? You have been born as *gopas* and you are losing your valour and energy. This one makes a lot of his neighing, but there is little substance in him. His strength is only on the outside. Like a wicked horse, he should be reined in. O wicked one! Come here. I am Krishna. Just as the wielder of Pinaka knocked out Pusha's teeth, ¹³⁸⁵ I will knock out all the teeth from your mouth.' Having said this, Govinda advanced in front of Keshi. With a gaping mouth, the *daitya* also rushed towards him. Janardana enlarged his arm and thrust it into the mouth of Keshi, the evil horse. When Krishna's arm entered Keshi's mouth, his teeth were knocked out and resembled white clouds that had been scattered away.

O *brahmanas*! Krishna's enlarged arm entered Keshi's body and became the cause of his destruction, like an ailment that has been neglected. ¹³⁸⁶ His lips were torn apart and he vomited a lot of blood mixed with froth. The corners of the mouth were extended and the sinews of the mouth were loosened. He sank down on the ground on his knees and released urine and excrement. His limbs were drenched in sweat. He was exhausted and was incapable of making any more efforts. The *asura* was extremely terrible, but his mouth was stretched open by Krishna's arm. He fell down, like a tree torn into two by a bolt of lightning. Torn into two parts, Keshi's body shone. Each part had two feet, one ear, one eye, one nostril and a bit of the back and the tip of the tail. When Keshi was killed by Krishna, the cowherds were delighted and surrounded him. His body showed no signs of exhaustion. Completely at ease, he stood there, laughing. The *gopas* and *gopis* were astounded that Keshi had been killed. They praised Pundarikaksha in charming words that were full of love. O *brahmanas*! Seated on a cloud, Narada swiftly arrived there. Seeing that Keshi was dead, his mind was filled with great joy. Narada said, 'This is wonderful. O Jagannatha! O Achyuta! Your pastimes are wonderful. You have killed Keshi, who caused suffering to the residents of heaven. You were eager to bring about his death in an encounter between a man and a horse. Having been killed by you, the wicked one has gone to heaven. O Madhusudana! In this incarnation, you have performed good deeds that have amazed me, but this surpasses them. O Krishna! Shakra and the gods were terrified of this horse. Looking up at the clouds, he used to shake his net of manes and neigh. O Janardana! You have now killed the evil-souled Keshi. Therefore, the world will know you as Keshava. ¹³⁸⁷ O slayer of Keshi! May you be fortunate. I will again meet you day after tomorrow, when you have an encounter with Kamsa. O one who holds up the earth! You will bring down Ugrasena's son, Kamsa, and his followers, and remove the burden of the earth. O Janardana! I will witness many battles between you and the kings on earth, which you will bring about. I will leave now. O Govinda! You have accomplished a great task for the gods. I have been honoured by you. May you be fortunate. Let me leave now.' When Narada left, Krishna was not at all surprised. Along with the

gopas, he entered the settlement of cowherds and was the only one whom the eyes of the *gopis* drank in.'

Chapter 1(83) (Akrura's visit)

Vyasa said, 'Akrura was eager to meet Krishna. On a chariot that could travel fast, he emerged and left for Nanda's Gokula. Akrura thought, "There is no one more blessed than me. The one who holds the *chakra* has used one of his portions to incarnate himself and I will see him. Today, my birth will be successful. My night has become an excellent morning. On waking up, I will today see the face of Vishnu, whose eyes are like the petals of lotuses. Even if men remember him in their fancies, all their sins are destroyed. He is the one from whom the lotus evolved. He is the being embodied in sacrifices. He is Purusha Purushottama. It is to him that all sacrifices are offered. He is the one who holds everything up. I will see the lord of the universe. By performing one hundred sacrifices to him, Indra became the king of the immortals. He has neither a beginning, nor an end. I will see that Keshava, Brahma, Indra, Rudra, the Ashvins, the Vasus, the Adityas and the large number of Maruts do not know his true nature. I will see that lord of the universe. He is in the *atman* of everything. He goes everywhere. He is everything. He is established in all beings. He is existence. He is the one who does not decay. He pervades everything. He alone is the lord and the truth. Resorting to yoga, he established himself in the forms of a fish, a tortoise, a boar, a lion and various other forms. He is the one who will have a conversation with me. To perform a task, that lord of the universe has now taken birth in Vraja and is there. To accomplish the task, the one who does not decay has voluntarily assumed a human form. He is stationed as Ananta, holding up the earth on his head. He has descended for the sake of the world and he will speak to me, Akrura. A father, a relative, a well-wisher, a brother, a mother and all other family relationships are because of his *maya*. Enough of these. I bow down to the lord of the universe. I bow down to

him. If he enters and spreads through a person's heart, he can cross over all this ignorance. Everything mortal is a consequence of his yoga and *maya*. I bow down to the one whose *atman* is knowledge. For those who perform sacrifices, he is the being embodied in sacrifices. ¹³⁸⁸ He is the eternal Vasudeva. Those who know *Vedanta* speak of him as Vishnu. I bow down to him. He is the refuge of the universe. He holds it up and it is established in him. He is the existent and the non-existent. He is *sattva*. May I be conveyed to that amiable one. If one remembers him, one becomes a recipient of everything that is beneficial. He is the supreme being. I always seek refuge with Hari.' His mind full of devotion in this way, he thought of Vishnu. Akrura reached Gokula when the sun was still shining.

'He saw Krishna there, engaged in the task of milking the cows. He was amidst the calves and his complexion was like that of a blooming blue lotus. His eyes were like the petals of a blossoming lotus and the *shrivatsa* mark was on his chest. His arms were elongated. His chest was broad and his nose was raised. An enchanting smile played on his lips and decorated his lotus face. With his feet firmly placed on the ground, the nails on his toes were raised and red. He was radiant in his yellow garments, decorated with wild flowers and the feathers of peacocks. His hands were like creepers, with a complexion like that of sapphire. He was adorned with white lotuses. O *brahmanas*! He saw Balabhadra, the descendant of the Yadu lineage, near him. He was as fair as a swan, the moon or the *kunda* flower and was attired in blue garments. He was tall and his arms were long. His face was like a blooming lotus. He seemed to be like another Mount Kailasa, surrounded by nets of clouds. O *brahmanas*! When the immensely intelligent Akrura saw them, his face turned as radiant as a blossoming lotus and he got goosebumps. 'This is the supreme refuge. ¹³⁸⁹ This is the supreme destination. Vasudeva is present here, in two different forms. On having seen the creator of the universe in the form of Krishna, both my eyes have attained success. Through the favours of the illustrious one, will my limbs come in contact with his limbs? Will I be embarked on that path of success? The prosperous Ananta is infinite in his forms. Will he touch me today with his lotus hands? Supreme men obtain success by being

touched with his fingers. All their sins are destroyed. He is the best of well-wishers. He is the best of kin. There is no other divinity. Will he embrace me with his large arms today? If he does this, he will then purify my *atman* and free it from the thriving bondage of *karma*. Having obtained proximity with the beloved one, I will prostrate myself and join my hands in salutation. The one who is praised will address me as “Akrura”. When that happens, our lives become great. In the absence of this, shame on birth. There is no well-wisher whom he loves the most. There is no one whom he loves, no one whom he hates, no one whom he neglects. Nevertheless, he loves those who are his devotees. He is like divine trees which bestow boons on those who seek refuge with them. The Ashvins, the Rudras, Indra and the Vasus bestow boons when they are pleased. ¹³⁹⁰ He used his *chakra* to kill the lords of the *daityas* and removed them from the sight of the *daitya* women. By offering him water, Bali obtained agreeable objects of pleasure under the earth. ¹³⁹¹ Earlier, in this way, Shakra became the lord of the immortals and obtained the status of being lord of the gods for the duration of one *manvantara*. However, it is possible that he may not show me any respect. Kamsa has seized me and I have been tainted because of association with that evil one. Even though I have caused no harm, shame on a person like me, who is shunned by those who are virtuous. All *jnana* is in his *atman*. He is a mass of *sattva*. He is pervasive and is never tainted. He is never manifested. Even if he is not known, he is present in the hearts of all men in this world. He is the lord of the universe. He is the lord of all lords. Therefore, with my limbs lowered down in devotion, I will go to him. Vishnu is without a beginning, without a middle and with an end. He is without birth. He has been incarnated as Purushottama’s portion.’

Chapter 1(84) (Akrura's return)

Vyasa said, 'Thinking in this way, the Yadava approached Govinda. Lowering his head down at Hari's feet, he said, "I am Akrura." His ¹³⁹² hand was marked with the signs of a standard, a *vajra* and a lotus. Using this, he touched him. He lovingly pulled him towards himself and firmly embraced him. Bala and Keshava welcomed him in this way. They happily took him with them and entered their own house. Akrura was welcomed in many kinds of ways. As is appropriate, he was offered food that he ate. After that, he told them everything—how Anakadundubhi was reprimanded by Kamsa, how the evil-souled *danava* treated the goddess Devaki, how the evil-souled Kamsa had behaved towards Ugrasena and the purpose for which Kamsa had sent him. The illustrious slayer of Keshi heard everything in detail. He said, "O Danapati! I know about all the reasons. O immensely fortunate one! I will do whatever is held to be the best. It should not be thought that it will be otherwise. Know that Kamsa has already been killed by me. With you, Rama and I will go to Mathura tomorrow. With many types of gifts, the elders among the *gopas* will also go. O brave one! Let the night pass. You should not worry. Within three nights, I will kill Kamsa and his followers." After instructing the *gopas* about Akrura, ¹³⁹³ Keshava and Balabhadra went to Nandagopa's house and slept there.

'When the sparkling day dawned, along with Akrura, the immensely strong Rama and Krishna got ready to leave for the city of Mathura. Seeing this, the large number of *gopis* shed tears. The bangles slipped from their hands. Extremely miserable, they sighed and spoke to each other. "If Govinda goes to Mathura, how will he return to Gokula? He will use his ears to drink in the sweet conversation of city women. The women of the city will enmesh him in their graceful and amorous words. How will his

mind be attracted towards the *gopas* and *gopis* of the village? Hari is the essence of this cowherd settlement and destiny has taken him away. Evil-souled and wicked fate has struck at the *gopa* women. The women of the city smile and utter words that are deep in sentiments. Their gait is languorous and graceful. They cast enchanting sidelong glances. Hari is from the village and he will be bound up in their amorous bonds. How can he possibly return to our side again? This Keshava will ascend a chariot and go to Mathura. Our hopes have been destroyed by the cruel Akrura. ¹³⁹⁴ Does the cruel one not know that these people are supremely in love with him? Hari has given us endless joy. Why is he taking him elsewhere? Extremely cruel, Govinda is leaving with Rama. He has ascended the chariot. Restrain him quickly. Why are you saying that it is not proper for us to speak in the presence of our elders? When we are being scorched by the fire of separation, what are the elders doing? With Nandagopa as the foremost, the *gopas* have got ready to leave. No one is making any efforts to restrain Govinda. For the women who live in Mathura, night has yielded to an excellent morning today. With eyes that are like bees, they will enjoy Achyuta's lotus face. As Krishna proceeds, those who have an obstructed view of him along the route are blessed. Their minds will be pleased and their body-hair will stand up in delight. For the eyes of the citizens of the city of Mathura, there will be a great festival. Today, they will be able to look at Govinda's face. What dreams have those extremely fortunate ones seen? With dilated eyes and without any obstruction, they will be able to see Adhokshaja. Alas! The creator's heart is merciless. After having shown the *gopis* a great treasure, he has plucked out their eyes today. Since Hari is leaving, his love for us has diminished. That is the reason the bangles have quickly slipped off our hands. Akrura's heart is cruel. He is driving the horses swiftly. Who will not feel compassion for such miserable women? The dust raised by the wheels of Krishna's chariot can be seen, though Hari has gone far away. Now even that dust cannot be seen." Extremely miserable, the large number of *gopis* looked on in this way. Along with Rama, Keshava left the region of Vraja.

‘Travelling on a chariot yoked to swift horses, he reached the banks of the Yamuna. Rama, Akrura and Janardana reached the spot when it was midday. Akrura told Krishna, “Until I complete the required water-rites in the waters of Kalindi, ¹³⁹⁵ remain here.’ They agreed. O *brahmanas*! Offering prayers to the supreme *brahman*, the immensely radiant one entered the waters of the Yamuna. He bathed and performed his ablutions. He saw Balabhadra there, with one thousand hoods raised up. ¹³⁹⁶ He was as unblemished as a *kunda* flower. His eyes were as large as the petals of a full-blown lotus. He was surrounded by a large number of Vasuki’s offspring, giant serpents who survive on air. They praised him. He was adorned in a garland of fragrant wildflowers. He was clad in blue garments and his beautiful form was excellent. He wore excellent earrings. Intoxicated, he was submerged in the water. He saw Krishna seated on his lap, with a complexion that was as dark as the clouds. His large eyes were coppery-red. His limbs were large and he was four-armed. He was ornamented with the *chakra* and other weapons. He was attired in yellow garments and was adorned with colourful garlands. He was as colourful as a cloud tinged with a garland of lightning and Shakra’s bow. ¹³⁹⁷ The *shrivatsa* mark was on his chest and his resplendent armlets and diadem were excellent. He saw the one who is unblemished in deeds, adorned with lotuses. Sanandana ¹³⁹⁸ and other unblemished sages, those who have obtained success in yoga, were there, thinking of him with their eyes fixed on the tips of their noses. ¹³⁹⁹ Recognizing Bala and Krishna, Akrura was astounded. He thought, ‘How did they come here so fast?’ He was about to speak, but Janardana paralyzed his power of speech. He emerged from the water and approached the chariot. There, he saw both of them seated in the chariot. As earlier, Rama and Krishna were there in human form. He went and immersed himself in the water again. He again saw them being praised by *gandharvas*, sages, *siddhas* and giant *uragas*. At this, Danapati understood the true meaning of this. He praised the lord Achyuta, who is full of every kind of knowledge. Akrura said, ‘I bow down to the one who only exists in the form of consciousness. He is the *paramatman*, whose greatness is unthinkable. He pervades everything in a single form and in

many forms. I bow down to you. You exist in the form of sound. You cannot be thought of. You exist in the form of oblations. I bow down to you. I bow down to the one who exists in the form of *vijnana*. O lord! You are superior to Prakriti. You alone exist in five forms—the *atman* of the elements, the *atman* of the senses, the *atman* of Pradhana, the *atman* ¹⁴⁰⁰ and the *paramatman*. Be pleased. You are the *atman* of all kinds of *dharma*. Among everything that perishes, you are imperishable. You are thought of and praised as Maheshvara, Vishnu, Brahma and other entities. Your own nature has many different forms that cannot be described. Your *atman* and your purpose cannot be described. Your designations cannot be described. I bow down before the supreme lord. O protector! Your names, types and other things are only conceptions. They don't exist. You are the supreme *brahman*. You are eternal and without transformation. You are without birth. However, in the absence of some kind of conception, the objective cannot be accomplished. Hence, all the names are yours and you are worshipped under the names of Krishna, Achyuta, Ananta and Vishnu. You are in all atmans. You are without beginning. You are thought of as all the divinities and the entire universe. You are the universe. You are the *atman* of the universe. You are devoid of any transformations and differences. Other than you, there is nothing in anything. You are Brahma, Pashupati, Aryama, Vidhatri, Dhatri, the lord of the gods, the wind-god, the fire-god, lord of the waters, the lord of wealth and the Destroyer. You are one. However, you differentiate your powers in different forms throughout the universe. You create the universe. You use your rays to destroy the universe. The universe is full of your qualities. You are without birth. But you exist in this visible universe. Your form is supreme existence. You are spoken of as the one without decay. Your *atman* is in *jnana*. You are existence and non-existence. I prostrate myself before you. Oum! I bow down to Vasudeva. I bow down to Samkarshana. I bow down to Pradyumna. I bow down to Aniruddha.' Inside the water, the Yadava praised Krishna in this way. In his mind, he thought of incense and flowers and worshipped the lord of everything. Discarding all material objects, he immersed his mind in him. Immersed in the *brahman*, he remained there and meditated for a very long time."

‘O excellent *brahmanas*! Having decided that he had become successful in his objective, he emerged from the waters of the Yamuna and went to the chariot again. He saw Rama and Krishna there, stationed as they had been earlier. Noticing from his eyes that Akrura was amazed, Krishna spoke to him. Shri Krishna said, “O Akrura! In the waters of the Yamuna, have you seen anything wonderful? It can be ascertained from your wide-open eyes that you have been amazed.” Akrura replied, “O Achyuta! Inside the water, I saw an extraordinary form. Now I see that figure in embodied form in front of me. This universe is the great-souled one’s wonderful form. O Krishna! I am associated with you, who is that extraordinary wonder. O Madhusudana! But what of all this? We will go to Mathura and I am scared of Kamsa. Shame on a life where one has to subsist on scraps given by others.” Having said this, he urged the horses, which were as fleet as the wind. In the evening, Akrura reached the city of Mathura. Along with Krishna and Rama, the Yadava looked at the city of Mathura. Akrura said, “O immensely valiant ones! I alone will enter on the chariot. The two of you proceed on foot. The two of you should not go to Vasudeva’s house. Because of you, that aged person has been expelled by Kamsa.” Having said this, Akrura entered the city of Mathura.

‘Rama and Krishna entered and reached the royal road. The men and the women looked at them with delighted eyes. Like two young elephants that were playing, those two brave ones proceeded. As they wandered around, they saw a man who dyed clothes and washed them. They asked him for beautiful and excellent garments. He was Kamsa’s washerman and it wasn’t surprising that because of his favours, he was rude. He laughed at Rama and Keshava and used many words to abuse them. At this, Krishna became angry. He used a blow of his palm to strike the washerman, whose head fell down on the ground. Having killed him, they took yellow and blue garments from him. Full of joy, Krishna and Rama went to the house of a garland-maker. The garland-maker was amazed and his eyes widened in surprise. He thought, “Which noble lineage have these two been born in?” He saw them attired in those excellent yellow and blue garments and thought that they were two gods who had come to earth. With faces that

were like blossoming lotuses, they asked him for flowers. With his hands stretched out, he lowered his head down on the ground. The one who earned his living from making garlands said, “O protectors! O ones with pleasant faces! Be pleased. It is my good fortune that you have come to my house. I will worship you.” With a cheerful face, he gave them the flowers they asked for. He tempted them by offering them more beautiful flowers. The garland-maker bowed down to them repeatedly. He gave them beautiful and fragrant flowers that did not decay. Pleased, Krishna bestowed a boon on the garland-maker. “O fortunate one! Shri, who seeks refuge with me, will never desert you. O amiable one! Your strength will never diminish. Nor will your wealth ever diminish. As long as the sun and the earth exist, your sons and grandsons will enjoy extensive objects of pleasure. At the time of death, through my favours, you will remember me and obtain the celestial world. O fortunate one! Your mind will always turn towards *dharma*. The children born from your sons will have long lifespans. Your descendants will not suffer from calamities or taints. O immensely fortunate one! Your descendants will last as long as the sun exists.” O best among sages! Having said this, worshipped by the garland-maker and with Baladeva as his aide, Krishna emerged from his house.’

Chapter 1(85) (Death of Kamsa)

Vyasa said, ‘Along that royal road, Krishna saw a Kubja ¹⁴⁰¹ advancing, with a vessel full of unguents in her hand. She was in the bloom of youth. Playfully, Krishna asked her, ‘Who are these unguents for? Where are you taking them? O one with eyes like a blue lotus! Tell me truthfully.’ When she was addressed affectionately, she was attracted towards the graceful Hari. She looked at him and Bala and spoke. Kubja said, ‘O beloved! How can you not know? I have been engaged by Kamsa. I am engaged in the task of preparing unguents and am known as Naikavakra. ¹⁴⁰² Unguents prepared by others do not please Kamsa. Because of his favours, I have also obtained a great deal of wealth.’ Shri Krishna said, ‘O one with a beautiful face! Kings deserved these excellent fragrances. Please give us unguents that are appropriate for the likes of us.’ Hearing this, she lovingly told Krishna, ‘Let it be taken.’ She gave both of them appropriate unguents for their limbs. Those two bulls among men smeared their limbs with those unguents and were as resplendent as a white and a dark cloud, decorated with Indra’s bow. Shouri was conversant with techniques of conversation. While talking, he placed two of his fingers under her chin and raised it up. Keshava pressed down on her feet and straightened her body. When she became upright, she turned into a beautiful woman. She became full of love and desire. With enchanting and graceful words, she caught hold of Govinda’s garments and said, ‘Come to my house.’ Keshava told her, ‘I will indeed come to your house.’ Then he let her go. He looked at Rama’s face and laughed.

‘Their limbs were smeared with unguents and they were clad in blue and yellow garments. Adorned with colourful garlands, they went to the place where the bow was kept. They asked the guards about where the jewel

among bows was kept. When they were told, Krishna grasped the bow and powerfully strung it. When it was bent for stringing, that large bow snapped. There was an extremely large sound that filled all of Mathura. When the bow was broken, the guards censured them. However, they quickly killed the guards and soldiers and left the place where the bow had been kept.

‘Kamsa heard that Akrura had returned and he was also told about how the bow had been shattered. He spoke to Chanura and Mushtika. Kamsa said, “Those two cowherd boys have arrived. They will rob me of my life. In my presence, you should kill them in a wrestling match. O immensely strong ones! If you destroy them in a wrestling match, you will satisfy me. I will give you everything that you ask for. It cannot but be otherwise. They wish to harm me and they must be killed, through fair means or foul. When they have been killed, you will become tributary kings in this kingdom.” ¹⁴⁰³ Having instructed the wrestlers, he summoned the elephant-keeper and addressed him in a loud voice. “Let Kuvalayapida, the crazy elephant, be placed at the gate. When those two cowherd boys arrive at the arena for the wrestling match, they must be killed.” Having instructed him in this way, he checked to see that all arrangements had been made for the viewing galleries. With his death imminent, Kamsa waited for the sun to rise.

‘All the citizens and other people assembled and sat in the common viewing galleries. Along with their servants, the lords of the earth were seated in the royal galleries. The wrestlers and referees approached the wrestling arena prepared by Kamsa. Kamsa himself was seated in a lofty gallery. Galleries had been constructed for the women from the inner quarters, the courtesans and other women from the city. Nandagopa and the other *gopas* were in other galleries. Akrura and Vasudeva were in galleries that were towards the end. Devaki, who loved her son, was amidst the women. Even if it happened to be the time of death, she wished to see her son. The trumpets were sounded. Chanura boasted, while Mushtika slapped his arms. There were people who lamented. The elephant Kuvalayapida had been engaged to kill them. But Baladeva and Janardana killed him. Wielding the tusks as weapons and with their bodies smeared with musth

and blood, they entered that extremely large arena. While everyone looked on, they were proud and seemed to be playing. They entered, like two lions amidst deer. There were loud tumultuous sounds everywhere in the arena. Surprised, people exclaimed, “This is Krishna. This is Balabhadra. This is the one who killed the terrible Putana, who roamed around in the night. This is the one who overturned the cart and shattered the twin *arjuna* trees. This is the child who climbed atop Kaliya *naga* and danced. This is the one who held up Govardhana, the giant mountain, for seven nights. This is Achyuta, the great-souled one. As if playing, he killed Arishta, Dhenuka and Keshi, all wicked in conduct. This is his elder brother, the mighty-armed Baladeva. He is advancing in sport, delighting the minds of the women. The wise people who know about the truth of the Puranas have spoken about him.” “Gopala will be born in the Yadava lineage and will save everyone. Vishnu is in all beings and his birth has taken place from Vishnu’s portion. He has been incarnated on earth from his portion. He will certainly remove the earth’s burden.” At that moment, this is the way the citizens described Rama and Krishna. Because of her love, milk started to flow from Devaki’s breasts. On seeing his sons, it was as if Vasudeva was witnessing a great festival. Because of his delight, old age deserted his body. The women from the royal inner quarters and the women from the city looked on with wide-open eyes. They could not stop looking at them. The women said, “O friends! Look at Krishna’s face. His eyes are like lotuses. As a result of the exertions of fighting with the elephant, there are some beads of sweat. His face resembles a blooming autumn lotus, with drops of water clinging to it. Your birth has now been enjoyed. Your vision has obtained success. He is the refuge of the universe. The *shrivatsa* mark is on his chest. Look at the child who has vanquished even those who cannot be destroyed. Look at the chest of the one who is capable of crushing an adversary. O beautiful one! Look at his arms. O one who is enchanted! Do you not see the one whose face is like a white lotus? This is Balabhadra. Clad in blue garments, he has arrived here. O friend! Look at him. Mushtika and Chanura may be planning, but Balabhadra will prove to be the enemy’s equal. O friend! Look. Hari is advancing to wrestle with Chanura. Are there

no aged ones here who are driven by reason? Hari's body is delicate and he is only approaching youth. That great *asura* has a developed body that is as tough as a diamond. These two extremely delicate ones are about to approach youth and have arrived in this arena. Diti's son ¹⁴⁰⁴ and Chanura are foremost among wrestlers. They are extremely terrible. In this great wrestling match, the referees have caused a transgression of the rules. Though a child is fighting with a strong person, the referees are ignoring it." While the women of the city were speaking in this way, causing great delight among the people, the illustrious Hari made the ground quake with his footsteps. Balabhadra playfully slapped his arms and it was a great wonder that the earth did not shatter at each of his steps.

'The extremely valiant Krishna fought with Chanura. Mushtika, the accomplished *daitya*, fought with Baladeva. Hari was Chanura's equal and there was a great encounter between them, without using weapons. They shook each other and hurled each other down. They struck each other with their fists, with blows as firm as the *vajra*. They elbowed and kicked each other. It was an extremely terrible encounter. In that assembly, which was like a festival, they displayed their respective strength and energy. The more Chanura fought with Hari, the more he lost his energy and there were no relatives to cheer him on. Krishna, who pervades the universe, fought with him, as if he was toying with him. Kamsa was watching the fight between Chanura and Krishna and saw that his representative was becoming exhausted and losing his strength, while that of Krishna was increasing. He became angry. Filled with rage, he waved his hands and stopped the trumpets from blaring. In that instant, the drums and the playing of musical instruments stopped. However, many trumpets of the gods were sounded from the sky. Remaining invisible, the gods praised him in their joy. "O Govinda! Victory to you. O Keshava! Slay the *danava* Chanura."

Madhusudana toyed with Chanura for a long time. He then made efforts to kill him. He raised him up and whirled him around. Having whirled the *daitya* wrestler around for one hundred times, the slayer of enemies dashed him down on the ground and he lost his life while he was still suspended in the air. Flung down on the ground, Chanura's body shattered into one

hundred pieces. Because of the great flow of blood, the earth was covered in mire. At that time, just as Hari had fought with Chanura, the immensely strong Baladeva fought with Mushtika. He struck him on the head with his fists and struck him on the chest with his knees. He flung him down on the ground and crushed him, making him lose his life. There was an immensely strong king of wrestlers named Toshalaka. Striking him with his left fist, Krishna brought him down on the ground. Chanura was killed. The wrestler Mushtika was brought down. Toshalaka was conveyed to his destruction. At this, all the wrestlers fled. Krishna and Samkarshana jumped around in the arena. They were delighted and dragged *gopas*, who were of the same ages as they were, to the arena.

‘Kamsa’s eyes became red with rage and he spoke to his men. “Use force to evict these *gopas* from the assembly. Quickly seize and bind the wicked Nanda. Vasudeva must be punished like someone who is not aged.”¹⁴⁰⁵ Let him be killed. Do the same with the *gopas* who are boasting with Krishna. Seize their cattle and whatever riches they possess.” As he was commanding this, Madhusudana laughed. He leapt onto the gallery where Kamsa was seated. He powerfully seized him by the hair, so that his crown was dislodged and fell down on the ground. He felled Kamsa down on the ground and pinned him there with his own body. The weight of the entire universe was in Krishna and when that weight descended on him, the king, Ugrasena’s son, lost his life. The immensely strong Madhusudana seized Kamsa’s dead body by the hair and dragged it to the middle of the arena. The body was great in weight and a great weight had fallen on it. In addition, the great-souled one had dragged Kamsa’s body with great force. Therefore, the body was disfigured. As Krishna was dragging Kamsa, his brother, Sunama, arrived there, full of rage. However, playfully, Balabhadra brought him down. At this, there was a tumultuous roar everywhere in that circular arena, on seeing that Krishna had contemptuously killed the lord of Mathura.

‘Krishna, with the immensely strong Baladeva as his aide, quickly touched the feet of Vasudeva and Devaki. Vasudeva and Devaki raised Janardana up. Remembering the words that had been spoken at the time of

his birth, they stood there, bowing down before him. Vasudeva said, “O divinity! O lord of the gods! O supreme among the gods! O lord! Be pleased. O Keshava! You have saved us through your favours. Having been worshipped, the illustrious one has taken an *avatara* in my house, for the sake of slaying those who are wicked in conduct. Our lineage has been sanctified. You are inside all beings. You are stationed within all beings. It is the truth that everything, the past and the future, flow from you. You are worshipped through sacrifices. You cannot be thought of. O Achyuta! You are in all the gods. You are the sacrifice. You are the one who performs the sacrifice. You are the supreme lord of sacrifices. But since you have been born as Devaki’s son, the love causes this mental confusion and mortification. You are the creator of all beings. You are without a beginning and without an end. How can a human tongue like mine address you as a son? O Jagannatha! This entire universe has originated in you. Barring your *maya*, how can someone like you have been born from us? Everything in the universe, mobile and immobile, is established in you. How can someone like that lie down in a human womb or lap? O supreme lord! Be pleased. Save the universe. You have taken an incarnation and are not actually my son. O lord of the universe! O supreme lord! Why are you using your *atman* to confound the minds of everyone, beginning with Brahma and ending with a tree? With my eyes confused by *maya*, I thought of you as a son. O lord of cattle! Extremely scared of Kamsa and my mind overwhelmed by fear of the enemy, I conveyed you to Gokula. Rudra, the Maruts, the Asvins, Shatakratu and the Sadhyas have witnessed your deeds. You are Vishnu. You are the lord. You have come to us for the welfare of the universe. Earlier, we were filled with great confusion.”’

Chapter 1(86) (Return of Sandipani's son)

Vyasa said, 'After witnessing all his deeds, knowledge was generated in Devaki and Vasudeva. Realizing this, to confound all the Yadus, Hari extended his Vaishnavi *maya* again. ¹⁴⁰⁶ He said, "O mother! O father! Samkarshana and I have been eager to see you for a very long time, but we were scared of Kamsa. Among virtuous sons, the part of life that is spent without worshipping the mother and the father is futile. O father! If an embodied person who is born, worships his preceptor, gods, *dvijas*, the mother and the father, his birth is successful. O father! Therefore, pardon all the transgressions we have committed. Because of Kamsa's valour and power, we were under the subjugation of the enemy." Having said this, in due order, he bowed down before the elders among the Yadus. He worshipped them in the appropriate way and satisfied their minds.

'Kamsa was lying down dead on the ground and Kamsa's wives surrounded him. Overwhelmed by grief and misery, his mothers lamented. ¹⁴⁰⁷ Hari was also sad at what he had been forced to do and comforted them in many ways. His own eyes were full of tears and he reassured them. Madhusudana freed Ugrasena from his bondage. With his son dead, he instated him in his own kingdom. ¹⁴⁰⁸ Having been instated in the kingdom by Krishna, the lion among the Yadus performed the funeral rites for his son and all the others who had been killed. When the funeral rites had been performed, Hari approached the throne and said, "O lord! Without any hesitation, instruct us about the tasks we should perform. Because of Yayati's curse, this lineage does not deserve this kingdom. ¹⁴⁰⁹ But you have obtained it. With me as your servant, you can command the gods not to speak of kings." Having told Ugrasena this, the illustrious Keshava, who was acting like a human, ¹⁴¹⁰ addressed Vayu in human words. Shri Krishna

said, “O Vayu! Go to Indra.” Tell him, “O Vasava! Enough of your pride. Give Ugrasena your assembly hall, known as Sudharma. Krishna has said that the king deserves this excellent jewel. The assembly hall known as Sudharma is appropriate for the Yadus.” Thus addressed, Vayu went and told Shachi’s consort everything. Purandara gave Vayu the assembly hall known as Sudharma. Seeking refuge in Govinda’s arms, the bulls among the Yadus enjoyed the divine assembly hall, decorated with excellent jewels, brought by Vayu.

‘Baladeva and Janardana knew every kind of *vijnana*. They knew every kind of *jnana*. Those two valiant ones, excellent ones from the Yadu lineage, knew, but they wished to preserve the progression from preceptor to disciple. Sandipani from Kashi then resided in the city of Avanti. ¹⁴¹¹ To learn about weapons, those two brave ones went to him. They became his disciples and behaved as one should towards a preceptor. Thus, those two brave ones demonstrated proper conduct to all the people. They studied the collected texts of *dhanurveda*, along with all its mysteries. O *brahmanas*! This was extraordinary. But they accomplished this in sixty-four days and nights. This superhuman feat was impossible. Therefore, Sandipani thought that the sun-god and the moon-god had come to him. As soon as it was mentioned, they learned everything about all the weapons. They then asked, “Please tell us. What shall we offer as a guru’s *dakshina*?” The immensely intelligent one witnessed that deed, which was beyond the senses. He asked for his son, who had died in Prabhasa, in the salty ocean. Taking their weapons, the two of them went to the salty ocean and told the ocean, “Give us our guru’s son.” The great ocean joined its hands in salutation and offering *arghya* in a vessel, said, “I have not abducted Sandipani’s son. O slayer of *asuras*! A *daitya* named Panchanjana, in the form of a conch shell, has seized the child. He is in my waters now.” Thus addressed, Krishna entered the waters and killed Panchajana. He gathered the bones and an excellent conch shell was created from this. ¹⁴¹² Its blare reduces the strength of the *daityas*, destroys *adharma* and enhances the energy of the gods. Filling everything with the sound of Panchajanya, Hari went to Yama’s city. With Baladeva’s strength, he defeated Vaivasvata Yama. The

child was undergoing hardships and he asked for him, with a body just like it used to be earlier. ¹⁴¹³ Along with Bala, Krishna, supreme among strong ones, returned the son to his father. They returned again to Mathura, protected by Ugrasena. Rama and Janardana delighted the men and women who were there.'

Chapter 1(87) (Jarasandha's attack)

Vyasa said, 'O *brahmanas*! The immensely strong Kamsa had married two of Jarasandha's daughters—Asti and Prapti. The immensely strong and powerful lord of Magadha, Jarasandha, was filled with rage when their husband was killed. He arrived with a contingent so as to kill Hari and the Yadavas. Arriving in Mathura, the lord of Magadha laid siege. He was surrounded by twenty-three *akshouhinis* of soldiers. Emerging with a small contingent, the powerful Rama and Janardana fought with those powerful soldiers. O excellent sages! Bala and the immensely strong Krishna thought of invoking their ancient weapons. At this, the *chakra*, the Sharnga bow, the two quivers filled with inexhaustible arrows and the Koumadaki mace arrived through the sky before those two valiant ones. Through the sky, the plough arrived in Balabhadra's hands. O *brahmanas*! The club Sunanda, which resembled the fire throughout, also arrived. In the battle, the lord of Magadha and his soldiers were defeated. The brave Rama and Janardana entered the city again. O supreme *brahmanas*! Though the extremely wicked Jarasandha had been defeated, he had not lost his life. Therefore, Krishna thought he had not been truly defeated. O supreme *brahmanas*! With his forces, Jarasandha arrived again and attacked. Rama and Krishna defeated him again. Extremely indomitable, the king of Magadha fought eighteen battles against the Yadus, led by Krishna. In each battle, he was defeated by the Yadus. Though Jarasandha possessed a larger force, a smaller force made him flee. The Yadava force was able to counter many because of the protection and greatness of the *chakra*, wielded by Vishnu's portion. The lord of the universe was playfully observing the *dharma* and conduct of humans. But he released many kinds of weapons against the enemy. He is the one who creates and destroys the universe in his mind. He

did not have to do much to strike against the enemy. However, he was observing the *dharma* of humans. This meant alliances with the stronger and fighting against those who were weaker. This meant exhibiting *sama*, *dana*, *danda* and *bheda*, ¹⁴¹⁴ bringing down the staff on some occasions and fleeing on others. The lord of the universe playfully undertakes what he wishes. Thus, he followed efforts made by those with human bodies.'

Chapter 1(88) (Muchukunda's prayer)

Vyasa said, ‘O *brahmanas*! In an assembly of the Yadus in the settlement of cowherds, Shalya called a brahmana named Gargya a eunuch. At this, all the Yadavas laughed. Therefore, filled with anger, he went to *dakshinapatha*. Desiring a son who would cause fear among the Yadus, he tormented himself in austerity. He worshipped Mahadeva and only ate iron powder. In the twelfth year, Hara was pleased and granted him a boon. The lord of the Yavanas had no son. He had intercourse with his wife and a son who was as resplendent as the fire was born. ¹⁴¹⁵ He was named Kalayavana and his chest was as hard as the tip of the *vajra*. Instating him in his own kingdom, the lord of the Yavanas left for the forest. He was maddened by his valour and pride. He asked Narada about the most powerful kings on earth and Narada told him about the Yadavas. He surrounded himself with one thousand crores of *mlecchas* and with elephants, horses and chariots, made great efforts. O sages! He constantly thought about the Yadavas every day and becoming intolerant towards them, left for the city of Mathura. Krishna thought, “On seeing that the Yadava forces have been reduced by Yavana, Magadha will strike against us. Or, after destroying the diminished forces of Magadha, Kalayavana will become strong and will advance to kill us. The Yadus confront two calamities. Therefore, I will construct an invincible fortress for the Yadus, a place from which even the women will be able to fight, not to speak of the bulls among the Vrishnis. It will be a place where wicked enemies will not be able to advance much against the Yadavas, even if I am intoxicated, distracted, sleeping, or am residing somewhere else.” Having thought this, Govinda sought twelve *yojanas* from the great ocean and constructed the city of Dvaraka there. There were large gardens and large ramparts there. It was adorned with hundreds of

lakes. There were hundreds of walls and fortifications and it resembled Indra's Amaravati. Janardana brought the people who resided in Mathura there. When Kalayavana's arrival was imminent, he himself went to Mathura.

'When the soldiers arrived and set up camp outside Mathura, without any weapons, Govinda went out and Yavana saw him. The king got to know that this was Vasudeva, whom even great yogis cannot obtain in their minds. With his arms as weapons, ¹⁴¹⁶ he followed him. Followed by him, Krishna entered a large cave. The immensely valiant Muchukunda, the lord of men, was sleeping there. Yavana also entered and saw a man lying down on a bed. Thinking that this was Krishna, the evil-minded one kicked him with his foot. O sages! As soon as he glanced at him, the blazing fire resulting from the rage instantly reduced Yavana to ashes. Having taken part in a battle between the gods and the *asuras*, he had defeated giant *asuras* and had not slept for a very long time. Therefore, he had asked the gods for a boon that he might be able to sleep. The gods had said, "When you are asleep, if anyone wakes you up, the fire that is generated from your body will instantly reduce that person to ashes." ¹⁴¹⁷ Having thus burnt the wicked one, he saw Madhusudana and asked, "Who are you?" He replied, "I have been born in the lunar dynasty. I am Vasudeva's son, born in the Yadu lineage." Hearing this, Muchukunda remembered the words of the aged Gargya. Remembering everything, he prostrated himself before Hari, the lord of everything and said, "You have been born as Vishnu's portion. You are the supreme lord. Earlier, Gargya had said that Hari's birth would occur in the Yadu lineage, at the end of dvapara, in the twenty-eighth *mahayuga*. There is no doubt that you are he, and have arrived for the welfare of mortals. I am no longer able to tolerate your extremely great energy." He continued in words that rumbled deeply, like clouds full of rain. "Your feet are extremely delicate. In the great battle between the gods and the *asuras*, the extremely great *daitya* soldiers were unable to withstand your great energy. I can't stand it either. For a being who has descended into *samsara*, you are the supreme refuge. O one who destroys the afflictions of those who seek refuge! Be pleased. Take away everything inauspicious in me. You are

the being who is the oceans, the mountains, the rivers, the forests, the earth, the sky, wind, water and fire. You are the supreme being. You pervade everything. You are the one who devises birth. You are devoid of sound and other objects of the senses. You do not suffer from old age. You have no birth. You are devoid of decay. The immortals, the ancestors, the *yakshas*, the *gandharvas*, the *rakshasas*, the *siddhas* and the *apsaras* originate from you. Humans, large animals, birds, reptiles and small animals originate from you. So do the large trees, the past and the future, everything mobile and immobile, everything embodied and disembodied, gross and subtle. You are the creator of the universe. Without you, there is nothing. O illustrious one! I have been whirled around in this cycle of *samsara*. I have suffered from the three kinds of hardship ¹⁴¹⁸ and they have never ceased. Happiness and unhappiness have been like mirages, mistaken to be water bodies. O protector! O lord! Whatever I have accepted has only been for the sake of torment—the kingdom, the earth, the army, the treasure, allies, sons, wives, servants and sound and other objects of the senses. O one without decay! O lord of the gods! I accepted them, thinking that they would lead to happiness. However, they have eventually caused me torment. O protector! Even the large number of gods, who had gone to the world of the gods, desired to obtain my assistance. What is eternal? Where is *nivritti*? ¹⁴¹⁹ Everything in the universe is the result of your powers. O supreme lord! Without worshipping you, how can there be *nivritti*? Foolish ones who are confounded by your *maya* obtain birth, death, old age and the like. Amidst all these, those wicked ones see the king of the dead. ¹⁴²⁰ In extremely terrible hells, they are bound by hundreds of nooses. Such men obtain misery. This universe is your form. Confounded by your *maya*, I am excessively addicted to material objects. O supreme lord! Therefore, I have been whirled around in this fathomless pit of ‘mine’. Thus, without any shore, I seek refuge with you now. You are the lord and the supreme destination. There is nothing else. My mind is exhausted and tormented from *samsara*. O refuge! I wish to become non-attached.”

Chapter 1(89) (Balarama's return to Gokula)

Vyasa said, 'The intelligent Muchukunda praised him in this way. Hari is the lord of all beings and has no beginning and no end. He spoke. Shri Krishna said, "O lord of men! Go to the divine worlds that you desire. Through my favours, your supreme prosperity will increase and will be unimpeded. You will enjoy divine and great objects of pleasure. After this, you will take birth in a great lineage. However, through my favours, you will remember your past lives and will obtain emancipation." Thus addressed, the king prostrated himself before Achyuta, the lord of the universe. He emerged through the mouth of the cave and saw that men were short. The king realized that *kali* yuga was imminent. To torment himself in austerity, he went to Nara and Narayana's place in Gandhamadana. Having slain the enemy, Krishna seized his forces, resplendent with elephants, horses and chariots, and arrived in Mathura. Having brought them to Dvaravati, he offered them to Ugrasena. The Yadus became strong and no longer worried about being defeated.

'O Indras among *brahmanas*! Now that all conflicts had been pacified, Baladeva was eager to meet his kin and went to Nanda's Gokula. As was the case earlier, the victor over enemies showed a great deal of respect and spoke affectionately to the *gopas* and *gopis*. He embraced some and in turn, was embraced by some. He laughed with some *gopas* and *gopis* who were his equals. The *gopas* addressed the wielder of the plough in many pleasant words. Some *gopis* were delighted and full of affection. But there were others who were full of envy. The *gopis* asked, "Is Krishna, who loves the women of the city, happy? Love must have made him agitated. He laughs at our efforts, but never at those of the women of the city. He makes them possess greater fortune, while affection towards us is of short duration.

Does Krishna remember that we followed him and sang with him? Will he come here at least once, to see his mother? What is the point of conversing in this way? Let us talk about other things. He will exist without us and we will have to exist without him. For his sake, we abandoned our fathers, mothers, brothers, husbands and relatives. But he is ungrateful. Nevertheless, does Krishna ever speak about coming here? Your words are like *amrita*. Damodara Govinda's mind is attached to the women of the city. It is evident that we will find it extremely difficult to see him.' With their minds attached to Hari, in melodious voices, they invited him and repeatedly addressed him as Krishna and Damodara. Krishna had delivered a message in extremely sweet voice and it was full of deep love, devoid of pride. Comforting the *gopis*, Rama delivered this in a sweet and amiable voice. The minds of the *gopas* were also attached to Hari. As used to be the case earlier, Rama laughed with them and conversed with all the residents of Vraja.'"

Chapter 1(90) (Balarama and the plough)

Vyasa said, ‘With the *gopas*, the great-souled one roamed around in the forest. He was Shesha, who holds up the earth. But he was disguised in the form of a human. Having performed extensive deeds, he had assumed an *avatara* for a task. So as to enable him to enjoy himself, Varuna spoke to Varuni. ¹⁴²¹ Varuna said, “This immensely energetic one always desires liquor. O auspicious one! For the sake of his enjoyment and pleasure, go.” Thus addressed, Varuni went near him. She went to the banks ¹⁴²² in the forest of Vrindavana and positioned herself in a hole in a *kadamba* tree. While wandering around, Baladeva inhaled the wonderful smell of liquor and experienced the delight that he had earlier had from liquor. O sages! The wielder of the plough suddenly saw a stream of liquor descending from the *kadamba* tree and was filled with great happiness. He was happy. Along with the *gopas* and *gopis*, who were accomplished in singing and the playing of musical instruments, he drank, while they sang. Because of the excessive heat and exhaustion, there were beads of sweat, resembling sparkling pearls, on him. Agitated, he said, “O Yamuna! Come here. I wish to have a bath.” The river ignored the words of an intoxicated person and showed disrespect. Since she did not come there, the wielder of the plough became angry and seized his plough. Intoxicated because of the liquor, he seized her with the tip of his plough and said, “O evil one! You did not come. Since you did not come, according to your wishes, go elsewhere.” Dragged by him, the river suddenly gave up her course and flooded the forest where Baladeva had dragged her. With scared and agitated eyes, she assumed a body and told Rama, “O one who has a club as his weapon! Please be pleased. Free me.” He said, “If you know about my valour and strength, I will bring down my plough on you and divide you into one

thousand flows.” Thus addressed, the river was scared and placated him. Bala released Yamuna at the spot where the ground had been flooded. In that great forest, he bathed and obtained a handsome form. Lakshmi gave him blue garments that had the complexion of the ocean, a beautiful blue lotus to adorn himself, earrings and a garland made of lotuses that did not decay, given by Varuna. He adorned himself with the blue lotus and the beautiful earrings. Attired in blue garments, the prosperous and auspicious one looked handsome. Thus adorned, Rama enjoyed himself in Vraja. After two months, he returned to the city of Dvaraka. King Raivata had a daughter named Revati. Bala married her and Nishatha and Ulmuka were born through her.’

Chapter 1(91) (Pradyumna's return)

Vyasa said, 'In the kingdom of Vidarbha, Bhishmaka was the king in Kundina. ¹⁴²³ His son was Rukmi and his daughter was Rukmini. Krishna desired Rukmini. The one with the beautiful smiles also desired him. However, because of his hatred, Rukmi did not wish that she should be bestowed on the one who holds the *chakra*. Urged by Jarasandha and Rukmi, Bhishmaka, extensive in his valour, bestowed Rukmini on Shishupala. All the kings, with Jarasandha as the foremost, and Shishupala went to Bhishmaka's city of Kundina. To witness the marriage of the king of Chedi, ¹⁴²⁴ surrounded by the Yadus, Krishna and Balabhadra also went to Kundina. Though Rama and the other relatives opposed it, on the day before the marriage, Hari abducted the maiden. At this, the prosperous Poundraka, Dantavakra, Viduratha, Shishupala, Jarasandha, Shalva and other kings became angry and made great efforts to kill Hari. However, they were defeated by Rama and the assembled bulls among the Yadus. "I will not enter Kundina without killing Keshava in a battle." Having taken this pledge, Rukmi rushed against Krishna, so as to kill him. The one with the *chakra* toyed with him and slew his forces, consisting of elephants, horses, infantry and chariots. He defeated him and flung him down on the ground. Having vanquished Rukmi, following the norms of the *rakshasa* form of marriage, Madhusudana married Rukmini. ¹⁴²⁵ Pradyumna, Madana's portion, was born through her. The valiant one was abducted by Shambara, but he killed Shambara.'

The sages asked, 'How was the valiant one abducted by Shambara and how did he kill him? O immensely intelligent one! Please describe this divine account to us.'

Vyasa replied, ‘O *brahmanas*! ‘This one will kill me.’ Thinking this, on the sixth day after birth, Kalashambara ¹⁴²⁶ abducted Pradyumna from the delivery-chamber. Having abducted him, he flung him into the extremely terrible salty ocean, full of turbulent waves and whirlpools and the abode of crocodiles and *makaras*. As he fell there, a fish swallowed the infant. Despite the blazing digestive fire inside the stomach, he did not die. O *brahmanas*! Along with other fish, this fish was caught by those who captured fish. They killed it and offered it to Shambara, the noble *asura*. His wife, named Mayavati, was the mistress of the entire household. The unblemished one supervised everything that the cooks did. When the stomach of the fish was sliced open, she saw an extremely beautiful child, resembling new sprouts on Manmatha’s tree after it has been burnt. ¹⁴²⁷ The slender-limbed one asked, ‘Who is this? How did he enter here?’ Narada replied, ‘Krishna is the one who causes the creation and destruction of the entire universe and this is his son. Shambara abducted him from the delivery-chamber and flung him into the ocean. Swallowed by a fish, he has now come under your subjugation. O one with the excellent eyebrows! This is a jewel among men. Rear him without any hesitation.’ Addressed in this way by Narada, she reared the child. Right from his childhood, she was confounded by his beauty and felt a great deal of love for him. O excellent *brahmanas*! When he was adorned with the bloom of youth, the one with the gait of an elephant desired him. Mayavati taught the great-souled one all her *maya*. She thought that Pradyumna was just like her, and her heart and eyes were immersed in him. When she wished to unite with him, Krishna’s lotus-eyed son replied to her. Pradyumna said, ‘Casting aside maternal behavior, why are you acting in this perverse way?’ She told him, ‘You are not my son. You are Vishnu’s son and you have been abducted by Kalashambara. He flung you into the ocean. I obtained you from the stomach of a fish. Your mother is crying for you. However, your beloved, who loves you a lot, is here.’ Hearing this, Pradyumna challenged Shambara to a fight. The immensely strong one’s mind was full of rage and he fought. Madhava’s son slew all the *daitya* soldiers. After crossing seven forms of *maya*, he fought using the eighth kind of *maya*. ¹⁴²⁸ Using this *maya*, he

killed the *daitya* Kalashambara. Taking her with him, he went to his father's city. With Mayavati, he descended in the inner quarters. ¹⁴²⁹ On seeing him, Krishna's women were delighted, but did not know what to do. The unblemished Rukmini's eyes were fixed on him with affection and she spoke lovingly. Rukmini said, 'You are in the bloom of youth and a mother with a son like you is blessed. Were my son Pradyumna to be alive, he would have been of the same age. O son! Since your mother has been adorned by you, she is fortunate. Or, because of my affection towards you, perhaps you are another one of Hari's sons. O son! That seems to be apparent from your form, which is like his.' At that time, Narada arrived, along with Krishna.

'Delighted, he ¹⁴³⁰ spoke to the Queen Rukmini, who was roaming around in the inner quarters. Shri Krishna said, "O one with the excellent eyebrows! This is indeed your son. After having been abducted by Shambara, he has returned. When he was still an infant, he was abducted from your delivery-chamber. This virtuous Mayavati is his wife. She is not Shambara's wife. Listen to the reason for this. O Rukimini! When Manmatha was destroyed, she ¹⁴³¹ waited for him to be born again. Using a form made out of *maya*, she confounded Shambara. In the course of marriage and enjoyment with the *daitya*, this auspicious one with the intoxicating eyes only showed him the form made out of *maya*. Kama has again been born as your son and this is his beloved Rati. You should not harbor any doubts. This is your beautiful daughter-in-law." After this, Rukmini and Keshava were filled with joy. The entire city uttered words of praise. On seeing that Rukmini had got back and was united with her son, who had been destroyed a long time ago, all the people in Dvaravati were astounded.'

Chapter 1(92) (Rukmi's death)

Vyasa said, ‘Rukmini gave birth to eight sons—Charudeshna, Sudeshna, the handsome Charudeha, Sushena, Charugupta, Bhadracharu, Charuvinda and Charu, supreme among strong ones. She also had a daughter, Charumati. Other than this, Krishna had seven other beautiful wives—Kalindi; Mitravinda; Satya, the daughter of Nagnajit; ¹⁴³² Queen Jambavati, who was always content; Rohini, the daughter of the king of Madra, who was full of good qualities and was always good in conduct; Satyabhama, the daughter of Satrajit; and Lakshmana, who had a beautiful smile. The wielder of the *chakra* had sixteen thousand other wives. In a *svayamvara*, Rukmi's auspicious daughter chose the immensely valiant Pradyumna, Hari's son, and married him. These two had an extremely strong and valiant son, Aniruddha. This scorcher of enemies was valiant, but was captured in a battle. ¹⁴³³ For him, Keshava accepted Rukmi's grand-daughter. Though Rukmi sought to rival Shouri, he bestowed her on his daughter's son. O *brahmanas*! On the occasion of the marriage, along with Hari, Rama and the other Yadavas went to Rukmi's city, known by the name of Bhojakata. ¹⁴³⁴

‘When the marriage was over, the kings, with the king of Kalinga as the foremost, addressed Rukmi in these words. Kalinga and the others said, “The wielder of the plough is not skilled in playing dice. But he has great addiction towards it. O immensely radiant one! Therefore, we will defeat Bala in a match with the dice.” Rukmi, who was full of strength, agreed to what the kings had said. In an assembly hall, he started a match of dice against Rama. When the stake was one thousand *nishkas*, ¹⁴³⁵ Rukmi defeated Bala. On the second day, Rukmi won another one thousand. Baladeva wished to win. But Rukmi, who possessed excellent knowledge

about playing dice, put up a stake of ten thousand *nishkas*. O *brahmanas*! At this, the foolish lord of Kalinga showed all his teeth and laughed at Bala. Puffed up with pride, Rukmi spoke. Rukmi said, “O those in the assembly! Bala is ignorant and has been defeated by me in playing dice. Whether it is fighting, or the knowledge about playing dice, he is ignorant.” The wielder of the plough saw that the king of Kalinga was exhibiting his teeth. He heard Rukmi’s wicked words and became angry. Full of rage, the wielder of the plough put up a stake of one crore *nishkas*. Accepting the wager, Rukmi rolled the dice. Having won, Baladeva said, “This has been won by me.” However, Rukmi uttered false words and told Bala, “It is mine. It is true that you had mentioned the stake. But I had not accepted it. In that case, if you have won, how is it that I have not won?” An invisible voice that rumbled deeply was heard in the sky and this voice from the sky said, “Baladeva has won and Rukmi has uttered a falsehood. Even though words have not been spoken, there are things that are accepted through deeds.” This increased the great-souled Baladeva’s rage. Bala stood up and his eyes were red with anger. Using the *ashtapada*, ¹⁴³⁶ the immensely strong one killed Rukmi. The king of Kalinga was trembling and Bala forcibly seized him. In rage, he knocked out the teeth that he had exhibited while he was laughing. Bala dragged the great pillar that was made out of molten gold. Using that, the angry Bala killed the kings who were on the other side. O *brahmanas*! Bala was angry with that entire assembly of kings and as all of them started to run away, there were sounds of lamentation. Madhusudana heard that Bala had killed Rukmi. However, because he was scared of Rukmini and Bala, he did not utter a single word. ¹⁴³⁷ O excellent *brahmanas*! Now that the wedding was over, along with Keshava, the Yadus took Aniruddha with them and returned to Dvaraka.’

Chapter 1(93) (Naraka's death)

Vyasa said, 'O sages! Seated on the back of Airavata, Shakra, the lord of the three worlds, came to Dvaravati to meet Shouri. He entered Dvaraka and approached Hari. He told him what the *daitya* Naraka had done. Indra said, "O Madhusudana! O protector! Though you are established in the form of a human, you have pacified all the miseries of the gods. To protect the ascetics, you have killed Arishta, Dhenuka, Pralamba, Keshi and all the others. You have conveyed all the others, Kamsa, Kuvalayapida and Putana, the slayer of children, to their destruction. The three worlds have been saved through your chastisement and intelligence. The residents of heaven have obtained their shares offered at sacrifices and have been satisfied. O Janardana! However, there is a reason why I have come to you now. Hearing this, please do whatever is necessary to act and counteract. The earth has a son named Naraka and he is the lord of Pragjyotishapura.¹⁴³⁸ O slayer of enemies! He causes suffering to all beings. O Janardana! Having slain gods, *siddhas*, *asuras* and kings, that *asura* has imprisoned their daughters in his house. He has seized the umbrella, from which water flows, from Prachetas. He has taken away Maniparvata, the summit of Mandara. My mother¹⁴³⁹ had two divine *amrita* earrings. Amrita flowed from them. Having taken these away from Aditi, the *asura* now desires the elephant Airavata. O Govinda! I have described his wicked conduct to you. You should yourself think about what needs to be done to counter him." Hearing this, Devaki's illustrious son smiled. Arising from his excellent seat, he clasped Vasava by the hand.'

'Having thought about it, he ascended Garuda, who travelled through the sky. Making Satyabhama also mount, he went to Pragjyotishapura. While the residents of Dvaraka watched, happy in his mind, Shakra mounted the

elephant Airavata and went to the abode of the gods. To neutralize enemy soldiers, for one hundred *yojanas* on every side, Pragjyotishapura was surrounded by terrible nooses. Hurling Sudarshana *chakra*, Hari severed those nooses. When Mura arose, Keshava killed him. ¹⁴⁴⁰ The fire that emerged from the sharp edges of Hari's *chakra* burnt down over seven thousand sons of Mura, as if they were moths. O *brahmanas*! Having killed Mura, Hayagriva and Panchajana, the intelligent one hurried and attacked Pragjyotishapura. ¹⁴⁴¹ There was a great battle there, between Naraka and his large army and Krishna. Govinda killed thousands of *daityas*. The powerful Bhouma Naraka unleashed showers of *shastras* and *astras*. The wielder of the *chakra* hurled his *chakra* and sliced the *daitya* into two. When Naraka was killed with the *chakra*, the earth took Aditi's earrings and approached. She addressed Jagannatha in these words. The earth said, "O protector! When you raised me up in your form as a boar, this son was born to me as a result of that touch with you. You are the one who gave him and you are the one who has brought him down. Please accept these earrings and protect his offspring. O lord! O one with the excellent face! O illustrious one! It is for the sake of reducing my burden that you have used your portion to arrive in this world. Please show me your favours. You are the creator, the re-creator, ¹⁴⁴² the destroyer and the undecaying origin. The universe is your form. O Achyuta! How can I praise you? O illustrious one! You are the one who pervades. You are that which is pervaded. You are always the act, the doer and the task that is performed. You are in the atmans of all beings. All beings originate from your *atman*. O Achyuta! How can I praise you? You are *paramatman*. You are the *atman*. You are the *atman* in beings. You are the one without decay. Since there is no way to praise you, why should one even attempt it? O one who is in the atmans of all creatures. Be pleased. Please pardon all the sins committed by Naraka. My son has been brought down." The illustrious one, the origin of all beings, agreed to what the earth had said. O supreme among sages! He took all the jewels from Naraka's residence. O supreme *brahmanas*! In the place where maidens were kept, the infinitely valiant one saw sixteen thousand and one hundred maidens. He also saw six thousand elephants, each with

four sharp tusks and twenty-one million horses from Kamboja. Using Naraka's servants, Govinda immediately sent the maidens, the horses and the elephants to the city of Dvaraka. Hari placed Varuna's umbrella and Maniparvata on top of Garuda, the lord of birds. Along with Satyabhama, Krishna himself ascended and went to the abode of the gods to give Aditi's earrings.'

Chapter 1(94) (Indra's prayer)

Vyasa said, 'Garuda easily carried Varuna's umbrella, Maniparvata and Hrishiksha and his wife. Having reached Svargadvaya, Hari blew on his conch shell. So as to worship Janardana, all the gods arrived with vessels. Having been worshipped by the gods, Krishna entered the residence of the mother of the gods, which was like the summit of a white mountain, and saw Aditi. Along with Shakra, he bowed down before her. Janardana told her about Naraka's destruction and gave her two excellent earrings. Aditi, the mother of the universe was pleased. With a serene mind, she praised Hari, the creator of the universe. Aditi said, "O Pundarikaksha! O one who grants devotees freedom from fear! I bow down before you. You are the eternal *atman*. You are in the atmans of all beings. Your *atman* is in everything. You are the creator of beings. Your essence is in *prana*, the mind, intelligence and the senses. Your *atman* is in the *gunas*. You are beyond the three *gunas*. You are devoid of the opposite pair of sentiments. You are pure and are established in all hearts. You are devoid of conceptions of white, long and every other similar trait. You are not touched by birth and similar things. You are devoid of a state where one dreams. O Achyuta! You are *sandhya*, night, day, earth, sky, wind, water, fire, mind, intelligence and the elements. You are the cause behind creation, preservation and destruction. You are the lord of all doers. Your forms are spoken of as Brahma, Vishnu and Shiva. You are the lord of everything. Your *maya* pervades everything in the universe, mobile and immobile. O Janardana! If one takes what is not the *atman* to be the *atman*, this is because of your *maya*. The sense of 'I' and 'mine' are generated from this. O protector! In the midst of *samsara*, this is what your *maya* does. O protector! Devoted to their own *dharma*, men who worship you transcend all this and free

themselves from *maya*. Brahma and all the other gods, humans and animals are submerged in the great whirlpool of Vishnu's *maya*. They are surrounded by the blinding darkness of confusion. They worship you, hoping for their desires to end. O illustrious one! These men are bound by your *maya*. For the sake of destroying the enemy, I too worshipped you, desiring a son. Since it was driven by *maya*, it was not for the sake of emancipation. This is like asking for a loincloth as covering from a tree that grants all objects of desire. Even for those who have performed good deeds, such transgressions result from their own taints. O one without decay! Be pleased. You are the one who confounds the entire universe with your *maya*. O origin and lord of beings! O origin of *jnana*! Destroy our ignorance. I bow down before the one who has the *chakra* in his hand. I bow down before the one who has the conch shell in his hand. O one with the mace in your hand! O one with the lotus in your hand! O Vishnu! I bow down before you. I have seen your form, adorned with the gross signs. I do not know your supreme truth. O supreme lord! Show me your favours." Thus, praised by Aditi, Vishnu smiled and spoke to the one from whom the gods had resulted. Shri Krishna said, "O goddess! You are our mother. Be pleased. Be the one who bestows boons." Aditi replied, "Let it be as you wish. O tiger among men! In the world of the mortals, all the gods and *asuras* will find it impossible to vanquish you." At that time, along with Shakra's consort, Satyabhama bowed down before Aditi and repeatedly requested her to be pleased. Aditi said, "O one with the excellent eyebrows! Through my favours, you will not suffer from old age or disfigurement. O one with the unblemished limbs! You will enjoy all the objects of pleasure." With Aditi's permission, the king of the gods showed a great deal of respect and worshipped Janardana.

'After this, along with Satyabhama, Krishna saw all the excellent celestial gardens, Nandana and the others. Jagannatha Keshava, the slayer of Keshi, saw the *parijata* tree. It had bunches of excellent and extremely fragrant blossoms. It was divine and cool, causing delight. It was adorned with tender sprouts. When these were crushed, *amrita* resulted, with a complexion like that of molten gold. O excellent *brahmanas*! On seeing

this, Satyabhama spoke to Govinda. Satyabhama said, “O Krishna! Why don’t we take this tree to Dvaraka? You say that you love Satya ¹⁴⁴³ a lot. If those words are true, please take it there, for the pleasure-garden in my house. You have said that you do not desire Jambavati or Rukmini as much as you desire me. O Krishna! If the words spoken by you are true, do what will bring me pleasure. O Govinda! If the words uttered by you were true and not deceitful, let this *parijata* become an ornament in my house. With a bunch of *parijata* flowers in my braid of hair, I wish to become radiant and beautiful amidst my co-wives. Hence, I desire it.” Thus addressed, Hari laughed and placed the *parijata* tree on Garuda. The guards in the grove spoke to him. The guards in the grove said, “O Govinda! Shachi is the queen of the king of the gods. You should not take away the *parijata* tree. When the ocean was churned for *amrita*, it arose and was accepted by the gods, so as to provide ornaments for Shachi. You cannot take it and go and escape unharmed. You want it because of your folly. Who can take it and go and expect to remain unharmed? O Krishna! Indra of the gods will certainly disfigure you. O Achyuta! Enough of this. Shakra will raise the *vajra* in his hand and all the immortals will follow him, leading to a conflict. The learned do not praise a deed that leads to a bitter end.” Addressed in such words, Satyabhama became extremely angry. Satyabhama said, “Who is Shachi? Who is Shakra, lord of the gods? Who does *parijata* belong to? This *parijata* tree is the common property of all the worlds. When it arose out of the water in ancient times, why should Vasava have taken it? O guards of the grove! Liquor, the moon and Shri are the common property of all the worlds. ¹⁴⁴⁴ It is the same with this tree, which arose from the water. If Shachi does not let it go, because she is extremely proud of the strength of her husband’s arms, quickly go and tell Puloma’s daughter my words.” Proud of her own husband, Satyabhama spoke these words. “If you love your husband and if he loves you, prevent my husband from taking this tree away. I know that your husband, Shakra, is the lord of the gods. Yet, as a mere woman, I will take the *parijata* tree away.” Thus addressed, the guards went and told Shachi about what had been said. Shachi goaded her husband, the lord of the gods. O *brahmanas*! For the sake of the *parijata* tree, Indra,

surrounded by all the soldiers of the gods, started to fight with Hari. The gods wielded weapons like clubs, swords, bludgeons and spears. Shakra was there, with the *vajra* in his hand. Govinda saw that Shakra was astride the king of elephants and that all the gods had presented themselves for the battle. He blew on his conch shell and filled the directions with that sound. He shot arrows, numbering thousands and tens of thousands. The sky and the directions were covered by hundreds of arrows. On seeing this, the gods released many kinds of *shastras* and *astras*. Madhusudana, the lord of the universe, toyed with them. With a single weapon, he sliced each of the weapons released by the gods into one thousand fragments. The destroyer of *uragas* ¹⁴⁴⁵ roamed around. He seized the noose of the king of the waters ¹⁴⁴⁶ and tore it to bits, as he does the body of a young serpent. Devaki's illustrious son hurled a mace and fragmented the staff hurled by Yama, making it fall down on the ground. Using his *chakra*, the lord shattered the palanquin of the lord of wealth ¹⁴⁴⁷ into bits as small as sesamum seeds. With Shouri's glance, the sun-god and the moon-god were deprived of their energy. The arrows reduced the fire-god to hundreds of pieces. The Vasus were driven away in different directions. The *chakra* severed the tips of Rudra's trident and made it fall down on the ground. Like bits of cotton from a *shalmali* tree, arrows shot from the Sharnga bow dispatched Sadhyas, Vishvadevas, Maruts and *gandharvas* into the air. The bird Garuda used his mouth, wings and claws to mangle the bodies of the gods and minor gods and eat them. Like two clouds showering down rain, Indra of the gods and Madhusudana showered down thousands of arrows on each other. In that place, a battle raged between Airavata and Garuda. Along with all the gods, Shakra fought with Janardana. When all the *shastras* and *astras* were shattered, Vasava quickly seized his *vajra*, and Krishna, his Sudarshana *chakra*. On seeing that the king of the gods and Janardana had picked up the *vajra* and *chakra*, great sounds of lamentation arose everywhere in the three worlds, among mobile and immobile objects. When Indra hurled the *vajra*, the illustrious Hari seized it. Without releasing his *chakra*, he said, "Wait! Wait!" The *vajra* belonging to Indra of the gods was lost. His mount was mangled by Garuda. As he proceeded to run away,

Satyabhama addressed him in these words. Satyabhama said, “O lord of the three worlds! It is not proper that Shachi’s husband should run away in this manner. For your enjoyment, Shachi will present you with a garland of *parijata* flowers. What kind of a kingdom of the gods is this? You can no longer see Shachi lovingly approach you with a garland of resplendent *parijata* flowers, as used to be the case earlier. O Shakra! Enough of trying. You should not be ashamed. Let this *parijata* tree be taken away. Let the miseries of the gods go away. When she saw me come to her house, because of her excessive pride and insolence, Shachi did not honour me and show me sufficient respect. Since I am a woman, my mind gets drawn to trifling matters. O Shakra! Proud of my own husband, I picked up a fight with you. Enough of *parijata*. Why should one take away what belongs to another? Because of beauty and fame, which woman does not become proud?” O *brahmanas*! Thus addressed, the king of the gods returned. He said, “O angry friend! Enough on this unfortunate matter. He is the cause behind the creation, preservation and creation of everything, and I am not ashamed at being defeated by him. The universe is his form. He is without a beginning and everything merges into him. He is without a beginning and without a middle. Without him, none of the beings would have originated. He is the cause behind creation, preservation and destruction. O queen! Having been routed by him, how can I be ashamed? The earth and all its groves are his form. The small and the extremely subtle are his form. He is known only by those who know the Vedas, not by anyone else. He is the lord who is without birth. He is the one who has not been created. He is eternal. If he so wishes, the original lord can take the entire universe away. Who is capable of defeating him?”

Chapter 1(95) (Sixteen thousand and one hundred maidens)

Vyasa said, ‘The illustrious Keshava was praised in this way by the king of the gods. He laughed and spoke in words that were full of deep sentiments. The illustrious one said, “You are Indra, the king of the gods. O lord of the universe! We are mortals. You should pardon any transgressions that have been committed by me. Let this *parijata* tree be taken away to its proper spot. O Shakra! I seized it because of Satya’s words. Take back the *vajra*, which you had hurled towards me. O Shakra! This is your weapon, used to shatter enemies.” Shakra replied, “O lord! Why are you confounding me by telling me that you are mortal? We know that you are the infinite and illustrious one, the source of bliss. O Jagannatha! You are who you are. You are established in your own conduct. O slayer of *asuras*! You act so as to remove the stakes of the universe. O Krishna! Let this *parijata* be taken away to the city of Dvaravati. As long as you are in the world of the mortals, it will remain on earth.” Hari agreed to what Indra of the gods had said and returned to earth, praised by *siddhas*, *gandharvas* and *rishis*. Taking the excellent tree with him, Krishna left speedily. O *brahmanas*! Arriving above Dvaraka, ¹⁴⁴⁸ he blew on his conch shell, generating delight among the residents of Dvaraka. Along with Satyabhama, he descended from Garuda and placed the giant *parijata* tree in the pleasure-garden. People who approached it could remember their past lives. For a distance of three *yojanas* around it, the ground was rendered fragrant because of the scent of its flowers. When the Yadavas came to see the tree, they inhaled divine and human fragrances. Krishna accepted Naraka’s possessions that had been brought there—servants, elephants, horses and wealth. When an auspicious occasion presented itself, Janardana

married the women, all the maidens who had been brought from Naraka's residence. O supreme *brahmanas*! Govinda followed his own *dharma* and at the same time, in a separate body, he accepted the hands of each of them, following the norms. There were more than sixteen thousand and one hundred women. The illustrious Madhusudana simultaneously assumed that many forms. However, each maiden thought that Madhusudana was with her alone. "Govinda has accepted only my hand." O *brahmanas*! Hari is the creator of the universe and the universe is his form. He spent the nights in each of their homes.' ¹⁴⁴⁹

Chapter 1(96) (Battle with Bana)

Vyasa said, ‘O *brahmanas*! I have already told you about Hari’s sons born through Rukmini, Pradyumna and the others. Satyabhama gave birth to Bhanu and other sons. Through Rohini, Hari’s sons were Prapaksha and other radiant ones. Samba and others, strong in arms, were born through Jambavati. Nagnajiti had Bhadravinda and other extremely strong sons. Among Shaibya’s sons, Sangramjit was the foremost. ¹⁴⁵⁰ Vrika and others were the sons of Madri. ¹⁴⁵¹ Among Lakshmana’s sons, the chief was Gatravan. Shruta and others were the sons of Kalindi. The wielder of the *chakra* had other sons through other wives. He had eighty-one thousand and one hundred sons. ¹⁴⁵² Among all these, Pradyumna, Rukmini’s son, was the eldest. Aniruddha was Pradyumna’s son and Aniruddha’s son was Vajra. O supreme among *brahmanas*! The immensely strong Aniruddha was captured in an encounter and married Usha, Bana’s daughter and Bali’s grand-daughter. Because of this, there was a terrible battle between Hari and Shankara. The wielder of the *chakra* cut off Bana’s one thousand arms.’

The sages asked, ‘For the sake of Usha, how did a battle occur between Hara and Krishna? How did Hari destroy Bana’s arms? O immensely fortunate one! You should tell us everything about this. We are extremely curious to hear about this auspicious account.’

Vyasa said, ‘O *brahmanas*! Usha, Bana’s daughter, saw Parvati sport with Shambhu and felt an urge that she should also do something like that. Gouri, who knows about the minds of everyone, spoke to the beautiful one. “Enough of this repentance. You will also amuse yourself with your husband.” Thus addressed, she thought, “Who will be my husband and when?” ¹⁴⁵³ Parvati spoke to her again. Parvati said, “O princess! On the twelfth day of *shukla paksha* in the month of Vaishakha, the person who

overpowers you in your dreams will become your husband.” As the goddess had spoken, on that particular day, a man overpowered her in her sleep and she fell in love with him. However, when she awoke and was eager, she could not see him. O *brahmanas*! Without any sense of shame, in front of her friend, she exclaimed, “Where has he gone?” Bana had a minister named Kumbhanda and his daughter, Chitrlekha, was her friend. She asked, “Who are you speaking about?” At first, since she was ashamed, she did not tell her friend. However, having gained her trust, she ¹⁴⁵⁴ heard everything that she said. When she had got to know everything, she again told her everything the goddess had spoken and said, “Quickly devise a means so that the task can be accomplished.” Chitrlekha drew pictures of the foremost gods, *daityas*, *gandharvas* and humans and showed them to her. She looked away from *gandharvas*, *uragas*, gods and *asuras* and fixed her glances on humans, especially Andhakas and Vrishnis. Seeing Krishna and Rama, the one with the excellent eyebrows became bashful. O *brahmanas*! When her glance fell on Pradyumna, she turned away in shame. However, as soon as her glance fell on her beloved, Pradyumna’s son, she exclaimed, “This is he. This is he.” Her friend comforted Usha. Using her powers of yoga, she travelled to Dvaravati.’

Chapter 1(97) (Usha and Aniruddha)

Vyasa said, ‘Bana prostrated himself before the three-eyed one and said, “O god! Without any battles, I am disgusted with my one thousand arms. Will there be any battle where my arms can taste success? Without a battle, what purpose do my heavy arms serve?” Shankara replied, “O Bana! Your standard will break, something that has never happened before. When that occurs, you will face a battle that will delight those who eat flesh.” Happy, he bowed down to Shambhu and returned to his house. He saw that his standard had broken down and was filled with great delight. Meanwhile, using her knowledge and strength of yoga, Chitrlekha, the excellent friend, brought Aniruddha there, where the maidens resided in the middle of the inner quarters. There, he pleased himself with Usha. The guards got to know and went and told the king of the *daityas*. The great-souled one commanded his servants and soldiers. However, using an iron beam, the slayer of enemy heroes killed them. When they were slain, Bana himself arrived there on his chariot, ready to kill him. But though he fought to the best of his capacity, he was defeated by the valiant one. Thereafter, he continued to fight using *maya*. Using *mantras*, he invoked *pannagastra* ¹⁴⁵⁵ and bound the descendant of the Yadu lineage. There was speculation among the Yadus in Dvaravati. “Where has Aniruddha gone?” Narada told them that Bana had captured him. The Yadavas had already heard that a woman accomplished in knowledge had taken him away to Shonitapura. Therefore, they believed this. As soon as Hari remembered Garuda, he arrived. With Bala and Pradyumna, he mounted and went to Bana’s city. At the entry to the city, there was a fight with the extremely strong *pramathas*. Destroying them, Hari was conveyed near Bana’s city. For the sake of protecting Bana, Maheshvara *jvara*, ¹⁴⁵⁶ possessing three feet and three

heads, fought with the wielder of the Sharnga bow. As soon as those ashes touched Krishna's limbs, he experienced a great scorching. Baladeva also experienced this and closed his eyes. Thus, he fought with the divinity who wields the Sharnga bow. Vaishnava *jvara* ¹⁴⁵⁷ swiftly expelled him from Krishna's body. He was struck by blows from Narayana's arms. He was agitated and suffered. Seeing this, the god, the grandfather, exclaimed, "Let him be pardoned." Saying this, the illustrious Madhusudana dissolved Vaishnava *jvara* within his own body. "Men who remember the fight between you ¹⁴⁵⁸ and me will be freed from fever." Saying this, Hari went away. After this, the illustrious one defeated the five fires and conveyed them to their destruction. ¹⁴⁵⁹ As if he was playing, Vishnu crushed the army of the *danavas*. After this, the entire *daitya* army, Shankara and Kartikeya united with Bali's son to fight against Shouri. There was an extremely terrible clash between Hari and Shankara. All the worlds were agitated and suffered from the many kinds of *shastras* and *astras*. As the great encounter raged there, the gods thought, "It is certain that the destruction of the entire universe has arrived." Using *jrimbhanastra*, ¹⁴⁶⁰ Govinda made Shankara yawn. After this, in every direction, the *daityas* and the *pramathas* were destroyed. Overwhelmed by the yawning, Hara sat down on his chariot. He was incapable of fighting with Krishna, whose deeds are unblemished. Guha's ¹⁴⁶¹ mount was mangled by Garuda, he himself suffered because of Pradyumna's weapon. Krishna's *humkara* destroyed Guha's javelin and bow. Shankara was destroyed because of the yawning. The wielder of the Sharnga bow vanquished the *daitya* soldiers and Guha.

'After this, Bana arrived there, so as to fight with the forces of Krishna's son. ¹⁴⁶² He was astride a giant chariot, with the horses controlled by Nandisha. ¹⁴⁶³ The immensely valiant Balabhadra fought with many of Bana's soldiers. Without deviating from *dharma*, Pradyumna pierced them with arrows. Bana saw that his forces were being dragged by the tip of the plough, powerfully uprooted by the club and devastated by the arrows of the wielder of the *chakra*. Thereafter, there was a clash between Krishna and Bana. They shot blazing arrows at each other, piercing the bodies and the armour. Krishna used his arrows to slice down the arrows shot by Bana.

Bana pierced Keshava. The wielder of the *chakra* pierced Bana. O *brahmanas*! Wishing to defeat each other, Bana and Krishna struck each other and wounded each other with weapons and clubs. All the extensive *shastras* and *astras* were severed and destroyed. After this, Hari made up his mind to kill Bana with the *chakra*. It was full of energy and was as resplendent as one hundred suns. Hari, who used his *chakra* to slay *daityas*, picked up his Sudarshana *chakra*. So as to destroy Bana, Madhu's enemy was about to release the *chakra*. However, Kotari, the knowledge of the *daityas*, appeared in front of Hari. ¹⁴⁶⁴ She was naked. When Hari saw that she was in front of him, he closed his eyes. So as to slice off the arms of Bana, his enemy, he released Sudarshana. Released by Achyuta, one by one, it sliced off Bana's arms. The *chakra* swiftly severed the *asura*'s arms, which had released *shastras* and *astras*. Thereafter, it returned to Madhusudana's hand and he wished to release it again, to destroy Bana. However, realizing this, Umapati, ¹⁴⁶⁵ the destroyer of Tripura, appeared before Govinda and placated him. He saw that the terrible Bana's arms had been severed and that blood was flowing from them. Rudra said, 'O Krishna! O Jagannatha! O Krishna! I know that you are Purushottama. You are the supreme lord, the *paramatman*. You are without a beginning and without an end. You are supreme. In your pastimes and your efforts to slay *daityas*, you yourself assume embodied forms as gods, humans and inferior species. Please show me your favours. O lord! I have granted Bana freedom from fear. You should not falsify the words that I have uttered. He has prospered because he sought refuge with me. O one without decay! It is not his fault. I am the one who conferred a boon on the *daitya*. You should pardon him.' Thus addressed, Govinda spoke to Umapati, the one who has the trident in his hand. His face was amiable and he had lost all intolerance towards the *asura*. The illustrious one said, 'O Shankara! Since you have granted him a boon, let Bana remain alive. Out of deference to your words, I am withdrawing my *chakra*. You granting him freedom from fear is like me granting him freedom from fear. O Shankara! You should not look on me as different from you. You, I, and the entire universe with gods, *asuras* and humans, are identical. Men who are confounded by ignorance see them

as different.’ Saying this, Krishna went to the spot where Pradyumna’s son was. The wind generated by Garuda destroyed the bonds the hooded ones had created. He made Aniruddha and his wife sit on Garuda. With Rama and Krishna’s son, Damodara arrived in the city of Dvaraka.’

Chapter 1(98) (Burning of Kashi)

The sages asked, ‘Shouri assumed a human form and performed great deeds. Playfully, he defeated Shakra, Sharva and all the gods. To carry out divine tasks that other great deeds, did Hari perform? Please tell us. We have great curiosity.’

Vyasa replied, ‘O best among sages! I will tell you. Listen lovingly. For instance, in his incarnation as a man, Krishna burnt down Varanasi. There was Poundraka Vasudeva. ¹⁴⁶⁶ People who were confounded by their ignorance said, “Vasudeva has been incarnated on earth. You are he.” He thought that he was Vasudeva and that he had assumed an *avarata* on earth. With his entire memory destroyed, he sported all of Vishnu’s symbols. O excellent *brahmanas*! He sent a messenger to Krishna. “Give up the *chakra* and other symbols. Those truly belong to me. O foolish one! Give up everything that is spoken of as belonging to Vasudeva. If you wish to ensure your life, come and seek refuge with me.” Addressed in this way, Janardana laughed and spoke to the messenger. The illustrious one said, “I will unleash my own sign, the *chakra*, towards you. O messenger! Go and convey these words of mine to Poundraka. I know that your words are driven by good intentions. Therefore, let us act accordingly. I will take my symbols and come to your city. There is no doubt that I will unleash my own sign, the *chakra*, towards you. Since you have commanded me, I will indeed follow your instructions and come. Without any delay, I will act accordingly and come tomorrow. O king! I will certainly seek refuge with you. I will truly act so that there is no reason to fear you.” Having been told this, the messenger left. As soon as Hari remembered him, Garuda arrived and astride Garuda, he swiftly left for the city. The lord of Kashi heard about Keshava’s efforts. ¹⁴⁶⁷ With all his soldiers and companions, he

arrived so as to provide support along the flanks. Poundraka Vasudeva surrounded himself with a large army, including the army of the king of Kashi, and advanced against Keshava. Hari saw him from a distance, seated on his chariot. He held a *chakra*, a conch shell and a mace in his hands. He also had a lotus in his hand. He was garlanded and held the Sharnga bow. Suprana adorned his standard. His chest bore the *shrivatsa* mark.¹⁴⁶⁸ He had a diadem and earrings and was attired in yellow garments. Hari saw all this. On seeing this, the one, the Garuda on his standard, laughed in a deep voice.

‘O *brahmanas*! He fought with that army, consisting of elephants and horses and full of swords, double-edged swords, clubs, spears, javelins and bows. In an instant, piercing arrows that were like fire were released from the Sharnga bow. That entire army was destroyed and brought down through these and the mace and the *chakra*. Janardana also conveyed the army of the king of Kashi to its destruction. He then spoke to the foolish Poundraka, who was sporting his own signs. The illustrious one said, “O Poundraka! Through the mouth of the messenger, you had asked me to let go of my signs. That is exactly what I will do now. I am releasing my *chakra*. I am throwing away my mace. I have commanded Garuda. Let him climb atop your standard.” Saying this, he released his own *chakra*, which destroyed Poundraka’s *chakra*. His mace uprooted his mace. His Garuda shattered his Garuda. At this, lamentations arose among the people. Seeing that his friend was in trouble, the lord of Kashi fought with Vasudeva. The arrows released from the Sharnga bow severed his head and flung it inside the city of Kashi, causing great wonder among the people. In this way, Shouri killed Poundraka and the king of Kashi and his followers. He returned to Dvaravati and amused himself, as the immortals do in heaven.

‘The people saw the head of the king of Kashi fall down inside the city and exclaimed, “What is this? Who has done this?” They were astounded. Learning that he had been killed by Vasudeva, his son,¹⁴⁶⁹ assisted by the priests, satisfied Shankara. Shankara was propitiated in the great *kshetra* of Avimukta¹⁴⁷⁰ and told the son of the king, “Ask for a boon.” He said, “O illustrious one! O Maheshvara! Through your favours, for the sake of

slaying Krishna, my father's killer, let a Kritya arise." ¹⁴⁷¹ Thus addressed, he agreed that it would be this way. From a spot beyond the *dakshinagni*, from the place where the fire was kept, a giant Kritya arose. Her terrible and cruel mouth blazed. Her disheveled hair was in flames. Angry, she exclaimed, "Krishna! Krishna!" and rushed towards Dvaravati. All the people saw the terrible one, with malformed eyes. They went and sought shelter with Madhusudana, the refuge of the universe. The people said, "The son of the king of Kashi has worshipped the one with the bull on his banner. O one who wields the *chakra*! For your death, a giant Kritya has arisen. Slay the fierce Kritya. Her matted hair is blazing like flames." At that time, his mind was fixed on playing dice. However, he playfully hurled his *chakra*. It was extremely terrible and emitted flames, dense with garlands of fire. Vishnu's Sudarshana *chakra* followed Kritya. Devastated by the *chakra*, Maheshvari Kritya started to run away speedily. However, just as fast, it started to follow her. O supreme among sages! Kritya quickly entered Varanasi, her power having been countered by Vishnu's *chakra*. The entire force of Kashi and the army of *pramathas* advanced against the *chakra*, with all kinds of *shastras* and *astras*. The army unleashed many kinds of *shastras* and *astras*. However, it consumed all these. Having destroyed all these, it went to the city of Varanasi. There were large numbers of servants, citizens, horses, elephants and humans there. There were innumerable fortifications and chambers that even the gods could not glance at. The flames engulfed all the houses, ramparts and turrets. Swiftly, the *chakra* burnt down the city and everything in it. The eyes found it impossible to behold it. However, completely indifferent, it did all this with very little effort. Dazzling in its brilliance, the *chakra* then returned to Vishnu's hand.'

Chapter 1(99) (Balarama's greatness)

The sages said, 'O sage! We wish to hear about the intelligent Balabhadra again, about his bravery and valour. You should describe that to us. We have already heard about his dragging the Yamuna and other deeds. O immensely fortunate one! Tell us everything else that Bala did.'

Vyasa replied, 'O sages! Hear about Rama's deeds. He is infinite and immeasurable. He is Shesha, who holds up the earth. The brave Samba, Jambavati's son, forcibly abducted Duryodhana's daughter at the time when her *svayamvara* had been arranged. This enraged the immensely valiant Karna, Duryodhana and others, and Bhishma, Drona and others. They defeated him in battle and bound him up. O sages! Hearing this, all the Yadavas were angry at Duryodhana and the others and made great efforts so that they might be killed. However, his words slurred because of his intoxication, Baladeva was intoxicated. Bala restrained them, saying, "Because of my words, the Kouravas will release him." Baladeva went to the city of Gajasahvya. ¹⁴⁷² He didn't enter the city, but remained in a grove that was outside the city. Having learnt that Bala had arrived, Duryodhana and the others offered Rama a cow, a gift and water. Having accepted all these in the proper way, he told the Kouravas, "It is Ugrasena's command that Samba should be quickly released." O *brahmanas*! O supreme among *brahmanas*! Hearing his words, Karna, Duryodhana and the others, and Bahlika and all the other kings became angry. They glanced towards the one who wielded the plough as a weapon, belonging to the Yadu lineage, which did not deserve a kingdom. The Kouravas said, "O Bala! What are these words that you have spoken? How can a Yadava command one who has been born in the Kuru lineage? If Ugrasena is capable of commanding the Kouravas, then enough of these white umbrellas and other ornaments that

are appropriate for kings. O Baladeva! Therefore, depart. Samba has committed a wicked deed. We will not release him because of what you say, or because of Ugrasena's command. Since we deserve respect, the Kukuras and Andhakas used to bow down to us earlier. But that is not being observed now. How is it that a master is being commanded by servants? Because we treated you as equals and sat down on the same seat to eat, you have become full of insolence. But it is not your fault. Good policy does not please those who should be ignored. O Bala! The person you have spoken about should be worshipped by us and treated lovingly. But your lineage is not behaving in a similarly appropriate way towards our lineage." Having said this, all the Kurus did not release Hari's son. Having made up their minds, all of them entered Gajasahvya.

'At this, the insult led to his becoming wrathful. Intoxicated, the one who used the plough as a weapon raised his terrible plough and whirled it around. As the great-souled one struck with its side, the earth was shattered. He slapped his chest and the sound filled the directions. His eyes turned extremely coppery-red and as he spoke, his forehead was furrowed in a frown. Baladeva said, "These evil-souled Kouravas have no substance. But they are intoxicated by their strength and wish to establish their supremacy over us. This is indeed due to destiny. Ugrasena's instructions cannot be disregarded and dishonoured. But because of their *adharma*, they wish to disobey, though his commands are followed by Shachi's consort, along with the gods. Ugrasena is always present in Sudharma, the assembly hall of Shachi's consort. Shame on these people. They are content with a king's seat, leftovers of hundreds before them. The wives of his servants use clumps of flowers from the Parijata tree. However, they do not regard him as a lord of the earth. ¹⁴⁷³ Let Ugrasena, the protector of all the kings, remain where he is. Today, I will go to his city only after removing all the Kouravas from earth—Karna, Duryodhana, Drona, Bhishma, Bahlika, Duhshasana, Bhuri, Bhurishrava, Somadatta, Shala, Bhima, Arjuna, Yudhishtira, the twins and all the other Kouravas. I will slay them and destroy their horses, chariots and elephants. Taking the brave Samba and his wife with me, I will go to the city of Dvaraka and tell Ugrasena and the

relatives about this. Alternatively, as urged by the king of the gods, I will quickly remove the burden. Along with the Kurus and all the Kouravas, ¹⁴⁷⁴ I will swiftly hurl the city of Nagasahvya into the Bhagirathi.” The one who used the club as a weapon said this and his eyes were red with rage. The one with the palm tree on his standard ¹⁴⁷⁵ turned the face of the plough downwards and placing the tip on the walls of Hastinapura, started to heave. The city was suddenly whirled around. On seeing this, the hearts of all the Kouravas were agitated and they screamed. The Kouravas said, “O Rama! O mighty-armed one! Please forgive us. O Rama! You should pardon us. O one with the plough as a weapon! Please be pacified and restrain your rage. O Bala! We have understood your strength. Samba and his wife will be freed. We have been guilty of not knowing about your powers. Please forgive us.” O bulls among sages! Along with Samba and his wife, the Kouravas quickly emerged from their own city. Bhisma, Drona, Kripa and the others prostrated themselves before him and spoke pleasant words. Bala, supreme among strong ones, said, “I have pardoned you.” O *brahmanas*! Even today, the signs of the city being whirled around are evident. Such was Rama’s powers. He possessed all the signs of strength and valour. Along with the wielder of the plough, the Kouravas honoured Samba and sent him and his wife, along with the riches given at the time of a marriage.’

Chapter 1(100) (Dvividā's death)

Vyasa said, 'O sages! Listen. O *brahmanas*! All of you hear about the other things that Bala, who is full of strength, did. Naraka, the Indra among the *asuras*, was opposed to the side of the gods. The *vanara* named Dvividā was immensely valiant and was his friend. ¹⁴⁷⁶ This strong one was bound in enmity against the gods. Dvividā said, "Krishna has killed Naraka, who was full of strength and pride. Therefore, I will act against all the gods." Accordingly, he destroyed sacrifices and devastated the mortal world. Confounded by his ignorance, he destroyed sacrifices. He violated the rules of the virtuous and destroyed embodied beings. Fickle in his behavior, he burnt down kingdoms, cities, villages and the intervening places. Sometimes, he hurled down mountains and crushed villages. He uprooted mountains and flung them into the waters of the oceans. He stood in the midst of oceans and agitated the oceans. O *brahmanas*! Thus agitated, the ocean violated the shoreline. The great force flooded the shores, the villages and the cities. He could assume any form at will and assumed giant forms. In these proud forms, the *vanara* wandered around, plundering and crushing everything. In this way, the evil-souled one distorted the entire universe. Deprived of self-studies and *vashatkara*, the *brahmanas* were extremely miserable.

'On one occasion, the one with the plough as his weapon was drinking in the grove of Raivata. The immensely fortunate Revati and other beautiful women were with him. As they sang, amidst those charming women, he was like a crown. The supreme and excellent one from the Yadu lineage pleased himself, like Kubera on Mandara. The *vanara* arrived there. Seizing the plough and the club, he stood in front of him and started to mimic him. Facing the women, the monkey ¹⁴⁷⁷ laughed. He hurled the

vessels filled with liquor away. Full of rage, Bala reprimanded him. Nevertheless, ignoring him, he ¹⁴⁷⁸ continued to make a chattering sound. At this, Bala stood up and angrily seized his club. The supreme among monkeys seized the terrible summit of a mountain and hurled it. However, as it was flung, the best among Yadavas shattered it into one thousand fragments with his club and it fell down on the ground. As the club was brought down, the monkey avoided it and struck Bala on the chest with force, strength and rage. At this, Bala became angry and struck him on the head with his fist. With a little bit of life left in him, Dvivida fell down, vomiting blood. As his body fell down, the summit of the mountain was shattered into a hundred fragments. O sages! It was as if it had been struck by the *vajra* of the wielder of the *vajra*. From above, the gods showered down flowers on Rama. They praised him and applauded his great deed. “This wicked monkey took the side of the *daityas* and caused harm. O brave one! He made the universe suffer. It is good fortune that he has come to his end.” In this way, there are many deeds that the intelligent Baladeva performed. They cannot be enumerated. He is Shesha, who holds up the earth.’

Chapter 1(101) (Krishna's departure for his abode)

Vyasa said, 'In this way, with Baladeva as his aide, Krishna killed *daityas*. For the sake of the universe, he destroyed wicked kings. Along with Phalguna, ¹⁴⁷⁹ the illustrious lord reduced the burden of the earth and destroyed all the *akshouhinis*. That is the reason Hari assumed an *avatara*. To reduce the earth's burden, he killed all the kings. Using the curse invoked by *brahmanas*, he then destroyed his own lineage. Krishna abandoned Dvaraka and gave up his human form, which was Vishnu's portion. He again entered his own abode.'

The sages asked, 'How did he use a curse to exterminate his own lineage? How did Janardana give up his human body?'

Vyasa replied, 'In the great *tirtha* of Pindaraka, some young Yadu men met the great sages, Vishvamitra, Kanva and Narada. They were insolent because of their youth and were goaded by future events. They dressed up Samba, Jambavati's son, as a woman. They approached the sages, prostrated themselves and spoke to them. The young men said, "O lords! This woman desires a son. What will she deliver?" Those *brahmanas* possessed divine knowledge and could not be deceived by the young men. Wishing to destroy them, the *brahmanas*, excellent in their vows, invoked a curse on them. The angry sages said, "She will deliver a club which will exterminate the entire lineage of Yadavas." Addressed in this way, the young men told Ugrasena all that had happened. A club came out of Samba's stomach and Ugrasena had the club crushed to a powder. The powdered bits were flung into the ocean and some *eraka* grass was generated from this. O *brahmanas*! However, when the iron club was powdered, a small fragment remained. It could not be powdered and it was

in the shape of a miniature club. When this was flung into the ocean, it was swallowed by a fish. The fish was caught in a net. A hunter named Jara ¹⁴⁸⁰ killed the fish and took the piece out from its stomach. Hari knew the supreme purport of everything and possessed every kind of power. However, he did not wish to act and counter what had been ordained by destiny.

‘A messenger sent by the gods came and prostrated himself before Keshava. He spoke to him in secret and said, “O illustrious one! I am a messenger sent by the gods, the Vasus, the Ashvins, the Maruta, the Adityas, the Rudras, the Sadhyas and the others. O lord! Hear the message sent by Shakra to you. The gods have said, ‘O illustrious one! More than one hundred years have passed since you incarnated yourself to reduce the burden. You have descended and have favoured the gods by slaying *daityas* and others who were wicked in conduct. The earth’s burden has been reduced. Along with you, their protector, let the gods return to the abode of the gods. ¹⁴⁸¹ O Jagannatha! You have spent more than one hundred years here. If it pleases you, please return to heaven now. That is what the gods want. But if you still wish to remain here, as your followers, until such time, we, the gods, will also have to remain as humans.” The illustrious one replied, “O messenger! I know everything that you have told me. However, I have started the destruction of the Yadavas. If the Yadavas are not exterminated, they will constitute a grave burden on the earth. But I will quickly ensure their destruction, within seven nights. Dvaraka was retrieved from the ocean and I will submerge it in the ocean again. Having destroyed the Yadavas, I will proceed to the abode of the gods. With Samkarshana as my companion, I will give up this human body. The gods, and Indra of the gods, should take it as if I have already gone there. For the sake of reducing the earth’s burden, Jarasandha and the others have been killed. However, the Yadus constitute an even greater burden. I must reduce this extremely great burden on earth. After this, I will do what they have asked and go to the world of the immortals. Please tell them that.” Thus, addressed by Vasudeva, the messenger of the gods prostrated himself before him. O sages! He went to heaven and presented himself before the king of the gods.

‘Night and day, the illustrious one witnessed evil portents in heaven, in the sky and on earth, signifying the destruction of the city of Dvaraka. Seeing this, he told the Yadavas, “Behold these extremely terrible and great omens. To pacify these, without any delay, we should go to Prabhasa.” Uddhava, the great devotee, prostrated himself before Hari and asked, “O illustrious one! What should I do now? Instruct me. O illustrious one! I think that you will destroy this entire lineage. O Achyuta! I can see portents that indicate the destruction of the lineage.” The illustrious one replied, “Through my favours, you will have a divine power of movement. Go to the sacred hermitage of Badari, on Mount Gandhamadana. This is Nara and Narayana’s region and is the most sacred spot on earth. With your mind in me, through my favours, you will obtain success there. When I have destroyed the lineage, I will go to heaven. After it has been abandoned by me, the ocean will flood Dvaraka.” Thus, addressed and urged by Keshava, Uddhava prostrated himself before him and went to Nara and Narayana’s region. O *brahmanas*! All the Yadavas mounted chariots that could travel fast. With Krishna, Rama and the others, they left for Prabhasa.

‘Having reached Prabhasa, the Kukuras and Andhakas controlled themselves. However, to please themselves and with Vasudeva’s permission, they started to drink liquor. As they drank, there was a clash between them. The fire of dissension that resulted, led to the destruction of the Yadavas. Using the strength of divine weapons, they killed each other. When the weapons were exhausted, they seized the *eraka* reeds that were nearby. As soon as they seized the *eraka* reeds, these were seen to turn as hard as the *vajra*. With these, they struck extremely terrible blows and killed each other. O *brahmanas*! Pradyumna, Samba, Kritavarma, Satyaki, Aniruddha, Prithu, Viprithu, Charudeshna, Subahu, Akrura and others struck each other with *eraka* grass that was like the *vajra* and killed each other. Hari tried to restrain them. But they thought that Keshava had come to help them, and continued to kill each other. At this, Krishna also became angry and seized a fistful of *eraka*. In his hands, this turned into an iron club. Acting like an assassin, he killed all the Yadavas who were left. Others violently attacked and killed each other. O supreme *brahmanas*! While

Daruka looked on, Jaitra, the chariot of the wielder of the *chakra*, was swiftly dragged into the middle of the ocean. The *chakra*, mace, Sharnga bow, the quivers, the conch shell and the sword circumambulated him and left along the path of the sun. O excellent *brahmanas*! In an instant, with the exception of the mighty-armed Krishna and Daruka, all the Yadavas were destroyed. As they roamed around, they saw Rama seated near the root of a tree. They saw a giant serpent emerge from his mouth. Then, worshipped by *siddhas* and *uragas*, the serpent left for the ocean. With an offering of *arghya*, the ocean presented himself before him. Worshipped by the excellent serpents, he entered the water. Witnessing Bala's departure, Keshava spoke to Daruka. The illustrious one said, "Tell Vasudeva and Ugrasena everything—Baladeva's departure and the destruction of the Yadavas. Seated in yoga here, I will give up my body. Tell the residents of Dvaraka and Ahuka that the ocean will flood the entire city. Therefore, prepare your chariots and wait for Arjuna to arrive. Do not remain in Dvaraka, but leave with Pandava. You should go wherever Kourava ¹⁴⁸² goes. Go to Kounteya Arjuna and tell him my words. 'These are my relatives. To the best of your capacity, protect them.' With the people of Dvaravati, along with Arjuna, you will leave and Vajra ¹⁴⁸³ will become the king of the Yadus."

Chapter 1(102) (Krishna's ascent to heaven)

Vyasa said, 'Thus addressed, Daruka repeatedly prostrated himself before Krishna. After having performed *pradakshina* several times, he left, as he had been instructed. He first went to Dvarka. The immensely intelligent one then brought Arjuna and made Vajra the king. The illustrious Govinda Vasudeva merged his *atman* into the *atman* of the *brahman* and supported all beings. He honoured the words of the *brahmanas* and showed respect to the words of Durvasa. ¹⁴⁸⁴ O excellent ones! He seated himself in yoga, placing one foot on the other knee. The hunter named Jara arrived there. He held an arrow, the head made out of the last bit of the iron club. He noticed the foot, which was in the form of a deer. ¹⁴⁸⁵ O supreme among *brahmanas*! He halted and pierced it with the spike. Having gone closer, he saw a four-armed man. He prostrated himself and repeatedly said, "Please show me your favours. Taking you to be a deer, I have done this in my ignorance. Please pardon me. Since I am already being consumed by my crime, you should not burn me down." The illustrious one replied, "You should not have the slightest bit of fear. O hunter! Through my favours, go to heaven, the place where there is happiness." As soon as he spoke these words, a *vimana* arrived. Through his favours, the hunter mounted it and left for heaven. When he had left, the illustrious one united his *atman* with the *atman*. ¹⁴⁸⁶ He merged himself into the *brahman*—the undecaying, unthinkable and sparkling essence of Vasudeva. He is without birth, without old age and without destruction. He is immeasurable and is in all atmans. Giving up his human body, he went to heaven.'

Chapter 1(103) (Conclusion of Krishna's account)

Vyasa said, 'Arjuna hunted out the bodies of Krishna and Rama and performed the funeral rites. One by one, he did it for the others too. There were said to be eight main queens, Rukmini as the foremost. Taking Hari's body, they entered the fire. O excellent ones! Revati embraced Rama's body and entered the blazing fire, which turned cool as soon as it touched her. Hearing about this, Ugrasena, Anakadundubhi, Devaki and Rohini also entered the fire. Following the norms, Arjuna performed the funeral rites. Taking all the people, Vajra and thousands of Krishna's wives, ¹⁴⁸⁷ he left Dvaravati. Protecting the people and Vajra, Kounteya proceeded slowly. O *brahmanas*! Krishna had brought the Sudharma assembly hall to the world of the mortals. It left for heaven, along with the Parijata tree. On the day when Hari left earth and went to heaven, that is the day when the dark *kali* yuga descended. The giant ocean flooded the empty city of Dvaraka. However, the ocean did not flood the house of the best among the Yadus. O *brahmanas*! The illustrious Keshava is always present there. Therefore, the giant ocean has not crossed that boundary, not even today. It is great and extremely sacred. It destroys every kind of sin. If one sees the place where Vishnu played, one is freed from sins.

'O supreme sages! The land of Panchanada has a lot of grain and wealth. ¹⁴⁸⁸ Partha made arrangements for all the people to reside there. Partha, a single archer, was conveying all the women, their husbands having been killed. On seeing this, bandits, wicked in their deeds, became greedy. Avarice overwhelmed their minds. The *abhiras* were extremely difficult to subdue and they consulted each other. ¹⁴⁸⁹ The *abhiras* said, "Arjuna is a single archer. The husbands of the women have been killed. How can he

cross us and take them away? Shame on his strength. Having killed Bhishma, Drona, Jayadratha, Karna and others, he is full of pride. He does not know about the strength of those who reside in villages. Taking himself to be superior in strength, he shows disrespect towards all other men, especially villagers. What is the need to speak a lot?” With sticks and stones as weapons, thousands of them attacked the people whose protectors had been killed. Kounteya returned. He laughed and spoke to the *abhiras*. Arjuna said, “O those who are ignorant of *dharma*! If you do not wish to die, withdraw.” Ignoring Arjuna’s words, they seized the wealth, the women and Vishvaksena’s wives from him. At this, Arjuna started to string the divine Gandiva bow, which had never been destroyed in battle. However, the valiant one was unable to do this. When he managed to string it with a great deal of difficulty, it became loose again. Though he thought about them, Pandava could not remember the weapons. Cheerfully, Partha tried to shoot the arrows that remained. However, the wielder of Gandiva was unable to pierce the enemy. The inexhaustible arrows that the fire-god had given him ¹⁴⁹⁰ were destroyed. As he fought with the cowherds, Arjuna was defeated and exhausted. Kounteya thought, “Krishna was the strength when all the kings were defeated through my arrows.” As Pandu’s son looked on, those excellent women were abducted by the *abhiras*. Others went away wherever they wished. O *brahmanas*! When the arrows were exhausted, Dhananjaya struck the bandits with the end of his bow. But they only laughed at these blows. O excellent sages! As Partha looked on, the *mlecchas* seized the excellent Vrishni and Andhaka women and left in different directions. Jishnu was miserable and exclaimed, “This is a great sorrow. Alas! It is misery that the illustrious one has abandoned me.” He wept. Arjuna said, “The bow, the weapons, the chariot, the horses—all of these have been destroyed in an instant, like donations given to a person who is not learned. Destiny is indeed strong. Without the great-souled one, I am no longer capable. I have been defeated by those who are inferior. These are the same arms. This is the same fist. This is the same spot. I am the same Arjuna. But without the sacred one, everything is without substance. It is certain that my nature as Arjuna and Bhima’s nature as Bhima were

determined by him. Without him, I have been defeated by *abhiras*? How can it be otherwise?” Having said this, Jishnu went to the excellent city of Indraprastha and instated Vajra, the descendant of the Yadava lineage, as the king there. ¹⁴⁹¹

‘After this, he met Vyasa, who was residing in a forest. Having met the immensely fortunate one, he humbly greeted him. As he bent down at his feet, he ¹⁴⁹² scrutinized him closely and asked, “O Partha! Why is there a shadow on you? Have you followed some dust created by goats? Have you killed a brahmana? Are you miserable because your desire for victory has been shattered? What deviation has led to this present shadow? Were your offspring refused when they asked for something? Have you got attached to a woman one should not have intercourse with? Is that the reason you have lost your radiance? Have you eaten sweets alone, without having given to *brahmanas* first? O Arjuna! Did you take away wealth from someone who was distressed? Has the ray of the sun or the force of the wind touched you? Have you been struck by evil glances? How else can you be deprived of your prosperity? Have you touched water with nails in it? Have you been sprinkled by water from a pot? ¹⁴⁹³ Why is there this great shadow on you? In a battle, have you been defeated by a person who is inferior?”’

Vyasa continued, ‘Arjuna sighed and said, “O illustrious one! Listen.” O *brahmanas*! He told him about how he had been defeated. Arjuna said, “He was our strength. He was our energy. He was our valour. He was our prowess. He was our prosperity and our shade. Hari has forsaken us and has departed. O sage! Though we were inferior, in his greatness, he smiled at us before he spoke. With him gone, we are deprived and are like pillars. Purushottama was the essence behind my weapons, arrows and Gandiva. He has now given up his body and has left. It was because Govinda looked on us that our prosperity, victory, wealth and improvement resulted. But that illustrious one has abandoned us and has left. Bhishma, Drona, the king of Anga, ¹⁴⁹⁴ Drona and others were consumed because of his powers. But that Krishna has now left the earth. It seems to me that the earth is like a lady who has lost her youth, her beauty and her radiance. O father! ¹⁴⁹⁵ As a result of being separated from the wielder of the *chakra*, I am not the only

one who is suffering. Because of his powers, Bhishma and the others were like moths before a fire. Without Krishna, I have now been defeated by cowherds. It is because of his powers that Gandiva was famous in the three worlds. Without him, I have been chastised by *abhiras* wielding sticks. O great sage! I was conveying thousands of women who were without protectors. But bandits, using sticks as weapons, have taken them away. Using sticks as weapons, *abhiras* have subjugated my strength and have taken away all of Krishna's excellent riches, brought by me. It shouldn't be surprising that I am faded. It is extraordinary that I am still alive. O grandfather! I am without shame. My limbs have been smeared by the mud of being dishonoured by those who are inferior." O supreme *brahmanas*! He was miserable and distressed. Hearing him, I addressed the great-souled Pandava in these words. "O Partha! Enough of being ashamed. You should not grieve. Know that for all creatures, the working of time is like this. O Pandava! Time is responsible for creatures existing and not existing. O Arjuna! Understanding that time is the root of everything, act so as to steady your mind. Rivers, oceans, mountains, the entire earth, gods, humans, animals, trees and reptiles have all been created by time. It is time that will again lead to their destruction. When you understand that everything is because of time, you will obtain peace. O Dhananjaya! Krishna's greatness is exactly as you have described it. He assumed an *avatara* to reduce the earth's burden. In earlier times, suffering from the burden, the earth went to the gods. Janardana, who can assume any form at will, incarnated himself for that purpose. That task has been accomplished. All the kings have been killed. The entire lineage of Vrishnis and Andhakas has been destroyed. O Arjuna! No other task was left for him on the surface of the earth. Having accomplished what was needed to be done, as he willed, the illustrious one has departed. The god of the gods originates creation. He is the one who sustains preservation. He is also capable of destroying, as he has done now. O Partha! Therefore, you should not lament at your being vanquished. When the time is right, men will exhibit their valour. You could single-handedly kill Bhishma, Drona and the kings. O Arjuna! Did their defeat not have a cause in time? Their defeat was because

of the powers of Vishnu. That is also the truth about your defeat by bandits. He is origin and destruction. The divinity, the lord of the universe, enters other bodies. Established there, in the end, he is the one who brings about the destruction of all beings. O Kounteya! At the time of your origin, Janardana was your aide. At the time of your end, Keshava glanced favourably towards your adversaries. Who would have believed that you would kill all the Kouravas, including Gangeya? ¹⁴⁹⁶ Who would have believed that you would be defeated by *abhiras*? O Partha! Amongst beings, all this occurs because of Hari's pastimes. In the battle, this is what caused the Kouravas and others to be defeated by you. Though you protected the women, this is what led to their being abducted by bandits. O Arjuna! I will tell you exactly what happened once. O Partha! In ancient times, the brahmana Ashtavakra remained submerged in water for many years, praising the eternal lord. When large numbers of *asuras* were defeated, there was a great festival on the slopes of Meru. Hundreds and thousands of celestial women, Rambha, Tilottama and others, were going there and saw the sage immersed in the water up to his neck. There was the weight of matted hair on his hand. O Pandava! They praised and worshipped the great-souled one. As he was engaged in uttering the *stotras*, they humbly prostrated themselves before him. O best among Kouravas! All of them praised the best among *brahmanas*. When they praised him, he was pleased with them. Ashtavakra said, 'O immensely fortunate ones! I am pleased with you. I will grant you everything that you wish for, even if it is very difficult to obtain.' Rambha, Tilottama and other divine *apsaras* replied. The *apsaras* said, 'O brahmana! If you are pleased, grant us what we do not possess now.' Others said, 'O brahmana! O illustrious one! O Indra among *brahmanas*! If you are pleased, we wish to obtain Purushottama as a husband.' From inside the water, the sage replied that it would indeed be that way. As he arose from the water, they saw his disfigured form, crooked in eight parts. ¹⁴⁹⁷ On seeing him, some concealed their smiles. But others laughed out aloud. O descendant of the Kuru lineage! Enraged, the sage cursed them. Ashtavakra said, 'You laughed at me and showed me disrespect because of my form. Because of what you

have done, I will curse you. Because of my favours, you will obtain Purushottama as your husband. However, all of you will suffer because of my curse. You will fall into the hands of bandits.’ When they heard what the sage had said, they placated him and he said, ‘You will again return to the world of the gods.’ Thus, because of Ashtavakra, those excellent women obtained Keshava as a husband and because of the sage’s curse, they fell into the hands of bandits. O Pandava! You should not have the slightest bit of grief on this account. Everything is taken away by the one who is the lord of everything. Your imminent destruction has also been decided by him. That is the reason your strength, energy, valour and greatness have been taken away. For those who are born, death is inevitable. Every fall leads to a rise. Union ends in separation. Any accumulation is destroyed. Understanding this, the learned do not grieve. Nor are they delighted. There are others, like the learned, who seek to learn from these events. O best among men! Knowing this, along with your brothers, give up the entire kingdom. Go and perform austerities in the forest. Go and tell Dharmaraja these words of mine. O brave one! Day after tomorrow, along with your brothers, obtain the intended destination.” Thus addressed, Arjuna went and told Partha and the twins everything that he had seen and everything that he had been told. ¹⁴⁹⁸ All of them heard Vyasa’s words, as narrated by Arjuna. Handing over the kingdom to Parikshit, the sons of Pandu went to the forest. O best among sages! I have, thus, told you in detail how Vasudeva was born in the Yadu lineage and about everything that he did.’

Chapter 1(104) (Vishnu's manifestations)

The sages said, 'O best among sages! The manifestation of the divinity who is the god of the gods and of Rama on earth is extremely rare. You have spoken about it and about his activities. However, having heard about the illustrious one's account, we are not satisfied. We wish to hear about other manifestations of the lord of the universe. In the Puranas, the virtuous have spoken about the infinitely energetic Vishnu's manifestation as *varaha*. We have heard about it. However, we do not know about his conduct and his nature in detail. We do not know about his deeds, his qualities and his sentiments. What was the reason? What was *varaha*'s nature? What was his form? Who was the divinity? What was his conduct and prowess like? What did he do? When *brahmanas* assembled at a sacrifice and are told about the great *varaha*'s conduct, their minds are pleased. It brings happiness to all the worlds. O brahmana! How did Narayana assume the form of *varaha*? How did the destroyer of enemies use his tusks to raise the earth up from the ocean? We wish to hear about the activities of the slayer of enemies in detail. O lord! Our minds are inclined to hear about the intelligent Hari Krishna's deeds in due order and about his advent. O brahmana! What was his nature? You should tell us.'

Vyasa replied, 'You have asked great and weighty questions. To the best of my capacity, I will tell you. Hear about Vishnu's glory. It is good fortune that your inclinations have turned towards hearing about Vishnu's powers. O excellent *brahmanas*! I will tell you about Vishnu's manifestation. He possesses a thousand faces, a thousand eyes, a thousand feet, a thousand heads, a thousand hands, a thousand tongues and a thousand diadems. He is the divinity who does not decay. He is the radiant lord. He confers a thousand boons. He has a thousand beginnings. He has a thousand arms. He

is the one without decay. He is the sacrifice, the extraction of *soma* juice, the person performing the sacrifice, the oblation, the sacred vessels, the altar, the initiation for the sacrifice, the kindling, the ladle, the broad spoon, *soma*, the basket, the mortar, the water used for sprinkling, *dakshinayana*, the *adhvaryu*, the brahmana who chants *Sama* hymns, the assistant priests, the sacrificial hall, those present at the sacrifice, the sacrificial altar, the wheel, the stake, the narrow spoon, the *charu*, the pestle, the sacrificial room to the east, the sacrificial arena, the person offering oblations and everything else. He is everything short and extremely large in size, all mobile and immobile objects. He is rites of atonement, *arghya*, the level ground for the sacrifice and *kusha* grass. He is the *mantras* that convey oblations offered at sacrifices into the fire. He is the one who conveys the shares in a sacrifice, he is the shares. He is the one who eats first, he is the one who partakes of *soma*. He is the oblations offered into the flames. He is the one with the upraised weapons. *Brahmanas* who know the Vedas speak of him as the eternal lord of a sacrifice. The intelligent Vishnu, lord of the gods, bears the *shrivatsa* mark on his chest. In the past, he has been manifested thousands of times. The grandfather has said that there will be many manifestations in the future too. O immensely fortunate ones! You have asked me about a divine and sacred account, about the former manifestations of Vishnu. This is an auspicious account and destroys all sins. O immensely fortunate ones! Listen with single-minded attention. O unblemished ones! In due order, I will describe what you have asked me about. This is about the greatness of Vasudeva and about the immensely intelligent one's conduct. This is about his powers, used for the welfare of the worlds of the gods and mortals. The valiant one, who is in the atmans of all beings, manifests himself several times. I will speak about the manifestations that have sacred and divine qualities.

‘The god of the gods, the lord of the universe, sleeps for one thousand yugas. ¹⁴⁹⁹ When those one thousand yugas are over, to accomplish certain tasks, he manifests himself. The ancient divinity blazes like the fire, flaming in his energy. In ancient times, he created Brahma, Kapila, Tryambaka, the gods who reside in heaven, the *saptarshis*, the *nagas*, the *apsaras*, the

immensely powerful Sanatkumara and the great-souled and illustrious Manu, creator of subjects. All mobile and immobile objects perished in the ocean. The gods, *asuras* and men were destroyed. The *uragas* and *rakshasas* were destroyed. The invincible Madhu and Kaitabha manifested themselves and wished to fight. After having bestowed innumerable boons on them, the illustrious one killed them. In ancient times, the one with the lotus in his navel slept in the waters of the ocean. The gods and the large number of *rishis* were born inside the lotus. This manifestation of the lord of the universe is named Poushkaraka. ¹⁵⁰⁰ In the Puranas, this is spoken about in connection with divine learning. In the manifestation known as *shrutimukha*, the great-souled one appeared in the form of a *varaha*. In this, Vishnu, the best among the gods, assumed the form of a *varaha*. ¹⁵⁰¹ The earth with its mountains, forests and groves, right up to the frontiers of the ocean, was destroyed and submerged in a single ocean of water. The lord entered that single ocean of water. For the welfare of the worlds, he raised up the earth, from the ocean, on his tusks. The one with one thousand heads, the original creator of the worlds established the earth again. In this way, desiring the welfare of beings, he assumed the form of Yajna Varaha. In ancient times, he raised the goddess earth up from the waters of the ocean. O *brahmanas*! I have spoken to you about *varaha*.

‘Next comes Narasimha. In this form of Indra among the deer, he killed Hiranyakashipu. O *brahmanas*! In ancient times, in krita yuga, this enemy of the gods was insolent because of his strength. This original ancestor of the *daityas* performed extremely great austerity for ten thousand years. He fasted and performed *japa* for another one thousand years. For another five hundred years, he observed a vow of silence. Brahma was pleased at his tranquility, self-control, *brahmacharya*, austerity and *niyama*. On a radiant *vimana*, yoked to swans and with the complexion of the sun, Svayambhu himself appeared before him. The Adityas, Vasus, the Marut divinities, the Rudras, the Vishvadevas and their aides, the *yakshas*, the *rakshasas*, the *kinnnaras*, the directions, the sub-directions, the rivers, the oceans, the *nakshatras*, the *muhurtas*, those who travel through the sky, the giant planets, the *devarshis*, those aged in austerity, the learned *siddhas*, the

sacred *rajarshis*, the *gandharvas* and large numbers of *apsaras* were with him. The prosperous preceptor of mobile and immobile objects was surrounded by all the gods. Brahma, supreme among those who know about the *brahman*, addressed the *daitya* in these words. Brahma said, “O one who is excellent in vows! I am pleased with your devotion and austerity. O fortunate one! Ask for a boon. You will get whatever you wish for.” Hiranyakashipu replied, “O grandfather of the worlds! Let gods, *asuras*, *gandharvas*, *yakshas*, *uragas* and *rakshasas* be unable to kill me. Let angry *rishis*, or those who are full of austerity, be unable to kill me with their curses. This is the first boon that I choose. May *shastras*, *astras*, mountains, trees, anything that is dry, anything that is wet, anything that is above and anything that is below, be unable to kill me. If a person is capable of destroying me, along with my servants, soldiers and mounts, with a single blow of his hand, let him be the cause of my death. May I be the following. I will be the sun-god and the moon-god. I will be wind, fire, water, space, air and everything. I will be ego, anger and desire. I will be Varuna, Vasava and Yama. I will be the lord of riches. I will be the one who bestows riches. I will be the lord of *yakshas* and *kimpurushas*.” Brahma said, “O son! I have granted you these divine and extraordinary boons. O son! There is no doubt that you will obtain everything that you desire.” Having said this, the illustrious grandfather quickly left for Vairaja, Brahma’s abode that is frequented by large numbers of *brahmarshis*. Having heard about the granting of the boon, gods, *nagas*, *gandharvas* and sages presented themselves before the grandfather. The gods said, ‘O illustrious one! Through these boons, the *asura* will cause us impediments. O illustrious one! Be pleased. Quickly think about a means of bringing about his death. O illustrious one! You are Svayambhu. You are the lord and original cause behind all creatures. You are the creator of *havya* and *kavya*. You are certainly the unmanifest Prakriti.” The god Prajapati heard these words, which were for the welfare of the worlds. The illustrious one answered the large number of gods in the following words. Brahma said, “O gods! He will certainly obtain the fruits of his austerity. However, when the fruits of austerity are exhausted, the illustrious Vishnu will kill him.” Hearing the

words of the one who had originated from the lotus, all the gods were delighted and returned to their own divine and respective abodes. The *daitya* Hiranyakashipu was insolent because he had been given those boons. As soon as he obtained the boon, he started to obstruct the subjects. The immensely fortunate sages, devoted to their vows, were in their hermitages, self-controlled and devoted to the *dharma* of truth. He oppressed them. The great *asura* defeated the gods in heaven. The *asura* brought the three worlds under his subjugation and started to reside in heaven. Insolent because of the boon he had received, the *danava* roamed around on earth. He gave the *daityas* shares in sacrifices and deprived the gods of their shares in sacrifices. The Adityas, Vasus, Sadhyas, Vishvadevas and Maruts sought refuge with the immensely strong Vishnu, the one who is the refuge. He is the divinity who is full of the *brahman*. He is the sacrifice. He is the eternal divinity and the *brahman*. He is the lord of the past, the present and the future. He is revered by all the worlds. He is Narayana, the lord and the god. He is the one with whom one seeks refuge. They went to him for refuge. The gods said, “O lord of the gods! We are now scared of Hiranyakashipu. Please save us. You are our supreme divinity. You are our supreme preceptor. O supreme among gods! You are the supreme creator of Brahma and the others. Your eyes are like the petals of a blooming lotus. You are the one who causes destruction to the side of the enemy. For the sake of destruction of Diti’s lineage, we have sought refuge with you.” Vasudeva replied, “O immortals! Cast aside your fear. I am granting you freedom from fear. O gods! Before long, you will get heaven back. This *daitya* and his companions are insolent because of the boon. He cannot be killed by Indra and the other immortals. I will slay him.” Saying this, the illustrious one took leave of the lords of heaven. The immensely strong one went to Hiranyakashipu’s abode. The lord assumed a form that was half that of a man and half that of a lion. Assuming the Narasimha form, he touched one hand with the other hand. His form was like that of a dense cloud. His voice was like that of a dense cloud. His blazing energy was like that of a dense cloud. His force was like that of a cloud. He was like a proud tiger in his valour. The extremely strong *daitya* was protected by large numbers on

insolent *daityas*. When he saw him, he slew him with a single blow of his hand. I have spoken to you about Nrisimha. ¹⁵⁰²

‘Vamana is next. In ancient times, for the destruction of the *daityas*, the powerful Vishnu assumed the Vamana form in the course of the powerful Bali’s sacrifice. In three strides, he agitated the great *asuras*, who could not be agitated by others. There were Viprachitti, Shiva, Shanku, Ayahshanku, Ayahshira, Ashvashira, the valiant Hayagriva, Vegavan, Ketuman, Ugra, the great *asura* Ugravyagra, Pushkara, Pushkala, Ashva, Ashvapati, Prahlada, Kumbha, Samhrada, Gamanyapriya, Anuhrada, Harihaya, Varaha, Samhara, Anuja, Sharabha, Shalabha, Kupatha, Krodhana, Kratha, Brihatkirti, Mahajihva, Shankukarna, Mahasvana, Diptajihva, Arkanayana, Mrigapada, Mrigapriya, Vayu, Garishtha, Namuchi, Shambara, the great Vikshara, Chandrahanta, Krodhahanta, Krodhavardhana, Kalaka, Kalakopa, Vritra, Krodha, Virochana, Garishtha, ¹⁵⁰³ Varishtha, Pralamba, Naraka, Indratapana, Vatapi, Ketuman, ¹⁵⁰⁴ who was proud of his strength, Asiloma, Puloma, Vashkala, Pramada, Mada, Svamishra, Kalavadana, Karala, Keshi, Ekaksha, Chandrama, Rahu, Samhrada, ¹⁵⁰⁵ Sambara and Svana. They had *shataghnis* ¹⁵⁰⁶ and *chakras* in their hands. They had clubs in their hands. Others used machines drawn by horses. Others used javelins as weapons. Some held spears and mortars in their hands, others wielded battle-axes. Some had nooses and clubs in their hands. There were bludgeons in the hands of others. Some *danavas* used giant boulders as weapons, others had spears in their hands. Those immensely strong ones, who came from many regions, used many kinds of terrible weapons. Some had faces like tortoises and cocks, others had faces like hares and owls. Some had faces like donkeys and camels, others had faces like boars. Some had faces like cats and peacocks, and there were others with extremely gigantic faces. Some had cruel faces like crocodiles and sheep, others had faces like cows, goats and buffaloes. Some had faces like lizards and porcupines, other *danavas* had faces like jackals. Some had faces like rats and frogs, others had terrible faces like wolves. Some had fierce faces like *makaras*, other *danavas* had faces like *krouncha* birds. There were *danavas* with faces like Garuda, mules and peacocks. Some had garments made out of the hides of gigantic

elephants. Others had garments made out of black antelope skin. Some covered their bodies with barks of trees, others were attired in blue garments. Some wore head-dresses and diadems. Other *asuras* had earrings. Some had crowns, others wore their hair long. Some extremely radiant ones had necks that were like conch shells. The *daityas* were attired in many kinds of garments. They had many kinds of garlands and unguents. They gathered their own blazing and energetic weapons and one by one, surrounded Hrishiksha from every direction. The lord crushed all the *daityas* with his feet, hands and the palms of his hands. He assumed an extremely terrible form and swiftly traversed the earth. As his valour covered the earth, the sun and the moon were near his chest. ¹⁵⁰⁷ As his size increased, the sky was near his navel. As he increased even further, everything was at the level of his knees. O *brahmanas*! I have spoken to you about Vishnu's great valour. The entire earth had been taken away, but he took it back from the bulls among the *asuras*. Vishnu, supreme among strong ones, gave Shakra the earth. This manifestation of the great-souled one is known as Vamana. *Brahmanas* who know about the Vedas speak about Vishnu's fame.

‘Vishnu is in the atmans of all beings. The great-souled one had another manifestation known as Dattatreya, who was full of great fortitude. The Vedas, the rites and the sacrifices had got destroyed. The *dharma* of the four *varnas* had become narrow and loose. There was a great increase in *adharma*. Truth had been destroyed, with everything established in falsehood. With *dharma* destroyed, the subjects were suffering. The great-souled one brought back sacrifices, rites and the Vedas. The great-souled one freed the four *varnas* from their narrowness. The intelligent Dattadreya, the one who bestows boons, conferred a boon on the intelligent Kartavirya, the king of Haihaya. “O king! For my sake, you have used these two arms of yours. Therefore, there is no doubt that you will have one thousand arms. O lord of the earth! You will protect the entire earth. When you are present in a battle, large numbers of enemies will find it impossible to look at you.” This was the extraordinary and auspicious manifestation of the prosperous Vishnu.

‘The great-souled one was again manifested as Jamadagni’s son. Because of his one thousand arms, enemies found it impossible to vanquish King Arjuna ¹⁵⁰⁸ in battle. But lord Rama ¹⁵⁰⁹ killed him and destroyed his army. King Arjuna was seated on his chariot and Rama brought him down on the ground. Though Arjuna thundered like a cloud, Rama crushed him. The descendant of the Bhrigu lineage severed all of his one thousand arms. He used his blazing battle-axe to destroy him and his kin. The earth, adorned with the mountains Meru and Mandara, was strewn with *kshatriyas* and he emptied it of *kshatriyas* twenty-one times. The extremely illustrious Bhargava made it bereft of *kshatriyas* and to destroy all his sins, performed a horse sacrifice. At this sacrifice, the descendant of the Bhrigu lineage offered a great donation as *dakshina*. Cheerfully, he gave the earth to Kashyapa, Marichi’s son. At this great horse sacrifice, the immensely illustrious one gave the king elephants, horses, sparkling chariots, supreme charioteers, inexhaustible gold, cattle and kings among elephants. Even today, for the welfare of the worlds, the descendant of the Bhrigu lineage, the lord who was Jamadagni’s son, roams around, performing terrible austerity. He is like a god and resides on prosperous Mahendra, supreme among mountains. Vishnu is the lord of the gods. He is eternal and without decay. This manifestation of the great-souled one is known as that of Jamadagni’s son.

‘In the twenty-fourth *mahayuga*, Vishvamisra was born first. He ¹⁵¹⁰ was born as Dasharatha’s son, with large eyes like lotuses. The mighty-armed one, the lord of all lords, divided himself into four parts. ¹⁵¹¹ He was like the sun in his energy and was known in the world as Rama. The immensely illustrious one was born so as to please the worlds, chastise *rakshasas* and extend *dharma*. It is said that the Indra among men was engaged in the welfare of all beings. The one who knew about every kind of *dharma* resided in the forest for fourteen years. Rama was engaged in the welfare of all beings and Lakshmana followed him. In the forest, Raghava tormented himself in austerity for fourteen years. The one who was formerly known as Lakshmi followed her husband. She assumed the form that people knew as Sita and remained at his side. To accomplish the task of the gods, he resided

in Janasthana. ¹⁵¹² The cruel Poulastya ¹⁵¹³ harmed the bull among men. The immensely illustrious one sought out Sita's trail and killed him. Ravana, Indra among *rakshasas*, was invincible in battle and could not be slain by large numbers of gods, *asuras*, *yakshas*, *rakshasas* and serpents. He resembled a mass of blue collyrium and was united with crores of *rakshasas*. Ravana was cruel and made the three worlds shriek. He was impossible to vanquish and impossible to withstand. He was insolent and was like a tiger in his valour. He was insolent because of the boon he had received and large numbers of gods found it impossible to look at him. In a battle, he killed Ravana, along with his advisers and his soldiers. The lord of the *rakshasas* was gigantic in size and immense in strength. Rama, the supreme lord of beings, quickly slew that Ravana. In an encounter, for Sugriva's sake, he killed Vali, the immensely strong Indra among *vanaras* and instated Sugriva. Madhu's son was the insolent *danava* named Lavana. The great and brave *asura* was insolent because he had received a boon, but he killed him in Madhu's forest. ¹⁵¹⁴ Maricha and Subahu were supreme among strong ones. Using their strength, they destroyed the sacrifices of sages who had cleansed their souls. However, the great-souled one dashed their hopes and killed them. In battles, he killed other *rakshasas* who were terrible in encounters. Viradha and Kabandha—the two *rakshasas* were terrible in their valour. They were *gandharvas* who had become confounded because of curses and the tiger among men killed them. In battles, Rama used arrows that were as radiant as the sun's rays and flashes of lightning, with colourful tufts and made out of molten gold. Their essence was like that of the great Indra's *vajra*. He used these to kill enemies. For slaying enemies of the gods, impossible for even the gods to assail, the intelligent Vishvamitra gave him *shastras*. In earlier times, he was present at the great-souled Janaka's sacrifice and in his pastimes, playfully shattered Maheshvara's bow. Rama, supreme among all those who uphold *dharma*, performed all these deeds. Without impediments, he continuously undertook ten horse sacrifices. As long as Rama ruled over the kingdom, there was no malice or use of inauspicious words. The wind that blew did not cause any agitation. No wealth was ever taken away. Widows did not

lament and there were no calamities. As long as Rama ruled over the kingdom, everything was auspicious there. Creatures did not suffer from any fear on account of water, fire, wind or blows. The old never had to perform funeral rites for the young. ¹⁵¹⁵ *Kshatriyas* were devoted to those who observed *brahmacharya* ¹⁵¹⁶ and *vaishyas* were devoted to *kshatriyas*. The shudras did not suffer from *ahamkara* and served the three *varnas*. Women did not serve those who were not their husbands and husbands did not serve those who were not their wives. Everyone in the world was self-controlled and the earth was devoid of bandits. Rama alone was the one who sustained. Rama was the one who protected. As long as Rama ruled over the kingdom, the lifespan was for one thousand years and people had one thousand sons. They did not suffer from disease. As long as Rama ruled over the kingdom, there was unity everywhere on earth, among gods, *rishis* and humans. In this connection, those who know about ancient accounts recite a chant. “Such was the true greatness of the intelligent Rama that people were immersed in him. Rama was young. His eyes were red and his face was radiant. He was pleasant in speech. His arms stretched all the way up to his knees. He was mighty-armed and his face was excellent. His shoulders were like those of a lion. Rama ruled over the kingdom for ten thousand years. Without stopping, the sounds of hymns from the *Rig*, *Sama* and *Yajur* Veda and the sound of the great-souled one’s bow twanging were heard in the kingdom. So were the sounds of ‘Let it be given, let it be eaten.’ ¹⁵¹⁷ He blazed in his own radiance and was full of the *guna* of *sattva*. Rama, Dasharatha’s son, was more radiant than the sun or the moon.” ¹⁵¹⁸ He performed hundreds of sacred sacrifices and when these were completed, *dakshina* was given. The immensely strong Raghava left Ayodhya and went to heaven. Such was the mighty-armed descendant of the Ikshvaku lineage. Having slain Ravana and his companions, the lord went to heaven.

‘In the *kalpa* known as Mathura, for the welfare of all the worlds, the great-souled one had another manifestation known as Keshava. In this form in a human body, the valiant one killed the *daityas*—Shalva, Chedi, Kamsa, Dvivida, Arishta, Vrishabha, Keshi, Putana the female *daitya*, the elephant

Kuvalayapida, Chanura and Mushtika. Extraordinary in his deeds, he severed Bana's one thousand arms. In encounters, the immensely strong one killed Naraka and Yavana. Having used his energy to slay the lords of the earth, he took away their jewels. On earth, the lords of the earth who were wicked in conduct were killed.

‘In this way, for the welfare of the worlds, the great-souled one will manifest himself in the village of Shambhala, under the name of Kalki Vishnuyasha. For the welfare of the worlds, there are many other divine manifestations of the immensely illustrious divinity. Along with large numbers of gods, those who know about the *brahman* have sung about them in the Puranas. In reciting his manifestations, even the gods are confounded. What is described in Puranas is like what exists in the Vedas and *shruti* texts. Only an indicative list of manifestations is recited. The lord is the preceptor of all the worlds and his manifestations deserve to be recited. When his manifestations are recited, the ancestors are pleased. If a man joins his hands in salutation and hears about the infinitely valiant Vishnu's yoga *maya*, he is freed from all sins. Through the favours of the illustrious one, who is the lord of yoga, he quickly obtains enhancement, prosperity and extensive objects of pleasure. O best among sages! I have, thus, described the sacred account of the infinitely valiant Vishnu's manifestations. This destroys all sins.’

Chapter 1(105) (Path to Yama's world)

The sages said, 'O sage! We are not yet satisfied with hearing about sacred *dharma*. When recited from your mouth, it is like *amrita*. We still have great curiosity. O sage! You know everything about the creation and destruction and the destination that *karma* of beings leads to. O great sage! Therefore, we are asking you. It has been heard that the path to Yama's world is extremely difficult to traverse. It causes great misery and hardship. It always generates fear in all beings. How do men follow that path and go to Yama's abode? What is the length of that road! O supreme among eloquent ones! Please tell us. O sage! O one who knows everything! We are asking you. Please tell us everything in detail. O sage! What modes can men use, donations, *dharma* and *niyama*, to avoid suffering the miseries of hell? How far is Yama's world from that of humans? What deeds make one go to heaven and what deeds make one go to hell? How many different regions are there in heaven and how many in hell? Where do those who perform good deeds go? Where do those who perform wicked deeds go? As a being is conveyed to Yama's world, tell us about his form, size and complexion.'

Vyasa replied, 'O tigers among sages! O ones excellent in vows! Listen to my words. The wheel of *samsara* may not suffer from old age, but it has no stability. From the instant one leaves to the moment one arrives, I will tell you everything about the path to Yama. There is no one else who can speak about it. O excellent ones! You have asked me about that path. The distance from Yama's world to that of humans is eighty-six thousand *yojanas*. It has been said that the path is as hot as molten copper. All creatures who are described as living beings must traverse that path. Men who perform auspicious deeds go to auspicious regions. Those who perform

evil deeds go to evil regions. There are twenty-two hells in Yama's kingdom. Those who are wicked in their deeds are separately cooked there. They are Naraka, Rourava, Roudra, Shukara, Tala, Kumbhipaka, Mahaghora, Shalmala, Vimohana, Kitada, Krimibhaksha, Lalabhaksha, Bhrama, Nadyahpuyavaha, Rudhirambha, Agnijvala, Mahaghora, Samdasha, Shunabhojana, Ghora, Vaitarani and Asipatravana. No shade from trees can be found there. ¹⁵¹⁹ There are no lakes, ponds, tanks, wells or water bodies, or places from which one can drink. There are no pavilions or residences, no rivers or mountains. Along that path, there is not a single place where a person can rest. When a person is suffering or exhausted because of travelling, he cannot rest. Everyone must perforce travel along that great path. When the time arrives, he must cast aside well-wishers, relatives, wealth and other things. Irrespective of whether one has been born from a womb, from an egg, from sweat or whether one is a tree or plant, irrespective of being mobile or immobile, one must travel along that great path. Gods, *asuras* and humans are all under the subjugation of Vaivasvata. Everything on earth known as living, woman, man or eunuch, in the forenoon, afternoon or at midday, at the time of *sandhya*, at midnight, at dawn or dusk, whether aged, middle-aged or young, in the womb or in childhood—must proceed along that great path. ¹⁵²⁰ Death can happen when one is away from home or at home, on the ground or in a *kshetra*, in water, or in one's house, seated, standing or lying down, whether one is awake or asleep. Everyone must travel along that great path. A being can experience his lifespan for as long as it has been destined. When that lifespan is over, he has to let go of his life, even if he does not wish to. An embodied being gives up his life because of different reasons—water, fire, poison, weapon, hunger, physical ailment or as a result of falling down from a mountain.

‘When the lifespan is over, he gives us this entire large body that consists of the five elements and assumes another body in which he enjoys the hardships that have resulted from his own deeds. Having obtained this firm body, he experiences happiness and unhappiness. A man who has perpetrated wicked deeds experiences great hardships. A person who has followed *dharma* is cheerful when he is conveyed to Yama's abode amidst

happiness. The heat within the body is agitated and is fanned by a fierce wind. It blazes like a fire without kindling and strikes at the inner organs. The wind known as *udana* flows upwards and prevents the water and food that have been ingested from moving downwards. Along with their wives, sons and kin, those who have donated water and cooked food do not face hardships. There are those who have donated food, with their minds purified by faith. They find satisfaction, even though there is no food there. A person who has not uttered a falsehood, one who has not brought about dissension among those who are affectionate towards each other, a person who is a believer and one who is devoted, proceed towards a happy death. Those who are devoted to worshipping gods and *brahmanas*, those who are not envious, those who are pure and generous and those who are modest—such men face a happy death. If a person does not give up dharma because of desire, anger or hatred, if a person acts in accordance with what he has said, and if a person is amiable, he obtains a happy death. Men who give water to those who are thirsty and food to those who are hungry—at the time of death, they are filled with happiness. Those who donate riches conquer cold. Those who donated sandalwood conquer heat. Those who do not cause anxiety to others conquer pain and misery at the time of death. Those who impart knowledge conquer confusion. Those who donate a lamp conquer darkness. Those who bear false witness, those who speak lies, those who take away life and those who criticize the Vedas—at the time of death, they are overwhelmed by confusion. Yama's evil-souled attendants arrive. They are fierce and have foul smells. They wield heavy clubs in their hands. When they appear before his eyes, the person starts to tremble. He screams, calling out to his brother, mother and father. O *brahmanas*! However, sound does not come out and not a single syllable can be discerned. His eyes roll around in fright. He breathes with a great deal of difficulty. Full of pain in this way, he frees himself of the body. He assumes another external body that is just like the body he has cast aside. In this body, which has originated from his father and mother, he experiences the pain of *karma*. The amount of pain is proportionate to the magnitude of the karma and the person's age, condition and status. Yama's messenger ties

him up in terrible nooses. At the time of death, the being experiences extreme pain. The elements leave the body and the breath of life emerges through the throat. Like leaving a womb, the *jivatman* gives up the body. The breath of life gives up the body, which consists of the six sheaths. ¹⁵²¹ Mothers, fathers, brothers, maternal uncles, wives, sons, friends and preceptors are left behind on earth. He can see them, extremely distressed and with their eyes full of tears. The breath of life abandons the body and departs.

‘As soon as they see that a being’s lifespan is exhausted and his life is over, Yama’s terrible messengers arrive, desiring to take him away. There is darkness that is impossible to traverse. It is extremely terrible, enveloped in darkness. The path yields both joy and misery, but is extremely difficult for evil-doers to traverse. It is difficult to tolerate and seems to be without an end. It is difficult to look at and impossible to cross. It seems to be a long distance that is impassable and always causes injury to evil-doers. Controlling the being with nooses, Yama’s servants drag him along. Striking him with clubs, they convey him along that great path. At the time of departure, they arrive on mounts that are bears, tigers, donkeys, camels, monkeys, scorpions, wolves, owls, serpents, cats and vultures. There are others astride hawks and jackals and with lizards and herons as mounts. They assume many terrible forms, like those of boars, *vetalas* ¹⁵²² and buffaloes, which are terrifying to all beings. The faces are long and fierce, with crooked noses. Some have three eyes. Some have large jaw bones, cheeks and faces. Some have teeth that hang downwards. Malformed and pointed teeth jut out. The limbs are covered with flesh and blood. The fangs are extremely strong. The mouths are like the nether regions, with horrible and blazing tongues. The malformed eyes blaze, fickle and tawny. Some eyes are like those of cats, others like those of owls. Some eyes are like fireflies, others like *shakragopas*. In the midst of masses of hair, some eyes do not flicker and are like fires. The ornaments are extremely terrible, as if serpents are coiled around them. They are garlanded with skulls and the limbs drip blood. There are dark snakes around the throats and these hiss fiercely. The coarse and stiff hair is as fierce as blazing flames. The faces

are covered with snake-like beards and the body hair is brown and tawny. There are extremely terrible staffs in their hands, which hang down like clubs. Some have two arms, others have four arms. Others possess ten, sixteen or twenty arms. There are others with innumerable arms. Some have thousands of arms. There are many kinds of terrible weapons that blaze—javelins, spikes, *chakras*, nooses, chains and staffs. These extremely strong and horrible ones have many kinds of extremely resplendent weapons. When the lifespan of a mortal person ends, these extremely terrible ones arrive. Following Yama's command, all of them seize the being.

‘The being assumes a body in which he can bear the hardships of his own deeds and in this body, he is conveyed to Yama's abode. At that time, the being is bound in nooses, fetters and chains that are like the *vajra*. He is conveyed, severely struck by Yama's terrible servants. He stumbles, weeps and screams repeatedly. ‘Alas! O father! O mother! O son!’ Tainted by his own *karma*, he says this. He is struck by sharp spears, thick clubs that are sharp at the edges, swords, javelins and extremely terrible staffs that are like the *vajra*. Roaring loudly, they strike him with *vajras* and spears and censure him. In every direction, he is struck by each of these terrible ones. He is afflicted by grief and loses his senses. Here and there, he stumbles. Thus dragged, the being is conveyed along that extremely fearful path. It is full of *kusha* grass, thorns, termite-hills, spikes, stones and gravel. There are blazing fires and hundreds of *vajras* that have a caustic touch. He is scorched by the hot rays of the blazing sun. As jackals howl in hideous tones, he is dragged along by Yama's messengers. While he is dragged along, hundreds of fierce jackals tug at his flesh. In this way, an evil-doer proceeds along the terrible path to Yama's abode. He is scared in some places, he is terrified in other places. There are some places where he stumbles. Weeping in his miseries, he proceeds along that great path. He is censured and anxious. Suffering from fear, he tries to run away. Anyone who is said to have a body and anyone who is said to be alive has to proceed in this way, along the path that is covered with thorns and hot sand. As they proceed, men who have not given gifts are scorched. As they proceed, those who have killed beings follow a path strewn with fat, blood,

foul urine and excrement. They are smeared with these and their skin is burnt and cracked. Those who have killed living beings shout and scream. They shriek, but no sound emerges. Along the path, those who have killed beings suffer from pain. As they proceed, they are struck and pierced with javelins, catapults, swords, bludgeons, arrows and sharp spears. The wicked ones are devoured by dogs, tigers, wolves and herons. In every direction along that path, they suffer from the rocks. Along the path, those who have eaten flesh are struck and sliced with saws. In every direction, they are pierced by the tips of the horns of buffaloes and bulls. Boars strike those who have eaten flesh. Along the path, wicked ones who have destroyed honey are stung and bitten by swarms of bees and flies. Along the path, a deceitful man who has killed a trusting master, friend or woman is severed with weapons. Along the path to Yama's abode, a man who has killed animals or struck an innocent person is devoured by *rakshasas*. If a man has stolen the garments or covering of another person's wife, as he proceeds to Yama's abode after death, he has to run there naked. There are evil-souled and wicked evil-doers who have stolen garments, grain, gold, homes and fields. As they proceed along the path to Yama's abode, they suffer from blows through rocks, bludgeons and staffs and a great deal of blood flows. There are men who are not scared of hell. They steal the possessions of *brahmanas*. O *brahmanas*! These worst among men are struck and made to scream. They are tied to dry pieces of wood and their ears, eyes and noses are sliced off. Their bodies are smeared with pus and blood. They are fiercely struck by horrible vultures, jackals and the hideous servants. As they proceed to Yama's abode, these sinners scream. In this way, that path is extremely terrible and blazes like the fire. It is horrible, impassable and impenetrable for men who are destined to proceed that way. The complexion is like that of molten copper and there are blazing flames and sparks. It is strewn with thorns and branches of red amaranth and they are struck with hideous and thick javelins and *vajras*. There are fierce thorns that blaze everywhere. The blazing sand seems to have burning coal mixed in it and the path is impassable because of insects. There are fierce nets of flames and the person is scorched by the rays of the sun. The embodied

being is dragged along this extremely cruel path. Screaming and suffering from the misery, there are occasions when the being falls down.

Nevertheless, Yama's servants strike him with all the different weapons. In this way, a greedy sinner is struck and certainly dragged along, because the being cannot resist Yama's servants. Everyone has to proceed along this extremely difficult path. He is conveyed by many of Yama's messengers, who are completely contemptuous of him. Yama's servants convey the being along that extremely difficult path.

‘O *brahmanas*! He is then made to enter a terrible city that is made out of copper and iron. That city is huge and extends for a hundred thousand *yojanas*. It is auspicious and is in the shape of a square, with four gates laid out. The walls are made out of gold and rise up ten thousand *yojanas*. It is adorned with sapphires, emeralds and rubies. However, that city is terrible because of large numbers of terrible gods, *danavas*, *gandharvas*, *yakshas*, *rakshasas* and *pannagas*. The eastern gate is auspicious and is decorated with hundreds of flags, diamonds, sapphires, lapis lazuli and pearls. There are large numbers of *gandharvas* and *apsaras* who sing and dance. This entry is meant for gods, *rishis*, *yogis*, *gandharvas*, *siddhas*, *yakshas* and *vidyadharas*. The excellent gate to the north is adorned with bells and whisks. The umbrellas and whisks are laid out and it is ornamented with many kinds of jewels. There are the sounds of *veenas* and flutes and the auspicious sounds of charming songs. Large numbers of sages chant hymns from the Rig, Yajur and Sama Veda. Those who know about *dharma* and are devoted to vows of truth enter through here. So do men who give water during the summer and fire during the winter, those who massage the bodies of those who are exhausted, those who are pleasant in speech, those who are devoted to donations, those who serve their mothers and fathers, those who are engaged in serving *brahmanas* and those who always worship guests. The city has a large gate to the west, studded with jewels. The steps are ornamented with colourful jewels and clubs. There are the sounds of huge drums, smaller drums, conch shells and large drums. There are the constant sounds of large numbers of *siddhas* chanting auspicious hymns. Men who are devoted to Shiva happily enter through this gate. So

do those who have bathed in all the *tirthas*, those who have observed vows of the five fires, brave ones who have died during campaigns, those who have died on Mount Kalanjara, brave ones who have died while saving others from fires, and those who have died for the sake of their masters, friends, people in general, or those who have died while saving cattle. O stores of austerity! These brave men enter through the west gate. The south gate to the city is extremely terrible and causes fear to all beings. There are sounds of lamentation. It is enveloped in darkness and there are sharp horns. ¹⁵²³ Because of thorns, scorpions, snakes and *vajragopas*, ¹⁵²⁴ it is extremely difficult to traverse this. Wolves, tigers, bears, lions, jackals, dogs, cats and vultures, with blazing mouths, always tear at all the evil-doers as they enter through this gate. Those who kill *brahmanas*, cows, children, the aged and the distressed; those who kill those who have sought refuge, or are extremely trusting, or women, friends and those who are unarmed; foolish ones who have intercourse with those whom one should not have intercourse with; those who steal the possessions of others; those who appropriate what has been given in trust; poisoners and arsonists; those who steal land, houses, beds, garments and ornaments belonging to others; cruel people who seek out the weaknesses of others; those who always utter falsehoods; those who cause great miseries in villages, cities and kingdoms; those who bear false witness; those who sell their daughters; those who eat what should not be eaten; those who have intercourse with daughters or daughters-in-law; those who speak harsh words to the mother or the father; and others who have been determined as having committed grave sins—all such people enter through the southern gate.’

Chapter 1(106) (Description of hell)

The sages asked, ‘How do sinners enter the city through the southern gate? O stores of austerity! We wish to hear about this. Please tell us in detail.’

Vyasa replied, ‘I will tell you about that awful gate. It is terrible and extremely terrible. It is full of many kinds of predatory creatures and there are the howls of hundreds of female jackals. It is full of shrieks. It is impossible to traverse and makes the body hair stand up. It is surrounded by *bhutas*, *pretas*, *pishachas* and other *rakshasas*.¹⁵²⁵ Evil-doers see such an extremely terrible gate. They are suddenly overcome by confusion and lament in fear. They are cruelly dragged, bound in chains and nooses. They are repeatedly beaten with sticks and censured. When they regain their senses, they enter through the southern gate, covered in blood and stumbling at every step. There are sharp thorns along the path, which is strewn with gravel. There are rocks that are as sharp as a razor’s edge. Some places are covered with mud. There are moats one cannot cross. Some places have iron needles that are like teeth. In some places, mountains and trees have fallen down and blocked the way. Miserable, they travel along a path covered with burning lumps of coal. In some places, there are dangerous pits. In others, there are extremely slippery rocks. There is sand that is very hot, or there are sharp spikes. Some places have hot iron plates, while others have forest conflagrations. Some places have hot boulders, others are covered with ice. In other places, there is sand and as soon as one enters, one sinks all the way up to one’s neck. Some places are covered with foul water, while others are strewn with blazing husk. Some places have terrible lions, wolves, tigers, gnats and insects. Some places have giant leeches, while others have pythons. Some places have fierce

flies, other places have poisonous snakes. Some places have wicked elephants and horses, crazy because of their strength. In some places, giant bulls with sharp horns dig up the path. Angry and crazy buffaloes with huge horns devour them, as do fierce *dakinis* ¹⁵²⁶ and horrible *rakshasas*. As they proceed, they suffer from extremely terrible ailments. The extremely strong wind is mixed with a huge storm of dust. Large rocks shower down and strike them and they are without any shelter. In some places, as they proceed, they are shattered by bolts of lightning. They are pierced all over with a giant shower of arrows. Thunder and extremely fierce meteors descend on them. As they enter, they are scorched by showers of burning coal. They are shrouded in a great shower of dust and weep. They are repeatedly frightened by the extremely terrible roaring of the clouds. They are crushed by the showering down of arrows everywhere. As they proceed, they are sprinkled by large downpours of alkaline water. There is an extremely cold, harsh and rough wind. It shatters them from every direction, drying them and making them shrivel. Along this path, men may have no provisions to sustain themselves. It is very difficult to pass and they are without a shelter. There is no water in any direction. They suffer from that great exhaustion, but there is no place of refuge. All the foolish embodied evil-doers are conveyed in this way by Yama's extremely powerful messengers, who use force to carry out his commands. They are alone and have no independent will. They are devoid of friends and relatives. They grieve over their own deeds and weep repeatedly. They cannot yet turn into *pretas*. Their throats are parched and their palates are dry. They are emaciated and scared. Those who are not scared are scorched by the flames of hunger. Some are tied in chains, some other are hung downwards. Yama's messengers, fierce in their strength, parch them and drag them along. There are men with their faces hanging downwards. As they are dragged along, they are extremely miserable. Though they ask repeatedly, they are not given food or water. In voices choking with tears, they plead, "Please give. Please give." They are miserable and join their hands in salutation, suffering from hunger and thirst. They can see superior and inferior kinds of food and every kind of drink. There are fragrant

objects. Seeing these, they ask repeatedly. They can see curds, milk and *ghee* mixed with *shali* rice. There are fragrant and cool drinks, and water. On seeing these, they ask. However, Yama's terrible servants have eyes that are red at the ends. They censure them in harsh words. Yama's servants say, "You did not offer oblations at the right time, you did not give to *brahmanas*. When something was given to *brahmanas*, you forcibly stopped that. The fruits of those sins have now appeared. O wicked ones! Earlier, you did not give your property to *brahmanas*. Where is it now? It has not been burnt in fire, it has not perished in water, nor has it not been stolen by kings or bandits. These heaps of rice should be thought of as those donations, which should have been given to virtuous ones full of *sattva*. This food has all the types—*bhokhsya*, *peya*, *lehya* and *choshya*.¹⁵²⁷ Since you never gave these, you will not get these. Food is always brought here and given to those who have offered oblations, performed sacrifices and given to *brahmanas*. O those who will go to *naraka*!¹⁵²⁸ How can we give you what belongs to others?" Hearing the words of the servants, though they still suffer from hunger and thirst, they become indifferent. Yama's servants strike them with terrible weapons—clubs, iron rods, spears, javelins, spikes, bludgeons, catapults, clubs, battle-axes and arrows. Extremely cruel, Yama's messengers strike them from the rear. From the front, lions, tigers and other creatures devour the evil-doers. They can neither get in, nor can they leave, but suffer from great misery. Suffering because of what they themselves have done, the sinners shriek in extremely hideous tones.

'In this way, the men are made to suffer a great deal. Yama's servants then make the sinners enter and take them to the place where Yama himself is present. Yama has *dharma* in his soul. He is the god who ensures *dharma*. He is the one who controls everyone. After having suffered a lot along the path, the men reach the city of the dead. The messengers present them in front of Yama. The evil-doers, perverse in their intelligence, see the terrible one, with his eyes fixed on the sinners. His cruel face is fanged. His forehead is furrowed and his glance is harsh. He has a large beard and his hair stands up. His lower lip throbs. The angry one has eighteen arms and

resembles a mass of blue collyrium. All the weapons are upraised in his hands and he also holds his terrible staff. His eyes are like blazing flames and he is astride a giant buffalo. His garments and garlands are red and he is as lofty as a gigantic cloud. His voice is like the roar of the cloud of universal destruction when it drinks up the great ocean. He seems to devour the three worlds and vomit flames. Mrityu ¹⁵²⁹ is near him, with a complexion like that of the fire of destruction. The terrible Kritanta ¹⁵³⁰ is also there, resembling the fire of universal destruction. The foremost demon, Mahamari, is there and so is the terrible Kalaratri. ¹⁵³¹ There are many kinds of ailments and hardships, in diverse fearful forms. They hold javelins, spears, goads, nooses, *chakras* and swords. They are fierce, holding *vajras*, staffs, razors, quivers and bows. They are known to be cruel and immensely valiant, with complexions like that of collyrium. Yama's messengers are horrible, with every kind of weapon upraised in their hands. He is surrounded by these extremely terrible ones. The sinners see Yama and the terrible Chitragupta. Yama reprimands the sinners a lot. The illustrious Chitragupta enlightens them with words of *dharma*. Chitragupta says, "O performers of evil deeds! O ones who stole the possessions of others! O ones insolent because of beauty and valour! O ones who outraged the wives of others! You will now enjoy the *karma* that you have yourselves done. Why did you perform wicked deeds and bring this calamity on your own selves? Suffering from your own *karma*, why are you lamenting now? Enjoy the miseries you are yourselves responsible for, it is not anyone else's fault. O lords of the earth who have come before me now! You were evil in intelligence and insolent because of your strength, performing terrible deeds. O king wicked in deeds! You were responsible for subjects getting destroyed. For the sake of a kingdom that would last for a short period, why did you perform wicked deeds? Confused by your greed for the kingdom, you used force to unfairly punish subjects. O kings! Enjoy the fruits now. Where is the kingdom and the wife for whom you performed these inauspicious deeds? Abandoning all of that, you are stationed here alone. We cannot see the strength you used to destroy subjects. You have been flung down by Yama's messengers. This is the kind of fruit that has resulted

now.” In this way, Yama also makes them understand with many kinds of words. The evil-doers and kings stand there, grieving and silent. After instructing the kings about their deeds, Dharmaraja himself speaks and states how the sins can be purified. Yama says, “O Chanda! O Mahachanda! Seize these kings. In the fires of one *naraka* after another, purify their sins.” They rise swiftly and seize the kings by their feet. Whirling them with great force, they throw them up and seize them again. Depending on the magnitude of the sin, Yama’s messengers then violently strike them against a flat piece of rock, like the *vajra* striking a large tree. Shattered in this way, they exude streams of blood. The embodied being loses his senses and can no longer move. Touched by the wind, he gradually regains his senses. To purify the sins, the man is then hurled into an ocean of *narakas*.¹⁵³² O Indras among *brahmanas*! Other evil-doing and extremely miserable men are presented before Yama by the messengers. Yama’s messengers say, “O god! Following your instructions, we have brought this extremely deluded person before you. He has always been engaged in great sins and has turned his face away from *dharma*. This one is avaricious and wicked in conduct. He has perpetrated major sins and minor sins too. He is impure and has always engaged in violence. This evil-souled one has had intercourse with those one shouldn’t have intercourse with. He has stolen the possessions of others. This one has sold his daughter and bore false witness. He is ungrateful and has deceived his friends. This one is insolent and has always criticized *dharma*. In the mortal world, this evil-souled one has performed wicked deeds. O lord of the gods! Now tell us whether he should be punished or shown favours. We will not act contrary to what our master asks us to do.” Having placed these evil-doers before the lord of the gods and informing him, the messengers leave to bring other thousands, lakhs and hundreds of crores of men who deserve to go to hell. When the crime committed has been ascertained, Yama instructs his own dreadful servants to punish the evil-doers. The punishment is according to what Vasishtha and others have determined. Angrily, Yama’s servants act so as to extinguish the sins. The sinners are struck and brought down with goads, clubs, staffs, saws, spears, javelins, swords and tridents. There are thousands, lakhs and

hundreds of crores of men destined for hell. Yama's servants make them suffer because of the sins they themselves have accumulated through their deeds.

‘Hear about the nature of these terrible *narakas*—their names and their dimensions. Such men go there. There is a famous *naraka* known as Mahavichi ¹⁵³³ and it is flooded with blood. It extends for ten thousand *yojanas* and is strewn with thorns as tough as the *vajra*. Immersed there, they are crushed and pierced with thorns as tough as the *vajra*. A man who kills a cow suffers in this extremely awful *naraka* for a hundred thousand years. The extremely terrible Kumbhipaka ¹⁵³⁴ extends for ten million *yojanas*. It is full of copper pots and is covered with hot sand and coals. A person who kills a brahmana, steals land or appropriates what is given in trust, is hurled and burnt there until all beings are destroyed in the flood. Rourava ¹⁵³⁵ is enveloped in flames and has iron stakes that are as tough as the *vajra*. It extends for sixty thousand *yojanas*. In that hell, men are impaled with blazing iron stakes. Like sugar cane, ¹⁵³⁶ men who bear false witness are made to suffer there. The *naraka* known as Manjusha ¹⁵³⁷ is made out of blazing iron. Those who have been seized and imprisoned are hurled there and burnt. The *naraka* Apratishtha ¹⁵³⁸ is full of pus, urine and excrement. A person who makes a brahmana suffer falls there, with his head facing downwards. O supreme among *brahmanas*! The *naraka* Lakshaprajvalita ¹⁵³⁹ is dreadful and polluting. A drunkard is immersed there and burnt. The *naraka* known as Mahaprabha ¹⁵⁴⁰ is full of lofty and blazing spears. A person who causes dissension between a husband and a wife is pierced with spears there. The extremely dreadful *naraka* Jayanti ¹⁵⁴¹ is full of rocks made out of iron. There, sinners who associate with the wives of others are struck with these. The *naraka* known as Shalmala ¹⁵⁴² has tough and blazing thorns. A woman who has intercourse with many men has to embrace these and becomes miserable. The tongues of those who always utter falsehoods and hurt others have their tongues plucked out and sliced off by Yama's assistants and servants. Yama's servants use iron spikes to pierce the eyes of those who cast sidelong glances full of attachment towards the wives of others. Those who have intercourse with mothers,

sisters, daughters and daughters-in-law and those who kill women, children and the aged suffer there for as long as there are fourteen Indras.¹⁵⁴³ There is a dreadful *naraka* known as Maharourava¹⁵⁴⁴ that is full of garlands of flames. It extends for fourteen thousand *yojanas*. A foolish man who burns down a city, a field, a home or a village with fire is burnt there for the duration of a *kalpa*. The one known as Tamisra¹⁵⁴⁵ extends for a hundred thousand *yojanas*. It is terrible. Men who are thieves are made to fall down there and are struck by Yama's servants with swords, double-edged swords, clubs, tridents, spears, maces and other swords for the duration of three hundred *kalpas*. The one known as Mahatamisra¹⁵⁴⁶ is double the size of Tamisra. It is full of leeches and snakes and is devoid of light, causing great misery. A person who kills a mother or a father or kills a trusting friend, remains there and is destroyed for as long as the earth lasts. The *naraka* named Asipatravana¹⁵⁴⁷ gives rise to great sorrows. It extends for ten thousand *yojanas* and is full of blazing swords. Having fallen down there, the sinner is struck with hundreds of swords. A person who kills a friend is sliced there, for as long as beings are not destroyed in the deluge. The *naraka* known as Karambavaluka¹⁵⁴⁸ extends for ten thousand *yojanas*. It is in the shape of a well and is surrounded with blazing sand, coal and thorns. Those extremely dreadful people who burn others or always use false pretexts are burnt and pierced there for a hundred and ten thousand and three hundred years. The *naraka* named Kakola¹⁵⁴⁹ is full of worms and pus. Evil-souled ones who eat sweetmeats alone are flung there. The *naraka* named Kudmala¹⁵⁵⁰ is full of urine and blood. Men who do not perform the five sacrifices¹⁵⁵¹ are hurled there. Mahabhima¹⁵⁵² has an extremely foul stench and is full of flesh and blood. Worst among men who are addicted to eating what should not be eaten fall down there. Mahavata¹⁵⁵³ is full of worms, insects and corpses. If a man sells his daughter, he falls down there and is made to hang face downwards. The *naraka* named Tilapaka¹⁵⁵⁴ is extremely dreadful. Those who cause sufferings to others are crushed there, like sesamum seeds. In the *naraka* Tailapaka,¹⁵⁵⁵ the ground is flooded with hot oil. A person who has killed a friend or someone who has sought refuge, is cooked there. The one named Vajrakapata¹⁵⁵⁶ has chains that are like the

vajra. Those who sell milk are made to cruelly suffer there. The one known as Nirucchvasa ¹⁵⁵⁷ has blinding darkness and is devoid of wind. Those who obstruct donations to *brahmanas* are rendered immobile and flung there. The one named Angaropachaya ¹⁵⁵⁸ is dazzling, with burning coal. A person who says he will give something to a *brahmana*, but does not give it, is burnt there. *Naraka* Mahapayi ¹⁵⁵⁹ extends for a hundred thousand *yojanas*. Those who always indulge in false conversations are made to fall down there, heads facing downwards. *Naraka* Mahajvala ¹⁵⁶⁰ is horrible, radiant and blazing. A man with wicked intelligence is burnt there for a very long time. In the *naraka* known as Krakacha, ¹⁵⁶¹ men who are addicted to having intercourse with those one should not have intercourse with, are sliced with fierce saws that are as sharp as the *vajra*. *Naraka* Gudapaka ¹⁵⁶² is surrounded by lakes full of flaming molasses. A man who causes a mixture of the *varnas* is flung there and burnt. *Naraka* Kshuradhara ¹⁵⁶³ is full of sharp razors. Until the end of the *kalpa*, men who steal the land of *brahmanas* are sliced there. The *naraka* known as Ambarisha ¹⁵⁶⁴ is radiant with the fire of universal destruction. A person who steals gold is burnt there for one crore of *kalpas*. The *naraka* named Vajrakuthara ¹⁵⁶⁵ is full of *vajras*. Evil-doers who cut down the shades ¹⁵⁶⁶ of trees are sliced there. The *naraka* known as Paritapa ¹⁵⁶⁷ blazes with the fire of universal destruction. A poisoner or an evil-doer who steals honey ¹⁵⁶⁸ is cooked there. The *naraka* Kalasutra ¹⁵⁶⁹ is fashioned out of strings of *vajra*. Those who plunder the crops of others are whirled around there and sliced. The *naraka* named Kashmala ¹⁵⁷⁰ is full of phlegm and mucus from the nose. Men who are addicted to liquor and flesh are hurled there for the duration of a *kalpa*. *Naraka* Uragandha ¹⁵⁷¹ is full of saliva, urine and excrement. Those who do not offer *pindas* to ancestors are hurled into that *naraka*. The *naraka* named Durdhara ¹⁵⁷² is full of leeches and scorpions. A person who accepts a bribe remains there for ten thousand years. *Naraka* Vajramahapida ¹⁵⁷³ is fashioned out of *vajra*. Those who steal riches, grain, gold and objects belonging to others are flung into this and burnt, tortured by Yama's servants. Yama's messengers use razors to slice those thieves into tiny bits. For foolish ones who kill living beings and eat them, till the end of the

kalpa, Yama's servants make them eat their own flesh, like crows and vultures. If people steal seats, couches and garments belonging to others, like sugar cane, they are crushed there, as are men who bear false witness. The *naraka* described as Ayasa ¹⁵⁷⁴ is made out of blazing iron. Those who seize and imprison others are flung there and burnt. *Naraka Atratishttha* ¹⁵⁷⁵ is full of pus, urine and excrement. Those who criticize the *smṛiti* texts and the Vedas fall there, with their heads facing downwards. The *naraka* known as Parilumpa ¹⁵⁷⁶ is full of vultures, dogs and wolves. Those who kill the young and the aged ¹⁵⁷⁷ are scorched in that terrible place. The *naraka* named Karala ¹⁵⁷⁸ is full of dreadful *pretas*. A person who makes *brahmanas* suffer is devoured by *rakshasas* there. The terrible *naraka* Vilepana ¹⁵⁷⁹ is full of blazing lac. O excellent *brahmanas*! Drunkards are immersed there and burnt. *Naraka Mahapreta* ¹⁵⁸⁰ has a lofty and blazing trident. There, that trident is used to pierce those who cause dissension between a husband and a wife. *Naraka Mahaghora* ¹⁵⁸¹ has a blazing iron slab. A wicked person who has intercourse with another person's wife is dragged on it. The *naraka* known as Shalmali ¹⁵⁸² has a tree with firm and blazing thorns. A man who seeks out the weaknesses of others is made to embrace this and suffers from grief. If people utter lies or truth that hurts others, Yama's assistants and servants pluck out their tongues. Those who have intercourse with mothers, sisters, daughters or daughters-in-law are hurled on masses of burning coals by Yama's servants and burnt. If foolish people take away the *dharma*, ¹⁵⁸³ homes, gold or possessions of others, Yama's messengers pierce them with javelins and spikes. If those with evil intelligence steal fruits and leaves of other men, Yama's angry messengers burn them, like grass being burnt by the fire. If a man with evil intelligence is always attached to the objects or wives of others, Yama's messengers dig out his heart with a blazing trident. If men turn themselves away from *dharma* in deeds, thoughts and words, in Yama's world, they receive terrible and severe hardships. In this way, there are hundreds, thousands, lakhs and hundreds of crores of *narakas*. Men who perform evil deeds go to these. Even if a man does even the slightest bit of something that is inauspicious, he obtains terrible hardships in a *naraka* in Yama's world. Foolish men do not listen to the virtuous words spoken by

Dharma. Instead, they reply, “Who has himself seen all this?” Men who make efforts to perform wicked deeds day and night, those who are confused and deluded and do not follow *dharma*, and those who wish to enjoy fruits in this world and turn themselves away from the world hereafter, are worst among men. They fall into extremely dreadful *narakas*. Residence in *naraka* is terrible, but residence in heaven brings happiness. By undertaking inauspicious and auspicious deeds, men respectively go there.’

Chapter 1(107) (Destination of the virtuous)

The sages said, ‘You have spoken about Yama’s path, which is terrible and extremely miserable. Alas! O excellent one! You have also spoken about the terrible *narakas* and Yama’s gates. O brahmana! Please tell us. Is there any means whereby men can travel along Yama’s extremely terrible path and reach Yama’s abode in happiness?’

Vyasa replied, ‘Men who are full of *dharma*, those who are devoted to non-violence, those who serve their preceptors and those who worship gods and *brahmanas*, along with their wives and sons, proceed from the human world to that place along a path I will tell you about. They travel to Dharmaraja’s city on many kinds of divine *vimanas* that are adorned with diamonds and gold, served by large numbers of *apsaras*. Those who devotedly donate many kinds of objects to *brahmanas* happily travel along that great path. Those who give well-cleaned food to *brahmanas*, in particular those who give to learned *brahmanas* with supreme devotion, proceed to Dharmaraja’s city on ornamented *vimanas* and excellent young women make efforts to serve them. Those who speak the truth and are pure inside and outside, they are said to be like immortals and go to Yama’s abode on *vimanas*. In the name of Vishnu, those who give cattle and other sacred donations to virtuous people who are pure and earn a living with difficulty, know about *dharma*. Those prosperous ones go to Dharmaraja’s city on *vimanas* that have divine complexions and are adorned with wonderful jewels. They are served by large numbers of *apsaras*. Those who give a pair of sandals, an umbrella, a couch, a seat, garments or ornaments proceed to Dharmaraja’s city on chariots drawn by ornamented elephants. Divine silver and gold umbrellas are held above their heads. Those who are pure in their hearts and worship and devotedly give molasses, drinks and

food to foremost *brahmanas*, travel to Yama's abode on many kinds of golden vehicles. As they wish, they are repeatedly served by excellent women. Those who carefully give *brahmanas* pure and well-cleaned milk, *ghee*, curds, molasses and honey go to Yama's abode on golden *vimanas* yoked to *chakravakas*. They are served by *gandharvas* who play musical instruments. Men who give fruits and fragrant flowers travel to Dharma's city on *vimanas* yoked to swans. Those who are full of faith and give learned *brahmanas* or other *brahmanas* sesamum, *tiladhenu* or *ghritadhenu*, go to Vaisvasvata's city on sparkling vehicles that resemble the lunar disc. Beautiful *gandharvas* sing to them. Those who construct tanks, wells, ponds, lakes, large tanks, ponds filled with lotuses and reservoirs full of cool water proceed on vehicles that have the complexion of golden moons, to the sounds of divine bells. Those immensely radiant ones are fanned with fans made out of palm leaves. Those who possess wonderful, auspicious and agreeable temples, with sparkling jewels, for families of gods, go to Dharmaraja's city, full of many kinds of people, on *vimanas* that have the speed of the wind. They are accompanied by guardians of the worlds. Those who donate water, which sustains life for all creatures, happily proceed, devoid of thirst, on *vimanas* that are exceedingly fast. Those who give wooden footwear, vehicles, stools and seats to *brahmanas* travel happily along the path. Those who donate golden and excellent footstools studded with gems leave on *vimanas* ornamented with many *apsaras*. Men who plant colourful pleasure-gardens full of excellent flowers and excellent fruits, cool and beautiful with the shades of trees, thus bringing benefit to men, are served, when they travel, by excellent and ornamented women who sing and dance. Those who give gold, silver, coral and pearls leave on *vimanas* that are golden and radiant. Those who donate land are radiant and every object of their desire is met. They travel of *vimanas* that are like the rising sun and which roar a lot. Those who bestow ornamented maidens on *brahmanas* travel to Yama's abode on *vimanas* and are surrounded by divine women. O excellent *brahmanas*! Those who are full of great devotion and give *brahmanas* fragrances, aloe, camphor, flowers and incense are ornamented and travel to Dharma's city on

colourful vehicles. They are extremely radiant and decorated well, attired in fragrant and excellent garments. Those who donate lamps travel on vehicles that illuminate the ten directions. Those vehicles are as radiant as the fire and resemble the sun. Men who donate houses travel to Dharmaraja's residence in houses that are ornamented with gold and resemble the rising sun. Those who give vessels for water, pitchers and pots for washing the head ¹⁵⁸⁴ are worshipped by *apsaras* and travel on proud and large elephants. Those who give *brahmanas* oil for the feet, oil for the head, water for bathing and water for drinking travel to Yama's abode on horses. Those who offer rest to suffering and exhausted brahmana travelers go happily on vehicles yoked to *chakravakas*. Those who welcome and worship *brahmanas*, offering them seats, are extremely content and travel happily along the path. A man who greets Hari with the words "I bow down to the divinity who is devoted to *brahmanas*" or addresses a cow as "O destroyer of sins", travels happily along that path. A person who is devoid of insolence and falsehood and eats only after others have, travels along the path on a vehicle yoked to cranes. A person who eats only once a day and is devoid of deceit and insolence, happily travels to Yama's abode on a vimanas yoked to swans. A person who conquers his senses and eats only once in four days, goes to Dharma's city on a vehicle yoked to peacocks. A person who is controlled in his vows and eats only on every third day, travels to the destination on vehicles and divine chariots drawn by elephants. If a pure person conquers his senses and eats only once in every six days, he travels to Dharmaraja's city on a chariot drawn by elephants, as if he is Shachi's consort himself. He is adorned with many beautiful jewels and there are many kinds of sounds that pronounce his victory. A person who fasts for a fortnight travels to Dharmaraja's city on a vehicle yoked to tigers, served by gods and *asuras*. A person who controls his senses and fasts for a month travels to Yama's abode on a vehicle that is as radiant as the sun. A person who is single-minded and firm in his vows is served by noble *gandharvas* and travels on a vehicle that is as radiant as the sun. A person who purifies his body by being completely fixed on Vishnu in his *atman*, goes to heaven astride a chariot that has the complexion of the fire.

Devoted to Narayana, if a person enters the fire, he travels to Yama's abode on a *vimana* that resembles the fire. If a mortal man fasts and remembering Vishnu, gives up his life, he goes to Dharma's city on a vehicle that is like the fire. If a man enters the water and gives up his life, he happily travels on a vehicle that is like the lunar disc. Devoted to Vishnu, if a man offers his body to vultures, he travels to Yama's abode on an excellent and golden chariot. If a man dies while preventing the seizure of women or cattle, or if he dies in a battle, he travels on a vehicle that is as radiant as the sun, served by immortal maidens. If a person devoted to Vishnu conquers his senses and travels to *tirthas*, he is ornamented and happily travels along that terrible path on vehicles. O best among *brahmanas*! If a person performs sacrifices and gives away copious quantities of *dakshina*, he happily travels on a *vimana* that resembles molten gold. A person who does not cause suffering to others and sustains his servants, he happily travels on a *vimana* that is as radiant as gold. If a person is forgiving towards all creatures, if he grants beings freedom from fear, if he is free of anger and confusion, if he is not arrogant and if he controls his senses, he travels on an extremely radiant *vimana* that resembles the full moon. When he travels to Vaivasvata's city, he is served by gods and *gandharvas*. If a person is full of purity and single-mindedly worships Vishnu, Brahma, Tryambaka or Ravi, he reaches instantly. If a man is full of truth, purity and compassion and does not eat flesh, he travels happily to Dharmaraja's city. Among all the food that can be eaten, there is nothing sweeter than meat. Therefore, meat must not be eaten. Happiness does not result from sweet things. In ancient times, Brahma, supreme among those who know about the *brahman*, said, "A person who donates one thousand cows and a person who does not eat meat are equal." O *brahmanas*! Therefore, the benefits of not eating flesh are the same as the merits for visiting all the *tirthas* and the fruits from all the sacrifices. In this way, those who are devoted to *dharma* and are devoted to the vow of donating, happily travel on vehicles to Yama's world, to the place where the god, who is Ravi's son, resides.

'On seeing those who are devoted to *dharma*, the divinity honours them himself. He lovingly welcomes them and gives them a seat, *padya* and

arghya. “O great-souled ones! You are blessed. You have caused great benefit to your own selves. You have performed these good deeds for the sake of divine happiness. Ascend this *vimana*, ornamented with divine women and objects of pleasure. Go to heaven, which is unmatched and possesses all the objects of desire. Enjoy those great objects of pleasure until your store of auspicious deeds is exhausted. After this, come here and enjoy the fruits of whatever trifling inauspicious acts you have performed.” Men who are pure in their sentiments see Dharmaraja’s amiable aspect, as if he is like their own father. Therefore, one must always serve *dharma*. It confers the fruit of emancipation. *Artha*, *kama* and *moksha* are described as flowing from *dharma*. *Dharma* is the father, the mother and the brother. *Dharma* is the lord and well-wisher. *Dharma* is the master, friend, protector, creator and nourisher. *Artha* flows from *dharma*. *Kama* flows from *artha*. Objects of pleasure and happiness flow from *kama*. Single-minded attention to *dharma* leads to prosperity. A supreme destination in heaven results from *dharma*. O *brahmanas*! The serving of *dharma* saves from great fear. There is no doubt that the state of being a god and the state of being a *brahmana* result from *dharma*. O supreme *brahmanas*! When the sins men formerly accumulated are exhausted, the mind turns to *dharma*. After thousands of lives as other species, one obtains the extremely rare state of being human. Therefore, a person who does not follow *dharma* is indeed deceiving himself. Know that the despised, the poor, the disfigured, the diseased and those who are the servants of others are devoid of *dharma*.¹⁵⁸⁵ Those who have long lifespans, those who are brave, those who are learned, those who enjoy objects of pleasure, those who are wealthy and those who are handsome—such people have practised *dharma* earlier. O *brahmanas*! In this way, those who are devoted to *dharma* go to the supreme destination. Those who practise *adharma* are born as inferior species. If men are devoted to Vasudeva, Yama is incapable of harming them even in *naraka*. They do not see him even in their sleep. He is the divinity who slays *daityas* and *danavas*. He has no beginning and no end. Men who constantly bow down to him do not see Yama. If people seek refuge in him in their thoughts, words and deeds, Yama is incapable of depriving them the fruit of

emancipation. O *brahmanas*! Narayana is the protector of the universe. Those who constantly bow down before him go to Vishnu's abode. Those who prostrate themselves before Vishnu never see Yama's messengers or city, that path, or *naraka*. If a man is confounded and performs a lot of sins, as long as he bows down before Hari, the destroyer of all sins, he does not go to *naraka*. If a man is a deceiver, but constantly remembers Janardana, when he gives up his body, he goes to Vishnu's world, where there is no disease. Even if a person chants Hari's name when he is excessively angry, all his sins are destroyed and he obtains emancipation, just as the lord of Chedi ¹⁵⁸⁶ did.'

Chapter 1(108) (Cycle of *samsara*)

Lomaharshana continued, ‘After hearing about the path to Yama and the miseries of *naraka*, the excellent sages again asked Vyasa about their doubts.’

The sages asked, ‘O illustrious one! O one who knows about every kind of *dharma*! O one who is accomplished in all the sacred texts! Who is the aide to a mortal person? When the residence that is the body is given up, the father, the mother, sons, preceptors, kin, matrimonial allies and the large number of friends are people who are like a piece of wood or a clod of earth. When they return to this world, who follows him?’

Vyasa replied, ‘O *brahmanas*! A person is born alone and he dies alone. He has to traverse the impassable path alone. He has to face the hardships alone. The father, the mother, brothers, sons, preceptors, kin, matrimonial allies and the large number of friends are no aides. These people are like a piece of wood or a clod of earth. They abandon the dead body. They weep for a short while and then turn their faces away. When the body has been cast away, one has to follow *dharma* alone. Therefore, men must always follow *dharma*. That is the aide. A being who is full of *dharma* obtains the supreme destination of heaven. In that way, a being who is full of *adharma* obtains *naraka*. That is the reason a learned person is not delighted with wealth earned through sin. It has been said that *dharma* alone is the aide for men. Because of greed, confusion, compassion, fear and other things, even an extremely learned person may be driven by greed and confusion and perform acts to obtain the possessions of others. *Dharma*, *artha* and *kama*—these are the three that yield fruits in a life. These three must be obtained after one has given up *adharma*.’

The sages said, ‘O illustrious one! We have heard the extremely beneficial words you have spoken about *dharma*. Our minds now wish to know about the accumulation that is the body. When a man’s body dies, he passes into a subtle and unmanifest form. This is a form that cannot be discerned with the eyes. How does *dharma* follow him?’

Vyasa replied, ‘The earth, wind, space, water, fire and the *atman*—together, these can always see *dharma*. Night and day, they are witnesses to every being in this world. Along with them, *dharma* follows the *jivatman*. O excellent *brahmanas*! The *jivatman* gives up the body, consisting of skin, bones, flesh, semen and blood. A *jivatman* united with *dharma* obtains happiness in this world and in the world hereafter. What else will I tell you about?’

The sages said, ‘O illustrious one! You have spoken about how *dharma* follows. We wish to know about this. How does semen result?’

Vyasa replied, ‘O supreme *brahmanas*! The divinities of earth, wind, space, water and fire who are in the body and the mind consume the food. O *brahmanas*! The five elements are, thus, satisfied. The mind is the sixth. The great semen is generated in this way and it is the pure *atman*. O *brahmanas*! The union of man and women then results in the fetus. I have, thus, told you everything. What else do you wish to hear?’

The sages said, ‘O illustrious one! You have told us how the fetus is created. You should tell us how the being results from this.’

Vyasa replied, ‘The being results when it is overwhelmed by the elements. When the elements are separated, the being again proceeds to the supreme destination. Life is obtained by being united with the elements and the divinities of the five elements watch over his *karma*, auspicious and inauspicious. What else do you wish to hear?’

The sages said, ‘O illustrious one! Having cast aside skin, bones and flesh and having been separated from the elements, when he enjoys joy and misery, where is the being located?’

Vyasa replied, ‘O *brahmanas*! When the semen arrives and quickly unites with the woman’s ovulation, at that time, the *jivatman* is united with his *karma*.¹⁵⁸⁷ He is made to suffer hardships by Yama’s servants and Yama’s

servants strike him. ¹⁵⁸⁸ The man then suffers misery and hardships in the cycle of *samsara*. O *brahmanas*! Since birth, if a being performs good deeds in this world, he enjoys the fruits of that *dharma*. Since birth, if a man has always been united with *dharma*, he is always served by happiness. Alternatively, if the being has sometimes practised *dharma* and sometimes practised *adharma*, he experiences happiness alternating with unhappiness. When a person united with *adharma* goes to Yama's kingdom, he suffers from great miseries and is born as inferior species. One's *karma* determines what species one is born as. Now hear about a being who is united with confusion. This has been spoken about in the sacred texts of *itihasa* and the Vedas. After Yama's terrible kingdom, he comes to the world of the mortals. O *brahmanas*! In this world, there are sacred spots that are like those of the gods. That apart, there are places the inferior species go to. O *brahmanas*! Yama's residence has qualities that are like those of Brahma's world. Restrained by the bonds of *karma*, beings also experience miseries.'

'Depending on sentiments and *karma*, a man attains dreadful ends. If a brahmana has studied the four Vedas, but is so deluded that he receives donations from a fallen person, he is born as an ass. O *brahmanas*! He lives as an ass for fifteen years. Having died as an ass, he is born as a bull and lives for seven years. Having died as a bull, he is born as a brahma-*rakshasa*. ¹⁵⁸⁹ After having been a brahma-*rakshasa* for three months, he is born as a brahmana. A person who performs a sacrifice for a fallen person is born as a worm. O *brahmanas*! He lives in that form for fifteen years. When he is released from his form as a worm, he is born as a donkey. He is a donkey for five years, a pig for five years, a cock for five years, a jackal for five years and a dog for one year. After this, he is born as a human. When a jealous man dies, he is born as a horned animal. An evil-minded person who betrays trust is born as a fish. O *brahmanas*! After having remained as a fish for eight years, he is born as a deer. After having been a deer for four months, he is born as a goat. After a full one year is over, he dies as a goat. The being is then born as an insect and later, as human. A mortal man whose senses are confounded steals paddy, sesamum, beans, gram, mustard,

chickpeas, legumes, kidney beans, wheat, linseed and other kinds of grain. O best among sages! That shameless person is born as a rat. O best among sages! After he dies, he is born as a pig. As soon as he is born as a pig, he dies because of a disease. He is then born as a dog and next, as a dumb human. After this, for five years, he is again born as a dog. A man who has intercourse with another person's wife is born as a wolf, a dog, a jackal, a vulture, a snake, a heron and a crane. O *brahmanas*! If a confounded and evil-souled person seduces his brother's wife, he becomes a male cuckoo for one year. If a person is overwhelmed by desire and seduces his friend's wife, his preceptor's wife or the king's wife, when he dies, he is born as a pig. He is a pig for five years, a crane for ten years, an ant for three months and an insect for a month. After having gone through this, he returns to *samsara* in the form of a worm. He lives in the form of a worm for fourteen months. When the man's *adharma* has been exhausted, he is born as a human. If a person has promised his daughter to someone but wishes to bestow her on someone else instead; or if an intelligent disciple perpetrates a sin against his instructor; there is no doubt that he has three births in *samsara*. O *brahmanas*! These are a dog, a predatory creature and an ass. After the sins are exhausted, once he dies, he is born as a brahmana. If a disciple performs a wicked act towards his preceptor's wife, even if done mentally, his mind is full of *adharma* and he has performed a fierce act in *samsara*. Therefore, he is born as a dog and lives in that form for three years. When he dies in that form, he is born as a worm. Having become a worm, he lives in that state for one year. When he dies, he is born as a brahmana. A disciple is like a son. Acting willfully, if a preceptor kills a disciple without any reason, he is born as a fierce creature. O *brahmanas*! If a son shows disrespect towards his father or mother, when he dies, he is first born as a donkey. Having become a donkey, he lives in that form for ten years. After this, that man is born as a crocodile for one year. If a son causes rage in his father or mother, or if a person does not pay attention to his preceptor's instructions, when he dies, he is born as a donkey. He lives in the form of a donkey for two years. After this, for seven months, that man is born as a cat. A man who abuses his father or mother is born as a

sarika bird. O *brahmanas*! If he strikes his parents, he is born as a tortoise. He remains a tortoise for ten years and a porcupine for three years. He then becomes a snake for six months. After this, he is born as a human. If a person has accepted his subsistence from his master, the king, but acts so as to harm him, he is full of delusion. When he dies, he is born as a monkey. He is a monkey for ten years, a rat for seven years and a dog for six months. After this, he is born as a human. If a man misappropriates something left with him in trust, once he has gone to Yama's dominion, he goes through one hundred births in *samsara*. After this, he is born as a worm. O *brahmanas*! He lives as a worm for fifteen years. When his evil deeds have been exhausted, he is born as a human. O *brahmanas*! If he is born as a worm for some other reason, he lives in that form for thirteen years. O supreme *brahmanas*! When his *adharma* is exhausted, he is released and born as human. If a person does not perform the acts of the gods or the ancestors, if he does not offer oblations to the gods or the ancestors, when he dies, he is born as a crow. After one hundred years as a crow, he is born as a cock. He is next born as a snake for one month. After this, he becomes human. An elder brother is like a father. If a person does not show him respect, when he dies, he is born as a heron. He lives as a heron for ten years and then becomes a *jivaka* bird.¹⁵⁹⁰ When he dies, he becomes a human. If a *vrishala*¹⁵⁹¹ has intercourse with a brahmana woman, he is born as a worm. When he dies in that form, he is born again as a pig. O *brahmanas*! As soon as he has been born as a pig, he dies because of a disease. O *brahmanas*! Because of his deeds, that foolish person is then born as a dog. He becomes a dog because of what he has done. After that, he is born as a human and has offspring. However, when he dies, he is born as a rat. O *brahmanas*! When an ungrateful person dies, he goes to Yama's kingdom. In Yama's kingdom, he is bound and those cruel ones make him undergo hardships. They strike him with staffs, clubs, tridents and extremely terrible rods that are on fire. He goes to the dreadful Asipatravana and to Shalmali, thickly covered with sand. O *brahmanas*! Having reached Yama's kingdom, there are many other terrible sufferings he has to go through. When he returns to the wheel of *samsara*, he is born as a worm. O

brahmanas! For fifteen years, he remains as a worm. The man then enters a womb, but dies in the womb. After this, the being goes through many hundreds of conceptions. Having come to *samsara* many times, he is born as inferior species. In this way, he undergoes hardships for a large number of years. When he is born again, he is born as a tortoise. A person who steals curds is born as a crane that swims. An evil-minded person who steals unclean fish is born as a honeybee. A person who steals a fruit, a root or a cake is born as an ant. A person who steals winnowed corn faces the consequence of being born as a rat. A person who steals *payasam* is born as a partridge. A person who steals a cake stuffed with sweetmeats is born as a thief. ¹⁵⁹² An evil-minded man who steals water is born as a crow. An evil-minded man who steals copper is born as a green parrot. A person who steals a silver vessel is born as a pigeon. A person who steals a golden vessel is born as a worm. A person who steals a silken garment is born as an osprey. A man who steals a silkworm is born as a dancer. A man who steals silk is born as a parrot. When a man who steals a girdle dies, he is born as a swan. When a man who steals cotton dies, he is born as a curlew. O *brahmanas*! A man who steals a woolen garment is born as a sheep. A man who steals a silken garment is born as a hare. When a man who steals aromatic powder dies, he is born as a peacock. A person who steals a red garment is born as a *jivajivaka*. O *brahmanas*! A man who steals dyes and fragrances is full of greed and becomes a mole. He lives in that form for fifteen years. When his *adharma* has been exhausted, he is again born as a human. A person who steals milk is born as a crane. O *brahmanas*! A man who steals oil is full of delusion. When he dies, he becomes a creature that drinks oil. ¹⁵⁹³ For wealth or enmity, if a man uses weapons to kill a person who is unarmed, he is the worst among men. When he dies, he is born as an ass. He lives as an ass for two years and is killed by weapons. When he dies, he is born as a deer and constantly suffers with anxiety. After a year has passed, the deer is pierced by a weapon. When the deer dies, he is born as fish that is captured in a net. In the fourth month after this, he is born as a beast of prey. He lives as a beast of prey for ten years and as a tiger for five years. When he dies, in the course of time, his understanding is awakened.

With his *adharma* exhausted, he is born as a human. A person who steals a musical instrument is born as a jackal. A man who steals food mixed with oilcakes is born as a fierce and tawny rat. O best among *brahmanas*! This evil-souled one always bites men. An evil-minded person who steals ghee is born as a crow or a cormorant. A man who steals meat and fish is born as a crow. A person who steals salt is born as a cricket. When a man who appropriates something left with him in trust dies, he is born as a fish. He dies in the form of a fish and then becomes human. However, though born as a human, he has a short lifespan. O *brahmanas*! If a man performs wicked deeds, he is born as inferior species. He does not know anything about the nature of *dharma*. Evil men who constantly neglect vows face joys and miseries, but are diseased. There is no doubt that such wicked people are born as *mlecchas*. Men who are evil in conduct are full of greed and delusion. Men who avoid wicked deeds since the time of their birth are free from disease, handsome and wealthy. Women who perform wicked deeds are thought to become the wives of wicked people. I have generally told you everything about the sins of stealing. O bulls among *brahmanas*! However, I have only given you a brief indication. O *brahmanas*! In ancient times, the immensely fortunate Brahma was asked about this in an assembly of gods and *rishis* and I heard that conversation. I have told you everything that was described then. O best among sages! Having heard this, make up your minds to follow *dharma*.'

Chapter 1(109) (Donation of food)

The sages said, ‘O brahmana! O unblemished one! You have spoken to us about *adharma*. O supremely eloquent one! We now wish to hear about the progress of *dharma*. How do those who perform wicked deeds obtain inauspicious ends? Through what deeds does one obtain an auspicious end?’

Vyasa replied, ‘Under the influence of *adharma*, if a person performs wicked deeds, his mind is perverse and he goes to hell. However, having followed *adharma* because of delusion, if a person repents, with his mind fixed on *samadhi*, he no longer performs wicked deeds. As his mind gradually condemns his wicked deeds, progressively, his body is freed from *adharma*. O brahmanas! If he tells brahmanas who speak about *dharma* about his acts of *adharma*, he is swiftly freed from those crimes. When a man fixes his mind and speaks about proper *dharma*, he is progressively released. This is just like a snake casting aside the skin it has formerly enjoyed. If a man controls his mind, immerses it in *samadhi* and donates many kinds of objects to brahmanas, he obtains the destination of heaven. O excellent brahmanas! Even if a man has committed perverse deeds, if he gives donations, he is united with *dharma*. I will tell you about this. Among all kinds of donations, the donation of food is said to be the best. An upright person who desires *dharma* must give all kinds of food. The life of humans is based on food and it is through this that creatures are born. The worlds are established in food. Therefore, food is praised. The gods, *rishis*, ancestors and humans praise food. By donating food, a man goes to heaven. Excellent food, obtained through legitimate means, must be given to brahmanas. With a happy mind, this must be given to those who are engaged in self-studying. With a happy mind, even if a person feeds ten

brahmanas only once, he does not become inferior species. O supreme *brahmanas*! If he feeds ten thousand *brahmanas*, even if he has always been engaged in wicked deeds, a man is freed from *adharma*. If a person who knows about the *Vedas* uses food obtained as alms, invites a *brahmana* and gives this to the *brahmana* engaged in self-studying, he obtains happiness. O *brahmanas*! If a *kshatriya* does not cause injury to *brahmanas*, properly protects them, controls himself and gives food that has been obtained to *brahmanas* who know the *Vedas*, he has *dharma* in his soul. All his wicked deeds are destroyed. If a *vaishya* gives *brahmanas* what he has obtained through agriculture, after one-sixth has been taken away, ¹⁵⁹⁴ he is freed from sins. If a *shudra* gives *brahmanas* food obtained at the risk of life, even if this means treating his body harshly, ¹⁵⁹⁵ he is freed from sins. If a person gives *brahmanas* food not obtained by birth, ¹⁵⁹⁶ not obtained through force and not obtained through violence, he never has to face hardships. A person must happily give food obtained through legitimate means to aged *brahmanas* who know about the *Vedas*. He will then be freed from sins. Food brings energy to the worlds and a man who donates it becomes energetic. If one follows the path indicated by the virtuous, one is freed from all sins. The path created by donations is the path along which the learned have travelled. Among all donors, the one who donates food follows eternal *dharma*. In every kind of situation, a man must give food obtained through legitimate means. Food obtained through legitimate means always leads to the supreme destination. By donating food, a man reaches the supreme destination. After death, he obtains the happiness that is characterized by every kind of object of desire. In this way, a man is full of the auspicious and is freed from sins. Therefore, food earned through legitimate means must be given. A householder must always eat food after offering oblations to *prana*. ¹⁵⁹⁷ Instead of rendering the day futile, a man must offer donations of food. If a man always feeds one hundred who are supremely learned in the *Vedas*, learned about *nyaya*, learned about *dharma* and learned about *itihasa*, he does not have to go to terrible *naraka*. Nor does he return to *samsara*. After death, he obtains happiness characterized by all the objects of desire. If he acts in this way, he

is without anxiety and enjoys himself. He is handsome, famous and wealthy. O *brahmanas*! I have told you everything about the great fruits from donations of food, which form the foundation for all donations and *dharma*.'

Chapter 1(110) (*Shraddha* rituals)

The sages asked, ‘Those who have left for the world hereafter reside in places determined by their own *karma*. How should their *shraddha* be performed by sons and other relatives?’

Vyasa replied, ‘I bow down to Jagannatha Varaha, the creator of the worlds. Listen. I will tell you about *shraddha*, as it has been described. O excellent *brahmanas*! In ancient times, the ancestors were submerged in the waters of the Koka. ¹⁵⁹⁸ The lord and divinity performed a *shraddha* for them there and saved them.’

The sages asked, ‘Why were the ancestors submerged in the waters of the Koka? O supreme *brahmana*! How did Varaha save them in that *tirtha* of Kokamukha, which yields the fruits of objects of desire and emancipation? We are extremely curious and wish to hear. Please tell us.’

Vyasa replied, ‘The ancestors are divine humans. In ancient times, along with the Vishvadevas, during the *sandhya* between *treta* yuga and *dvapara* yuga, they were on the slopes of Mount Meru. While they were seated there, a maiden who was Soma’s daughter appeared before them. She was divine and beautiful. Joining her hands in salutation, she stood before them. The ancestors spoke to the divine one who had appeared there. The ancestors asked, “O fortunate one! Who do you belong to? Who is your lord? You should tell us about this.” Thus, addressed by the divine ancestors, she replied, “I am Kala. I am Chandra’s daughter. As I wish, I can choose you as my masters. Urja is my first name and the second name is Svadha. Today, you have thought of the name Koka for me.” Hearing her words, the ancestors, the divine humans, glanced towards her face. But they were not satisfied. The Vishvadevas got to know that they were glancing towards the maiden’s face. Realizing that they had deviated from yoga, they

abandoned them and left for heaven. The illustrious one with the cool rays was unable to see his daughter, Urja. Anxious in his mind, he wondered. “Where has the immensely illustrious one gone?” Through the power of his austerity, Soma got to know that the ancestors had looked at her with eyes of desire and had accepted her in their hearts. O *brahmanas*! Shashadhara ¹⁵⁹⁹ was extremely angry at the ancestors and cursed them, “You will lose your senses, deviate from yoga and fall down. You have been extremely foolish. You have looked at my daughter with eyes of desire, even though she has not been bestowed on you. Had she been virtuous, she would have shown respect towards her father. Instead, she has independently accepted you as her husbands. She has given up *dharma* and will, therefore, become a river. She will flow in the cold mountains and will be known in the worlds as Koka.” In this way, the ancestors, the divine humans, were cursed by Chandramas. Dislodged from yoga, they fell down on the foothills of the Himalayas. Urja also fell down on the extensive king among mountains, at the supreme *tirtha* that was the confluence of seven oceans. She was a river named Koka, with a strong flow, and there were hundreds of *tirthas* along her banks. Along with other rivers, she flowed from the summit of the mountain and was known as Sarit. ¹⁶⁰⁰ O *brahmanas*! Separated from yoga, the ancestors saw the great river with the cool water. However, they did not recognize the one with the beautiful eyes. The king of the mountains saw that they were suffering from hunger. He instructed a *badari* tree and a cow to yield flows of honey. There was milk, honey, divine water from Koka and *badari* fruit. The supreme mountain decided that this would be the means of subsistence. O excellent sages! The ancestors resided there, using this as sustenance. Ten thousand years passed as if it was but a single day. The world was without the ancestors and Svadha had also left. The *daityas*, *yatudhanas* and *rakshasas* became strong. The *daityas* and *yatudhanas* saw that the large number of ancestors had been separated from the Vishvadevas. From every direction, they attacked them with force. The ancestors saw that the *daityas* and *yatudhanas* were descending on them. They angrily seized a lofty boulder and stood on the banks of Koka. When they seized the boulder, Koka used the force of her water to hide the

ancestors and flooded the Himalayas. The *daityas* and *rakshasas* saw that the ancestors had vanished and climbed up Vibhitaka. ¹⁶⁰¹

‘Hidden in the waters, the ancestors had no food. They grieved and suffered from hunger and thirst. They saw that they were miserable inside the water. The ancestors chanted hymns to the god Janardana and sought refuge with Hari. The ancestors said, “Victory to Govinda. Victory to the abode of the universe. O Keshava! We seek your favours. O Janardana! O one who is unblemished in his powers! You should save us from inside the water. O lord! O one who should be worshipped! O Vaikuntha! O Varaha! O Vishnu! O Narayana, the lord of everything! O lord of all the great lords! The roamers in the night are terrible to behold and we are scared. Please save us. O Upendra! O Yogi! O slayer of Madhu and Kaitabha! O Vishnu! O Ananta! O Achyuta! O Vasudeva! O prosperous one! O one who holds the Sharnga bow, the *chakra*, the lotus and the conch shell in his hands! O lord of the gods! Save us from the *rakshasas*. You are the father of the universe. O Shambhu! The large numbers terrible of roamers in the night are incapable of countering you. We seek refuge with you. As soon as your name is chanted, the roamers in the night and other demons run away. O Vishnu! They head towards destruction, and dharma and truth become important.” Thus, praised by the ancestors, the one who holds up the earth assumed the divine form of a boar. The god saw the ancestors submerged in the waters in Kokamukha, holding the boulder on their heads. In the form of a boar, Janardana saw them submerged in the water. Vishnu made up his mind to save the terrified ancestors. Using the tip of his tusks, the boar hurled the boulder away. The lord gathered up the ancestors from under the rock. As soon as they touched the boar’s body, the ancestors became as radiant as gold. Thus, in Kokamukha, God Vishnu removed their reason for fear. In that *tirtha* to Vishnu, in the form of a boar, the god saved the ancestors.’

‘Controlling himself, in the place known as Lohargala, ¹⁶⁰² Vishnu offered them water. Keshava took some *kusha* grass that had generated from his own body hair and sesamum seeds produced from his own sweat. In that desired *tirtha*, he created an excellent firebrand that was as radiant as the

sun and a vessel. He stood under the gigantic *vata* tree and used the pure waters of the Ganga. From the lofty summit, he gathered the juices of herbs used in sacrifices. He brought honey, milk, fragrances, flowers, incense and unguents. He obtained a cow from the lake and jewels from the ocean. He marked the earth with his tusks and sprinkled it with water from his sweat. He marked the earth with *kusha* grass and repeatedly marked it again with the firebrand. The tips of the *kusha* grass faced the east, while the other ends were in his body hair. He summoned the *rishis* and asked for their permission to offer oblations to the ancestors. When they agreed, the lord used *mantras* to summon the Vishvadevas. The lord gave them seats. Hari invoked them in accordance with *mantras* and rites mentioned in the Vedas. The one who wields the *chakra* and the mace, offered *akshata* for the protection of the gods. *Akshata*, barley and herbs have been generated from the portions of all the gods. They protect all the directions. That is the reason they are used for purposes of protection. Gods, *danavas*, *daityas*, *rakshasas*, *yakshas* and mobile and immobile objects are incapable of doing anything to those who are, thus, protected. Since they have not been harmed by anyone, they are known as *akshata*.¹⁶⁰³ In ancient times, Vishnu earmarked these for the protection of the gods. The boar offered *kusha*, fragrances, barley, flowers and *arghya*. He progressively offered them to all the Vishvadevas and sought their permission. ‘I invoke the ancestors, those who are divine and those who are humans.’ When they agreed to be invoked, he invoked them in that sacred way. The one who knew about the Vedas held the *darbha* grass and sesamum at the base of the fingers.¹⁶⁰⁴ He placed his left hand on his left knee and offered them seats. Varaha placed his right hand on his right knee and used *mantras* to invoke the ancestors.¹⁶⁰⁵ To protect himself on the left, he uttered the *apahata mantra*.¹⁶⁰⁶ Having performed the invocation, he pronounced the names and *gotras* of the ancestors. After this, Varaha pronounced the *mantra* to make the ancestors and *brahmanas* prosperous.¹⁶⁰⁷ He pronounced *mantras* used for annual rites and spread out the *arghya* for them. ‘Let these immortal words make the father of my father remain here.’¹⁶⁰⁸ I offer this *arghya* to my paternal grandfather, to the one who was my paternal grandfather. I offer this *arghya*

to my paternal great grandfather, to the one who was my paternal grandfather.’ He offered the mixture of *kusha*, fragrances and sesamum to the right. Thereafter, Janardana repeated the process for his maternal grandfather. Devotedly, he again worshipped them with fragrances and incense. Pronouncing *mantras* to the Adityas, the Vasus and the Rudras, the lord of the universe worshipped them and offered them food in the form of *ghee*, sesamum and *kusha*. He placed this in the decreed vessel and sought the permission of the sages. ‘Shall I offer oblations into the fire?’ They granted him permission to proceed. He offered three oblations, to Soma, Agni and Yama. He uttered the seven undecaying *shlokas* from the Yajur Veda, *ye mamaka* and so on. ¹⁶⁰⁹ O *brahmanas*! Mentioning the name and the *gotra*, he offered the remaining oblations to each of the three ancestors. ¹⁶¹⁰ He then placed the remaining part of the food in the vessel meant for *pinda*. He first offered *ghee* mixed with honey as food for the gods, next to the ancestors, in the vessel meant for the *pinda*. With single-minded attention, he offered succulent and tasty food, along with *payasam*, to the *brahmanas*. The food had a little bit of vegetables and a lot of fruit. It possessed the six flavours and was like *amrita*. ¹⁶¹¹ He pronounced *mantras* to the earth, *madhuvata* and so on. ¹⁶¹² When the *brahmanas* started to eat, he chanted the five *mantras* that begin with *yatte*. ¹⁶¹³ Though he did not chant a lot, he did chant *trimadhu* and *trisuparna* from *Brihadaranyaka*. He also chanted the *soura sukta* and the *purusha sukta*. ¹⁶¹⁴ When they had eaten, he asked the *brahmanas* whether they were satisfied. When they said they were satisfied, he gave them water so that they could break their silence. He offered the vessel for the *pinda* to the shadow. ¹⁶¹⁵ He divided the food into two parts, and each of those parts into three parts again. Next, Varaha marked out the ground and covered it with *kusha* grass. He turned the blades of the *kusha* grass towards the south and spread out a seat on this. Devotedly, he placed the sesamum and the roots on the *kusha* and adding fragrances and flowers, placed these on the *pinda*. ‘May the earth hold this.’ Saying this, he gave the *pinda* to his paternal grandfather and his paternal great grandfather, who were in the firmament. The boar also gave the *pinda* to his maternal grandfather. When the offering of *pinda* is

complete, the remaining food is to be enjoyed as *lepa*.¹⁶¹⁶ ‘This is for the ancestors.’ Saying this, he devotedly offered a new, white and washed cloth that was two finger-lengths in size. Offering fragrances and flowers, he performed *pradakshina*. After this, one should sip water from the palm of one’s hand. However, before doing this, *brahmanas*, ancestors and gods must be made to sip water first. Along with flowers and *akshata*, the ground must be sprinkled with water. Sesamum and water must first be offered to the ancestors. Sesamum, water and *akshata* must next be offered to the ancestors. ‘May we never decay.’ This must be said to the ancestors. ‘May you be pleased.’ This must be said to the gods. When they are pleased, he must retreat and perform *japa* thrice with *aghamarshana*. Having retreated, he must perform *japa* with *janme*.¹⁶¹⁷ ‘O ancestors! Give us homes that are full of wealth and riches.’ ‘May these bear energy.’ Saying this, he placed the sacred vessel for the *arghya* and *pinda* in the waters of Koka. Using cold milk, honey and sesamum, he offered water to the ancestors. After offering water to the ancestors on that solar day, the god who holds the club gave silver and *dakshina* to *brahmanas*. They said, ‘May you be fortunate.’ They also said, ‘Divide what has been left among humans.’ He asked the best among *brahmanas*, ‘Is everything complete?’ They replied that it had been. He asked, ‘Are you pleased?’ They replied that they were. He asked the *brahmanas* about the remaining food and they said, ‘Along with your followers, eat it.’ He held them by the hand and led them outside the altar. He used his right hand to sprinkle his mass of hair with water from Kotitirtha¹⁶¹⁸ and sought their benedictions. They replied, ‘May those who give to us prosper.’ The boar honoured their feet and performed *pradakshina*. He gave them a seat and covering so that they could rest. The lord then entered and took the middle *pinda*. He offered this to the shadowy form who was the earth’s wife. The beautiful one accepted this and said, ‘May the ancestors enter my womb.’ When she accepted the *pinda*, he honoured the feet of the *brahmanas*. The boar thought that he would let the ancestors leave.

‘However, Koka and the ancestors thought about what would be good for them and spoke to him. “O illustrious one! Earlier, when we were in the

firmament, we were cursed by the cool sun. ¹⁶¹⁹ ‘You will deviate from yoga and all of you will be dislodged from the firmament. We entered Rasatala, but you saved us. O one who protects yoga! Since we deviated from yoga, the Vishvadevas ¹⁶²⁰ abandoned us. May the Vishvadevas always protect us again. O lord! O boar! Through your favours, we will go to heaven. O Soma! O supreme god! O one who holds up yoga! O reservoir of yoga! May Soma save us, so that we never deviate. Through yoga, may we always reside in the firmament and on earth. May some of us obtain nourishment in the firmament within a month. Urja is our wife and will be known by the name of Svadha. She possesses excellent yoga. She will be the mother of yoga and will roam around in the air.’” The ancestors spoke in this way to Varaha, the creator of beings. Vishnu spoke to the ancestors and to the great river, Koka. “Everything will be exactly as you have wished. Yama will be your supreme deity, Soma will be the one who instructs you, and Agni will be thought of as the divinity who presides over sacrifices to you. Your abodes will be Agni, Vayu and Surya. Brahma, Vishnu and Rudra will be the divinities who protect you. The Adityas, the Vasus and the Rudras will be your forms. You will be the yoga in the bodies of yogis. You will be reservoirs of yoga for those who are excellent in vows. You will roam around as you will, distributing fruits among creatures—those in heaven, those in *naraka*, those on earth and mobile and immobile objects. Through the strength of your yoga, you will occupy the best of places. Urja, the daughter of the moon, has been fashioned out of honey. This immensely fortunate one will become Daksha’s daughter, Svadha. This one, beautiful in face, will be your wife. Famous as the river Koka, she will flow in the king of the mountains. Protected by my form, she will be immensely sacred and will have one crore of *tirthas*. From today, I will reside there, destroying all sins. The sight of the sacred Varaha and his worship grants objects of pleasure and emancipation. The drinking of the waters of Koka destroys great sins. Bathing in that sacred *tirtha* and fasting grants heaven. The benefits of donations are infinite and destroy birth, death and old age. In *krishna paksha* in the month of Magha, when there is no moon, ¹⁶²¹ one must go to Kokamukha and remain there for five days. If a *shraddha* to the

ancestors is performed at that time, there is no doubt that the fruits mentioned earlier are reaped. I will always stay at that spot on the eleventh and twelfth lunar days. If one fasts there for two months, the fruits mentioned earlier are reaped. O immensely fortunate ones! Therefore, you can now go wherever you wish to. I will reside here.” Saying this, he vanished. When Varaha had left, the ancestors took their leave from Koka and left. Koka, along with the tirthas, resided on that king of mountains. The womb of the shadowy form of the earth prospered from partaking the *pinda*. Faithfully, the beautiful one conceived from Varaha. She had a son known as Bhouma Narakasura. Vishnu bestowed on him the city of Pragjyotisha. I have thus described to you the divine Varaha form of Vishnu, the granter of boons, in Kokamukha. On hearing this, a man becomes unblemished and is purified of all sins. He obtains the fruits of ten horse sacrifices.’

Chapter 1(111) (*Shraddha* rituals continued)

The sages asked, ‘O illustrious one! In detail, please tell us again about the rituals for *shraddha*. O store of austerities! How is it performed, by whom, and for whom?’

Vyasa replied, ‘O tigers among sages! Hear in detail about the *shraddha* rituals. I will tell you about how it is performed, where, when and by whom and about the required objects. *Brahmanas*, *kshatriyas* and *vaishyas* must perform *shraddhas*, using *mantras*, according to what has been decreed for their own *varna* and their own *dharma*. Women and inferior *varnas* like *shudras* must perform them according to the instructions of *brahmanas*. The rituals must be followed. However, for them, there will be no *mantras* and no sacrifice involving the fire. O *brahmanas*! They must be performed in *tirthas* like Pushkara, sacred houses, the summits of large mountains, sacred regions, the sacred waters of male and female rivers, lakes, the confluence of rivers with the seven oceans, in one’s own house when it has been smeared, in places for which one has obtained permission, near the roots of divine trees and ponds where sacrifices can be performed. These are places where *shraddhas* can be performed. There are places that are said to be prohibited—the lands of Kiratas, Kalingas, Konkanas, Krimis, Dasharnas, Kumaryas, Tanganas, Krathas, the northern banks of the Sindhu, the southern banks of the Narmada and the eastern side of Karatoya. It is said that *shraddhas* must not be performed there. Every month, *shraddha* must always be performed when there is no moon. On the day of the full moon, a *shraddha* should be performed during *rikshagochara*.¹⁶²² O *brahmanas*! Men perform *nitya shraddha* without the gods, *naimittika* is done along with the gods.¹⁶²³ There are also *nitya naimittika*, *kamya* and other *shraddhas* that are performed every year. *Vridhhi shraddha* must be

performed at the time of birth and other rites. O *brahmanas*! For these, an even number of *brahmanas* must be honoured and invited. When the sun enters Kanya, ¹⁶²⁴ fifteen days have formerly been identified as appropriate for *shraddhas*. *Pratipada* ¹⁶²⁵ is for obtaining wealth; *dvitiya* for offspring; *tritiya* for sons; *chaturthi* for destroying enemies; *panchami* for obtaining prosperity; *shashthi* for a man who wishes to be honoured; *saptami* for becoming the leader of a group; *ashtami* for supreme intelligence; *navami* for obtaining women; *dashami* for satisfaction of all desires; *ekadashi* for obtaining knowledge about the Vedas and all the rites; the worship of the ancestors on *dvadashi* ensures victory; and on *trayodashi*, the ceremony must certainly be performed for an increase in offspring, animals, intelligence, independence, excellent nourishment, a long lifespan and prosperity. If a *shraddha* ceremony is faithfully conducted, there is no doubt that these are obtained. If a person died while young, or if he was killed through weapons, if the ancestors are to be pleased, *shraddha* with food must be faithfully performed on *chaturdashi*. If a man purifies himself and carefully performs *shraddha* on *amavasya*, he obtains all the objects of desire and heaven for eternity. O best among sages! After this, listen to my words. I will tell you about what brings pleasure to the ancestors. With *havishya* food, ¹⁶²⁶ the ancestors are satisfied for a month. With *havishya* food, the ancestors are satisfied for a month. With fish and meat, the paternal ancestors are satisfied for two months. Know that the meat of deer satisfies the ancestors for three months. With the flesh of hares, the ancestors are nourished for four months. The flesh of birds satisfies them for five months and that of boar for six months. Goatmeat satisfies them for seven months and *ena* ¹⁶²⁷ flesh for eight months. There is no doubt that the meat of the *ruru* antelope satisfies them for nine months. The meat of *gavaya* ¹⁶²⁸ satisfies them for ten months. The flesh of sheep satisfies the ancestors for eleven months. The milk of cows and *payasam* satisfies them for a year. There is no doubt that the flesh of a rhinoceros, the flesh of the red goat, jute, ¹⁶²⁹ honey, rice mixed with meat or *rohita* fish offered by a son's descendants or a daughter's descendants or a *shraddha* performed in Gaya, satisfies the ancestors for an infinitely long period of time. Honey

and mixtures of honey bring eternal benefit. “May someone be born in our lineage who offers us oblations of water and *payasam* mixed with honey during the monsoon, at the time of Magha *nakshatra*.” ¹⁶³⁰ One should wish for many sons. Even if one of them goes to Gaya, marries a girl who is a Gouri, ¹⁶³¹ releases a blue bull, or worships the ancestors at the time of Krittika *nakshatra*, men obtain heaven.’

‘A *shraddha* ceremony in Rohini *nakshatra* ensures offspring; in Soumya, one obtains energy; ¹⁶³² in Ardra, one obtains valour; in Punarvasu, one obtains fields; in Pushya, one obtains inexhaustible wealth; in Ashlesha, an excellent lifespan; in Magha, offspring and nourishment; in Phalguni, good fortune; in Uttara, ¹⁶³³ one becomes generous and obtains offspring; a man who performs *shraddha* in Hasta obtains excellence in the sacred texts; in Chitra, one obtains beauty, energy and offspring; in Svati, there are gains through trade; in Vishakha, one always obtains sons; an observance in Anuradha makes a person a *chakravarti*; in Jyeshtha, one obtains lordship; in Mula, there is excellent health; in Ashadha, there is fame, especially in Uttara; ¹⁶³⁴ in Shravana, there are auspicious objects of desire; in Dhanishtha, one obtains great riches; in Abhijit, one becomes knowledgeable in the Vedas; in Varuna, ¹⁶³⁵ one obtains success as a physician; in Proshthapada, one obtains goats and sheep; in Uttara, one obtains cattle; ¹⁶³⁶ in Revati, one obtains metal vessels; in Ashvini, one obtains horses; and a person who performs *shraddha* in Bharani obtains an excellent lifespan. A person who knows the truth knows about these fruits in different *nakshatras*. O *brahmanas*! Therefore, depending on one’s desires, the rituals of *shraddha* must accordingly be observed. If there are great desires, the ceremony must be performed when the sun enters the sign of Kanya. A man who desires anything must perform a *shraddha* ceremony when the sun enters the sign of Kanya. All the wishes are satisfied then. A *nandimukha* ceremony ¹⁶³⁷ must also be performed when the sun enters the sign of Kanya. In accordance with Varaha’s words, it can also be performed on the day of the full moon. Then the sun enters the sign of Kanya, and the ancestors, in heaven, on earth, in the firmament and in mobile and immobile objects, desire *pinda*. When the sun enters Kanya, for those sixteen days,

any rituals performed are equal to those from royal and horse sacrifices. Those rare fruits are obtained. The divinity Narayana has said this. When the sun enters Kanya, the ancestors must be worshipped with water, vegetables and roots. When the one with the sharp rays enters the *nakshatras* of Uttara or Hasta, ¹⁶³⁸ if a person devotedly worships the ancestors, he resides in heaven. When the sun enters the *nakshatra* of Hasta, on the instructions of the lord of the ancestors, ¹⁶³⁹ the city of the ancestors is empty until Vrishchika ¹⁶⁴⁰ is seen. When the sun has crossed Vrishchika, the gods and the ancestors return, cursing because of their extremely intolerable miseries. ¹⁶⁴¹ In the manvantaras, beginning with the mother, in due order, one must perform *ashtaka* and *anvashtaka shraddhas*. ¹⁶⁴² During an eclipse, at the time of *vyatipata*, when there is a conjunction between the sun and the moon and when the planets make one's natal *nakshatra* suffer, it has been said that a *parvana shraddha* ¹⁶⁴³ must be performed. Following the rituals, *shraddhas* must be performed when one *ayana* changes into another, when the sun enters the vernal or the autumnal equinox, and at the time of *sankranti*. However, these *shraddhas* must be performed without offering *pinda*. A man must follow the rituals and perform *shraddha* on the third day of Vaishakha, the ninth day in Kartika, the full moon day and at the time of *sankranti*. With *payasam*, *shraddha* must be performed on the thirteenth day of Bhadrapada and at the time of *amavasya* in Magha, as is done during *dakshinayana*. When a learned brahmana who knows about the Vedas arrives in one's house, one must follow the rituals and perform an excellent *shraddha* with him alone. ¹⁶⁴⁴ When objects approved by the virtuous for a *shraddha* have been gathered, as has been decreed, supreme *brahmanas* must be used to perform a *parvana shraddha*. Every year, it must be undertaken on the day when the father or the mother died, and also for the paternal uncle and the elder brother, if they died without having sons. In *parvana shraddhas*, the gods are first offered oblations. *Ekoddishtha* ceremonies ¹⁶⁴⁵ are performed without the gods. For those with gods, two *pindas* must be offered. ¹⁶⁴⁶ For rites to the ancestors, three or one *pinda* can be offered. For a maternal grandfather, the rituals are identical to those that have been described. When a person has died, his son must place *pinda*,

water, sesamum and *kusha* grass on the ground, outside the house and near a body of water. On the third day, along with *brahmanas*, the bones of the dead person ¹⁶⁴⁷ must be gathered. The purification is done on the tenth day for a dead brahmana, on the twelfth day for a *kshatriya* and on the fifteenth day for a *vaishya*. For a shudra, the purification happens after a month. In a house where there has been a childbirth, *ekoddhishta* is recommended on the twelfth day, at the end of a month and at the end of three fortnights. O *brahmanas*! For a year, the *shraddha* ceremony must be performed every month. After that, in due order, one must undertake *sapindikarana*. ¹⁶⁴⁸ Once *sapindikarana* has been performed, it has been said that *parvana shraddha* must be undertaken. After that, the dead move from the state of being a *preta* to the state of being an ancestor. It has been said that ancestors are of two types, manifest and unmanifest. *Nandimukha* ceremonies are for those who are not manifest, while *parvana* rites are for those who are manifest. *Pretas* subsist on *ekoddhishta* rites. These are the three kinds of ancestors that have been determined.'

Chapter 1(112) (Offering *pindas*)

The sages asked, ‘O supreme among *brahmanas*! How must *sapindikarana* be done? O supreme among eloquent ones! What are the rituals for performing this for those who are dead?’

Vyasa replied, ‘O *brahmanas*! Listen to my words about *sapindikarana*. This too is without the gods. A single sacred *arghya* is offered. There is no use of the fire. There is no invocation. To the right, an odd number of *brahmanas* are fed. In addition to these monthly rites, there are other specific things. O supreme among *brahmanas*! I will tell you about these. Listen attentively. There must be four vessels, filled with sesamum, fragrances and water. O *brahmanas*! Three of these are for the ancestors and one is for the *preta*.¹⁶⁴⁹ Each of these vessels must be sprinkled with some water from the *preta*’s vessel. While this is being done, from the beginning to the end, one must perform *japa* with *ye samanah*. It has been said that for women too, water and the other things must be offered. However, if they did not have sons, *sapindikarana* is not done. Every year, men must undertake *ekoddishtha* for dead women. Following the rituals ordained for dead ancestors, the task must be done on the death anniversary. In there is no son, *sapindas* can perform the ceremony. In the absence of a son, a *sapinda* can perform the rite.¹⁶⁵⁰ If there is no *sapinda*, a *sahodaka* can undertake the rite.¹⁶⁵¹ If there is no son, the rites can be properly undertaken by a daughter’s son. A daughter’s son can also perform the ceremony for a maternal grandfather. When it is performed for a maternal grandfather or a paternal grandfather, it is known as *dvyamushyayana*. Following the rites, they¹⁶⁵² must be worshipped through a *naimittika* funeral ceremony. If there is no one else, women can perform the rite for their husbands, but without the use of *mantras*. If they are also not there, the

king must ensure that all the rites are properly undertaken by those from the family. If they are also absent, the rites can be properly performed by men who are from the same class. The king is a relative of all the *varnas*.¹⁶⁵³ O *brahmanas*! I have, thus, spoken to you about *nitya* and *naimittika* rites. Now hear about the funeral rites for other *shraddhas*, those that are *nitya-naimittika*. When the moon wanes, the learned know this time as *darsha*, the time of *naimittika*.¹⁶⁵⁴ But since this also indicates its permanence, this is hence the time for a *nitya-naimittika* rite. A father's great grandfather and those above him are not entitled to *sapindikarana*, and to *pindas* offered to ancestors. They can only feed on the *lepa*.¹⁶⁵⁵ Anyone else, who is fourth generation upwards, becomes *lepabhuja*.¹⁶⁵⁶ There is no longer any link and this is the only kind of enjoyment possible. It is known that there are three kinds of men who are linked through the *pinda*—the father, the grandfather and the great grandfather. The others, the grandfather's grandfather upwards, are linked through *lepa*. Including these three generations, the person performing the ceremony is the seventh in the line. The sages have, thus, laid down the connection for these seven generations. Those who are further up from the person performing the ceremony enjoy *anulepa*.¹⁶⁵⁷ There are other ancestors who are residents in hell, or have been born as inferior species, or are *bhutas*. The person performing the ceremony must follow the recommended rites for all of them through the *shraddha*. O *brahmanas*! I will tell you how each of them is satisfied. When men place food down on the ground, those who have become *pishachas* are satisfied through this. O *brahmanas*! When a garment is wrung after taking a bath, the drops that fall on the ground satisfy those who have become trees. When drops of fragrant water fall down on the ground, this satisfies those who have become gods. When a *pinda* is raised, the drops of water that fall down on the ground satisfy those who have been born as inferior species. There may be children in the lineage who have died. Though they deserved to have rites performed for them, they were deprived. They are suffering and are satisfied from the water scattered during sweeping. After eating, *brahmanas* rinse their mouths with water. Others obtain satisfaction from this, or from the water used for washing their feet. The departed ones who

have been born as other species are thus satisfied, in the respective lineages they have been born in, through what the person performing the sacrifice does, or through what *brahmanas* do, through the sprinkling of food or water, pure or impure. ¹⁶⁵⁸ O *brahmanas*! They are satisfied when the *shraddha* is properly performed. There are men who undertake *shraddha* ceremonies with wealth earned by other people. This satisfies those who have been born as *chandalas* or *pulkasas*. O *brahmanas*! In this way, many relatives are satisfied, even from the water sprinkled at *shraddha* ceremonies. Therefore, a man must faithfully follow the rites and undertake a *shraddha* ceremony to the best of his capacity, even with vegetables. If the required *shraddha* ceremony is undertaken, no one in the lineage suffers.

‘*Brahmanas* who are self-controlled and versed in *agnihotra* must be invited to *shraddhas*—such as a distinguished and learned brahmana, a person learned in the Vedas, a person learned in *Trinachiketa*, ¹⁶⁵⁹ one who knows the three *Madhus*, ¹⁶⁶⁰ one who knows the three *Suparnas*, ¹⁶⁶¹ one who knows the six Vedangas, a person who is devoted to his parents and his own sisters and a person who knows the Sama Veda. The officiating priest, the family priest, the *acharya* and the *upadhyaya* must be fed first. ¹⁶⁶² The invitees to a *shraddha* are the maternal uncle, the father-in-law, the brother-in-law, a person who teaches a group of villages, ¹⁶⁶³ a brahmana who teaches a congregation, those who know about the meaning of the Puranas, those who have no desire, those whose desires are satisfied with a trifle and those who do not receive gifts. *Brahmanas* are the ones who purify groups. Therefore, the best of *brahmanas*, mentioned earlier, must be invited on the preceding day. They are the ones who must be engaged for rites connected with the gods and the ancestors. They must control themselves, and so must the person performing the *shraddha*. If a person offers food at a *shraddha* and after eating it, indulges in sexual intercourse, for an entire month, his ancestors lie down on that semen. If a person has intercourse with a woman and then offers food at a *shraddha* and eats it, for an entire month, his ancestors drink semen and urine. Therefore, the first task for a wise person is to issue the invitations. Until the day arrives, all association with women

must be avoided. In the course of time, self-controlled mendicants will arrive for alms. Controlling his mind, he must prostrate himself before them. He must please and feed them. In that way, a learned person will feed yogis. The ancestors have a foundation in yoga. Therefore, yogis must always be worshipped. If there is a single yogi among one thousand *brahmanas*, he can make the person performing the sacrifice and the invitees cross over, like a boat across the water. Those who know about the *brahman* recite a chant about the ancestors. Earlier, the ancestors sung this about King Aila. ‘We are always eager. When will a son be born, who will offer us a *pinda* on the ground from what is left after a yogi has eaten? When will a *pinda* be offered in Gaya? When will we get the great offering of the flesh of a rhinoceros? When will we be satisfied for a month with jute, ¹⁶⁶⁴ sesamum or *krisara*? As an oblation to the Vishvadevas and Soma, the flesh of a rhinoceros is supreme. We desire the flesh of a rhinoceros, from the colour of the horn on the head to the feet.’ In the month of Magha, following the rites, the ceremony must be performed on the thirteenth day. During *dakshinayana*, *payasam* mixed with honey and clarified butter must be offered. Therefore, with a controlled mind, a man must faithfully worship his ancestors. One then obtains everything that one desires and is cleansed of all sins. When the ancestors are satisfied through a *shraddha*, the Vasus, the Rudras, the Adityas, the *nakshatras*, the planets and the stars are pleased with men. When the ancestors are satisfied through *shraddhas*, they thus bestow long-lives, offspring, wealth, learning, heaven, liberation, happiness and kingdoms. The ancestors prefer the afternoon to the forenoon. The *brahmanas* who have arrived at the house must be welcomed and honoured. With hands cleaned and with *kusha* mats, he must make them sit down on their seats. Following the rites, after the *shraddha* has been performed, those excellent *brahmanas* must be fed. Devotedly prostrating himself before them, he must speak to them pleasantly and give them permission to leave. He must follow them up to the door and return only when they have granted permission. After this, the *nitya* rites must be performed and guests fed. Some excellent people wish to perform *nitya* rites for their ancestors. Others say these should not be undertaken for

ancestors, but that the other rites must be performed, as mentioned earlier. Some say the rites for the ancestors should be done separately. Other say there is no need for this, but the rites must be performed, as mentioned earlier. A man must eat the food along with the servants. A person who knows about *dharma* controls himself and undertakes a *shraddha* ceremony for the ancestors in this way, so that the foremost among the *brahmanas* are satisfied. I will now tell you about the worst of *brahmanas*, who are to be avoided—a person who harms his friends, one with diseased nails, one who is impotent, a person suffering from tuberculosis, a person suffering from white leprosy, one who lives by trade, a person who has dark teeth, a bald-headed person, a person who is one-eyed or blind, a person who is deaf, dumb or foolish, a cripple or lame person, one who is an eunuch, a person with diseased skin, one with a crooked arm, a leper, a red-eyed person, one who is hunch-backed, a dwarf, one who is ugly, a lazy person, one who is an enemy to his friends, one who is from a wicked lineage, one who herds animals, one who is malformed, a person who has married before his elder brother, an unmarried elder brother whose younger brother has got married, the son of a woman whose husband has married before his elder brother, the husband of a *vrishala*,¹⁶⁶⁵ and the son of such a person. Any such brahmana should not be invited to a *shraddha*. Nor should one invite a person who has officiated at a *samskara* of a *vrishala*'s son, a person who has not married, a person who has married his brother's widow, a person who receives a salary as a teacher, one who has been taught by a salaried teacher, a person who lives off his daughter, one who is a hunter, a person who sells *soma*, a person who has been cursed, a thief, a fallen person, one who lives off usury, a deceiver, a person who indulges in calumny, one who has abandoned the Vedas, a person who has abandoned the fire and donations, a cruel person, a person who is a priest or servant to a king, one who is devoid of learning, an envious person, a person who hates the aged, a person who cannot be tolerated, one who is harsh, one who is foolish, one who earns his living off an idol, an astrologer who studies the *nakshatras*, one who makes arrows, a censured person, one who performs sacrifices for those who are not worthy of sacrifices, a eunuch,¹⁶⁶⁶ one who is condemned

and one who is inferior. Such people should not be invited to *shraddhas*, since they defile the gathering. If the wicked are honoured and the virtuous are not shown respect, destiny instantly brings down a terrible rod of punishment. The sacred texts have clear guidelines. If one abandons these and feeds a foolish person, he gives up the original *dharma* and such a giver will be destroyed. If a brahmana has sought refuge and a person abandons him and feeds someone else, the giver is destroyed from the sighs, ¹⁶⁶⁷ which are like flames.

‘When garments are not donated, rites, sacrifices, Vedas and austerities do not exist. Therefore, garments must be given, especially at the time of *shraddhas*. If a person makes large donations of silk or cotton garments at a *shraddha*, he obtains excellent objects of desire. Just as a calf hunts out its mother from a multitude of cows, the ancestors hunt out the food from the *brahmanas* who have eaten. Though the ancestors are dead, they are offered food along with *mantras*, with their names and *gotras* mentioned. This is conveyed to them ¹⁶⁶⁸ and they are satisfied. ‘For the gods! For the ancestors! For the great yogis! I bow down. *Svaha! Svadha!* I always bow down. I bow down.’ At the beginning and at the end of the *shraddha*, *japa* must be performed thrice with these words. When the *pinda* is offered, he must control himself and perform *japa* in this way. At this, the ancestors arrive quickly and the *rakshasas* run away. In the three worlds, the *mantra* pleases them and saves them. A garment made out of new silk or cotton thread, or hessian, must be given. But a silk garment that is woven out of thread must be avoided. ¹⁶⁶⁹ If there is no fringe to the garment, a wise person avoids it. This does not please the ancestors. Nor does it bring benefit to the donor. A *pinda* must not be offered to an ancestor who is alive. Following the rites, he must be fed the food that he desires. Full of faith and devotion, a man must offer the *pinda* into the fire. If he desires offspring, he must get his wife to offer the middle *pinda* after the *mantras* have been recited. If he desires to be radiant and supreme, he must offer the *pinda* to cows. If he desires wisdom, fame and deeds, he must offer it to the water. If he desires a long lifespan, he must offer it to crows. If he desires sons or a house, he must offer it to cocks. Some *brahmanas* also say that the

pinda must be held from the front. The *pinda* must be lifted up in accordance with what the *brahmanas* desire, with their permission. A *shraddha* must always be performed in accordance with what the *rishis* have said in earlier times. Otherwise, there are taints and the ancestors do not remain there. To worship and satisfy the ancestors, a learned person will give the following in a *shraddha*—barley, paddy, sesamum, *masha*, wheat, chickpea, *mudga*, *shyamaka*, mustard, *nivara*, *hasti-shymaka*,¹⁶⁷⁰ *priyangu*,¹⁶⁷¹ *prasatika*¹⁶⁷² and *trinika*.¹⁶⁷³ Carefully, the following fruits must be given in a *shraddha*—*amra*, *amrataka*, *bilva*, *dadima*, *bijapuraka*, old *amalaka*, *kshira*,¹⁶⁷⁴ *narikela*, *parushaka*,¹⁶⁷⁵ *vatsaka*,¹⁶⁷⁶ *kharjura*, *draksha*, *nilaka*,¹⁶⁷⁷ *kapitthaka*, *patola*,¹⁶⁷⁸ *priyala*,¹⁶⁷⁹ *karkandhu*,¹⁶⁸⁰ *badari*, *vaikankata*¹⁶⁸¹ and *naranga*. O *brahmanas*! The following are appropriate for a *shraddha* and should be offered—treacle, sugar, unrefined sugar, molasses, parched rice,¹⁶⁸² the milk of cows, curds, *ghee*, sesamum oil, rock salt from the ocean, rock salt from lakes, pure fragrances, sandalwood, aloe, *kumkuma*, the herb known as *kalashaka*, grain after threshing, unhusking and winnowing, objects like roots and wild vegetables. O *brahmanas*! The flowers that can be given and are appropriate for a *shraddha* are *jati*, *champaka*, *lodhra*, *mallika*, *bana*, *barbari*,¹⁶⁸³ the leaves of *ashoka*, *tulasi*,¹⁶⁸⁴ *tilaka*,¹⁶⁸⁵ purifying *shatapatras*,¹⁶⁸⁶ fragrant *shefalikas*,¹⁶⁸⁷ *kubjaka*, *tagara*, *mriga*,¹⁶⁸⁸ wild *ketaki*, *yuthika* and *atimukta*. One must carefully offer *kamala*, *kumuda*, *padma*, *pundarika*, *indivara*, *kokanada* and *kahlara*.¹⁶⁸⁹ The appropriate fragrances are said to be sulphur, *mansi*,¹⁶⁹⁰ *valaka*,¹⁶⁹¹ *kukkuti*,¹⁶⁹² *jatipatraka*,¹⁶⁹³ *nalikeshira*,¹⁶⁹⁴ *granthiparni*¹⁶⁹⁵ and *sundari*.¹⁶⁹⁶ *Guggula*, sandalwood, *shrivasa*,¹⁶⁹⁷ aloe and *rishi-guggula* are also appropriate.

‘*Rajamasha*, *chanaka*, *masura*, *koradushaka*, *viprusha*, *markata* and *kodrava* should be avoided.¹⁶⁹⁸ Curds, milk and *ghee* from female buffaloes, yaks, deer, sheep, an animal without cloven hooves, women and camels must be avoided. Fruits from *tala*, *varuna*, *kakola*, *bahupatra*, *arjuna*, *jambira*, red *bilva* and *shala* must be avoided.¹⁶⁹⁹ In particular, fish and the flesh of pigs, tortoises and cattle must not be used. One should avoid anything that is foul, musk, *rochana*,¹⁷⁰⁰ red sandalwood, yellow

sandalwood, strong fragrances, white frank incense, olibanum, *kumari*,¹⁷⁰¹ *kirata*,¹⁷⁰² carrot, turnip, tamarind, sorrel, *varuma*,¹⁷⁰³ *chanapatrika*,¹⁷⁰⁴ orris, shatapushpa,¹⁷⁰⁵ anything with a hollow stalk, *gandhashukara*,¹⁷⁰⁶ *halabhritya*,¹⁷⁰⁷ mustard, onion, garlic, *manaskandha*, *vishaskanda*,¹⁷⁰⁸ *vajrakanda*,¹⁷⁰⁹ *gadasthika*,¹⁷¹⁰ *purushalva*¹⁷¹¹ and *sapindalu*.¹⁷¹² These should not be used in a *shraddha* rite. In a *shraddha* ceremony, one must not use bottle gourd, *tiktaparna*,¹⁷¹³ pumpkin, *katukatraya*,¹⁷¹⁴ brinjal, *shivajata*,¹⁷¹⁵ hairy *vata*, black and red-complexioned cranes.¹⁷¹⁶ The fruit of *vibhitaka* must be avoided in *shraddhas*. O excellent ones! Something that has a sharp taste should not be given at a *shraddha*. Nor *kovidara* or *shingru*.¹⁷¹⁷ One should not give something that is excessively sour, slippery, harsh or raw. Nor should one give something that has lost its juices. The smell of liquor must be avoided. One must avoid asafoetida that has a strong smell, *phanisha*,¹⁷¹⁸ *bhunimba*,¹⁷¹⁹ *nimbarajika*,¹⁷²⁰ bad *tumburus*¹⁷²¹ from Kalinga and sour *vetasa*.¹⁷²² *Dadima*, *magadhi*,¹⁷²³ *nagara*,¹⁷²⁴ *ardraka*,¹⁷²⁵ *tittidi*,¹⁷²⁶ *amrataka*, *jivaka*¹⁷²⁷ and *tumburu* can be given. *Payasam*, *shalmali*,¹⁷²⁸ *mudga*, *modaka*, tasty drinks and milk should be faithfully offered. O *brahmanas*! One must offer what is tasty and pleasant. Something that is slightly sour and slightly bitter can be given at *shraddhas*. Something that is excessively sour, excessively salty, bitter and pungent is food for *asuras*. These should not be used in *shraddhas*. Something that is sweet and pleasant, tasty, even if it is sour or bitter, is food for the gods. These should be used in *shraddhas*. The meat of a goat, *vartika*, partridge, hare, jackal,¹⁷²⁹ *lavaka* and *rajiva* can be used in *shraddhas*.¹⁷³⁰ It has been said that the flesh of a rhinoceros, a red jackal, a red fish with scales and a *simhatunda* fish can be used in *shraddhas*. Manu has spoken about the use of the *rohita* fish.¹⁷³¹ However, *brahmanas* should not use it for *havya* or *kavya*. O *brahmanas*! I have said this in accordance with what Varaha has said. If one eats the food I have indicated as prohibited, one goes to the hell named *rourava*. O stores of austerity! The following have been prohibited by Varaha. They should not be eaten by *brahmanas* and should not be offered to ancestors. They are *rohita*, pig, tortoise, iguana, swan, *chakravaka*, *madgu*, fish without scales, osprey,

anything without bones, *vasahari*,¹⁷³² cock, *kalavinka*, peacock, *bharadvaja*,¹⁷³³ *sharngaka*,¹⁷³⁴ mongoose, owl, cat, *lopakas*¹⁷³⁵ and other things extremely inauspicious, *tittibha*,¹⁷³⁶ *jambuka*,¹⁷³⁷ tiger, bear and hyena. If an evil-minded person eats these and other greatly tainted objects, he commits a great sin and goes to the hell named *rourava*. If an evil-souled person offers this condemned flesh to his ancestors, he ensures that his ancestors are dislodged from heaven and descend into hell. If he eats vegetables mixed with *kusumbha*,¹⁷³⁸ *jambira*, *shingru*, *kovidara*, *pinyaka*,¹⁷³⁹ *viprusha*, *masura*, *grinjana*,¹⁷⁴⁰ *shana*,¹⁷⁴¹ *kodrava*, *kokilaksha*,¹⁷⁴² *chukra*,¹⁷⁴³ *kambuka*,¹⁷⁴⁴ *padmaka*,¹⁷⁴⁵ *chakora*, the flesh of a hawk, *vartula*,¹⁷⁴⁶ *alavu*,¹⁷⁴⁷ *talini*¹⁷⁴⁸ or the unripe fruit of a palm tree, he goes to hell. If a man offers these to his ancestors, along with them, he goes to a place that is full of pus. Therefore, a learned person must make every effort not to have these. For the sake of the ancestors, Varaha himself has lovingly prohibited these. The sages have said that it is better to offer one's own flesh instead. Therefore, out of love, a man must not offer these prohibited items of food. O *brahmanas*! If inadvertently, or out of confusion, he has eaten these prohibited items once, he must perform a rite of atonement. For a week, every day, he must subsist on fruits, roots, curds, milk, butter-milk, cow's urine and barley. This must also be done if he has made *brahmanas* eat these prohibited items. In particular, Vishnu's devotees must purify their bodies in this way. O store of austerities! According to one's capacity, one must avoid the prohibited items and perform a *shraddha* ceremony. If a man follows the rules and performs a *shraddha* according to one's powers, all the creatures in the universe, beginning with Brahma, are satisfied.'

The sages asked, 'If the father is alive, but the grandfather and the father's grandfather are dead, how will the *shraddha* be performed? Please tell us about this in detail.'

Vyasa replied, 'Just as the father would have performed the *shraddha* himself, his son should undertake it in exactly the same way. In this way, the *dharma* of the Vedas and customary *dharma* does not suffer.'

The sages asked, 'O brahmana! If the father is dead, but the grandfather is alive, how should *shraddha* be performed? You should tell us.'

Vyasa replied, ‘He must offer *pinda* to his father and feed his grandfather. He must offer *pinda* to the great grandfather. This is the determination of the sacred texts. The dead must be offered *pinda* and those who are alive must be fed. However, in such cases, *sapindikarana* and *parvana shraddha* must not be performed. If a man undertakes the sacrifices meant for the ancestors, there is no doubt that he swiftly attains a long lifespan, and number of sons and his wealth increases. O *brahmanas*! If a man reads this account of a sacrifice to the ancestors at the time of a *shraddha* ceremony, his ancestors feed on his food for a period of three yugas. I have, thus, described what has been thought of as a sacrifice to the ancestors. This destroys sins and enhances good merits. At the time of a *shraddha*, a person must control himself and hear it and recite it.’

The Brahma Purana will continue in Volume 2.

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- ¹ For example, *shlokas* 2.4.10, 4.1.2 and 4.5.11 of the Brihadaranyaka Upanishad use the two expressions together.
- ² Chandogya Upanishad, 7.1.2.
- ³ *Ancient Indian Historical Tradition*, F. E. Pargiter, Oxford University Press, London, 1922.
- ⁴ *Sutas* were bards, minstrels, raconteurs.
- ⁵ The Critical Edition of the Valmiki Ramayana was brought out by the Baroda Oriental Institute, now part of the Maharaja Sayajirao University of Baroda. The Critical Edition of the Mahabharata was brought out by the Bhandarkar Oriental Research Institute, Pune.
- ⁶ The Bhagavad Gita translation was published in 2006 and reprinted in 2019, the translation of the Critical Edition of the Mahabharata in 10 volumes between 2010 and 2014 (with a box set in 2015) and the translation of the Critical Edition of the Valmiki Ramayana in 2017. The translations are by Bibek Debroy, and in each case, the publisher is Penguin.
- ⁷ *The Brahmamahapurāṇam*, Nag Publishers, Delhi, 1985.
- ⁸ The Brahma Purana, Parts I to IV, translated by a board of scholars, Motilal Banarsidass Publishers, Delhi, 1985 to 1986.
- ⁹ *Studies in the Puranic Records on Hindu Rites and Customs*, R. C. Hazra, University of Dacca, 1940. This has since been reprinted several times, by different publishers.
- ¹⁰ *The Bhagavata Purana*, Volumes 1–3, Penguin Books, 2018. *The Markandeya Purana*, Penguin Books, 2019.

- ¹ Nara and Narayana were ancient *rishis*, sometimes referred to individually, but more often, together. Narayana is identified with Vishnu/Krishna and Nara with Arjuna. Sarasvati is the goddess of speech. Jaya is a term used for the Mahabharata text. But Puranas also begin with this invocation.
- ² Illusion.
- ³ A *kalpa* is one of Brahma's days.
- ⁴ Literally, the excellent being.
- ⁵ Attributes, specifically, *sattva* (purity), *rajas* (passion) and *tamas* (darkness).
- ⁶ The cycle of death and rebirth, worldly existence.
- ⁷ *Shala* is a tall tree (*shorea robusta*), *karnikara* is a flowering tree, *panasa* is jackfruit, *dhava* is the axlewood tree, *khadira* is a kind of tree, *amra* is mango, *jambu* is rose-apple, *kapittha* is wood-apple, *nyagrodha* is the Indian fig tree, *devadaru* is a kind of pine, *ashvattha* is the holy fig tree, *parijata* is the coral tree, *chandana* is sandalwood, *agaru* is agallochum, *patala* is the trumpet flower, *bakula* is a flowering tree, *saptaparni* is the name of a tree, *punnaga* is nutmeg, *nagakeshara* is a flowering tree, *tamala* is a tree with dark bark, *narikela* is coconut, *arjuna* is a tall tree and *champak* is a tree with yellow and fragrant flowers. *Shala* is mentioned twice.
- ⁸ The four stages (*ashramas*) of life are *brahmacharya* (celibate student stage), *garhasthya* (householder), *vanaprastha* (retiring to the forest) and *sannyasa* (stage of renunciation). For those in *sannyasa*, the text uses the word *yati* (mendicant).
- ⁹ *Yava* and *medhya* are two different kinds of barley and both are mentioned.
- ¹⁰ The fire is the bearer of oblations.
- ¹¹ *Sutas* were bards and raconteurs. Lomaharshana, also known as Romaharshana, means the body-hair standing up. This may mean the *suta*'s body-hair stands up. But it is usually taken to mean that his accounts made the body-hair of listeners stand up. Lomaharshana was Vedavyasa's disciple and Vedavyasa taught him the Puranas.
- ¹² *Agamas* are texts other than the *Vedas*, such as the *tantra* texts.
- ¹³ Gods are *devas* or *suras*. As the antithesis of *suras*, there are the demons, *asuras*. *Daityas* and *danavas* are used as synonyms for *asuras*. *Daityas* are the offspring of Diti and *danavas* are the offspring of Danu.

- ¹⁴ That is, Mahabharata.
- ¹⁵ That is, *moksha*.
- ¹⁶ *Gandharvas* and *yakshas* are semi-divine species, often depicted as companions of Kubera, the lord of riches. *Gandharvas* are accomplished in singing and music. *Uragas* are serpents, also known as *nagas*. *Uragas/nagas* are different from ordinary snakes (*sarpas*). *Uragas/nagas* can assume any form at will, live in special regions and have semi-divine qualities.
- ¹⁷ The one who originated from the golden egg, Brahma.
- ¹⁸ *Jnana* is knowledge gleaned from the external world. *Vijnana* is self-knowledge.
- ¹⁹ Vedavyasa.
- ²⁰ *Vedanga* means a branch of the *Vedas* and these were six kinds of learning that were essential to understand the *Vedas*—*shiksha* (phonetics), *kalpa* (rituals), *vyakarana* (grammar), *nirukta* (etymology), *chhanda* (metre) and *jyotisha* (astronomy).
- ²¹ Brahma.
- ²² *Samkhya* is one of the six schools of philosophy (*darshana*) and this draws on the taxonomy of *samkhya*, which is not always uniform. Purusha is transcendental and pure consciousness and is devoid of *gunas*. Pradhana, or Prakriti, has *gunas* and is the cause of all manifestations. Ahamkara is ego and Mahat, also known as *buddhi*, is intellect. This results in five subtle elements, five gross elements, five organs of sense, five organs of action and the mind.
- ²³ Meaning without birth.
- ²⁴ *Sarga*.
- ²⁵ The one who created himself, a term usually, though not invariably, applied to Brahma.
- ²⁶ Born from Nara.
- ²⁷ Narayana = Nara + *ayana* (path/course).
- ²⁸ Prajapati means lord of subjects. The list of Prajapatis varies.
- ²⁹ Usually, it is stated that Brahma used his mental powers to create four sons known as Sanaka, Sananda, Sanatana and Sanatkumara. Since they were not interested in creation, Brahma subsequently used his mental powers to create the seven sages mentioned earlier. Thus, Sanatkumara is older.

- ³⁰ These Rudras (inferior Rudras so to speak) are not to be confused with the Rudra who was born from Brahma's rage. These inferior Rudras, usually numbering eleven, were the sons of the sage Kashyapa and Aditi.
- ³¹ There are several inconsistencies in these lines. For instance, Skanda has not yet been created.
- ³² Brahma.
- ³³ Another inconsistency.
- ³⁴ The lord of clouds and rain.
- ³⁵ The use of the word *manvantara* (in the text) can give rise to confusion. *Sarga* (creation) is better. The first creation was of Sanatkumara and the others, the second of the *rishis*.
- ³⁶ That is, the son of Virat.
- ³⁷ Meaning Manu.
- ³⁸ Svaayambhuva, born from Svayambhuva.
- ³⁹ 71.4 *mahayugas*.
- ⁴⁰ Dhruva is the Pole Star. In the sky, the *saptarshis* are the constellation Great Dipper, part of Ursa Major.
- ⁴¹ Shukracharya, usually referred to as the preceptor of the *asuras*.
- ⁴² Svayambhuva Manu.
- ⁴³ The *brahmanas* killed Vena in their rage. Vena died without having a son. So that there might be a king, the *brahmanas* kneaded the dead body's right hand.
- ⁴⁴ Etymologically, a *kshatriya* is one who protects.
- ⁴⁵ *Rajasuya yajna*.
- ⁴⁶ The *sutas* were charioteers, as well as raconteurs of tales. *Magadhas* were minstrels and bards. So were *bandis*. But *magadhas* seem to have also composed, while *bandis* sung the compositions of others.
- ⁴⁷ The word used is *punyajana*. *Saptajana* is a synonym. These were seven sages who were originally *rakshasas*. *Gandharvas* are semi-divine species, celestial singers and musicians. *Apsaras* are semi-divine species, celestial dancers.
- ⁴⁸ That is, Antardhi.
- ⁴⁹ The knowledge of using weapons, the art of fighting.
- ⁵⁰ The word used is *tata*. It means son, but is used for anyone who is junior.
- ⁵¹ Agni is the fire-god.
- ⁵² The *nakshatras* aren't quite stars. They can be constellations too. There are twenty-seven *nakshatras*.

- ⁵³ Brahma.
- ⁵⁴ The celestial *rishi*.
- ⁵⁵ In one of his births, Narada was the son of Kashyapa and Muni.
- ⁵⁶ Born through Brahma's mental powers. The text uses the word Parameshthi for Brahma.
- ⁵⁷ In one of his births, Narada was thus Daksha's son.
- ⁵⁸ Brahma.
- ⁵⁹ Daksha.
- ⁶⁰ The five thousand mentioned earlier.
- ⁶¹ When the Haryashvas were about to procreate, Narada told them that they should first ascertain whether there was enough space on earth to hold offspring. The Haryashvas went off to explore the earth and never returned. In that sense, they were destroyed.
- ⁶² Narada's.
- ⁶³ Narada.
- ⁶⁴ Brahma.
- ⁶⁵ Asikni/Virani was also born from Brahma's left thumb and was, thus, his daughter. Narada, Brahma's son, was born as her son.
- ⁶⁶ We have changed the text a bit. As it stands, the text suggests Daksha bestowed his daughter on Parameshthi/Brahma.
- ⁶⁷ Daksha.
- ⁶⁸ Astronomy.
- ⁶⁹ Not to be confused with the moon.
- ⁷⁰ The same as Agni.
- ⁷¹ Shiva.
- ⁷² The Pleiades. Kartikeya/Kumara/Skanda was reared by the Krittikas. They adopted him as their son.
- ⁷³ One of Daksha's daughters married to Kashyapa.
- ⁷⁴ These minor Rudras are not to be confused with the major Rudra, Shiva. There are eleven minor Rudras. Since the text doesn't enable one to distinguish an adjective from a proper name, there are actually fifteen names in the list. The names of the eleven Rudras vary from Purana to Purana. So an external source doesn't enable one to identify the adjectives.
- ⁷⁵ Twelve with Vishnu and Shakra included.
- ⁷⁶ *Vidyut* means lightning and there are believed to be four kinds of lightning—tawny (with gusts of wind), red (during summer), yellow

(during the monsoon) and black (during famines).

⁷⁷ Usually listed as twelve Adityas, eleven Rudras, eight Vasus and two Ashvins.

⁷⁸ Uma is Shiva's wife.

⁷⁹ Respectively descended from Pulomaa and Kalaka.

⁸⁰ This is a reference to the Nivatakavachas. The Mahabharata tells us how Arjuna killed them.

⁸¹ The *shlokas* disrupt the continuity. These are Tamra's daughters.

⁸² Suparna is Garuda's name.

⁸³ Shankha is mentioned twice.

⁸⁴ Since he killed a demon named Paka, Indra is known as the chastiser of Paka. Naturally, Indra didn't want this son to be born. Shakra is one of Indra's names, as is Maghavan.

⁸⁵ Do not cry.

⁸⁶ From the etymology given. The Maruts are sometimes described as seven in number, sometimes as forty-nine. They are wind-gods and Indra's companions.

⁸⁷ Respectively, the gods of rains and the sun.

⁸⁸ Indra.

⁸⁹ Girisha means Shiva. *Bhutas* are demons, *pishachas* are demons who survive on flesh.

⁹⁰ Plaksha is the Indian fig tree. *Vanaspati* is any large forest tree. Specifically, it is a tree that has fruit, but no visible flowers.

⁹¹ In this context, *dvipa* means a region of the earth, akin to a continent. The earth is divided into seven *dvipas*.

⁹² Meaning Vaivasvata Manu became Manu instead of Chakshusha Manu, not that Vaivasvata Manu replaced Prithu. The 'he' presumably refers to Brahma.

⁹³ The word used is *tata*. As mentioned earlier, the word is used for someone who is younger, like a son. But the word also means father and is used for someone who is older, like a father. This being Lomaharshana, the sages would perhaps address him as someone junior, though it might also be the other way round.

⁹⁴ The three objectives of human existence (*purushartha*) are *dharma*, *artha* (pursuit of wealth) and *kama* (pursuit of the senses). These are for this world. *Moksha* (emancipation) is a fourth objective, for liberation from this world.

- ⁹⁵ In this Purana, the word Prajapati is used in a more general sense than in other Puranas.
- ⁹⁶ Mrityu means Death. While Kala has more than one meaning, here, it is synonymous with Death.
- ⁹⁷ *Vashatkara* is the exclamation ‘vashat’ made at the time of offering an oblation. *Svadha* is said at the time of offering oblations to the ancestors and *svaha* is said at the time of offering oblations to the gods.
- ⁹⁸ A *yajna* and a *kratu* are both sacrifices. However, the former is performed with a sacrificial post and the latter without one. More specifically, the former is performed with sacrificial animals and the latter without sacrificing animals.
- ⁹⁹ Meaning, ‘Be seated.’
- ¹⁰⁰ The *nishadas* were hunters who dwelt in mountains and forests.
- ¹⁰¹ Fishermen.
- ¹⁰² *Arani* stands for the two churning sticks used to kindle a fire, by rubbing them against each other.
- ¹⁰³ A son is known as *putra* because he saves (*trayate*) from the hell named *put*.
- ¹⁰⁴ A king is consecrated/crowned with water sprinkled over the head.
- ¹⁰⁵ Etymologically, a king is known as *rajan* because he delights the subjects.
- ¹⁰⁶ They granted him passage.
- ¹⁰⁷ *Soutya* is the day when *soma* is pressed for a sacrifice.
- ¹⁰⁸ The land of Anupa was in Vidarbha, in Maharashtra now. Magadha is mostly in Bihar, with some parts of Bengal, Odisha and eastern UP. *Anupa* means a region near water.
- ¹⁰⁹ The text uses the word *vasudha* for the earth. *Vasudha*, or *vasundhara*, means store of riches (*vasu*).
- ¹¹⁰ *Chhandas*.
- ¹¹¹ The performer of one hundred sacrifices, Indra’s name.
- ¹¹² The sun-god.
- ¹¹³ Antaka means the Destroyer, here, mentioned separately from Yama. *Sudha* means both nectar from flowers and a beverage for the gods.
- ¹¹⁴ The bottle gourd.
- ¹¹⁵ The power of illusion.
- ¹¹⁶ The power of disappearing and becoming invisible.
- ¹¹⁷ The same name is given for *yakshas* and *rakshasas*.

- ¹¹⁸ Tall tree.
- ¹¹⁹ Respectively, the one who nurtures, the one who creates and the one who purifies.
- ¹²⁰ Madhu and Kaitabha were two *asuras* killed by Vishnu. The fat (*meda*) from their bodies created the earth.
- ¹²¹ Or Prithivi.
- ¹²² We only have eight names. The Harivamsha gives the missing names as Savana and Putra.
- ¹²³ They were *saptarshis* during the second *manvantara*.
- ¹²⁴ These are nine names. The Harivamsha gives ten names - Havirdhra, Sukriti, Jyoti, Apa, Murti, Ayasmaya, Prathita, Nabhashya, Nabha and Surya.
- ¹²⁵ This leaves things unclear. The Urjas were reborn as Vasishtha's sons during the third *manvantara* and became the *saptarshis* of that *manvantara*.
- ¹²⁶ There is a problem with the text here. Following the Harivamsha, the five categories of gods should be Adya, Prabhuta, Ribhu, Prithuka and Lekha.
- ¹²⁷ Chakshusha Manu's wife was Nangvala.
- ¹²⁸ Or Vishvadevas.
- ¹²⁹ Vaivasvata Manu.
- ¹³⁰ The Brahma Purana leaves this unclear. Reading the Harivamsha, one understands this means the forty-nine Maruts.
- ¹³¹ The Harivamsha explicitly states that at the end of a *manvantara*, twenty-eight of the winds go to heaven.
- ¹³² Meaning Kripacharya.
- ¹³³ We have been given nine names. Typically, ten sons are named for a Manu.
- ¹³⁴ Presumably meaning the Maruts again.
- ¹³⁵ The names of the future Manus are often given as Savarni, Daksha-Savarni, Brahma-Savarni, Dharma-Savarni, Rudra-Savarni, Rouchya and Bhoutya, such as in the Markandeya Purana.
- ¹³⁶ One among Manus, not one among Savarni Manus.
- ¹³⁷ Daksha's daughter.
- ¹³⁸ Vivasvat, Aditya and Martanda are names of Surya, the sun-god.
- ¹³⁹ The egg/fetus (*anda*) is not dead (*mrita*).
- ¹⁴⁰ The word *chhaya* means shadow.

- ¹⁴¹ Chhaya's name. Savarna means similar in complexion.
- ¹⁴² She was ashamed of having left her husband.
- ¹⁴³ That is, Vaivasvata Manu.
- ¹⁴⁴ The mother is Savarnaa, the son is Saavarna. This is the same as Savarni Manu.
- ¹⁴⁵ Vaivasvata Manu.
- ¹⁴⁶ One of Surya's names.
- ¹⁴⁷ She turned her rear away from him.
- ¹⁴⁸ Another name for Surya, the maker of radiance.
- ¹⁴⁹ Saturn.
- ¹⁵⁰ The same as Yamuna.
- ¹⁵¹ As a ruler.
- ¹⁵² That is, Manu's.
- ¹⁵³ Resulting in *chandra vamsha*, the lunar dynasty. Soma is the moon and Budha is Mercury.
- ¹⁵⁴ Usually, but not invariably, identified as Paithan in Maharashtra.
- ¹⁵⁵ We haven't been told who these are. Dhrishnuka is the same as Dhrishta. Ambarisha was the son of Nabhaga and Danda/Dandaka was the son of Ikshvaku.
- ¹⁵⁶ Dandakaranya, named after Danda/Dandaka.
- ¹⁵⁷ This does not fit at all.
- ¹⁵⁸ Dvaravati or Dvaraka.
- ¹⁵⁹ A gate is *dvara*. Hence a city with *dvaras*, Dvaravati.
- ¹⁶⁰ Balarama.
- ¹⁶¹ Raivata.
- ¹⁶² Raivata.
- ¹⁶³ We have earlier been told that they were *kshatriyas* who became *vaishyas*. The Harivamsha has such statements about Nabhaga's two sons, without mentioning Rishta.
- ¹⁶⁴ *Kshut* means to sneeze. Hence the name.
- ¹⁶⁵ Literally, the northern road. The northern part of Jambudvipa.
- ¹⁶⁶ *Ashtaka* is the eighth lunar day, but during *krishna paksha*, the dark lunar fortnight.
- ¹⁶⁷ A funeral or other ceremony performed for the ancestors.
- ¹⁶⁸ One who has eaten a hare (*shasha*).
- ¹⁶⁹ Not to be confused with the more famous Prithu.
- ¹⁷⁰ In UP, near Ayodhya, the capital of the Kosala kingdom.

- ¹⁷¹ Vishnu's energy.
- ¹⁷² Royal sage.
- ¹⁷³ Samhataśvha's.
- ¹⁷⁴ Prasenajit's.
- ¹⁷⁵ Trasadasyu.
- ¹⁷⁶ *Shvapakas* are sometimes equated with *chandalas*. *Shva* means dog and *paka* means to cook. Thus, *shvapaka* means someone who cooks dogs (eats dogs) or cooks for dogs (lives with dogs).
- ¹⁷⁷ Because there was no king in the kingdom.
- ¹⁷⁸ Satyavrata.
- ¹⁷⁹ Vishvamitra was descended from Kusha and is, therefore, Koushika. *Gala* means throat or neck and Galava's name is derived from that.
- ¹⁸⁰ *Vrata* is a vow. Chanting (*japa*) of a *mantra* takes place in the course of observing a vow. This *japa* can be of three types—*vachika* (loud chanting), *manasika* (silent chanting mentally) or *upamshu* (when only the person performing the *japa* can hear the chanting, which is in a low voice).
- ¹⁸¹ One can deduce what this means. The maiden who had been abducted by Satyavrata was being married to someone else. However, the seven steps hadn't been completed.
- ¹⁸² *Shanku* means stake/dart and *tri* is three.
- ¹⁸³ Trishanku's son.
- ¹⁸⁴ *Vijaya* means victory.
- ¹⁸⁵ Bahu.
- ¹⁸⁶ Thus, Bahu was ousted by the Haihayas and Talajanghas.
- ¹⁸⁷ His mother had been fed poison by her co-wife. *Sagara* means *sa* (with) *gara* (poison).
- ¹⁸⁸ Ourva was born in the Bhargava lineage.
- ¹⁸⁹ Sagarā's son and Sagara would dwell in heaven for eternity.
- ¹⁹⁰ Gift given to a guest.
- ¹⁹¹ The king was Sagara and the ocean became Saagara.
- ¹⁹² One born from a Suta, that is, Lomaharshana.
- ¹⁹³ A *muhurta* is a period of 48 minutes and in a 24-hour period, there are 30 *muhurtas*.
- ¹⁹⁴ Literally, he knew the heart of the dice.
- ¹⁹⁵ *Anuttara* means foremost, excellent.
- ¹⁹⁶ The semen flowed as tears of *soma* through the eyes.

- ¹⁹⁷ The word used is *pradakshina*, which is much more specific than a mere act of circling. This circling or circumambulation has to be done in a specific way, so that the right side (*dakshina*) always faces what is being circled. If one is undertaking a tour of pilgrimage, this must begin with the south, then move to the west, then the north and finally the east. The right side, so to speak, then always faces the centre of the earth.
- ¹⁹⁸ *Padma* can be taken as an extremely large number, or specifically, as one thousand billion. In the latter case, a hundred thousand billion years.
- ¹⁹⁹ Of gold coins.
- ²⁰⁰ Sinivali is the deity (and the day) for the day preceding the night of the new moon, while Kuhu is the deity (and the day) for the night of the new moon.
- ²⁰¹ *Avabhritha* is the most important final component of a sacrifice, characterized by the taking of a bath.
- ²⁰² Soma.
- ²⁰³ Brihaspati.
- ²⁰⁴ Shukracharya, the preceptor of the demons.
- ²⁰⁵ The name of Shiva's bow.
- ²⁰⁶ Over Tara.
- ²⁰⁷ A mark of love and affection.
- ²⁰⁸ From Brihaspati (Jupiter). Budha is Mercury.
- ²⁰⁹ Urvashi was a celestial *apsara* and Pururava was a mere man.
- ²¹⁰ Kubera's capital.
- ²¹¹ Another name for Badarikashrama.
- ²¹² These are respective durations of time—ten years in Chaitraratha, five years along the Mandakini, five years in Alaka and so on.
- ²¹³ Jahnavi is another name for Ganga.
- ²¹⁴ Kanchana is the same as Kanchanaprabha.
- ²¹⁵ Jahnu's daughter. There is a parallel story about a sage named Jahnu. When Ganga flooded his hermitage, Jahnu drank her up. When Bhagiratha pleaded with the sage, Jahnu released Ganga and she became known as Jahnavi.
- ²¹⁶ There are several versions of the story, most centering around jealousy between Ganga and Kaveri.
- ²¹⁷ Kushika's.
- ²¹⁸ *Charu* is an oblation of rice, barley and pulses, cooked in butter and milk. Gadhi didn't have a son. He only had a daughter, Satyavati.

- ²¹⁹ That is, Satyavati's mother had done it deliberately, not inadvertently.
- ²²⁰ This is an additional explanation for the mix-up between Parashurama (Jamadagni's son) and Vishvamitra (Gadhi's son).
- ²²¹ Koshi in Bihar.
- ²²² The son, Parashurama.
- ²²³ This sentence hangs loose. Thus stated, they seem to have been Satyavati and Richika's sons. More commonly, they are described as Ajigarta's sons. Later, Shunahshepha was adopted by Vishvamitra as a son.
- ²²⁴ A *brahmarshi* is the highest state of being a *rishi*, higher than a *maharshi*.
- ²²⁵ In between the *varna* system.
- ²²⁶ A reference to Shunahshepha being adopted by Vishvamitra.
- ²²⁷ Literally, protected by the gods (*deva*).
- ²²⁸ However, more than seven names have been given earlier.
- ²²⁹ A maharatha is a great warrior who can fight ten thousand soldiers single-handedly.
- ²³⁰ The word used is *tata*.
- ²³¹ Those descended from Shunaka.
- ²³² The text says Kashya's son. Perhaps it means Kashyapa's son, since that preserves continuity in the text.
- ²³³ Dhanu.
- ²³⁴ Dhanvantari.
- ²³⁵ Medicine. Literally, the technique of ensuring a long lifespan.
- ²³⁶ *Ayurveda* covers eight topics—general medicine, pediatrics, extraction of foreign objects, ENT (ear, nose, throat) ailments, pacification of spirits, toxicology, rejuvenation and aphrodisiacs.
- ²³⁷ One of Shiva's attendants. There are various versions of this curse, all involving Divodasa.
- ²³⁸ Divodasa.
- ²³⁹ Agastya's wife.
- ²⁴⁰ Alarka.
- ²⁴¹ Alarka was known as Sannati. *Sannati* means righteousness/virtue.
- ²⁴² We aren't told who Vatsa was. The Harivamsha tells us Vatsa was Satyaketu's son.
- ²⁴³ Vishnu.
- ²⁴⁴ Yayati.

- ²⁴⁵ The king of Chedi was Vasu and Vasu's eldest son was Brihadratha. Brihadratha established a dynasty in Magadha and Jarasandha was born into this dynasty.
- ²⁴⁶ Druhyu got the west and Anu the north.
- ²⁴⁷ That is, a fire.
- ²⁴⁸ *Kala* means part and also a digit of the moon. There are sixteen *kalas* in the whole.
- ²⁴⁹ A *putrika* is a daughter who is regarded as a son. After marriage, she lives in her father's household. Her son is regarded as her father's son and becomes the heir.
- ²⁵⁰ Rahu.
- ²⁵¹ Prabhakara means someone who creates light.
- ²⁵² Gold, cattle, land.
- ²⁵³ The five wives mentioned.
- ²⁵⁴ Dasharatha of the Ramayana had a daughter named Shanta who was adopted by King Lomapada.
- ²⁵⁵ Rishyashringa.
- ²⁵⁶ According to the Mahabharata, Tamsu was Matinara's son.
- ²⁵⁷ As in Bharatavarsha.
- ²⁵⁸ It is described in the Mahabharata, not in the Brahma Purana. Through three wives, Bharata had nine sons. These sons were not worthy. Since Bharata didn't approve of them, their mothers killed them. Bharata then performed a sacrifice and Bhumanyu originated from this sacrifice. Bharata adopted Bhumanyu as his son and successor. Here, the name is given as Vitatha.
- ²⁵⁹ *Vitatha* means futile.
- ²⁶⁰ Perhaps there is a typo. The Harivamsha says that he was the destroyer of all *rakshasas*.
- ²⁶¹ We have been told earlier that Alarka was descended from Vatsa.
- ²⁶² A *sarvamedha* sacrifice lasts for ten days and at this sacrifice, the sacrificer offers up his own self.
- ²⁶³ These were Gadhi's two sons and daughter.
- ²⁶⁴ Some *shlokas* from Chapter 1(8) are now repeated.
- ²⁶⁵ Shunahshepha's subsequent name.
- ²⁶⁶ Protected by five (*pancha*).
- ²⁶⁷ From *kripa* (compassion). Kripa was male and Kripa was female.

- ²⁶⁸ Being used here for Somaka, descended from Ajamidha. The word Ajamidha can be applied to anyone in the Ajamidha lineage.
- ²⁶⁹ Uparichara Vasu possessed a *vimana* which could travel through the sky. He conquered the Chedi kingdom. Girika was Uparichara Vasu's wife.
- ²⁷⁰ Since we don't know which Janamejaya is being spoken about, there is a break in continuity.
- ²⁷¹ This son was Vichitravirya.
- ²⁷² Through Vichitravirya's wives.
- ²⁷³ Abhimanyu, born through Subhadra.
- ²⁷⁴ That is, Hastinapura.
- ²⁷⁵ Literally the great journey, meaning death.
- ²⁷⁶ The text says Sucharu, but clearly means Subahu.
- ²⁷⁷ In the Mahabharata, Droupadi followed Yudhishtira to the forest.
- ²⁷⁸ Meaning, with sides like a goat.
- ²⁷⁹ Romaka's wife.
- ²⁸⁰ When Puru accepted his old age.
- ²⁸¹ The implication seems to be the following. Samyata was from the Turvasu line, therefore she carried the curse. Samvarta was from the Puru line, therefore he did not carry the curse. But because of the marriage, the curse passed on to Dushyanta.
- ²⁸² This gross error occurs because these parts of the Brahma Purana lift parts from elsewhere, such as the Harivamsha. Lomaharshana is addressing the sages, there is no king being addressed. In the Harivamsha, similar passages are addressed to King Janamejaya.
- ²⁸³ Since Sucheta's sons have not been mentioned, this is an inconsistency.
- ²⁸⁴ Since we do not know who Mahishmat was, this hangs loose.
- ²⁸⁵ Kartavirya Arjuna.
- ²⁸⁶ When he was not fighting, he had two arms.
- ²⁸⁷ Numbered in coins
- ²⁸⁸ *Chakravarti* is a universal emperor, literally, a king whose wheel (*chakra*) travels everywhere on earth.
- ²⁸⁹ The god of rain.
- ²⁹⁰ Kartavirya Arjuna's capital, identified with Maheshvara in Madhya Pradesh. Kartavirya Arjuna conquered Mahishmati from Karkotaka *naga*.
- ²⁹¹ It is possible this is a typo and should read adorned with crocodiles (*graha*) and not villages (*grama*).

- ²⁹² There are seven nether regions—Atala, Vitala, Sutala, Rasatala, Talatala, Mahatala and Patala, but Patala is also used as a generic term for all the nether regions taken together.
- ²⁹³ During the churning of the ocean.
- ²⁹⁴ Garuda.
- ²⁹⁵ Ravana was Pulastya's grandson and Vishrava's son. Thus, Ravana was Poulastya.
- ²⁹⁶ Parashurama, who killed Kartavirya Arjuna.
- ²⁹⁷ Chitrabhanu and Vibhavasú are names for the fire-god, Agni.
- ²⁹⁸ Kartavirya Arjuna, who was the king of the Haihaya kingdom.
- ²⁹⁹ Vasishtha was Varuna's son.
- ³⁰⁰ The text does not clearly indicate where Narada's statement ends and where Lomaharshana's begins. But this is as good a place as any.
- ³⁰¹ That is, they were known as the Haihayas earlier, but no longer.
- ³⁰² Vrishni and Andhaka were actually the sons of Yudhajit, but the text has 'sons' in the dual.
- ³⁰³ Indra. Indra killed a demon named Paka.
- ³⁰⁴ The king of Kashi.
- ³⁰⁵ The one with the tawny horses, Indra's name.
- ³⁰⁶ Meaning, giver of a cow.
- ³⁰⁷ The names of Akrura's brothers.
- ³⁰⁸ Ugrasena.
- ³⁰⁹ Krishna's father. *Anaka* means a drum (or thunder-cloud), *dundubhi* also means a drum.
- ³¹⁰ Probably meaning Avanti, the king of Avanti.
- ³¹¹ Kuntibhoja.
- ³¹² An unmatched warrior, superior to a *maharatha*.
- ³¹³ The same as Devashrava.
- ³¹⁴ Vishnu.
- ³¹⁵ This doesn't belong. Rukmini married Krishna and their son was Pradyumna. But Krishna hasn't been born yet.
- ³¹⁶ Seventh in the second list.
- ³¹⁷ Balarama.
- ³¹⁸ Shura's descendant, meaning Krishna.
- ³¹⁹ This sentence doesn't belong here.
- ³²⁰ In the second list of seven.

- ³²¹ This requires explanation. Gargya was the priest of the Yadavas and was Shishirayana's brother-in-law. Doubting Gargya's virility and taking him to be a eunuch, Shishirayana placed a hand on Gargya's testicles.
- ³²² Shiva. Gargya was devoted to Shiva.
- ³²³ This requires explanation again. Having given birth to the child, the *apsara* vanished and Gargya handed the child over to a king of the *yavanas*. The *yavanas* are Ionians or Greeks.
- ³²⁴ An *akshouhini* is an army and consists of 21,870 chariots, 21,870 elephants, 65,610 horses and 109,350 infantry men.
- ³²⁵ Jarasandha attacked Mathura eighteen times and made the Yadavas flee to Dvaraka. In some accounts, Kalayavana was Jarasandha's general.
- ³²⁶ Shiva, Kalayavana having been born through Shiva's favours.
- ³²⁷ *Madhu* means sweet.
- ³²⁸ Also known as Varnasha.
- ³²⁹ Devavridha.
- ³³⁰ To distinguish with the sons, Shantidevaa, Sudevaa and Devarakshita.
- ³³¹ Kamsaa.
- ³³² Brother and sister possessed the same name for Sutanu and Kanka.

333 In the list of Bhajamana's sons, this name has not been mentioned earlier.
334 There is repetition with what has been stated earlier and some
inconsistencies.
335 Inconsistencies again.
336 The sun-god. Ravi is another name for Surya, as is Vivasvat.
337 Satrajit.
338 Without the blazing disc.
339 That is, you don't really need it.
340 Surya's name.
341 Krishna decided that he was more suitable to possess it.
342 There were friends who followed Krishna.
343 Krishna.
344 The name of the king of the bears.
345 Balarama or Baladeva.
346 The name of Vishnu and Krishna's bow, made of horn.
347 Krishna. Krishna is Vaasudeva, his father is Vasudeva.
348 Since all of them had left, this is an inconsistency.
349 Krishna's name, the one without decay.
350 Satyabhama.
351 Meaning Kroshta.
352 Meaning Prishni, Madhu's son.
353 She married Samba.
354 This concerns an incident from the Mahabharata. Duryodhana plotted to
burn down the Pandavas in a house of lac in Varanavata. The Pandavas
were presumed dead and Krishna went to Varanavata for the funeral rites.
355 Balarama.
356 The curse remains unclear, but may refer to the curse of Kamsa being
killed.
357 Shatadhanva.
358 A *yojana* is a measure of distance, between 8 and 9 miles.
359 The person is Akrura. The idea is that the possession of Syamanataka
enabled him to collect these materials.
360 Balarama.
361 Because Akrura had left Dvaraka, with his fortunate Syamantaka.
362 Indra.
363 Meaning Kaccha, a marshy area, Kutch in Gujarat.
364 Krishna.

- ³⁶⁵ He could wear it openly and no longer needed to conceal it.
- ³⁶⁶ The sun.
- ³⁶⁷ Semi-divine species, companions of Kubera.
- ³⁶⁸ *Dvipas* are like continents. *Varshas* are sub-divisions of continents, they are like sub-continents.
- ³⁶⁹ Respectively, oceans made out of salty waters, sugar-cane juice, liquor, *ghee*, curds, milk and sweet water.
- ³⁷⁰ Mount Meru is in the form of an inverted cone.
- ³⁷¹ Nishadha to the south of Meru and Nila to the north of Meru.
- ³⁷² With Nishadha, Meru and Nila accounted for, the others are Himalayas, Hemakuta, Shveta and Shringi. Of these Hemakuta and Himalayas are to the south of Meru and Shveta and Shringi are to the north of Meru. Hemakuta is 90,000 *yojanas* long and the Himalayas 80,000 *yojanas* long. Shveta is 90,000 *yojanas* long and Shringi 80,000 *yojanas* long.
- ³⁷³ Jambu-dvipa is divided into nine *varshas*—Bharata, Kimpurusha, Hari, Ramyaka, Hiranmaya, Uttarakuru, Ilavrita, Bhadrashva and Ketumala. Ilavrita is in the centre.
- ³⁷⁴ Respectively in Mandara, Gandhamadana, Vipula and Suparshva. *Kadamba* is *stephegyne parvifolia*, *jambu* is the rose apple tree and both *pippala* and *vata* are holy fig trees.
- ³⁷⁵ Of Gandhamadana.
- ³⁷⁶ Each of the mountains Mandara, Gandhamadana, Vipula and Suparshva has a grove and a lake. This is usually stated as Chaitraratha in Mandara, Nandana in Gandhamadana, Vaibhaja in Vipula and Savitra in Suparshva.
- ³⁷⁷ With Meru being compared to a lotus.
- ³⁷⁸ That is, Meru.
- ³⁷⁹ The two Nishadhas cause confusion and the first should probably be Rishabha.
- ³⁸⁰ This suggests that out of Nishadha (Rishabha) and Pariyatra, one is to the east of Meru and the other is to the west of Meru. What is probably intended is that Nishadha (Rishabha) and Pariyatra are to the west of Meru and Jathara and Devakuta are to the east of Meru.
- ³⁸¹ Celestial bards.
- ³⁸² A *kinnara* or *kimpurusha* belongs to semi-divine species, companions of Kubera.

- ³⁸³ *Varaha* is boar, *kurma* is tortoise and *matsya* is fish. *Vishvarupa* is the universal form.
- ³⁸⁴ Excluding Bharatavarsha.
- ³⁸⁵ A *kulachala* is a great mountain, but any great mountain is not necessarily a *kulachala*. *Kulaparvata* is a synonym.
- ³⁸⁶ Region where *karma* is performed and its fruits enjoyed.
- ³⁸⁷ A metaphor for life on earth.
- ³⁸⁸ One seems to be missing. But the ninth sub-division is also known as Bharata.
- ³⁸⁹ Tapti.
- ³⁹⁰ Identified with Purna, or part of Tapti.
- ³⁹¹ Speculatively identified as a tributary of Warda.
- ³⁹² The river Bhima.
- ³⁹³ Distinct from the earlier Rishikulya.
- ³⁹⁴ The text has the singular, though it should be in the plural.
- ³⁹⁵ The singular again.
- ³⁹⁶ Places of enjoyment.
- ³⁹⁷ They have long lifespans.
- ³⁹⁸ The *jambu* tree in Jambudvipa.
- ³⁹⁹ The same as Rohita.
- ⁴⁰⁰ The silk-cotton tree.
- ⁴⁰¹ As the lord.
- ⁴⁰² The name of the seventh river hasn't been given.
- ⁴⁰³ As the lord.
- ⁴⁰⁴ Only three names are given.
- ⁴⁰⁵ The *shirisha* tree, a variety of acacia or mimosa.
- ⁴⁰⁶ That is, *moksha*.
- ⁴⁰⁷ He was the lord of Pushkaradvipa.
- ⁴⁰⁸ This seems to indicate a radius of fifty thousand *yojanas*.
- ⁴⁰⁹ Obviously, other than Manasottara.
- ⁴¹⁰ The text only uses the word three, presumably meaning the three *Vedas*.
- ⁴¹¹ Respectively, the bright and dark lunar fortnights.
- ⁴¹² An *angula* is the length of a finger.
- ⁴¹³ Sweet, sour, salty, bitter, pungent and astringent.
- ⁴¹⁴ Lokaloka can be interpreted in various ways, places where there is light versus places where there is darkness, populated places versus uninhabited regions, and so on.

- ⁴¹⁵ The final *shlokas* of this chapter are difficult to translate, since the meaning is not self-evident.
- ⁴¹⁶ The earth.
- ⁴¹⁷ Hells.
- ⁴¹⁸ Usually twenty-eight hells are mentioned. Here, we have a list of 27.
- ⁴¹⁹ Rourava is a hell where one suffers at the hands of fierce animals known as *rurus*.
- ⁴²⁰ *Shukara* means pig. *Shoukara* probably means a hell where people are so tortured that they squeal like pigs.
- ⁴²¹ Saffron.
- ⁴²² This hell has not been mentioned earlier. *Taptaloha* means heated iron, while *Taptakumbha* means heated pot. Since the pot can be filled with molten iron, the two hells can be identical.
- ⁴²³ Literally, large blaze.
- ⁴²⁴ This has not been mentioned earlier, the word means speckled.
- ⁴²⁵ A place where one is confounded.
- ⁴²⁶ Where worms feed on the sinner.
- ⁴²⁷ Where worms lord over the sinner.
- ⁴²⁸ Where the sinner feeds on saliva.
- ⁴²⁹ Not mentioned earlier. An excessively fierce arrow probably means an arrow with poison at the tip, something generally condemned. *Vedhaka* probably means a place where the sinner is pierced or poisoned.
- ⁴³⁰ Not mentioned earlier. A place where the sinner is slaughtered, or set on fire.
- ⁴³¹ The same as *Adhahshira*, where the sinner is hung face downwards.
- ⁴³² Not mentioned earlier, a place rendered impure by worms.
- ⁴³³ *Krimipuya*.
- ⁴³⁴ Special auspicious days.
- ⁴³⁵ Not mentioned earlier, a place where the sinner faces hardships.
- ⁴³⁶ A place where the leaves of trees and bushes are like swords.
- ⁴³⁷ Literally, a net of fire.
- ⁴³⁸ A place where the sinner is bitten.
- ⁴³⁹ A place where the sinner is eaten by dogs.
- ⁴⁴⁰ Of birth as these species and then moving upwards in subsequent births.
- ⁴⁴¹ This seems to mean that one thousand births as inferior species enables one to have a single birth in a species that is just above the inferior one.
- ⁴⁴² Atonment.

- 443 *Manu*.
- 444 *Sandhya* is dawn and dusk, when night meets day and day meets night.
- 445 Bhuloka is earth, Svarloka is heaven and Bhuvarloka is the space in between the two.
- 446 *Grahas*.
- 447 We have translated *parimandala* as circumference.
- 448 Mercury.
- 449 Shukra or Venus.
- 450 Mars. Bhouma is another name for Mars.
- 451 Brihaspati or Jupiter.
- 452 Saturn.
- 453 Sanaka, Sananda, Sanatana and Sanatkumara.
- 454 Bhuloka, Bhuvarloka and Svarloka.
- 455 Created afresh at the end of a *kalpa*.
- 456 Not destroyed at the end of a *kalpa*.
- 457 *Brahmanda*.
- 458 Since Pradhana is infinite, this actually means six—the cosmic egg, water, fire, wind, space and Mahat.
- 459 Purusha and Prakriti/Pradhana.
- 460 Shishumara is the Gangetic porpoise/dolphin. In the sky, it is a constellation, which can partly be identified with Draco, the dragon. Dhruva is towards the rear end of Shishumara.
- 461 Dhruva.
- 462 The sun.
- 463 *Abhra* is a cloud, derived from ‘a’ (does not) shower down (*bhramshan*).
- 464 Surya.
- 465 There are 27 lunar mansions or *nakshatras*. Since some *nakshatras* are constellations, *nakshatra* should not really be translated as star.
- 466 There are four elephants that dwell in the four directions. These are known as *diggajas*, the elephant (*gaja*) for a direction (*dik*).
- 467 This seems to mean that it doesn’t go through the *diggajas*.
- 468 Both *tirthas* and *kshetras* are sacred places of pilgrimage. However, *tirthas* are associated with water, while *kshetras* are not.
- 469 Kotitirtha is repeated. This word, which means one crore *tirthas* together, can also be an adjective and therefore, occur in different locations. Some others that are repeated can also be adjectives, or generic names, such as Suryatirtha.

- 470 Suryaprabha is repeated.
- 471 Prayaga has already been mentioned.
- 472 Repeated again.
- 473 Repeated.
- 474 Repeated.
- 475 Repeated.
- 476 Repeated.
- 477 Repeated.
- 478 Repeated.
- 479 Repeated.
- 480 Repeated.
- 481 Repeated.
- 482 Repeated.
- 483 Repeated.
- 484 Repeated.
- 485 Repeated.
- 486 Repeated.
- 487 Repeated.
- 488 Repeated.
- 489 Repeated.
- 490 Repeated.
- 491 Repeated.
- 492 Mentioned earlier as Badari.
- 493 Repeated.
- 494 Repeated.
- 495 Repeated.
- 496 Repeated.
- 497 Repeated.
- 498 60,000 sages who were the sizes of thumbs. They preceded the sun's chariot.
- 499 *Punnaga* can mean either nutmeg or a white lotus, *karnikara* is the name of a tree, *sarala* is a kind of pine, *devadaru* is also a kind of pine, *shala/sala* is *Shorea robusta*, *tala* is a palm tree, *tamala* is a tree with dark bark, *panasa* is the jackfruit tree, *dhava* is the axlewood tree, *khadira* is a kind of tree, *patala* is *Bignonia Suaveolens*, *ashoka* is a tree with orange red flowers (*Saraca Indica*), *bakula* is a tree with fragrant

flowers, *karavira* is a kind of tree and *champaka* is a tree with yellow and fragrant flowers.

500 Transcendental knowledge about the *paramatman*.

501 *Agamas* are texts other than the *Vedas*, such as the *tantra* texts.

502 Vedavyasa was the son of Parashara and Satyavati. His name was Krishna Dvaipayana, Vedavyasa being like a title.

503 Semi-divine species.

504 The gods are asking themselves this.

505 The suggestion is that Bharatavarsha is the larger entity, while Bharata is the ninth of the mentioned *dvipas*.

506 Barbarians, those who did not speak Sanskrit.

507 Vipasha is repeated.

508 Clearly a different Sindhu.

509 Vetravati is repeated.

510 Vipasha is repeated.

511 Tridiva is repeated.

512 The Bharagya is Parashurama and the Govardhana in question was near Nasik.

513 *Dakshinapatha* means the southern route, but is a term also applied to the southern region.

514 Koshala is repeated.

515 The four stages of life (*ashrama*) are *brahmacharya* (state of being a student), *garhasthya* (householder stage), *vanaprastha* (seeking refuge in the forest) and *sannyasa* (renouncing).

516 That is, *vanaprastha*.

517 *Ishta* is religious rites, *purta* is civic works.

518 The six tasks recommended for *brahmanas*—teaching, studying, performing their own sacrifices, officiating at sacrifices, giving donations, receiving donations.

519 A kind of sacrifice.

520 The maker of the day, Surya's name.

521 Konaditya and Konarka have the same meaning. Derived from Surya's name of Konaditya/Konarka, the place is called Konarka/Konark (in Odisha).

522 *Bakula* is repeated.

523 *Tagara* is *valeriana*, *bana* is the porcupine flower, *atimukta* is the Harimantha tree, *kubjaka* is *achyranthes aspera*, *malati* is a kind of

jasmine, *kunda* is also a kind of jasmine, *mallika* is also a kind of jasmine, *ketaki* is the fragrant crepe myrtle or caldera, *lakucha* is the breadfruit tree, *sarala* is a kind of pine, *muchukunda* is a kind of *karnikara*, *saptaparna* is *alstonia scholaris*, *amrataka* is the hog-plum, *puga* is areca nut and *kapitthaka* is a kind of wood-apple.

⁵²⁴ January–February.

⁵²⁵ *Makara* is a mythical aquatic creature, which can loosely be translated as crocodile or shark.

⁵²⁶ *Anga-nyasa* is the mental appropriation (*nyasa*) of different limbs of the body (*anga*) to different divinities. *Kara-nyasa* is similarly done to different parts of the hand (*kara*). This is an act of purification.

⁵²⁷ A *mudra* is a symbolic and mystical positioning of the fingers and the thumb.

⁵²⁸ There is a *mantra* to Surya that goes *oum hram hrim hrum hraum hrah*. All these words have three *aksharas*. One possible interpretation is that one says *oum* for the east, *hram* for the heart, *hrim* for the head, *hrum* for the tuft of hair, *hraim* for the armour, *hroum* for the eyes and *hrah* for the weapon

⁵²⁹ *Japa*, silent chanting.

⁵³⁰ March–April.

⁵³¹ *Damana bhanjika yatra* is a specific festival in the month of Chaitra, celebrated during *shukla paksha*, either on the twelfth or fourteenth lunar day. The name originates from the destruction (*bhanjana*) of a demon named Damanaka by Vishnu. *Yatra* means a pilgrimage there.

⁵³² *Uttarayana* is the movement of the sun to the north of the equator, the period from the winter to the summer solstice. *Dakshinayana* is the movement of the sun to the south of the equator, the period from the summer to the winter solstice.

⁵³³ Shiva burnt down Kama, the god of love, and is therefore Kama's enemy.

⁵³⁴ *Yoga* has eight elements—*yama* (restraint), *niyama* (rituals), *asana* (posture), *pranayama* (breathing), *pratyahara* (withdrawal), *dharana* (retention), *dhyana* (meditation) and *samadhi* (liberation). That's the reason the expression *ashtanga* (eight-formed) *yoga* is used.

⁵³⁵ *Nastikas*.

⁵³⁶ We have translated *vyoma* as Surya's temple.

⁵³⁷ *Saptami* is the seventh lunar day. *Arka* is Surya's name, as well as a name for the sun plant.

- 538 Mahashveta means dazzling white. Mahashvetaa, in the feminine, is
Sarasvati or Durga's name. Here, in the masculine, it means Surya.
- 539 Surya.
- 540 The funeral cake of a *shraddha* ceremony.
- 541 A fragrant gum resin.
- 542 *Shrivasa*.
- 543 This presumably means at the times when one *ayana* changes to another.
- 544 When solstices/equinoxes occur in the signs of Sagittarius, Pisces,
Gemini or Virgo.
- 545 *Payasam* is a dish made out sweetened milk and rice. *Krisara* is a dish
made out of sesamum and grain.
- 546 The text uses the word mendicant, *bhikshuka*.
- 547 This Janaka is not to be confused with the Janaka who was Sita's father.
There were several kings named Janaka in the Janaka lineage.
- 548 Another name for Surya.
- 549 Sometimes identified with Chandrabhaga.
- 550 Earlier referred to as Amsha.
- 551 Samba was Krishna's son. To cure himself of leprosy (the result of a
curse), he worshipped Surya in Mitravana, on the banks of the
Chandrabhaga and established a temple for the sun there (the Multan sun
temple).
- 552 These are Narada's thoughts.
- 553 Probably, but not certainly, meaning Brahma, Vishnu and Shiva.
- 554 *Kshetra* means field. *Kshetrajna* means one who knows about the
kshetra.
- 555 The universe is his form.
- 556 The great Purusha.
- 557 *Prana* draws breath into the body, *apana* exhales it. *Vyana* distributes it
through the body and *samana* assimilates it. *Udana* gives rise to sound.
These are the five forms of the breath of life.
- 558 Prakriti evolved from him.
- 559 Alternatively, instead of cause and effect, the existent and the non-
existent.
- 560 Since this is addressed to Narada, it should be in the singular.
- 561 This should be in the plural.
- 562 Vishnu.

- ⁵⁶³ Though it is sometimes used in the sense of an instant, a *muhurta* is a measure of time equal to 48 minutes. *Kshana* is a smaller measure of time.
- ⁵⁶⁴ We have translated *hemanta* as late autumn and *shishira* as winter. The cold season is *hemanta*, between autumn and winter. Winter proper is *shishira*. *Hemanta* is the months of Margashirsha (also known as Agrahayana) and Pousha. Margashirsha is roughly mid-November to mid-December, while Pousha is mid-December to mid-January. *Shishira* is the months of Magha (mid-January to mid-February) and Phalguna (mid-February to mid-March).
- ⁵⁶⁵ That is, this set of twelve names is used on earth in general, whereas the next set of twelve is specific to specific months.
- ⁵⁶⁶ Chaitra is March–April, Vaishakha is April–May, Jyeshtha is May–June, Ashadha is June–July, Shravana is July–August, Proushtha (Proshthapada or Bhadra) is August–September, Ashvayuja (Ashvina) is September–October, Kartika is October–November, Margashirsha (Agrahayana) is November–December, Pousha is December–January, Magha is January–February and Phalguna is February–March.
- ⁵⁶⁷ Literally, king of hymns (praises).
- ⁵⁶⁸ This should be in the plural.
- ⁵⁶⁹ *Rajas* is associated with the colour red.
- ⁵⁷⁰ *Chandrayana* is a kind of fasting that follows the progress (*ayana*) of the moon (*chandra*). On the full moon night, one only eats fifteen mouthfuls of food. For the fifteen lunar days following the full moon, this is decreased by one mouthful per day. For the fifteen lunar days following the new moon, this is increased by one mouthful per day. *Krichha* means a vow of hardship.
- ⁵⁷¹ From egg (*anda*) that has been killed (*marita*).
- ⁵⁷² The text uses both *astra* and *shastra*. These are both weapons and the words are often used synonymously. However, an *astra* is a weapon that is hurled or released, while a *shastra* is held in the hand.
- ⁵⁷³ The word *chhaya* means shadow.
- ⁵⁷⁴ She was ashamed because she shouldn't have left her husband's household.
- ⁵⁷⁵ Manu was the elder of Samjna's sons, Yama was the younger one.
- ⁵⁷⁶ Towards one set, not one literally.
- ⁵⁷⁷ *Karmakanda* stands for ritualistic worship.

⁵⁷⁸ Not to be confused with the *rishi*, this Narada is a *gandharva*.

⁵⁷⁹ The seven *svaras* (notes) are *shadaja*, *rishabha*, *gandhara*, *madhyama*, *panchama*, *dhaivata* and *nishada*; *murchhana* is moving up or down the scale, with seven *svaras* to start, there are thus seven *murcchanas*; *tala* is the beat of time in music.

⁵⁸⁰ Musical instrument like a pipe.

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581 Brahma.
582 Indra's bow is the rainbow.
583 Agni's name.
584 We have added the numbering. Naturally, the numbers don't exist in the text. We have explained the meanings of the names only in instances where they aren't obvious. There are 110 names, not 108. This means that two of the names listed are adjectives and not proper names.
585 Good fortune, that is, the granter of good fortune.
586 The one who nourishes.
587 The one with the rays.
588 One without birth.
589 One who creates radiance.
590 Earth.
591 Water.
592 Energy/fire.
593 Space.
594 Refuge.
595 One with the shining rays.
596 Pure.
597 The mighty one.
598 Lightning.
599 The digestive fire.
600 Kindling.
601 Lord of energy.
602 One with the standard of *dharma*.
603 Creator of the *Vedas*.
604 Borne by the *Vedas*.
605 Refuge of all the immortals.
606 The different measurements of time.
607 Creator of the year.
608 Wheel of time.
609 Eternal Purusha.
610 Manifest and unmanifest.
611 Eternal.
612 Controller of time.
613 Controller of subjects.
614 Dispeller of darkness.

- 615 Part of the ocean.
- 616 Cloud.
- 617 Life.
- 618 Destroyer of enemies.
- 619 Refuge of the elements/creatures.
- 620 Lord of the elements/creatures.
- 621 Worshipped by all the worlds.
- 622 Creator.
- 623 One who causes revolutions.
- 624 Owner of sacrifices.
- 625 Origin of everything.
- 626 Lacking in greed.
- 627 The infinite one.
- 628 Granter of wishes.
- 629 With a face in every direction.
- 630 Granter of boons.
- 631 Engaged in the welfare of all beings.
- 632 Mind.
- 633 Origin of the elements/creatures.
- 634 Swift.
- 635 Sustainer of life.
- 636 Comet/meteor.
- 637 The original god.
- 638 Aditi's son.
- 639 With twelve manifestations.
- 640 Skilled.
- 641 Father-mother-paternal grandfather.
- 642 Gate to heaven.
- 643 Gate to offspring.
- 644 Gate to *moksha*.
- 645 Heaven.
- 646 Creator of the body.
- 647 The one with a tranquil soul.
- 648 Soul of the universe.
- 649 With a face everywhere.
- 650 The soul of mobile and immobile objects.
- 651 With a subtle soul.

- ⁶⁵² Mitra's son.
- ⁶⁵³ The compassionate one.
- ⁶⁵⁴ *Rakshasas*.
- ⁶⁵⁵ Shiva destroyed a city of the demons named Tripura.
- ⁶⁵⁶ Vrishadhava is the one with a bull (*vrisha*) on his banner (*dhvaja*), that is, Shiva or Mahadeva. Krittivasa means the one who is clad in a hide.
- ⁶⁵⁷ Ekamraka/Ekamra is in Bhubaneswar. This is the Lingaraja temple, which used to be under a single (*eka*) mango tree (*amra*).
- ⁶⁵⁸ Tryambaka is the three-eyed one, Shiva.
- ⁶⁵⁹ This bit is clearly addressed to the *rishis*.
- ⁶⁶⁰ Having offered oblations to the gods, they will touch water and conclude the rites, without having offered a share to Shiva.
- ⁶⁶¹ Himalayas.
- ⁶⁶² A *svayamvara* is when a maiden chooses her own husband from amongst several suitors.
- ⁶⁶³ *Ganas* are Shiva's companions and attendants.
- ⁶⁶⁴ Every day—hence, *eka* (one) *patala*.
- ⁶⁶⁵ *Eka* (one) *parna* (leaf).
- ⁶⁶⁶ A (not) a leaf (*parna*).
- ⁶⁶⁷ 'U' is an exclamation, a bit like 'Oh'. *Ma* means do not. Thus, Uma.
- ⁶⁶⁸ Women who follow *brahmacharya*.
- ⁶⁶⁹ Asita and Devala were two famous *rishis*. Sometimes, they are referred to as two distinct individuals. Sometimes, they are referred to as one individual.
- ⁶⁷⁰ Shiva, the auspicious one, is one of Uma's names.
- ⁶⁷¹ *Tilaka* is a mark made on the forehead.
- ⁶⁷² *Bahuka*.
- ⁶⁷³ A guest is offered *padya* (water to wash the feet), *achamaniya* (water to rinse the mouth), *arghya* (a gift) and *asana* (a seat). *Madhuparka* is a mixture of honey and water, customarily offered to a guest.
- ⁶⁷⁴ This region is now partly in Madhya Pradesh and partly in Uttar Pradesh.
- ⁶⁷⁵ Become a *ganapati*.
- ⁶⁷⁶ Parvati's name. Literally, the daughter of a mountain.
- ⁶⁷⁷ A person who does not keep his word is censured.
- ⁶⁷⁸ The *svayamvara* had still not been formally performed. Parvati had chosen Shiva informally.
- ⁶⁷⁹ Yama.

- 680 Agni.
- 681 Rajaraja is one of Kubera's names.
- 682 Chandra.
- 683 Vishnu. Tarkshya is another name for Garuda.
- 684 Being used here as a name for the *naga* king.
- 685 *Chamaras*.
- 686 Indra. Indra killed a demon named Vritra.
- 687 Meaning Prakriti.
- 688 Written together as *yogamaya*.
- 689 Parvati.
- 690 All the seasons have arrived and this is a description of *varsha*, the rainy season. The six seasons (*ritus*) are *vasanta* or spring (Chaitra and Vaishakha), *grishma* or summer (Jyeshtha and Ashadha), *varsha* or monsoon (Shravana and Bhadrapada), *sharad* or early autumn (Ashvina and Kartika), *hemanta* or late autumn (Margashirsha/Agrahayana and Pousha) and *shishira* or winter (Magha and Phalguna).
- 691 *Abhimana*.
- 692 The rainbow.
- 693 In the rainy season, the husbands, who have been elsewhere on work, return to their homes and their wives.
- 694 The rainy season is being compared to a maiden.
- 695 This repetition is because after *hemanta* and *shishira*, *sharad* is now being described.
- 696 *Nipa* is another name for *kadamba*, *sarja* is another name for *sala*, *kovidara* is the Indian coral tree, *nageshvara* is the same as *nagakeshara*, *lavanga* is cinnamon, *kalaguru* is black agallochum and *shobhanjana* is the name of a tree.
- 697 *Koyashtis* are lapwings and *datyuhās* are gallinules.
- 698 Tree with orange-red flowers, flame of the forest, *Butea Frondosa*.
- 699 Ananga is Madana or Kama, the god of love.
- 700 *Kurubaka* is a kind of amaranth tree.
- 701 Along with Parvati.
- 702 Whose sign is a mountain.
- 703 The lord of the mountain.
- 704 One with the speed of the wind.
- 705 Malformed one, or one with a special form.
- 706 One who cannot be conquered.

- 707 One who destroys hardships.
- 708 The bestower of auspicious fortune.
- 709 One with a blue tuft.
- 710 Ambika's lord.
- 711 One with the form of the wind.
- 712 One with one hundred forms.
- 713 One with a terrible form.
- 714 One with malformed eyes.
- 715 One with one thousand eyes.
- 716 One with one thousand feet.
- 717 One who takes the form of the gods.
- 718 One who paralyzed Shakra's arms (in the form of the infant on Parvati's lap).
- 719 From whom the *Vedas* sprout.
- 720 Lord of mobile and immobile entities.
- 721 One who subdues.
- 722 One whose sign is a water-body.
- 723 The end of the *yugas*.
- 724 One who wears a garland of skulls.
- 725 One who wears a thread of skulls.
- 726 One who has a skull in his hand.
- 727 One who holds a staff.
- 728 One who holds a mace.
- 729 The lord of the three worlds.
- 730 One who is devoted to the world of animals.
- 731 One who holds a *khatvanga* (a staff with a skull on top) in his hand.
- 732 One who removes the afflictions of those who prostrate themselves.
- 733 The slayer of the head of a sacrifice, a reference to Daksha's sacrifice.
- 734 One who takes away black hair.
- 735 One who plucked out Bhaga's eyes, at the time of Daksha's sacrifice.
- 736 One who knocked out Pusha's teeth, at the time of Daksha's sacrifice.
- 737 One who wields *pinaka*, a trident, a sword, a broad sword and a club.
- 738 The destroyer of death. When Markandeya was about to die and Yama came to fetch him, Shiva killed Yama. Yama was revived later.
- 739 One with a third eye.
- 740 One who brought an end to Death.
- 741 One who resides on a mountain.

742 One with golden seed.
743 One who wears earrings.
744 One who destroys the *yoga* of *daityas*.
745 One with the sun and the moon as eyes.
746 One with an eye on the forehead.
747 One devoted to cremation grounds.
748 One who destroys the insolent.
749 One with a bare body.
750 One whose laughter is like one hundred lightning flashes.
751 This is repetition.
752 The virtuous householder.
753 One with perpetual matted hair.
754 One with half of the head shaved.
755 Lord of animals.
756 One who performs austerities in the water.
757 One who grants the prosperity of *yoga*.
758 The tranquil one.
759 The self-controlled one.
760 The cause behind creation and destruction.
761 One who shows favours.
762 One who ensures preservation.
763 The father.
764 One who kills.
765 The fierce one.
766 The auspicious one.
767 One who bestows boons.
768 The terrible one.
769 The commander.
770 This is repetition.
771 The pure one.
772 The destroyer of enemies.
773 One who has just been born.
774 The great god.
775 The wonderful one.
776 The one with a trident.
777 The immeasurable one.
778 The effect.

- 779 The cause.
- 780 One who acts in accordance with the wishes of Purusha.
- 781 One who brings about union between Purusha and the *gunas* of Pradhana.
- 782 One who makes Purusha and Prakriti act in every way.
- 783 One who drives everything that is done and everything that is not done.
- 784 One who unites with the fruit.
- 785 One who knows about time.
- 786 One who makes the rules for everyone.
- 787 One who causes disequilibrium in the *gunas*.
- 788 One who grants subsistence.
- 789 The lord of the lords of the gods.
- 790 The creator of beings.
- 791 Those who strike, being used as a synonym for *ganas*, Shiva's companions.
- 792 Kama, the god of love.
- 793 Kama's wife.
- 794 This was Pradyumna, Krishna's son.
- 795 The same as *champaka*.
- 796 In her earlier form, as Sati.
- 797 Vishrava's son, Kubera.
- 798 Agni.
- 799 Shiva's.
- 800 Gangadvara usually refers to Har ki Pauri in Haridvara/Haridwar.
- 801 Respectively those who drink *ghee* and *soma*.
- 802 Worms and insects.
- 803 That is, Shankara's share would go to Vishnu.
- 804 In that earlier system, Shankara did not have a share.
- 805 The one-third probably means that the other two shares are for Brahma and Vishnu.
- 806 There were four classes of priests, though the classification varied over time. The *hotri* is the chief priest and is accomplished in the *Rig Veda*. The *adhvaryu* is the assistant priest and is accomplished in the *Yajur Veda*, though later, the *udgatri* came to be identified with the *Sama Veda*. In addition, there was the *brahmana* or *purohita*.
- 807 In this rendering, the story of Sati self-immolating herself is not mentioned. With Sati having killed herself, in the more usual rendering,

Shiva created Virabhadra and Bhadrakali from his anger.

⁸⁰⁸ The ocean.

⁸⁰⁹ Caustic, acidic, sweet, salty, bitter and alkaline.

⁸¹⁰ The four types of food are those that are chewed (*charvya*), sucked (*choshya* or *chushya*), licked (*lehya*) and drunk (*peya*).

⁸¹¹ To be interpreted symbolically.

⁸¹² Meaning Daksha.

⁸¹³ This could mean Virabhadra or Shiva, but probably means the former. In any event, the two are regarded as identical.

⁸¹⁴ Meaning fever, physical, as well as mental.

⁸¹⁵ Shiva.

⁸¹⁶ God of the lords among the gods. We have not numbered the names because it is difficult to differentiate between a proper name and an adjective.

⁸¹⁷ Destroyer of strength (*bala*). There was a demon named Bala and Balasudana can also mean destroyer of Bala. However, the demon Bala was killed by Indra, not Shiva. There is no story about Shiva having killed a demon named Bala. Therefore, we have translated it in this way.

⁸¹⁸ One with one thousand eyes.

⁸¹⁹ One with malformed eyes.

⁸²⁰ Three-eyed one.

⁸²¹ Loved by the lord of the *yakshas*, that is, Kubera.

⁸²² With ears like cones.

⁸²³ With gigantic ears.

⁸²⁴ With ears like pots.

⁸²⁵ With an abode in the ocean.

⁸²⁶ With ears like those of a large elephant.

⁸²⁷ With ears like those of a cow.

⁸²⁸ With a hundred ears.

⁸²⁹ With a hundred stomachs.

⁸³⁰ With a hundred locks of hair.

⁸³¹ With a hundred tongues.

⁸³² Eternal one.

⁸³³ Protector of gods and *danavas*.

⁸³⁴ The embodied one.

⁸³⁵ Giant in form.

⁸³⁶ Ocean.

- ⁸³⁷ Varuna.
- ⁸³⁸ Bhava is the origin, Sharva is one who kills with arrows, Rudra is the dreadful one and Varada is one who bestows boons.
- ⁸³⁹ Pashupati is lord of animals and Andhakaghatin is one who killed Andhaka.
- ⁸⁴⁰ Trijata is one with three locks of matted hair, Trishirsha is one with three heads, Trishulavaradharin is one who wields an excellent trident, Tryambaka and Trinetra both mean three-eyed and Tripuraghna is the one who destroyed Tripura.
- ⁸⁴¹ Chanda is the fierce one, Munda is one with a shaved head and Vishvachandadhara is the fierce one who holds up the universe.
- ⁸⁴² Dandin is one with a staff, Shankukarna is one with ears like cones and Chandichanda is the fierce one who is with Chandi.
- ⁸⁴³ Ardhadandikesha is lord of those who hold half a staff, Shushka is the dry one and Vikrita is the malformed one.
- ⁸⁴⁴ Vilohita is one who is especially red, Dhumra is the one who is like smoke and Nilagriva is the one with a blue throat.
- ⁸⁴⁵ Apratirupa is one whose form cannot be matched, Virupa is the malformed one and Shiva is the auspicious one.
- ⁸⁴⁶ Suryapati is Surya's lord and Suryadhvajapatakin is one who has the mark of Surya on his standard and flag.
- ⁸⁴⁷ Lord of the *pramathas*.
- ⁸⁴⁸ With shoulders like those of a bull.
- ⁸⁴⁹ Hiranyavarna is one with a golden complexion, Hiranyakavacha is one with golden armour.
- ⁸⁵⁰ Hiranyakritachuda is one with golden tufts of hair, Hiranyapati is the lord of gold.
- ⁸⁵¹ Shatrughata is one who slays enemies, Chanda is repetition, Parnasamghasaya is one who lies down on a bed of leaves, Stuta is one who is eulogized through a hymn, Stuti is the eulogy or hymn and Stuyamana is one who is eulogized through a hymn.
- ⁸⁵² Sarva is one who is everywhere, Sarvabhaksha is one who eats everything, Sarvabhutantaratman is one who is in the *atman* of all beings.
- ⁸⁵³ Oblations are *homa*, Shukladhvajapatakin is one with white standard and flags.
- ⁸⁵⁴ Anamya is one who cannot be bent down, Namya is one to whom one should bow down.

- ⁸⁵⁵ One who makes a tumultuous sound.
- ⁸⁵⁶ Shayamana is one who is in the process of lying down, Shayita is one who has already lain down and Utthita is one who has woken up.
- ⁸⁵⁷ Sthita is one who is standing, Dhavamana is one who is running, Bhuta is one who has become and Kutila is one who is crooked.
- ⁸⁵⁸ Nartanashila is one who dances and Mukhavaditrakarini is one who uses his mouth like a musical instrument.
- ⁸⁵⁹ Vadhapaha is the destroyer of impediments, Lubdha is the greedy one and Gitavaditrakarini is one who sings and plays on musical instruments.
- ⁸⁶⁰ Jyeshtha is the oldest, Shreshtha is the best and Balapramathana is one who subdues the strong.
- ⁸⁶¹ Kalpana is conception, Kalpya is the one who is conceived, Kshama is the accomplished one and Upakshama is the one who is approaching accomplishment.
- ⁸⁶² The fierce one.
- ⁸⁶³ One with ten arms.
- ⁸⁶⁴ Kapalahasta is one with a skull in his hand, Sitabhasmapriya is one who loves white ashes, Vibhishana is one who terrifies, Bhima is the terrible one and Bhimavratadhara is one who observes terrible vows.
- ⁸⁶⁵ Nanavikritavaktra is one with many malformed faces, Khadgajihva is one with a tongue like a sword and Ugradamshtina is one with fierce teeth.
- ⁸⁶⁶ Pakshamamasalavadya is one with musical instruments on the sides and Tumbinavinapriya is one who loves *tumbinavina* (a *veena* made out of gourds).
- ⁸⁶⁷ Aghoraghorarupa is one who has the terrible form of Aghora and Ghoraghoratara is one who is more terrible than the most terrible.
- ⁸⁶⁸ Shanta is the tranquil one and Shantatara is one who is even more tranquil.
- ⁸⁶⁹ Buddha is the enlightened one, Shuddha is the pure one and Samvibhagapriya is one who loves classification.
- ⁸⁷⁰ Prapancha is the visible universe and Samkhyapara is one who loves *samkhyā*.
- ⁸⁷¹ Chandaikaghanta is one with a terrible bell, Ghantanada is the sound of a bell and Ghantini is one with a bell.
- ⁸⁷² Sahasrashataghanta is one with hundreds of thousands of bells and Ghantamalapriya is one who loves a garland of bells.

- ⁸⁷³ Pranadanda is the staff of life, Nitya is the permanent one and Lohita is the one who is red.
- ⁸⁷⁴ *Humkara* means to utter the sound ‘hum’, a sound believed to possess special powers. Huhumkara is one who emits the sound of *humkara*, Huhumkurapriya is one who loves that sound.
- ⁸⁷⁵ Aparavan is one who has no end, Girivrikshapriya is one who loves mountains and trees, Margamamshashrigala is the jackal who waits alongside roads for meat, Taraka is the one who makes a person cross over and Tara is the one who crosses over.
- ⁸⁷⁶ Yajnadhipati is the lord of a sacrifice, Krita is what has been done and Prakrita is what has been properly done.
- ⁸⁷⁷ Yajnavaha is one who is borne along by a sacrifice, Danta is one who is controlled, Tathya is the truth and Vitatha is falsehood.
- ⁸⁷⁸ Tata is bank, Tatyā is the support of a bank and Tatinipati is the lord of rivers (a river is *tatini*, something with a bank).
- ⁸⁷⁹ Annada is one who gives food, Annapati is the lord of food and Annabhuja is one who eats the food.
- ⁸⁸⁰ Sahasrashirsha is one with one thousand heads, Sahasracharana is one with one thousand feet, Sahasrodyutashula is one who has one thousand upraised tridents and Sahasranayana is one with one thousand eyes.
- ⁸⁸¹ Balarkavarna is one with the complexion of the rising sun and Balarupadhara is one with the form of a child.
- ⁸⁸² Balarkarupadhara is one who has the form of the rising sun and Balakridanaka is one who plays like a child.
- ⁸⁸³ Shuddha and Buddha are repetitions. Kshobhana is one who agitates and Kshaya is one who causes decay.
- ⁸⁸⁴ Tarangankitakesha is one whose hair is marked by waves and Muktakesha is one with loose hair.
- ⁸⁸⁵ Shatakarmatushta is one who is satisfied with the six tasks (such as teaching, studying, performing sacrifices, officiating at sacrifices, donating and receiving gifts, recommended for *brahmanas*), while Trikarmanirata is one who is devoted to the three tasks (such as performing sacrifices, studying and donating).
- ⁸⁸⁶ One who properly establishes the separate *dharma* of the *varnas* and the *ashramas*.
- ⁸⁸⁷ Shreshtha and Jyeshtha are repetitions, Kalakala is one who makes a sweet sound.

- ⁸⁸⁸ Shvetapingalanetra is one with white and tawny eyes,
Krishnaraktekshana is one with black and red eyes.
- ⁸⁸⁹ Dharmarthakamamoksha is *dharma-artha-kama-moksha*, Kratha is one who injures, Krathana is injury, Samkhya is *samkhya*, Samkhymukhya is the best of *samkhya* and Yogadhipati is the lord of *yoga*.
- ⁸⁹⁰ Rathyadhitrathya is a charioteer on the road, Chatushpathapatha is a crossroad (with four roads) on the path.
- ⁸⁹¹ Krishnajinottariya is one whose upper garment is made out of black antelope skin, Vyalayajnopavita is one whose sacred thread is a serpent, Ishana is the ruler, Rudrasamghata is a collection of Rudras, Harikesha is one with tawny hair.
- ⁸⁹² Tryambaka is repetition, Ambikanatha is Ambika's lord, Vyakta is one who is manifest, Avyakta is one who is not manifest.
- ⁸⁹³ Kala is time/destiny, Kamada is one who satisfies desires, Kamaghna is the destroyer of Kama, Dushtodvrittanivarana is one who counters the evil conduct of the wicked, Sarvagarihita is one who is condemned by everyone, Sarvagghna is one who destroys everyone and Sadyojata is one who has just been born.
- ⁸⁹⁴ Unmadana is one who causes madness,
Shatavartagangatoyardramurdhaja is one whose hair is wet from the hundreds of eddies in the water of the Ganga, Chandrardhasamyugavarta is one who has eddies (in the hair) from being united with the half-moon and Meghavarta is one with eddies like clouds (in the hair).
- ⁸⁹⁵ One who grants *artha*.
- ⁸⁹⁶ Annasrashta is creator of food, Bhokta is one who enjoys/eats,
Yajnabhuk is one who enjoys the share of a sacrifice, Anala is fire,
Jarayuja is a being from a womb, Andaja is a being born from an egg,
Svedaja is a being born from sweat and Udbhija is entities like plants and herbs.
- ⁸⁹⁷ At the time of destruction.
- ⁸⁹⁸ The lord of the universe.
- ⁸⁹⁹ Omkara is the sound of Oum. Rig should be written as Rik, we have written it as Rig to avoid confusion.
- ⁹⁰⁰ *Kala*, *kashtha* and *nimesha* are measurements of time.
- ⁹⁰¹ The list varies, but is usually fortitude, forgiveness, self-control, not appropriating the property of others, purity, control of the senses, intelligence, learning, truthfulness and lack of anger.

- ⁹⁰² Suvarna.
- ⁹⁰³ Indu is Chandra, Dhanada is Kubera and Anala is Agni.
- ⁹⁰⁴ Bhanu is Surya, Utphulla-Chitrabhanu is the complete disc of the sun, Svarbhanu is Rahu.
- ⁹⁰⁵ *Trisouparna* is the same as *Trisuparna*. The *Yajur Veda* has three *mantras* that are recited together and these are known as *trisuparna*. The *shatarudiya* is a *mantra* to Rudra from the *Yajur Veda*.
- ⁹⁰⁶ *Pralaya*.
- ⁹⁰⁷ Lohitanga is one with red limbs, Damshttrin is one with fangs, Mahavaktra is one with a large mouth, Mahodara is one with a large stomach, Shuchiroman is one with pure hair, Haricchmashru is one with a green beard and moustache and Urddhvakesha is one whose hair stands up.
- ⁹⁰⁸ Kutichara.
- ⁹⁰⁹ Sacrifice with four officiating priests, *adhvaryu* and so on.
- ⁹¹⁰ Lord of the mountain.
- ⁹¹¹ Daughter of the mountain.
- ⁹¹² The act of bowing down.
- ⁹¹³ With a fiery vision.
- ⁹¹⁴ Respectively, Brahma's region, the region of the gods and the region of desire.
- ⁹¹⁵ The protector.
- ⁹¹⁶ The meaning of Gogarga is unclear.
- ⁹¹⁷ The bird.
- ⁹¹⁸ Sthanu.
- ⁹¹⁹ Physical and mental, *jvara*.
- ⁹²⁰ In this context, *vinayaka* should be understood as someone who causes obstructions.
- ⁹²¹ Kartikeya.
- ⁹²² *Eka* (one) *amra* (mango).
- ⁹²³ Three layers to a gate. The word used is *trikacha*.
- ⁹²⁴ As weapons.
- ⁹²⁵ The word used is *shyama*, dark. *Shyama* is also used for a maiden who has not married, or has not had a child. However, since this is a description of women across all age-groups, dark is the natural meaning.
- ⁹²⁶ Presumably meaning, the hair is braided and does not hang loose and disheveled.

- ⁹²⁷ These are famous *apsaras*.
- ⁹²⁸ There is repetition because the earlier statements were about the women, these are about the men.
- ⁹²⁹ Cardamom.
- ⁹³⁰ Mango.
- ⁹³¹ Tree with bitter fruit, *azadirachta indica*.
- ⁹³² The same as *nipa*.
- ⁹³³ A kind of tree believed to contain fire, the same as a *shami* tree.
- ⁹³⁴ The lotus bark tree.
- ⁹³⁵ Variety of palm.
- ⁹³⁶ *Chakora* is a partridge, *shatapatra* is a woodpecker, *bhringaraja* is a kind of bird (it also means a bee), *kokila* is a cuckoo, *kalavinka* is a sparrow, *mayura* is a peacock, *priyaputra* is an unidentified bird, *shuka* is a parrot, *jivanjivaka* (usually *jivajivaka*) is a pheasant, *harita* is the green Haritala pigeon and *chataka* is the Jacobin cuckoo or pied crested cuckoo.
- ⁹³⁷ *Kadamba* is a kind of goose, *chakravaka* is the Brahminy duck, *karandava* is a kind of duck, *hamsa* is a swan and *plava* is a diving aquatic bird.
- ⁹³⁸ Literally, lake formed with drops (*bindu*) of water. There is a Bindusagar(a) lake in Bhubaneswar, near the Lingaraja temple.
- ⁹³⁹ *Ashtami*.
- ⁹⁴⁰ *Sankranti* is the movement of the sun from one sign of the zodiac (*rashi*) to another. Thus, there are twelve of these. The entry of Surya into Capricorn, with the movement from *dakshinayana* to *uttarayana*, is known as *makara sankranti*, while its entry into Cancer, with the movement from *uttarayana* to *dakshinayana*, is known as *karka sankranti*. The entry into Gemini, Virgo, Sagittarius and Pisces are known as *shadashiti*. The entry into Taurus, Leo, Scorpio and Aquarius are known as *vishnupada*. The entry into Aries and Libra is known as *vishuva sankranti*.
- ⁹⁴¹ Cake offered to ancestors.
- ⁹⁴² The wood-apple.
- ⁹⁴³ The *ashtami* (eighth lunar day) during *shukla paksha* in the month of Chaitra.
- ⁹⁴⁴ The *ekadashi* (eleventh lunar day) during *shukla paksha* in the month of Shravana.

⁹⁴⁵ Nandi.

⁹⁴⁶ *Kalpadruma*.

⁹⁴⁷ Kapila is believed to have instructed his mother, Devahuti, about *samkhya* on the banks of Bindusara.

⁹⁴⁸ The Viraja (Biraja) temple is in Jajpur, 125 kilometres north of Bhubaneswar. Durga is worshipped as Viraja there.

⁹⁴⁹ This is the Yajna Varaha (or Varahanatha) temple, on the banks of the river Vaitarani, in Jajpur.

⁹⁵⁰ There is a Varahi temple in Chaurasi in Puri district.

⁹⁵¹ Probably meaning Viraja.

⁹⁵² *Amalaka* is emblic myrobalan, *naranga* is orange, *bhurja* is the birch tree, *ashvakarna* is a kind of tree, *kharjura* is date, the word *siddha* is probably being used as an adjective (divine or polished), *madhudhara* may mean *madhudrava* (a tree with red blossoms), *shimshapa* is similar to *ashoka*, *tindu* or *tinduka* is ebony and *vibhitaka* is *Terminalia bellerica*, a kind of myrobalan. The word *amalaka* is repeated.

⁹⁵³ *Jambira* is citron, *aruna* (red) is probably an adjective describing *kankola* (*ashoka*), *dadima* is pomegranate, *bijapuraka* is lemon and *matulunga* is a kind of citron.

⁹⁵⁴ *Sarasa* and *baka* are both types of cranes. A *madgu* is a cormorant.

⁹⁵⁵ The word used is *bhikshu* or mendicant.

⁹⁵⁶ Vishnu. Vishnu resides in Purushottama *kshetra* or Puri.

⁹⁵⁷ Birds.

- ⁹⁵⁸ Balarama.
- ⁹⁵⁹ Speculatively, the five *tirthas* might be the Indradyumna tank (in Gundicha temple near Puri), Rohini *kunda* (inside Jagannath temple), Markandeya temple (Markandeshvara temple, near Jagannath temple), the ocean and Svetaganga tank (near Jagannath temple).
- ⁹⁶⁰ This is an alternative listing of the five (*pancha*) *tirthas*. Markandeya will mean the Markandeya temple and the *akshaya* (eternal) vata tree is the one next to the Markandeya temple.
- ⁹⁶¹ Ujjayini or Ujjain.
- ⁹⁶² Twice-born, a term applied not only to *brahmanas*, but also *kshatriyas* and *vaishyas*, depending on the context.
- ⁹⁶³ The hair was braided, not loose or disheveled.
- ⁹⁶⁴ The marking-nut plant.
- ⁹⁶⁵ Saffron.
- ⁹⁶⁶ Tamarind.
- ⁹⁶⁷ Black sandalwood.
- ⁹⁶⁸ Another name for *kovidara*.
- ⁹⁶⁹ Another name for *ashoka*.
- ⁹⁷⁰ The vegetable hummingbird tree, *sesbania grandiflora*.
- ⁹⁷¹ The toothbrush tree, *streblus asper*.
- ⁹⁷² Yellow myrobalan.
- ⁹⁷³ Another name for *mallika*.
- ⁹⁷⁴ The shrub *vitex negundo*.
- ⁹⁷⁵ Another name for *pippala*. Also known as *bahuvaraka*.
- ⁹⁷⁶ Jujube.
- ⁹⁷⁷ The Pongame oil tree.
- ⁹⁷⁸ The same as *bhringaraja*.
- ⁹⁷⁹ Parrot.
- ⁹⁸⁰ Dove.
- ⁹⁸¹ Wagtail.
- ⁹⁸² Hawk/falcon.
- ⁹⁸³ Pigeon.
- ⁹⁸⁴ Bathing the image.
- ⁹⁸⁵ Mother goddesses.
- ⁹⁸⁶ Poetry.
- ⁹⁸⁷ Literally, *shrivatsa* means the place where Shri (Lakshmi) resides. It is a twirl of curly hair on Vishnu's/Krishna's chest.

- 988 There were eight different types of shudras, though the listing varies. For instance, *vyadha* (hunter), *vyalagrahi* (those who eat snakes), *vagatita* (one with whom one does not speak), *chandala* (*brahmana* mother, shudra father) and so on.
- 989 For musical instruments.
- 990 This seems to be the only way to interpret the word *svajivina*.
- 991 Goldsmiths are repeated.
- 992 *Parvakara*.
- 993 Repeated.
- 994 Pounded ground meal, colloquially known as *sattu*.
- 995 Garudas constructed charms against snake-poison.
- 996 Blacksmiths.
- 997 Etymologically, those who would strike. Probably assistants to various smiths.
- 998 Used in the sense of accountants.
- 999 Repeated.
- 1000 Repeated.
- 1001 The Indian plum tree.
- 1002 A medicinal tree.
- 1003 Probably meaning *sindhuvaraka*.
- 1004 Repeated.
- 1005 Repeated.
- 1006 There does not seem to be any such tree. Probably *nimba* and *vata* have been spliced together.
- 1007 Another name for *punnaga*.
- 1008 A medicinal plant, *costus speciosus*.
- 1009 Repeated.
- 1010 A *sarika* bird is a kind of thrush, *Turdus Salica*.
- 1011 The same as *priyaputra*.
- 1012 Ravens.
- 1013 Kind of jasmine.
- 1014 Kind of coral tree.
- 1015 Subhadra.
- 1016 Meru.
- 1017 Birds, descendants of Suparna.
- 1018 Repeated.
- 1019 Black aloe.

1020 *Kankola*.

1021 *Karnikara*.

1022 In the text, *shishi* and *bhurja* seem to be separate trees. *Bhurja* is the birch tree, but there is no known tree by the name of *shishi*. Therefore, *shishibhurja* probably means birch trees that grow in the cold.

1023 Red amaranth.

1024 No such tree is known. So perhaps this qualifies some trees/flowers as being hidden (*gupta*).

1025 Lord of the universe.

1026 That is, Vishnu.

1027 Brahma.

1028 Born from an egg, born from a womb, born from sweat and trees and plants.

1029 There is a bit of repetition. The text has the two earlier sentences within brackets, so they might not belong.

1030 *Vanara* means special kind of *nara* (man). Hence, we have refrained from translating this as monkey.

1031 *Antyaja* can loosely be translated as outcaste. Literally, it means someone who is born in the extremities (of the main habitation). *Mleccha* can loosely be translated as barbarian, but means someone who does not speak Sanskrit.

1032 Unhusked grain.

1033 Brahma.

1034 The word used is *tata*. While this means son, it is also used for anyone who is junior.

1035 *Uttama* means excellent.

1036 Yama.

1037 *Indranila*.

1038 One with eyes like a lotus.

1039 Shveta-dvipa.

1040 Yama's task is to punish, but people are being instantly saved.

1041 The sand.

1042 That is, Shri.

1043 We have translated *yatra* as procession and *sankirtana* as chanting (it is public).

1044 Mahajyeshtha is interpreted as the full moon day in the month of Jyeshtha, but may also be a reference to astronomical measurements

based on Jupiter's twelve-year cycle. For instance, when Jupiter rises in the *nakshatra* of Jyeshtha, this is known as Mahajyeshtha.

1045 Balarama.

1046 Tributaries.

1047 This probably means that their limbs are soft to the touch.

1048 A *karnapura* is an ornament for the ear. An ear-ring (*kundala*) is in the lobe of the ear, while a *karnapura* is wound around the ear.

1049 Those who subsist on wild grain.

1050 *Shali* is a fine rice, *vrihi* is paddy, *yava* is barley, *masha* is *urad dal*, *mudga* is *moong dal*, *tila* is sesamum, *siddhartha* is boiled paddy, *chanaka* is chickpea, *godhuma* is wheat, *masura* is *masoor dal*, *shyamaka* is a kind of grain, *madhuka* is a honey-coloured grain, *nivara* is wild rice and *kulatthaka* is a fine pulse.

1051 *Snatakas*.

1052 In general, in the hierarchy of teachers, *upadhyaya* is inferior to *acharya*.

1053 The royal priest.

1054 *Indradyumna*.

1055 They should be made out of wood.

1056 The text has some *shlokas* that are not included as part of the main text. These have more details about the gifts given by *Indradyumna*. Since these aren't part of the main text, we have not translated them.

1057 Here too, the text has some *shlokas* not included as part of the main text and we have skipped those. The missing *shlokas* are mostly invocations to Vishnu.

1058 *Indradyumna*.

1059 The *daityas*.

1060 In the form of the *varaha* (boar) incarnation.

1061 *Advaita* is non-dual/non-duality, while *dvaita* is dual/duality.

1062 Without blemish.

1063 *Kamala* is Lakshmi's name.

1064 In this context, *yoga* means acquiring what one has not got and *kshema* means preserving what one has got.

1065 May the devotion be true.

1066 Dawn, midday mid-day and dusk.

1067 Krishna killed a demon named Mura. Therefore, *Murari* (*Mura's* enemy) is one of Krishna's names.

- ¹⁰⁶⁸ Garuda.
- ¹⁰⁶⁹ Dye made out of the madder plant.
- ¹⁰⁷⁰ Earlier, it has been described as an *ashvattha* tree.
- ¹⁰⁷¹ Being used as a name for Indradyumna.
- ¹⁰⁷² Balarama was born as a portion of Ananta. Ananta means one without end (*anta*).
- ¹⁰⁷³ The flower of flax, *linum usitatissimum*. Vishnu's complexion is often likened to this flower.
- ¹⁰⁷⁴ The supreme lord.
- ¹⁰⁷⁵ *Garhapatya*, *ahavaniya* and *dakshinagni*.
- ¹⁰⁷⁶ Shesha or Ananta.
- ¹⁰⁷⁷ That is, for the duration of fourteen *manvantaras*, there being a different Indra in each *manvantara*.
- ¹⁰⁷⁸ *Mandapa*.
- ¹⁰⁷⁹ That is, *amrataka*.
- ¹⁰⁸⁰ *Dhatuka* might mean the red bell bush.
- ¹⁰⁸¹ Literally, when the divinity of the *nakshatra* is the ancestors.
- ¹⁰⁸² The images.
- ¹⁰⁸³ Balarama.
- ¹⁰⁸⁴ This is Lomaharshana speaking.
- ¹⁰⁸⁵ The *samvartaka* fire is the fire of universal destruction. In this context, Aditya means the sun. There are twelve such Adityas (one for each month) and it was as if all of them were acting simultaneously.
- ¹⁰⁸⁶ In the form of the fire.
- ¹⁰⁸⁷ This must be a typo. *Ingula* is a medicinal tree. It should read *sindura*. That is, the complexion was that of vermilion.
- ¹⁰⁸⁸ An indirect way of describing the water.
- ¹⁰⁸⁹ By addressing him as a child.
- ¹⁰⁹⁰ Kind of animal that is found in marshy places, similar to deer.
- ¹⁰⁹¹ As a footnote, the text also gives an alternate version, with a slightly different rendering of what was seen inside the stomach. Except for the geographical bit, there are no major differences between the two versions.
- ¹⁰⁹² The text actually says Atala, Vitala, Patala, Bhutala, Vitala (repeated), Rasatala and Mahatala. These are the nether regions and we have amended it for the sake of consistency.
- ¹⁰⁹³ Kamala is one of Lakshmi's names.

- ¹⁰⁹⁴ These stories, about Kamsa, Keshi and Arishta, will be recounted later, in Chapters 81, 82 and 85.
- ¹⁰⁹⁵ Vishnu is Indra's younger brother and is, therefore, known as Upendra.
- ¹⁰⁹⁶ Intelligence.
- ¹⁰⁹⁷ That is, Agni.
- ¹⁰⁹⁸ That is, Kubera.
- ¹⁰⁹⁹ Kartikeya.
- ¹¹⁰⁰ As a footnote, the text gives some additional verses, not included as part of the main text. Therefore, we have not translated those. These are descriptions of what was seen inside the stomach, with many geographical places mentioned.
- ¹¹⁰¹ Markandeya's father was the sage Mrikandu.
- ¹¹⁰² *Ayana* means abode.
- ¹¹⁰³ Kubera.
- ¹¹⁰⁴ The subterranean fire is known as *vadava* (mare), because it is in the form of a mare's head.
- ¹¹⁰⁵ With Bharata replaced by 'excellent one', this is Bhagavad Gita, 4.7. There are some verses that the text has in a footnote, not in the main text. We have not translated these. They primarily say Narayana's *dharma* is white in *krita yuga*, dark blue in *treta yuga*, red in *dvapara yuga* and black in *kali yuga*. They also say that Narayana is the *atman* of the universe and that Narayana destroys the universe as Time, making the wheel of Time move.
- ¹¹⁰⁶ That is, as long as it is Brahma's night.
- ¹¹⁰⁷ This way of addressing Narayana is possible, but doesn't sound right. It probably belongs outside the quote and in the plural.
- ¹¹⁰⁸ Shiva.
- ¹¹⁰⁹ In the Lingaraja temple in Bhubaneswar, Shiva is worshipped as Harihara, Vishnu and Shiva combined.
- ¹¹¹⁰ Garudhadvaja is the one with Garuda on his banner, that is, Vishnu. Vrishadvaja is the one with the bull on his banner, that is, Shiva. Tripuraghna means the destroyer of Tripura, Shiva.
- ¹¹¹¹ The Markandeshvara temple is actually in Puri, just to the north of the Jagannath temple. This is the temple that is identified with Markandeya.
- ¹¹¹² That is, Jagannatha temple.
- ¹¹¹³ Aghora is one of Shiva's names. Strictly speaking, in the singular, there is nothing called *aghora mantra*. There are several that go by that name.

The only proper *aghora mantra* is *oum aghorebhya atha ghorebhya ghora ghora tarebhyah sarvebhyah sarva sarvebhyo namaste astu rudra rupebhyah*. Here, by *aghora mantra*, the text clearly means what is within quotes. Trilochana is one with three eyes, Shashibhushana is one who is ornamented with the moon, Virupaksha is one with malformed eyes and Mahadeva is the great god.

¹¹¹⁴ This is the second of the five *tirthas*.

¹¹¹⁵ Vainateya is Vinata's son, Garuda. Garuda is not an independent *tirtha*. The five *tirthas* are Shiva near Markandeya's lake, the *vata* tree, Krishna, Balarama and Subhadra.

¹¹¹⁶ Subhadra.

¹¹¹⁷ Revati is Balarama's wife.

¹¹¹⁸ Balarama killed a demon named Pralamba.

¹¹¹⁹ An *akshara* is a syllable, a part of a word with a single vowel sound. None of the *mantras* that follow has twelve *aksharas*, all of them have eight *aksharas*. The *mantra* with twelve *aksharas* is *Oum namo bhagavate Vasudevaya*, not mentioned in the text.

¹¹²⁰ The details about Chanura will be given in Chapter 82.

¹¹²¹ The city of Puri.

¹¹²² Narasimha is Vishnu's man-lion *avatara*. There is a Narasimha temple in Puri, believed to have been constructed by Indradyumna.

¹¹²³ The text uses the word Narakesari, with the same meaning.

¹¹²⁴ *Siddhis* mean powers. Specifically, *yoga* leads to eight major *siddhis* or powers. These are *anima* (becoming as small as one desires), *mahima* (as large as one desires), *laghima* (as light as one wants), *garima* (as heavy as one wants), *prapti* (obtaining what one wants), *prakamya* (travelling where one wants), *vashitvam* (powers to control creatures) and *ishitvam* (obtaining divine powers).

¹¹²⁵ A *siddha kshetra* is a place where someone is known to have obtained *moksha*.

¹¹²⁶ Other than Narasimha's *mantra*.

¹¹²⁷ The amulet over which *japa* is performed.

¹¹²⁸ Or hole or burrow.

¹¹²⁹ *Sanjivani* is the knowledge of bringing a dead person back to life.

Though it is not very clear, perhaps what is meant is that if a devotee decides to emerge from the cave, he should take these objects with him.

¹¹³⁰ Meaning Narasimha.

- ¹¹³¹ *Bhurja patra*.
- ¹¹³² *Gutika*, alternatively, a magic pill.
- ¹¹³³ The Shveta-Ganga pond is to the west of Jagannatha temple and right next to this pond are the temples to Shveta-Madhava and Matsya-Madhava.
- ¹¹³⁴ Death/Destiny.
- ¹¹³⁵ Meaning Shveta-Madhava, not the king.
- ¹¹³⁶ Shveta.
- ¹¹³⁷ That is, the Shveta-Madhava temple was built near Jagannatha temple.
- ¹¹³⁸ *Oum namo bhagavate Vasudevaya*.
- ¹¹³⁹ Bahurupa is one with many forms, Vishvarupa is one whose form is the universe.
- ¹¹⁴⁰ Padma-nabha is one with a lotus in his navel, Padma-garbha-bhava is the creator of the one who originated from the lotus (Brahma).
- ¹¹⁴¹ Padma-varna is one with the complexion of a lotus, Padma-hasta is one with a lotus in his hand.
- ¹¹⁴² Pushkaraksha is one with eyes like a lotus, Sahasraksha is one with one thousand eyes.
- ¹¹⁴³ Sahasra-pada is one with one thousand feet, Sahasra-bhuja is one with one thousand arms.
- ¹¹⁴⁴ Varada is one who bestows boons, Varishtha is the greatest, Varenya is one who should be worshipped, Hiranya is the golden one and Achutya is one who is not dislodged.
- ¹¹⁴⁵ Bala-rupa is one with the form of a child, Bala-padma-prabha is one who has the radiance of a tender lotus, Balarka-soma-netra is one who has the rising sun and the moon as his eyes and Munjakesha is one whose hair is like *munja* grass.
- ¹¹⁴⁶ Trivikrama is one with three strides, a reference to Vishnu's *vamana* incarnation.
- ¹¹⁴⁷ Shripati is lord of Shri (alternatively prosperity), Shridhara is the one who holds Shri (alternatively prosperity).
- ¹¹⁴⁸ Shriyakhanta means loved by Shri, Danta is one with self-control, Yogichintya is one who *yogis* think about.
- ¹¹⁴⁹ Lord of the senses.
- ¹¹⁵⁰ Yogishvara is lord of *yoga*, Shuddha is the pure one, Uttarana is the one who delivers, Sukha is happiness, Sukhanetra is one whose eyes are happiness and Sukritadharin is one who upholds good deeds.

- ¹¹⁵¹ Worthy of being worshipped.
- ¹¹⁵² Balarama killed a demon named Pralamba, this is described in Chapter 78.
- ¹¹⁵³ The three kinds of hardship relate to *adhidaivika* (destiny), *adhibhoutika* (nature) and *adhyatmika* (one's own nature).
- ¹¹⁵⁴ Vishnu's/Krishna's conch-shell.
- ¹¹⁵⁵ Garuda.
- ¹¹⁵⁶ Vishnu's first *avatara* was fish (*matsya/mina*). *Rohita* is a fish with a reddish tinge, hence the name *rohita* (red). It belongs to the carp family (*labeo rohita*) and is popularly known as *rohu*.
- ¹¹⁵⁷ The beach that is to the south-west of Puri is known as *svarga dvara* (gate to heaven).
- ¹¹⁵⁸ There is a temple to Ugrasena in Puri. Ugrasena was Krishna's grandfather.
- ¹¹⁵⁹ These are respectively known as *kara-nyasa* and *anga-nyasa*, the mental appropriation (*nyasa*) of different parts of the hand (*kara* or *hasta*) and different limbs of the body (*anga*) to different divinities.
- ¹¹⁶⁰ Here, Nara is to be interpreted as the eternal and divine *paramatman* that pervades the universe and water originated from Nara.
- ¹¹⁶¹ This doesn't make it clear. The *mantra* in question is *Oum namo Narayanaya*, with eight *aksharas*. Normally (not the way it is stated in the text), *nyasa* starts with the index finger of the right hand and ends with the index finger of the left hand, accounting for eight *aksharas*. Alternatively, the *mantra* *Oum namo bhagavate Vasudevaya* (with twelve *aksharas*) is used. In this case, the last four *aksharas* are for the joints of the thumbs.
- ¹¹⁶² Literally, *aghamarshana* means the cleansing of sins. The *aghamarshana mantra/sukta* is often recited before taking a bath. Though it occurs in various texts, the usual citation is the *Rig Veda* or the *Taittiriya Aranyaka* of *Krishna Yajur Veda*.
- ¹¹⁶³ The text uses the word *linga*. Because of the *pradakshina* mentioned later, clearly a Surya image has been fashioned.
- ¹¹⁶⁴ *Tarpana* is an act that brings pleasure. For example, for gods, sacrifices are also *tarpana*. Specifically for ancestors, *tarpana* is the performance of water-rites.
- ¹¹⁶⁵ The word *mandala* has multiple meanings. Here, it is a mystical diagram.

- ¹¹⁶⁶ Since the line is not very clear, we have done a little bit of interpretation here. *Nyasa* of both the body and the hands are being mentioned in the same breath. The four forms of Vishnu are Vasudeva, Samkarshana, Pradyumna and Aniruddha. The five limbs probably mean the feet, the flanks, the navel, the shoulders and the head.
- ¹¹⁶⁷ What follows, within quotes, are *mantras*.
- ¹¹⁶⁸ We have translated *tattva* as principle. Invoking the divinity in parts of the body is symbolic, the key is to unite oneself with the divinity's principles.
- ¹¹⁶⁹ Bath.
- ¹¹⁷⁰ Garment.
- ¹¹⁷¹ Fragrance.
- ¹¹⁷² Unguent.
- ¹¹⁷³ Brahma.
- ¹¹⁷⁴ Sacred thread.
- ¹¹⁷⁵ Ornament(s).
- ¹¹⁷⁶ Incense.
- ¹¹⁷⁷ Lamp.
- ¹¹⁷⁸ The four types of food are those that are chewed (*charvya*), sucked (*choshya* or *chushya*), licked (*lehya*) and drunk (*peya*). The six types of taste are sweet, sour, salty, bitter, pungent and astringent.
- ¹¹⁷⁹ Offering of food.
- ¹¹⁸⁰ Nourishment.
- ¹¹⁸¹ Kubera.
- ¹¹⁸² A *mudra* is a symbolic and mystical positioning of the fingers and the thumb.
- ¹¹⁸³ Literally, sending away or dismissal. The end of the worship.
- ¹¹⁸⁴ *Vyatipata* is an inauspicious period that lasts for almost 24 hours during every lunar month.
- ¹¹⁸⁵ Though not expressly stated, this probably means the days of the full moon in the months of Ashadha, Kartika and Magha.
- ¹¹⁸⁶ Bathing in the ocean.

- ¹¹⁸⁷ That is, he is not born again.
- ¹¹⁸⁸ That which takes away (*hara*) ten (*dasha*). The usual etymological derivation is that it is known as Dashahara because it takes place on the tenth day.
- ¹¹⁸⁹ *Dola* is a swing, hammock or palanquin. The text doesn't explicitly mention the day of the full moon in the month of Phalguna, but it is implied. A festival known as *dola* (*dolaa*) is held on the full moon day in Phalguna, with the young Krishna seated on a swing.
- ¹¹⁹⁰ Specifically, on the day of the full moon.
- ¹¹⁹¹ Mahajyeshthi is often simply interpreted as the full moon day in the month of Jyeshtha, when there is a ritual bathing of the image. More specifically, the full moon should be in the *nakshatra* of Jyeshtha and so on.
- ¹¹⁹² That is, a solar eclipse.
- ¹¹⁹³ It is not clear if this refers to seven tributaries of the Brahmaputra or seven *tirthas* along the Brahmaputra, probably the latter.
- ¹¹⁹⁴ The text does not state the name of Jyeshtha *nakshatra*, we have deduced this. The text simply states *nakshatra*.
- ¹¹⁹⁵ The river Bhogavati flows in the nether regions, but is manifested in the well. This well is within the premises of the Jagannatha temple and *snana yatra* is performed there.
- ¹¹⁹⁶ Balarama.
- ¹¹⁹⁷ A *snataka* is an individual who has completed the *brahmacharya* stage of studying and is ready to enter the next stage of life.
- ¹¹⁹⁸ *Marichipas*, sages who subsist on the rays of the sun and the moon.
- ¹¹⁹⁹ If this means Brahma, its inclusion sounds odd.
- ¹²⁰⁰ The personified form of modesty.
- ¹²⁰¹ Sinivali is the deity (and the day) for the day preceding the night of the new moon, Kuhu is the deity (and the day) for the night of the new moon, Raka is the deity (and the day) for the night of the full moon and Anumati is the deity (and the day) for the 14th night of *shukla paksha*.
- ¹²⁰² The seasons are repeated.
- ¹²⁰³ This is repeated.
- ¹²⁰⁴ Meaning Lakshmi.
- ¹²⁰⁵ A *kapila* cow is a tawny/brown cow, but is applied to a cow that is excellent.

- ¹²⁰⁶ Literally, donating (*utsarga*) a bull (*vrisha*), usually done at the time of a *shraddha* ceremony.
- ¹²⁰⁷ A *tiladhenu* is a cow (*dhenu*) made out of sesamum (*tila*), of prescribed weight and dimensions, donated to a *brahmana*.
- ¹²⁰⁸ Two pots are filled with water (*jala*) and other precious objects. One of these pots is thought of as a cow (*dhenu*) and the other as the calf. After the rituals, these two pots are donated to a *brahmana*.
- ¹²⁰⁹ As earlier, except that the pots are now filled with *ghrita/ghee*.
- ¹²¹⁰ Bathing Krishna.
- ¹²¹¹ There is an annual *ratha yatra* (chariot festival), when the images of Jagannatha, Balabhadra and Subhadra are taken on a chariot (*ratha*) to the Gundika/Gundicha temple. The Gundika temple is at a distance of three kilometres from the Jagannatha temple. During the annual festival, the images remain in Gundika temple for a week, with one day added for the journey and another day for the return to Jagannatha temple.
- ¹²¹² *Utthana*, or *utthana ekadashi* is the eleventh lunar day in *krishna paksha* in the month of Phalgun.
- ¹²¹³ What must be circumambulated remains unclear.
- ¹²¹⁴ *Apupa* is a sweet cake, *shashkuli* is a cake made out rice or barley, *vataka* is a small cake, *modaka* is a sweetmeat and *phanita* means molasses.
- ¹²¹⁵ Garments, flowers, lamps, incense and *naivedya*.
- ¹²¹⁶ The *guru* and Purushottama.
- ¹²¹⁷ The *guru* is distinct from the preceptor (*acharya*).
- ¹²¹⁸ Shashanka is the moon.
- ¹²¹⁹ Grape vines.
- ¹²²⁰ *Indradaru*, a kind of pine.
- ¹²²¹ The *bilva* tree.
- ¹²²² A *kalpavriksha* yields every object of desire.
- ¹²²³ A kind of jasmine.
- ¹²²⁴ That is, they assume Krishna's form.
- ¹²²⁵ Birds, descendants of Suparna.
- ¹²²⁶ These are personified forms. For example, Kirti is fame, Prajna is wisdom, Medha is intellect, Sarasvati is speech, Buddhi is intelligence, Mati is the power of reasoning, Kshanti is forbearance, Siddhi is success, Murti is form, Dyuti is resplendence, Prabha is radiance, Kanti is beauty, Shraddha is faith, Nidra is sleep and Ratri is night.

- 1227 These are names of *apsaras*.
1228 Raamaa, not Raama.
1229 One whose playful gait is like that of a swan.
1230 One whose gait is like that of a crazy elephant.
1231 *Nastikas*.
1232 Vinata's son, Garuda.
1233 Ganga.
1234 The word used is *kavi*. Though this also means poet, here the meaning of wise one seems more appropriate.
1235 Kubera is their lord.
1236 Jewel worn on top of the head.
1237 Omkara.
1238 Bamboo, sugarcane, coconut and palm are all referred to as king of grass.
1239 That is, one is not born again.
1240 Shvetamadhava.
1241 The earlier reference to Indradyumna is about Indradyumna's lake, while this is a reference to Indradyumna himself.
1242 They were scared that gods and men would worship Vasudeva and manage to defeat them.
1243 Kubera was the lord of the *yakshas*.
1244 One who defeated Indra.
1245 That is, I will worship Mahadeva now.
1246 Maricha, as instructed by Ravana.
1247 *Vanara* can loosely be translated as monkey, but such a translation can also be misleading.
1248 That is, where his forefathers had ruled earlier.
1249 As kings over individual kingdoms.
1250 During the monsoon.
1251 A reference to the *vata* tree.
1252 Fires on four sides and the sun overhead.
1253 The gods, especially Indra, were anxious that as a result of powers and boons obtained through such austerities, the positions of the gods would be usurped. Therefore, they sought to create impediments.
1254 An *apsara*.
1255 Indra killed a demon named Bala.

- ¹²⁵⁶ There are layers in the way the story is being told. Brahma is the original speaker, addressing the sages on Mount Meru. The account is repeated by Vyasa, speaking to the sages in Kurukshetra. The account is again repeated by Lomaharshana, addressing the sages in Naimisha. In this chapter, sections are sometimes attributed to Vyasa and sometimes to Brahma. For the sake of consistency, we have stuck with Brahma/Vyasa, within the same paragraph.
- ¹²⁵⁷ Respectively, the god of love, Spring and Breeze/Wind.
- ¹²⁵⁸ The starfruit tree.
- ¹²⁵⁹ Kind of plant.
- ¹²⁶⁰ Kind of ebony tree.
- ¹²⁶¹ *Kankola*.
- ¹²⁶² *Acacia farnesiana*.
- ¹²⁶³ Kind of dock or sorrel.
- ¹²⁶⁴ Probably meaning bamboo.
- ¹²⁶⁵ The blue lotus.
- ¹²⁶⁶ The rattan plant.
- ¹²⁶⁷ Probably means myrobalan.
- ¹²⁶⁸ The tawny one. Hari is one of Indra's names.
- ¹²⁶⁹ The god of love.
- ¹²⁷⁰ The six vices of *kama* (desire), *krodha* (anger), *lobha* (avarice), *moha* (delusion), *mada* (arrogance) and *matsarya* (jealousy).
- ¹²⁷¹ A vow of friendship is contracted by taking seven steps together, often around a fire.
- ¹²⁷² The *brahman* which enables one to cross over. Vishnu cannot be crossed in the sense that Vishnu cannot be comprehended.
- ¹²⁷³ In the sense of the ocean of *samsara*. Usually, the *brahmapara stotram* is quoted as a single *shloka* with two lines and it ends here. *paaram param vishnurapaarapaarah parah parebhyah paramaatmarupah sa brahmapaarah parapaarabhutah parah paraanaamapi paarapaarah*. In the text, a more complete *stotram* with four *shlokas* is given. For the other three *shlokas*, we have only given the translation.
- ¹²⁷⁴ The text has an additional *shloka* that it believes to be interpolated. He possessed all the signs and was adorned with all the ornaments. His limbs were smeared with divine sandalwood paste and he was adorned with celestial garlands.
- ¹²⁷⁵ The victorious one.

- 1276 The golden womb.
- 1277 With a lotus in the navel.
- 1278 Akhandala is Indra's name.
- 1279 Abode of Shri.
- 1280 We have translated Kushesha as water.
- 1281 Prishni was a queen who was reborn as Devaki.
- 1282 *Kshetra* is the physical body, *kshetrajna* is one who knows about the *kshetra*, that is, the *atman*.
- 1283 Vrishakapi is Vishnu or Krishna's name. Etymologically, it means someone whose virtue cannot be agitated.
- 1284 *Kala*, *cashtha*, *muhurta*, *kshana* and *lava* are various units for measuring time.
- 1285 Shiva's name, meaning the immovable one.
- 1286 An *angula* is the length of a finger.
- 1287 Here, the word *rita* is being used in the sense of divine law.
- 1288 Vishnu has ten *avatars* (incarnations) and it is tempting to interpret the ten forms as the ten *avatars*. But this alone does not explain the other numbers given. Though it is not very clear, the text probably has allusions to *pancharatra* doctrines. In these, Narayana has five manifestations—*para* (supreme), *vyuha* (there are four manifestations as Vasudeva, Samkarshana, Pradyumna and Aniruddha), *vibhava* (the *avatars*), *archa* (images that are worshipped) and *antarayami* (existing inside). The four parts manifest in the universe are then Vasudeva, Samkarshana, Pradyumna and Aniruddha. The eternal Purusha is the *para* form. The nine parts in heaven and the firmament are the ones other than the *para* form. The two parts on earth are Nara and Narayana, mentioned as fifth in the listing of Vishnu's 24 incarnations. The first four are Adipurusha, Sanatkumara, Varaha and Narada and these might be the four parts that used to be on earth.
- 1289 *Ghee* mixed with coagulated milk.
- 1290 Probably meaning the seven days of the week.
- 1291 Kamala is Lakshmi's name.
- 1292 Rama is Lakshmi's name.
- 1293 Padmaja is Lakshmi's name.
- 1294 A minute particle, sometimes translated as atom.
- 1295 As an image of being temporary and fickle.
- 1296 Here, Vasudeva means Krishna's father, Vasudeva, not Vaasudeva.

- ¹²⁹⁷ Cowherd. *Gopi* is the feminine.
- ¹²⁹⁸ The three categories are probably *dharma*, *artha* and *kama*. The three paths might mean *sattva*, *tamas* and *rajas*, or *jnana yoga*, *karma yoga* and *bhakti yoga*.
- ¹²⁹⁹ Indra's name.
- ¹³⁰⁰ Vishnu's man-lion (*narasimha*) incarnation.
- ¹³⁰¹ Brahma's.
- ¹³⁰² That is, it was in the water.
- ¹³⁰³ The encounter over Tara.
- ¹³⁰⁴ Demon killed by Vishnu.
- ¹³⁰⁵ The gods, the Adityas, are the descendants of Kashyapa and Aditi.
- ¹³⁰⁶ *Garhapatya* is the fire that burns in households. *Anvaharya* has various meanings, the simplest being the monthly sacrificial rites offered to the ancestors on the day of the new moon.
- ¹³⁰⁷ The eastern fire at a sacrifice.
- ¹³⁰⁸ *Kshana* is a measurement of time, with differing interpretations. A second or an instant is accurate enough. *Muhurta* is 48 minutes. *Nimesha* is the twinkling of an eye, a minute. *Kala* is a small measure of time, but that measure is not consistently defined. In terms of astronomy, *kala* is 1/60th of a degree, that is, a minute. A *kaṣṭha* is 1/30th of a *kala*. If used in the context of time, the three different kinds of measurements mean past, present and future. If interpreted independent of time, they can mean length, breadth and height.
- ¹³⁰⁹ Brahma, Vishnu and Shiva.
- ¹³¹⁰ Probably the *Rig Veda*, *Sama Veda* and *Yajur Veda*.
- ¹³¹¹ *Ahavanīya*, *garhapatya* and *dakṣhīṇatya* (the fire that burns in a southern direction).
- ¹³¹² Past, present and future.
- ¹³¹³ This probably means *nitya karma* (daily rites), *naimittika karma* (occasional rites) and *kāmya karma* (rites performed for a specific objective).
- ¹³¹⁴ *Sattva*, *rajas* and *tamas*.
- ¹³¹⁵ The four *Vedas*.
- ¹³¹⁶ *Brahmacharya*, *garhaṣṭhya*, *vanaprastha* and *sannyasa*.
- ¹³¹⁷ The juices are in food.
- ¹³¹⁸ *Kapha* and *pitta*, respectively.

- ¹³¹⁹ *Prana* is the breath of life or the life-force. *Prana* draws breath into the body, *apana* exhales it. *Vyana* distributes it through the body and *samana* assimilates it. *Udana* gives rise to sound.
- ¹³²⁰ On earth.
- ¹³²¹ Brahma.
- ¹³²² Brahma.
- ¹³²³ With some minor differences, this is a repetition of Bhagavad Gita 4.7.
- ¹³²⁴ Parashurama.
- ¹³²⁵ Narayana's.
- ¹³²⁶ As mentioned earlier, this is essentially Bhagavad Gita 4.7, followed by 4.8.
- ¹³²⁷ One part is incarnated on earth.
- ¹³²⁸ Indra.
- ¹³²⁹ Kamsa wanted to kill Devaki and Vasudeva. But Vasudeva promised that he would hand over all his sons to Kamsa. Hence, Kamsa did not kill Devaki and Vasudeva, but imprisoned them and guarded them.
- ¹³³⁰ The first six of Devaki's sons, killed by Kamsa. In an earlier birth, they had been Hiranyakashipu's sons and Hiranyakashipu had cursed them that they would be killed in this way.
- ¹³³¹ Convey the baby from Devaki's womb to Rohini's womb.
- ¹³³² Kamsa.
- ¹³³³ *Samkarshana* means attracting/dragging.
- ¹³³⁴ Bhuti is Prosperity, Sannati is Reverence, Kirti is Fame, Kanti is Beauty, Dhriti is Fortitude, Lajja is Modesty and Pushti is Nourishment. These goddesses are the personified forms of these attributes.
- ¹³³⁵ Literally, mother of the universe.
- ¹³³⁶ The personified form of knowledge.
- ¹³³⁷ The personified form of nectar.
- ¹³³⁸ The goddess has been incarnated in the form of Devaki.
- ¹³³⁹ The image is of dawn, before the sun rises.
- ¹³⁴⁰ The text gives an alternative rendering of this *shloka*. 'Because of what the earth said, the gods have sent Vasava's younger brother. O brave ones! They are tormented by my valour and I am not bothered by this.'
- ¹³⁴¹ Nanda and the *gopas* had come to Mathura to pay their taxes to Kamsa. They lived in Gokula.
- ¹³⁴² Balarama.
- ¹³⁴³ Vraja is the area around Vrindavana.

- ¹³⁴⁴ Literally, the one who holds up the earth.
- ¹³⁴⁵ This can mean grain of any kind. But it is specifically used for threshed and winnowed rice that has not been dehusked.
- ¹³⁴⁶ There are thirteen *samskaras* or sacraments. The list varies a bit. But one list is *vivaha* (marriage), *garbhalambhana* (conception), *pumshavana* (engendering a male child), *simantonnayana* (parting the hair, performed in the fourth month of pregnancy), *jatakarma* (birth rites), *namakarana* (naming), *chudakarma* (tonsure), *annaprashana* (first solid food), *keshanta* (first shaving of the head), *upanayana* (sacred thread), *vidyarambha* (commencement of studies), *samavartana* (graduation) and *antyeshti* (funeral rites). After *samavartana*, one ceases to be a student and becomes (usually) a householder. In this case, one is specifically talking about *namakarana*.
- ¹³⁴⁷ Hence Krishna is Damodara, from *dama* (rope) around the *udara* (stomach).
- ¹³⁴⁸ Vraja was a general area and there were many forests in Vraja. Vrindavana was one of these forests. The *gopas* left the forest they were then in and went to Vrindavana, another forest. Both forests were in Vraja.
- ¹³⁴⁹ *Kakapaksha* (like a crow's wing) is a description of sidelocks of hair on the temples of boys and young men.
- ¹³⁵⁰ A reddish insect, sometimes identified with a firefly. Also known as *indragopa*.
- ¹³⁵¹ That is, he went to the forest without Balarama.
- ¹³⁵² Kalindi is another name for Yamuna.
- ¹³⁵³ The text uses the word *anilashana*, something that feeds on the wind. This means serpent.
- ¹³⁵⁴ Either the three worlds or the three *Vedas*.
- ¹³⁵⁵ Compassion, forgiveness, cleanliness, lack of jealousy, altruism, lack of greed, purity and self-control.
- ¹³⁵⁶ Krishna.
- ¹³⁵⁷ *Bhandira* is the Indian fig tree.
- ¹³⁵⁸ That is, they were yellow and blue. Krishna was attired in yellow and Balarama in blue.
- ¹³⁵⁹ They resembled the rainbow.
- ¹³⁶⁰ Balarama was fair and Krishna was dark.

- ¹³⁶¹ Literally, playing like deer. This is like leapfrog, where one person jumps over another person's back. The defeated child has to carry the victorious child.
- ¹³⁶² This is Pralamba's description.
- ¹³⁶³ *Anvikshiki* is the science of inquiry (the meaning changed over time and varied according to the context), *trayi* stands for the three *Vedas*, *varta* is livelihood and *dandaniti* is punishment and good policy (broadly governance and jurisprudence).
- ¹³⁶⁴ Respectively, a sacrifice to the mountain and a sacrifice to cows.
- ¹³⁶⁵ To the mountain.
- ¹³⁶⁶ Though not explicitly stated, this is presumably Nanda speaking.
- ¹³⁶⁷ This statement makes it clear. In the form of Krishna, he remained with the *gopas*. However, he created a second form that appeared on the summit of the mountain and accepted the offerings. It is this second form that vanished.
- ¹³⁶⁸ These are clouds that appear at the time of universal destruction.
- ¹³⁶⁹ Indra saw Garuda, who remained invisible to others.
- ¹³⁷⁰ The usual etymology of Govinda is someone who knows cows (*go*), or obtains delight from cows.
- ¹³⁷¹ By sprinkling water on the head.

- 1372 At these superhuman exploits.
- 1373 There is abruptness in this. Time has elapsed since the conversation.
- 1374 There is no such known vow. The words *kamala* and *pada* both have several meanings. Perhaps this simply means the vow observed by the one with lotus feet.
- 1375 Therefore, she couldn't leave the house and go to Krishna.
- 1376 Here, the text mentions some additional verses that are not included in the text. These are descriptions of the rasa dance. Since these *shlokas* are not included in the main text, we have not translated them.
- 1377 The text uses the word *kishora*, which means less than fifteen years of age.
- 1378 Krishna's father.
- 1379 Akrura was generous in giving gifts and was known as Danapati.
- 1380 *Mahamatra*, which means superintendent of elephants, trainer and keeper, *mahout*.
- 1381 The word Yadava is used both in a narrow sense and in a broad sense, more often the latter. By using the word Yadava here, Kamsa probably means the ones descended from the Devaka side of the family. Through Devaki, this was Krishna's family. In a broad sense, Kamsa was also a Yadava. But he was descended from Ugrasena, Devaka's brother. Vasudeva (Krishna's father) was descended from Shurasena.
- 1382 Devotee of Krishna's.
- 1383 With the word Madhupriya used for Akrura, one has to speculate about what it means. Madhupriya means someone who loves *madhu*. The word *madhu* has multiple meanings—sweet, honey, liquor, spring. But it probably does mean that Akrura loved to drink. This is the sense in which it is used when the name Madhupriya is used for Balarama.
- 1384 That is, he travelled through the sky.
- 1385 At the time of Daksha's sacrifice, Shiva knocked out Pusha's teeth.
- 1386 And has not been treated.
- 1387 The usual etymology of Keshava is someone with long/handsome hair.
- 1388 Known as Yajnapurusha.
- 1389 These are Akrura's thoughts.
- 1390 The sense seems to be that Vishnu doesn't have to be pleased before granting a boon.
- 1391 This is a reference to the *vamana avatara*, when Bali treated Vishnu like a guest. Though Bali lost the three worlds, he obtained the nether regions

as a boon.

¹³⁹² Krishna's.

¹³⁹³ Instructing them to take care of Akrura.

¹³⁹⁴ Since *krura* means cruel, there is a pun. Akrura means a person who is not cruel.

¹³⁹⁵ Kalindi is another name for Yamuna.

¹³⁹⁶ Balarama was in the form of Ananta and Krishna was lying down on Ananta.

¹³⁹⁷ That is, a rainbow.

¹³⁹⁸ That is, Sananda. As a group, this means Sanaka, Sananda, Sanatana and Sanatkumara.

¹³⁹⁹ They were meditating on Krishna.

¹⁴⁰⁰ Meaning the *jivatman*.

¹⁴⁰¹ *Kubja* means a woman who is hunch-backed, with a crooked back. The word also means a female servant, but here, the first meaning is intended.

¹⁴⁰² One who is crooked in more than one place on the body.

¹⁴⁰³ We have amended the text. The text says *samanya* (which means general) and does not make sense. We have read it as *samanta* (vassal king).

¹⁴⁰⁴ Mushtika.

¹⁴⁰⁵ An aged person should not be killed.

¹⁴⁰⁶ He wanted them to continue to think of him as the son of Devaki and Vasudeva.

¹⁴⁰⁷ Kamsa's mother was Padmavati, but Ugrasena had more than one wife.

¹⁴⁰⁸ Own kingdom because Ugrasena had originally been the king, before Kamsa ousted him.

¹⁴⁰⁹ Yayati had cursed his sons, of whom Yadu was one, that they would not be kings.

¹⁴¹⁰ Otherwise, Krishna could have performed the task himself.

¹⁴¹¹ Ujjain.

¹⁴¹² Krishna's conch-shell, known as Panchajanya.

¹⁴¹³ The child was undergoing hardships in hell. Krishna asked that the son be restored, with a body just like the one before death.

¹⁴¹⁴ The traditional four means are *sama* (conciliation or negotiation), *dana* (bribery), *danda* (punishment) and *bheda* (dissension).

¹⁴¹⁵ Gargya had intercourse with the wife of the king of the Yavanas.

¹⁴¹⁶ Kalayavana did not carry any other weapons.

- ¹⁴¹⁷ Knowing about Muchukunda's boon, Krishna had set a trap for Kalayavana.
- ¹⁴¹⁸ The three kinds of hardship relate to *adhidaivika* (destiny), *adhibhoutika* (nature) and *adhyatmika* (one's own nature).
- ¹⁴¹⁹ *Nivritti* is detachment from fruits and renunciation of action.
- ¹⁴²⁰ Yama.
- ¹⁴²¹ Varuni is the goddess of liquor.
- ¹⁴²² Of the Yamuna.
- ¹⁴²³ Kundina was the capital of Vidarbha, identified with Kaundinyapura in Amravati division.
- ¹⁴²⁴ That is, Shishupala.
- ¹⁴²⁵ There were eight forms of marriage—*brahma*, *daiva*, *arsha*, *prajapatya*, *asura*, *gandharva*, *rakshasa* and *paishacha*. In the *rakshasa* form, the groom defeats the bride's kin, abducts her and marries her.
- ¹⁴²⁶ The same as Shambara.
- ¹⁴²⁷ There is an allusion to Manmatha having been burnt down by Shiva.
- ¹⁴²⁸ The word *maya* should be interpreted as power, with a hierarchy or layer in these. The first seven powers/layers were known to Shambara and were taught by Mayavati to Pradyumna. When Shambara used these against Pradyumna, he could counter them. The eighth or higher form of *maya* was Vaishnavi *maya*, known to Pradyumna, but not to Shambara.
- ¹⁴²⁹ They descended because they travelled through the sky and arrived in the inner quarters.
- ¹⁴³⁰ Krishna.
- ¹⁴³¹ Manmatha's wife, Rati.
- ¹⁴³² Therefore, also known as Nagnajiti.
- ¹⁴³³ The story will be told in Chapters 96 and 97. Aniruddha was captured by Bana. Aniruddha means someone who cannot be stopped or captured. Thus, the text has a pun with the word captured. Rukmi was Rukmini's brother. Aniruddha was the son of Pradyumna, the son of Krishna and Rukmini. Pradyumna's wife was Mayavati, Rukmi's daughter. Thus, Aniruddha was Rukmi's daughter's son. Aniruddha was married to Usha, Bana's daughter. But he was also married to Rochana, Rukmi's granddaughter.
- ¹⁴³⁴ Rukmi had pledged that he would not enter Kundina without killing Krishna, but was instead defeated by Krishna. Therefore, instead of Kundina, he started to live in Bhojakata.

- ¹⁴³⁵ A *nishka* is a coin made out of gold.
- ¹⁴³⁶ *Ashtapada* is the board used for playing with dice. It has eight (*ashta*) squares along each side.
- ¹⁴³⁷ Whether he approved of the action or disapproved, he would have offended one or the other.
- ¹⁴³⁸ The earth is Bhumi. Therefore, Naraka is known as Bhouma.
- ¹⁴³⁹ That is, Aditi.
- ¹⁴⁴⁰ Mura is an *asura*. Hence, Krishna is Murari, Mura's enemy (*ari*).
- ¹⁴⁴¹ Hayagriva and Panchajana do not belong here. Panchajana has already been killed by Krishna and Hayagriva was killed by Vishnu. But it is true that these two have already been killed.
- ¹⁴⁴² Referring to the primary creation and the secondary cycles of creation.
- ¹⁴⁴³ That is, Satyabhama. There is a pun on the word *satya* (true).
- ¹⁴⁴⁴ These also arose as a result of the churning of the ocean.
- ¹⁴⁴⁵ Garuda.
- ¹⁴⁴⁶ Varuna.
- ¹⁴⁴⁷ Kubera.
- ¹⁴⁴⁸ He was in the air, astride Garuda.
- ¹⁴⁴⁹ Assuming that many simultaneous forms.
- ¹⁴⁵⁰ Since Mitravinda was descended from King Shibi, she is also known as Shaibya.
- ¹⁴⁵¹ Madri means Rohini, the daughter of the king of Madra.
- ¹⁴⁵² The text is such that the number can be inferred in different ways. Krishna had eight main wives and 16,100 minor ones. With each wife, he had ten sons and one daughter. That is the standard account. Therefore, there were eighty main sons, through the eight main wives. Collectively, there were 161,080 sons. In any event, the text varies from the standard account.
- ¹⁴⁵³ Usha didn't speak. Parvati knew her thoughts.
- ¹⁴⁵⁴ Chitrlekha.
- ¹⁴⁵⁵ A weapon named after serpents (*pannaga*).
- ¹⁴⁵⁶ Shiva's fever, fever caused by Shiva.
- ¹⁴⁵⁷ Vishnu's fever, fever caused by Vishnu.
- ¹⁴⁵⁸ Maheshvara *jvara*.
- ¹⁴⁵⁹ The five fires (*agnis*) were fighting on Shiva's side. Depending on the context, there are different names for these five sacred fires.
- ¹⁴⁶⁰ A weapon that causes yawning.

- ¹⁴⁶¹ Kartikeya's.
- ¹⁴⁶² Pradyumna.
- ¹⁴⁶³ That is, Nandi.
- ¹⁴⁶⁴ Kotari, or Kotavi, is one of Durga's names, in her naked form. The word means a naked woman.
- ¹⁴⁶⁵ Uma's consort, Shiva, who destroyed the city of Tripura.
- ¹⁴⁶⁶ King Poundraka, who pretended to be Vasudeva/Krishna, called himself Vasudeva and sported all of Vasudeva's signs and symbols.
- ¹⁴⁶⁷ Poundraka was not the king of Kashi. He was the king of Vanga and Pundra, in what is West Bengal and Bangladesh now. His capital, Mahasthangarh, is in the village of Mahasthan in Bogra district of Bangladesh. At the time of this incident, he was visiting his friend, the king of Kashi.
- ¹⁴⁶⁸ All these were imitations.
- ¹⁴⁶⁹ The son of the king of Kashi.
- ¹⁴⁷⁰ Avimukta is another name for Varanasi.
- ¹⁴⁷¹ Kritya is a feminine deity to whom sacrifices are offered for destructive purposes.
- ¹⁴⁷² Gajasahvya is another name for Hastinapura, as is Nagasahvya. All these expressions mean 'the city of the elephant'.
- ¹⁴⁷³ There have been hundreds of ordinary kings earlier. Therefore, the throne is like a leftover. However, Ugrasena has the Parijata tree in his garden and even the wives of his servants can use those flowers.
- ¹⁴⁷⁴ Kouravas means descendants of the Kurus. Hence, both terms have been used, though they are really synonymous.
- ¹⁴⁷⁵ Balarama's standard had a palm tree.
- ¹⁴⁷⁶ Etymologically, *vanara* means similar to man (*nara*). The word is translated as monkey/ape. But we have decided to leave it as *vanara* here.
- ¹⁴⁷⁷ The word used here is *kapi*.
- ¹⁴⁷⁸ Dvividā.

- 1479 Arjuna.
- 1480 *Jara* means old age.
- 1481 Portions of the gods had also incarnated themselves on earth.
- 1482 As a descendant of Kuru, Arjuna was also Kourava.
- 1483 Aniruddha's son.
- 1484 That is, he honoured their curses.
- 1485 Meaning a deer's ear.
- 1486 The *jivatman* with the *paramatman*.
- 1487 Only the eight main ones had immolated themselves.
- 1488 The land of the five (*pancha*) rivers (*nada*), Punjab. The five rivers are Shatadru, Vipasha, Iravati, Chandrabhaga and Vitasta.
- 1489 *Abhiras* are cowherds. But here, they are being equated with bandits (*dasyus*) and later, with *mlecchas*.
- 1490 At the time of the burning of the Khandava forest.
- 1491 Parikshit was the king in Hastinapura.
- 1492 Vyasa. Vyasa is repeating the account to the sages. Therefore, when describing his conversation with Arjuna, he refers to himself in the third person.
- 1493 There are injunctions on water that can be used for bathing. It should not be from a pot and it should not be water in which there are parings of clipped nails.
- 1494 Karna.
- 1495 The word used is *tata*.
- 1496 Gangeya is Ganga's son, Bhishma.
- 1497 Ashtavakra was born crooked (*vakra*) in eight (*ashta*) parts of his body.
- 1498 Here, Partha means Yudhishtira. The text has the word Partha in the singular. It should be in the dual, so as to include Bhima too.
- 1499 That is, one thousand *mahayugas*.
- 1500 Derived from *pushkara* (lotus).
- 1501 In a footnote, the text mentions some additional *shlokas* here. Since these aren't included in the text, we haven't translated them. These *shlokas* describe the *varaha*'s form. The *Vedas* (*shruti*) were his face (*mukha*), explaining the name *shrutimukha*.
- 1502 Nrisimha is the same as Narasimha.
- 1503 Repeated. There may have been two of the same name.
- 1504 Repeated.
- 1505 Repeated.

- ¹⁵⁰⁶ A *shataghni* was a weapon that could kill one hundred in one blow. It could have been a type of catapult.
- ¹⁵⁰⁷ Vamana increased in size.
- ¹⁵⁰⁸ Kartavirya Arjuna.
- ¹⁵⁰⁹ Parashurama.
- ¹⁵¹⁰ Rama.
- ¹⁵¹¹ Rama, Lakshmana, Bharata and Shatrughna.
- ¹⁵¹² A part of the forest of Dandakaranya.
- ¹⁵¹³ Pulastya's descendant, Ravana.
- ¹⁵¹⁴ Lavana was killed by Shatrughna, in the area around Mathura.
- ¹⁵¹⁵ The young didn't die before the old.
- ¹⁵¹⁶ That is, *brahmanas*.
- ¹⁵¹⁷ Sounds heard at donations in sacrifices.
- ¹⁵¹⁸ The text does not clearly indicate where the chant ends. We have arbitrarily ended it here.
- ¹⁵¹⁹ This is a description of the path.
- ¹⁵²⁰ Death can happen at any time and at any place.
- ¹⁵²¹ The sheaths are usually numbered as five. The five that sheaths cover the *atman* are *annamaya* (related to food), *pranamaya* (related to energy), *manomaya* (related to the mind), *vijnanamaya* (related to knowledge) and *anandamaya* (related to bliss). However, there are seven chakras in the body. In ascending order along the spinal column, the seven *chakras* are *muladhara*, *svadhishtana*, *manipura*, *anahata*, *vishuddhi*, *ajna* and *sahasrara*. The number six might refer to the first six *chakras*.
- ¹⁵²² Ghost or goblin.
- ¹⁵²³ Presumably of animals.
- ¹⁵²⁴ The same as *indragopa*.
- ¹⁵²⁵ A *preta* is a ghost, the spirit of a dead person, or simply something evil. A *bhuta* has the same meaning. Strictly speaking, there are differences between *preta*, *bhuta* and *pishacha* (one who lives on flesh). A *preta* is the spirit (not necessarily evil) of a dead person before the funeral rites have been performed. A *bhuta* (not necessarily evil again) is the spirit of a dead person who has had a violent death and for whom, proper funeral rites have not been performed, and may not even be performed. A *pishacha* (necessarily evil) is often created deliberately through evil powers.
- ¹⁵²⁶ Female demon.

- 1527 The word *bhokshya* is being used in the sense of *charvya*.
1528 *Naraka* is a generic term for hell.
1529 Death.
1530 Destroyer.
1531 Mahamari is Epidemic, Kalaratri is Terrible Night.
1532 The number, listing and names of *narakas* varies from one text to another.
1533 Literally, great waves.
1534 Literally, where one is cooked in pots.
1535 Literally, the dreadful one. More specifically, a place where sinners are devoured by animals known as *ruru*.
1536 Just as sugar cane is crushed to extract juice.
1537 Literally, shaped like a box.
1538 Literally, lacking in stability.
1539 Literally, full of flaming lac.
1540 Literally, extremely resplendent.
1541 Literally, the one which conquers.
1542 Named after the silk cotton tree, which is full of thorns.
1543 That is, for the duration of fourteen *manvantaras*.
1544 The great Rourava.
1545 Literally, darkness.
1546 The great Tamisra.
1547 Where there are trees with leaves that are like swords.
1548 Full of mud and sand.
1549 The name has no obvious meaning, but may mean a place full of boars and ravens.
1550 Full of foul filth.
1551 The five sacrifices meant for householders.
1552 Literally, extremely terrible.
1553 Literally, the giant noose.
1554 Literally, where one is cooked like sesamum seeds.
1555 Where one is cooked in oil.
1556 With doors that are like the *vajra*.
1557 Without any breathing.
1558 Collection of coal.
1559 The great excrement. Etymologically, the meaning doesn't follow immediately, so this meaning is subjective.

- 1560 Literally, the great blaze.
1561 Literally, saw.
1562 Where one is cooked in molasses.
1563 As sharp as a razor.
1564 Literally, a frying pan.
1565 With axes that are *vajras*.
1566 That is, the branches.
1567 Literally, lamentation.
1568 Alternatively, steals liquor.
1569 Literally, string/thread of destiny.
1570 Foul/dirty.
1571 With a foul stench.
1572 Impossible to tolerate.
1573 Where *vajras* cause great suffering.
1574 Made of iron.
1575 Literally, ‘stay here’.
1576 Full of torments.
1577 We have corrected a typo in the text, which says *kruddha* (angry) instead of *vridhdha* (aged).
1578 Dreadful.
1579 Literally, smearing or ointment.
1580 Giant *preta*.
1581 Extremely terrible.
1582 The silk cotton tree, full of thorns.
1583 That is, obstruct the practice of *dharma*.
1584 We have translated *kakaraka* as a pot for washing the head.
1585 They have not practiced *dharma* in their former lives.
1586 Shishupala.
1587 Past *karma*.
1588 After death.
1589 A *brahmana* who is born as a *rakshasa*.
1590 *Jivajivaka*.
1591 While this means shudra, it also means outcast.
1592 The text says *kumbholuka*. While *uluka* is an owl, it is not obvious what *kumbholuka* means. We have taken this as *kumbhilaka*, or thief.
1593 Such as a cockroach.
1594 One-sixth is given to the king.

- 1595 He gives the food away even if he has to starve.
- 1596 It has to be earned by one's own self.
- 1597 Uttering a *mantra* for *prana*, the breath of life—*pranaya svaha*.
- 1598 The river Koka must have been near the Kokamukha *tirtha* in the Himalayas. Both the river and the *tirtha* were probably in Nepal.
- 1599 The one who holds the hare (*shasha*), a name for the moon. Shashanka is a variant.
- 1600 *Sarit* means river, derived as something that creeps and glides along.
- 1601 This seems to be the name of a mountain.
- 1602 There is a place known as Lohargala in Rajasthan, but this cannot be the same Lohargala.
- 1603 *Akshata* is grain that has not been dehusked.
- 1604 The part of the hand that is between the forefinger and the thumb is known as *pitri tirtha*. Anything offered to the ancestors is placed there.
- 1605 The text states *pitrivipranamayantu*, let the ancestors and *brahmanas* come. These are *shraddha mantras*, given in detail in Garuda Purana.
- 1606 The left is the inauspicious side. *Apahata* means warding off. This *mantra* wards off demons and anything inauspicious.
- 1607 Known as *apyayantu* etc.
- 1608 We have translated the *mantra* loosely.
- 1609 *Shukla Yajur Veda* 19.45 and the succeeding *shlokas*—*ye samanah samanaso jiva jiveshu mamakah . . .*
- 1610 The three generations.
- 1611 Sweet, sour, salty, bitter, pungent and astringent.
- 1612 *Madhu vata ritayate madhun ksharanti sindhavah madhvirnah santvoshadhih*. From *Rig Veda*, 1.90.6. Loosely, 'May the wind blow sweetly. May the rivers flow sweetly. May the herbs be sweet for us.'
- 1613 With the reference to *Brihadaranyaka Upanishad* that follows, this probably means *Brihadaranyaka Upanishad* 5.15.1. This doesn't begin with *yatte*, but begins with *hiranmayena patrena*. However, it does have the word *yatte* in the *mantra*. *Yatte* is too general to identify a *mantra* otherwise.
- 1614 *Trimadhu* means *madhu vata ritayate* etc. mentioned earlier. *Trisuparna* is usually interpreted as *Rig Veda* 10.114.3–5, though sometimes also as part of *Krishna Yajur Veda*. *Rig Veda* 10.114.3–5 is a hymn to the Vishvadevas and has three verses on the two birds (*suparna*), *paramatman* and *jivatman*. *Sourya sukta* or *surya sukta* means *Rig Veda*

1.115.1–6. *Purusha sukta*, also found in *Shukla Yajur Veda* and *Atharva Veda*, is hymn 10.90 of *Rig Veda*.

¹⁶¹⁵ The sun's shadow. *Shraddha* ceremonies are typically performed after mid-day, when the sun's shadow falls on one's feet, as one is seated.

¹⁶¹⁶ *Lepa* means wiping, in this case, the wiping of the hand after *pindas* have been offered. The right to *pinda* stops with the third ancestor in the lineage, the fourth is no longer entitled. Therefore, it stops with the great grandfather.

¹⁶¹⁷ This probably means *Shukla Yajur Veda* 19.45, mentioned earlier. Since *janme* means 'that which is for me', this may also simply mean the prayer that follows.

¹⁶¹⁸ A place where there are crores of *tirthas*.

¹⁶¹⁹ Meaning the moon.

¹⁶²⁰ The text says the lords of the universe, that is, Vishvadevas.

¹⁶²¹ On the day of *amavasya*.

¹⁶²² *Riskhagochara*, meaning transit (*gochara*) of a *nakshatra* (*riksha*), has an astronomical interpretation. The most obvious interpretation is when the transit of the *nakshatras* is auspicious.

¹⁶²³ *Nitya shraddha* is the one that is regularly performed on *amavasya* and days of the eclipse. The Vishvadevas are not invoked for this. *Naimittika* is the annual *shraddha*, performed on the death anniversary, or sacred days that one chooses. *Kamya shraddha* is done for a specific purpose/desire. *Vridhhi shraddha* is performed on special occasions like birth or marriage.

¹⁶²⁴ Virgo.

¹⁶²⁵ The first day of the lunar fortnight. The other days follow in sequence, second and so on.

¹⁶²⁶ *Havishya* is food that can be offered as oblations. It is simple and has no seasoning. It is only eaten on special occasions, such as when a vow is being observed.

¹⁶²⁷ Black antelope.

¹⁶²⁸ Kind of ox.

¹⁶²⁹ We have translated *kalashaka* as this (*corchorus capsularis*), though it might mean something else.

¹⁶³⁰ The ancestors are wishing this.

¹⁶³¹ A girl who is eight years old.

- ¹⁶³² There is no *nakshatra* named Soumya. This is a reference to Mrigashira, which used to be known earlier as Soma.
- ¹⁶³³ This means Uttara Phalguni. The earlier reference was to Purva Phalguni.
- ¹⁶³⁴ The fame is more in Uttara Ashadha than in Purva Ashadha.
- ¹⁶³⁵ Shatabhisha, Varuna being the older name.
- ¹⁶³⁶ Uttara Proshthapada (Bhadrapada), the earlier reference being to Purva Proshthapada (Bhadrapada).
- ¹⁶³⁷ A *shraddha* ceremony specific to ancestors known as Nandimukhas.
- ¹⁶³⁸ Since this in the context of Kanya, Uttara should mean Uttara Phalguni, which straddles Simha and Kanya.
- ¹⁶³⁹ Yama.
- ¹⁶⁴⁰ Scorpio.
- ¹⁶⁴¹ The ancestors temporarily leave, expecting the *shraddha*. When the *shraddha* is not performed, they are unhappy and curse their progeny.
- ¹⁶⁴² *Ashtaka* is the eighth lunar day, but during *krishna paksha*. *Ashtaka shraddhas* are typically performed during the months of Margashirsha (also known as Agrahayana), Pousha, Magha and Phalguna. Margashirsha is roughly mid-November to mid-December, while Pousha is mid-December to mid-January. Magha is mid-January to mid-February and Phalguna is mid-February to mid-March. *Anvashtaka shraddhas* are performed on the ninth lunar day in those three months, during *krishna paksha*.
- ¹⁶⁴³ That performed on a special occasion.
- ¹⁶⁴⁴ No other *brahmanas* are required for the purpose.
- ¹⁶⁴⁵ A monthly rite continued for one year.
- ¹⁶⁴⁶ One for the gods and one for the ancestors.
- ¹⁶⁴⁷ *Asthi*, the bones and ashes left after cremation.
- ¹⁶⁴⁸ This is described in the next chapter.
- ¹⁶⁴⁹ The person who has died and has not yet become an ancestor.
- ¹⁶⁵⁰ There is a long list of those who are *sapindas*, such as, in the absence of a son, a daughter, a daughter's son, a father, a mother, a brother, a brother's son and so on.
- ¹⁶⁵¹ There is another such list of *sahodakas*. The text says *sahodara*, brother. This is a typo and we have corrected it.
- ¹⁶⁵² The grandfathers.
- ¹⁶⁵³ Thus, if no one else is available, the king can do it himself.

- ¹⁶⁵⁴ *Darsha* is the night of the new moon. But this also signifies that the moon will now wax. Permanence is *nitya*. There are elements of both the temporary and the permanent.
- ¹⁶⁵⁵ *Lepa* means wiping, in this case, the wiping of the hand after *pindas* have been offered. The right to *pinda* stops with the third person in the lineage, the fourth is no longer entitled.
- ¹⁶⁵⁶ Feeding on *lepa*.
- ¹⁶⁵⁷ *Pinda* for three generations, *lepa* for three and *anulepa* beyond.
- ¹⁶⁵⁸ Impure as in *ucchishta*.
- ¹⁶⁵⁹ *Trinachiketa* is a part of the *Yajur Veda*.
- ¹⁶⁶⁰ The three verses in *Rig Veda* I.90.6-8.
- ¹⁶⁶¹ The *Taittiriya Aranyaka*.
- ¹⁶⁶² Both the *acharya* and the *upadhyaya* are teachers, but there is a hierarchy. An *upadhyaya* is just a teacher, whereas an *acharya* is a *guru*. The family priest is *purohita*.
- ¹⁶⁶³ We have translated *dronapathaka* in this way.
- ¹⁶⁶⁴ *Kalashaka*.
- ¹⁶⁶⁵ While this means shudra, it also means outcast.
- ¹⁶⁶⁶ This is repeated.
- ¹⁶⁶⁷ Of the neglected *brahmana*.
- ¹⁶⁶⁸ By the *brahmanas*.
- ¹⁶⁶⁹ These two sentences are difficult to understand and may refer to the type of loom.
- ¹⁶⁷⁰ Some kind of unidentified grain.
- ¹⁶⁷¹ This cannot be the creeper. So it probably means saffron.
- ¹⁶⁷² A kind of rice with small grains.
- ¹⁶⁷³ Probably meaning betel nut.
- ¹⁶⁷⁴ Milk. This does not belong in a list of fruit. It might, therefore, mean the fruit of the *ashvattha* tree.
- ¹⁶⁷⁵ A coarse fruit, difficult to identify.
- ¹⁶⁷⁶ Fruit of the *kutaja* tree.
- ¹⁶⁷⁷ The Indian fig.
- ¹⁶⁷⁸ This must be a typo and should be *patala*, that is, fruit of the trumpet flower tree.
- ¹⁶⁷⁹ A vine.
- ¹⁶⁸⁰ Jujube.
- ¹⁶⁸¹ A kind of tree.

- 1682 *Murmura*.
- 1683 The name of a tree.
- 1684 Holy basil.
- 1685 A tree with beautiful flowers.
- 1686 With one hundred petals, a lotus.
- 1687 Kind of plant.
- 1688 Unidentified.
- 1689 These are different types of lotuses. *Kamala* is a lotus that blooms during the day, *kumuda* is a lotus that blooms during the night, *padma* is a lotus, *indivara* is a blue lotus, *kokanada* is a red lotus and *kahlara* is a white lotus.
- 1690 *Nardostachys jatamansi*, spikenard.
- 1691 Kind of perfume.
- 1692 Probably a fragrance derived from the silk cotton tree.
- 1693 Nutmeg.
- 1694 A fragrant root.
- 1695 A fragrant tree.
- 1696 A kind of tree.
- 1697 Fragrance derived from a lotus.
- 1698 *Rajamasha* is a kind of bean (*rajma*), *chanaka* is a variety of chickpea, *masura* (*mashura*) is *masoor dal*, *koradushaka* (also known as *kodrava*) is a kind of inferior grain, *viprusha* probably means grain that is marked in some way and *markata* is a kind of grain.
- 1699 *Varuna* is *crateva nurvula*, *kakola* is *cocculus Indicus* and *bahupatra* is onion.
- 1700 A yellow pigment.
- 1701 Several plants are known by the name of *kumari*.
- 1702 A medicinal herb.
- 1703 This cannot be identified.
- 1704 This cannot be identified.
- 1705 *Anethum sowa* or dill.
- 1706 This cannot be identified.
- 1707 This cannot be identified.
- 1708 *Manaskandha* and *vishaskandha* are different varieties of *colocasia esculenta*.
- 1709 *Ipomoea batatas*.
- 1710 This cannot be identified.

- 1711 This cannot be identified.
- 1712 This cannot be identified.
- 1713 *Capparis trifoliata*, or anything with bitter leaves.
- 1714 Literally, the three bitter objects—a mixture of ginger, black pepper and long pepper.
- 1715 Probably meaning myrobalan.
- 1716 This doesn't quite fit. So it is possible *balaka* has some other meaning.
- 1717 A kind of pot-herb.
- 1718 This might mean food that is frothy, but probably means opium.
- 1719 *Andrographis paniculate*.
- 1720 A large species of *nimba*, known usually as *gandharaja*.
- 1721 A long gourd.
- 1722 Citron.
- 1723 Long pepper.
- 1724 Type of orange.
- 1725 Ginger.
- 1726 Tamarind.
- 1727 A medicinal plant.
- 1728 Probably meaning the gum of the silk-cotton tree.
- 1729 This contradicts what is said later. But the word *shiva* can mean nothing other than jackal. Perhaps there was some differentiation within jackals.
- 1730 *Vartika* and *lavaka* are two different kinds of quail, *rajiva* is a kind of deer. *Rajiva* is also a kind of fish. But since this sentence is about flesh of animals, we have interpreted it as deer.
- 1731 A kind of carp, commonly known as *rohu*.
- 1732 This probably means a donkey, though this identification is speculative.
- 1733 Sky-lark.
- 1734 A kind of bird.
- 1735 A kind of jackal.
- 1736 A kind of bird.
- 1737 Jackal.
- 1738 Safflower.
- 1739 This has multiple meanings, but probably means oilcakes.
- 1740 Turnip, also a variety of garlic.
- 1741 Hemp.
- 1742 A kind of shrub.
- 1743 Tamarind.

¹⁷⁴⁴ A shell with two valves.

¹⁷⁴⁵ This probably means the drug known as *padmaka*.

¹⁷⁴⁶ A kind of pulse.

¹⁷⁴⁷ A bottle gourd.

¹⁷⁴⁸ This probably means toddy.

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Acknowledgements

The corpus of the Puranas is huge—in scope, coverage and size. The Mahabharata is believed to contain 100,000 *shlokas*. The Critical Edition of the Mahabharata, edited and published by the Bhandarkar Oriental Research Institute (Pune), doesn't contain quite that many. But no matter, this gives us some idea of the size. To comprehend what 100,000 shlokas mean in a standard word count, the ten-volume unabridged translation I did of the Mahabharata amounts to a staggering 2.5 million words. After composing the Mahabharata, Krishna Dvaipayana Vedavyasa composed the eighteen *mahapuranas*, or major Puranas. So the belief goes. Collectively, these eighteen Puranas amount to 400,000 *shlokas*, translating into a disconcerting and daunting number of 10 million words.

After translating the Bhagavadgita, the Mahabharata, the Harivamsha (160,000 words) and the Valmiki Ramayana (500,000 words), it was but natural to turn one's attention towards translating the Puranas. (All these translations have been, and will be, published by Penguin India.) As the most popular and most read Purana, the Bhagavata Purana chose itself as the first to be translated (3 volumes, 500,000 words). The Markandeya Purana, another popular Purana (1 volume, 175,000 words) came next. That these translations were well-received was encouragement along the intimidating journey of translating the remaining Puranas and I am indebted to the reviewers of these various translations, including those of the Bhagavata Purana and the Markandeya Purana.

Which Purana should one choose next to translate? This journey of translation has been marked by several coincidences. While still in the process of choosing, I happened to visit Pushkara for the first time in my life. Temples to Brahma are rare. Among Brahma's temples, the most

important is the one in Pushkara. As I gazed at Brahma's image, at his *kamandalu* and *akshamala*, the decision made itself. It had to be the Brahma Purana. The eighteen Maha-Puranas, as the introduction explains, are sometimes individually identified with Brahma, Vishnu and Shiva. The Bhagavata Purana is a Purana identified with Vishnu. The Markandeya Purana, though identified with Brahma, is partly about Devi, and hence, by extrapolation, identified with Shiva. One should accordingly choose Brahma Purana, often described as the first Purana, though the present text is clearly not the original Brahma Purana. Average familiarity with the Brahma Purana might not be as great as with the Bhagavata Purana or the Markandeya Purana, but there was no denying the Brahma Purana's importance. Hence, this translation in two volumes, running into 390,000 words. The coincidence did not end there. I had completed the actual translation and was going to start on the Introduction. In between, I happened to visit Rajamahendravaram (Rajamahendrapuram or Rajahmundry if you prefer) for the first time in my life. From Pushkara Ghat, I looked on at the wide expanse of the Godavari and watched the *arati* to Goutami. I visited the Koti Lingeshvara temple. The places described in the Goutami *mahatmya* section seemed to come alive, from Tryambakeshvara to Antaravedi, from the Sahya range to the confluence with the ocean.

The journey of translation hasn't been an intimidating one only for me. Penguin India must also have thought about it several times, before going ahead with the Purana translations. Most people have some idea about the Ramayana and the Mahabharata. But the Puranas are typically rendered in such dumbed-down versions that the market has to be created. However, Penguin India also believed in the Purana Project, which still stretches into some interminable horizon in the future, almost two decades down the line. For both author and publisher, this is a long-term commitment. But Bhagavata Purana, Markandeya Purana and Brahma Purana have been done. With the publication schedule inevitably disrupted because of the Covid pandemic, Vishnu Purana comes next, followed by Shiva Purana. I am indebted to Penguin India. In particular, Meru Gokhale, Ambar Sahil

Chatterjee, Tarini Uppal and Rea Mukherjee have been exceptionally patient, persevering and encouraging. But for them, the Purana Project might not have taken off. I also thank the copy editors. These Purana translations have been brought alive by the wonderful cover designs and illustrations and I thank the illustrators and the designers.

Ever since this translation journey started in 2006, my wife, Suparna Banerjee Debroy, has been a constant source of support, ensuring the conducive and propitious environment for the work to continue unimpeded. Part II has a dialogue between Agni and Atreyi. Agni tells Atreyi, ‘At first, you were a *patni*. Then, for sustaining, you became a *bharya*. To give birth, you became *jaya*. Through your own qualities, you became *kalatra*.’ The vocabulary of Sanskrit is immensely rich. There are multiple synonyms for every word, each with a slightly different nuance. This is also true of the word ‘wife’—*patni*, *bharya*, *jaya* and *kalatra* are instances. Suparna has been all these and more. In every Purana text, I have been struck by the importance given to a wife, in her different roles and in the case of the Bhagavata Purana and the Markandeya Purana, I have quoted verses. The Brahma Purana is no different.

1.121.25 ‘Men desire wives for every kind of happiness. A wife is the source of happiness. Therefore, act in that way.’

2.10.30-31. ‘She is the mother of my *dharma*. She is the mistress of my body. She is always my aide in the pursuit of *dharma*, *artha*, *kama* and *moksha*. When I am content, she laughs. When I am angry, she wipes away my misery.’ One should note that this is said by a male pigeon about his wife.

2.59.60 ‘In every task undertaken by a man, the wife is an aide. Without her, there is no success in even the slightest of tasks.’ The translation work is not a slight task and without her as an aide and support, it wouldn’t have happened.

The Brahma Purana is rich in geography and it brought alive for me the region in, and around Odisha, a state I am especially fond of. Shaifalika Panda and Subhrakant Panda have told us stories about Odisha and have

also invited us there. This is an opportunity to tell our dear friends some stories about Odisha, by dedicating this book to a warm and generous couple.

Bibek Debroy
August 2021

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This digital edition published in 2021.

e-ISBN: 9789391149734

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